Fast Media Sorter Documentation

Step-by-step guides for every feature

https://serzhyale.github.io/FastMediaSorter_mob_v2/documentation/

Built 2026-10-14

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Getting Started

GETTING STARTED | All editions | RECIPE #01

All editions - which pages appear depends on the edition

First Launch and Setup Wizard

The welcome wizard runs once, the first time you open FastMediaSorter, and walks you through language, theme, device profile, network and cloud sources, capabilities, permissions and your default player - or you can skip straight to the end with the **Enable all** button on its first page. Every choice it makes lives in Settings afterward, so nothing here is a one-way door.

Why You'll Love This

Everyone meets FastMediaSorter for the first time exactly once, and that first minute quietly decides a few things: which language you read it in, whether it can see your network drives, and whether Android starts opening your photos and videos in it from now on. The welcome wizard exists so you make those calls on purpose, in a couple of minutes, instead of finding them out by accident later.

Nothing on these pages is final. Every choice you make here can be changed afterward in Settings, so there is no wrong tap - and if you would rather not answer a wizard's worth of questions at all, one button near the top does almost all of it for you.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

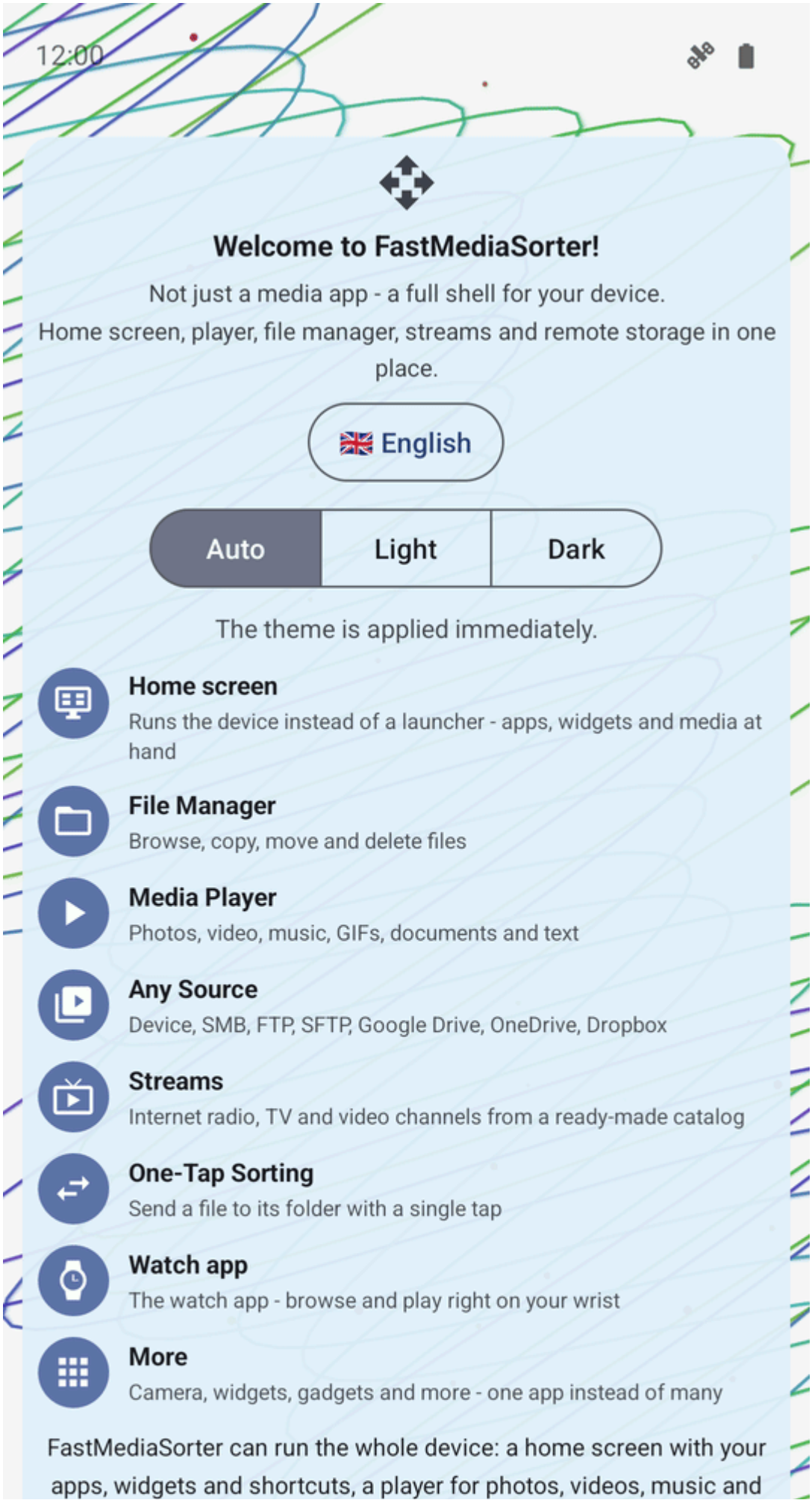
- FastMediaSorter freshly installed, in any edition - which wizard pages you see depends on which one you have.
- A few minutes, and if you plan to add network or cloud folders, their addresses or sign-in details close at hand.
- An internet connection if you turn on OCR or translation on the functionality page - both download a small engine the moment you switch them on.

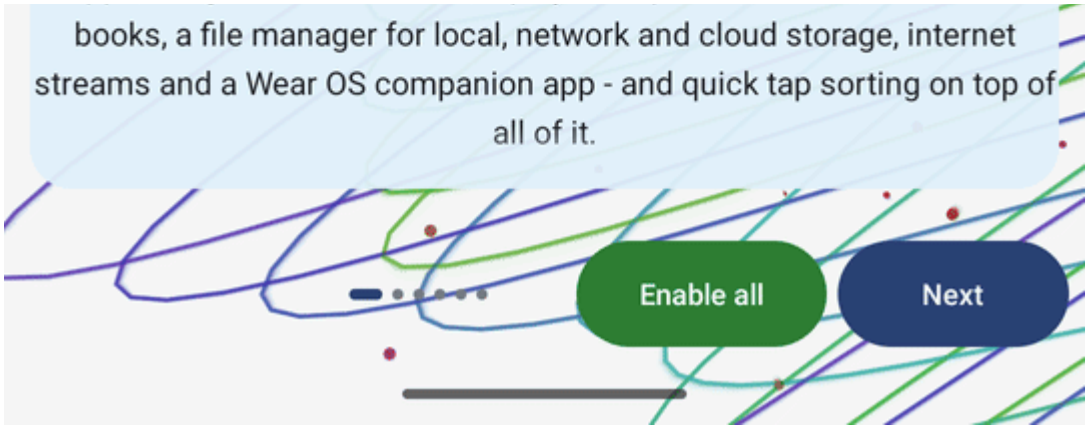
1 Page 1: meet the app, in your language and your look

The wizard opens the moment you launch FastMediaSorter for the first time and stays open until you finish it or tap **Enable all**. A row of dots above the bottom buttons shows how many pages there are and where you are; **Previous** and **Next** move between them, and **Finish** takes the place of **Next** on the last page. Every page answers to a fingertip just as well as to a keyboard, a D-pad or a mouse wheel, so a TV box or a car head unit with no touchscreen sets up the app exactly the same way a phone does.

The first page introduces FastMediaSorter as a short list of roles rather than a list of features: **File Manager** ("Browse, copy, move and delete files"), a player card titled **Media Player** or, on an edition without video and audio, **Photo Viewer**, **Any Source**, **One-Tap Sorting**, and a catch-all **More** card. A build that ships the home-screen launcher leads with a **Home screen** card instead, and one that ships internet Streams or the watch app gets its own card for each of those too, rather than folding them into **More**. Every card's second line names only the media types, protocols and services your particular edition can actually open, so nothing pitched here is missing once you look for it.

Two more controls share this page: a language button that names your current language and opens a searchable list when tapped, and an **Auto / Light / Dark** theme picker. Both take effect immediately, so you see the result before you decide anything else.


12:00
Welcome to FastMediaSorter!
Not just a media app - a full shell for your device.
Home screen, player, file manager, streams and remote storage in one place.
English
Auto
Light
Dark
The theme is applied immediately.
Home screen
Runs the device instead of a launcher - apps, widgets and media at hand
File Manager
Browse, copy, move and delete files
Media Player
Photos, video, music, GIFs, documents and text
Any Source
Device, SMB, FTP, SFTP, Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox
Streams
Internet radio, TV and video channels from a ready-made catalog
One-Tap Sorting
Send a file to its folder with a single tap
Watch app
The watch app - browse and play right on your wrist
More
Camera, widgets, gadgets and more - one app instead of many
FastMediaSorter can run the whole device: a home screen with your apps, widgets and shortcuts, a player for photos, videos, music and



The first wizard page: your role pitch, language and theme.

Said no to the home screen?

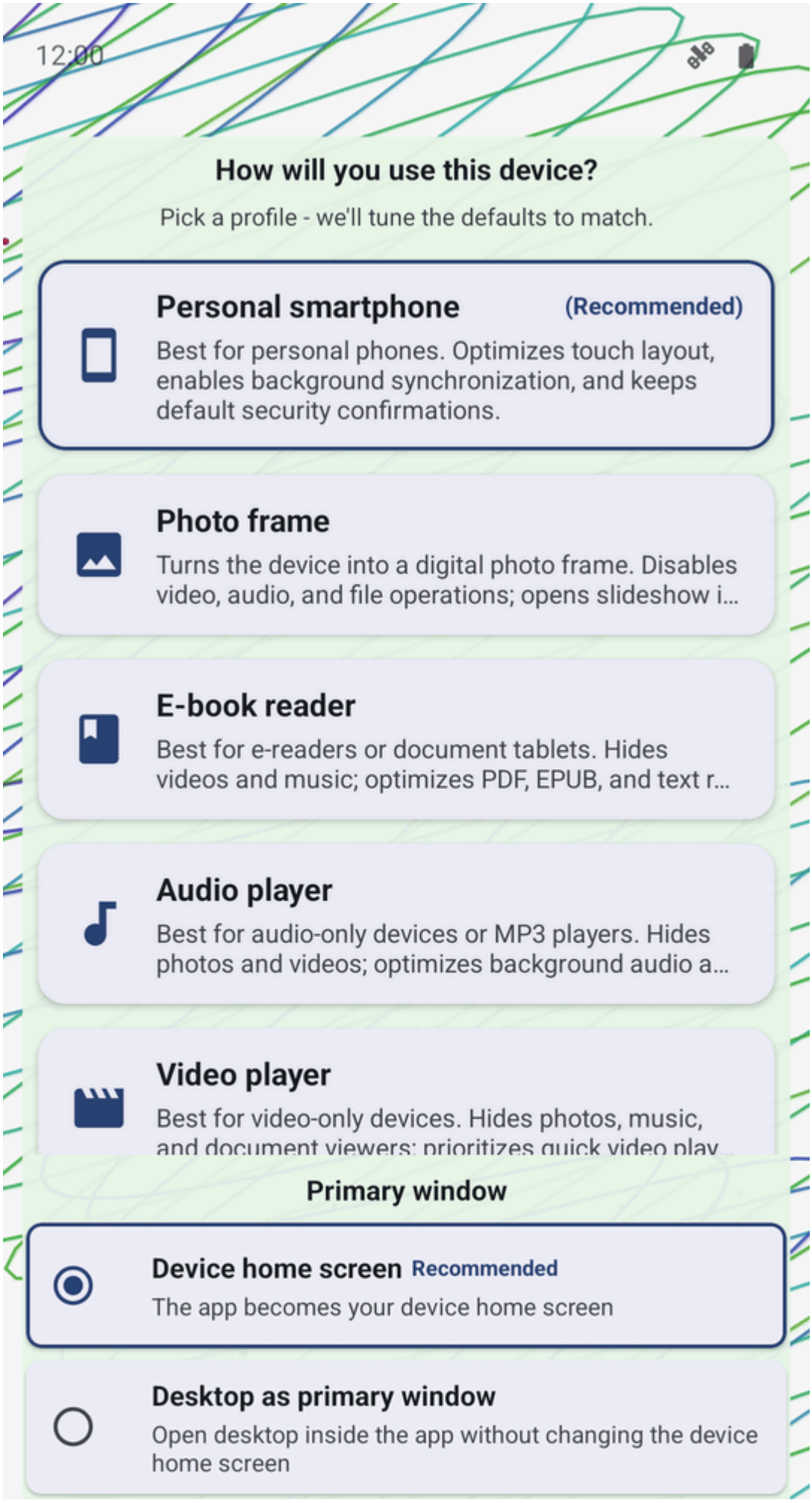
If a build offers to make FastMediaSorter your home screen and you decline, it remembers that - it will not ask again, not here and not the next few times you open Settings.

2 Page 2: tell it what kind of device this is

FastMediaSorter asks **"How will you use this device?"** and lays out a row of profile tiles: **Personal smartphone**, **Tablet & desktop mode**, **TV / media box**, **Car head unit**, **Audio player**, **Video player**, **E-book reader**, **Media player**, **Photo frame**, **VR headset**, and **Other / Custom**. It has already picked one for you, marked **(Recommended)**, based on the hardware it detected - tap a different tile if it guessed wrong.

Whichever tile is selected shows its whole description; every other tile stays clamped to one line, so the page does not turn into a wall of text. Tap the selected tile a second time to confirm it and move straight to the next page - a repeat tap means "this one, go on," the same as tapping **Next** would.

Moving past this page applies that device profile's whole settings preset, which decides what the pages that follow default to; anything you change afterward on your own still sticks. Picking **TV / media box**, **Car head unit** or **Photo frame** also leaves automatic power saving off, since those devices run on fixed power and a battery threshold would never trigger anyway - and **Photo frame** additionally turns off left-swipe-to-delete on a file row, to match the fact that this profile does not offer deletion at all.


12:00
How will you use this device?
Pick a profile - we'll tune the defaults to match.
Personal smartphone
(Recommended)
Best for personal phones. Optimizes touch layout, enables background synchronization, and keeps default security confirmations.
Photo frame
Turns the device into a digital photo frame. Disables video, audio, and file operations; opens slideshow i...
E-book reader
Best for e-readers or document tablets. Hides videos and music; optimizes PDF, EPUB, and text r...
Audio player
Best for audio-only devices or MP3 players. Hides photos and videos; optimizes background audio a...
Video player
Best for video-only devices. Hides photos, music, and document viewers; prioritizes quick video play...
Primary window
Device home screen
Recommended
The app becomes your device home screen
Desktop as primary window
Open desktop inside the app without changing the device home screen

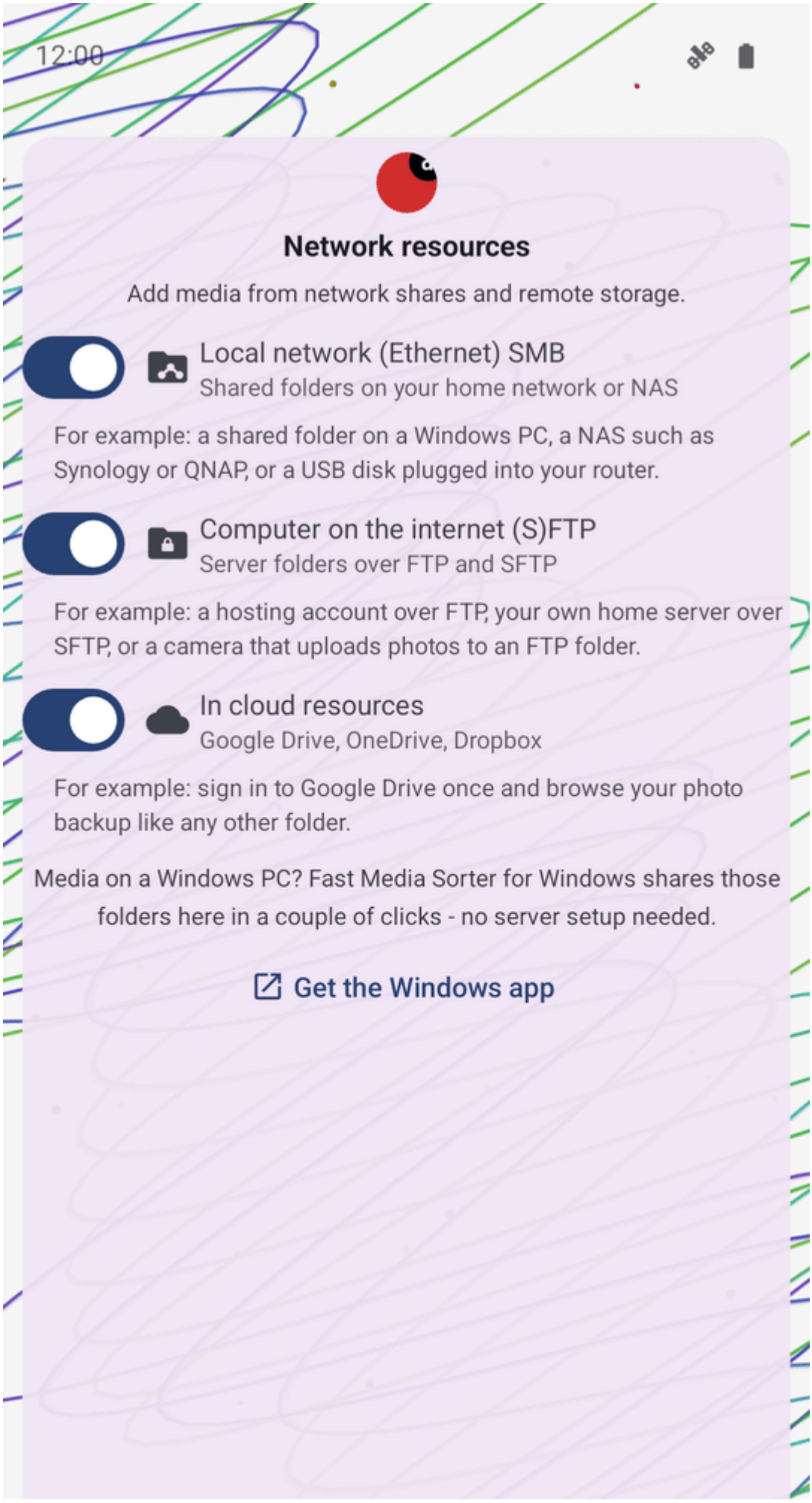
Choosing a device profile: the selected tile reads in full.

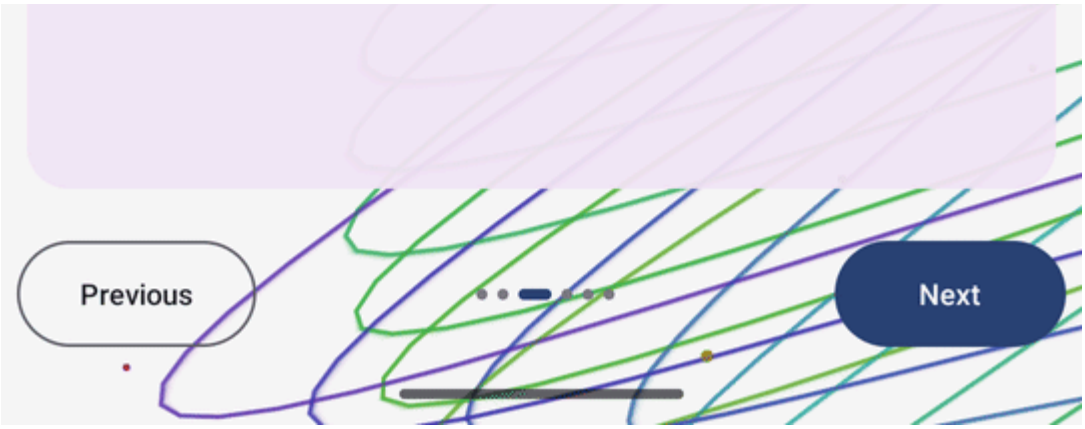
3 Page 3: turn on the network and cloud folders you use

On the Standard, Legacy, VR and noLegal editions, a **Network resources** page follows: "Add media from network shares and remote storage." Three group switches sit underneath, each one turning a whole family of sources on or off at once, with a plain-language example beside it:

- **Local network (Ethernet)** SMB - "Shared folders on your home network or NAS." For example, a shared folder on a Windows PC, a NAS such as Synology or QNAP, or a USB disk plugged into your router.
- **Computer on the internet (S)**FTP - "Server folders over FTP and SFTP." For example, a hosting account over FTP, your own home server over SFTP, or a camera that uploads photos to an FTP folder.
- **In** cloud resources - "Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox." For example, sign in to Google Drive once and browse your photo backup like any other folder.

Each switch only permits the group - you still add the actual folder or account afterward, from the main screen. The cloud row disappears on an edition without cloud support, and the whole page is left out on an edition with neither group.


12:00
Network resources
Add media from network shares and remote storage.
Local network (Ethernet) SMB
Shared folders on your home network or NAS
For example: a shared folder on a Windows PC, a NAS such as Synology or QNAP, or a USB disk plugged into your router.
Computer on the internet (S)FTP
Server folders over FTP and SFTP
For example: a hosting account over FTP, your own home server over SFTP, or a camera that uploads photos to an FTP folder.
In cloud resources
Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox
For example: sign in to Google Drive once and browse your photo backup like any other folder.
Media on a Windows PC? Fast Media Sorter for Windows shares those folders here in a couple of clicks - no server setup needed.
Get the Windows app



Turning on network and cloud source groups.

Already have a Windows PC on the network?

Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows shares chosen PC folders here in a couple of clicks, no server setup needed - this page has a **Get the Windows app** button for it.

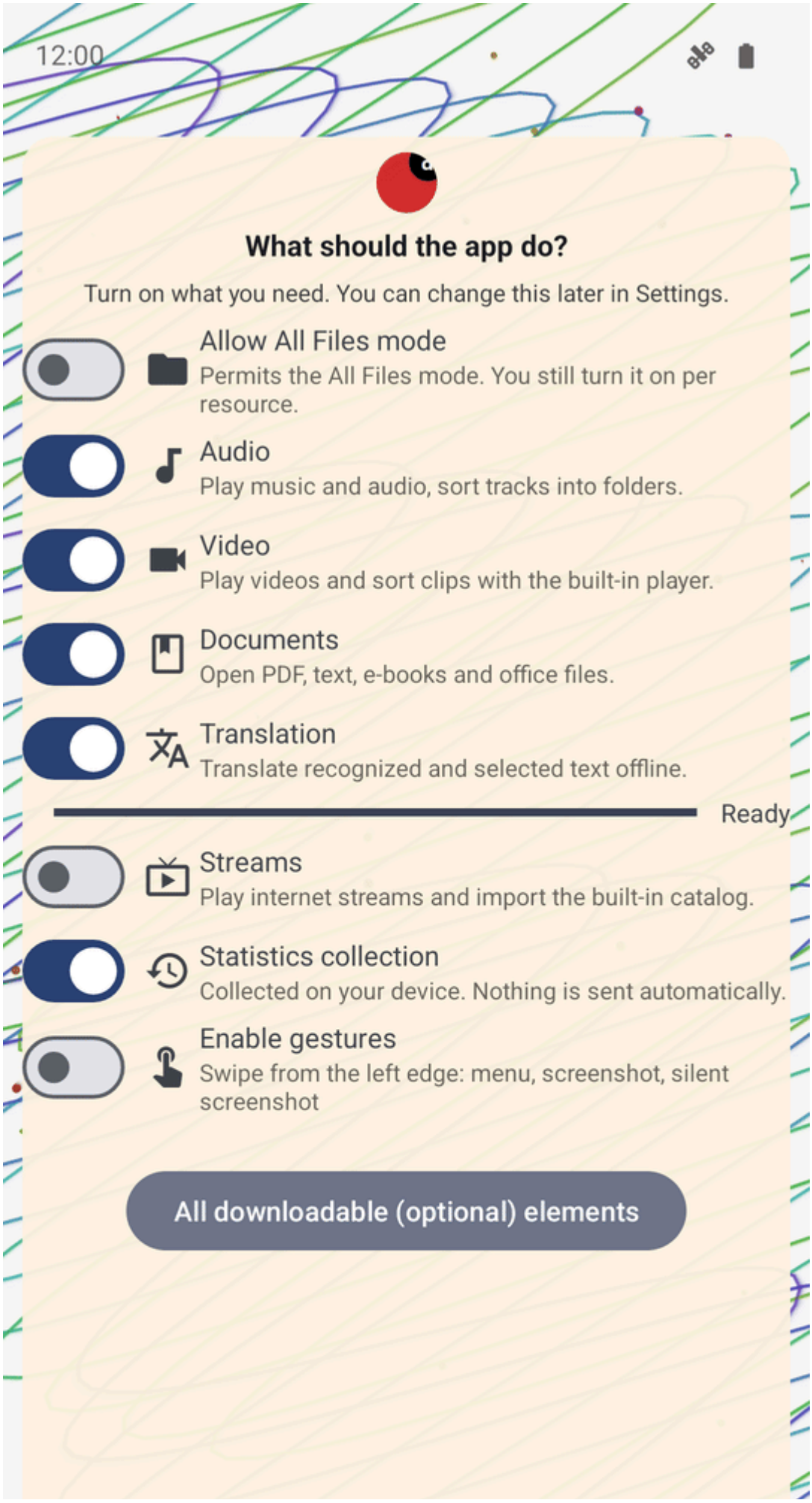
4 Page 4: choose what the app can do

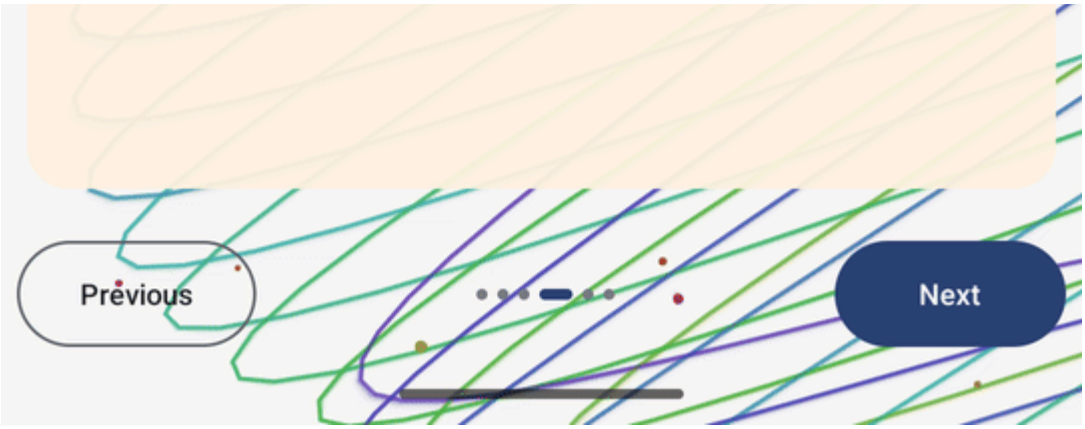
"What should the app do?" Turn on what you need - everything here can be changed later in Settings too. The switches: **Allow All Files mode** (permits it; you still turn it on per resource), **Audio**, **Video**, **Documents**, **Text recognition (OCR)**, **Translation**, and, on an edition that carries live Streams, a **Streams** switch that plays internet stations and channels and can import the built-in catalog.

Turning on OCR or Translation does more than flip a switch: each one queues a small recognition or translation engine to download right there, with a progress line that counts up and turns into "Ready" when it lands, or "Download failed - tap to retry" if it does not. The capability itself switches on only once its engine has installed successfully, so nothing is left half-enabled.

A **Statistics collection** switch sits lower on the page - on by default, on the Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions - with the note "Collected on your device. Nothing is sent automatically." Below it, on the Standard and noLegal editions, an **Enable gestures** switch turns on left-edge swipes: up opens the launch menu, right captures a screenshot and opens the editor, down captures one silently with a toast.

Every downloadable extra the app offers, not only OCR and translation, is one tap away too: **All downloadable (optional) elements** opens the extensions manager right over the wizard, so you can browse and install one without losing your place in setup.


12:00
What should the app do?
Turn on what you need. You can change this later in Settings.
Allow All Files mode
Permits the All Files mode. You still turn it on per resource.
Audio
Play music and audio, sort tracks into folders.
Video
Play videos and sort clips with the built-in player.
Documents
Open PDF, text, e-books and office files.
Translation
Translate recognized and selected text offline.
Ready
Streams
Play internet streams and import the built-in catalog.
Statistics collection
Collected on your device. Nothing is sent automatically.
Enable gestures
Swipe from the left edge: menu, screenshot, silent screenshot
All downloadable (optional) elements

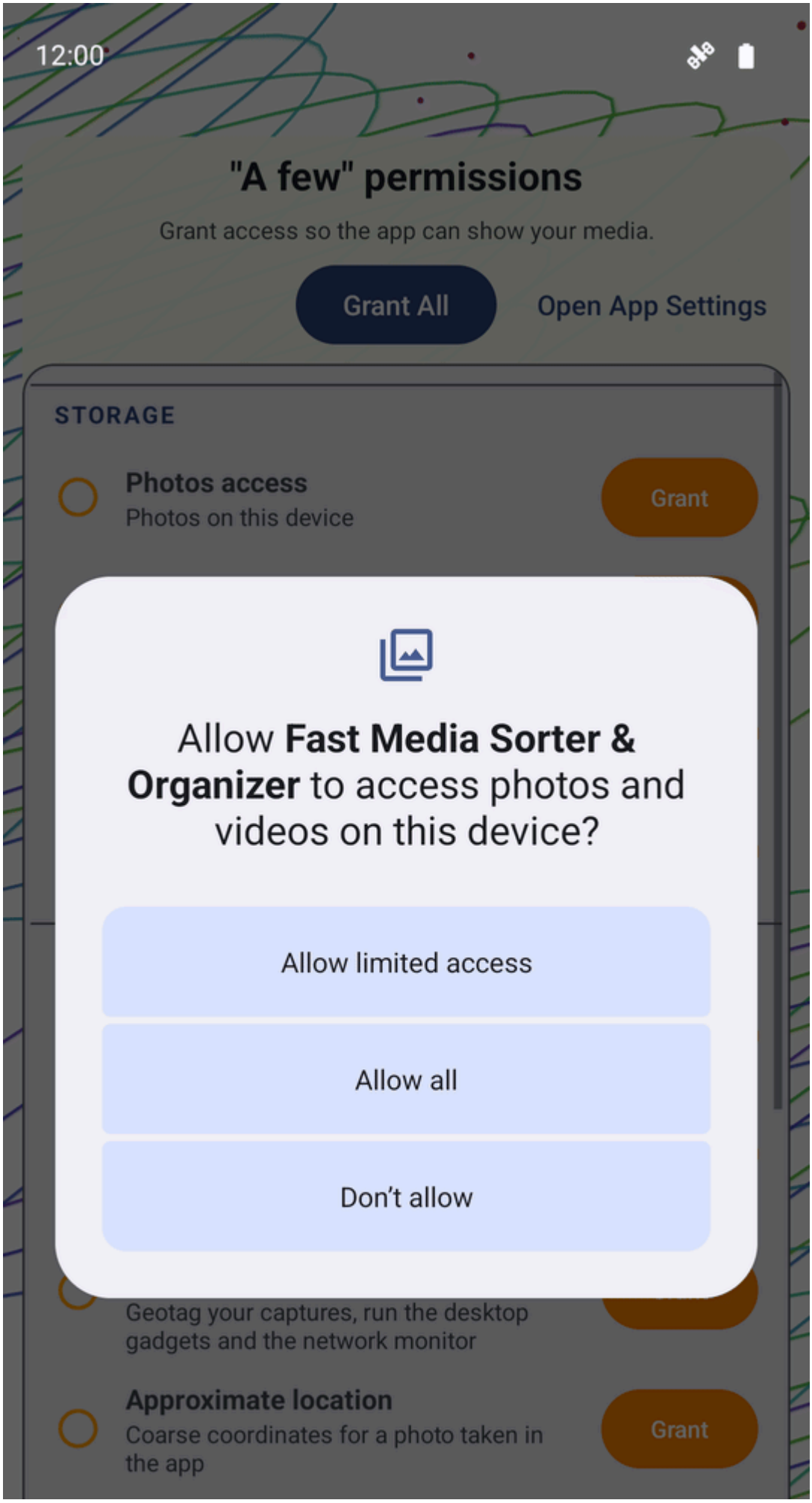


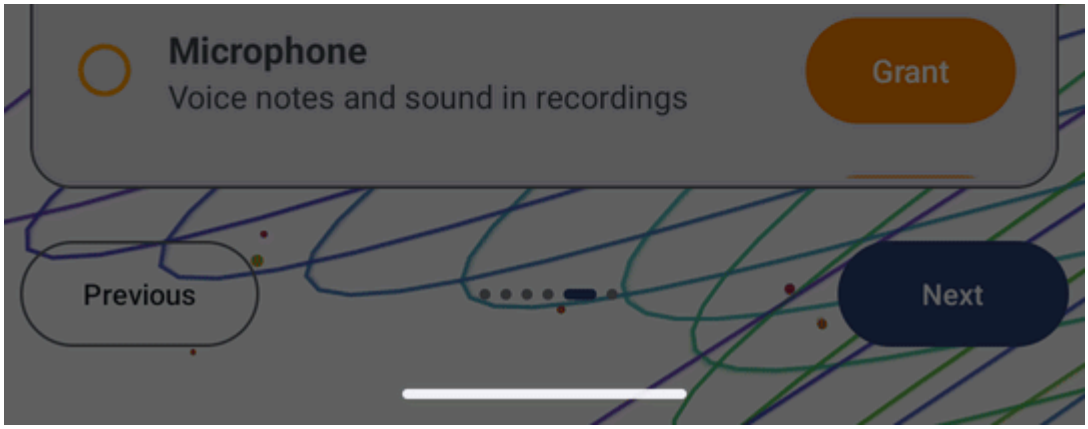
Turning on capabilities - an OCR engine downloading inline.

5 Page 5: grant the permissions it asks for

The permissions page lists every access this particular build can ask for, grouped and explained in plain language, with each row showing whether it is already granted. **Grant All** walks through every regular permission in one batch dialog, then opens each special one - the kind Android insists on its own settings page for - one at a time; **Open App Settings** jumps straight to the system screen for anything you would rather set by hand.

What the page offers changes with the edition and the Android version on your device, and every permission it can request - including drawing over other apps and installing an app from a file - gets the same explanation wherever the app asks for it again later. The full list, and exactly what each permission unlocks, has its own page: see Storage and system permissions.


12:00
"A few" permissions
Grant access so the app can show your media.
Grant All
Open App Settings
STORAGE
Photos access
Photos on this device
Grant
Allow Fast Media Sorter & Organizer to access photos and videos on this device?
Allow limited access
Allow all
Don't allow
Geotag your captures, run the desktop gadgets and the network monitor
Approximate location
Coarse coordinates for a photo taken in the app
Grant

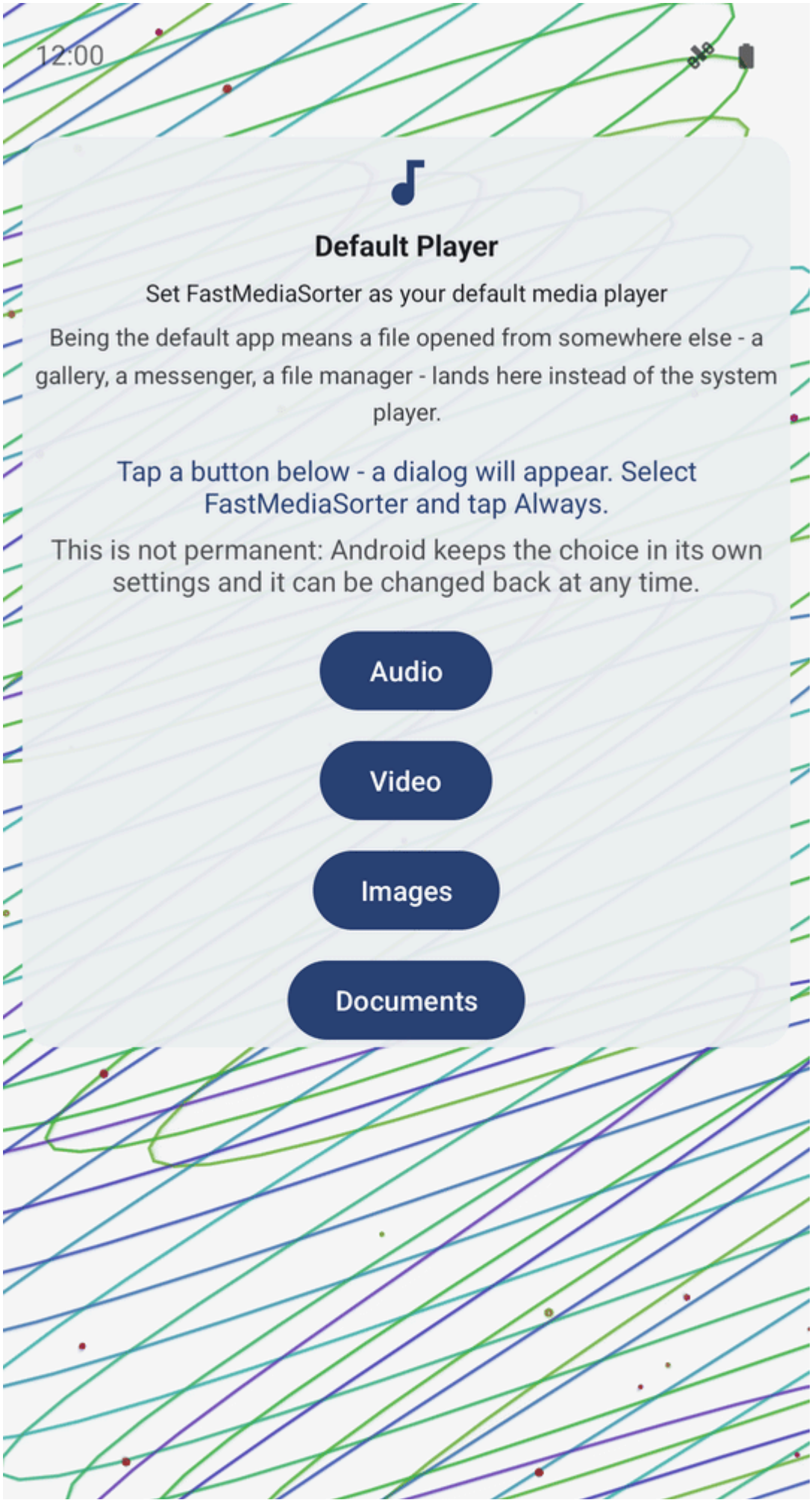


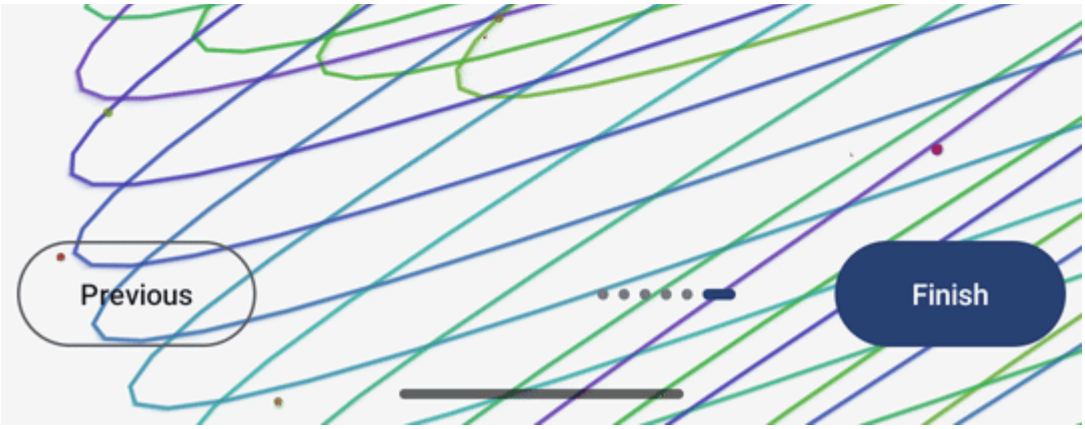
Granting a permission from the wizard's permissions page.

6 Page 6: make it your default player (first run only)

If nothing has claimed the role yet, one more page shows up: **Default Player** – "Set FastMediaSorter as your default media player." Four buttons, one per type – **Audio**, **Video**, **Images**, **Documents** – each opens Android's own app chooser. "Tap a button below – a dialog will appear. Select FastMediaSorter and tap **Always**."

The page explains what that choice actually changes: "Being the default app means a file opened from somewhere else – a gallery, a messenger, a file manager – lands here instead of the system player." And that trying it costs nothing: "This is not permanent: Android keeps the choice in its own settings and it can be changed back at any time." Once you have answered this page, or once FastMediaSorter already is the default for everything it can be, it stops appearing on later runs of the wizard.


12:00
Default Player
Set FastMediaSorter as your default media player
Being the default app means a file opened from somewhere else - a gallery, a messenger, a file manager - lands here instead of the system player.
Tap a button below - a dialog will appear. Select FastMediaSorter and tap Always.
This is not permanent: Android keeps the choice in its own settings and it can be changed back at any time.
Audio
Video
Images
Documents



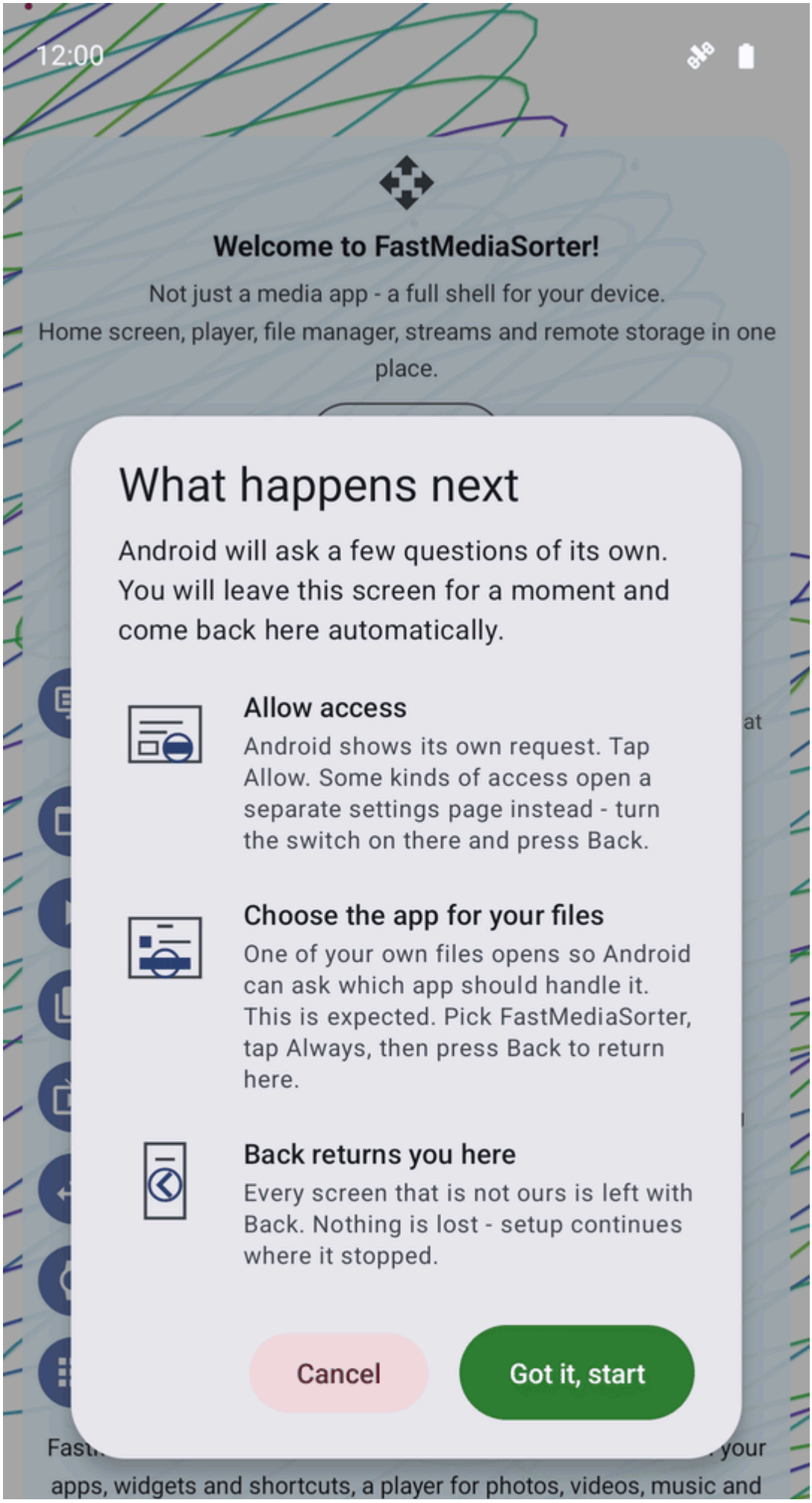
Setting FastMediaSorter as the default player, one media type at a time.

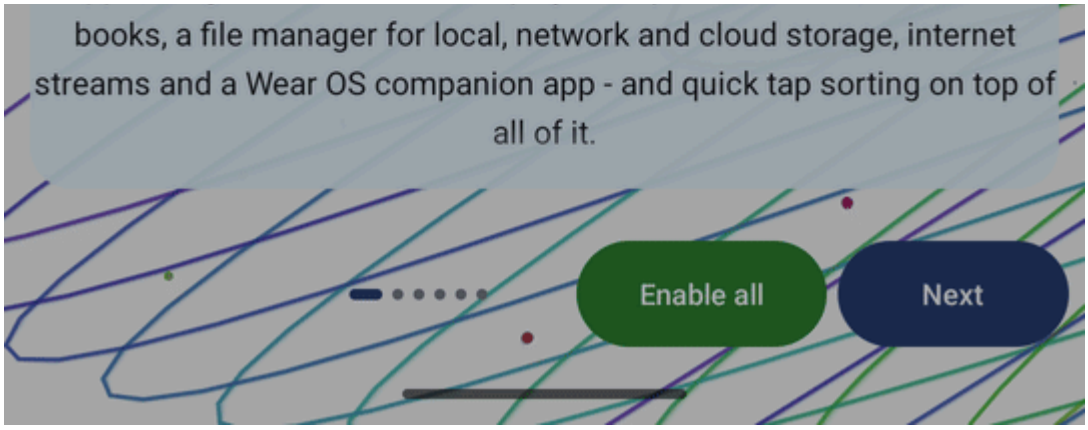
7 Or skip ahead - the Enable all shortcut

On the Standard, Legacy, VR and noLegal editions, a green **Enable all** button sits on the first page, next to the page dots. Tap it and a dialog explains **"What happens next"** first: "Android will ask a few questions of its own. You will leave this screen for a moment and come back here automatically." Three short steps follow it - **Allow access** ("Android shows its own request. Tap Allow. Some kinds of access open a separate settings page instead - turn the switch on there and press Back."), **Choose the app for your files** ("One of your own files opens so Android can ask which app should handle it. This is expected. Pick FastMediaSorter, tap Always, then press Back to return here."), and **Back returns you here** ("Every screen that is not ours is left with Back. Nothing is lost - setup continues where it stopped."). Tap **Got it, start** to continue, or dismiss the dialog and nothing changes.

Confirming opens the same device-profile picker from page 2 first, so an unlucky auto-detection is still visible and correctable before anything is applied. From there, Enable all switches on every setting that unlocks a capability your edition ships - image and GIF viewing included, plus every feature route compiled into the build - while leaving privacy, destructive, preference and resource-dependent settings untouched. It also brings back every "Send to.." recipient your edition enables by default - the system share sheet, Open with, Print, Email, Google Keep and the watch - even ones you had switched off earlier, though a recipient the edition ships off by default, such as the messengers or Google Lens, stays off, and one you switched on yourself is never touched.

A second reminder appears right before the default-app stage, worded the same way ("One more step: the app for your files.."), with **Show me** and **Skip this** buttons. Declining either reminder just leaves that one step unrun - the rest of Enable all still goes ahead.


12:00
Welcome to FastMediaSorter!
Not just a media app - a full shell for your device.
Home screen, player, file manager, streams and remote storage in one place.
What happens next
Android will ask a few questions of its own. You will leave this screen for a moment and come back here automatically.
Allow access
Android shows its own request. Tap Allow. Some kinds of access open a separate settings page instead - turn the switch on there and press Back.
Choose the app for your files
One of your own files opens so Android can ask which app should handle it. This is expected. Pick FastMediaSorter, tap Always, then press Back to return here.
Back returns you here
Every screen that is not ours is left with Back. Nothing is lost - setup continues where it stopped.
Cancel
Got it, start
apps, widgets and shortcuts, a player for photos, videos, music and



What Enable all is about to do, explained before it starts.

8 Finish, and what happens right after

Tap **Finish** on the last page and the wizard closes. The very first time only, FastMediaSorter opens **Settings** once on its own, with the main screen waiting behind it - so backing out of Settings lands you on the main screen, not back in the wizard. It never opens Settings uninvited again after that.

Changed your mind about the device profile, or want to turn a whole group of sources on or off again? Reopen this same wizard any time from Settings. It warns you first, since running it again can overwrite settings you have since tuned by hand.

What You Get

The app now speaks your language, looks the way you like, knows what kind of device it is running on, can see the network and cloud folders you turned on, and - if you asked it to - already answers to "Open with" and the system share sheet for the file types it plays. None of this is final: every choice lives in Settings afterward, and the wizard is one tap away if you want to run it again.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Enable all switches everything on for good.** Text recognition and translation stay on even when both of their parts finish installing at the same moment - they no longer switch themselves back off.
- **In a hurry?** Enable all on page 1 answers almost every later page for you and finishes setup in a few taps - see step 7 above.
- **Statistics collection stays on the device.** The switch on the functionality page only ever writes to local, anonymous numbers; nothing is sent out automatically.
- **Not sure about a permission yet?** Skip it here. The permissions guide explains what each one unlocks, and Settings lets you grant it later.
- **Which pages you see depends on the edition.** The noLegal edition, for example, shows every page in this recipe; a lighter edition may skip the network page or the default-player page entirely.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GETTING STARTED

Storage and system permissions

Every permission FastMediaSorter can ask for, what it unlocks, and how to grant or revisit it.

GETTING STARTED

Navigating the main workspace

What you land on right after setup, and how the main screen is laid out.

GETTING STARTED

Quick product tour

Installing the app, the first launch splash, and a map of what to read next.

GETTING STARTED | All editions | RECIPE #02

Understanding App Permissions

FastMediaSorter only asks for the permissions a feature actually needs, explains each one in the same plain words everywhere it is asked, and lets you grant them one at a time or all at once from **Settings, General, Permissions & Access** - with Android's own app settings always one tap away for changing your mind later.

Why You'll Love This

FastMediaSorter only sees and touches what Android lets it. Every permission it can ask for exists because some feature needs it - reading your photos, opening a shared folder over the network, writing a geotag into a picture you just took. Nothing is requested "just in case".

You already met a short version of this list on the welcome screen when you first opened the app. This page is the full picture: every permission this edition can ask for, in plain words, in one place, with a way to grant them one at a time or all together.

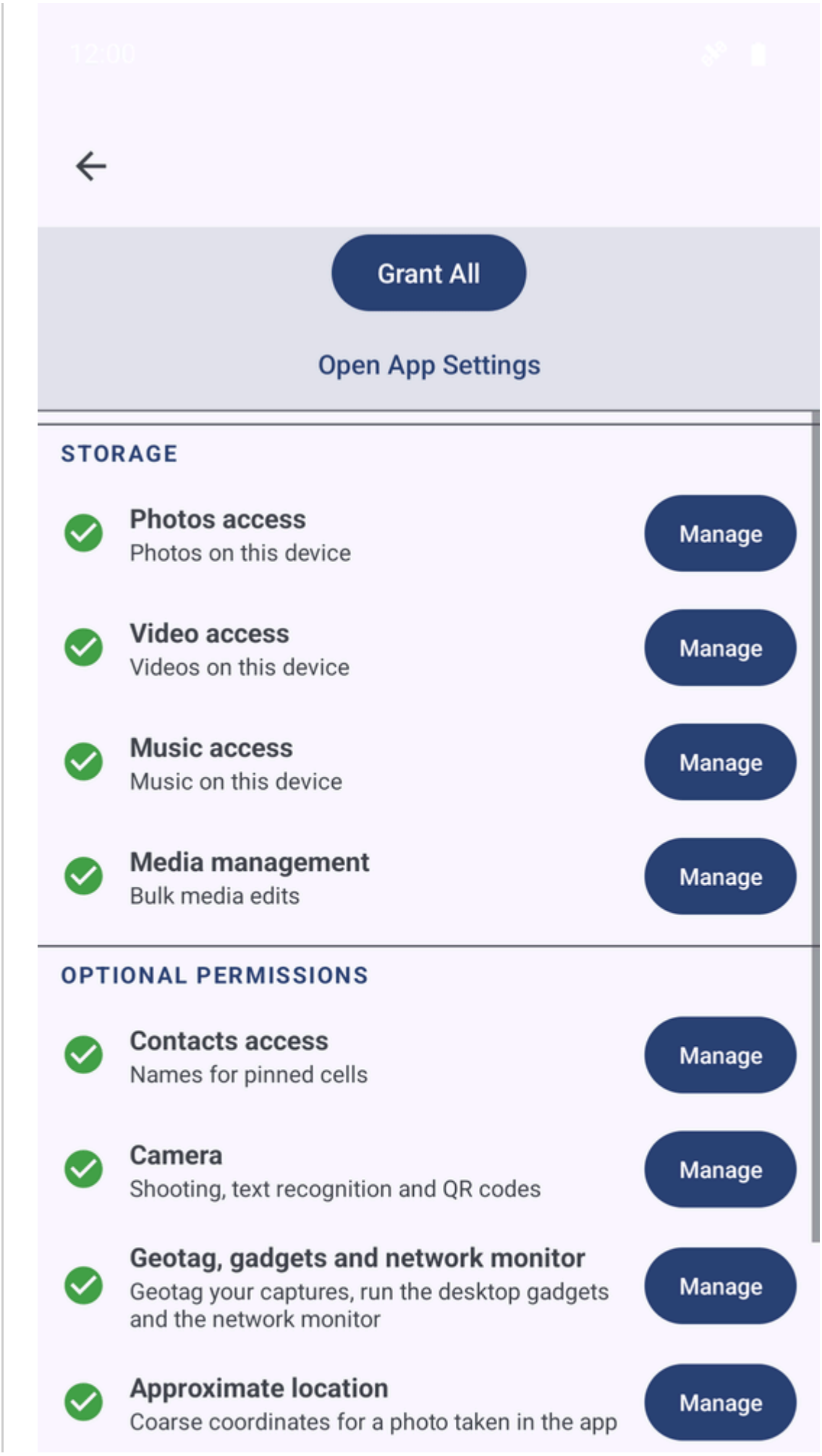
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

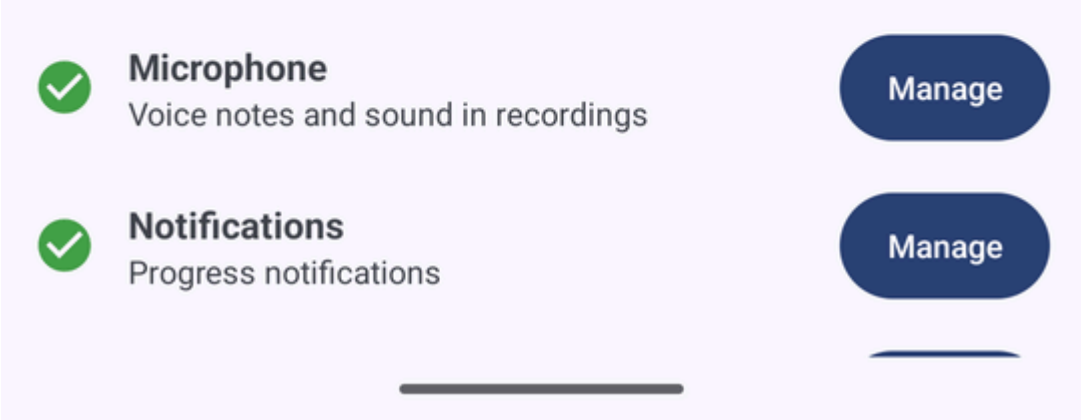
- FastMediaSorter installed, in any edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS. The exact list of rows differs a little by edition - a permission only appears if this build can actually use it.
- A few rows only appear from certain Android versions onward - each one names the version it needs, so there is nothing to look up.

1 Find the full list

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and tap **Permissions & Access**. The screen lists every permission this edition can request, grouped under headings: **Storage**, **Network**, **Microphone**, **Notifications**, **Camera**, **Location**, **System**, and - on editions that ship the launcher - **Contacts**. Each row shows a short label, a one-line description, and whether it is currently granted.

The same list, with the same wording, is also the last page of the first-launch setup wizard - see First launch and setup wizard.

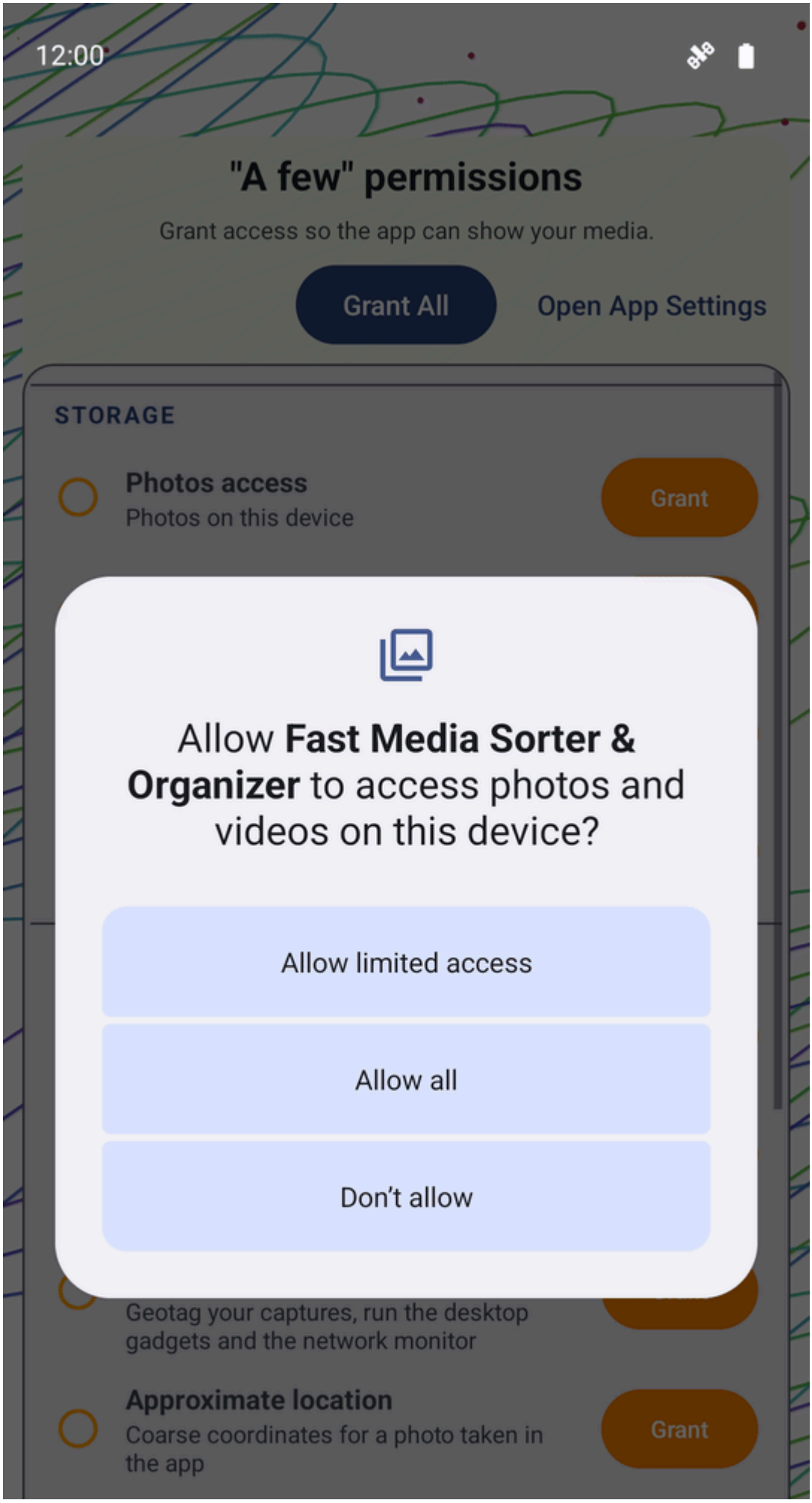

12:00
Grant All
Open App Settings
STORAGE
Photos access
Photos on this device
Manage
Video access
Videos on this device
Manage
Music access
Music on this device
Manage
Media management
Bulk media edits
Manage
OPTIONAL PERMISSIONS
Contacts access
Names for pinned cells
Manage
Camera
Shooting, text recognition and QR codes
Manage
Geotag, gadgets and network monitor
Geotag your captures, run the desktop gadgets and the network monitor
Manage
Approximate location
Coarse coordinates for a photo taken in the app
Manage

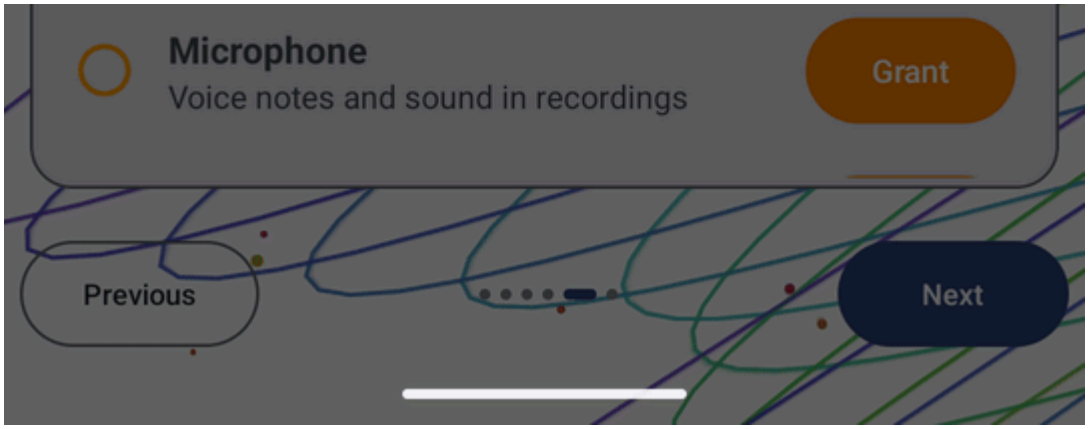


Settings, General, Permissions & Access.

2 Grant one permission at a time

Tap any row that is not yet granted. Most rows show Android's own request dialog right there - tap **Allow** and you are back on the list. A few permissions cannot be granted this way at all: Android insists on a dedicated screen for them, for example **Full storage management** or **Display over other apps**. For those, tapping the row opens that screen; make your choice there and press Back to return to FastMediaSorter.


12:00
"A few" permissions
Grant access so the app can show your media.
Grant All
Open App Settings
STORAGE
Photos access
Photos on this device
Grant
Allow Fast Media Sorter & Organizer to access photos and videos on this device?
Allow limited access
Allow all
Don't allow
Geotag your captures, run the desktop gadgets and the network monitor
Approximate location
Coarse coordinates for a photo taken in the app
Grant

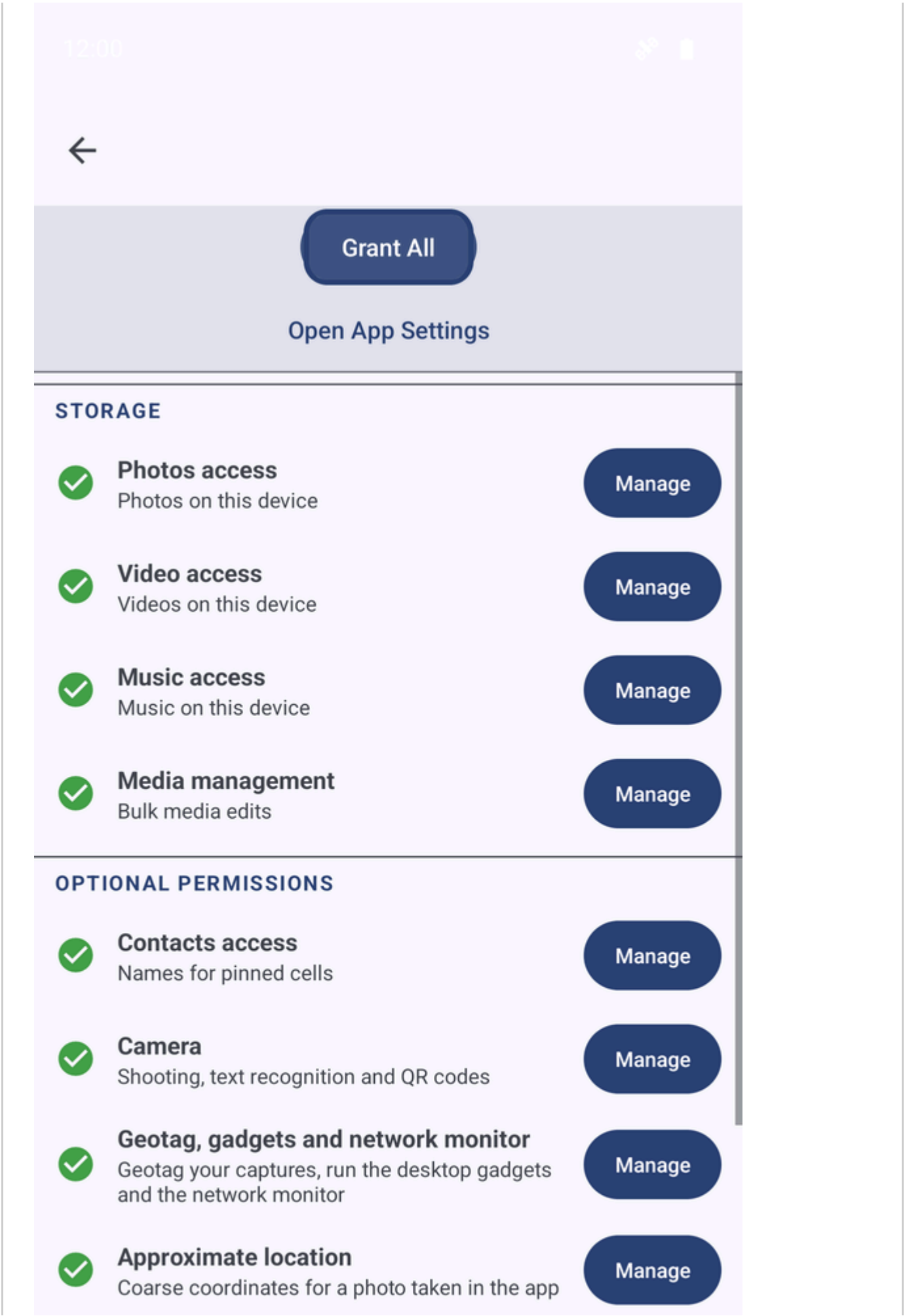


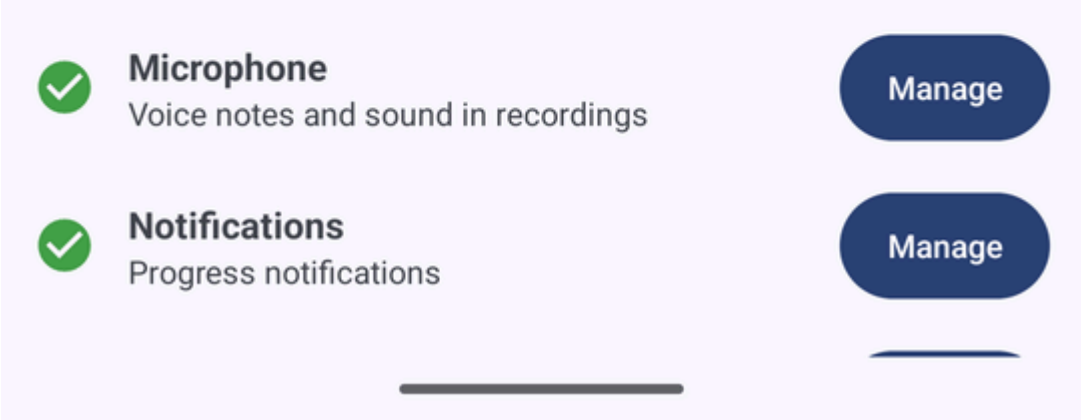
The system's own request dialog for one permission.

3 Grant everything in one go

Tap **Grant All** at the top of the screen instead of working through the rows one by one. The app answers one ordinary Android dialog for the permissions that support it, then walks you to each special-screen permission in turn, one system screen at a time, so you always know which one you are looking at.

Changed your mind about a specific one afterwards? Deny it the normal way in Android, or come back to this screen and revisit that single row.


12:00
Grant All
Open App Settings
STORAGE
Photos access
Photos on this device
Manage
Video access
Videos on this device
Manage
Music access
Music on this device
Manage
Media management
Bulk media edits
Manage
OPTIONAL PERMISSIONS
Contacts access
Names for pinned cells
Manage
Camera
Shooting, text recognition and QR codes
Manage
Geotag, gadgets and network monitor
Geotag your captures, run the desktop gadgets and the network monitor
Manage
Approximate location
Coarse coordinates for a photo taken in the app
Manage



Grant All walks through every permission for you.

4 What each group actually unlocks

- **Storage** - reading your photos, video and music, and, on the sideload noLegal edition only, full access to any folder for bulk media edits.
- **Network** - reaching SMB, SFTP, FTP and DLNA servers on your local network. On newer Android versions this is its own permission, separate from Wi-Fi being on.
- **Microphone** - recording voice notes and capturing sound inside screen recordings, on editions that record audio.
- **Notifications** - showing progress while a long job runs in the background, on editions that keep audio playing after you leave the app.
- **Camera** - taking photos and video inside the app, reading text and scanning QR codes, including the code used to pair a companion device.
- **Location** - writing coordinates into the photos and videos you shoot in the app. On editions with a launcher desktop or a Network Monitor, the same permission also drives the compass, speed, altitude and map desktop gadgets and the network monitor's GNSS and Wi-Fi details - the row on those editions names all of that, not only the geotag.
- **System** - background items such as an exemption from battery optimization for scheduled jobs, drawing the gesture strip over other apps, installing an APK you opened from a file (noLegal edition only), and reporting phone signal strength or step count on the launcher desktop.
- **Contacts** - reading a pinned contact's current name and photo so a launcher shortcut stays up to date, on editions with a launcher desktop.

A row you do not see simply does not apply to this edition or this Android version - the list never hides a permission the app could still use.

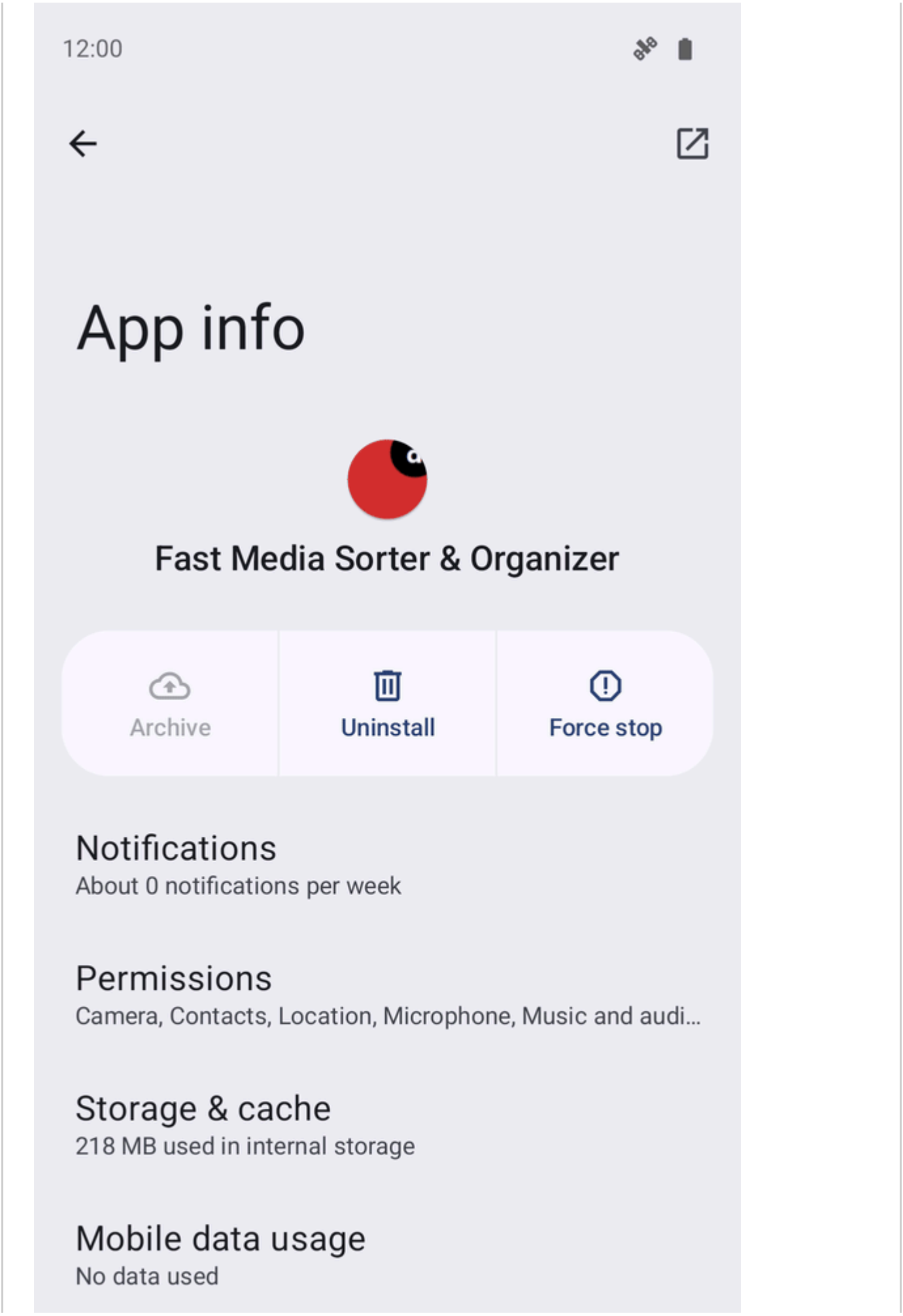
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Permission groups**
Settings, Permissions, scrolled down past Camera.

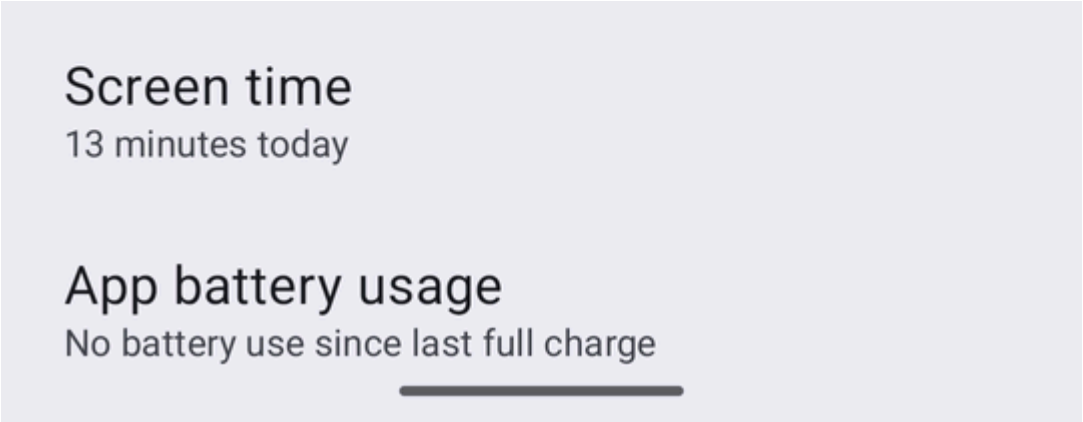
One wording, everywhere

Whichever screen asks for a permission - this list, the welcome wizard, or a dialog shown while you work - it explains that permission in the same words. Nothing changes meaning depending on where you happened to be asked.

5 Change a decision later

Tap **Open App Settings** to jump straight to Android's own application details screen for FastMediaSorter. That is the only place to grant a permission Android has stopped asking about in-app - typically one you denied twice in a row - and it is also where you go to revoke something you granted earlier.


12:00
App info
Fast Media Sorter & Organizer
Archive
Uninstall
Force stop
Notifications
About 0 notifications per week
Permissions
Camera, Contacts, Location, Microphone, Music and audi...
Storage & cache
218 MB used in internal storage
Mobile data usage
No data used



Android's own app settings screen.

What You Get

You know what every permission this edition can ask for is actually for, you can grant them one at a time or all in one pass, and you know exactly where to go in Android when you want to revisit a choice later.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Audio permissions are always offered where they belong.** In the editions that record or play sound in the background, the microphone and audio permissions are listed and can be granted - they are never hidden by mistake.
- **A row named 'Physical activity' or 'Install apps from files'?** Those only appear on the noLegal sideload edition, because only its manifest declares them - the Play Store edition never shows a permission it could not act on.
- **Location reads differently depending on your edition.** On Standard and noLegal it explains the desktop gadgets and Network Monitor too; on the others it stays a plain geotag explanation, because that is all those editions use it for.
- **A denied permission is not a dead end.** Most features that need one keep working in a reduced form, and a row you skip during setup stays visible here for whenever you change your mind.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GETTING STARTED

First launch and setup wizard

The short version of this same permissions list, on the last page of first setup.

GETTING STARTED

Navigating the main screen

What the resource list, command bar and panels do once permissions are granted.

SETTINGS

Navigating and searching Settings

Find any setting fast, including Permissions & Access.

GETTING STARTED | All editions | RECIPE #03

Navigating the Main Screen

The main screen is your home base: a resource list with All Files pinned first, a command bar that never runs out of room, tabs and optional panels that fit any screen width, and a filter and sort dialog that remembers your choice - with a corner pill to tell you when something is recording.

Why You'll Love This

The main screen is where every session with FastMediaSorter starts and usually ends. It is the one screen that has to make sense at a glance whether you have three resources or thirty - a folder on the phone, a shared drive at home, a handful of streams - so knowing what each part of it does saves you a few taps every single time you open the app.

Nothing here changes your files. This page is a map of the screen, not a set of actions to perform.

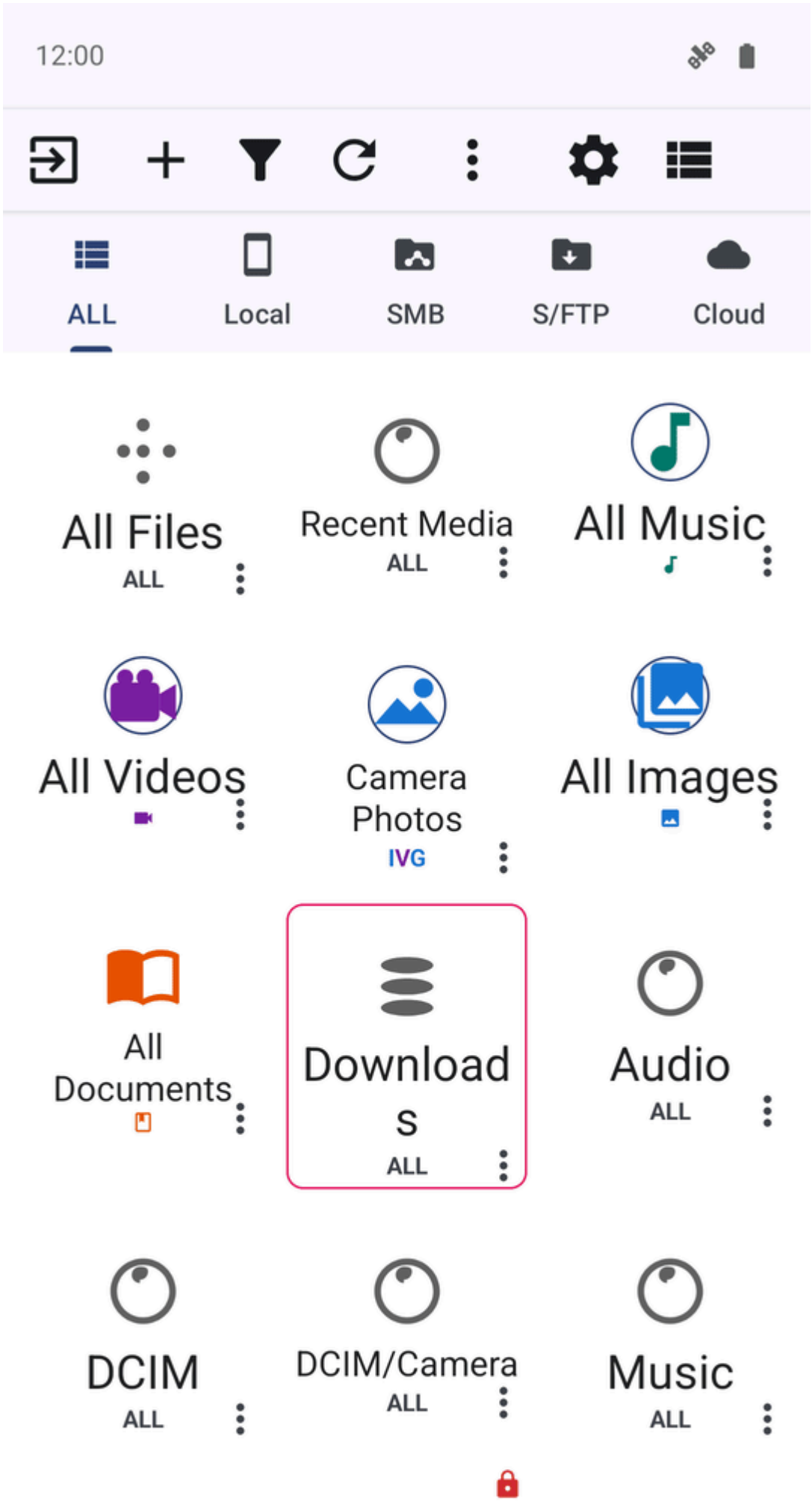
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

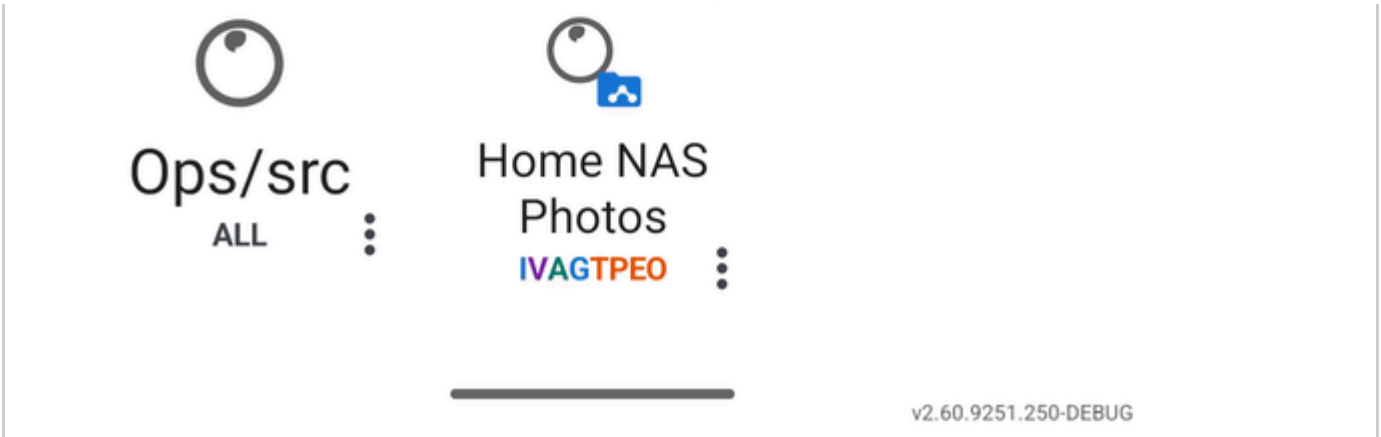
- FastMediaSorter in any edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS. A couple of pieces described here - the streams panel and the paired-watch filter - only exist on editions that ship streams or a Wear OS companion.
- At least one resource added, so the list and the panels have something to show. See Setting up local and removable storage if you have not added one yet.

1 Read the resource list

Your resources - folders, network shares, cloud accounts, streams and anything else you have added - are shown as rows or tiles in the resource list. The All Files resource, where it exists on this edition, always stays first no matter how you sort the rest, unless a tab or a filter hides it entirely.

Long-press and drag any other resource to put it where you want it; the app remembers the new order. Tap **View** on the command bar to switch the whole list between rows (list view) and tiles (grid view).

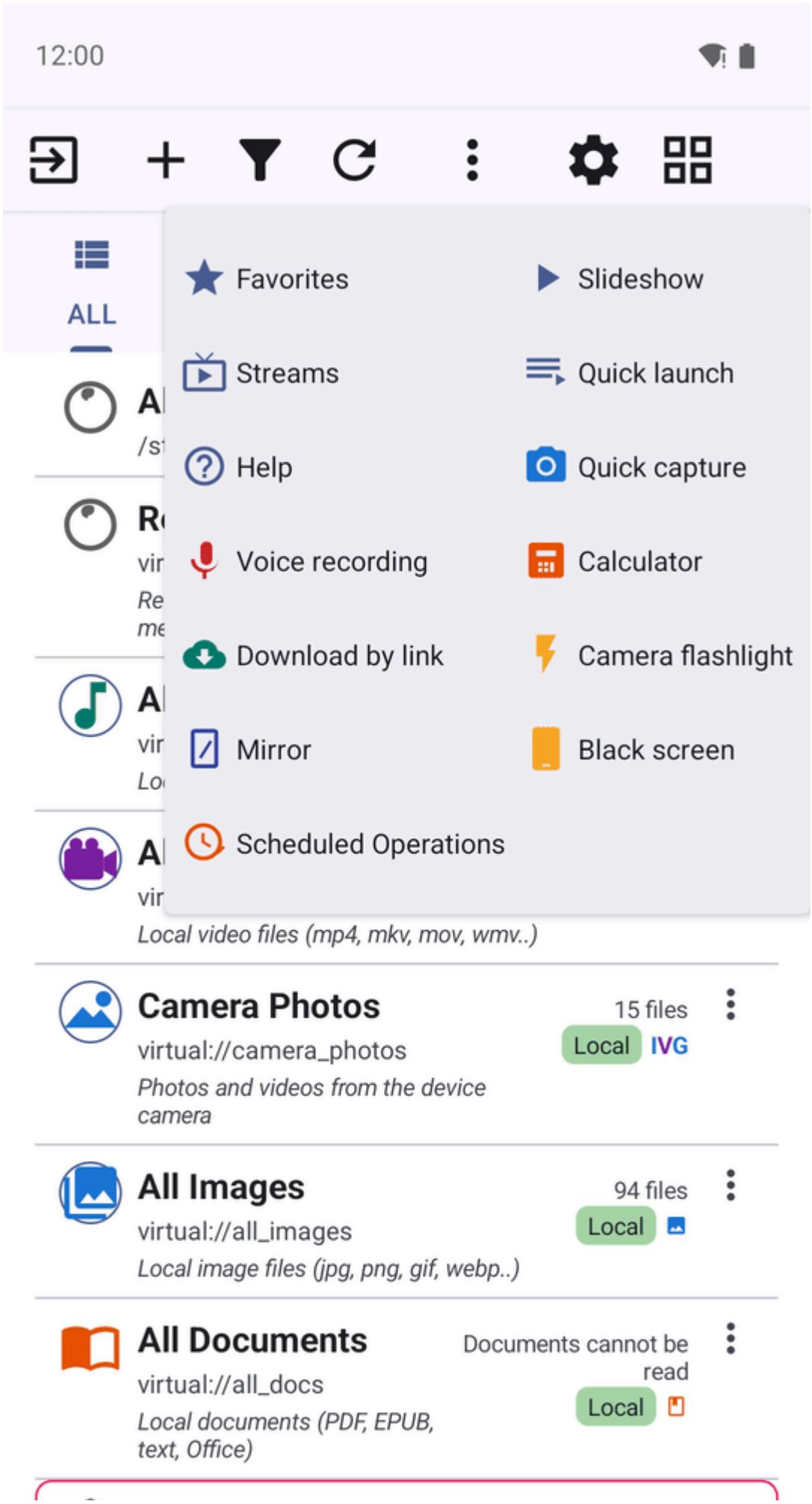

12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Downloads
ALL
Audio
ALL
DCIM
ALL
DCIM/Camera
ALL
Music
ALL

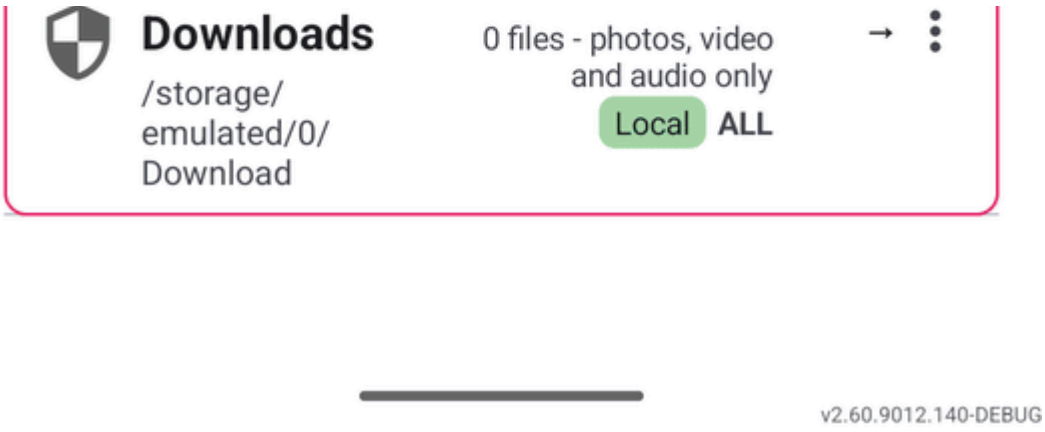


The resource list, in grid view.

2 The command bar across the top

The row of buttons above the list - **Exit**, **Add**, **Filter**, **Refresh**, **Settings**, **View**, **Favorites** and **Start Player** - is always there, though not always with its text labels. On a narrow screen the labels disappear first so every icon still fits; if icons alone still do not fit, the buttons at the right give way one at a time into the **More actions** (three-dots) menu, so a command is never simply cut off the edge of the screen.


12:00
ALL
Favorites
Slideshow
Streams
Quick launch
Help
Quick capture
Voice recording
Calculator
Download by link
Camera flashlight
Mirror
Black screen
Scheduled Operations
Local video files (mp4, mkv, mov, wmv..)
Camera Photos
15 files
Local
IVG
virtual://camera_photos
Photos and videos from the device camera
All Images
94 files
Local
virtual://all_images
Local image files (jpg, png, gif, webp..)
All Documents
Documents cannot be read
Local
virtual://all_docs
Local documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)



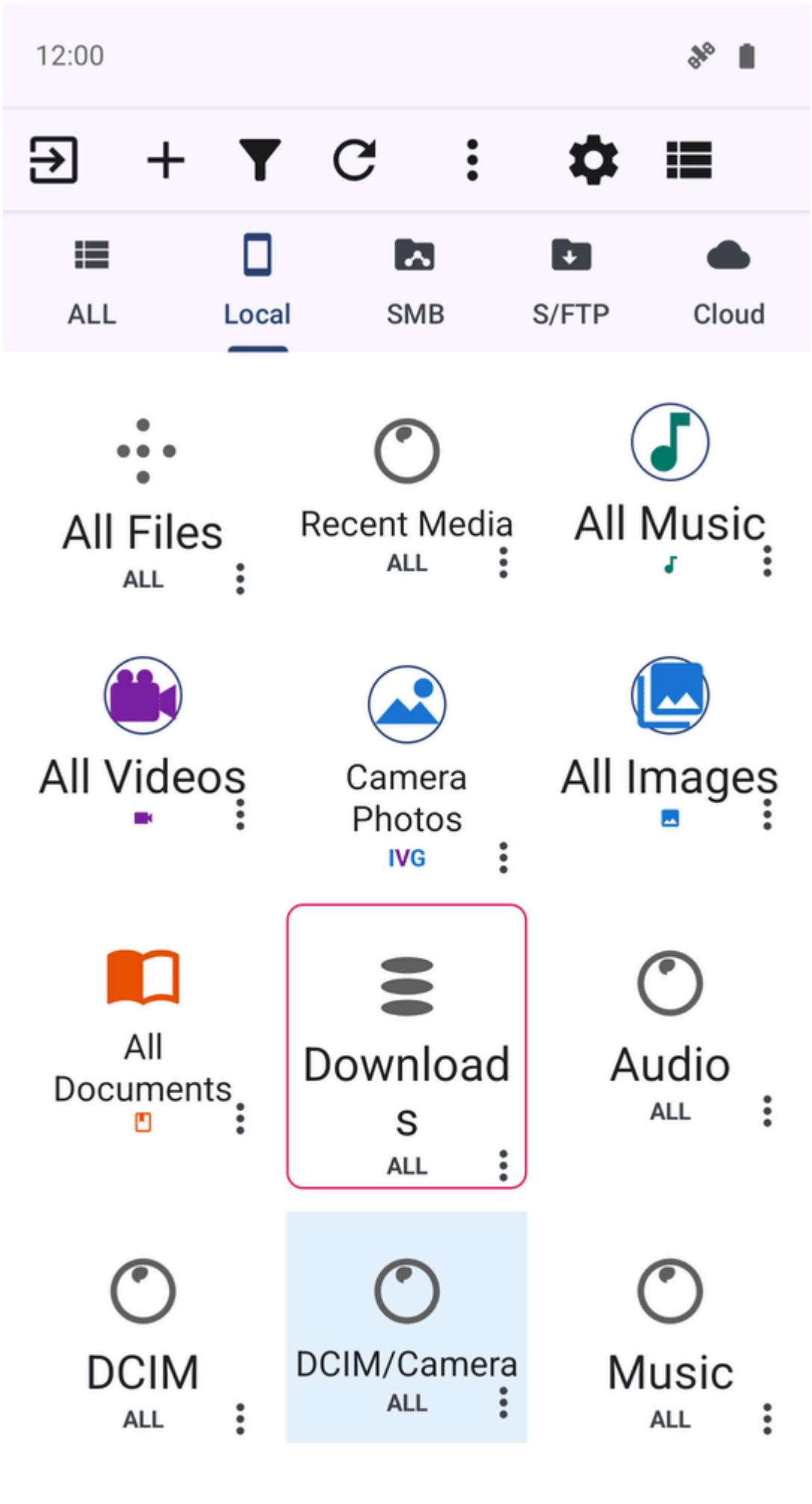
Buttons that do not fit move into More actions.

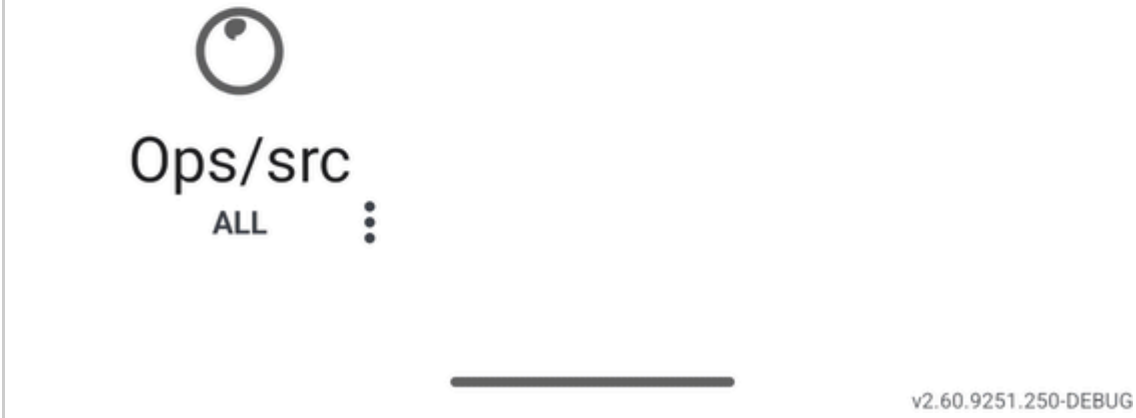
Everything still reachable

A command that moved into the three-dots menu works exactly the same as it did on the bar - it just needs one extra tap to find. Nothing you can do on a wide screen becomes unavailable on a narrow one.

3 Filter by type with the tabs

Just under the command bar sits a row of resource-type tabs - **ALL** and **Local**, plus **SMB**, **S/FTP** and **Cloud** on editions that have them - that narrow the resource list to one kind of resource with a single tap. Each tab takes a share of the available width rather than a fixed size, so every tab stays visible and tappable, Cloud included, in portrait, landscape and on the widest layouts.


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Download
s
ALL
Audio
ALL
DCIM
ALL
DCIM/Camera
ALL
Music
ALL

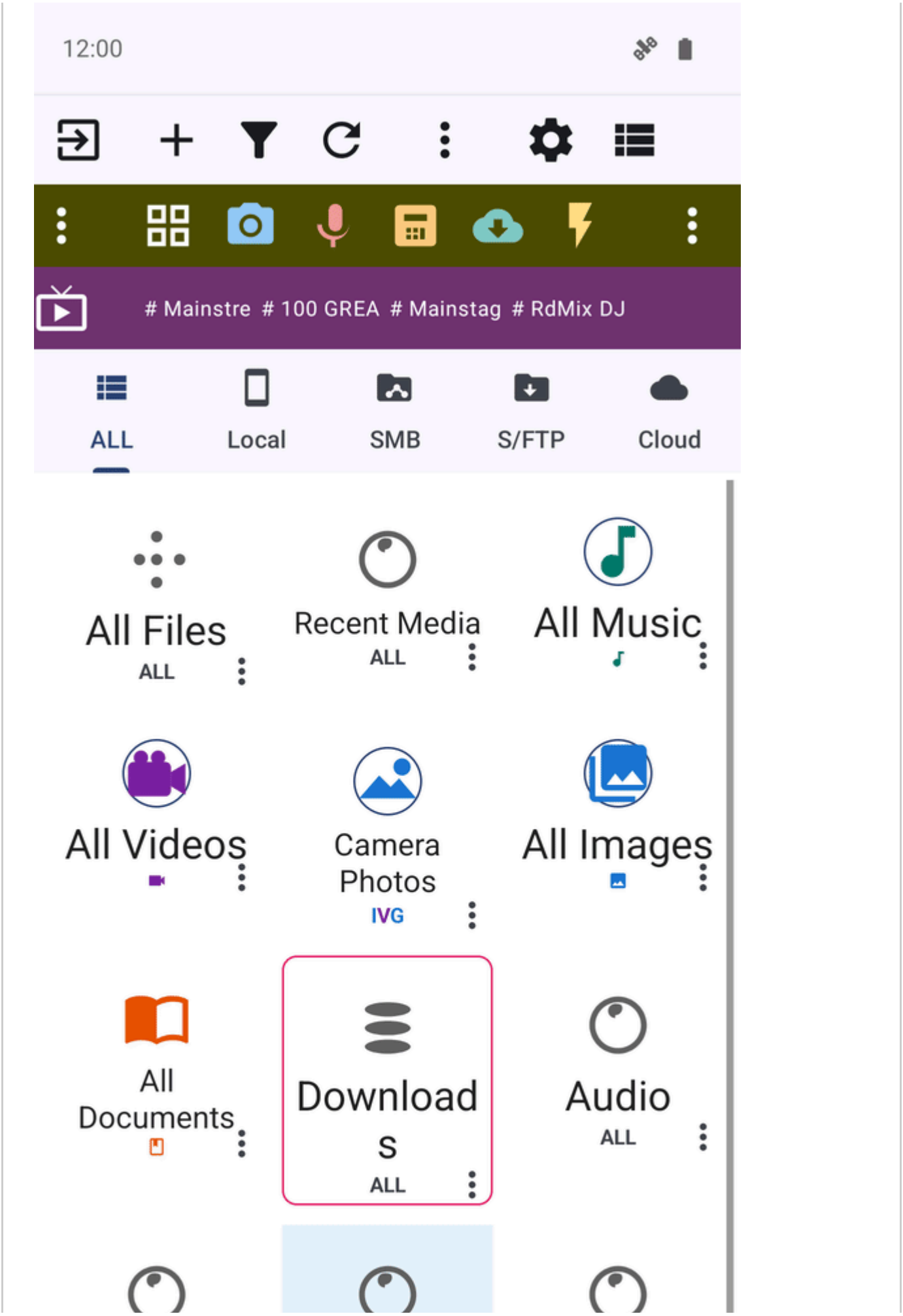


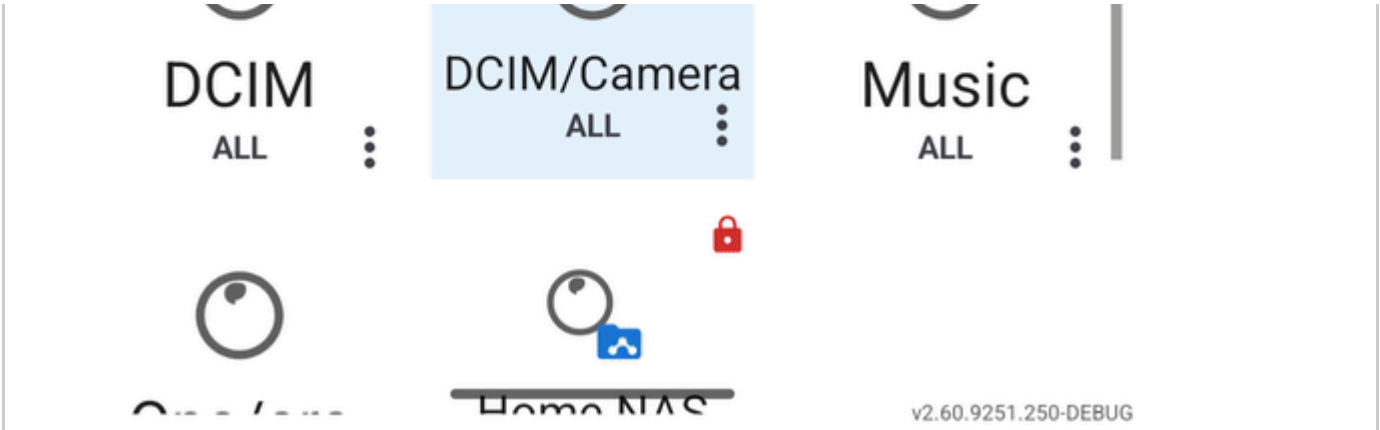
Every resource-type tab fits, even on a narrow screen.

4 The programs and streams panels

Two optional bars can sit above the resource list: the programs panel for one-tap access to the app's built-in programs (see Built-in programs), and, on editions that ship streams, the streams panel for your pinned channels (see Browsing internet stream channels). Turn either on or off in Settings.

On a wide layout the two panels and the tab strip line up on one shared grid, using the programs panel's own button width as the common measure. If the screen is too narrow for a panel to show in full, its icon collapses into a small chip that moves into the free space at the end of the command bar row instead of taking a row of its own - unless the command bar is already full, in which case the chip keeps its own row.


12:00
Mainstre # 100 GREA # Mainstag # RdMix DJ
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Download
s
ALL
Audio
ALL

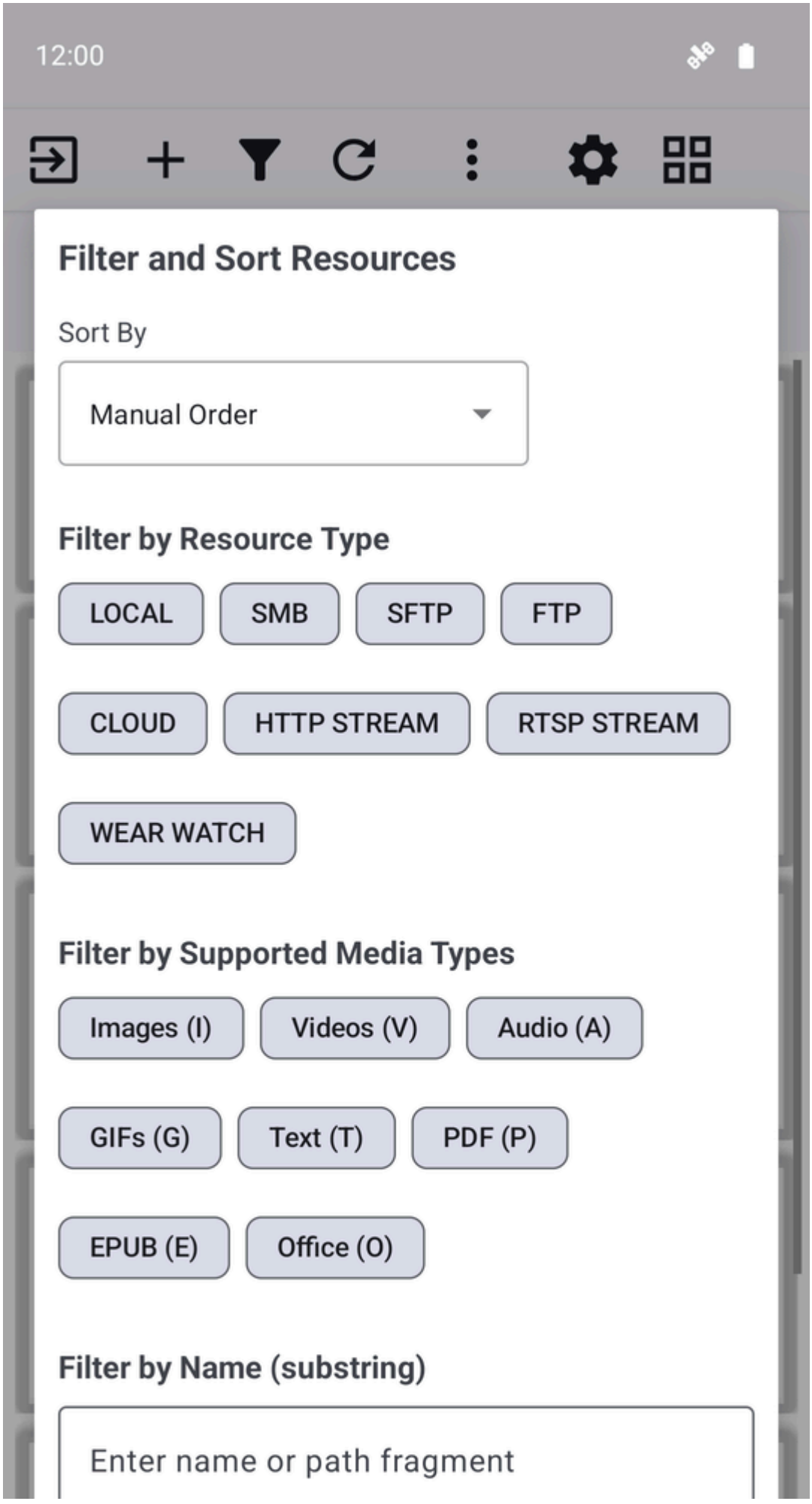


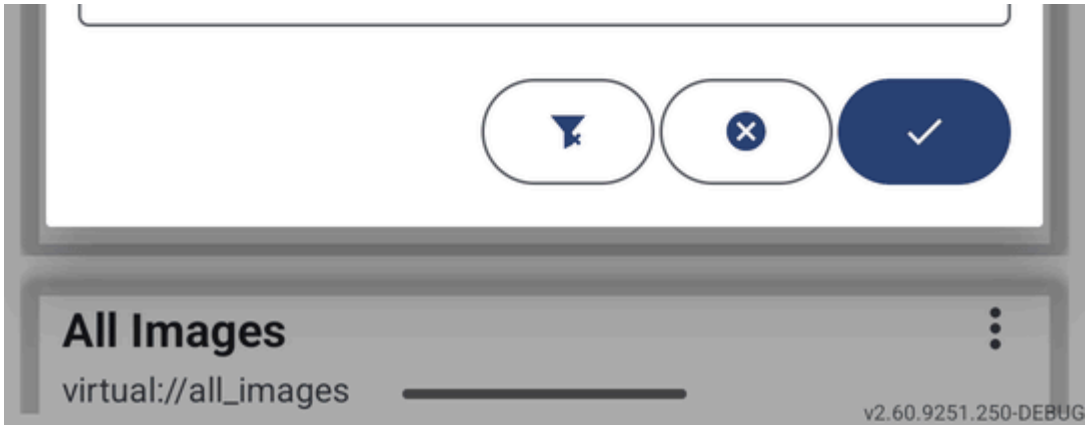
The programs panel and the streams panel, above the resource list.

5 Sort and filter the resource list

Tap **Filter** to open the **Filter and Sort Resources** dialog. From there you can filter by resource type, filter by the media types a resource supports, and choose a sort order. On Standard and noLegal you can also filter by a paired watch's own resource type.

Whatever you choose here is remembered and reapplied the next time you open the app - even after the app is force-stopped or the phone restarts - and a banner above the list reminds you which filters are currently on, so a short list reads as filtered rather than as resources gone missing. Full details: Sorting, filtering and quick search.


12:00
Filter and Sort Resources
Sort By
Manual Order
Filter by Resource Type
LOCAL
SMB
SFTP
FTP
CLOUD
HTTP STREAM
RTSP STREAM
WEAR WATCH
Filter by Supported Media Types
Images (I)
Videos (V)
Audio (A)
GIFs (G)
Text (T)
PDF (P)
EPUB (E)
Office (O)
Filter by Name (substring)
Enter name or path fragment



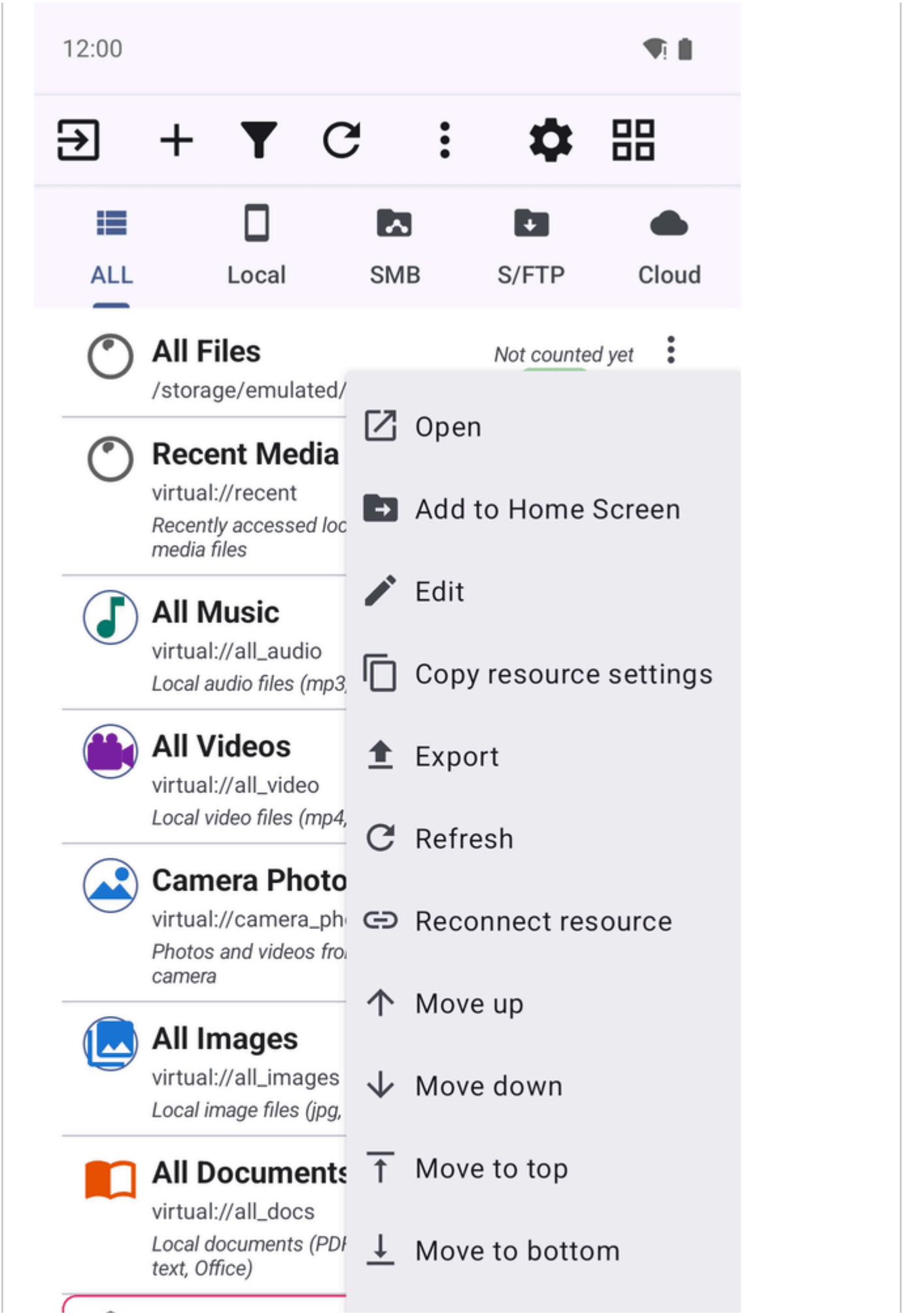
The Filter and Sort Resources dialog.

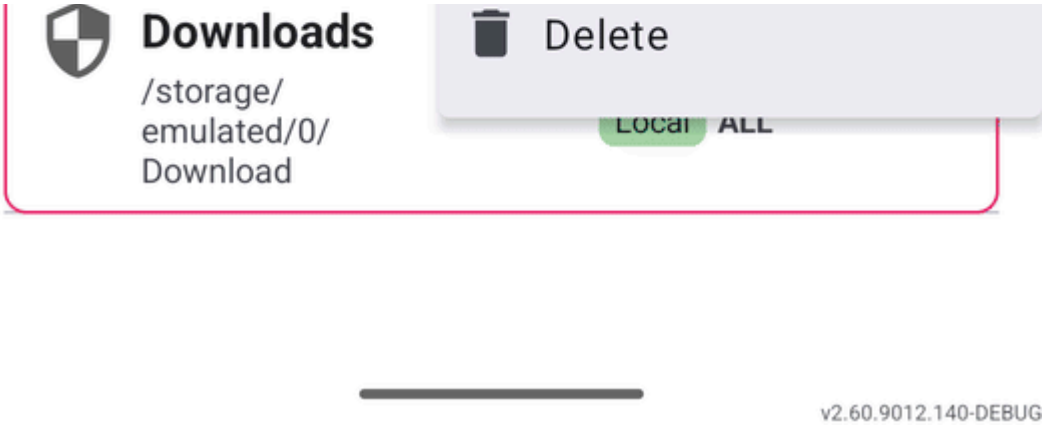
Cell size for grid view

Prefer bigger or smaller tiles? Go to Settings, General, and set Resource grid cell size to Small, Medium or Large - it scales whatever column count your screen and orientation already use.

6 More on one resource - the three-dots menu

Open the three-dots menu on any resource row for the actions that do not fit as icons - renaming, removing, and **Reconnect resource** for a folder that needs its connection refreshed. If the folder you pick during a reconnect does not match what the resource pointed to before, a confirmation dialog asks you to double-check before it is applied - and that dialog now stays on screen if you rotate the phone while it is open, instead of quietly disappearing.

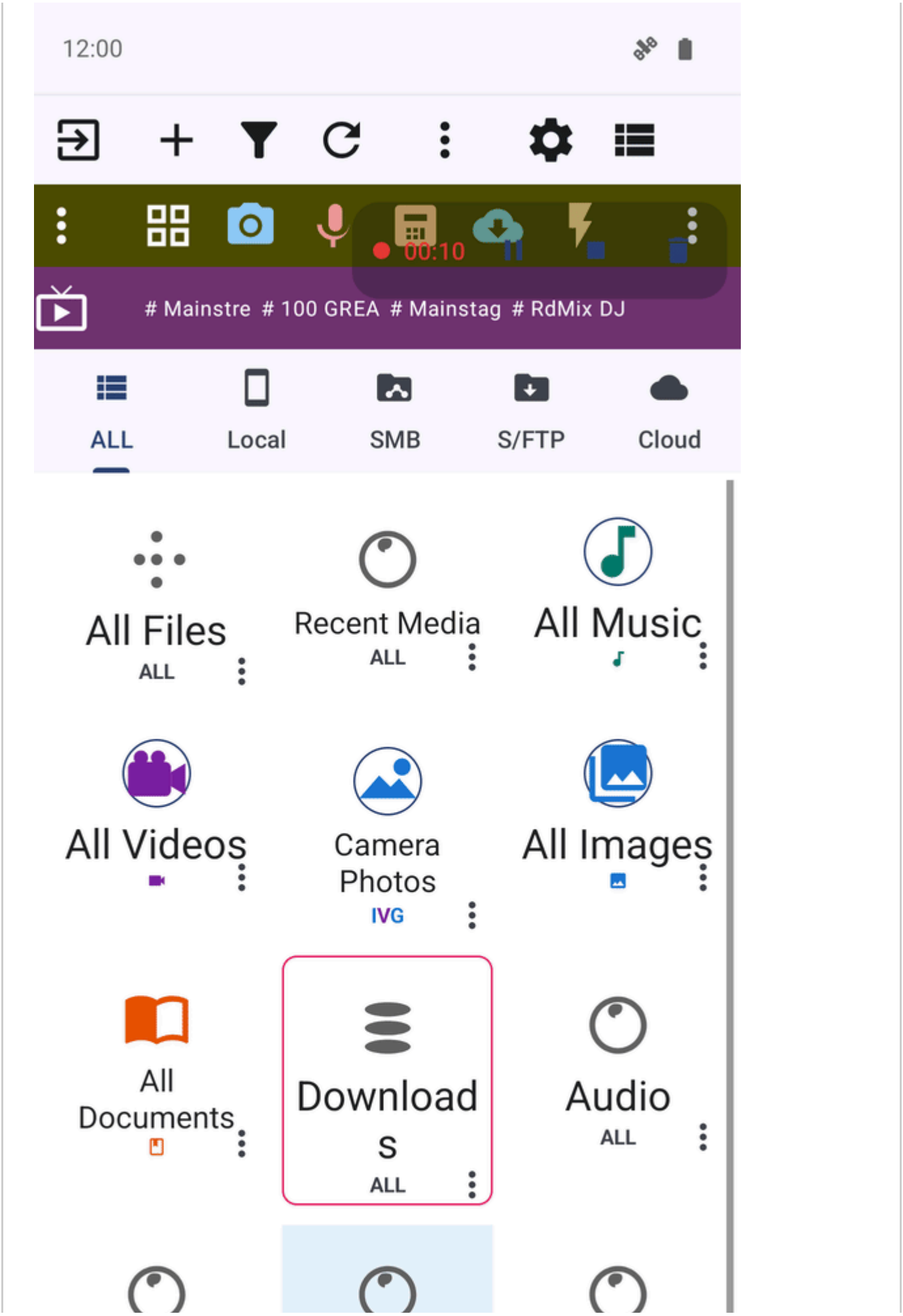

12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
/storage/emulated/
Not counted yet
Recent Media
virtual://recent
Recently accessed loc
media files
All Music
virtual://all_audio
Local audio files (mp3
All Videos
virtual://all_video
Local video files (mp4,
Camera Photo
virtual://camera_ph
Photos and videos fro
camera
All Images
virtual://all_images
Local image files (jpg,
All Documents
virtual://all_docs
Local documents (PDF
text, Office)
Open
Add to Home Screen
Edit
Copy resource settings
Export
Refresh
Reconnect resource
Move up
Move down
Move to top
Move to bottom

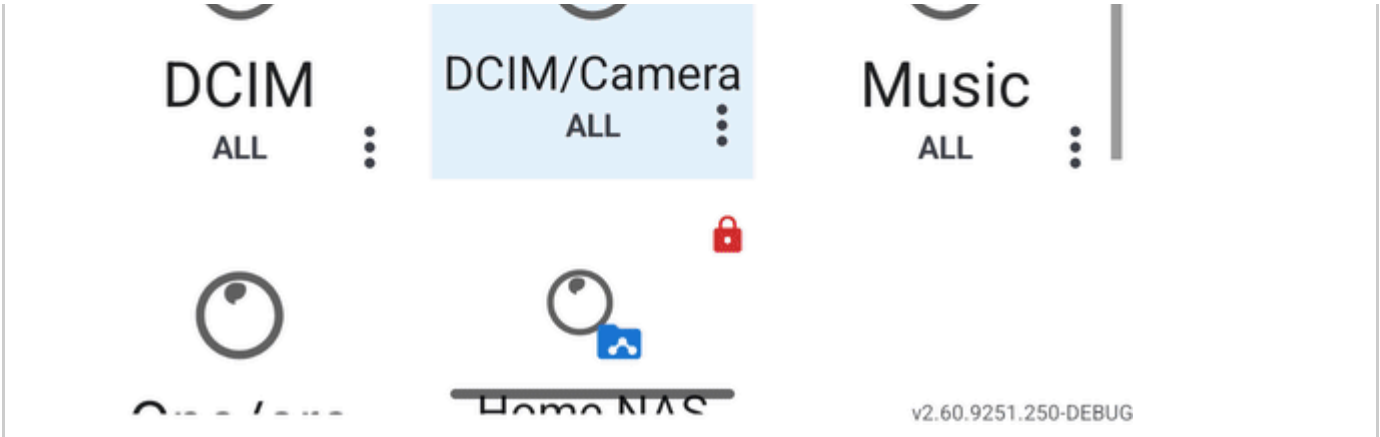


Actions for one resource live in its three-dots menu.

7 The recording indicator

While a screen recording or a quick voice capture is running, a small pill appears in a corner of the screen - a dot, a timer, and pause/resume and stop buttons - so you can check on or stop the recording without leaving the main screen. It now shows up reliably on wide landscape layouts too, such as a car head unit, where it used to stay invisible. See Recording the device screen with audio.


12:00
00:10
Mainstre # 100 GREA # Mainstag # RdMix DJ
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Download
s
ALL
Audio
ALL



The recording indicator, while a recording is running.

What You Get

You can read the resource list at a glance, reach every command whether or not the screen has room for its label, narrow the list with the tabs and the filter dialog, tell at a glance when something is recording, and know where to look when a resource needs reconnecting.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Built-in resources speak your language.** Recent Media, All Music, All Files, Downloads and the other ready-made resources rename themselves the moment you switch the app's language, instead of staying in whatever language was active on first launch.
- **A fresh install still shows real numbers.** The file count on the built-in collections fills in shortly after install, in the background, instead of sitting at zero until you open each one.
- **The Programs button stays centered.** Its icon and label sit in the middle of their cell in both the regular and the compact command bar, so it lines up with its neighbors either way.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GETTING STARTED

Understanding app permissions

What each permission unlocks, before you start adding resources.

STORAGE

Configuring local and removable storage

Add the folders that show up in this resource list.

BROWSING

Sorting, filtering and quick search

The full detail behind the Filter and Sort Resources dialog.

GETTING STARTED | All editions | RECIPE #04

All editions - install source depends on the edition

Quick Product Tour

From installing FastMediaSorter to the clock on its first splash to a map of which recipe to read next - this is the five-minute tour before the welcome wizard asks you anything.

Why You'll Love This

This page is the short version of the whole documentation site: where to get the app, what you see in the seconds after you tap its icon for the first time, and a map of which recipe to open next depending on what you actually want to do with it. If the welcome wizard is the conversation FastMediaSorter has with you once, this page is the five-minute walk around the building before that conversation starts.

Nothing here requires a decision. It is a look around, not a checklist.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- An Android phone, tablet, TV box, car head unit or headset - FastMediaSorter runs on all of them, in the editi built for that on hardware.
- A way to install an app: the Google Play Store, or a downloaded APK file for the editions that are not sold in a store.
- For the Windows-folder step: Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows running on the same network as your phone.

1 Get the app

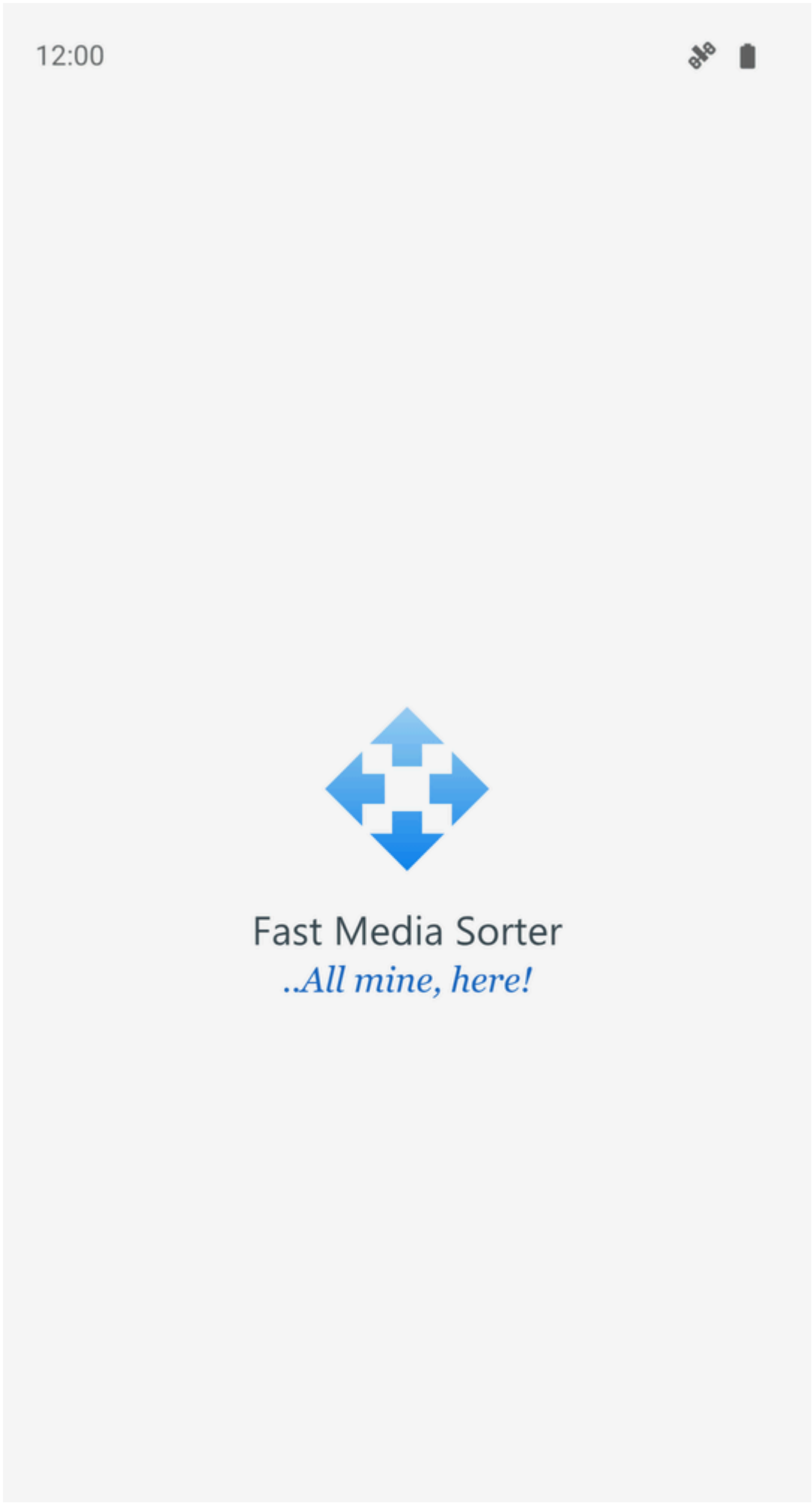
The Standard edition is on Google Play, like any other app - search for FastMediaSorter or open its store listing directly and tap **Install**.

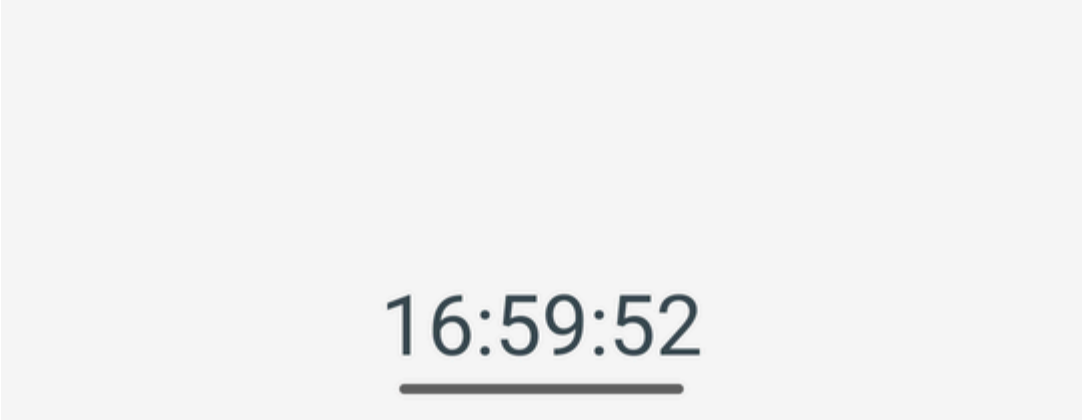
The other editions - noLegal, VR, Lite, Photos and Legacy - carry features a store will not list, so they are not sold there. You install one of these by downloading its APK file directly, either from the project's GitHub Releases page or from the IzzyOnDroid repository, and opening it. Android meets a package it has not seen installed from a store before and shows a one-time warning about it; that warning is about how many times Android has seen the file's signature, not about anything found inside it. Why Android warns about this APK, and exactly what to tap walks through both screens.

2 The first thing you see - a splash with a clock

Launching the app opens on its own startup splash instead of a bare window: the four-arrow logo arrives in the same blue as the launcher icon, growing into place rather than fading, with the app name and the line "..All mine, here!" beneath it, in the language of your device.

Underneath the logo, the current time counts by the second, in your device's own 12- or 24-hour style and time zone - so it reads exactly like your system clock, not like a stopwatch the app started on its own. The splash lasts exactly as long as the app takes to start: if it is ready sooner, the splash is gone sooner, and it disappears together with the clock the moment the app opens. On a first launch that goes straight to the welcome wizard, this splash is skipped - there is nothing yet to jump ahead of.


12:00
Fast Media Sorter
..All mine, here!

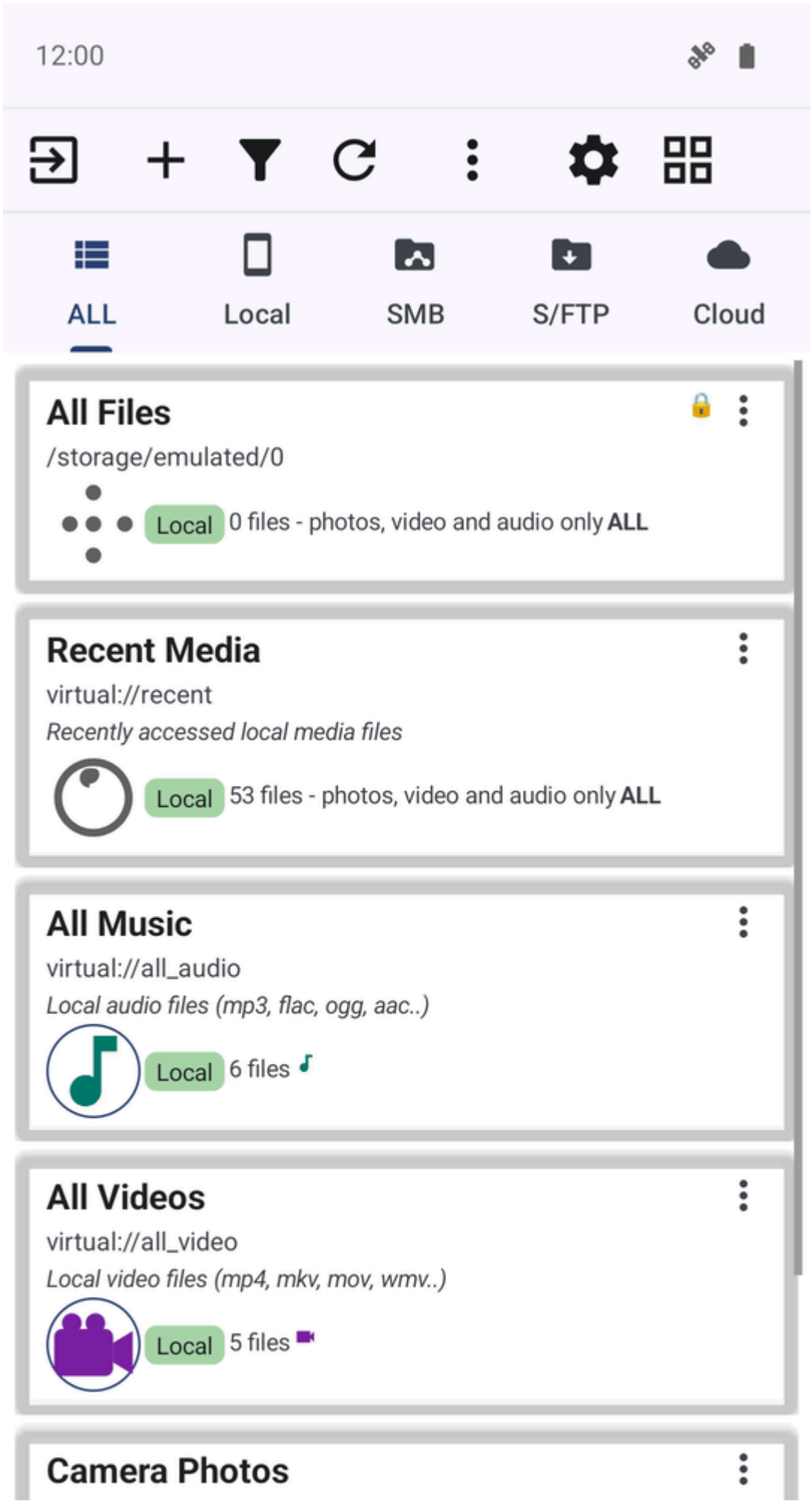


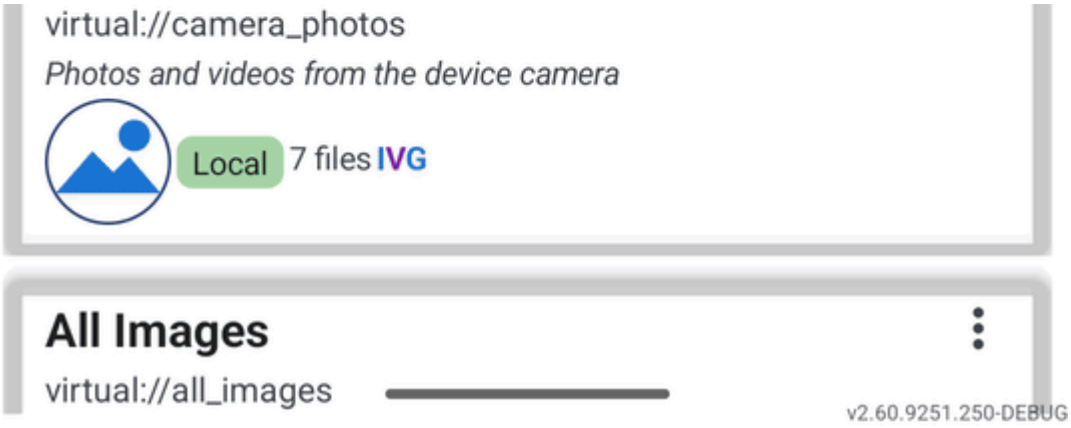
The startup splash, with the clock running underneath it.

3 Behind the splash - a fast, honest start

A few things happen while that splash is up, or right after it, that you notice as an absence of problems rather than as a feature: the first thumbnail grid does not stall, because the image loader is built on a background thread instead of on the main thread during your first photo load. The app itself does not stall either, because its file-transfer preferences open on first use instead of while the main screen is still being built.

And on a completely fresh install, the built-in collections on the main screen - All Music, All Videos, All Images, Camera Photos and Recent Media - already show their real file counts instead of a row of zeros. FastMediaSorter fills those virtual resource counts in on its own, in the background, at startup, so you do not have to open each one or run a manual rescan just to find out there is anything in it.


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
/storage/emulated/0
Local 0 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
Recent Media
virtual://recent
Recently accessed local media files
Local 53 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
All Music
virtual://all_audio
Local audio files (mp3, flac, ogg, aac..)
Local 6 files
All Videos
virtual://all_video
Local video files (mp4, mkv, mov, wmv..)
Local 5 files
Camera Photos



A fresh install, with real counts already on the built-in collections.

4 A quick look around, by role

Page 1 of the welcome wizard pitches FastMediaSorter as a handful of roles rather than a feature list, and this documentation site is organized the same way. Once you have looked around the main screen, here is where each role's own recipes live:

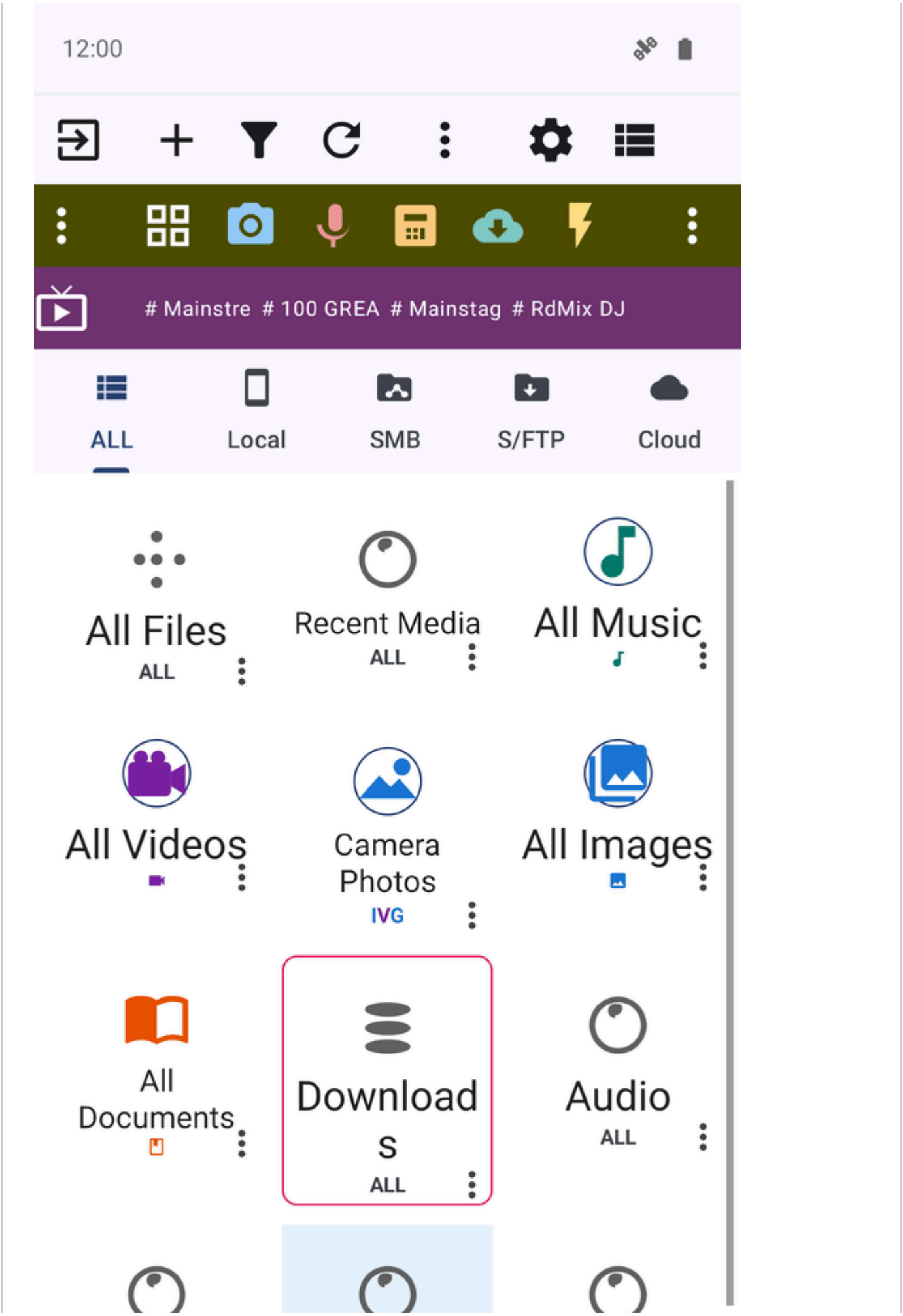
- **File manager** - browsing, sorting and file operations start at grid and list views and copy, move and delete.
- **Player** - photos and GIFs in the image viewer, video in playback controls, and music in playing and organizing.
- **Any source** - local, network and cloud folders start at storage sources setup and Windows network shares.
- **Streams**, on the editions that carry it - begins at the channel catalog.
- **More** - the desktop launcher, the watch app, the VR headset, and the full Settings map all branch off from here, alongside the seven editions compared.

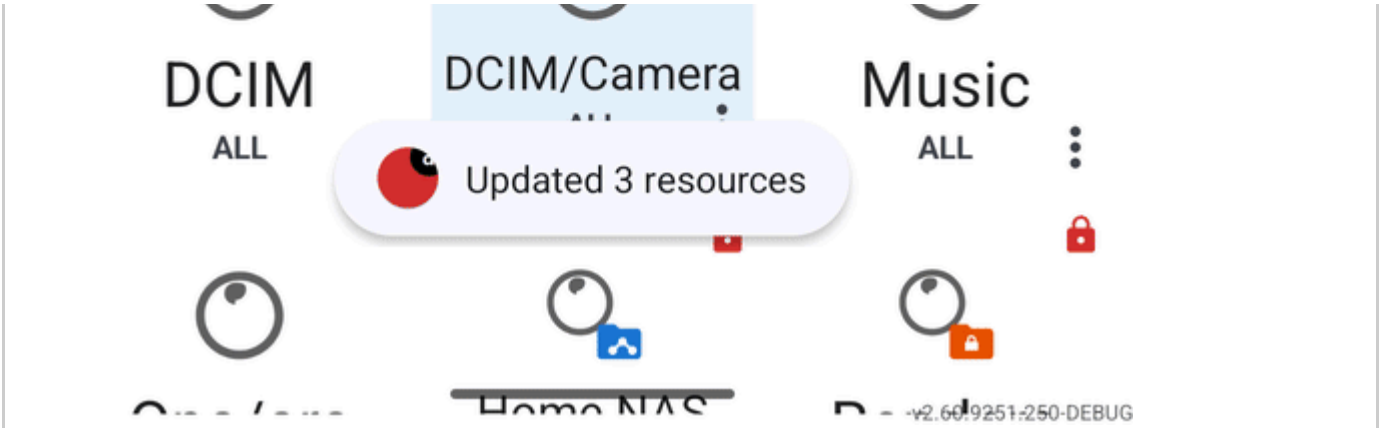
> **The watch trusts what the phone trusts**
>
> If you pinned an SFTP server's host key on the phone, the watch app enforces that same pin: a server presenting a different key is refused before your password is ever sent. The pin travels with the source, so there is nothing to set up on the watch itself - see watch companion data sync.

5 Bring in folders from your Windows PC

If you run Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows on the same network, you do not have to type in a server address by hand: scan its QR code, or open the `.fmscfg` file it hands you, and FastMediaSorter adds those PC folders as SFTP resources in one step.

Import the same file again later – say, after sharing one more folder on the PC – and it does not create duplicates. It recognizes a resource it already has by its server and folder path and updates that one instead, then shows a short toast telling you what happened: "Added: " or "Updated: " when exactly one resource changed, a combined count when several did, or "Resources already up to date" when nothing did.


12:00
Mainstre # 100 GREA # Mainstag # RdMix DJ
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Download
s
ALL
Audio
ALL



Re-importing a companion file updates the matching resource instead of duplicating it.

What You Get

You have the app installed, you know what that first splash is telling you, your built-in collections already show real numbers, and you have a map of which recipe to read next for whatever you actually came here to do - browse files, watch something, or bring in a folder from another machine.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The splash is honest about timing.** It stays up exactly as long as startup actually takes - a faster phone sees it for less time, not a fixed animation length.
- **No servers, no analytics.** FastMediaSorter has no backend of its own; nothing about how you use the app is sent anywhere without your say-so. See the privacy policy for the specifics.
- **Re-importing a companion file is always safe.** It only adds or updates the resources that changed - it never leaves you with two copies of the same PC folder.
- **Skipped the wizard by accident?** It is one tap away from Settings any time - see first launch and setup wizard.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GETTING STARTED

First launch and setup wizard

GETTING STARTED

Storage and system permissions

Language, theme, device profile, sources, permissions and your default player, page by page.

Every permission FastMediaSorter can ask for and what it unlocks.

GETTING STARTED

Navigating the main workspace

A full tour of the main screen you land on after setup.

EDITIONS

Seven editions compared

Which edition carries which capability, and how to tell them apart.

s and Capabilities

EDITIONS, EXTENSIONS & LANGUAGES | All editions | RECIPE #01

The Seven Editions of FastMediaSorter

FastMediaSorter comes in seven editions. They look and work the same, but each one is made for a certain kind of device or store. This page shows what each edition is for, which features it has, where to get it and how to move between them.

Why You'll Love This

FastMediaSorter is published in seven editions. They share the same look and the same way of working, but each one is made for a certain kind of device or store. A phone, an old tablet, a VR headset and a phone without Google services each get the edition that fits them best.

This page helps you pick the right edition before you install it, and tells you what to do if you later want a different one. If you already have the app and only want to know which edition it is, jump to step 3.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- An Android phone, tablet, TV box, car head unit or VR headset.
- Its Android version. You find it in the phone's own **Settings**, usually under **About phone** or **Software information**. Most editions need Android 8 or newer; the Legacy and FOSS editions also run on Android 6 and 7; the VR edition needs Android 10 or newer.
- About 100 MB of free space for the app itself, and more for your media.

1 Meet the seven editions

Here is what each edition is for, in one sentence each.

- Standard edition - the recommended full edition for phones, tablets, TVs and car head units. If you are not sure, take this one.
- Lite edition - a lighter edition that plays local photos, videos and music only, without network folders, cloud storage, documents or Streams.
- Photos edition - for pictures only, with network folders and cloud storage but without video, audio, documents or Streams.
- Legacy edition - for older Android devices, starting from Android 6, with most Standard features but without the launcher and the watch companion.
- FOSS edition - the open-source edition published in F-Droid, built without any closed-source parts.
- VR edition - for VR headsets such as Meta Quest, with the full media set and immersive mode for 3D and 360-degree files.
- noLegal edition - a sideload-only edition, installed from an APK file outside the app stores. It has everything the Standard edition has, plus a few extras that stores do not allow.

> **Not sure? Start with Standard**
>
> The Standard edition has the widest set of features and the easiest updates through Google Play. You can always move to another edition later without losing your settings - see step 5.

2 See what each edition can and cannot do

Every edition shows pictures and lets you browse, copy, move and sort files. The differences are in the extras. The list below is taken from the edition table that is generated from the app itself, so it is always exact.

- **Video and music** - in every edition except Photos.
- **Network folders** (SMB, FTP and SFTP) - in every edition except Lite.
- Cloud storage (Google Drive, Dropbox, OneDrive) - in Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR. Not in Lite and FOSS.
- **Documents and e-books** (PDF, EPUB and text files) - in Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR and FOSS. Not in Lite and Photos.
- **Streams** (internet radio and TV channels) and recording from the microphone - in Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR. Not in Lite, Photos and FOSS.
- **Text translation** - in Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR. Not in Lite, Photos and FOSS.
- **Playing music in the background** after you leave the player - in every edition except Lite and Photos.
- Chromecast, sending a video or photo to your TV - in Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos and Legacy. Not in VR and FOSS.
- **The** launcher (FastMediaSorter as your home screen), the Network Monitor and the watch companion - in Standard and noLegal only.
- Live Broadcast of your camera or microphone to other devices - in Standard, noLegal and Legacy.
- **Immersive VR playback** of 3D and 360-degree video - in the VR and noLegal editions.
- **Opening files from other apps** (FastMediaSorter as the default player) - in every edition except Lite.

  A feature that an edition does not have is not hidden behind a lock or a payment. It simply is not there: no menu item, no button and no setting for it.

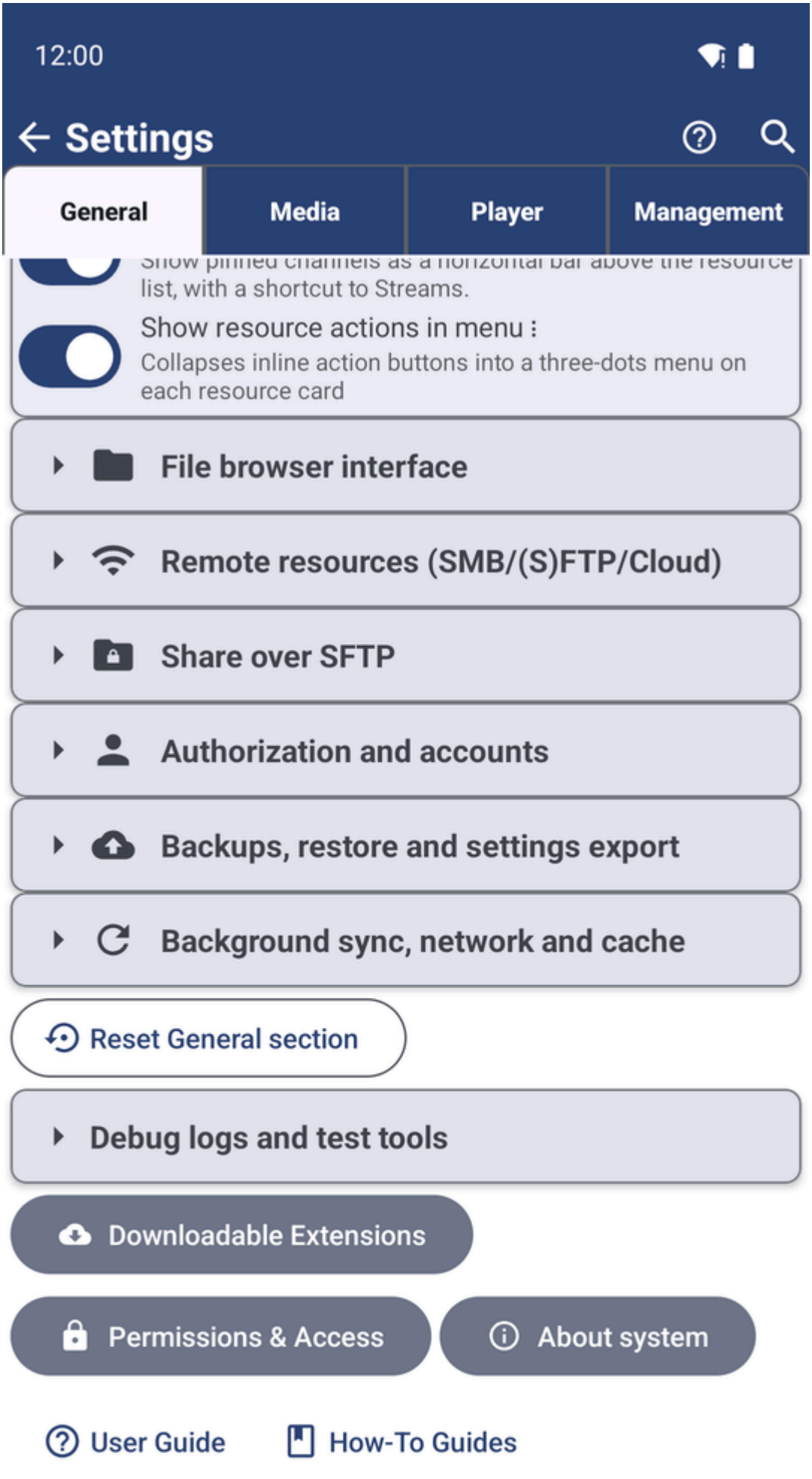
3 Find out which edition you have

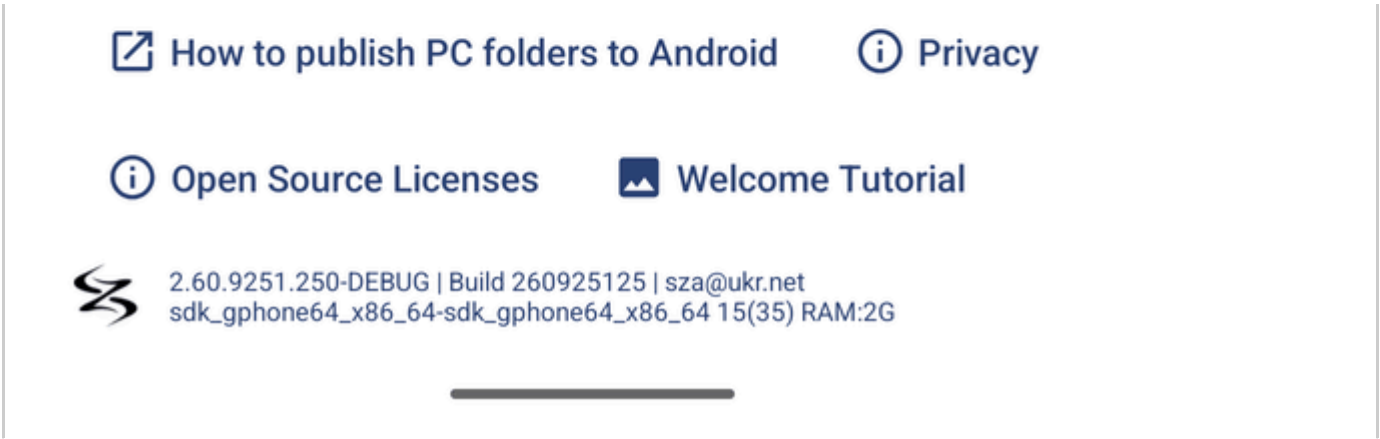
Open **Settings** and stay on the **General** tab. Scroll to the very bottom. The last line shows the version, the build number and the support address, for example `2.5.0-Lite | Build 250 | ...` (your numbers will differ).

The end of the version tells you the edition:

- nothing after the number - Standard edition;
- `-Lite`, `-Photos`, `-Legacy`, `-FOSS`, `-VR` or `-NoLegal` - the edition with that name.

The same information is in **Settings**, **General**, **Statistics**: the technical part of the report has an **Edition** row and an **App version** row. The Edition row uses the short internal name, such as `standard`, `photos` or `noLegal`.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
list, with a shortcut to Streams.
Show resource actions in menu :
Collapses inline action buttons into a three-dots menu on each resource card
File browser interface
Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)
Share over SFTP
Authorization and accounts
Backups, restore and settings export
Background sync, network and cache
Reset General section
Debug logs and test tools
Downloadable Extensions
Permissions & Access
About system
User Guide
How-To Guides



The version line at the bottom of Settings, General.

⚠ Some editions replace each other

The Lite, Photos, Legacy and FOSS editions are separate apps: each has its own icon and can live next to the Standard edition on the same phone. The Standard, VR and noLegal editions are the same app to Android, so installing one of them over another replaces it. Your files are never touched, and your settings usually stay, but a backup first costs nothing - see step 5.

4 Get the edition you want

Each edition has its own place to download it from.

- **Standard** – Google Play ↗, or the APK file from the latest GitHub release ↗.
- **Lite, Photos and Legacy** – the APK files from the latest GitHub release ↗. The same files are also kept in a Google Drive mirror as ZIP archives, for networks that block APK downloads.
- **VR** – the APK file from the same GitHub release, installed on the headset.
- **FOSS** – the F-Droid ↗ catalog.
- **noLegal** – its own download page on the FastMediaSorter website. It is never published in a store.

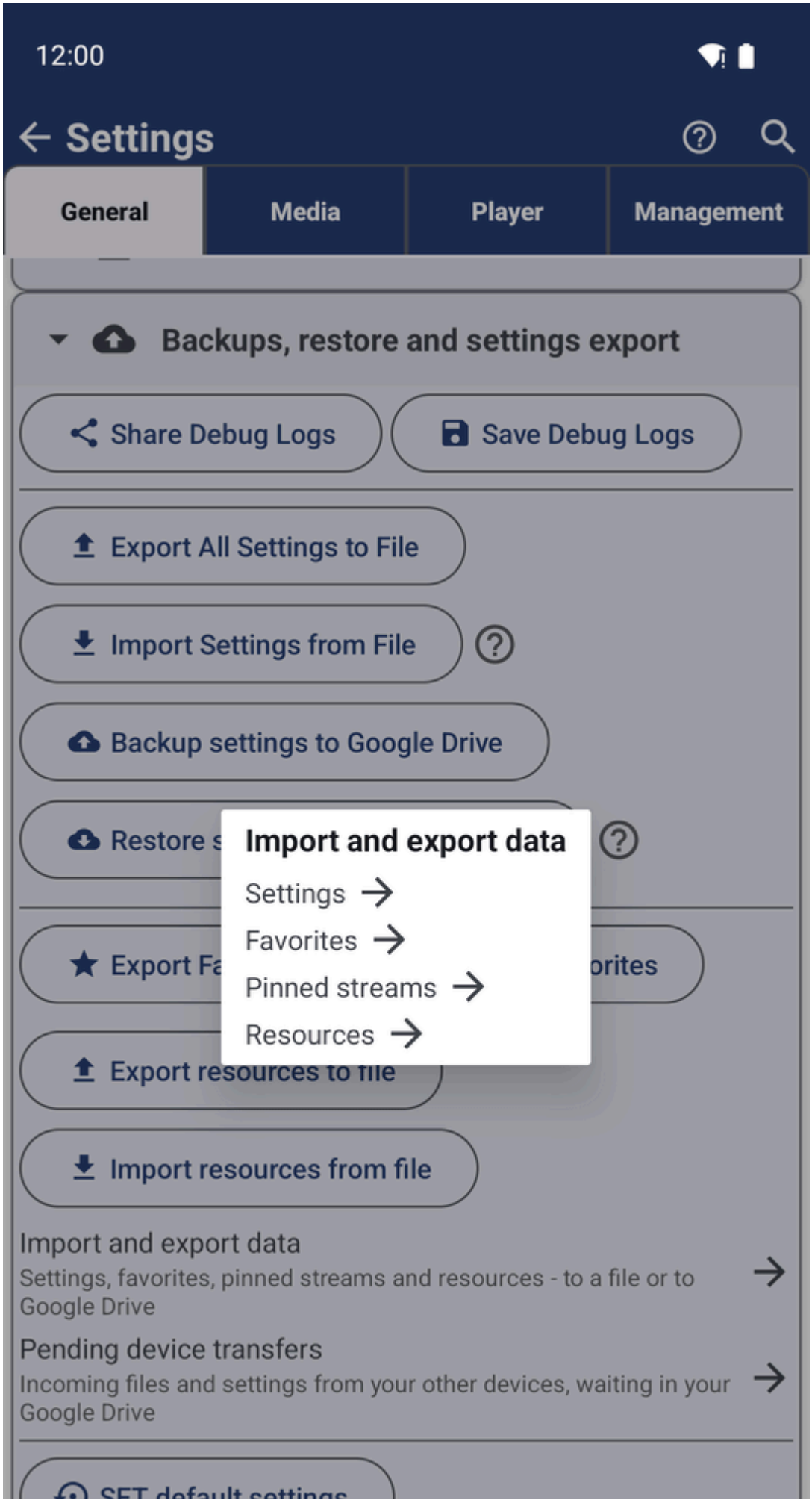
  When you install an APK file yourself, Android asks whether you trust the source. That is normal for every app that does not come from a store: allow it once for the browser or file manager you are installing from. The Android help page on unknown apps ↗ explains this screen. If Android shows a warning about the package, this page explains why and what to tap.

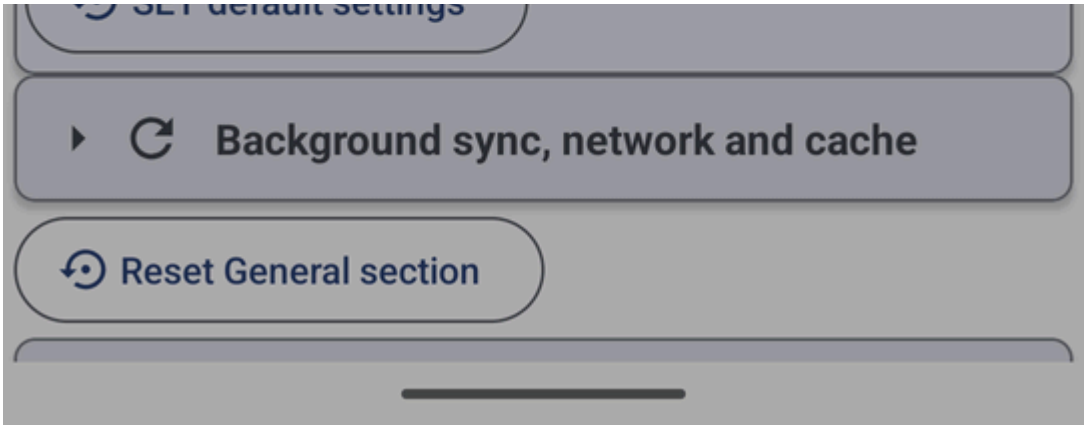
5 Move your settings to another edition

Before you switch, save your settings to a file, then load that file in the new edition.

1. In the edition you have now, open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and tap **Import and export data**.
2. Tap the kind of data to take with you: **Settings**, **Favorites**, **Pinned streams** or **Resources**. One kind moves at a time, so repeat these steps for each one you need.
3. Tap **Export – Device file** or **Export – Google Drive**, and save.
4. Install the new edition and open it.
5. In the new edition, go to the same place, **Import and export data**, tap the same kind, then **Import – Device file** or **Import – Google Drive**, and pick the file you saved.

   Everything the new edition also supports comes back: your resources, your favorites, your chosen units and the rest of your settings. What the new edition does not have – for example cloud resources in the Lite edition – is simply skipped. The full guide is in Backing up and restoring settings.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Backups, restore and settings export
Share Debug Logs
Save Debug Logs
Export All Settings to File
Import Settings from File
Backup settings to Google Drive
Restore s
Import and export data
Settings
Favorites
Pinned streams
Resources
Export Fa
orites
Export resources to file
Import resources from file
Import and export data
Settings, favorites, pinned streams and resources - to a file or to Google Drive
Pending device transfers
Incoming files and settings from your other devices, waiting in your Google Drive



The Import and export data dialog.

What You Get

You know which edition fits your device, where to get it, which features it brings, how to check which one is installed, and how to carry your settings over when you change your mind.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The FOSS edition from F-Droid** is built from source without any closed-source library. It keeps local media, network folders (SMB, FTP, SFTP), documents, EPUB, animations, background audio and the default player, and it has no cloud storage, casting, watch pairing, translation or text recognition - those leave no button, row or widget behind. It installs next to a copy from Google Play or a sideloaded copy instead of replacing it.
- **No install prompt in the VR edition.** Opening 3D content in the VR edition plays it straight away - the app no longer asks you to install the VR edition you are already running.
- **An old tablet refuses to install the app?** If it runs Android 6 or 7, take the Legacy or the FOSS edition instead - they are made for exactly that.
- **A feature from another page is missing on your phone?** Check step 2. Every page of this guide also names the editions each feature is in, near the top.
- **Some features need a download.** Text recognition, extra audio formats and a few other parts are downloaded only when you want them. See Downloadable extensions.
- **The app is in the wrong language?** See Choosing the app language and units.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

EDITIONS

Downloadable extensions

Add text recognition, extra audio formats and background videos only when you need them.

EDITIONS

Choosing the app language and units

Pick one of thirteen languages and switch between metric and US units.

GETTING STARTED

First launch and the setup wizard

What happens the first time you open the app, step by step.

EDITIONS, EXTENSIONS & LANGUAGES | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #02

Downloadable Extensions - Add Features Only When You Need Them

Extensions are optional parts of FastMediaSorter that you download only when you need them: text recognition, extra audio formats, background videos and stream catalogs. This page shows how to download, update and delete them.

Why You'll Love This

Some parts of FastMediaSorter are big and only a few people need them: the engine that reads text in pictures, the models for Russian and Ukrainian letters, a decoder for rare audio formats, looping videos behind your music. Packing all of them into the app would make it heavier for everybody.

So these parts are extensions: you download each one only when you want it, and delete it again when you need the space. Until you download an extension, the rest of the app works exactly as before.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

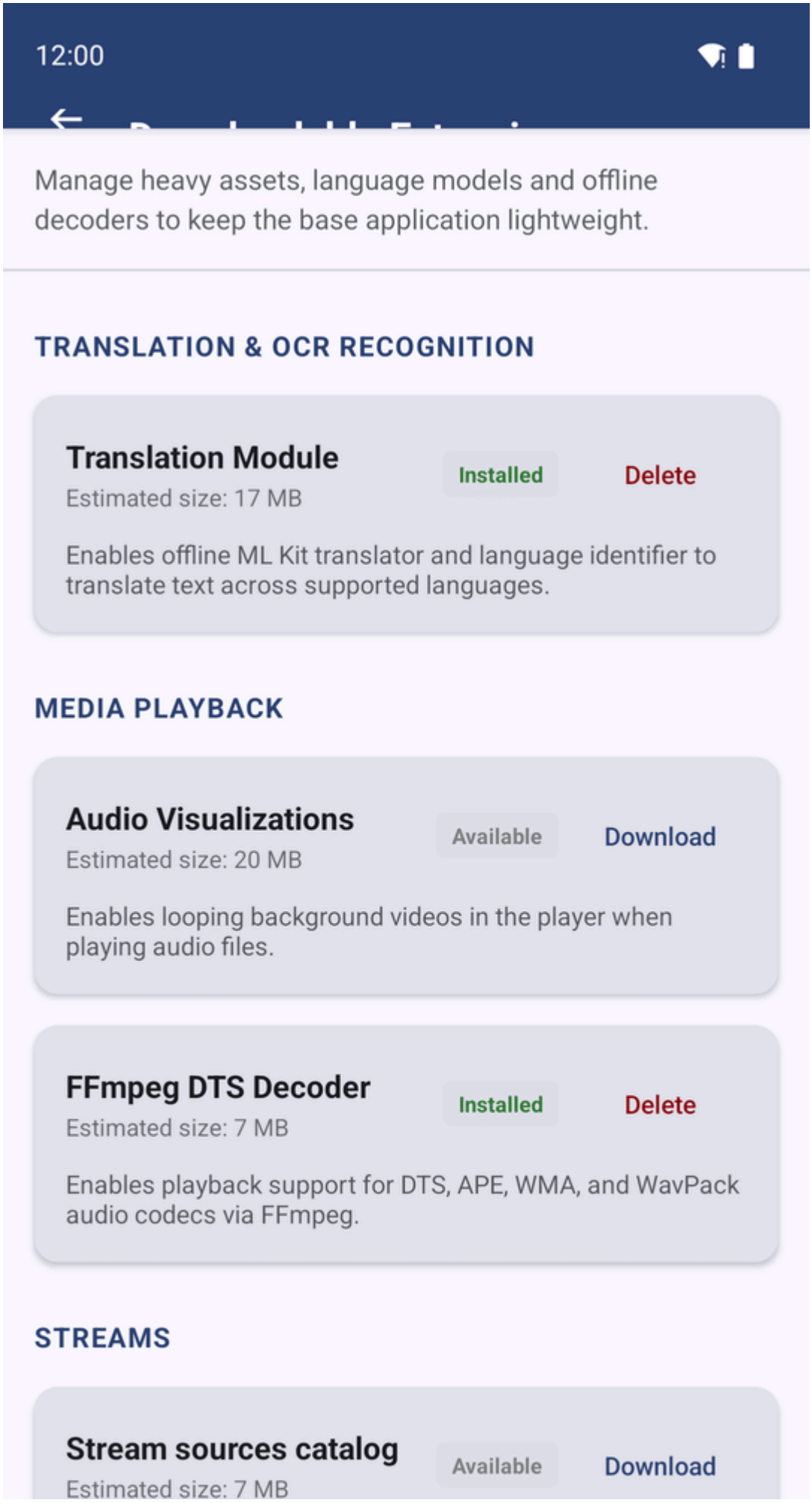
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition. The Lite, Photos and FOSS editions have no extensions screen, because the features the extensions add are not part of those editions. See The seven editions.
- An internet connection. Wi-Fi is best: the largest extension is about 44 MB.
- Some free space on the phone. Each row of the screen shows how much the extension needs.

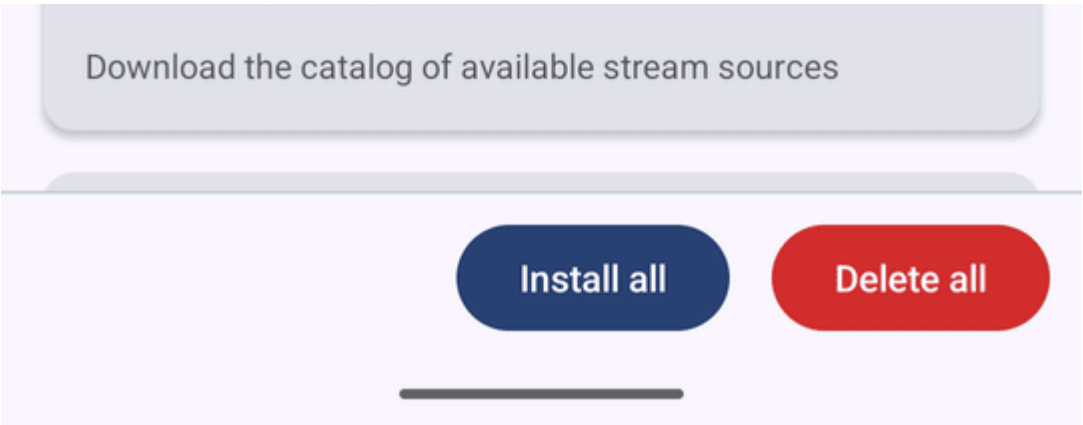
1 Open the Downloadable Extensions screen

Open **Settings**, stay on the **General** tab, and tap **Downloadable Extensions**. The screen opens with a short note at the top and a list of extensions below it, grouped under **Translation & OCR recognition**, **Media playback** and **Streams**.

There are two more ways to reach the same screen:

- **Settings**, the **Media** tab, the **Translation, digitization (OCR)** section, the row **OCR & translation downloads**.
- The page about features in the first-launch wizard.


12:00
Manage heavy assets, language models and offline decoders to keep the base application lightweight.
TRANSLATION & OCR RECOGNITION
Translation Module
Estimated size: 17 MB
Installed
Delete
Enables offline ML Kit translator and language identifier to translate text across supported languages.
MEDIA PLAYBACK
Audio Visualizations
Estimated size: 20 MB
Available
Download
Enables looping background videos in the player when playing audio files.
FFmpeg DTS Decoder
Estimated size: 7 MB
Installed
Delete
Enables playback support for DTS, APE, WMA, and WavPack audio codecs via FFmpeg.
STREAMS
Stream sources catalog
Estimated size: 7 MB
Available
Download



The Downloadable Extensions screen.

2 Know what each extension adds

Each row has a name, a short description, the **Estimated size** and a status on the right: **Available**, **Downloading**, **Installed**, **Failed** or **Update ready**.

- **OCR Engines** - the text-recognition engine that reads text from pictures and documents without the internet. You need it for text recognition.
- **Russian OCR Model** and **Ukrainian OCR Model** - better recognition of Russian and Ukrainian text. Download the one for the language of your documents.
- **Translation Module** - translates recognized text between languages on the phone itself. See Translating extracted text.
- **FFmpeg DTS Decoder** - plays audio in the DTS, APE, WMA and WavPack formats, including the DTS sound track of many movies.
- **Extended Video Playback** - plays video files and disc images the built-in player cannot open.
- **Audio Visualizations** - looping background videos that the audio player shows behind a track that has no cover picture.
- **Stream sources catalog**, **Channel preview atlas** and **Station logos** - the list of Streams to choose from, and the pictures shown for them in the grid. See Browsing the channel catalog.

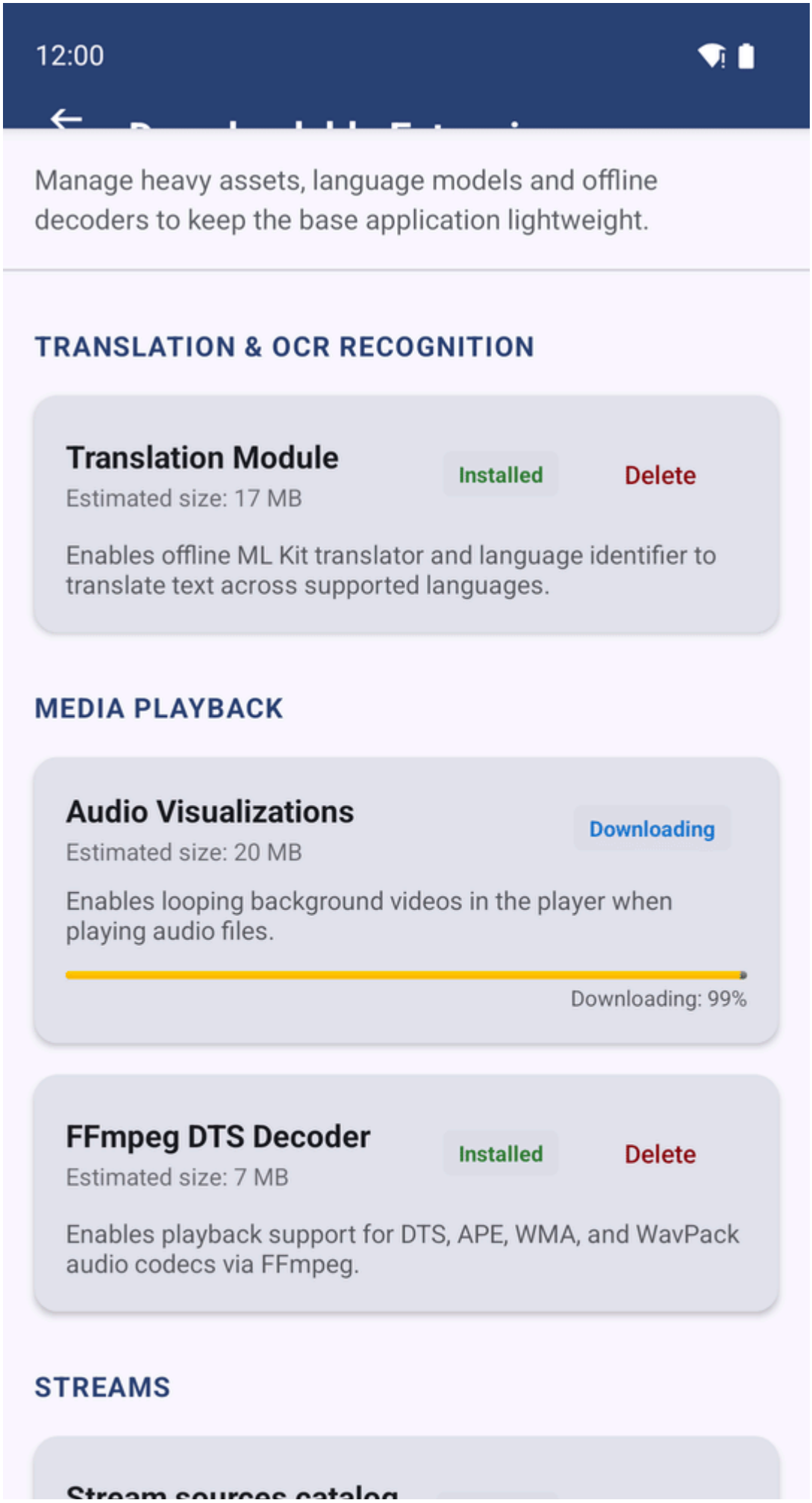
  The screen shows only the extensions that your edition and your device can use. The OCR rows, for example, appear only on a device with a recent enough Android and enough memory to run text recognition. If a row you read about here is missing, your edition or your device does not have that feature.

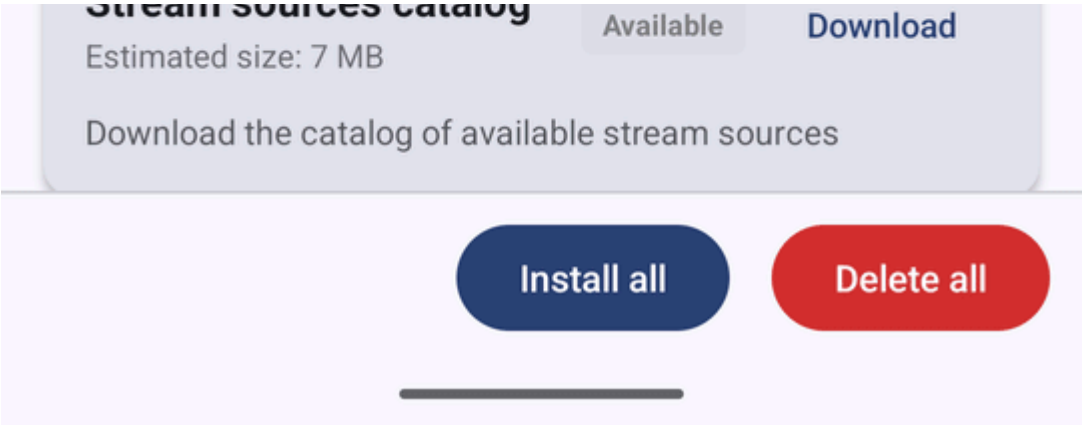
3 Download an extension

Tap **Download** on the row you want. The status changes to **Downloading** and a progress bar with the percentage appears in the row, for example "Downloading: 40%". You can leave the screen: the download goes on, and the row shows the right status when you come back.

Before an extension is marked **Installed**, the app checks that the downloaded file is complete and exactly the one it expects. A broken or interrupted download ends as **Failed**; tap **Download** again to retry.

To get everything at once, tap **Install all** at the bottom of the screen. The app downloads every extension that is not installed yet.


12:00
Manage heavy assets, language models and offline decoders to keep the base application lightweight.
TRANSLATION & OCR RECOGNITION
Translation Module
Estimated size: 17 MB
Installed
Delete
Enables offline ML Kit translator and language identifier to translate text across supported languages.
MEDIA PLAYBACK
Audio Visualizations
Estimated size: 20 MB
Downloading
Enables looping background videos in the player when playing audio files.
Downloading: 99%
FFmpeg DTS Decoder
Estimated size: 7 MB
Installed
Delete
Enables playback support for DTS, APE, WMA, and WavPack audio codecs via FFmpeg.
STREAMS



An extension being downloaded, with its progress in the row.

Nothing breaks if you say no

You never have to download an extension. Without it, only the feature it adds is missing; everything else works as before. When you later try to use that feature, the app offers the download again.

4 Keep your extensions up to date

A downloaded extension stays until you delete it. It survives app updates, and it is not removed when you or the phone clear the app's cache.

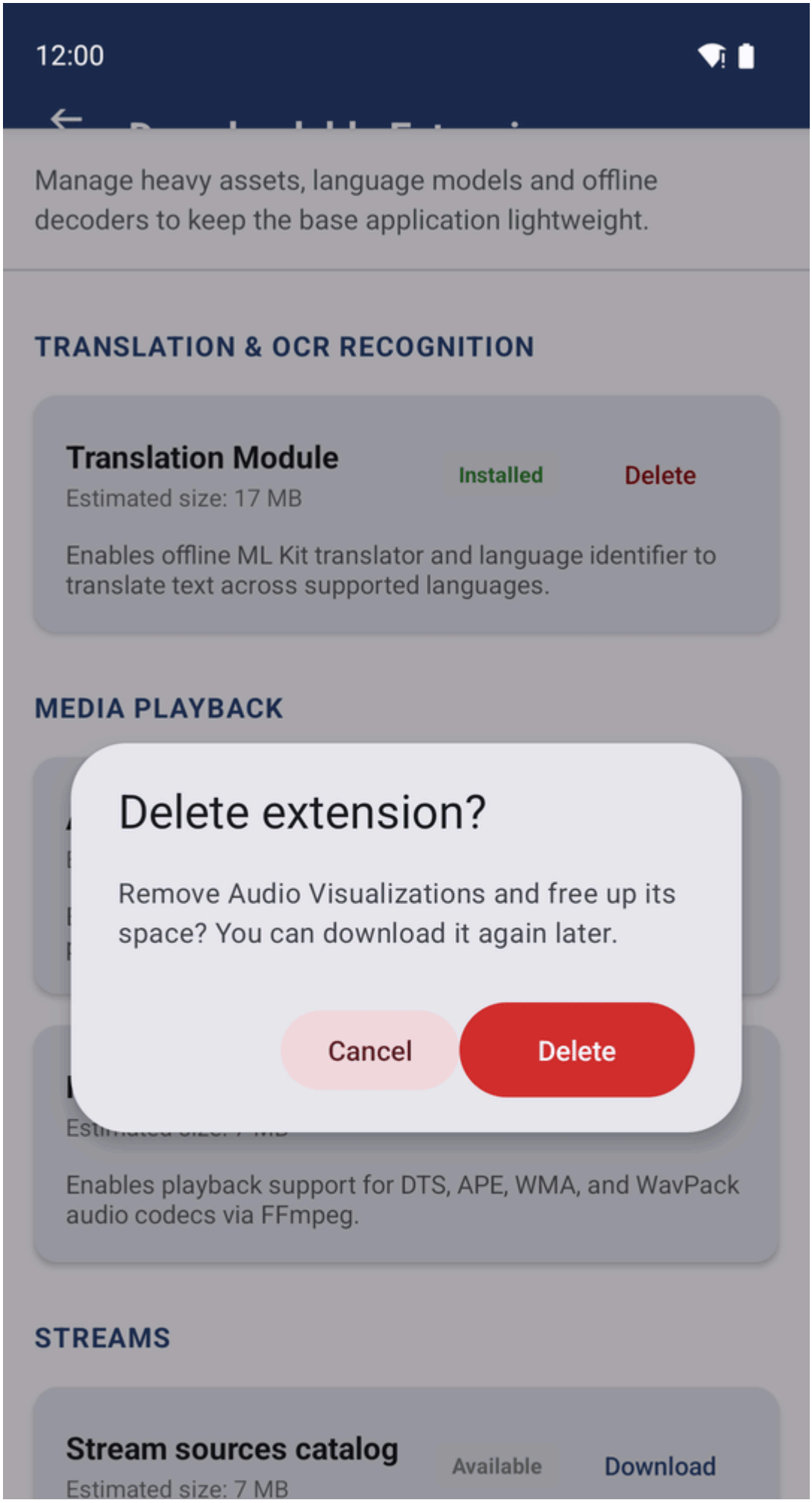
Sometimes a newer copy of an extension is published - a better model, a longer catalog, fresh station logos. Then the status of its row changes to **Update ready**. The old copy keeps working until you tap **Download** to take the new one.

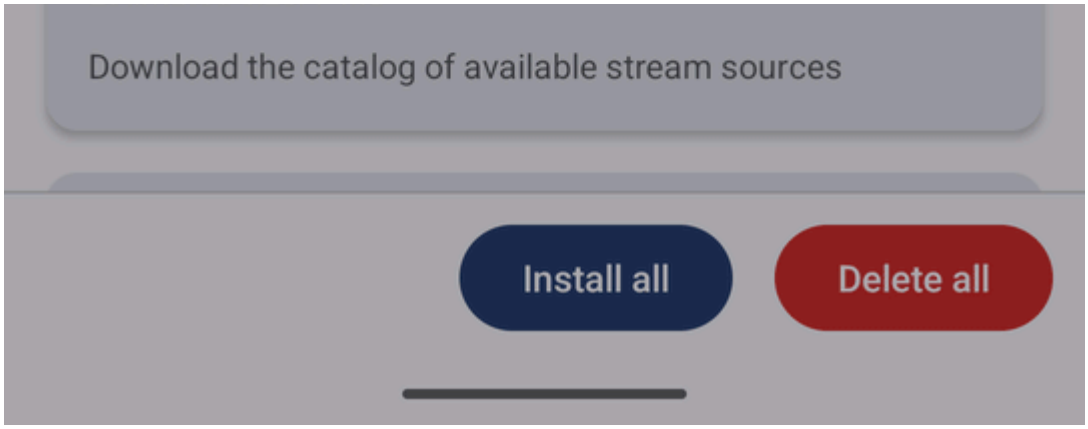
For the Streams rows, the size is measured on the file that is actually published, so the number you see is what you will download. Without an internet connection the row shows an estimate instead.

5 Delete extensions to free space

Tap **Delete** on an installed row. The app asks "Delete extension?" and explains that you can download it again later. Confirm, and the space is free again.

To remove all of them at once, tap **Delete all** at the bottom of the screen and confirm "Delete all extensions?".


12:00
Manage heavy assets, language models and offline decoders to keep the base application lightweight.
TRANSLATION & OCR RECOGNITION
Translation Module
Estimated size: 17 MB
Installed
Delete
Enables offline ML Kit translator and language identifier to translate text across supported languages.
MEDIA PLAYBACK
Delete extension?
Remove Audio Visualizations and free up its space? You can download it again later.
Cancel
Delete
Enables playback support for DTS, APE, WMA, and WavPack audio codecs via FFmpeg.
STREAMS
Stream sources catalog
Estimated size: 7 MB
Available
Download



Deleting an extension asks for confirmation first.

6 Play video files the built-in player cannot open (noLegal edition only)

Only in the noLegal edition, the sideload version installed from an APK file.

The noLegal edition has one more row under **Media playback**: **Extended Video Playback**. It adds a second video engine that plays video files and disc images the built-in player cannot open. It is a one-time download of about 44 MB.

You can download it from this screen in advance, or simply open a video that does not play: the app then offers the same download on the spot.

What You Get

The app stays light, and you add exactly the extras you use - text recognition in your languages, rare audio formats, background videos, stream catalogs - and remove them again whenever you need the space.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **On mobile data?** Download the large extensions later over Wi-Fi. Their size is shown in each row before you tap anything.
- **Moving to another edition?** Extensions are not part of a settings backup. Download them again in the new edition from the same screen. See The seven editions.
- **Text recognition reads Cyrillic badly?** Download the **Russian OCR Model** or the **Ukrainian OCR Model** - the basic engine alone recognizes those letters less accurately.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

TOOLS

Extracting text with offline OCR

Turn the text in a photo or scanned page into text you can copy.

EDITIONS

The seven editions

Which edition has which features, and how to move between them.

EDITIONS

Choosing the app language and units

Pick one of thirteen languages and switch between metric and US units.

EDITIONS, EXTENSIONS & LANGUAGES | All editions | RECIPE #03

Choosing the App Language and Units

FastMediaSorter speaks thirteen languages and shows times, distances and temperatures in metric or US units. This page shows how the app picks its language, how to change it, and how to choose your units.

Why You'll Love This

An app is easiest to use in your own language, with distances, temperatures and times written the way you are used to. FastMediaSorter speaks thirteen languages and can show everything either in metric units with a 24-hour clock or in US units with a 12-hour clock.

Usually you do not need to do anything: the app starts in the language of your phone. This page is for the moments when you want something else - the app in English on a phone set to German, or miles on a phone that shows kilometers.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Language and units work the same in all seven.
- An internet connection, only if you installed the app from Google Play and pick a language the phone has not used before: the app then downloads that language first.

1 Let the app pick your language on the first start

On the first start, FastMediaSorter looks at the list of languages in your phone's settings and takes the first one it speaks. Many people have more than one language in that list, for example Catalan first and Spanish second. FastMediaSorter does not speak Catalan, so it starts in Spanish - not in English.

The app speaks these thirteen languages: English, Arabic, Bengali, Chinese (Simplified), French, German, Hindi, Italian, Portuguese, Russian, Spanish, Ukrainian and Urdu.

If none of the languages in your phone's list is among them, the app starts in English. You can change it at any time, as step 2 shows.

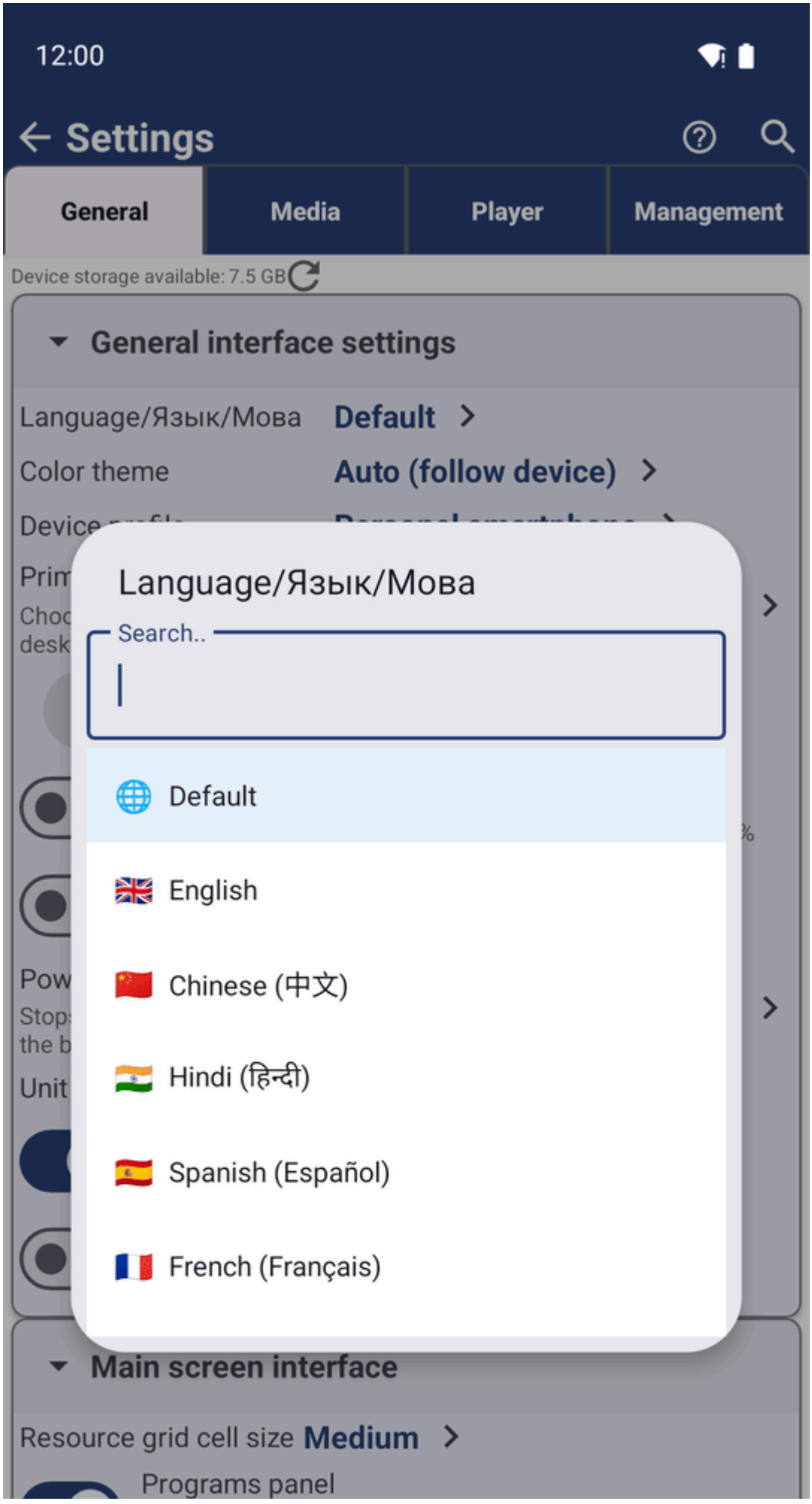
Change the order on the phone

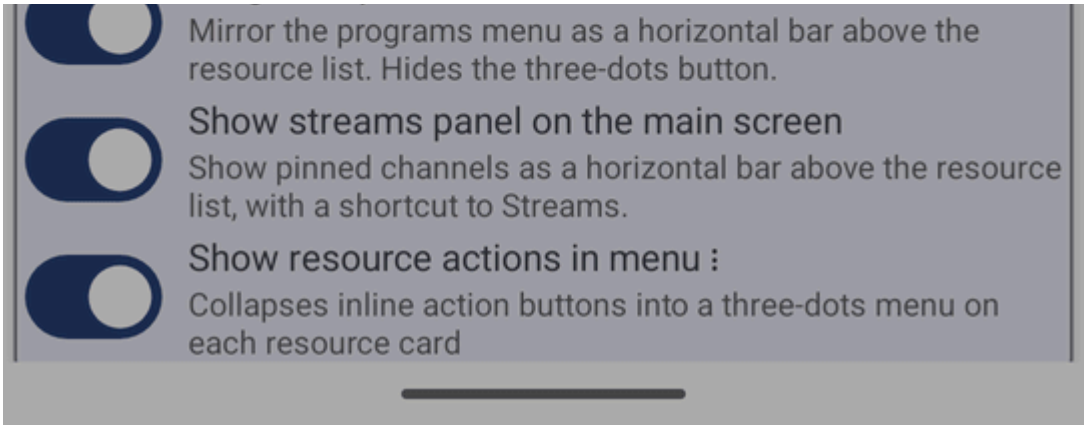
The list of phone languages is in the phone's own **Settings**, under **System** and **Languages** on most phones. Move the language you want to the top, and apps that follow the list use it. The Android help page on app languages ↗ shows where to find it on your phone.

2 Switch the app to another language

1. Open **Settings**, stay on the **General** tab, and open **General interface settings**.
2. Tap **Language/Язык/Мова**. The row carries its name in three languages on purpose, so that you can find it even when the app speaks a language you cannot read.
3. A list of languages opens. Type the first letters of a language to find it faster, then tap it.
4. The app asks **Restart Application**: to apply the new language, it has to restart. Tap **Restart**.

   The app closes and opens again in the new language, on the same screen of Settings. Your resources, favorites and settings stay as they were.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Device storage available: 7.5 GB
General interface settings
Language/Язык/Мова
Default
Color theme
Auto (follow device)
Language/Язык/Мова
Search..
Default
English
Chinese (中文)
Hindi (हिन्दी)
Spanish (Español)
French (Français)
Main screen interface
Resource grid cell size
Medium
Programs panel



The language list, opened from Settings, General.

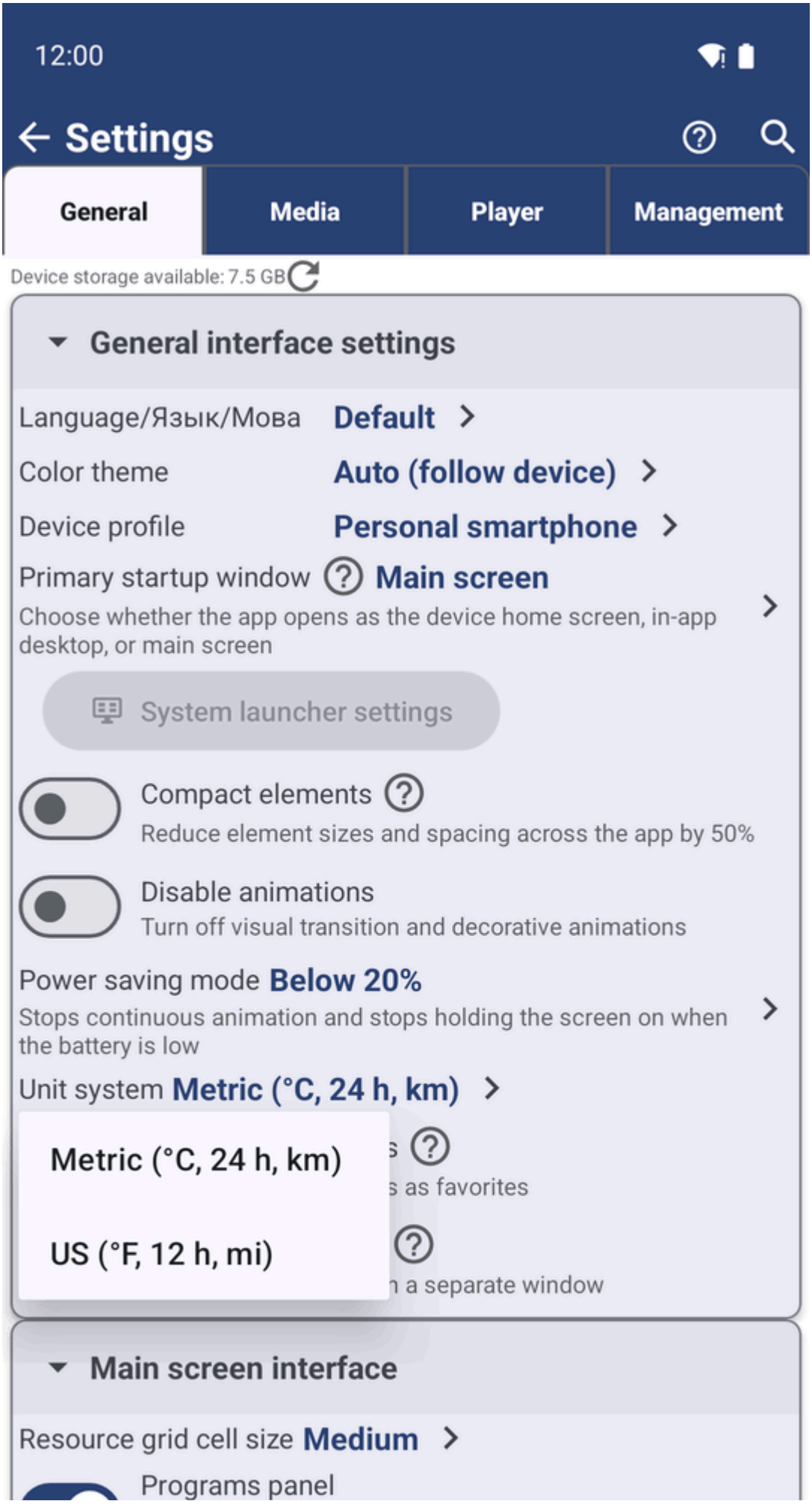
Buttons speak the app's language too

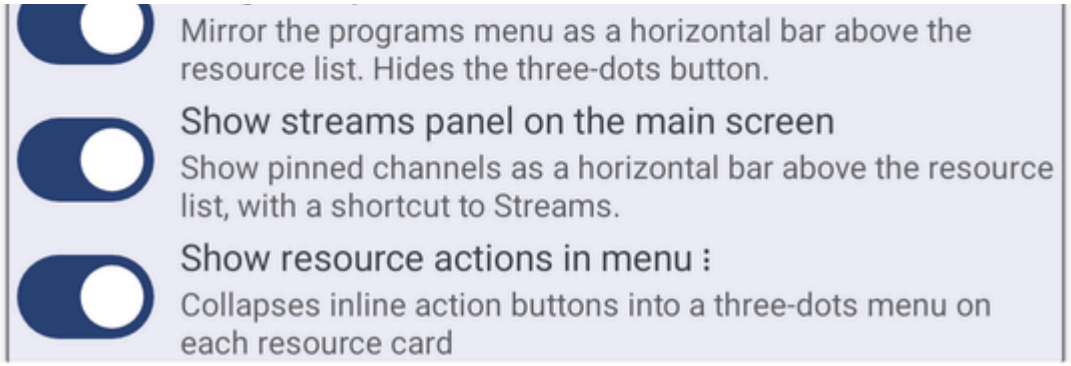
Every Cancel and confirm button in the app, and on the watch, uses the app's own language - even when the phone is set to another one. You never get a dialog in English with buttons in German.

3 Choose metric or US units

1. Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, **General interface settings**.
2. Tap **Unit system**.
3. Choose **Metric (°C, 24 h, km)** or **US (°F, 12 h, mi)**.
   The change applies at once, on every screen of the phone and the watch.

- **Metric** shows a 24-hour clock, dates as year-month-day, degrees Celsius, meters, kilometers and kilometers per hour.
- **US** shows a 12-hour clock with AM and PM, dates as month-day-year, degrees Fahrenheit, feet, miles and miles per hour.
  This one setting wins over the phone's own 24-hour switch, so the app always shows the clock the way you chose here.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Device storage available: 7.5 GB
General interface settings
Language/Язык/Мова
Default
Color theme
Auto (follow device)
Device profile
Personal smartphone
Primary startup window
Main screen
Choose whether the app opens as the device home screen, in-app desktop, or main screen
System launcher settings
Compact elements
Reduce element sizes and spacing across the app by 50%
Disable animations
Turn off visual transition and decorative animations
Power saving mode
Below 20%
Stops continuous animation and stops holding the screen on when the battery is low
Unit system
Metric (°C, 24 h, km)
Metric (°C, 24 h, km)
US (°F, 12 h, mi)
Main screen interface
Resource grid cell size
Medium
Programs panel



The Unit system choice in Settings, General.

4 See where the units appear

The unit system is used wherever the app shows a time, a distance, a speed or a temperature. The places you notice it most:

- the **Tourist** dashboard with its speed, altitude, trip distance, sunrise and sunset, weather and dew point - on the phone and as cards on the watch;
- the measurement history of the Network Monitor, where every row is stamped with its time;
- the weather and clock gadgets of the launcher and the widgets on your home screen.

When you move to another edition with a settings file, your unit choice comes with you. See The seven editions.

What You Get

The app speaks your language - picked from your phone's list on the first start, or chosen by you from thirteen - and shows every time, distance and temperature in the units you are used to.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Started in the wrong language and cannot read the menus?** Open **Settings** and look for the row with **Язык** and **Мова** in its name - it is the language row in every language.
- **The language download failed?** The app shows a short message and stays in its current language. Check the internet connection and pick the language again.
- **Switched to US units but the phone shows a 24-hour clock?** That is expected: the app follows its own **Unit system**, not the phone's clock setting.
- **Want the app in a language that is not in the list?** It is not available yet; the app keeps the closest language from your phone's list, or English.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

EDITIONS

The seven editions

Which edition has which features, and how to move between them.

EDITIONS

Downloadable extensions

Add text recognition in Russian and Ukrainian, and other extras, when you need them.

SETTINGS

Navigating and searching Settings

Find any setting in a few taps, or by typing its name.

ng and Sorting

BROWSING & SORTING | All editions | RECIPE #01

Browsing Media Collections

The file browser is where every resource opens: switch between grid and list, move through subfolders with a single path button, see every file with File Manager Mode, check details or lock a resource down, and reach removable drives, archives and documents that hand off to another app.

Why You'll Love This

Every resource opens into the same screen: the file browser. Whether it holds twelve photos or twelve thousand, this is where you look at what is actually inside a folder, step into subfolders, and decide what to do with each file. Knowing your way around it - the view switch, the toolbar, the menus tucked into a single button - saves you a search every time you open a resource.

Nothing on this page changes your files by itself. Turning on a setting or opening a menu only changes how the screen shows you what is already there.

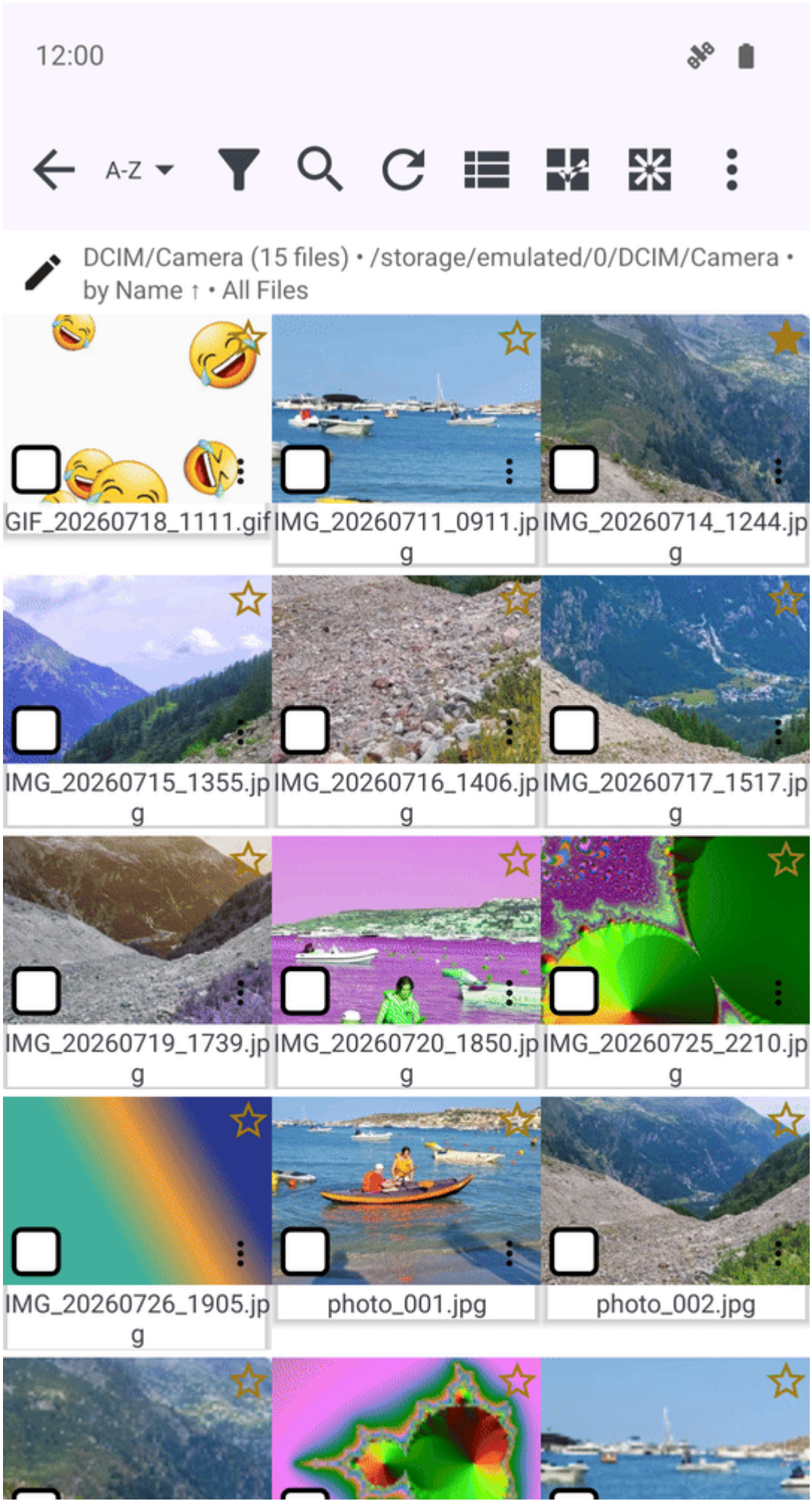
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

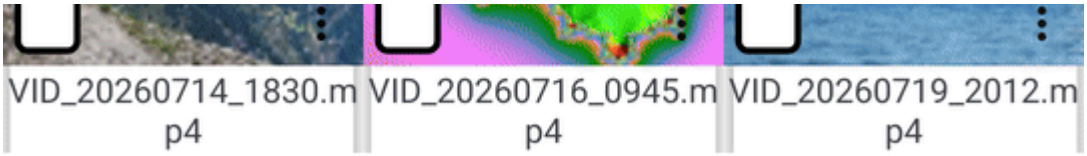
- FastMediaSorter installed. The file browser is part of every editi on: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- At least one reso urce added, so there is something to open. See Configuring local and removable storage if you have not added one yet.
- Installing an app straight from Browse works only in the sideload noLegal edition.

1 Open a resource and choose grid or list

Tap a resource on the main screen to open it in the file browser. Tap **View** in the toolbar to switch the whole folder between grid view, with a picture tile for every file, and list view, with one line per file and more room for text. Audio-only resources always stay in list view, since there is no picture to show. Your choice is remembered separately for every resource.

Under each thumbnail or name, a second line fills in with whatever detail matters most for that file: the resolution and date taken for a photo, the resolution and length for a video, the artist and title for a song, and the size and date for everything else.


12:00
A-Z
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Name ↑ • All Files
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
IMG_20260714_1244.jpg
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
IMG_20260720_1850.jpg
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
photo_001.jpg
photo_002.jpg



A folder open in grid view, with a thumbnail for every file.

2 Move through subfolders with the path button

When a resource is set to look inside subfolders, folders show up as regular rows or tiles you can tap into. The current folder's name sits in a single button at the top of the screen instead of a row of names that would grow every time you go one level deeper. Tap it to open a menu listing every folder in the path, from the resource itself down to where you are now, and tap any one of them to jump straight there.

On a long list, small buttons appear on the side to jump to the top or the bottom, or to move one screen at a time; they only show up once the list is actually long enough to need them.

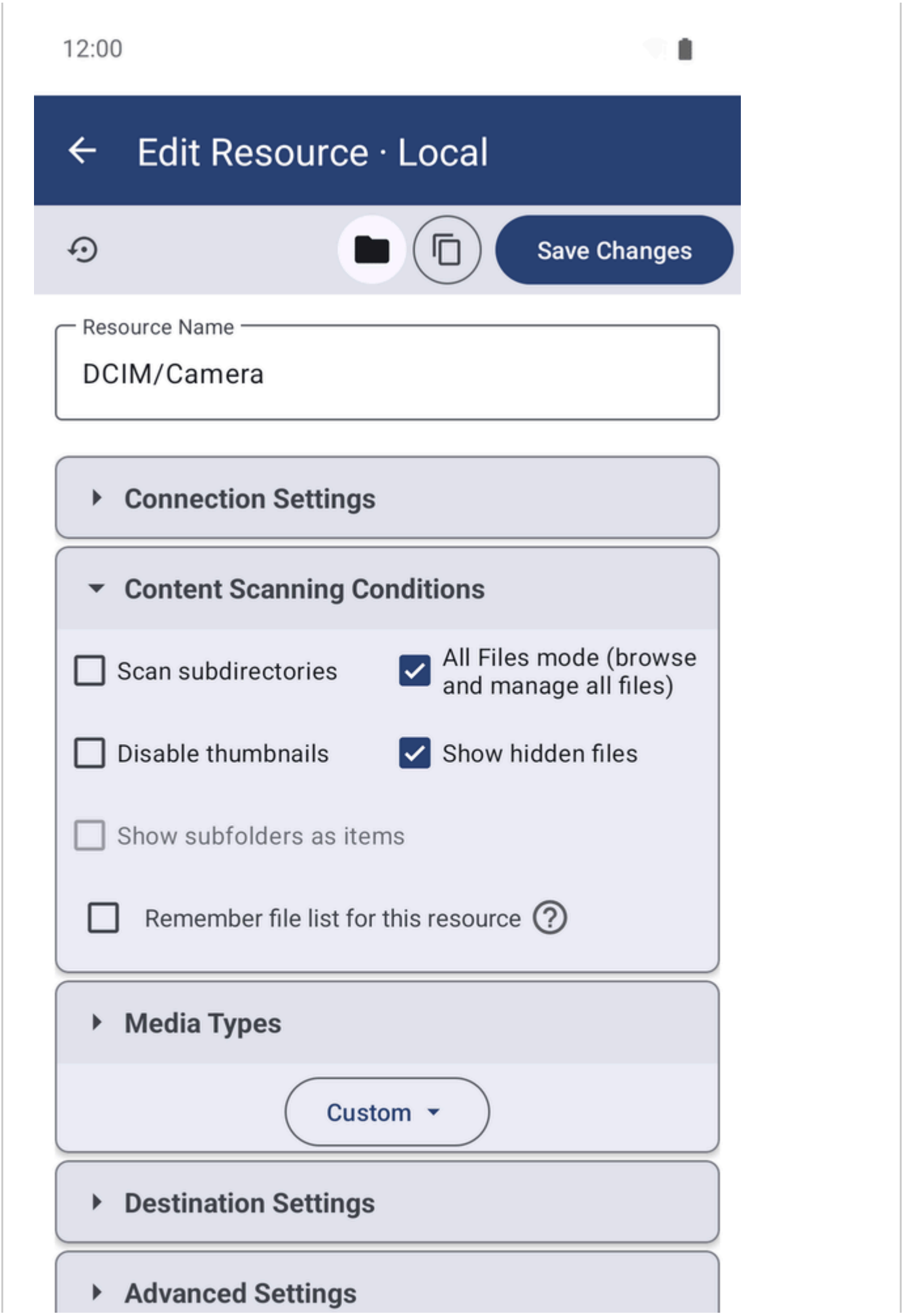
Coming back to where you were

The file browser keeps a back-navigable trail of the folders you opened, so the device back button steps you out one level at a time instead of leaving the resource in one tap.

3 See every file with File Manager Mode

By default a resource shows only the kinds of files it is set up for - pictures in a photo folder, for instance. To see everything in a folder, including files the app does not otherwise recognize, open the resource for editing and turn on **File Manager Mode**. The file browser then lists every file type in that folder, overriding whatever media filter the resource normally uses.

With File Manager Mode on, a second switch appears: **Show hidden files** reveals files and folders whose name starts with a dot, which stay invisible otherwise. Android can still keep some app-specific folders out of reach even with both switches on.


12:00
Edit Resource · Local
Save Changes
Resource Name
DCIM/Camera
Connection Settings
Content Scanning Conditions
Scan subdirectories
All Files mode (browse and manage all files)
Disable thumbnails
Show hidden files
Show subfolders as items
Remember file list for this resource
Media Types
Custom
Destination Settings
Advanced Settings

File Manager Mode and Show hidden files in the resource editor.

4 Add a folder or a quick drawing without leaving Browse

Tap **Create Folder** in the toolbar to add a subfolder right where you are - on local storage, an SMB or S/FTP share, or a cloud resource alike; the button is hidden on a read-only resource. The three-dots menu also offers **Create drawing**, which opens a blank page in the drawing editor and saves the picture straight into the current folder - handy for a quick sketch or a note without switching apps.

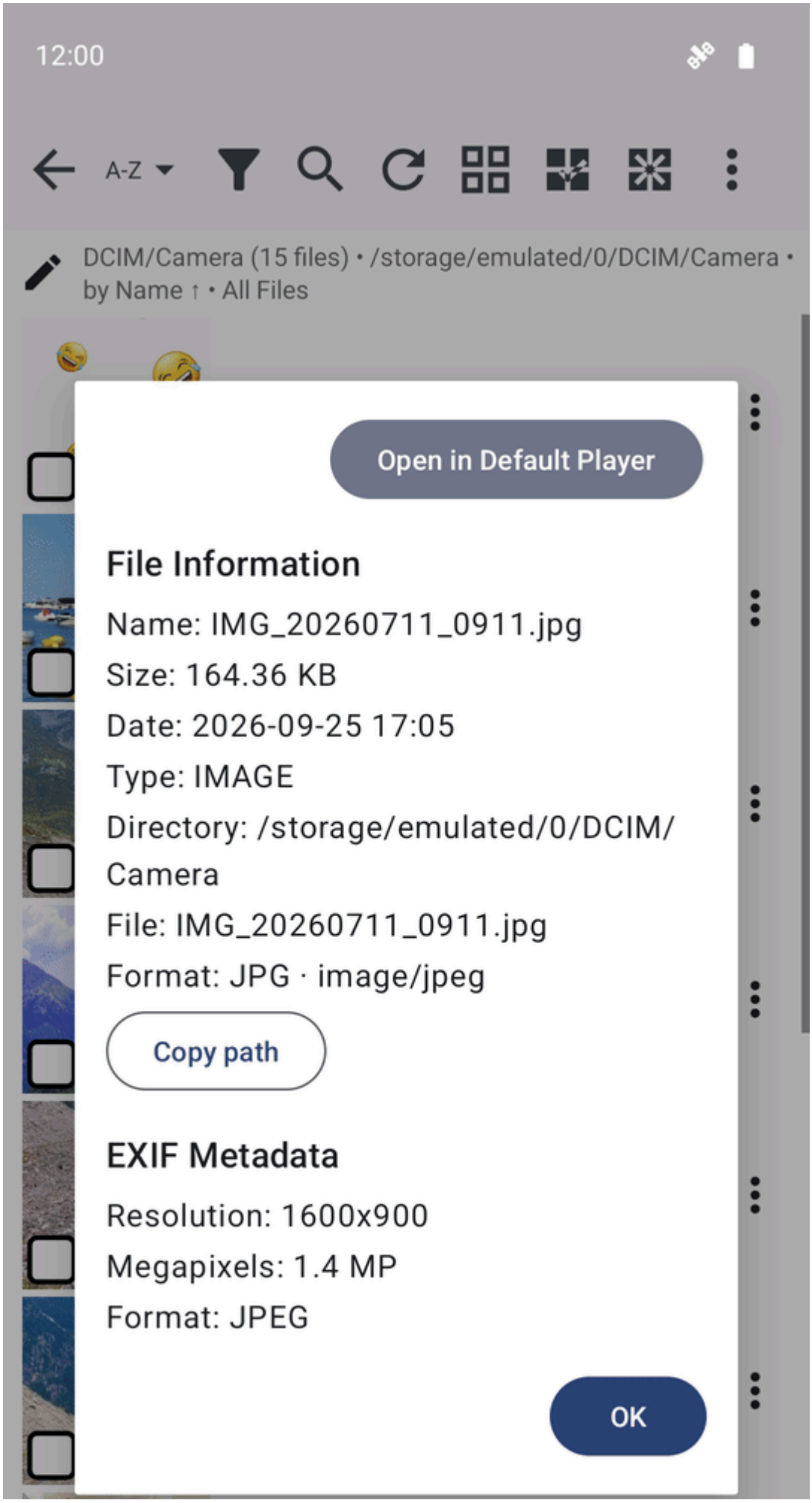
Settings, one tap away

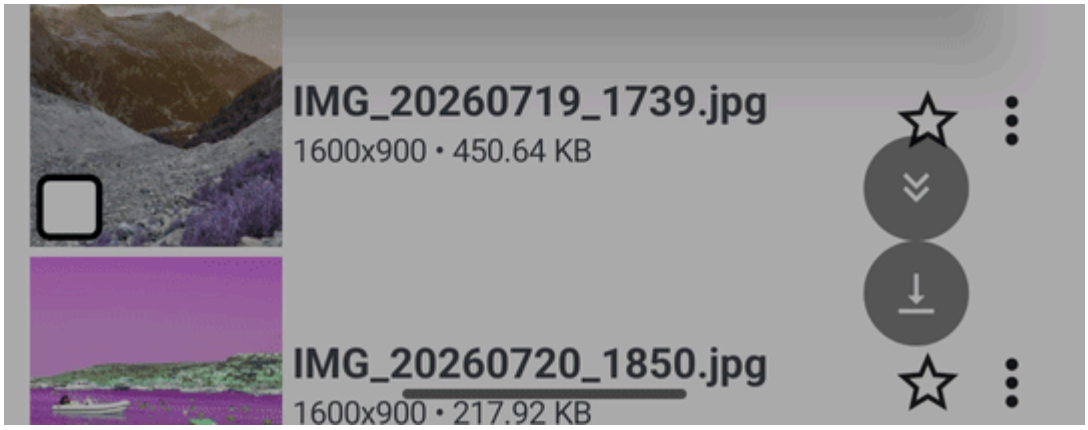
The same three-dots menu has an App settings entry at the bottom, so you can adjust a setting mid-browse and come straight back instead of returning to the main screen first.

5 Check a file's details and mark your favorites

Open the three-dots menu on any file and choose its details entry to see a bottom sheet with everything the app knows about it - size, full path, and media or photo details such as resolution or camera settings where they apply.

Every row also carries its own star button: tap it to add or remove the file from Favorites on the spot, without opening the file first. The star updates immediately, right there in the list.


12:00
A-Z
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera •
by Name ↑ • All Files
Open in Default Player
File Information
Name: IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
Size: 164.36 KB
Date: 2026-09-25 17:05
Type: IMAGE
Directory: /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/
Camera
File: IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
Format: JPG · image/jpeg
Copy path
EXIF Metadata
Resolution: 1600x900
Megapixels: 1.4 MP
Format: JPEG
OK



The file details bottom sheet, open for a photo.

6

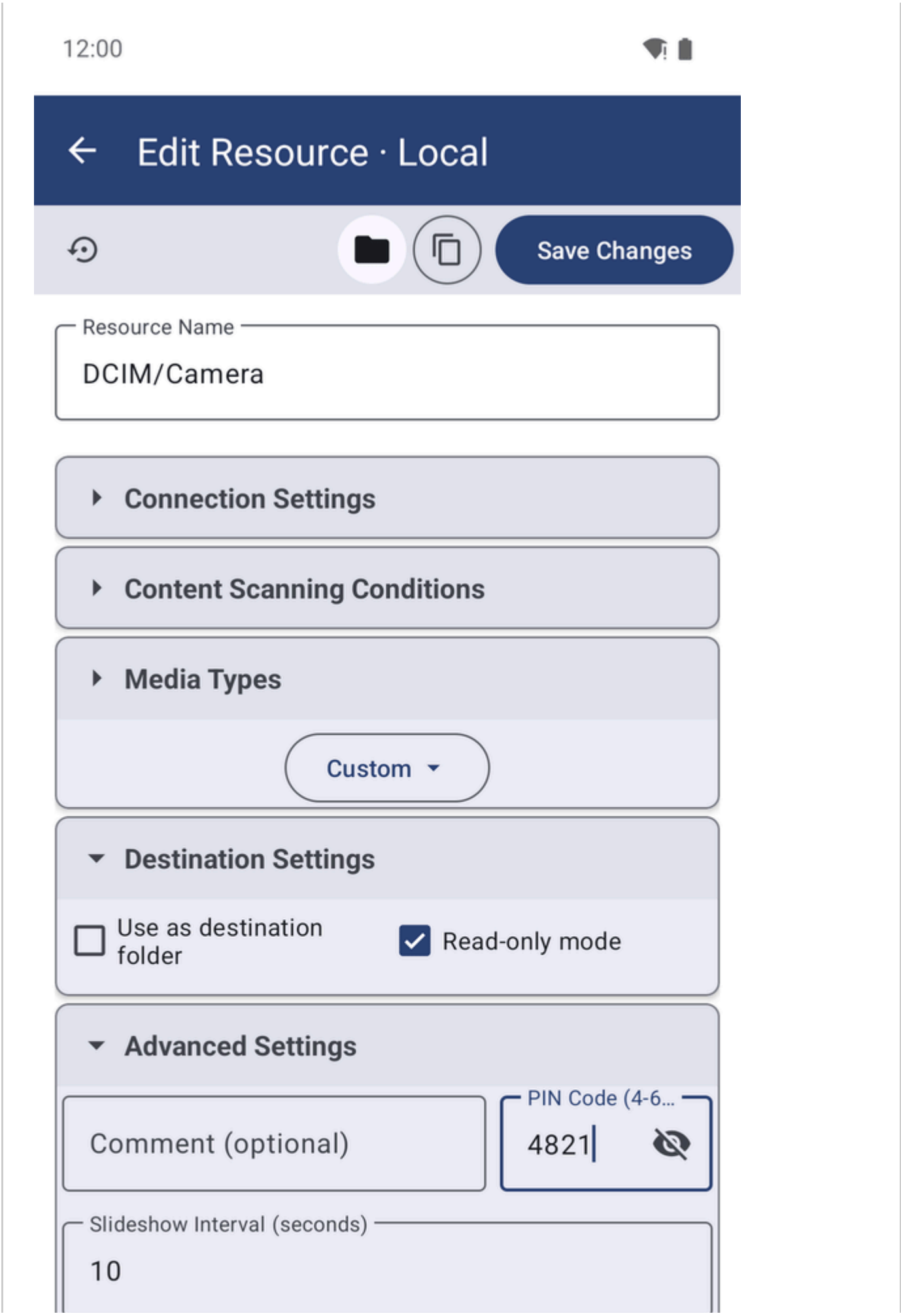
Play a song without opening the full player

In a music folder, tap the play button on a track's row to start it right there in the list, without opening the full audio player first. Playing a track from a network share downloads it to a local cache as it plays and quietly fetches the next track ahead of time, so the music does not stop between songs.

7 Lock a resource with read-only mode or a PIN

Two settings on a resource keep it from changing by accident. Turn on **Read-only mode** in the resource editor and every button that copies, moves, renames or deletes a file disappears from that resource; anything that tries anyway is stopped with a clear message.

Set a PIN - four to six digits, called **Access PIN** in the resource editor - and the file browser asks for it every time before that resource opens, with a small lock shown on its row on the main screen. This PIN only protects the resource inside the app; it has nothing to do with your device's own lock screen.


12:00
Edit Resource · Local
Save Changes
Resource Name
DCIM/Camera
Connection Settings
Content Scanning Conditions
Media Types
Custom
Destination Settings
Use as destination folder
Read-only mode
Advanced Settings
Comment (optional)
PIN Code (4-6...
4821
Slideshow Interval (seconds)
10

Access PIN and Read-only mode in the resource editor.

8 Shrink everything for a small screen

On a low-resolution phone or a device with a small display, go to **Settings** and turn on **Compact elements**. It scales the file list, the toolbar and their text down by about half, so more files fit on screen at once - the trade-off is that touch targets get smaller too. It applies across the file browser, not just one resource.

9 Removable drives, ZIP files and documents that open elsewhere

Plug in an SD card or a USB drive and it shows up in its own **Removable media** section when you add a folder, with its name and free space on the button. Confirm the volume once in the system dialog, and a resource on it browses, sorts and moves files exactly like built-in storage - a copy or move that will not fit is refused up front, naming which drive ran out of room.

Tap a ZIP file to extract it in place; a password-protected archive asks for the password first, and a wrong one or an unsupported protection is reported plainly rather than failing silently. Word, RTF, ODT and other office documents, along with protected PDFs, open by handing them to another app installed for that purpose - the row shows a small padlock when a PDF needs a password. Archives and disk images such as .iso, .7z, .rar and .dmg files carry their own registered file type too, so Open with and Share only offer apps that actually handle that format.

⚠ Seeing fewer files than you expect

Opened a folder without granting full storage access? A strip under the toolbar explains that only photos, video and audio show there. It appears once, the first time it happens, and stays out of your way after that.

10 Files with no picture of their own

A file the app cannot preview - not a picture, a document or an archive - still gets a bottom sheet of its own when you tap it, with Share, Open in, Copy, Move, Rename and Delete. When two such files start with the same name, their shared placeholder tile now has the file's own name written across it, so they no longer look identical at a glance; on the watch that name is drawn in white with a black outline so it stays readable over any tile.

11 On your watch too

The watch app can browse a network folder from your wrist, and it now keeps its listings honest: opening a network source under Music, Photos or Videos shows only that kind of file instead of everything mixed together, and file types such as .mkv or .flac that used to vanish from the list now show up. A network source with a folder saved on the phone opens straight to that folder on the watch too, instead of the whole server. The paired phone itself shows up on the watch as one resource, and it no longer lists the same file twice when it is reachable two different ways. Full detail: Browsing files on your smartwatch.

12 Install an app you downloaded (noLegal edition)

In the sideload noLegal edition, tapping an APK file in Browse hands it to the system installer, the same as tapping one from any other file manager. If the install is refused, Browse now says why - a newer version already on the device, a different signing key, not enough free space, or a damaged file - instead of one flat error. Leaving the screen while a cloud-downloaded APK is still downloading no longer reports a false failure; the download is simply dropped.

What You Get

You can open any resource straight into the view you prefer, move through subfolders with one button instead of a growing trail, see every file when you need to with File Manager Mode, check a file's details or lock a whole resource down, and reach removable drives, archives and documents that need another app - all from the same screen you already know.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A folder looked empty after coming back from the viewer, twice in a row?** The file browser re-checks the resource itself instead of trusting a stale list, so this now sorts itself out.
- **Preset resources such as All Images or Recent Media in the wrong language?** They pick up the app's current language the next time you launch, instead of up to 30 seconds later.
- **Want to change what a resource shows before you even open it?** See Sorting, filtering and quick search for sort order, filters and quick search.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

BROWSING

Sorting, filtering and quick search

Sort modes, shuffle, manual order, filters and the live search box.

BROWSING

Multi-selection and batch operations

Select several files at once and act on all of them together.

BROWSING

Thumbnail caching and indexing

Why folders open fast and stay accurate as files change.

BROWSING & SORTING | All editions | RECIPE #02

Sorting, Filtering and Quick Search

Put a resource in the order that suits it, narrow it down with a filter that stays with that resource, or jump straight to one file with live search - all from the same toolbar in the file browser.

Why You'll Love This

A folder that grew to a few hundred photos, downloads or recordings stops being useful the moment you cannot find anything in it. FastMediaSorter lets you put that folder in an order that makes sense - by name, by date, by size, or in whatever order you drag the files into yourself - and narrow it down to just the files you are looking for, without ever leaving the file browser.

None of this touches your files. Sorting, filtering and searching only change what you see and in what order; the files on disk stay exactly where and as they were.

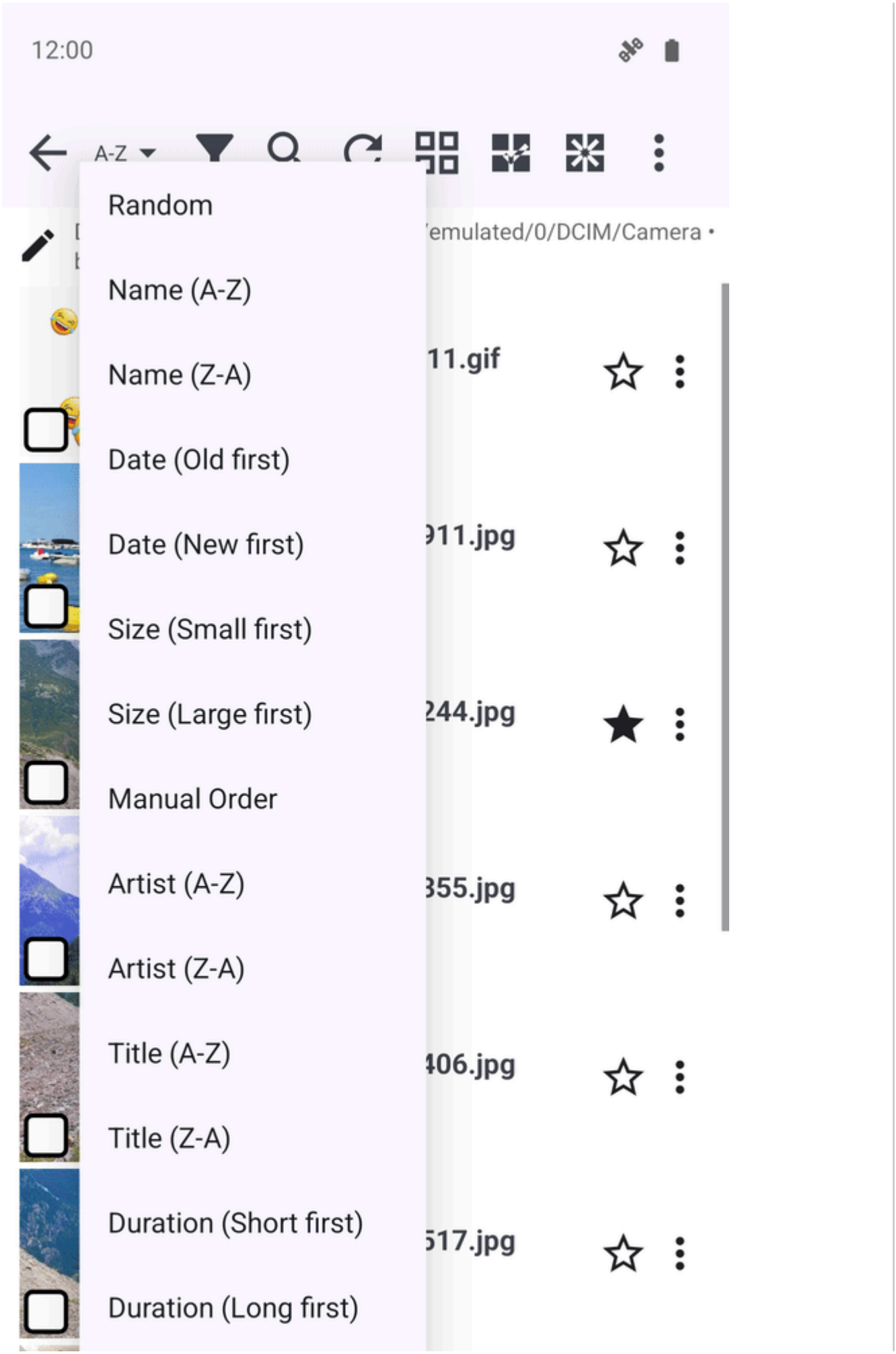
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed, with a resource open in the file browser.
- Sort modes, shuffle, manual reordering, filters and live search are part of every edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- More than a couple of files to look at - sorting and filtering an almost-empty folder has little to show for it.

1 Choose how your files are sorted

Open a resource in the file browser and tap the sort button in the top bar - it already shows the current order, such as "Date ↓". Tap **Sort by** and pick a mode: by name, date, size or type, or - for a folder of one kind of file - by artist, title, duration or the date a photo was taken.

FastMediaSorter remembers the sort mode for each resource on its own, so the folder greets you with the same order the next time you open it.


12:00
A-Z
Random
Name (A-Z)
Name (Z-A)
Date (Old first)
Date (New first)
Size (Small first)
Size (Large first)
Manual Order
Artist (A-Z)
Artist (Z-A)
Title (A-Z)
Title (Z-A)
Duration (Short first)
Duration (Long first)
emulated/0/DCIM/Camera •
11.gif
911.jpg
244.jpg
355.jpg
406.jpg
517.jpg

The Sort by menu in the file browser.

2 Shuffle the list, then shuffle it again

Pick **Random** in the Sort by menu and your files line up in a fresh, mixed order. Change your mind about the mix without leaving the screen: tap **Random** again – it is already selected – and FastMediaSorter reshuffles on the spot, landing on a different order every time, with no folder rescan needed.

12:00

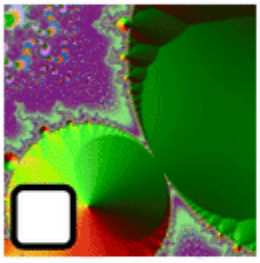
Random

DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • Random • All Files

1280x720 • 00:12 • 561.75 KB

IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB

IMG_20260720_1850.jpg
1600x900 • 217.92 KB

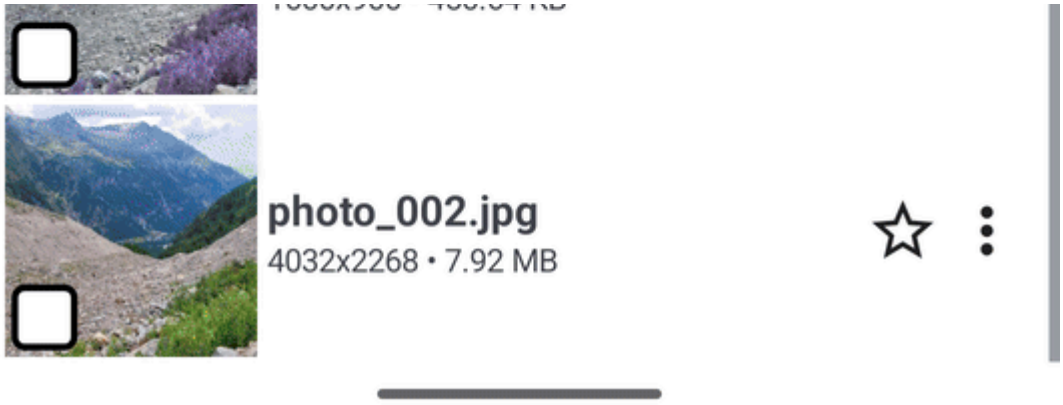


IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB

GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB

IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB

IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
1600x900 • 450.64 KB



Random sort - tap it again any time for a new mix.

3 Put files in the order you choose

Pick **Manual Order** to take the sequence into your own hands. Long-press a file and drag it to a new spot; a small drag handle appears on each row while manual order is active, showing you where dragging is allowed.

FastMediaSorter keeps the order you set for that folder, so it stays exactly as you left it the next time you open it.

12:00

Manual

DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • Manual Order • All Files

GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB

IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
1600x900 • 164.36 KB

IMG_20260714_1244.jpg
1600x900 • 304.16 KB

IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
1600x900 • 185.83 KB

IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB

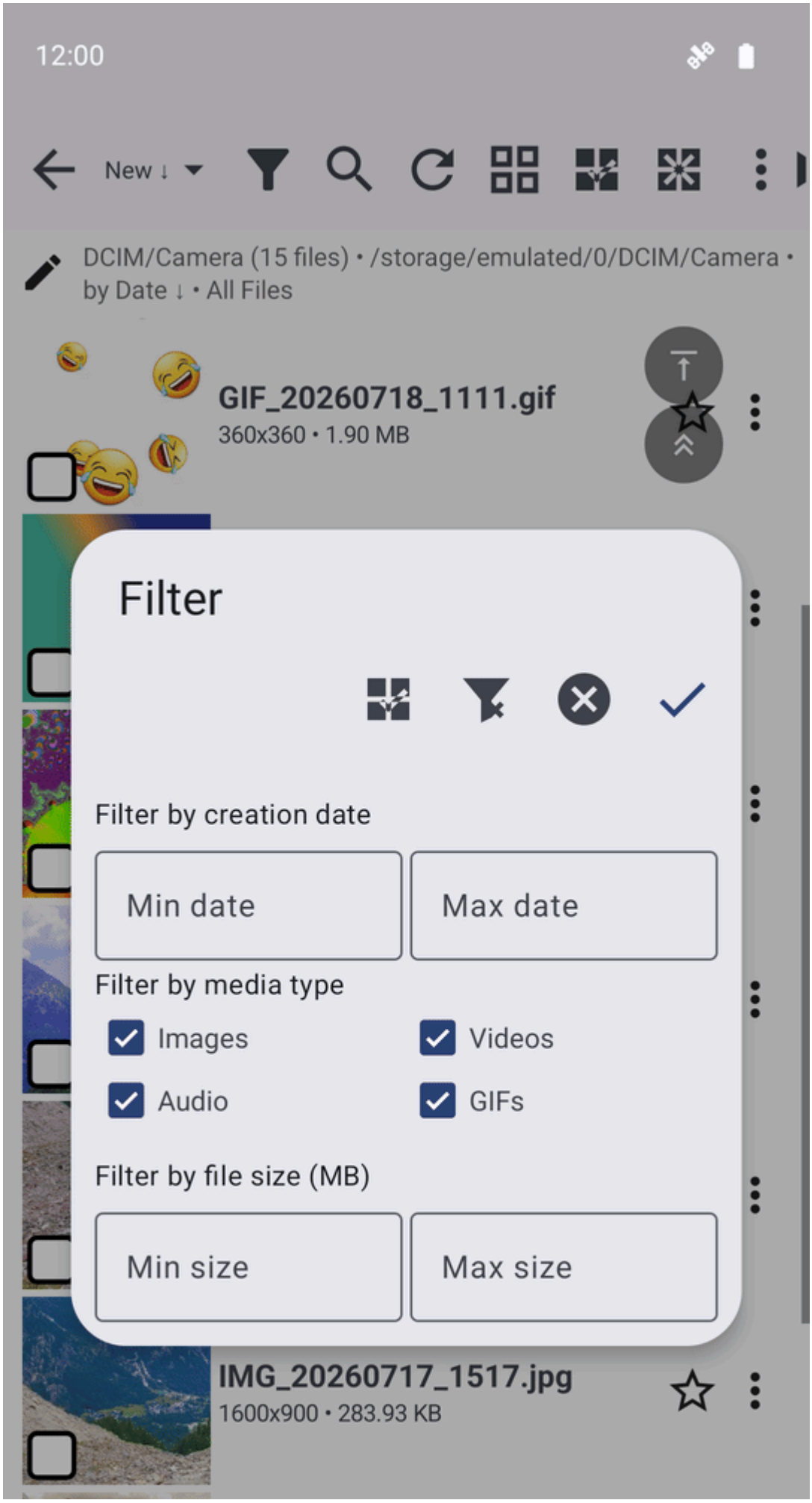
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB

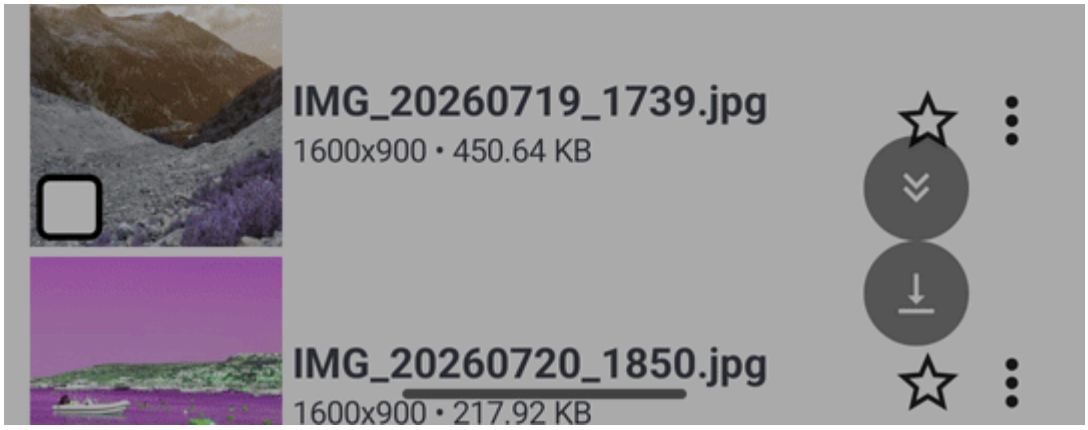
Dragging a file to a new spot in Manual Order.

4 Narrow the list with a filter

Tap the filter icon in the top bar to open **Filter**. Set a date range, a size range in megabytes, or tick only the media types you want - photos, videos, music, GIFs, documents and more, depending on what the resource holds. Tap **Apply filter** and the list narrows right away.

The filter belongs to that one resource and never leaks into another one you open afterwards. Come back to the same resource later and FastMediaSorter tells you it restored the filter you left it with.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Date ↓ • All Files
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
Filter
Filter by creation date
Min date
Max date
Filter by media type
Images
Videos
Audio
GIFs
Filter by file size (MB)
Min size
Max size
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB



The Filter dialog - date, size and media type.

5 See at a glance what is filtered

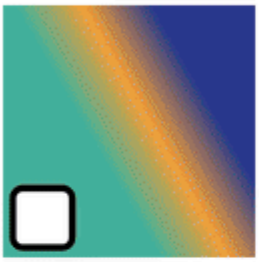
Whenever a filter is on, Browse restates it in plain words right under the toolbar, and the filter button itself carries a small number showing how many filters are active. Tap the filter button any time to change them, or tap **Clear filter** in the dialog to drop them all at once.

12:00

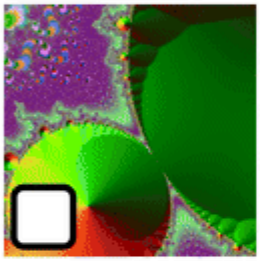
New ↓

DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Date ↓ • All Files

GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB

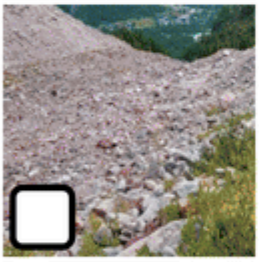


IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
1600x1200 • 47.31 KB



IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB

IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
1600x900 • 185.83 KB



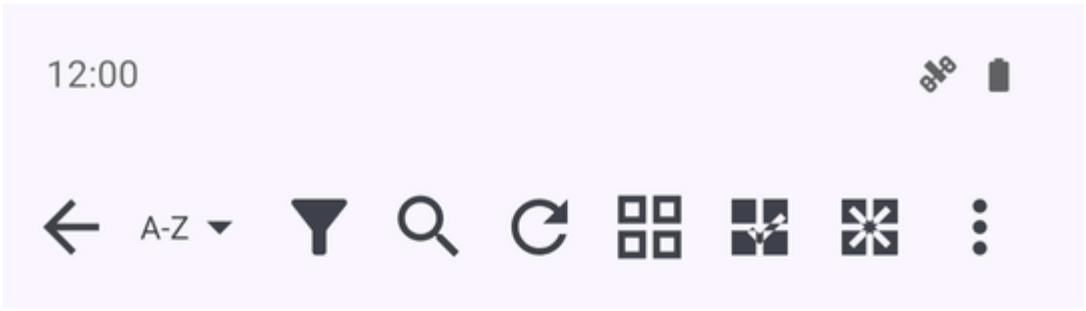
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB

IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB

The active filter, spelled out under the toolbar.

6 When the list comes up empty

If a folder looks empty after filtering, FastMediaSorter says why instead of leaving you guessing. When the **Maximum file size** setting is the reason files are missing, Browse names the setting and tells you how many files it is hiding, with a direct hint to raise the limit in Settings.



Pictures/Holiday (0 files) • /storage/emulated/0/Pictures/
Holiday • by Name ↑ • All Files

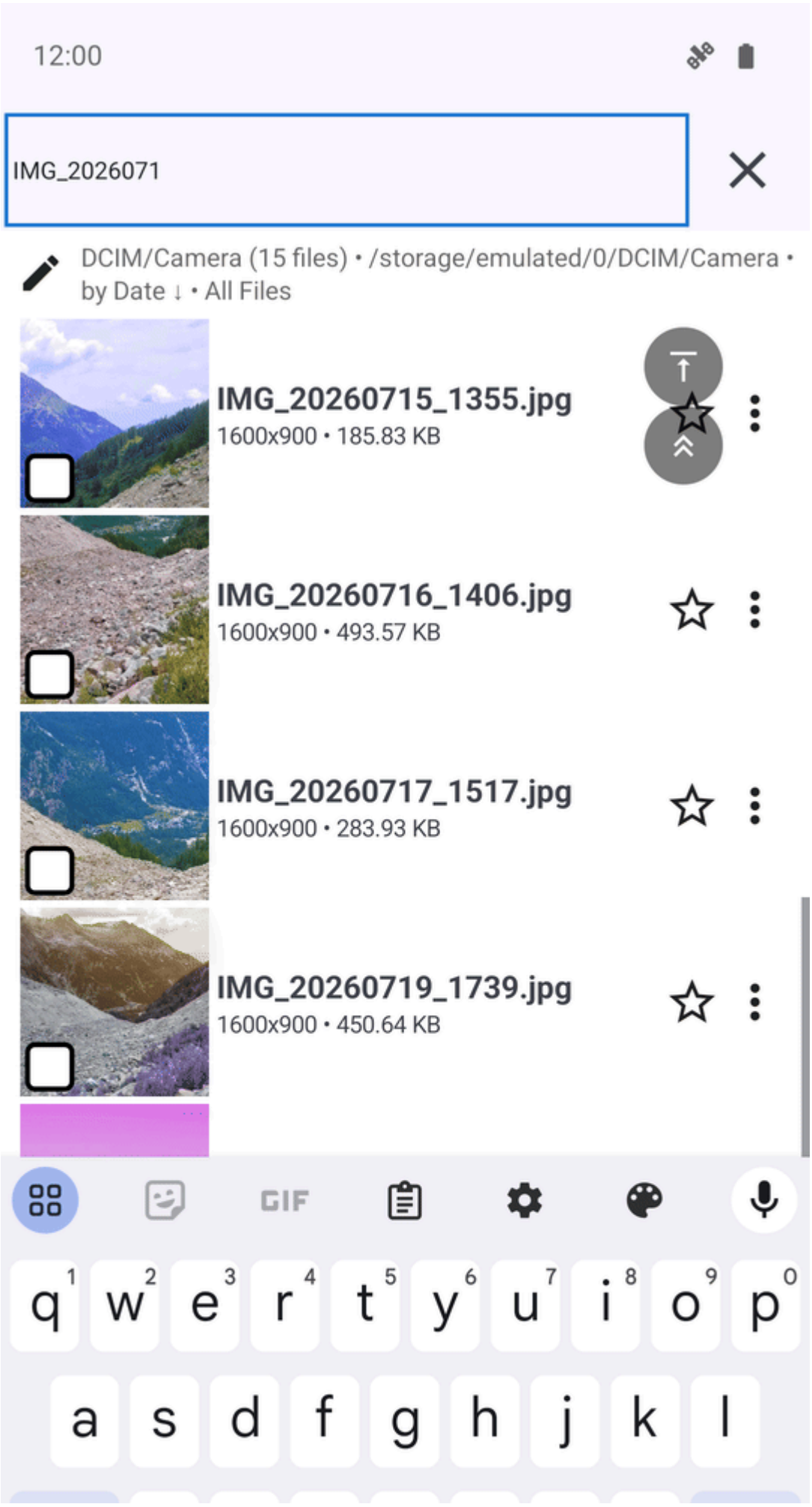
3 files are hidden by the maximum file size setting.

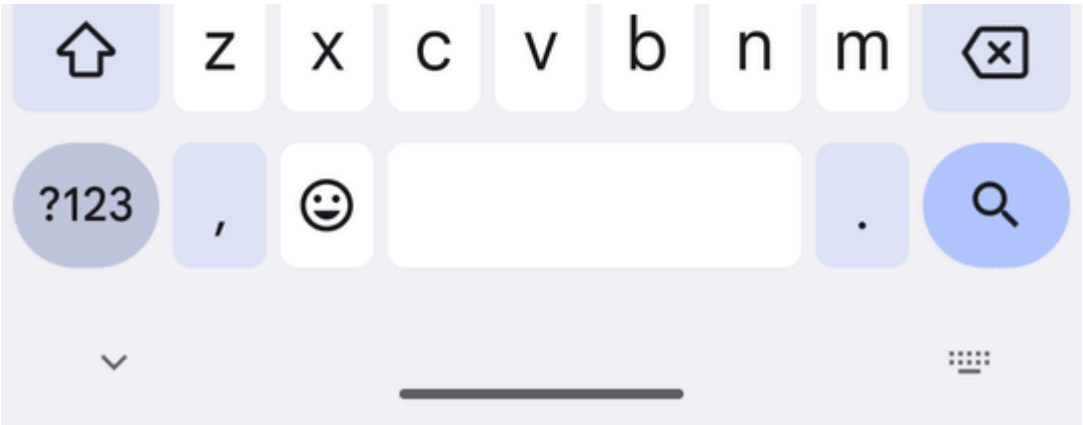
Raise the maximum file size in Settings to see them.

An empty list that explains itself.

7 Find one file fast with live search

Tap the search icon and a search box drops into the top bar. Type a few letters of the name and the list narrows as you type, filtered right there in memory with no rescan to wait on. Tap the close button on the search box to see everything again.


12:00
IMG_2026071
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Date ↓ • All Files
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
1600x900 • 185.83 KB
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
1600x900 • 450.64 KB
GIF
q w e r t y u i o p
a s d f g h j k l



Live search narrows the list as you type.

What You Get

You can put a folder in the order that makes sense for it, shuffle it for something new any time, narrow it down with a filter that stays with that one resource, and jump to a single file by typing a few letters - all without leaving the file browser.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Want every new resource to start already sorted your way?** Set a default in Settings, the Player tab, Sorting, slideshow and playback order section, field Default sort mode.
- **Sorting works the same in grid and list.** The Sort by menu and the Filter dialog behave identically whether Browse is showing thumbnails or a detail list - see Browsing media collections.
- **A big folder feels slow to sort on first open?** See Thumbnail caching and indexing for how FastMediaSorter keeps large folders responsive.
- **Filtering by file name too?** That comes from the same box as live search - type a name there and Filter keeps it alongside your date, size and type choices.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

BROWSING

Browsing media collections

BROWSING

Multi-selection and batch operations

Switch between grid and list, open folders, and find your way around the file browser.

Select several files at once and copy, move, delete or share them together.

BROWSING

Thumbnail caching and indexing

How FastMediaSorter keeps thumbnails and large folders fast to browse.

BROWSING & SORTING | All editions | RECIPE #03

Multi-Selection and Batch Operations

Tick as many files as you need with long-press and range-select, then run Copy, Move, Delete, Share or Archive on the whole batch at once from the file browser - or reach for a single file's own three-dots menu or a row swipe when that is all the job calls for.

Why You'll Love This

Some jobs need more than one file at a time - clearing out a folder of screenshots, moving a week of photos to a backup drive, sharing five files with a friend in one go. FastMediaSorter lets you tick as many files as you need and run one action on all of them at once, while a swipe or the row's own menu still covers the times you only want to act on a single file.

A copy or move of many files can take a while, especially over a network. It keeps running in the background once you send it there, so you are never stuck staring at a progress bar.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed, with a resource open in the file browser.
- Multi-selection, the grouped file menu, row swipe actions and the background transfer strip are part of every edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- Write access to the resource for Move, Rename, Delete and Archive - a read-only resource still allows Copy and Share.

1 Select more than one file

Long-press any file to enter selection mode. A checkbox appears on every row, and the file you pressed is already ticked. Long-press the checkbox of another file and every file between the two gets selected in one go, instead of ticking each one by hand.

Select All and **Deselect All** in the top bar cover the two extremes, and tapping a checked box again removes just that one file from the selection.

12:00
A-Z
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera •
by Name ↑ • All Files • 6 selected
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
IMG_20260714_1244.jpg
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
IMG_20260720_1850.jpg
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
photo_001.jpg
photo_002.jpg

Long-press a checkbox to select every file in between.

2 Run one action on the whole selection

Once you have files selected, a bar of actions appears at the bottom: **Copy**, **Move**, **Delete**, **Share** and, on this device's own storage, **Archive**. Tap one and it runs on every selected file at once. If you deleted or moved something by mistake, **Undo** appears in the same bar right after, for as long as FastMediaSorter still remembers the operation.

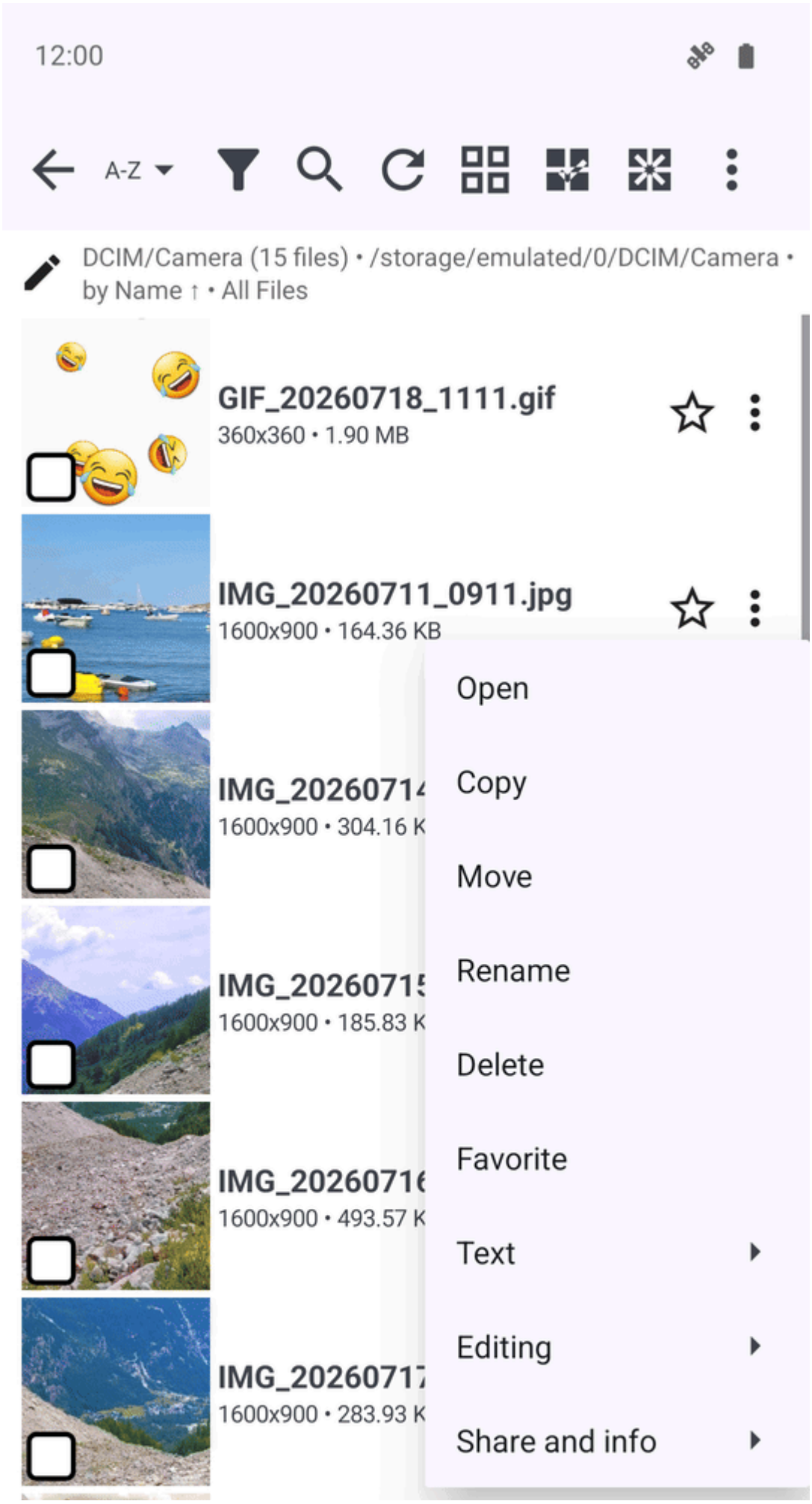
Rename shows up on the bar too, but it only opens a dialog when exactly one file is selected - renaming a batch of files at once is a separate tool. Copying and moving need a destination resource to send files to; see Moving, copying and deleting files.

12:00
A-Z
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera •
by Name ↑ • All Files • 3 selected
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
IMG_20260714_1244.jpg
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
IMG_20260720_1850.jpg
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
photo_001.jpg
photo_002.jpg

The batch action bar appears once you select files.

3 Act on one file with the three-dots menu

Tap the three-dots menu on any row to open its own menu instead. The most common actions - Open, Copy, Move, Rename and Delete - sit right at the top, one tap away. Everything else is grouped so the menu never turns into a long scroll: **Organize** (Favorite, Move up and Move down in the grid, Extract for a ZIP archive, Open in new window, and FileDO encryption), **Text** (search, translate and OCR for documents, books and images), **Editing** (crop, draw over, save a frame) and **Share and info** (send elsewhere, file information, print, lyrics). Only the groups that make sense for that file's type show up. A group with a single action is not a submenu at all: that action sits at the top level, which is why **Favorite** often appears right under Delete.


12:00
A-Z
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera •
by Name ↑ • All Files
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
1600x900 • 164.36 KB
IMG_2026071
1600x900 • 304.16 K
IMG_2026071
1600x900 • 185.83 K
IMG_2026071
1600x900 • 493.57 K
IMG_2026071
1600x900 • 283.93 K
Open
Copy
Move
Rename
Delete
Favorite
Text
Editing
Share and info

The per-file menu, grouped into submenus.

4 Swipe a row for an instant action

In the file list, a swipe left or right runs one action without opening any menu. Out of the box, one direction deletes and the other opens **Send to…**, but you can pick a different action for either direction - or turn a direction off - in Settings, the General tab, File browser interface section, under **Swipe left action** and **Swipe right action**.

While the row slides, it names the action it is about to run, so a swipe you did not mean to start can be let go before it fires. Deleting by swipe asks for the same confirmation as deleting from a menu, and an action turned off in Settings stays unavailable to the gesture too.

12:00

A-Z

DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Name ↑ • All Files

GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB

IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
1600x900 • 164.36 KB

_20260714_1244.jpg
900 • 304.16 KB

Delete

IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
1600x900 • 185.83 KB

IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB

IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB

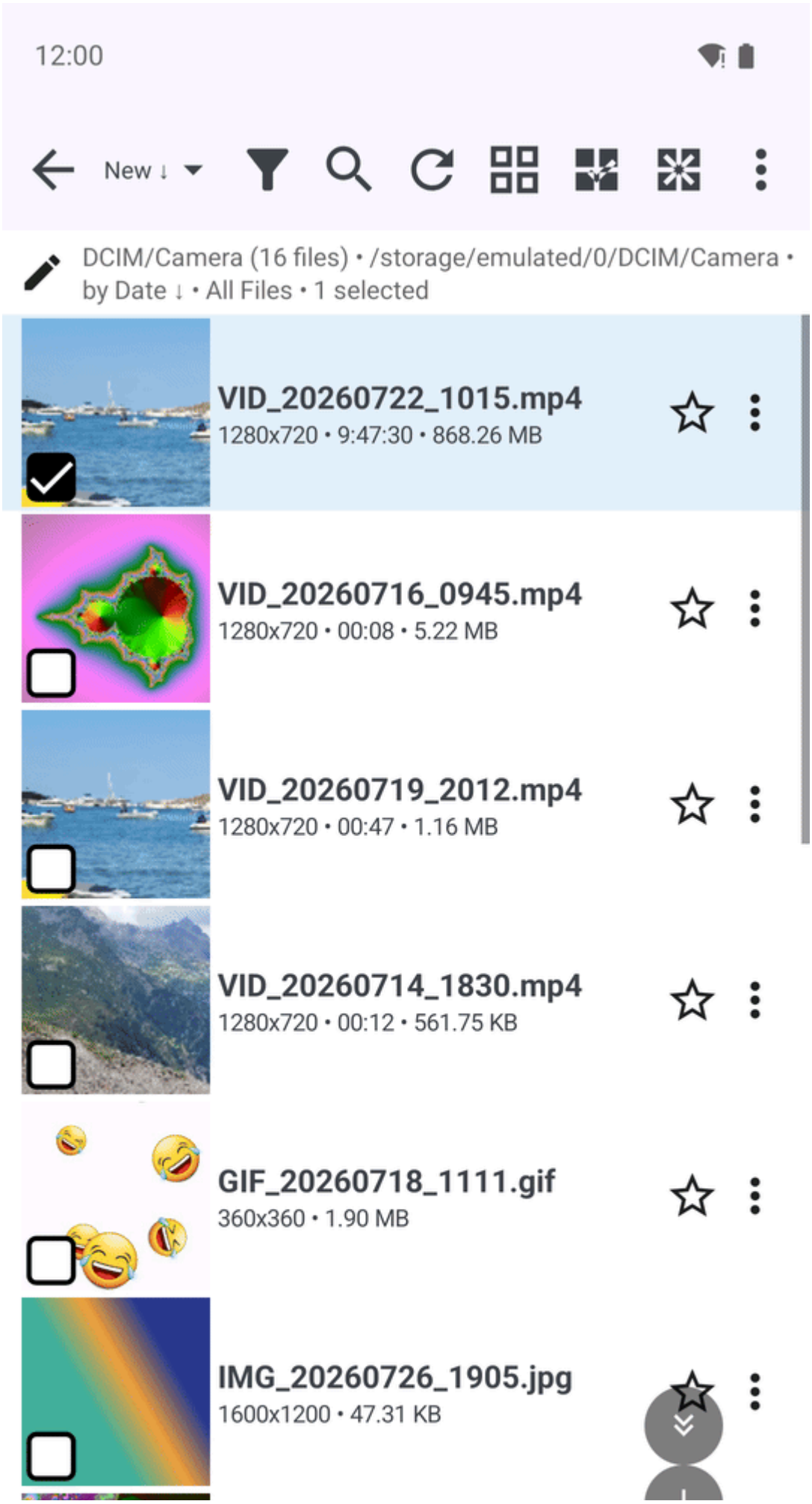
Swiping a row reveals the action before it runs.

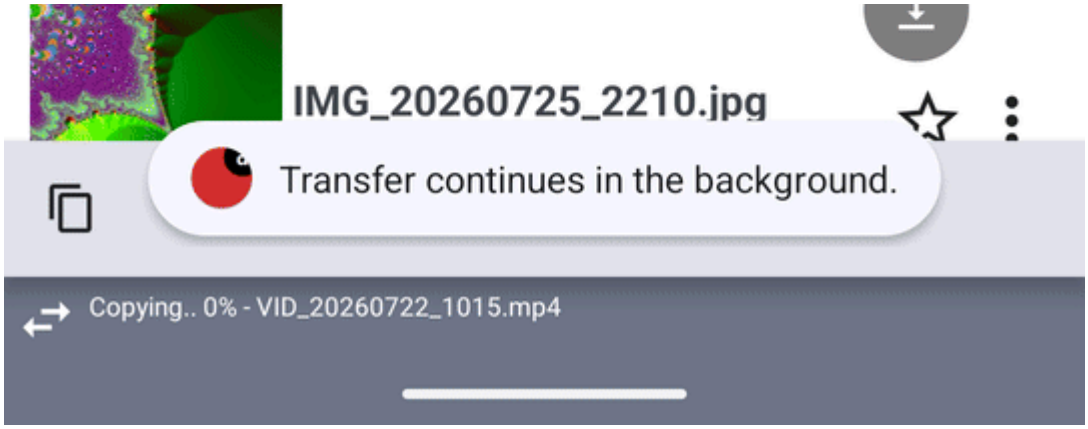
Reaches every edition

Row swipe actions work in every edition.

5 Let a big copy or move run in the background

Starting a copy or move on a batch opens a progress dialog. Tap **Background** and the operation keeps running while you carry on browsing. A slim strip then sits at the bottom of Browse, naming the operation, the percent done and the file currently being copied - tap the strip any time to bring the progress dialog back.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (16 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Date ↓ • All Files • 1 selected
VID_20260722_1015.mp4
1280x720 • 9:47:30 • 868.26 MB
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
1280x720 • 00:47 • 1.16 MB
VID_20260714_1830.mp4
1280x720 • 00:12 • 561.75 KB
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
1600x1200 • 47.31 KB



A backgrounded copy stays visible on a tappable strip.

What You Get

You can gather up a whole batch with long-press and range-select and send it off with one tap, reach for a single file's own menu or a swipe when that is all you need, and keep a big transfer going in the background without losing sight of it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Changed your mind about a swipe?** Slide the row back before letting go, or turn that direction off in Settings if you never use it.
- **Renaming several files at once?** That needs its own tool - see Batch Renaming Patterns.
- **Selecting with a keyboard or D-pad?** Extend the selection up or down without touching the screen - see Keyboard, D-pad and TV navigation.
- **Only seeing Copy and Share on the bar?** Move, Rename, Delete and Archive need write access to the resource - a read-only resource hides them on purpose.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

BROWSING

Sorting, filtering and quick search

Order a folder your way, shuffle it, filter it down and find one file fast.

STORAGE

Moving, copying and deleting files

Where copied and moved files go, and how undo and destinations work.

BROWSING

Browsing media collections

Switch between grid and list, open folders, and find your way around the file browser.

BROWSING & SORTING | All editions | RECIPE #04

Thumbnail Caching and Indexing

The file browser loads thumbnails in the background, remembers a folder between visits, and updates itself when files change on the device - so a folder opens fast and stays accurate, even when it holds thousands of files.

Why You'll Love This

None of this is a screen you open on purpose. It is what happens just before a folder appears: a thumbnail loading in, a stored list coming back instead of being re-read from scratch, a new photo from the camera showing up without a tap on refresh. There is no setting called "caching" in the app, but you notice the difference the first time you open a folder of two thousand photos and it does not freeze.

This page has nothing to configure. It explains what the file browser is already doing for you, so a moment of loading - or the rare case where it needs to catch up - makes sense instead of looking like something is wrong.

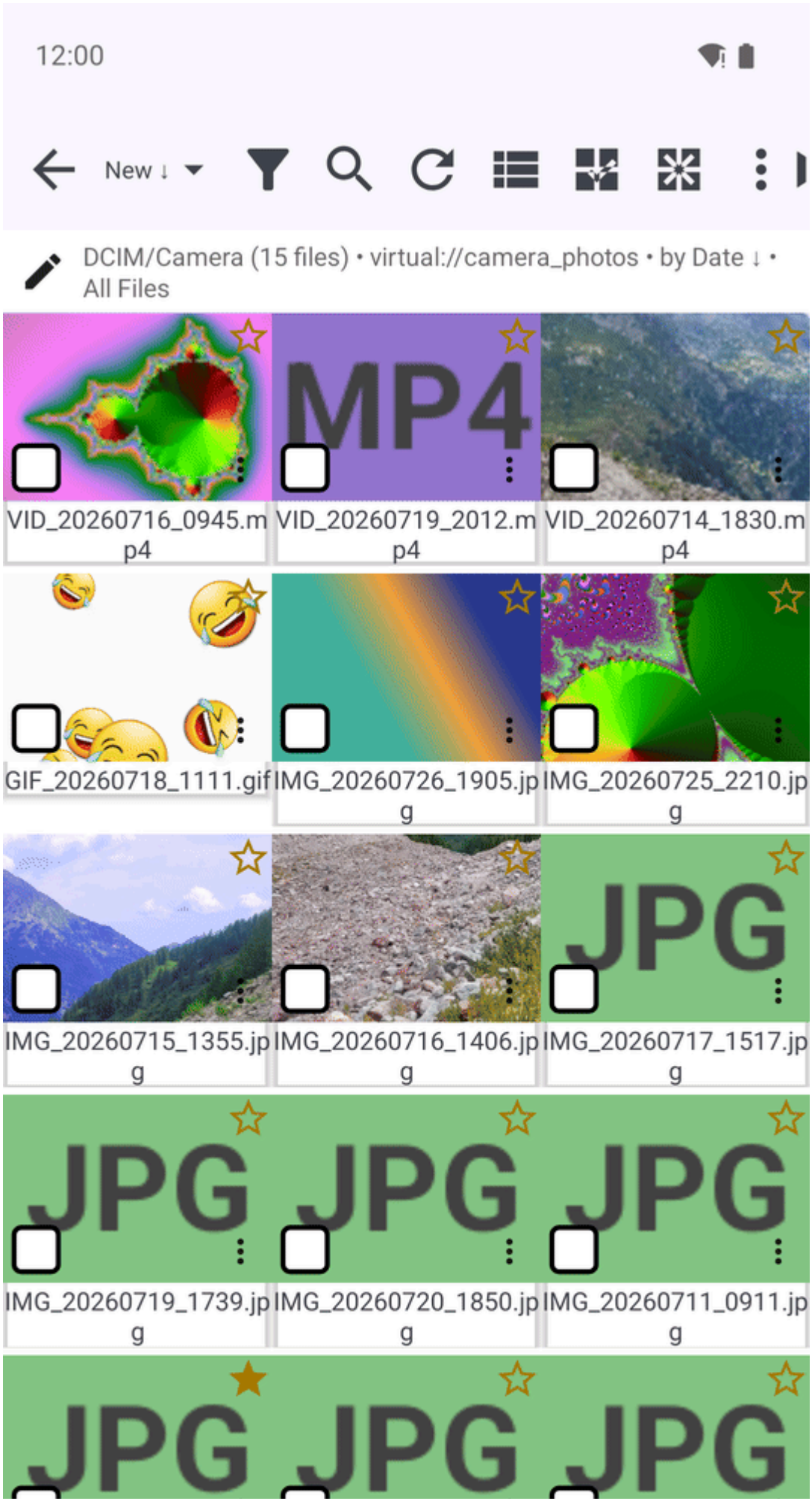
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

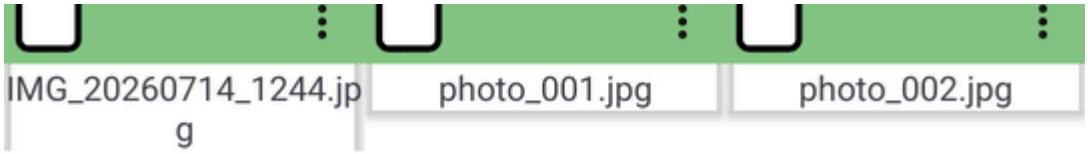
- FastMediaSorter in any edition. This is background behavior, not a feature you switch on.
- At least one resource with enough files to notice a difference - a folder of a few hundred photos shows it better than a folder of five.

1 Why thumbnails appear almost instantly

Every kind of resource - a local folder, an SMB share, a cloud account, a PDF library - loads its thumbnails through its own loader built for that source, so a network folder does not wait on the same steps a local one does. Thumbnails pause while you scroll fast, so flicking through a long list does not fight the loader for every frame you pass, and a folder with a huge number of files switches thumbnail loading off automatically rather than grinding to a halt.

After a network resource finishes its regular sync, a background task quietly loads the thumbnails for the files it just cached, over Wi-Fi, skipping anything already loaded - so by the time you open that resource, more of it is ready to look at than what you last saw.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ •
All Files
MP4
JPG
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
VID_20260714_1830.mp4
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
IMG_20260720_1850.jpg
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg



Thumbnails filling in as a folder opens.

2 Reopening a folder is instant the second time

When it is turned on for a resource, the scanned file list is saved after the first look, so opening that resource again restores the list at once instead of scanning the folder from the start. This matters most on a slow network share or a folder with thousands of files, where a full re-scan is the part that used to make you wait.

3 The list updates itself when files change

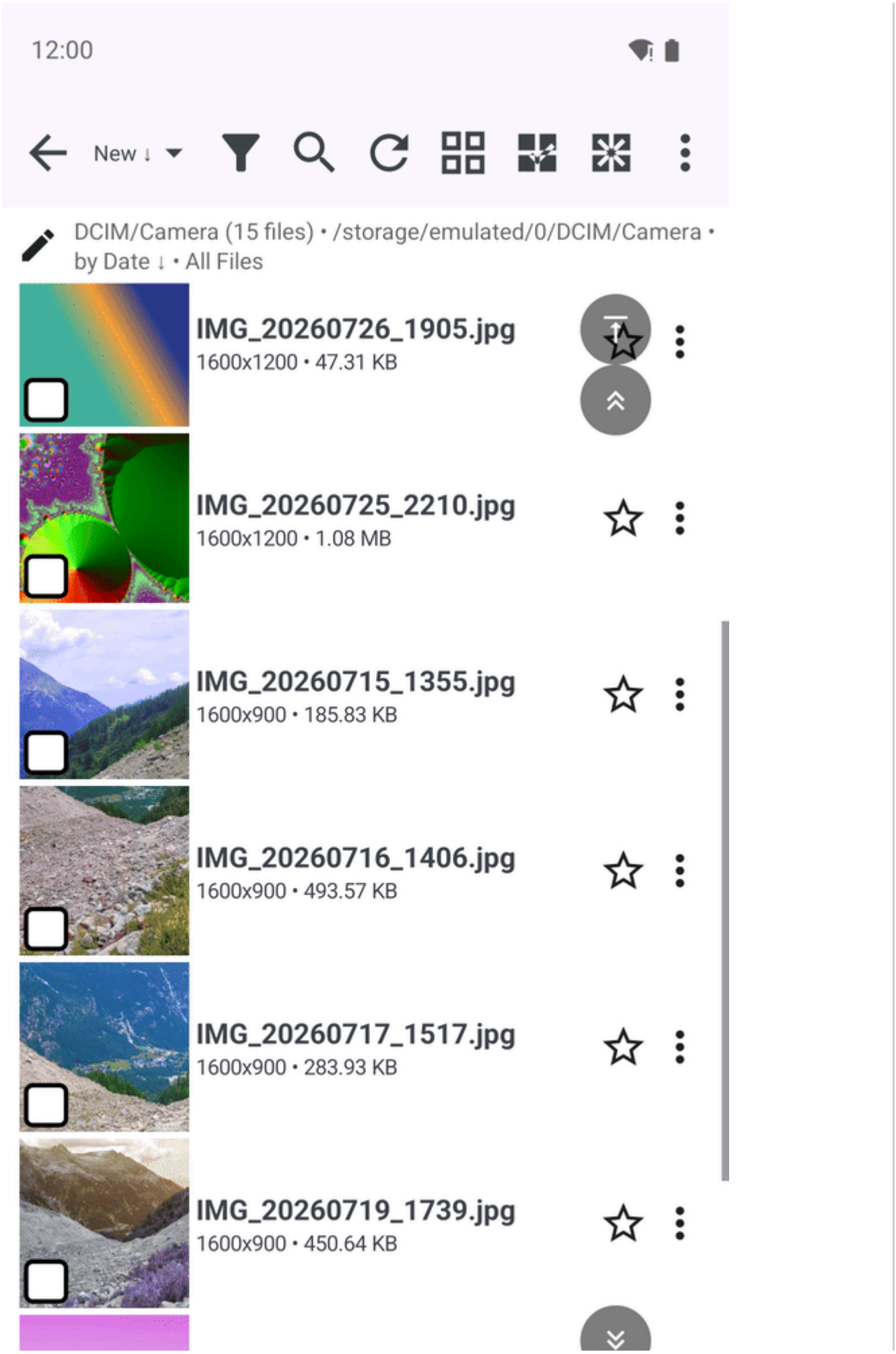
For a local resource, the app keeps a light watch on the folder on disk. When something changes there - a file renamed outside the app, a new one dropped in - the list quietly updates in place, or reloads if the change is too large to patch, without you tapping refresh.

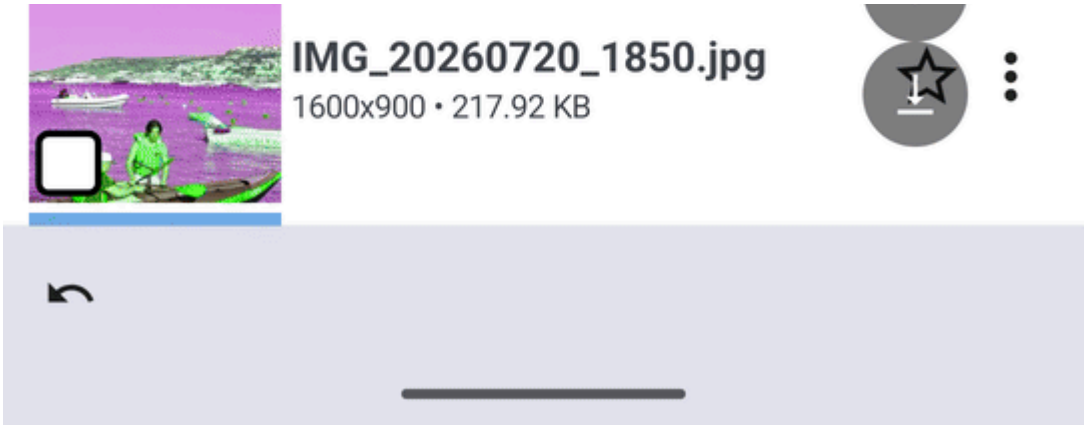
A second watch looks specifically at the device's own media collection, so a photo the camera just saved shows up in the matching resource on its own.

4 Big folders open in pages, and scrolling stays smooth

A folder with hundreds of files loads in chunks instead of all at once, so opening it does not spike the phone's memory. Scrolling through a large folder of images no longer reads files from disk on the same thread that draws the screen, which used to be a common cause of the app briefly freezing mid-scroll.

The paired phone resource on the watch pages the same way: past the first 50 items, a **Show more** button asks the phone for the next page instead of trying to fetch everything at once.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera • by Date ↓ • All Files
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
1600x1200 • 47.31 KB
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
1600x900 • 185.83 KB
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
1600x900 • 493.57 KB
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB
IMG_20260719_1739.jpg
1600x900 • 450.64 KB



Scrolling a large folder, with the jump buttons on the side.

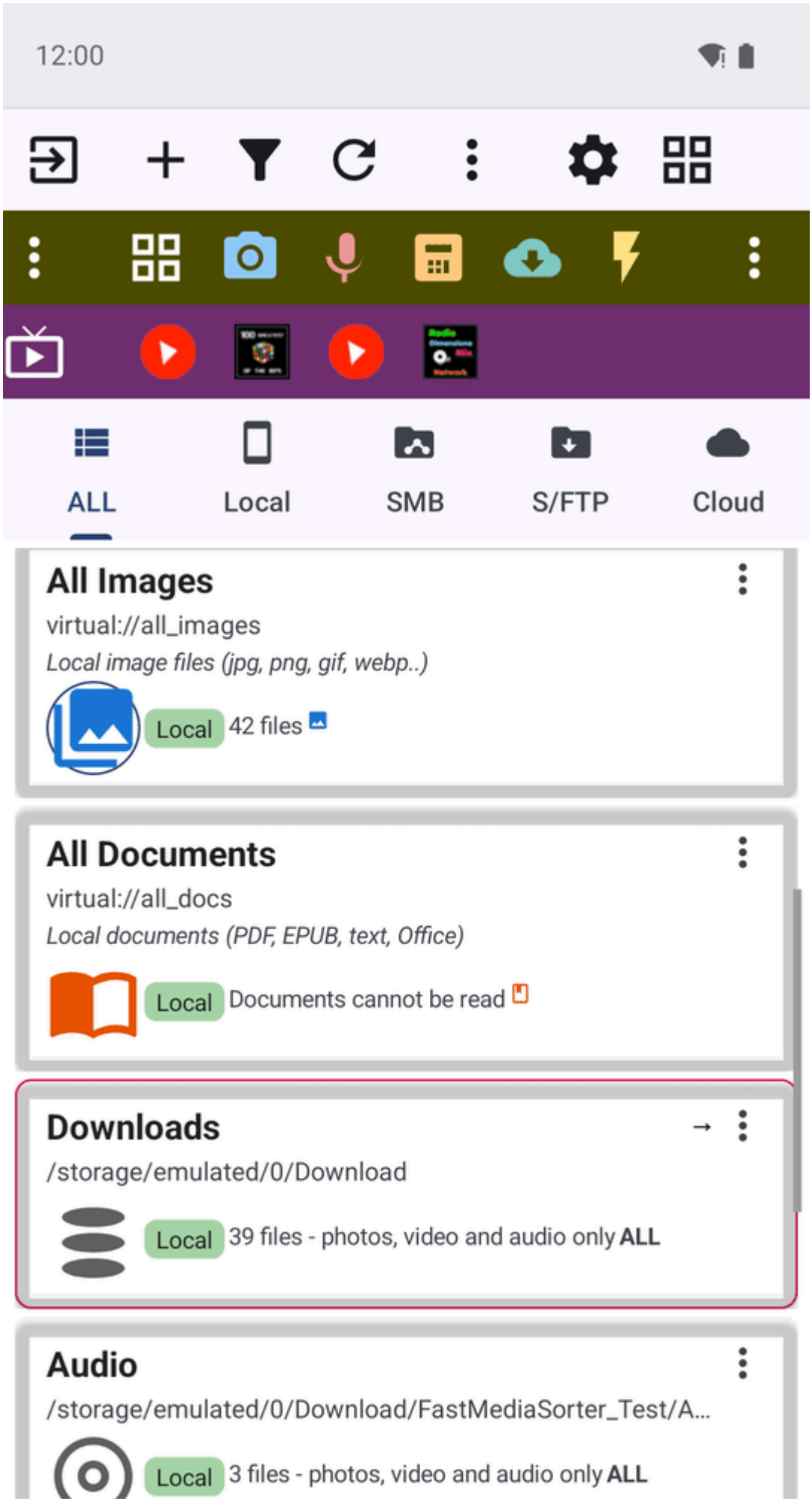
5

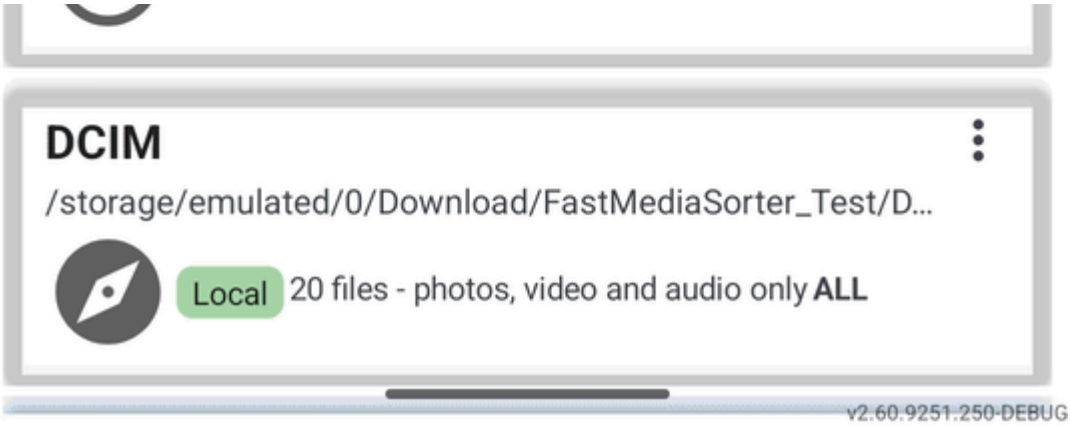
Broken and animated thumbnails are handled gracefully

A file that is truly empty, zero bytes, is recognized before the app tries to decode it: the folder shows its plain file-type icon right away and remembers not to try again, instead of asking for a thumbnail on every single re-scroll. Animated WebP and APNG files, which used to fall back to a broken-file icon, now show a still picture of their first frame instead, in the file list, in launcher folder previews and in the file details sheet.

6 Your file counts and folder stats stay accurate

A resource's file count, subfolder count, and when it was last opened or last synced are written down whenever you browse it, and no longer reset to zero – or to nothing at all – just by leaving the screen or opening a file. A cloud resource records the time of its last sync the same way. See Navigating the Main Screen for where these numbers show up on a resource's card.


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Images
virtual://all_images
Local image files (jpg, png, gif, webp..)
Local
42 files
All Documents
virtual://all_docs
Local documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)
Local
Documents cannot be read
Downloads
/storage/emulated/0/Download
Local
39 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
Audio
/storage/emulated/0/Download/FastMediaSorter_Test/A...
Local
3 files - photos, video and audio only ALL



A resource's file count and last-opened date, kept accurate.

7 Built-in collections stay steady during a copy or move

Collections such as All Images or Recent Media are put together on the fly rather than pointing at one folder, which used to make them reload or blink empty for a moment while a copy or move was running in the background. They now stay loaded and steady through a transfer instead of flickering.

8 Keyboard focus stays visible when you select a row

Moving through the file list with a keyboard, a D-pad or a mouse draws a focus ring around the current row. Selecting that row - ticking its checkbox - used to make the ring disappear, since selection and focus shared the same highlight; now they are drawn separately, so you can always see both which row is selected and which one focus is on. More on keyboard and remote control: Keyboard, D-pad and TV navigation.

9 Your marks and settings survive an app update

A few small things used to have a chance of resetting when the app updated itself in the background: whether a file was marked hidden or read-only, what kind of file or transfer job a cached record referred to, and whether a copy or move that just finished was reported as done. All three now survive an update untouched - and if a record from before an update ever turns out unreadable, it is quietly dropped instead of making the app stumble.

What You Get

Folders open fast and stay fast: thumbnails load in the background, a folder you already scanned reopens instantly, the list keeps itself honest as files change on the device, and even a very large folder scrolls smoothly. Your favorites, hidden-file flags and resource statistics ride through an app update untouched.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A folder feels slower than usual right after adding a lot of files?** The background thumbnail preload only runs over Wi-Fi and only after the resource's regular sync finishes - give it a moment.
- **Want to control what the list shows, not just how fast it loads?** See Sorting, filtering and quick search.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

BROWSING

Browsing media collections

BROWSING

Sorting, filtering and quick search

Grid and list view, subfolders, File Manager Mode and more.

Sort modes, shuffle, manual order, filters and the live search box.

BROWSING

Multi-selection and batch operations

Select several files at once and act on all of them together.

s, Destinations and File Operations

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #01

Adding Folders from Your Phone, Memory Card and USB Drive

Add a folder from the phone, a memory card or a USB drive as a resource, meet the ready-made collections the app creates for you, and let a folder show every kind of file with Reconnect resource.

Why You'll Love This

Your photos from the last holiday sit in the camera folder, the music you copied years ago lives on the memory card, and a USB stick from a friend is plugged into the phone. FastMediaSorter shows none of them until you tell it where to look. Every place you add becomes a resource - one row or tile on the main screen that opens straight into that folder.

Adding a local folder takes a minute and changes nothing in your files. Removing the resource later removes only the app's entry; the folder and everything in it stay where they are.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

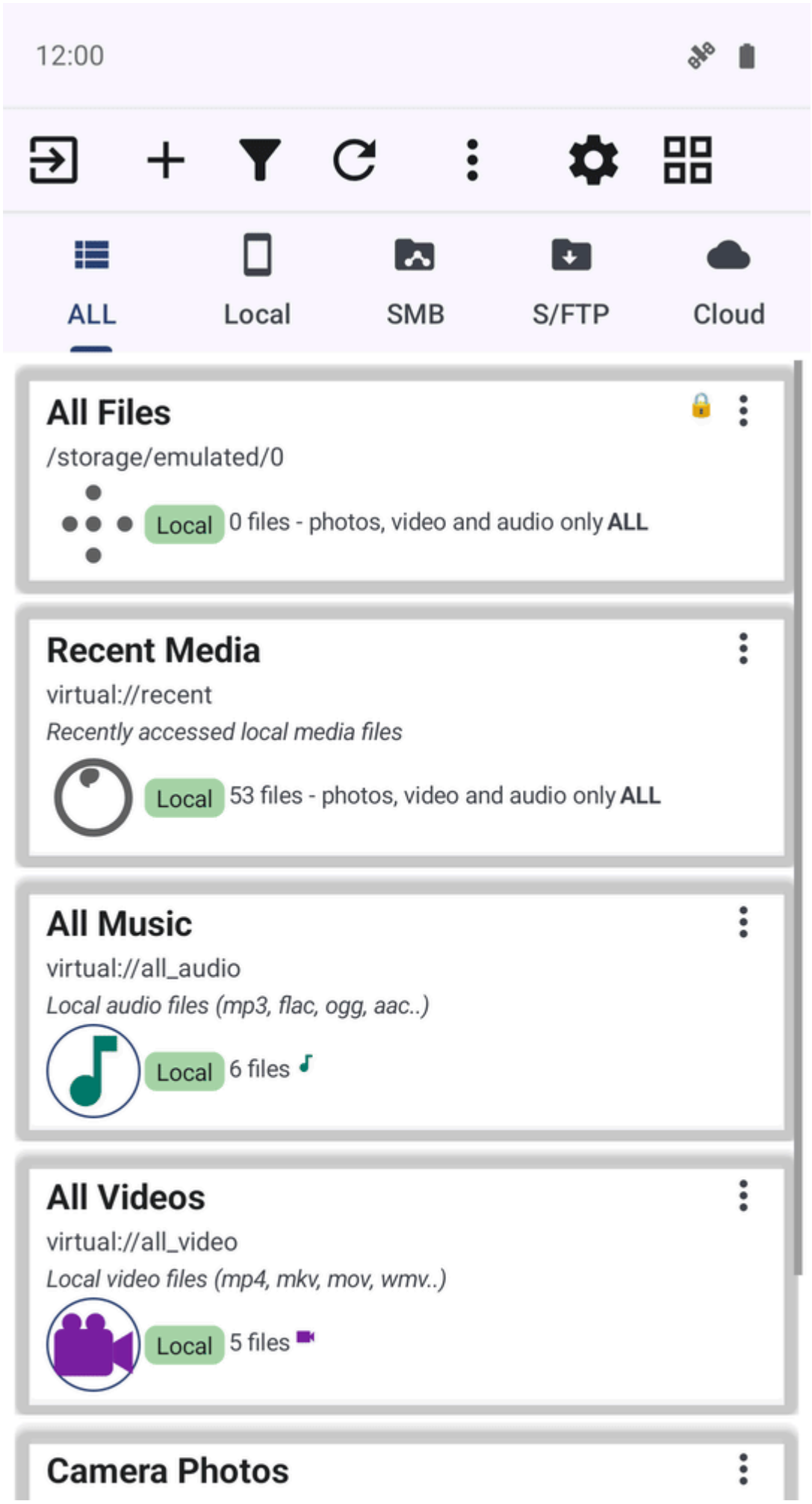
- FastMediaSorter in any edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS. Adding a folder from the device works in all of them.
- The permission to read your media. The app asks for it on first launch; see Understanding app permissions if you said no.
- For a memory card or a USB drive: the card inserted or the drive connected (a USB drive usually needs a small USB-C or OTG adapter).

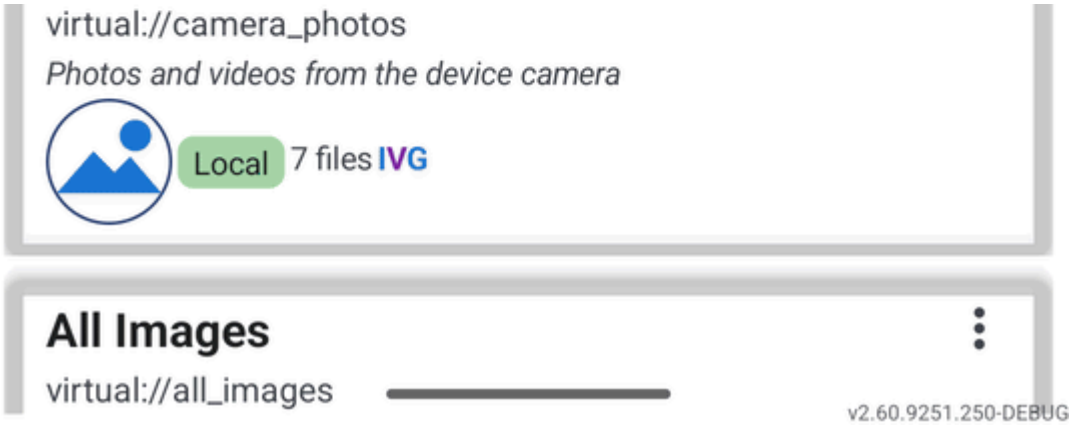
1 Look at what is already there

You do not have to add anything to get started. On first launch the app creates a few ready-made virtual resources that collect files of one kind from all over the device:

- **Recent Media** - the media files you opened lately.
- **All Music**, **All Videos** and **All Images** - every song, video or picture on the device, whatever folder it is in.
- **Camera Photos** - the photos and videos from the camera, newest first, shown as tiles.
- **All Documents** - PDF, e-book and text files, in the editions that open documents.

A collection appears only when your edition supports that kind of file. If you deleted one by mistake, it comes back by itself the next time the app starts.


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
/storage/emulated/0
Local 0 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
Recent Media
virtual://recent
Recently accessed local media files
Local 53 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
All Music
virtual://all_audio
Local audio files (mp3, flac, ogg, aac..)
Local 6 files
All Videos
virtual://all_video
Local video files (mp4, mkv, mov, wmv..)
Local 5 files
Camera Photos

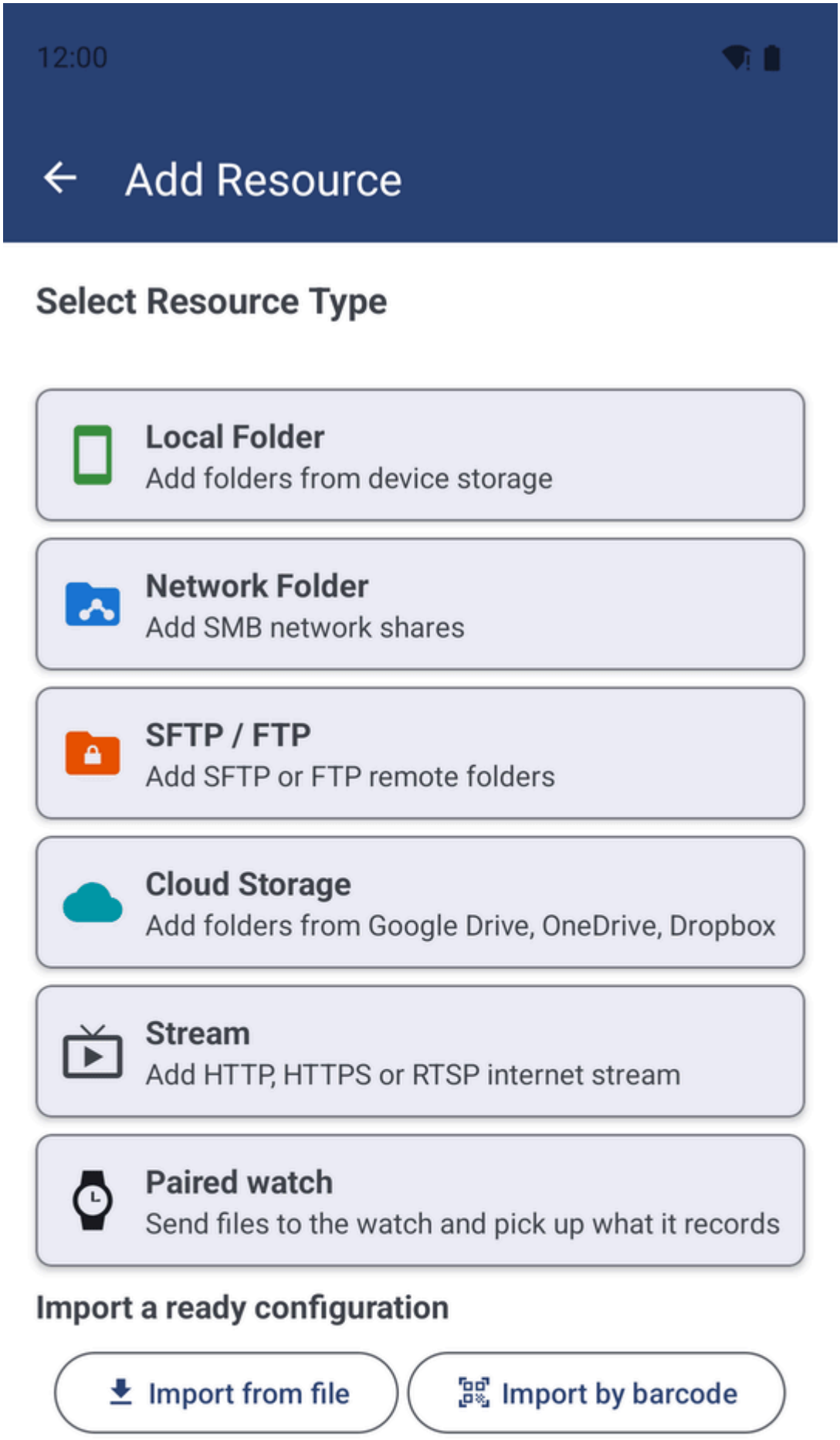


The ready-made collections on a fresh install.

2 Open the Add Resource screen

On the main screen tap **Add** on the command bar. The **Add Resource** screen opens with the heading **Select Resource Type** and a card for each kind of place: **Local Folder**, **Network Folder**, **SFTP / FTP**, **Cloud Storage** and **Stream**, as far as your edition has them.

Tap **Local Folder** – "Add folders from device storage". In the editions where no network or cloud places exist, or when you have switched them all off, the app skips this choice and opens the local folder screen straight away.


12:00
Add Resource
Select Resource Type
Local Folder
Add folders from device storage
Network Folder
Add SMB network shares
SFTP / FTP
Add SFTP or FTP remote folders
Cloud Storage
Add folders from Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox
Stream
Add HTTP, HTTPS or RTSP internet stream
Paired watch
Send files to the watch and pick up what it records
Import a ready configuration
Import from file
Import by barcode

Choose what kind of place to add.

3 Pick the folder

The **Add Local Folder** screen offers two ways:

- **Scan Local** - the app searches the device for folders that hold media and lists them. Tick the ones you want.
- **Add Manually** - opens the **Select Folder** window, where you choose one folder yourself.

In the **Select Folder** window you find:

- Quick buttons for the ready-made collections, grayed out when they are already added.
- Quick buttons for well-known folders: the root of the internal storage, **DCIM**, **Pictures**, **Download**, **Documents** and the media folders of WhatsApp, Telegram and Instagram.
- One button for each memory card or USB drive that is connected right now, with its name and free space.
- **Browse with System Picker** - opens Android's own folder window, where you can walk to any folder and tap **Use this folder**.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Select Folder window**
Select Folder dialog open, an SD card inserted so its volume button shows.

A memory card or USB drive

Tap the button with the card's or drive's name. If Android has not yet given the app access to it, the app explains why it needs access and then opens Android's folder window on that card - just tap **Use this folder** there. A USB drive disappears from the list when you unplug it, and its resource shows as unavailable until you plug it in again.

4 Choose how the folder is read

Before you confirm, look at the options under the folder:

- **Scan subdirectories** (on by default) - also shows the files inside every folder within this one. Turn it off to see only the files that lie directly in the chosen folder.
- **Add to Quick Sort** - makes this folder a destination, so you can later copy or move files into it with one tap (see Sorting files into destinations).
  Confirm, and the new resource appears in the resource list. The app counts its files in the background and shows the number on the resource.

  Later you can change everything - the name, the kinds of files shown, a PIN - by long-pressing the resource and choosing **Edit**. With **All Files** mode on for a resource, the editor also offers **Show Hidden Files** for files whose names start with a dot.

5 When a folder shows only photos, video and audio

Since Android 11 an app sees every kind of file in a folder only if it holds the special "access to all files" permission, or if you picked the folder yourself in Android's folder window. Some editions never ask for "access to all files", and in the others you may have said no, so a folder added by its path shows only photos, video and audio. The app tells you so instead of pretending the folder is complete:

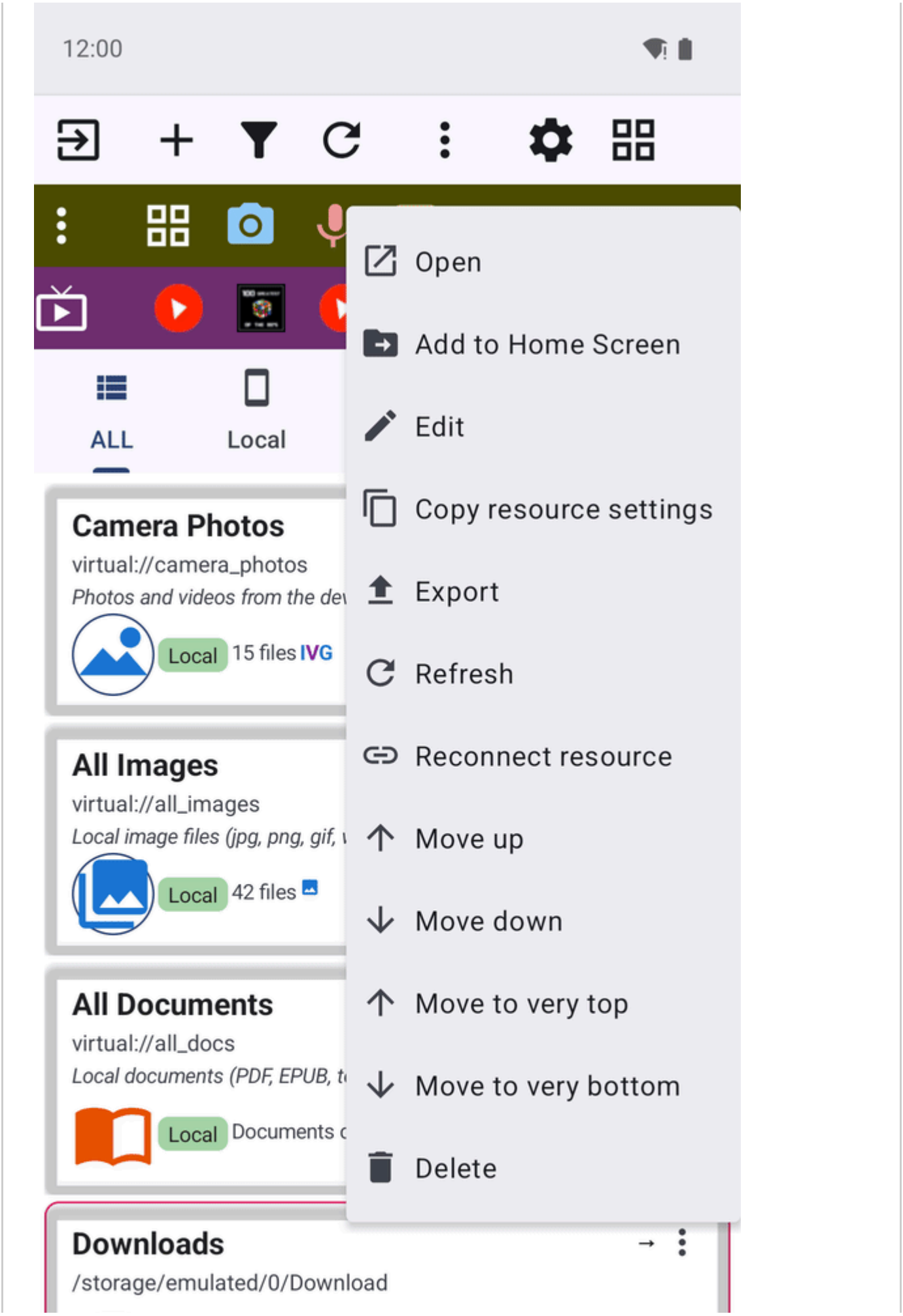
- The file count on the resource reads, for example, "124 - photos, video and audio only". The All Documents collection shows "Documents cannot be read" instead of a zero.
- The first time you open such a folder, a note at the top explains how to see the documents too.
- The filter does not offer document types that the folder cannot return.

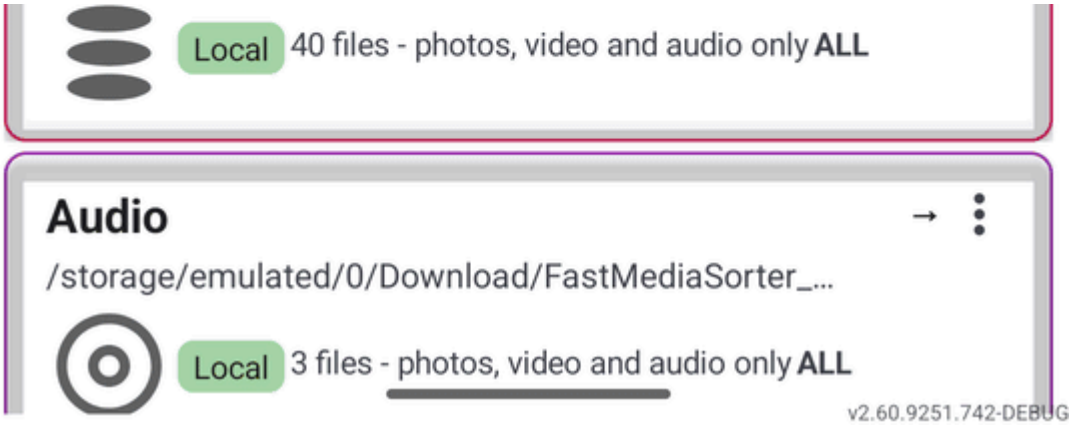
6 Reconnect a folder to see every file

To let the app see documents and other files in that folder, give it the folder through Android's folder window:

1. On the main screen tap the three-dots menu on the folder's row.
2. Tap **Reconnect resource**.
3. Android's folder window opens. Walk to the same folder and tap **Use this folder**.

The resource keeps its name, its Favorites, its place in Quick Sort and its scheduled operations - only the way the app reaches the folder changes. **Reconnect resource** appears only for folders that need it, and only on Android 11 or newer.


12:00
ALL
Local
Camera Photos
virtual://camera_photos
Photos and videos from the dev
Local 15 files IVG
All Images
virtual://all_images
Local image files (jpg, png, gif,
Local 42 files
All Documents
virtual://all_docs
Local documents (PDF, EPUB, t
Local Documents
Downloads
/storage/emulated/0/Download
Open
Add to Home Screen
Edit
Copy resource settings
Export
Refresh
Reconnect resource
Move up
Move down
Move to very top
Move to very bottom
Delete



Reconnect resource in the folder's menu.

What You Get

Your camera roll, your music folder, the memory card and the USB stick each have their own resource on the main screen. One tap opens any of them in the file browser, and the ready-made collections keep gathering new files by themselves.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **One Resource Profile dialog.** Choosing a resource profile opens the same **Resource Profile** dialog when you add a resource and when you edit it; the File Manager profile keeps the switches for the kinds of files visible, and each preset sets the same kinds of files wherever you pick it.
- **Removing a resource never deletes files.** Long-press it and remove it: only the app's entry goes away.
- **Too many folders from one scan?** Untick the ones you do not need before you confirm - you can always add a folder later.
- **Folders on another computer or in the cloud** are added from the same Add Resource screen - see Adding network folders and cloud storage.
- **Keep a folder private** with a PIN - see Protecting files with a PIN and encryption.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage

Add a shared folder on your home computer, a server or Google Drive.

Sorting files into destinations

Turn your folders into one-tap targets for sorting photos.

BROWSING

Browsing media collections

Look through a resource as tiles or as a list.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS

Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS

RECIPE #02

Network folders - all except Lite; cloud storage - all except Lite and FOSS

Adding Network Folders and Cloud Storage as Sources

Add a shared folder on a home computer or NAS, an FTP or SFTP server, or a Google Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive folder as a resource, switch whole groups of them off, and let the app's caches keep them quick.

Why You'll Love This

The family photo archive is on the old computer in the living room, the films are on a NAS in the corridor, and last year's pictures went to Google Drive. You do not have to copy all of that onto the phone to look through it or sort it. Add each place once as a resource, and it opens like any folder on the phone.

This page is the overview: what kinds of places you can add and what the app does to keep them quick. The step-by-step setup for each kind of server has its own page, linked below.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

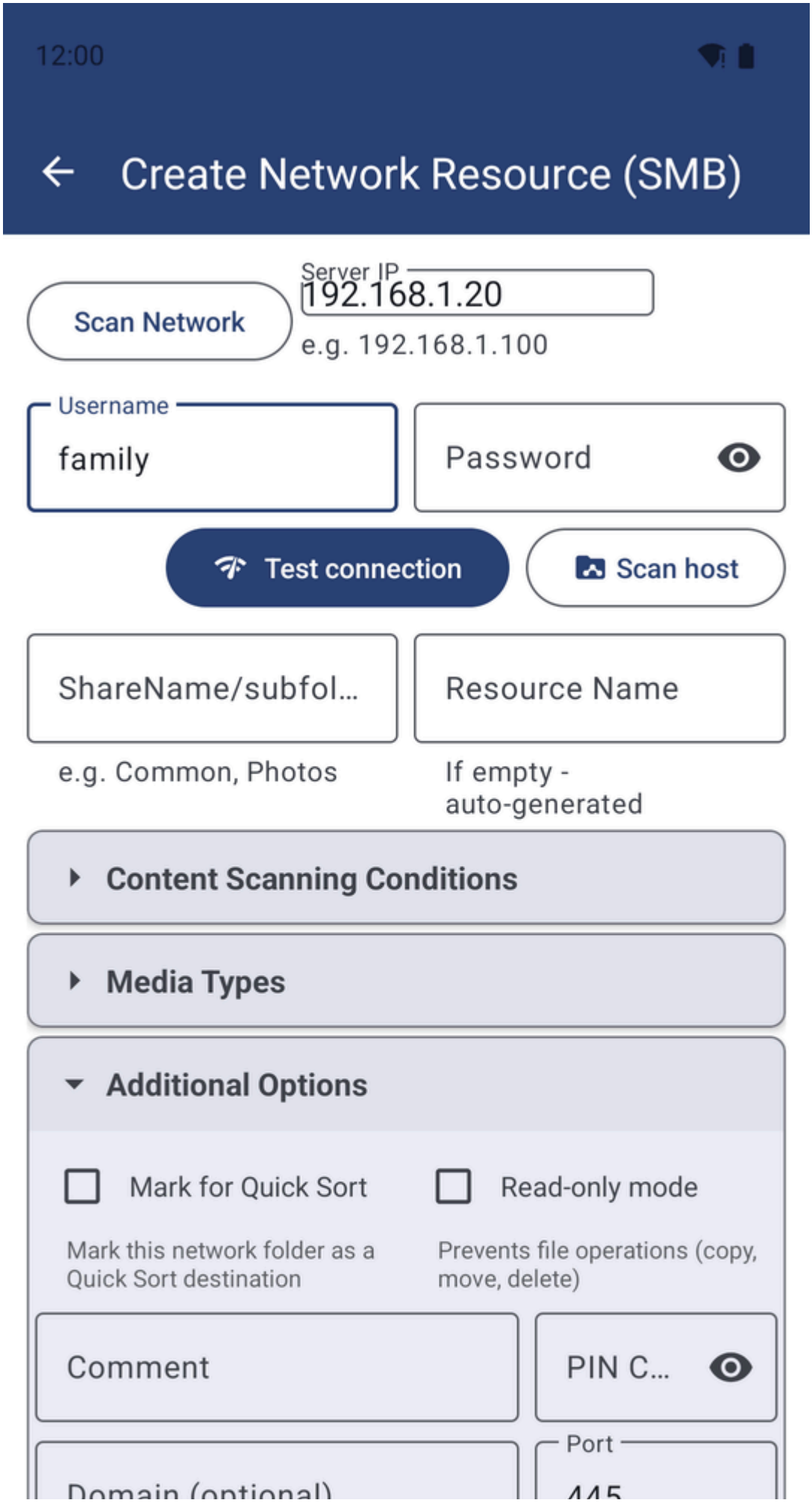
- Network folders and FTP or SFTP servers: every edition except Lite. Cloud storage: Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR - not Lite and not FOSS. See The seven editions.
- For a network folder: the phone and the computer or NAS on the same Wi-Fi or network, and the user name and password of the shared folder.
- For an FTP or SFTP server: its address, and a user name with a password or an SSH key.
- For cloud storage: a Google, Dropbox or Microsoft account.

1 Add a shared folder from your home network

On the main screen tap **Add**, then **Network Folder** - "Add SMB network shares". The **Create Network Resource (SMB)** screen asks for:

- **Server IP**, for example `192.168.1.100`. Not sure? Tap the network scan button and pick your computer or NAS from the list of devices the app finds.
- **Username** and **Password** of the shared folder, and a **Domain** only if your network uses one ("Leave empty if not needed").
- **Port** - leave `445` unless your administrator told you otherwise.

  Tap **Scan host** to list the shared folders on that computer, tick the ones you want and add them. **Test connection** checks the name and password without adding anything. The full walk-through, including how to share a folder on Windows, is in Connecting SMB/Windows shares.


12:00
Create Network Resource (SMB)
Scan Network
Server IP
192.168.1.20
e.g. 192.168.1.100
Username
family
Password
Test connection
Scan host
ShareName/subfol...
Resource Name
e.g. Common, Photos
If empty - auto-generated
Content Scanning Conditions
Media Types
Additional Options
Mark for Quick Sort
Mark this network folder as a Quick Sort destination
Read-only mode
Prevents file operations (copy, move, delete)
Comment
PIN C...
Domain (optional)
Port
445

Adding a shared folder from a home computer.

2 Add a folder on an FTP or SFTP server

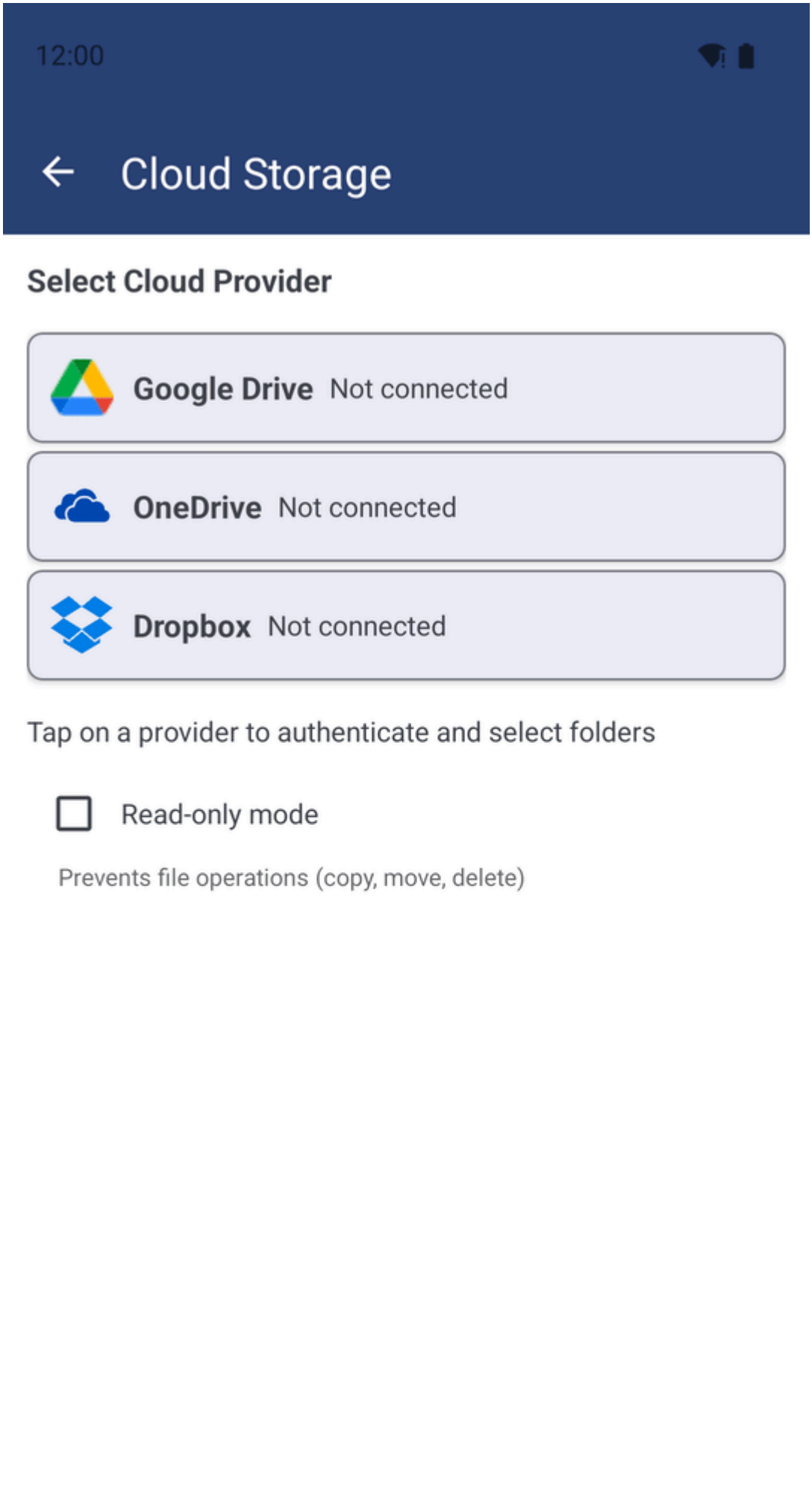
Tap **Add**, then **SFTP / FTP**. On the **Add S/FTP Resource** screen choose **SFTP** or **FTP** at the top; the port fills in by itself (22 for SFTP, 21 for FTP). Enter the **Host**, the **Username** and the folder path, for example `/home/user/media` or just `/`.

For SFTP you can sign in with a **Password** or with an **SSH Key**: paste the key or tap **Load File**, and add the key's passphrase if it has one. Tap **Test Connection**, then **Add Resource**. More in Connecting SFTP and FTP servers.

3 Add a Google Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive folder

Tap **Add**, then **Cloud Storage** - "Tap on a provider to authenticate and select folders". Tap **Google Drive**, **Dropbox** or **OneDrive**, sign in with your account in the window that opens, then pick the cloud folder you want to see in the app.

Each chosen folder becomes a resource of its own. The details for each provider are in Google Drive integration and Dropbox and OneDrive.


12:00
Cloud Storage
Select Cloud Provider
Google Drive Not connected
OneDrive Not connected
Dropbox Not connected
Tap on a provider to authenticate and select folders
Read-only mode
Prevents file operations (copy, move, delete)

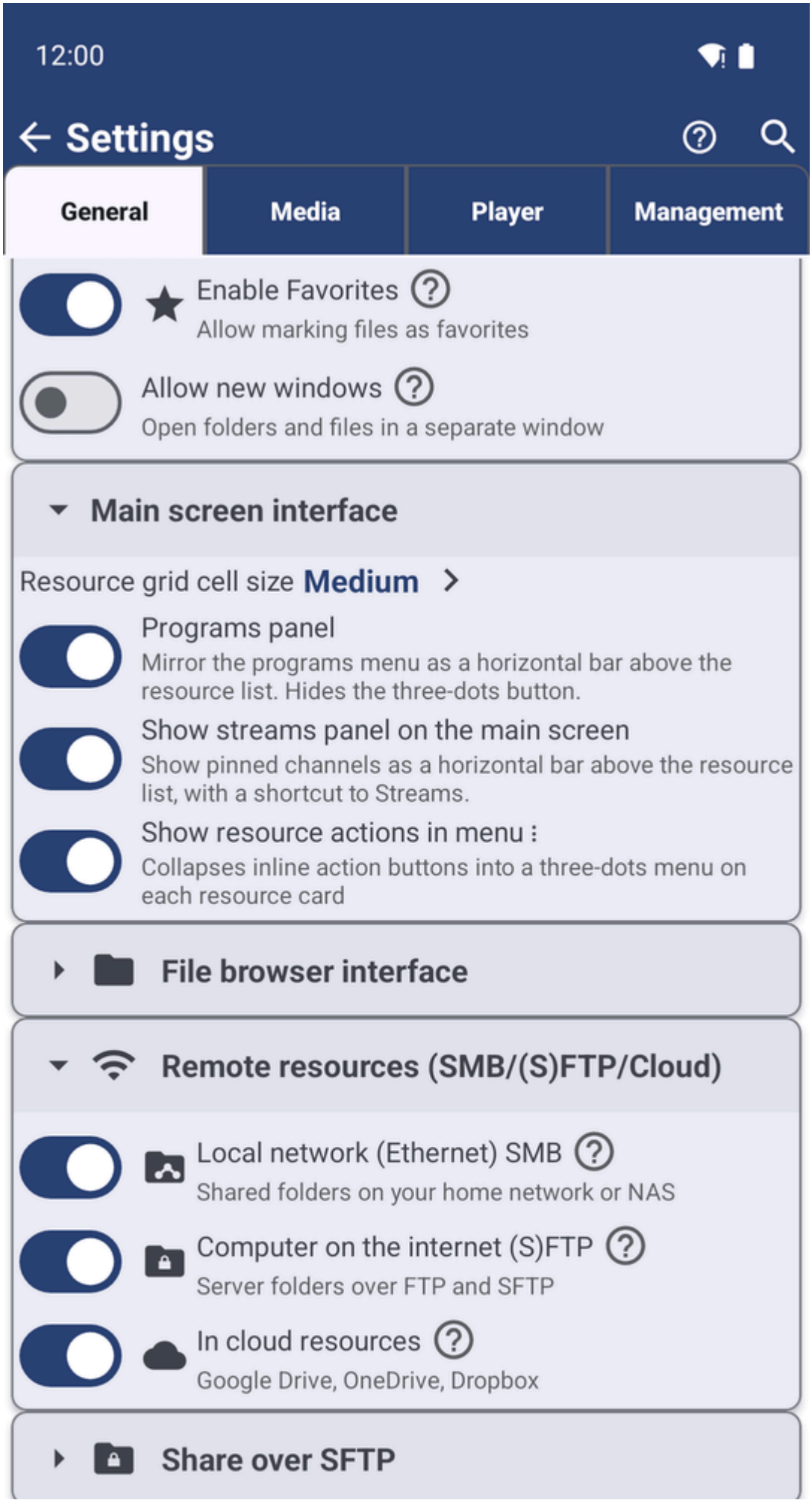
Pick a cloud provider and sign in.

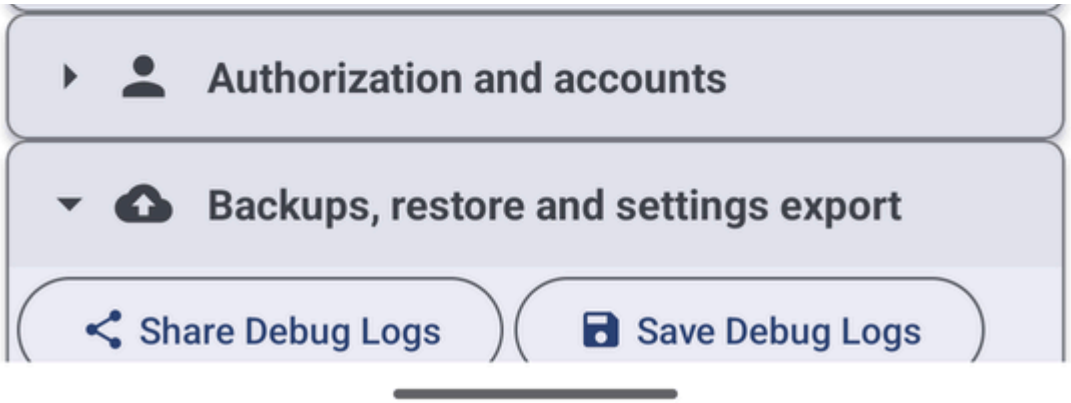
4 Hide a whole group of places for a while

If you do not use network or cloud places at all, or want them out of sight for a trip, switch them off as a group. Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and find **Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)**. There are three switches:

- **Local network (Ethernet) SMB** - shared folders on your home network or NAS.
- **Computer on the internet (S)FTP** - server folders over FTP and SFTP.
- **In cloud resources** - Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox.

When you turn a group off while you still have resources of that kind, the app asks "Hide these folders?" and explains: they are hidden, not deleted. They come back, with all their settings, the moment you turn the switch on again. While a group is off, its card also disappears from the Add Resource screen.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Enable Favorites
Allow marking files as favorites
Allow new windows
Open folders and files in a separate window
Main screen interface
Resource grid cell size Medium
Programs panel
Mirror the programs menu as a horizontal bar above the resource list. Hides the three-dots button.
Show streams panel on the main screen
Show pinned channels as a horizontal bar above the resource list, with a shortcut to Streams.
Show resource actions in menu
Collapses inline action buttons into a three-dots menu on each resource card
File browser interface
Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)
Local network (Ethernet) SMB
Shared folders on your home network or NAS
Computer on the internet (S)FTP
Server folders over FTP and SFTP
In cloud resources
Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox
Share over SFTP



Switch whole groups of places on or off.

5 Why network folders open quickly the second time

The app does three things by itself so that network and cloud places feel almost as fast as the phone:

- **It remembers the file list.** When you open a network folder again, you see its files at once, while the app quietly checks the server for changes in the background.
- **It keeps small previews.** Thumbnails of network and cloud files are saved on the phone, so the tiles do not have to be downloaded again every time. For a folder with more than 10,000 files the app switches previews off by itself and shows file-type icons instead; you can change this with **Disable thumbnails** in the resource's settings.
- **It keeps a playback copy when streaming is not possible.** Some servers cannot send a video piece by piece. Then the app downloads it into a streaming cache first, so it plays smoothly and can resume after a lost connection.

6 Decide how long the streaming cache is kept

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and find **Background sync, network and cache**:

- **Streaming cache TTL** - how long a cached file is kept after you last played it: **Off**, **1 day**, **3 days**, **7 days** or **30 days**. Older copies are removed by themselves.
- **Streaming cache cleanup** - what happens when you leave the player: **Ask each time**, **Auto-delete** or **Auto-keep**.
- **Clear streaming cache** - removes all cached copies now. The confirmation shows how much space you get back. When there is nothing to clear, the app says "Streaming cache is empty. Nothing cached, nothing wasted."

7 Moving to a new phone

When you move to a new phone with Android's own "copy apps and data" transfer, your Google Drive and Dropbox sign-ins come along. On the first start on the new phone these cloud resources simply open - there is no message and nothing to tap.

OneDrive keeps its sign-in in a place the app cannot copy, so on the new phone you sign in to OneDrive once more. If you signed out of a provider on the old phone before the move, that provider is not carried over either.

What You Get

The computer in the living room, the NAS and your cloud folders sit on the main screen next to the phone's own folders. Lists open instantly, previews appear without waiting, and you decide how much space the streaming cache may take.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A slow shared folder recovers on time.** When an SMB connection starts to falter while several files load at once, the app notices every timeout and reconnects when it should, instead of missing some of them.
- **A wrong SFTP path says so.** An SFTP resource whose folder no longer exists on the server shows a plain 'not found' message instead of a general error.
- **A red or unavailable network resource** usually means the computer is asleep or the phone left the home Wi-Fi. Wake the computer and pull down the list to refresh.
- **Everything in one move to a new phone.** Besides the automatic cloud sign-in, you can carry all resources, including network passwords, in a backup file - see Sharing and backing up your resources.
- **Copying between the phone and the network** works in both directions - see Copying, moving and deleting files.
- **Not sure which way of connecting your own devices fits you?** The media exchange portal compares the home network, the exchange server and live broadcast, and shows which program does what on each device.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Connecting SMB/Windows shares

The full walk-through for shared folders on Windows and NAS.

STORAGE

Sharing and backing up your resources

Give your list of places to another phone or keep it safe in a backup.

STORAGE

Adding folders from this device

The phone's own folders, memory cards and USB drives.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #03

All editions (details per step)

Sharing and Backing Up Your Resources

Pack your resources into a file for another phone, import them back, bring in a ready configuration from the Windows companion, keep a full backup in Google Drive, and know what happens if the app's database ever has to be reset.

Why You'll Love This

You spent an evening adding the shared folders of the home computer, the NAS and the cloud, with all their passwords. Now your partner wants the same list on their phone, or you are getting a new phone yourself. Typing everything again is the last thing you want.

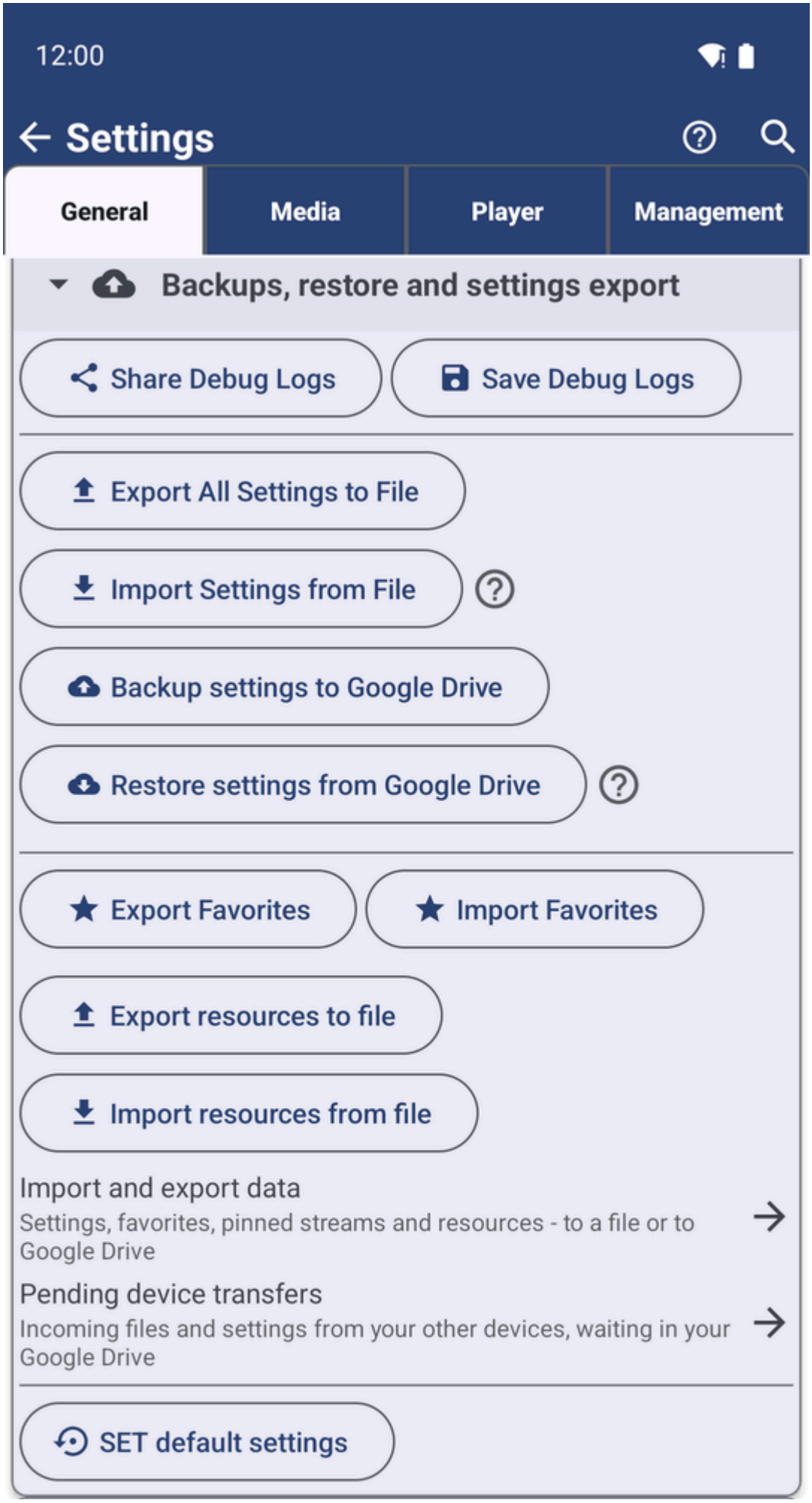
FastMediaSorter can pack your resources into a file, read them back on another phone, and keep a full backup of resources, Favorites and settings in your Google Drive.

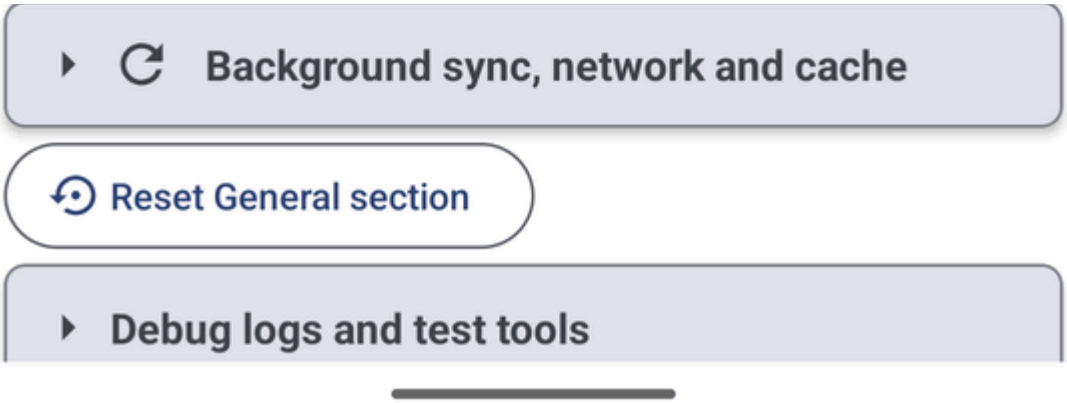
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- Exporting and importing resources to a file, and the Google Drive backup: the editions Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR
- Importing a ready configuration from the Windows companion: the Standard edition.
- For the Google Drive backup: a Google account connected in the app.

1 Find the backup card in Settings

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and expand the card **Backups, restore and settings export**. Everything on this page, except the Windows companion import, starts here.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Backups, restore and settings export
Share Debug Logs
Save Debug Logs
Export All Settings to File
Import Settings from File
Backup settings to Google Drive
Restore settings from Google Drive
Export Favorites
Import Favorites
Export resources to file
Import resources from file
Import and export data
Settings, favorites, pinned streams and resources - to a file or to Google Drive
Pending device transfers
Incoming files and settings from your other devices, waiting in your Google Drive
SET default settings



The backup card in the General settings.

⚠ Treat the file like a key ring

Anyone who gets the file can open your shared folders and servers. Send it directly to the person who needs it, and delete it afterwards.

2 Give your resources to another phone

Tap **Export resources to file**, choose which resources to include, then choose where to save the file.

Before saving, the app warns: "This file will contain access passwords in plain text. Share it only with people you trust." The file carries each resource with its address, user name, password and PIN, so the other phone can open the places straight away.

When it is done you see how many resources were exported and how many were skipped. An SFTP resource that signs in with an SSH key stored inside the app is always skipped, because such a key cannot move to another device.

3 Bring resources in from a file

On the other phone open the same card and tap **Import resources from file**, then pick the file. The app first shows what will happen, for example "3 new resource(s) will be added and 1 existing will be overwritten." Tap **Import** to go ahead.

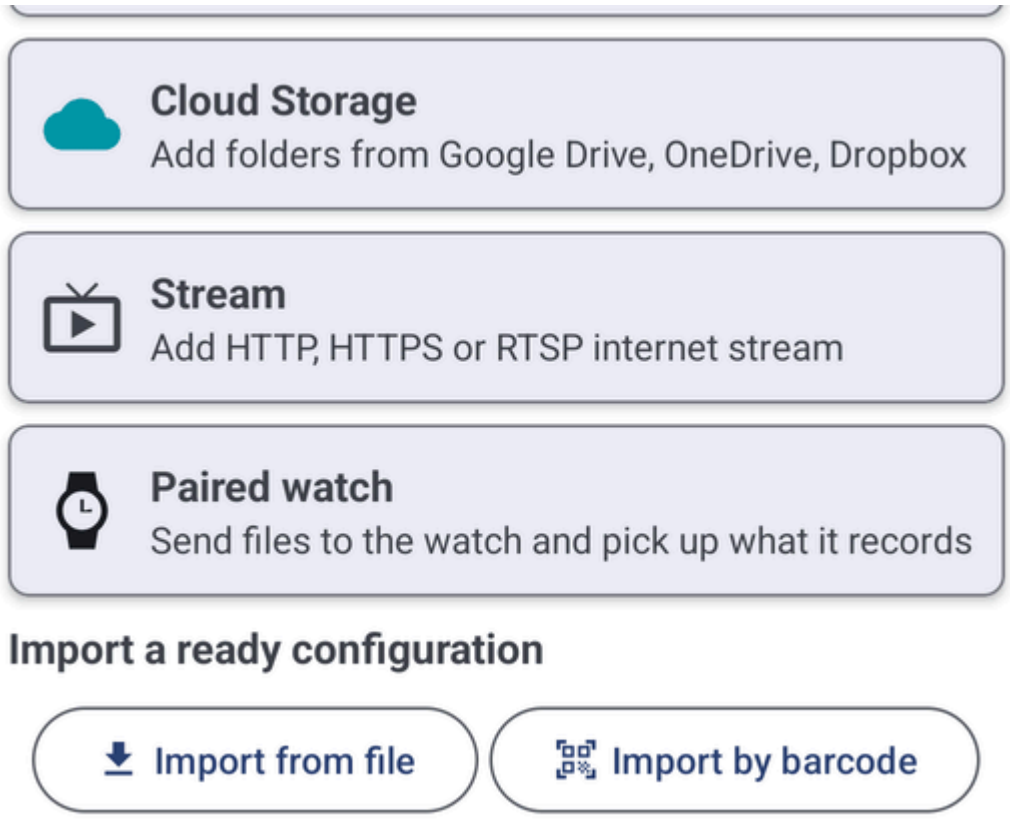
At the end you see "Created 3, updated 1, skipped 0." A file that was not made by this function is refused with "This file is not a valid resources file." – nothing changes in that case.

4 Import a ready configuration from the Windows companion

Standard edition only.

The FastMediaSorter Windows companion can prepare a complete resource on your computer - the shared folder, the account, the kinds of files, even a PIN - and hand it to the phone as a small `.fmscfg` file or as a barcode on the screen.

On the phone tap **Add** on the main screen. Under **Import a ready configuration** tap **Import from file** and pick the `.fmscfg` file, or tap **Import by barcode** and point the camera at the barcode on the computer screen. The resource arrives fully set up. Files from older versions of the companion still import; a file from a newer version than the app understands is refused, and nothing changes.



Import a ready configuration on the Add Resource screen.

5 Keep a full backup in Google Drive

Tap **Backup settings to Google Drive**. The app saves all settings, every resource with its network passwords and saved site sign-ins, your Favorites, your scheduled operations and your launcher desktop into your Google Drive, and reports, for example, "Backed up 12 resources, 40 favorites and all settings to you@gmail.com". The card shows the date of the last backup and the account.

To bring it back, tap **Restore settings from Google Drive**. The app shows where the backup came from and what will happen:

- Settings are replaced.
- Resources and Favorites are added to the ones you already have; exact duplicates are skipped.
  Confirm, and you see how many resources and Favorites were added and how many were already there.

6 Move just one kind of data

Sometimes you want only the Favorites, or only the settings. Tap **Import and export data** - "Settings, favorites, pinned streams and resources - to a file or to Google Drive". In the window that opens choose:

- What: **Settings**, **Favorites**, **Pinned streams** or **Resources**.
- Which way: **Export** or **Import**.
- Where: **Device file** ("Pick a file on this device") or **Google Drive** ("Use the file in the connected Google Drive account").
  A file that holds another kind of data, or comes from a newer version of the app, is refused with a clear message, and nothing is changed.

7 If the app ever has to reset its database

In the Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions.

Very rarely - for example after a failed update - the app cannot open the small database where it keeps your resources and Favorites. Instead of stopping or quietly starting empty, it saves a copy of the old database, starts with a fresh one and tells you so in a **Database reset** window: what happened, the reason, and the folder where the copy of the previous database was saved.

Your media files are not touched by this. Restore your resources and Favorites from the Google Drive backup or from an exported file, and keep the saved copy - it can help if you ask for support.

What You Get

Your list of places travels to another phone in one file, or comes back from Google Drive after a reset, with passwords and PINs in place. You spend the evening looking at photos instead of typing server addresses.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Back up before a big change.** A backup takes a few seconds; do one before you reset the phone or move to a new one.
- **Cloud sign-ins move by themselves** with Android's phone-to-phone transfer - see Adding network folders and cloud storage.
- **All settings in one place**: the full list of backup and export options is described in Backing up and restoring settings.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage

Add the servers and clouds that you will later share.

GENERAL

Backing up and restoring settings

Every backup option of the app on one page.

STORAGE

Protecting files with a PIN and encryption

Keep a resource or a single file away from other eyes.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #04

Sorting Files into Destinations with Quick Sort

Turn your folders into numbered, colored destinations, then copy or move the photo or video you are looking at into one of them with a single tap or a number key.

Why You'll Love This

Three thousand photos from the summer, all in one camera folder. You want the good ones in "Best of 2026", the family ones in "For grandma", the receipts in "Taxes" and the rest left where they are. Dragging files one by one in a file manager would take a week.

Quick Sort turns this into a rhythm: look at a photo, tap the button of the folder it belongs to, and the next photo is already on the screen. Each folder you sort into is a destination - a resource with its own number and color.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Network destinations need any edition except Lite; cloud destinations any edition except Lite and FOSS.
- The folders you want to sort into, added as resources the app can write to - see Adding folders from this device. Read-only resources cannot be destinations.

1 Meet your first destination - Downloads

On first launch the app already makes the phone's **Downloads** folder destination number one, so Quick Sort works out of the box: there is always at least one place to send a file.

2 Turn a folder into a destination

There are three ways, use whichever is closest:

- When adding a folder, tick **Add to Quick Sort** (for a network folder or an SFTP server: **Mark for Quick Sort**).
- On the main screen or in the file browser, open the resource's three-dots menu and tap **Add to Quick Sort**.
- Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, the group **Quick Sort destinations**, and tap **+ Add**. The list offers every resource you can write to that is not a destination yet.

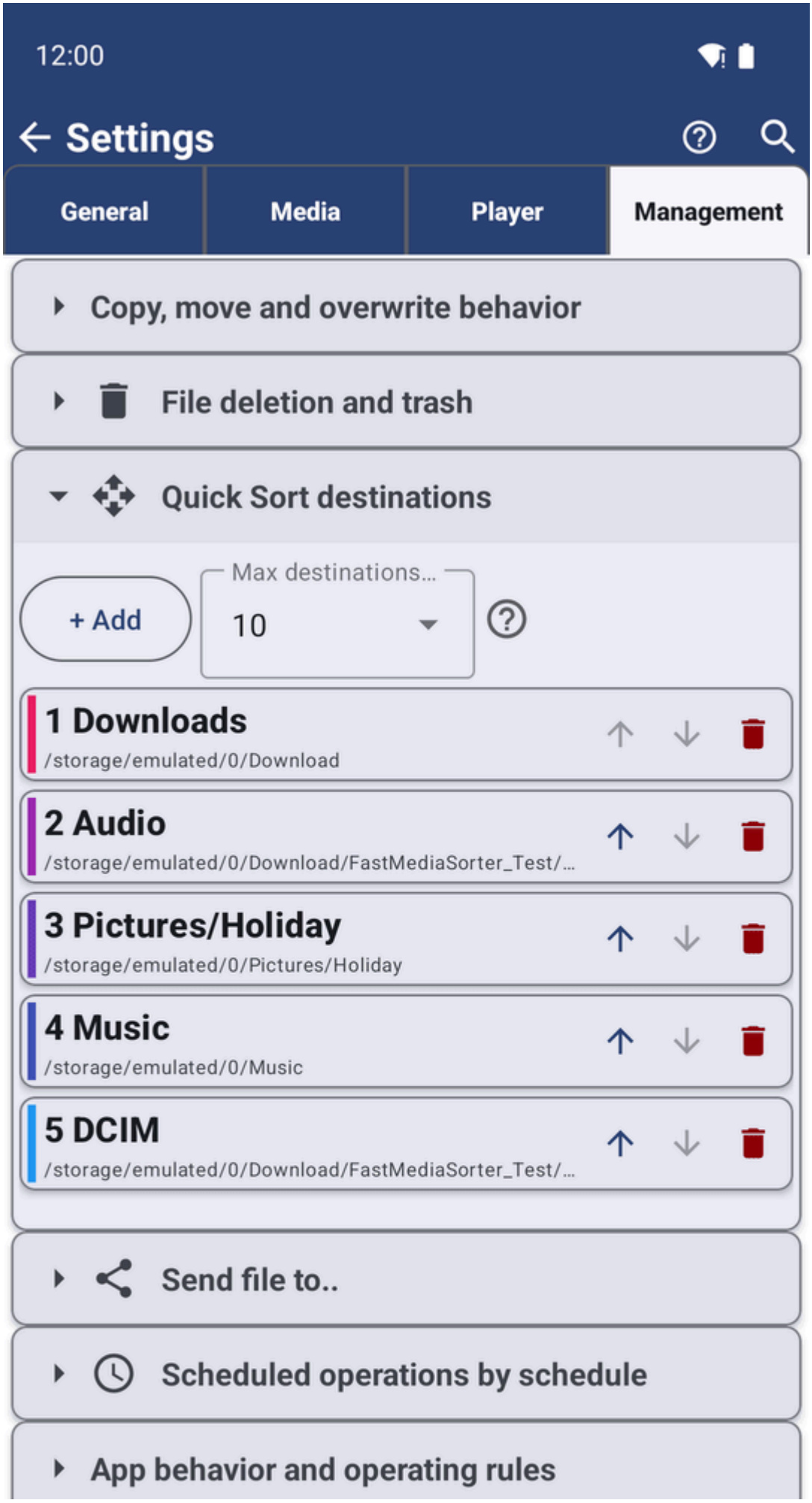
Each new destination gets the next free number and its own color from a set of ten.

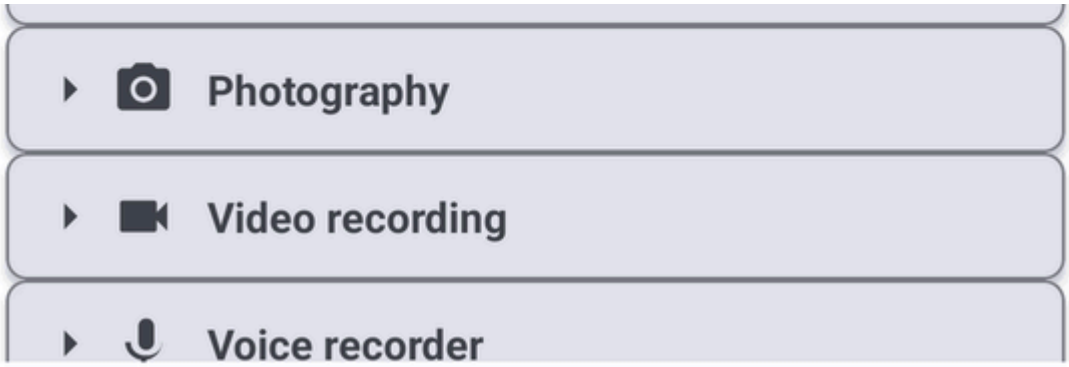
3 Arrange, recolor and limit your destinations

In **Settings**, **Management**, **Quick Sort destinations** you see all destinations in their order. For each one:

- Tap the color square to pick another color - handy when "Delete later" should be red and "Keep" green.
- Use the up and down arrows to change its place, and so its number.
- Tap the delete button to take it off the list ("Remove Destination"). The folder and its files stay; it only stops being a destination.

  Max destinations (1–30) decides how many destinations you can have; the default is 10.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Copy, move and overwrite behavior
File deletion and trash
Quick Sort destinations
+ Add
Max destinations...
10
1 Downloads
/storage/emulated/0/Download
2 Audio
/storage/emulated/0/Download/FastMediaSorter_Test/...
3 Pictures/Holiday
/storage/emulated/0/Pictures/Holiday
4 Music
/storage/emulated/0/Music
5 DCIM
/storage/emulated/0/Download/FastMediaSorter_Test/...
Send file to..
Scheduled operations by schedule
App behavior and operating rules



Your destinations, their colors and their order.

4 Sort while you look at files

Open a folder full of unsorted photos and tap the first one. In the player, the command panel shows two rows of colored buttons, one for each destination:

- **Copy to..** - puts a copy into that destination and leaves the original where it is.
- **Move to..** - moves the file there; it leaves the current folder.

Tap a destination button and the file goes there straight away - no extra question. With **Go to next file after copying** (on by default) the next photo appears at once, so you can keep a steady pace: look, tap, look, tap. After a move the next file appears by itself, because the moved one has left the folder. The folder you are sorting from never shows a button of its own.

The transfer runs in the background, so even a large video to the home computer does not hold you up.

12:00

Copy to.. and Move to.. with your destinations.

5 Make the panel fit your screen

- Tap the **Copy to..** or **Move to..** title to fold that row away when you only copy or only move. When both are folded, they sit side by side in one line.
- The buttons share the width of the screen by themselves: a few destinations get wide buttons, many destinations get more rows of smaller ones, and the text shrinks so that every name stays readable - on a phone, a tablet or a TV.
- Each button keeps its destination's color, with dark or light text chosen so the name is always easy to read.

6 Send a file to a folder that is not a destination

At the end of each row there is a **..** button. It opens Android's folder window: pick any folder, and the file is copied or moved there just once, without adding the folder to your destinations.

7 Sort with number keys on a keyboard or TV remote

With a keyboard, a TV remote or a game pad, each visible button gets a small number badge. Keys **1** to **9** and **0** (for the tenth) fire the buttons in order - first all **Copy to..** buttons, then the **Move to..** buttons. Fold the Copy row away, and the numbers go to the Move buttons. The key badges show the keys you actually assigned, if you changed them in the keyboard settings (see Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control).

8 Same names, and changing your mind

- When the destination already has a file with the same name, the file is left out by default, and nothing at the destination is replaced. Turn on **Overwrite existing file when copying** or **Overwrite existing file when moving** in **Settings**, **Management**, **Copy, move and overwrite behavior** if the new file should replace the old one.
- Tapped the wrong button? A short message with **Undo** appears at the bottom right after the copy or move. Tap it to take the last step back.

What You Get

The summer's three thousand photos are sorted in one evening: the best in "Best of 2026", the family ones in "For grandma", the receipts in "Taxes" - each with one tap, in colors you chose, and the camera folder is finally tidy.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Colors are a memory aid.** Give the same color to destinations that belong together, and sorting becomes a matter of reflex.
- **Copy first, move later.** When you sort for somebody else, copy - your own folder stays complete.
- **Tap zones instead of buttons.** You can also let taps on parts of the screen copy or move - see Touch zones in Video playback and navigation.
- **Many files at once** are copied from the file browser instead - see Copying, moving and deleting files.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Copying, moving and deleting files

Work with many files and folders at once, the trash and Undo.

PHOTOS

Viewing photos, GIFs and zoom gestures

Swipe through the photos you are sorting.

STORAGE

Running file jobs on a schedule

Let the app fill your destinations by itself.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #05

All editions (network - all except Lite; cloud - all except Lite and FOSS)

Copying, Moving and Deleting Files and Folders

Select files and whole folders in the file browser, copy or move them between the phone, network folders and the cloud, delete them with or without the trash, and take the last step back with Undo.

Why You'll Love This

Quick Sort is for one file at a time. But sometimes you want to grab forty photos at once and put them on the memory card, move a whole "Holidays 2019" folder to the computer at home, or clear a folder of blurry shots. That is everyday file work, and the file browser does it without a separate file manager.

Copies and moves work between any two places the app knows: the phone, a memory card, a network folder, an FTP or SFTP server and cloud storage. Deleted files go to the trash first, where the phone allows it, so a mistake is not the end of the world.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

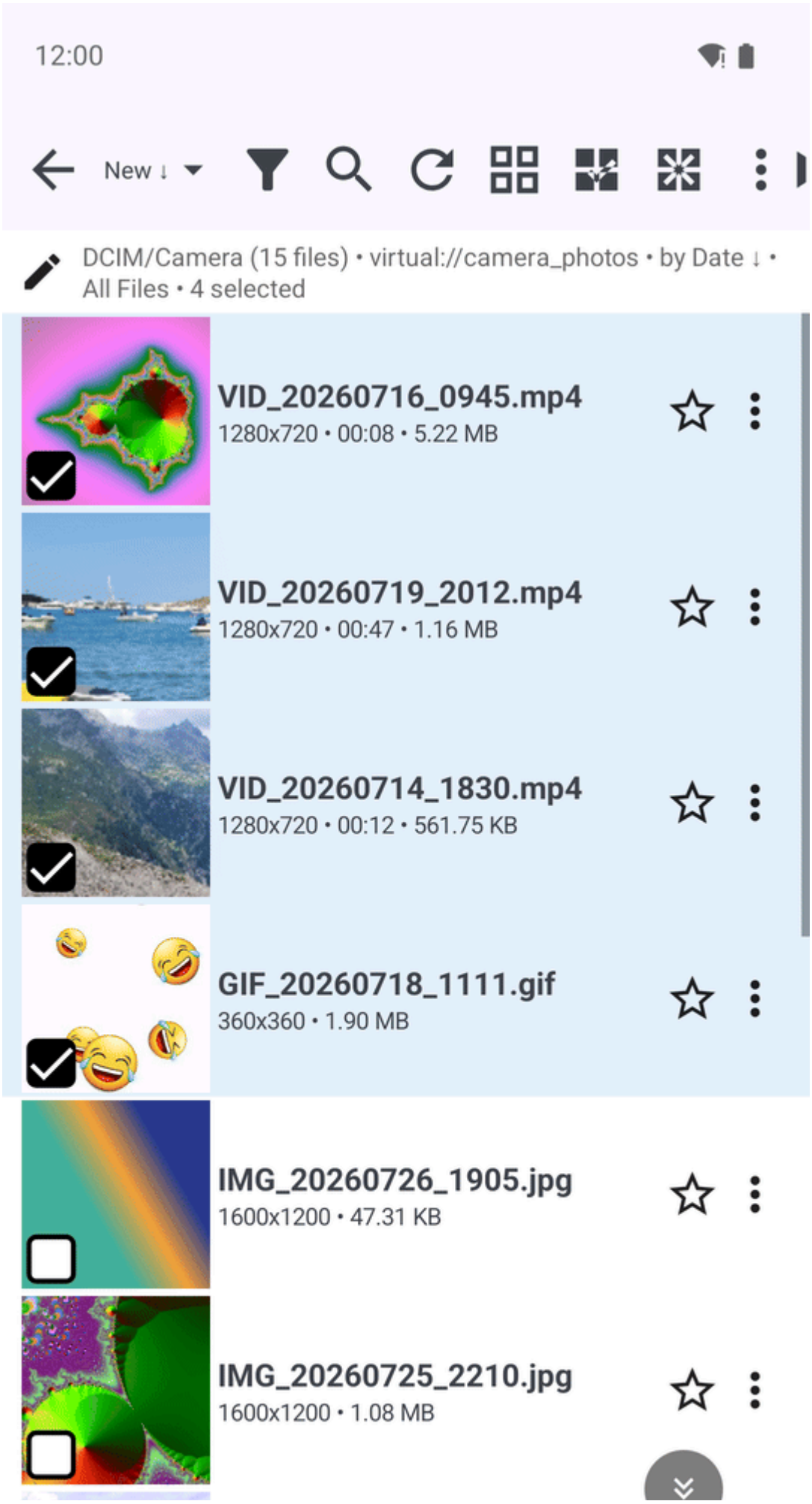
- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Lite copies and moves between folders on this device and memory cards; FOSS also to and from network folders and servers; Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR also to and from the cloud. The Photos edition works with pictures.
- A resource open in the file browser. Move, rename and delete need a resource the app can write to.

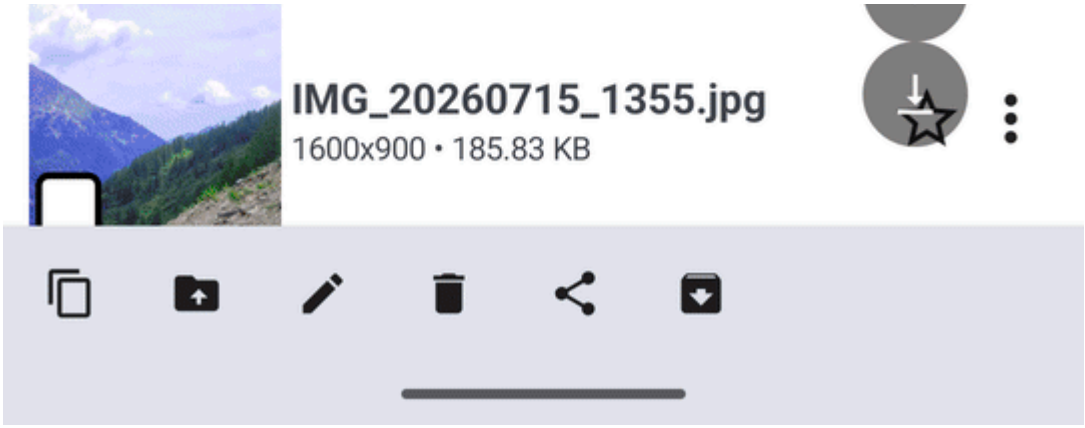
1 Select files and folders

Every row in the file browser has a check box - on files and on folders alike. Tick the ones you want. To select a whole run, tick the first file, then long-press the last one: everything in between is selected too.

Select All at the top ticks the whole folder, the button next to it clears the selection. The number of selected items appears after the folder's name, for example "Holidays • 12 selected".

As soon as something is selected, a bar with the operations appears at the bottom: **Copy**, **Move**, **Rename**, **Delete**, **Share**, **Archive** and **Undo**. On a read-only resource you see only **Copy** and **Share**.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ •
All Files • 4 selected
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
1280x720 • 00:47 • 1.16 MB
VID_20260714_1830.mp4
1280x720 • 00:12 • 561.75 KB
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
1600x1200 • 47.31 KB
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB



Tick files and folders, then choose an operation.

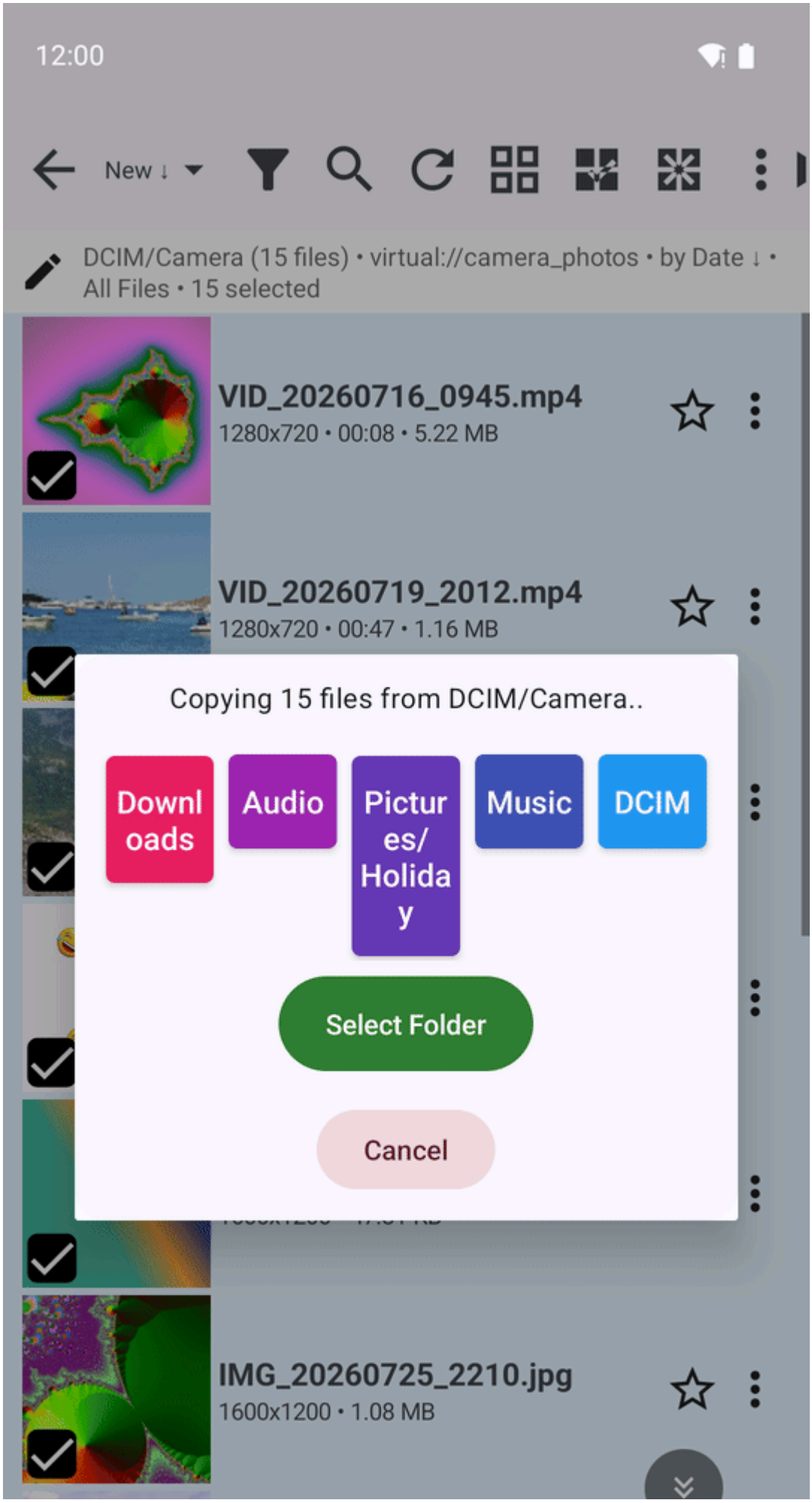
2 Copy or move them somewhere else

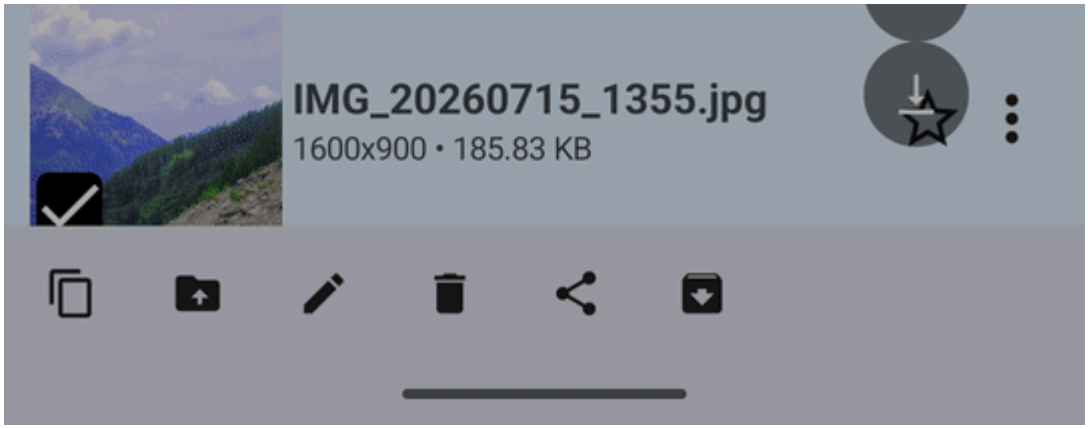
Tap **Copy** or **Move**. A window says what is going to happen, for example "Copying 12 files from Camera", and "Folders included: 1" if you picked folders. Below are your destinations as colored buttons, and **Select Folder** for any other place.

Tap a destination, or tap **Select Folder** and choose a folder in Android's folder window. The transfer starts.

A folder is copied with everything inside it, every subfolder included - even from the phone to the home computer or to the cloud. The app refuses unsafe choices before it starts, and says why:

- "A folder can't be copied or moved into itself. Choose a destination outside it."
- "This folder is already in the chosen destination. Pick a different destination."
- "Not enough space on SD card - 1.2 GB more is needed. Free up room there or pick another destination."


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ •
All Files • 15 selected
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
1280x720 • 00:47 • 1.16 MB
Copying 15 files from DCIM/Camera..
Downl oads
Audio
Pictur es/ Holida y
Music
DCIM
Select Folder
Cancel
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB

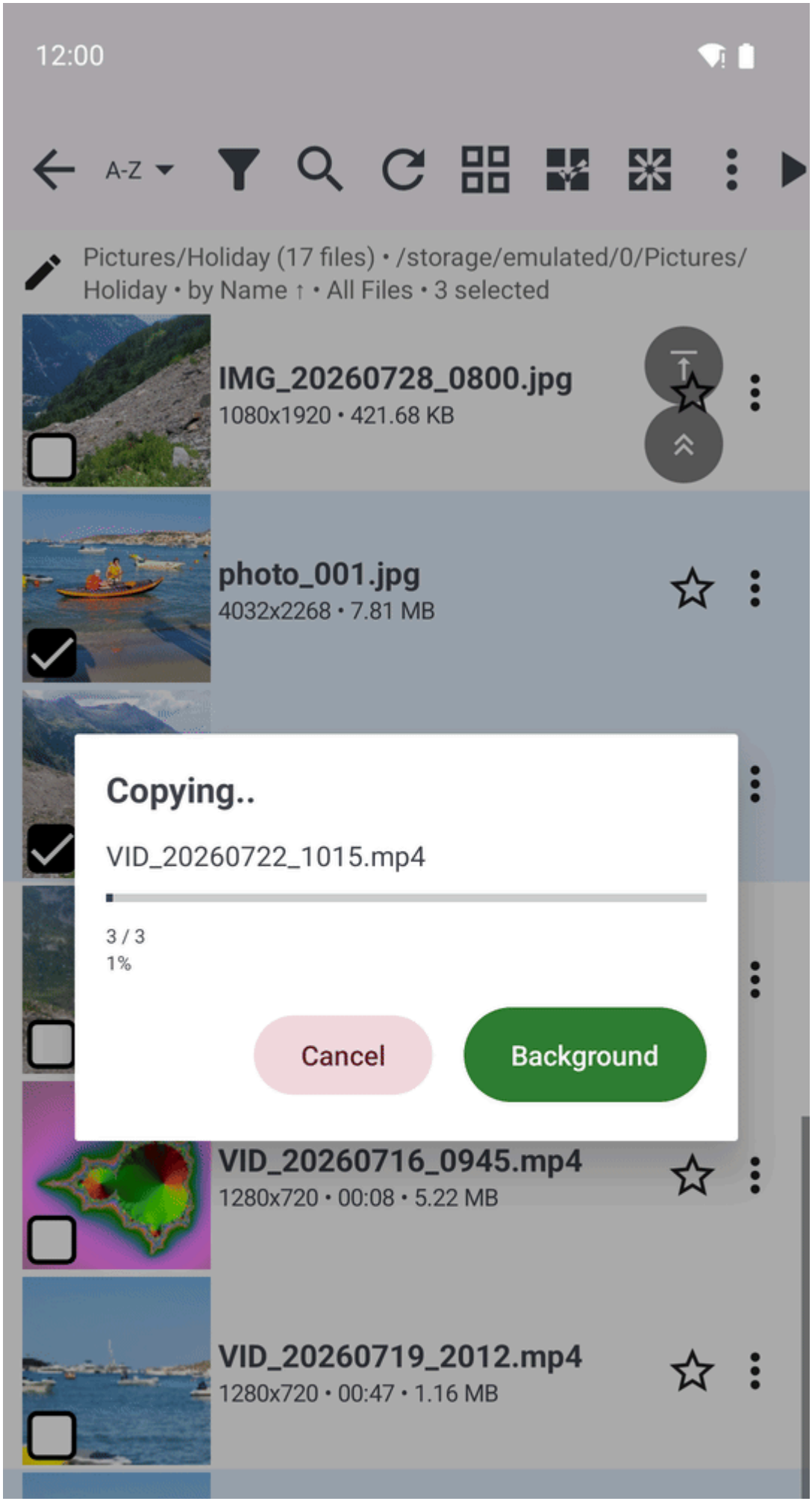


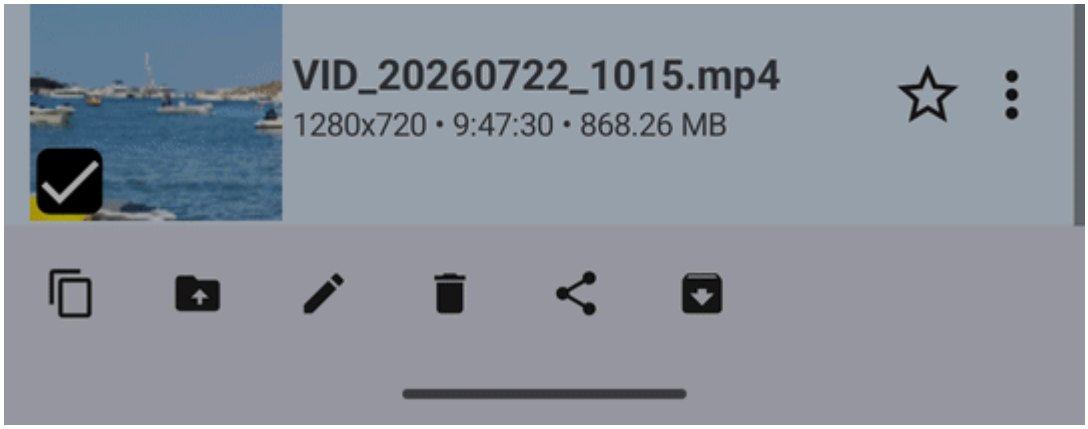
Choose where the files go.

3 Watch it go - or let it run in the background

A progress window shows the file being copied, how many are done ("3 / 12"), the speed ("1.5 MB/s"), the overall percentage and the time left ("~2m 10s"). The speed is averaged over a few seconds, so the numbers stay calm instead of jumping about.

Tap **Background** to carry on with other things; **Cancel** stops the transfer. What happens in the background is described in Background transfers and their progress.


12:00
A-Z
Pictures/Holiday (17 files) • /storage/emulated/0/Pictures/
Holiday • by Name ↑ • All Files • 3 selected
IMG_20260728_0800.jpg
1080x1920 • 421.68 KB
photo_001.jpg
4032x2268 • 7.81 MB
Copying..
VID_20260722_1015.mp4
3 / 3
1%
Cancel
Background
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
1280x720 • 00:47 • 1.16 MB

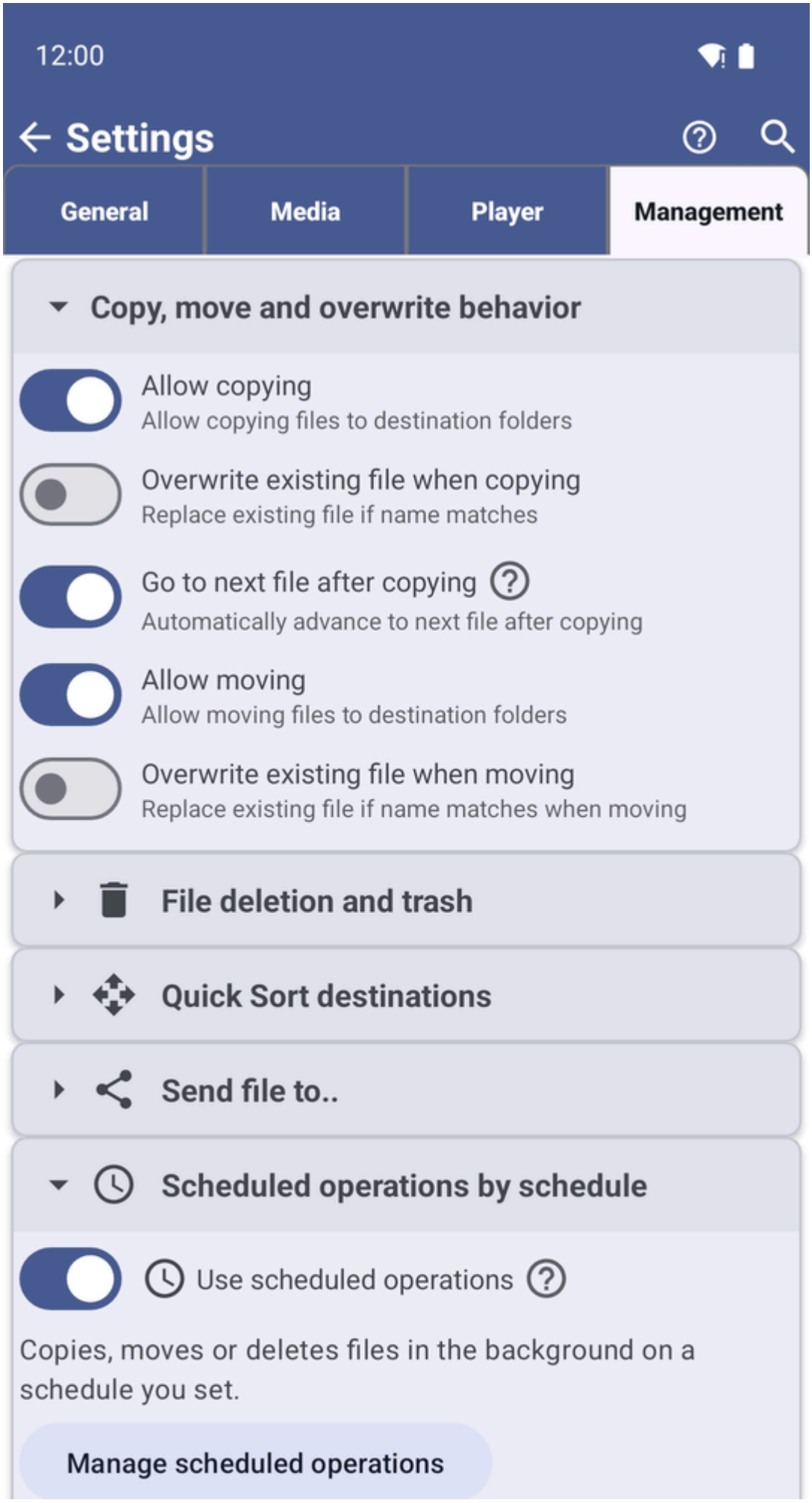


Progress with speed and time left.

4 When a file with the same name is already there

Nothing is replaced unless you ask for it. With overwriting off, a file whose name already exists at the destination is left out, and the file at the destination stays as it was. The final message counts only the files that were really copied or moved - if it says fewer than you selected, the rest already existed there.

To replace such files, open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, **Copy, move and overwrite behavior**, and turn on **Overwrite existing file when copying** or **Overwrite existing file when moving**.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Copy, move and overwrite behavior
Allow copying
Allow copying files to destination folders
Overwrite existing file when copying
Replace existing file if name matches
Go to next file after copying
Automatically advance to next file after copying
Allow moving
Allow moving files to destination folders
Overwrite existing file when moving
Replace existing file if name matches when moving
File deletion and trash
Quick Sort destinations
Send file to..
Scheduled operations by schedule
Use scheduled operations
Copies, moves or deletes files in the background on a schedule you set.
Manage scheduled operations

Two switches decide whether a file with the same name is replaced.

⚠ Deleting cannot always be undone

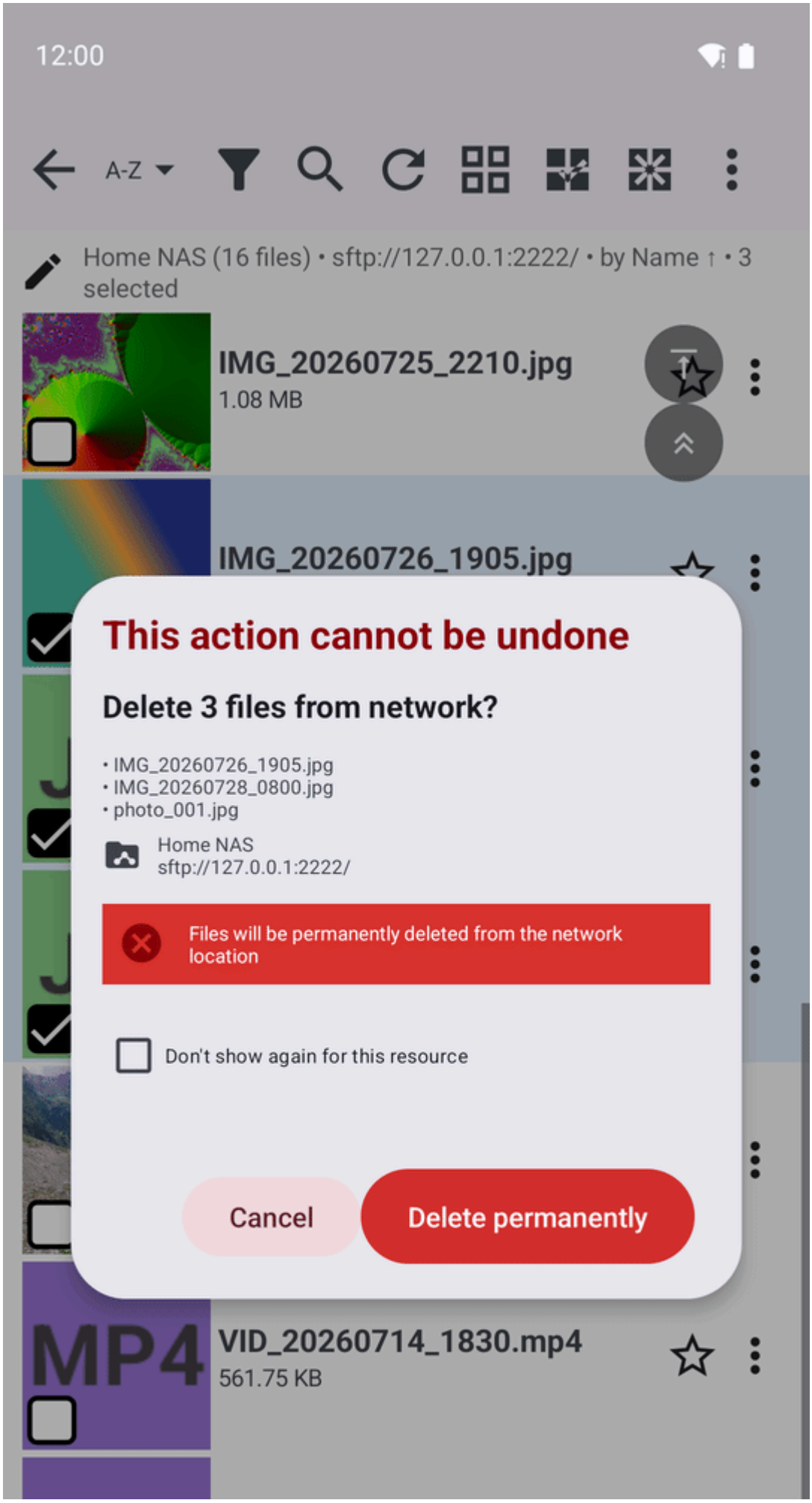
On a network folder or in the cloud, and on the phone with the trash off, **Delete** removes the files for good - **Undo** cannot bring them back.

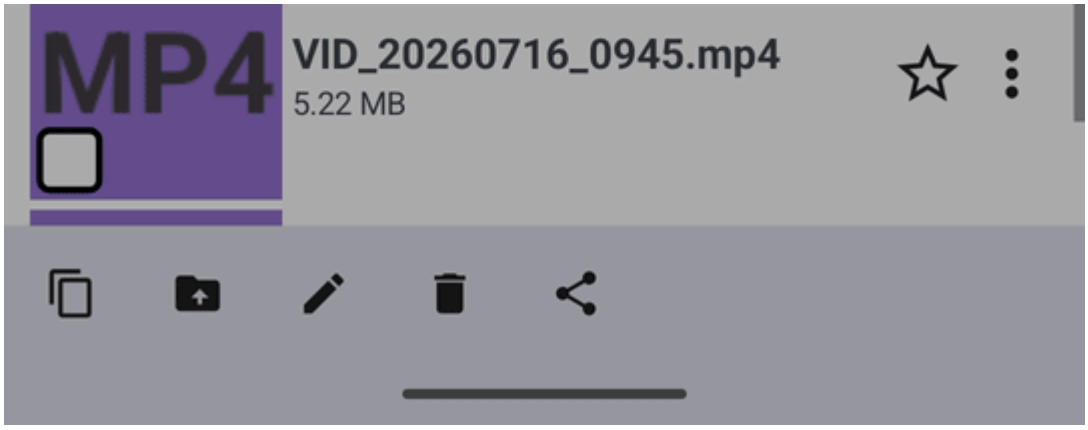
5 Delete files and folders

Select what should go and tap **Delete**. What happens next depends on where the files are and on your settings:

- **On the phone or memory card with the trash on** – the files move into a hidden `.trash` folder next to them, where Undo can bring them back. Turn this on or off with **Use trash folder (.trash)** in **Settings**, **Management**, **File deletion and trash**.
- **Without the trash** – the files are deleted for good. On Android 11 and newer, Android itself may show its own window asking you to allow the deletion of media files; tap **Allow**.
- **On a network folder or in the cloud** – these places have no trash, so the app shows a list of what will go and a **Delete permanently** button, once per resource. Tick **Don't show again for this resource** if you do not need the reminder.

  With **Enable Safe Mode** and **Confirm before delete** on, the app first asks "Delete Files?" – or, for a whole folder, "Delete folder .. and all its contents?". If the trash cannot be used for some files, the app says so: "Trash is unavailable for some files – they were deleted permanently."


12:00
A-Z
Home NAS (16 files) • sftp://127.0.0.1:2222/ • by Name ↑ • 3 selected
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1.08 MB
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
This action cannot be undone
Delete 3 files from network?
• IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
• IMG_20260728_0800.jpg
• photo_001.jpg
Home NAS
sftp://127.0.0.1:2222/
Files will be permanently deleted from the network location
Don't show again for this resource
Cancel
Delete permanently
MP4
VID_20260714_1830.mp4
561.75 KB



Deleting on a network folder is permanent.

6 Undo the last step

Right after a copy, move, delete or rename, a message at the bottom offers **Undo**, and the **Undo** button stays in the operations bar. You have about ten seconds:

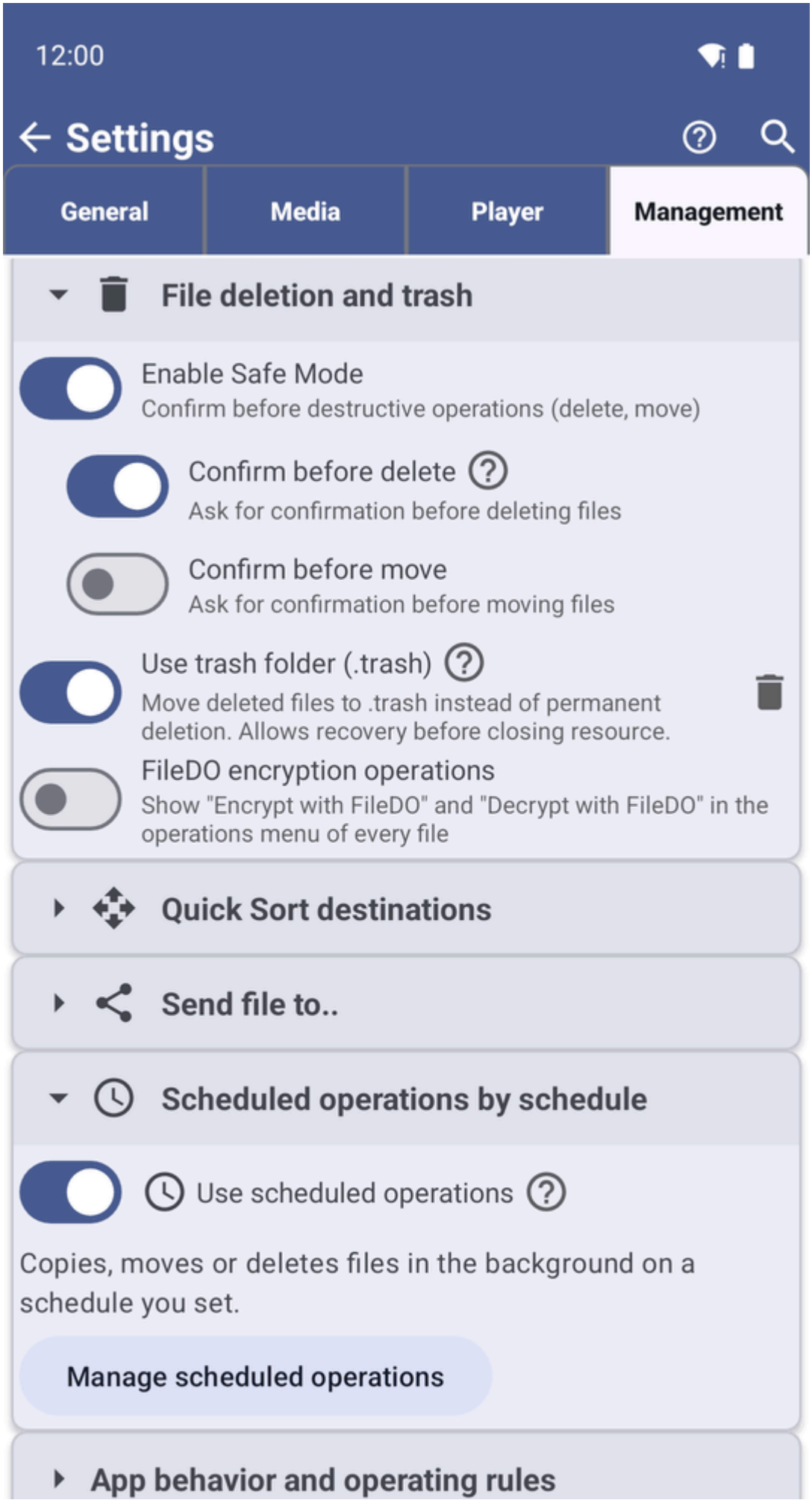
- **Undo a delete** - the files come back out of the trash to their place.
- **Undo a move** - the files go back where they came from. A moved folder is carried back as a background transfer ("Moving the folders back..").
- **Undo a copy** - the copies are deleted. For folders the app asks first, "Undo the folder copy?", and warns that anything added to the copies since will go too; tap **Delete the copies** to confirm. The original folders stay where they are.
- **Undo a rename** - the old name comes back.

In the player, the **Undo** button of the command panel brings back the file you just deleted.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Undo after a delete**
Browse on a local folder, 3 photos just moved to the trash, the Undo message visible.

7 How long the trash keeps files

The trash is a safety net for the moment, not an archive. A background task runs about every 15 minutes and empties trash folders whose contents are older than a few minutes, so the space comes back by itself. To empty all trash folders at once, tap the **Clear Trash** button next to **Use trash folder (.trash)** - the app reports how many trash folders it removed.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
File deletion and trash
Enable Safe Mode
Confirm before destructive operations (delete, move)
Confirm before delete
Ask for confirmation before deleting files
Confirm before move
Ask for confirmation before moving files
Use trash folder (.trash)
Move deleted files to .trash instead of permanent deletion. Allows recovery before closing resource.
FileDO encryption operations
Show "Encrypt with FileDO" and "Decrypt with FileDO" in the operations menu of every file
Quick Sort destinations
Send file to..
Scheduled operations by schedule
Use scheduled operations
Copies, moves or deletes files in the background on a schedule you set.
Manage scheduled operations
App behavior and operating rules

Clear Trash empties every trash folder at once.

What You Get

Forty photos are on the memory card, the "Holidays 2019" folder with all its subfolders is on the home computer, the blurry shots are gone - and the one photo you deleted by mistake came back with a single tap on Undo.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Moving between the phone and the cloud** takes as long as your connection needs; send it to the background and keep sorting.
- **Delete by mistake on a network folder?** There is no trash there. When in doubt, move files to a 'To delete' folder first and empty it later.
- **Renaming several files** has its own page - see Renaming files and folders.
- **Selecting in bigger ways** - filters, range selection and more - is covered in Multi-selection and batch operations.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Background transfers and their progress

What happens while a big copy runs and you do something else.

STORAGE

Renaming files and folders

Give one file or a whole batch new names.

STORAGE

Freeing space

Find duplicates and big files, pack files into ZIP archives.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #06

All editions (details per step)

Background Transfers and Their Progress

What happens while a big copy or move runs in the background - the notification, the thin progress line at the bottom of every screen, files shared into the app, unreachable servers, expired cloud sign-ins, and new files saved on the phone when their destination is out of reach.

Why You'll Love This

Copying two hundred holiday videos to the computer at home can take a while. You do not want to stare at a progress window for that long - you want to keep sorting photos, answer a message, or just put the phone down.

FastMediaSorter runs copies and moves as background tasks that carry on when you leave the screen or close the app. This page shows how to keep an eye on them, and what the app does when something gets in the way.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Receiving files shared from other apps: Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy. Network servers and the cloud: see Copying, moving and deleting files for which editions have them.
- Permission to show notifications, so Android can display the progress while the app is closed.

1 Send a transfer to the background

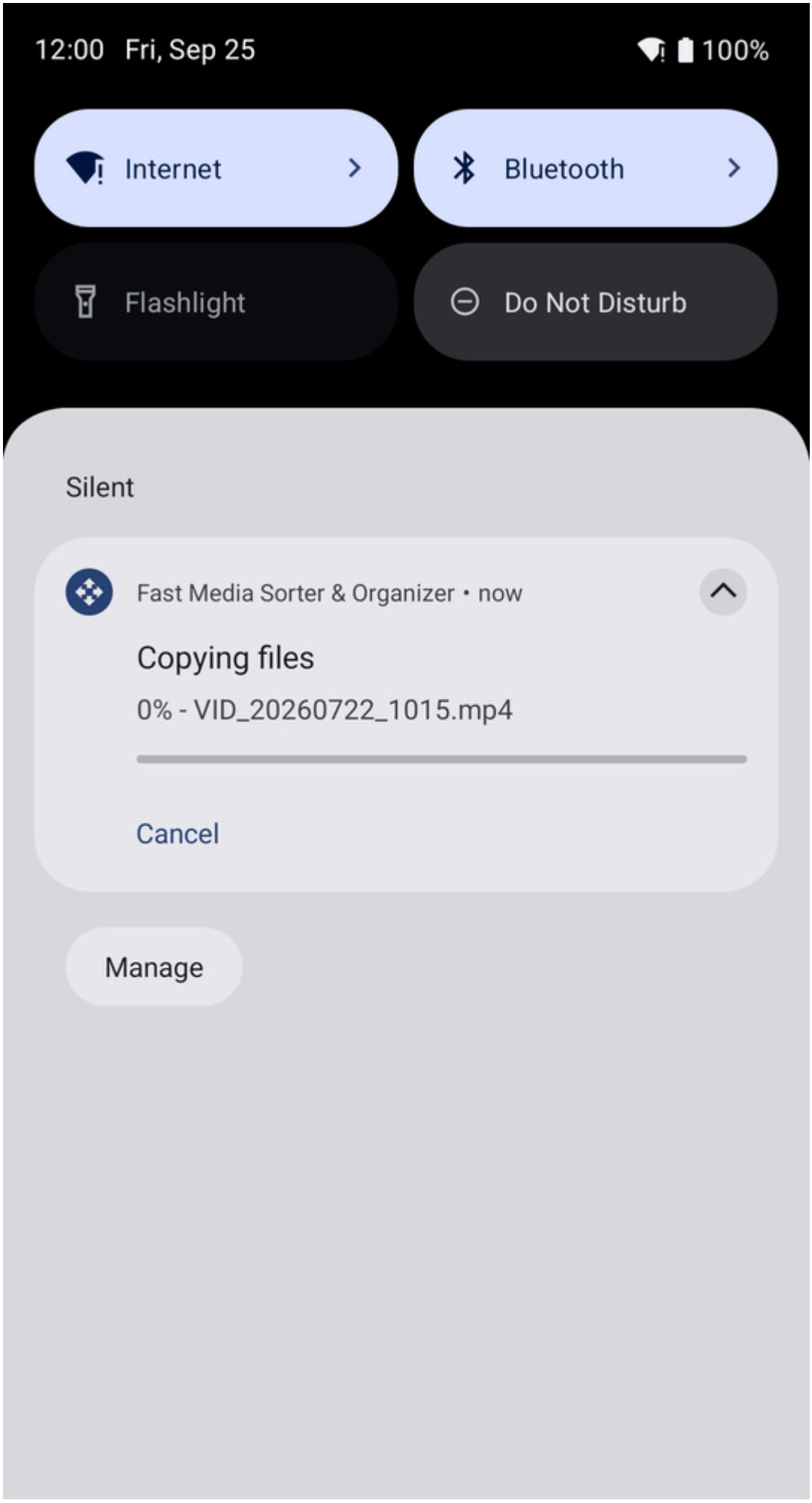
Start a copy or move in the file browser, and in the progress window tap **Background**. The app says "Transfer continues in the background." and you are free: open another folder, sort photos in the player, or leave the app.

Transfers started with Quick Sort in the player run in the background from the start. One transfer runs at a time; if you start another while one is still going, the app says "A file transfer is already running."

2 Follow it in the notification

While the transfer runs, the notification shade shows "Copying files" or "Moving files" with the percentage and the current file, and a **Cancel** button. At the end you get "File transfer complete" with the number of files, and "Folders transferred: 2" if folders were part of it. If something failed, the notification says "File transfer failed" with the reason.

Tap the notification to go back to the folder you started from.


12:00 Fri, Sep 25
100%
Internet
Bluetooth
Flashlight
Do Not Disturb
Silent
Fast Media Sorter & Organizer • now
Copying files
0% - VID_20260722_1015.mp4
Cancel
Manage

A copy running in the background.

3 The thin progress line at the bottom of the screen

As long as a transfer runs, a thin line along the very bottom edge of the app fills up from left to right, on every screen - so you always know that something is still being copied. In the file browser it also shows a short text such as "Copying 42% - IMG_2031.jpg". Tap it to open the full progress window again.

4 Folders stay up to date by themselves

When a background task changes a folder while you are looking at something else - a scheduled operation moved files away, or the watch asked to delete a file - the folder's list catches up the moment you return to it. You do not see files that are no longer there, and you do not have to refresh by hand.

5 Receive files from other apps

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions.

In any app - a messenger, the gallery, a browser - tap **Share** and choose FastMediaSorter. The same window as for **Copy** opens straight away: tap a destination or **Select Folder**. The copying then continues in the background with the usual notification, even after the window has closed, and a final notification tells you when it is done.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Receiving a shared photo**
A photo shared from the gallery app, destination dialog over it.

6 When the server cannot be reached

Before copying to a network folder, the app checks in a couple of seconds whether the computer or NAS answers. If it does not - it is switched off, or the phone left the home Wi-Fi - the transfer stops right away with "Destination server is unreachable - transfer aborted", instead of hanging for minutes. Your files stay where they were. Wake the computer and try again.

7 When the cloud asks you to sign in again

Cloud services end a sign-in from time to time. If that happens during a copy or move, the app shows **Authentication Required** - "Cloud authentication required. Please go to Resources and sign in to this Cloud resource." Tap **Sign In** to sign in to that provider right there, then start the transfer again. In the background the notification says "Sign in required - Open FastMediaSorter to sign in and continue".

8 A new file is never lost

When the app saves a new file - a photo from its camera, a voice note, a download - into a network folder or the cloud, and that place cannot be reached, it saves the file on the phone instead and tells you where: "Saved to DCIM/Camera - Home PC is unavailable". Photos go to the camera folder, videos to Movies, other files to the matching standard folder. Move them to their place later - see Photos, videos and voice notes into a folder.

What You Get

The two hundred videos arrived on the home computer while you kept sorting photos, the notification told you when they were done, and nothing got lost on the way - not even when the Wi-Fi dropped for a moment.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Allow notifications.** Without them the transfer still runs, but you only see its progress inside the app.
- **Big transfers and battery saving.** For very long copies, keep the phone on the charger; some phones slow down background work on a low battery.
- **A permission is missing?** On Android 11 and newer the notification may say 'Permission required' - open the app, allow the access and start again.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Copying, moving and deleting files

Start copies and moves, and undo them.

STORAGE

Running file jobs on a schedule

Background copies that start by themselves.

TOOLS

Sharing files to nearby devices and apps

The other direction - send files from the app to others.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #07

Renaming Files and Folders

Rename one file, a folder or several files at once in the file browser or in the player - on the phone, on network folders and in the cloud - and take a rename back with Undo.

Why You'll Love This

Camera names like `IMG_20260712_183412.jpg` tell you nothing a year later. "Anna's first bike ride.jpg" does. A good name makes a photo easy to find by search and easy to recognize in any app.

FastMediaSorter renames right where you look at your files: one photo in the player, or a whole batch in the file browser, each with its own new name. It works on the phone, on the memory card, on network folders and in cloud storage.

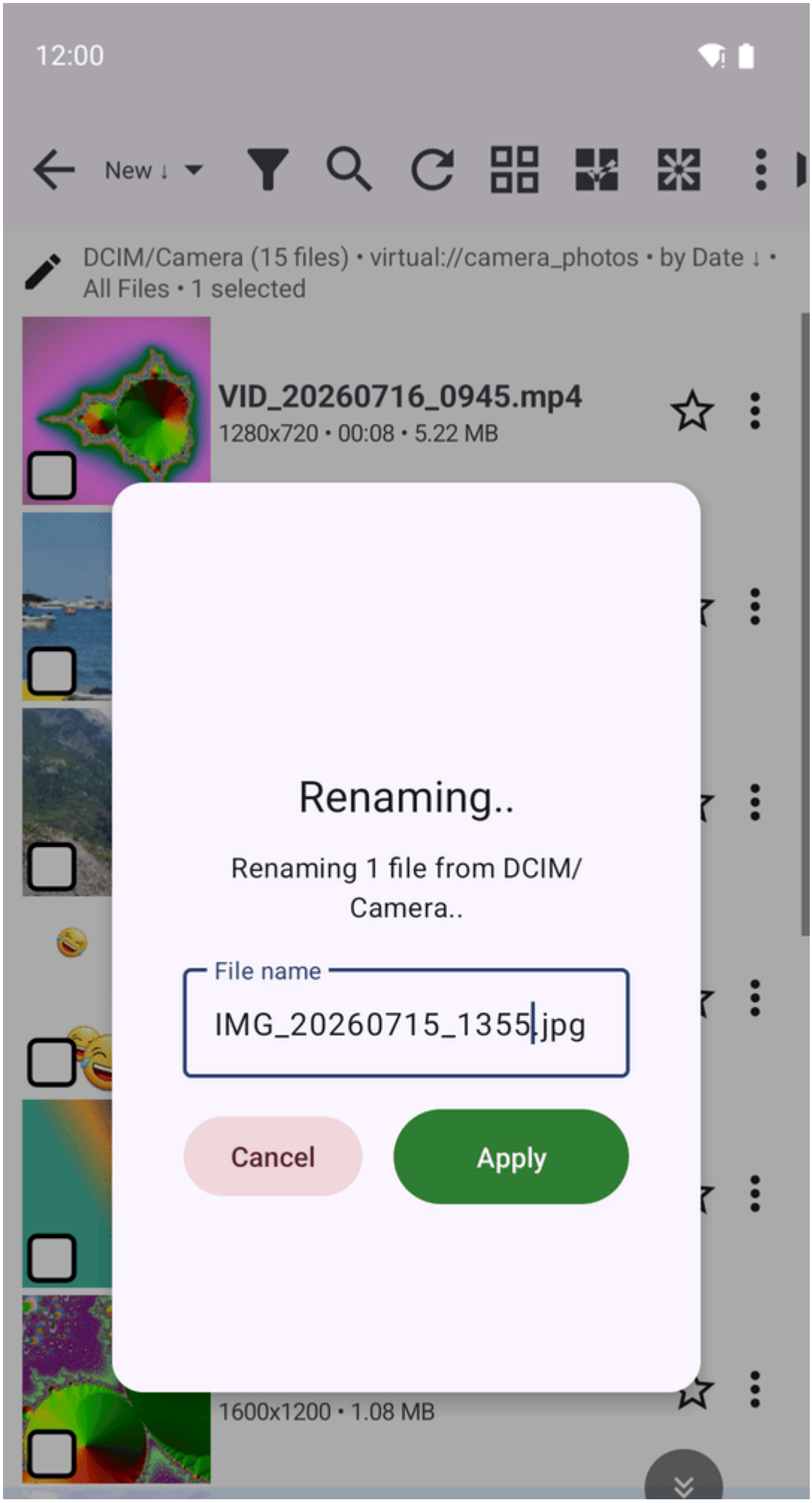
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS.
- A resource the app can write to. On a read-only resource the Rename button does not appear.

1 Rename one file

In the file browser tick the file and tap **Rename** in the bar at the bottom. The **Renaming..** window shows the current name with the part before the extension already selected, so you can simply type the new name - the `.jpg` stays. Tap **Apply**.

If the name is empty, the app says "File name cannot be empty." If another file already has that name, you see "File already exists: .." and can choose a different one.

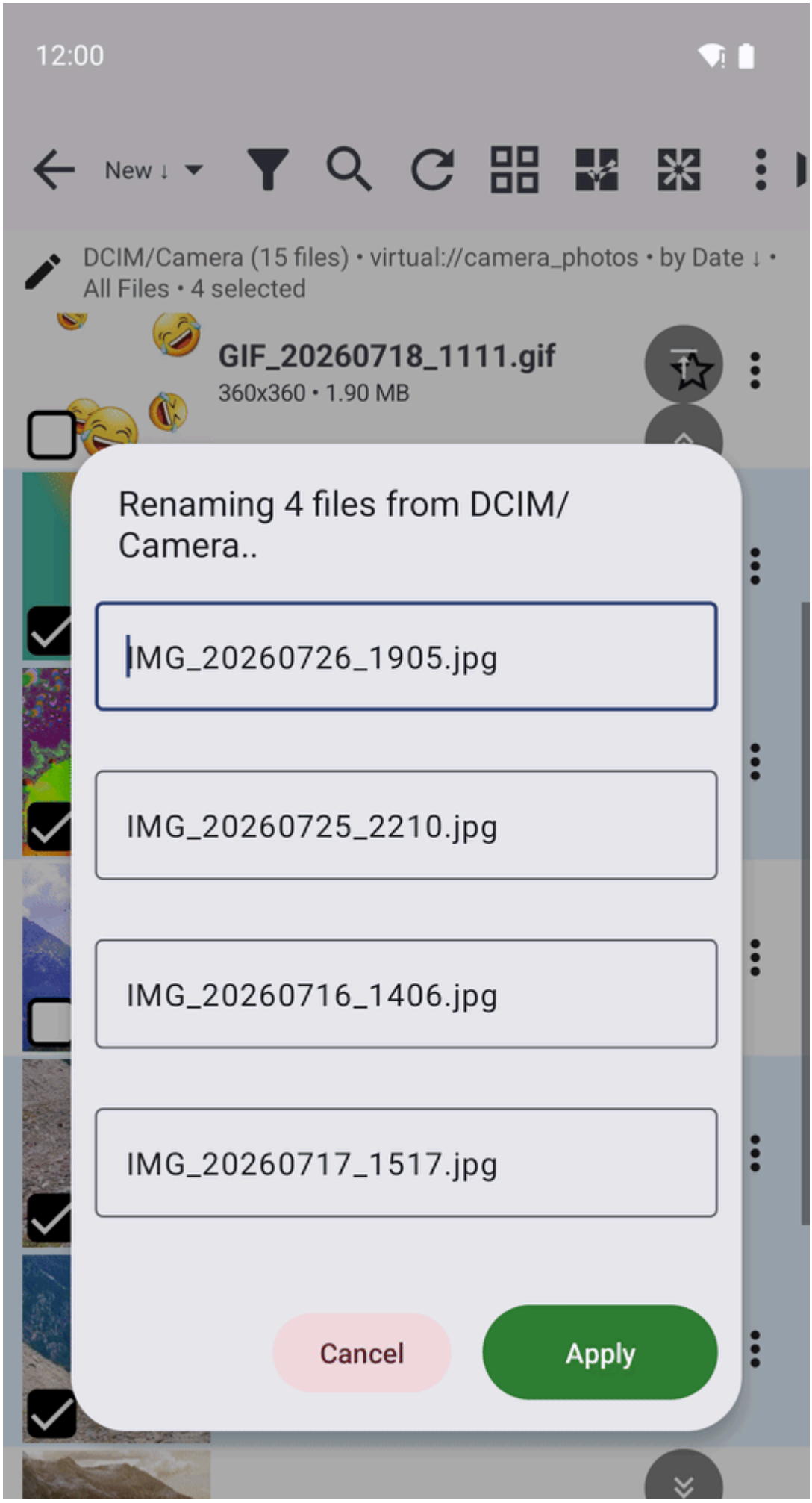

12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ •
All Files • 1 selected
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
Renaming..
Renaming 1 file from DCIM/
Camera..
File name
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg
Cancel
Apply
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB

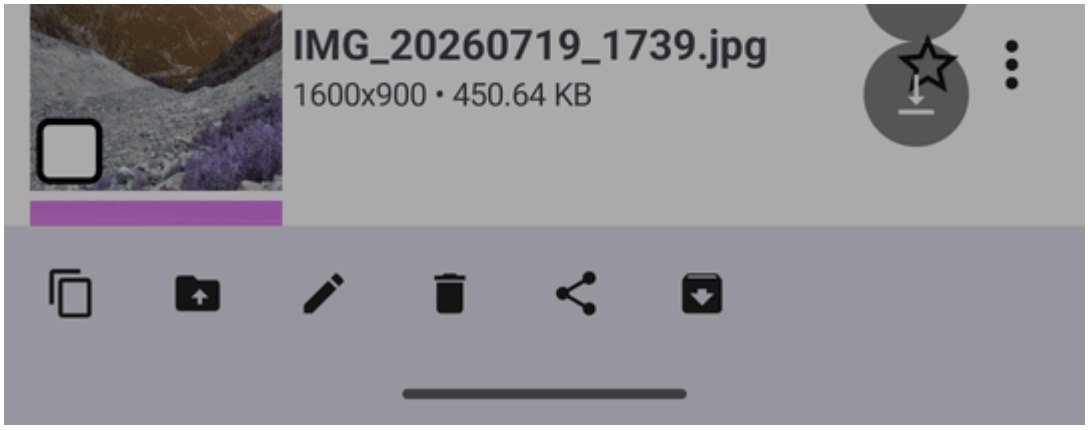
Type the new name; the extension stays.

2 Rename several files at once

Tick several files and tap **Rename**. The window now lists every selected file with its own name field, filled with its current name. Go down the list and change the names you want – you can leave some as they are. Tap **Apply**, and all changes are made in one go.

If one of the new names is already taken, that file keeps its old name and the app lists it afterwards; the others are renamed.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ •
All Files • 4 selected
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
Renaming 4 files from DCIM/
Camera..
IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
IMG_20260716_1406.jpg
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
Cancel
Apply



Every selected file gets its own name field.

3 Rename a folder

Folders are renamed the same way: tick the folder and tap **Rename**, or use **Rename** in the folder's own three-dots menu. Everything inside the folder stays as it is.

4 Rename while you look at a photo

In the player tap **Rename** on the command panel. The same **Renaming..** window opens for the file on the screen. This is the quickest way to give good names to photos while you go through them one by one. With a keyboard you can also use its rename shortcut, and a touch zone can be set to rename.

5 Take a rename back

Right after renaming in the file browser, tap **Undo** in the message at the bottom or in the operations bar, and the old name comes back. Other apps such as the gallery see the new names too: after a rename the app tells Android about the change, so the file does not appear twice or vanish from them.

What You Get

The birthday photos are called "Anna's birthday 01.jpg" to "Anna's birthday 12.jpg", the scans have readable names, and you can find any of them later by typing a word into search.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Keep the extension.** Changing `.jpg` to something else does not convert the file - it only confuses other apps. The app selects just the name part for you, so you do not remove it by accident.
- **Names on network folders** follow the rules of the computer they live on; Windows, for example, does not allow characters like `?` or `:` in names.
- **Want files in a certain order?** Start their names with a number, like `01 Arrival.jpg`, `02 Beach.jpg` - and sort the folder by name (see Sorting, filtering and quick search).

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Copying, moving and deleting files

The other everyday operations of the file browser.

BROWSING

Sorting, filtering and quick search

Find your newly named files in a moment.

STORAGE

Quick Sort destinations

Sort renamed photos into their folders with one tap.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #08

Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR; ZIP archives in all editions

Freeing Space - Duplicates, Big Files and ZIP Archives

Find identical files across your folders and delete the extra copies, remove every file above or below a chosen size in one go, and pack selected files into a ZIP archive.

Why You'll Love This

The phone says the storage is almost full. Somewhere in the camera roll, the WhatsApp folder and the old backup from the laptop, the same photos sit three times over, and a few forgotten screen recordings take gigabytes each.

This page shows three tools that deal with it: a finder for identical files, a way to delete files by size, and a ZIP packer that turns a pile of small files into one tidy archive.

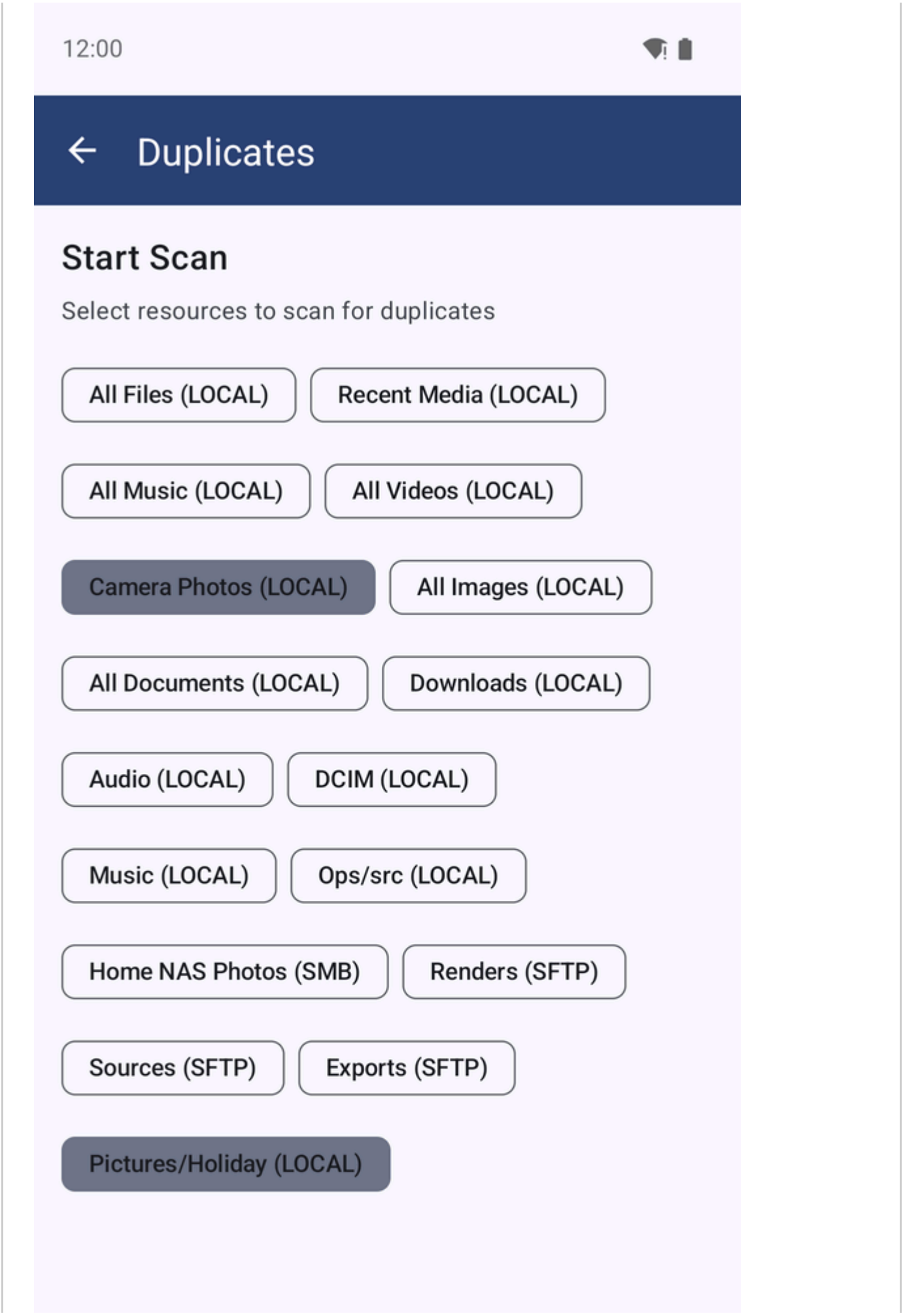
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

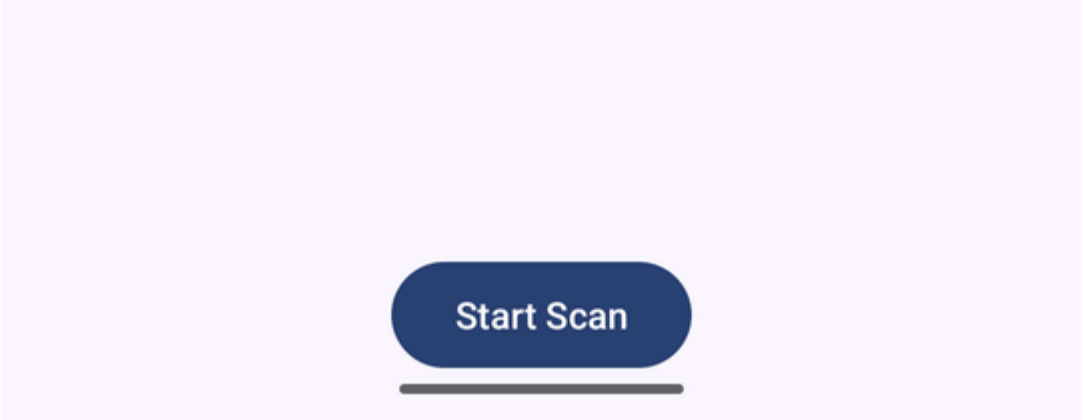
- Finding duplicates and deleting by size: the Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR editions.
- ZIP archives: every edition - Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- A resource you can write to. ZIP archives are made from files on this device only.

1 Start the search for duplicates

Open a resource in the file browser, open the three-dots menu at the top and tap **Find Duplicates**. The **Duplicates** screen opens with a list of all your resources - "Select resources to scan for duplicates". The resource you came from is already ticked and sits at the top; tick any others that may hold copies, for example the camera folder and the WhatsApp folder together.

Tap **Start Scan**. If a network or cloud resource is ticked, the app warns first: "Network scan may take a long time and consume a lot of traffic. Continue?"


12:00
Duplicates
Start Scan
Select resources to scan for duplicates
All Files (LOCAL)
Recent Media (LOCAL)
All Music (LOCAL)
All Videos (LOCAL)
Camera Photos (LOCAL)
All Images (LOCAL)
All Documents (LOCAL)
Downloads (LOCAL)
Audio (LOCAL)
DCIM (LOCAL)
Music (LOCAL)
Ops/src (LOCAL)
Home NAS Photos (SMB)
Renders (SFTP)
Sources (SFTP)
Exports (SFTP)
Pictures/Holiday (LOCAL)

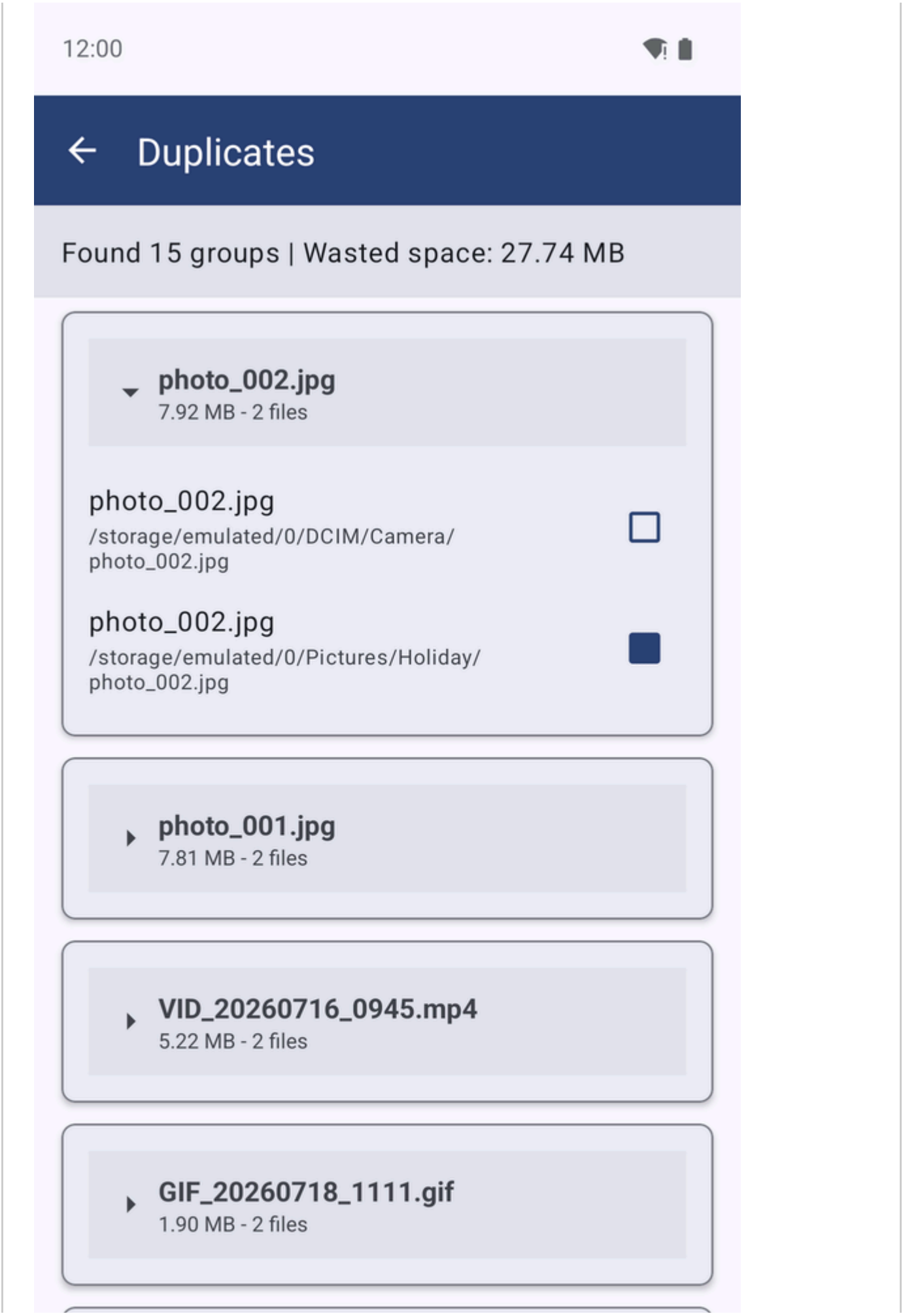


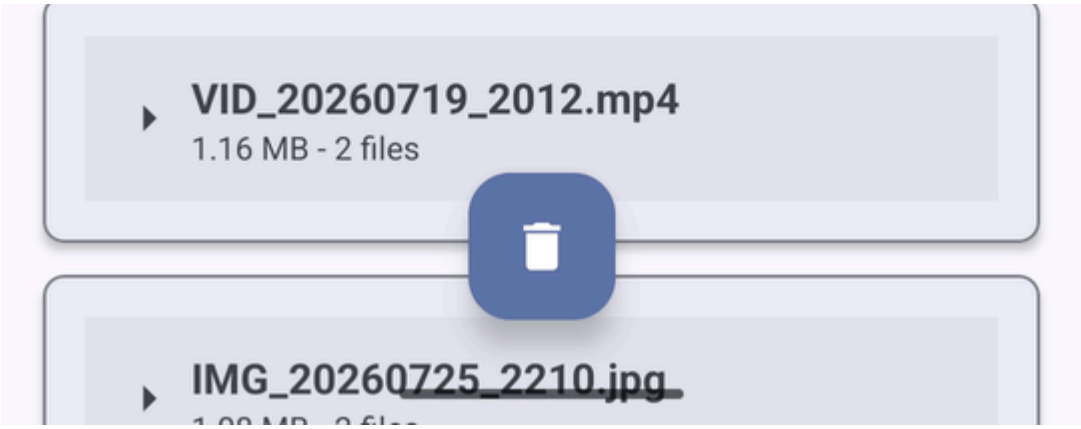
Choose where to look for copies.

2 Look at the groups of identical files

The app compares files in three rounds – first by size, then by their first few bytes, and at last by their complete content – so only truly identical files end up together, however they are named. The scan keeps running with a notification if you leave the screen.

The result is a list of groups, the biggest waste first: each group says how many files it has and how much space the extra copies take ("Wasted space: 240 MB"). In every group the app has already ticked all copies except the oldest one, which it treats as the original.


12:00
Duplicates
Found 15 groups | Wasted space: 27.74 MB
photo_002.jpg
7.92 MB - 2 files
photo_002.jpg
/storage/emulated/0/DCIM/Camera/
photo_002.jpg
photo_002.jpg
/storage/emulated/0/Pictures/Holiday/
photo_002.jpg
photo_001.jpg
7.81 MB - 2 files
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
5.22 MB - 2 files
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
1.90 MB - 2 files



Groups of identical files, extra copies already ticked.

⚠ This deletion cannot be undone

The app asks 'Are you sure you want to permanently delete..?' before it deletes. Look through the ticks once more – especially in groups where the copies sit in different folders.

3 Delete the extra copies

Change the ticks if you want to keep a different copy – you can also drag across several files to tick them at once – or delete one file with its own delete button. Then tap **Delete Selected**, which shows how many files and how much space it will free. Confirm, and the selected copies are deleted for good.

In a hurry? **Find and Delete Duplicates** in the same menu opens the same screen, ready to delete right after the scan.

⚠ Network and cloud folders have no trash

On a network or cloud resource the confirmation adds a red line: 'Warning: trash is not supported for this resource. Deletion will be permanent!' On the phone's own folders deleted files go to the trash when it is switched on – see Copying, moving and deleting files.

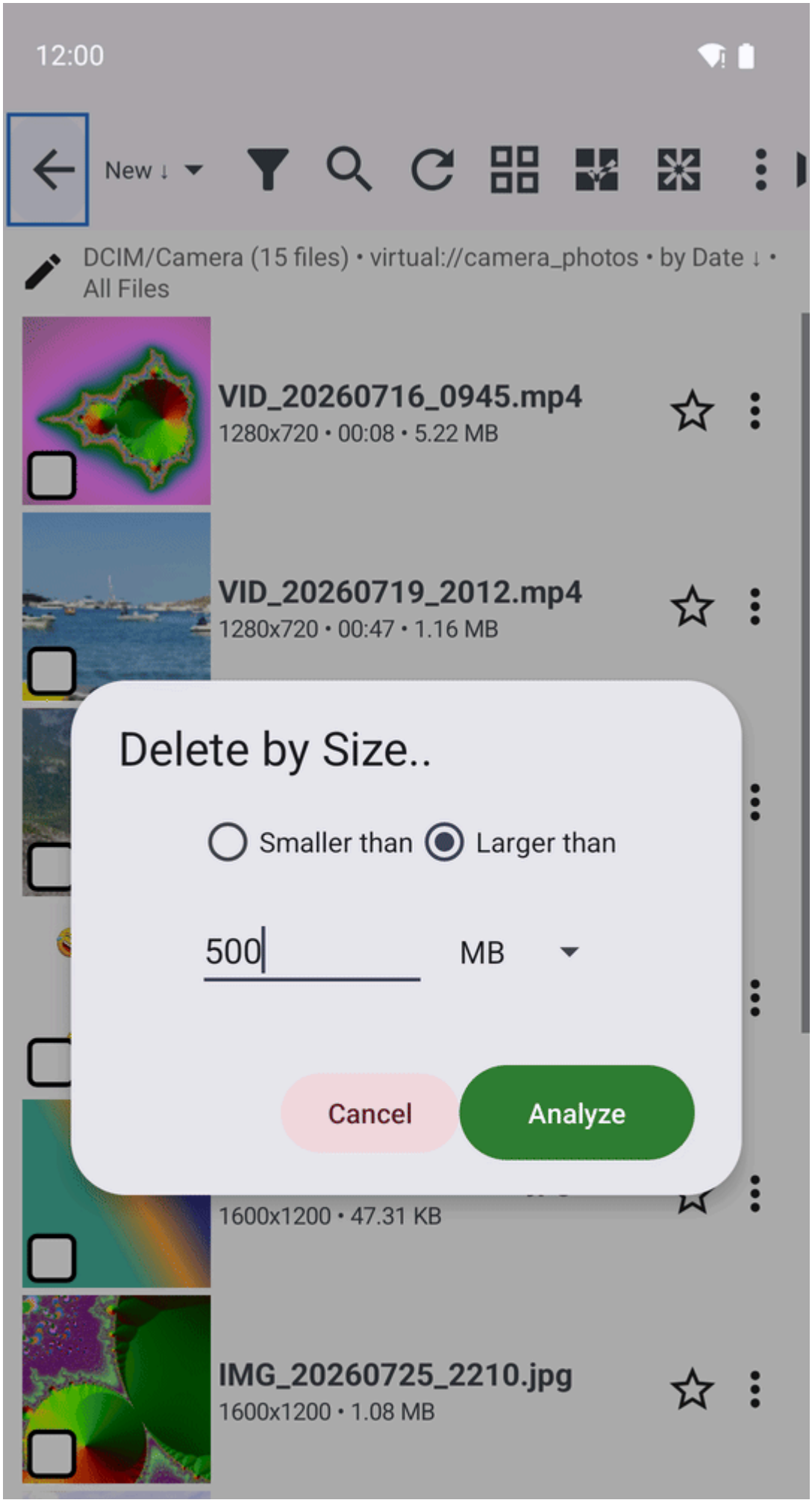
4 Delete every file above or below a size

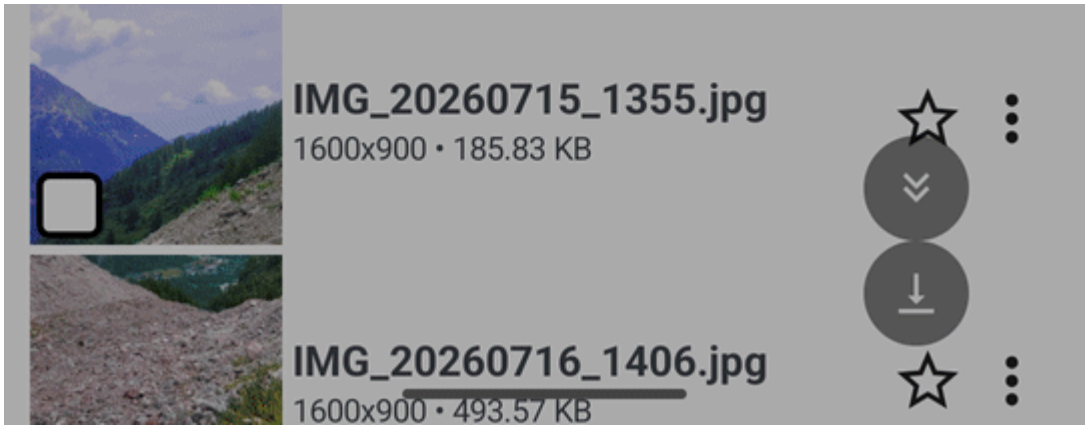
In the file browser's three-dots menu tap **Delete by Size…**. In the window choose:

- **Smaller than** or **Larger than**.
- A number, and the unit **KB**, **MB** or **GB**.

Tap **Analyze**. The **Confirm Deletion** window shows how many files match and how much space you will free, for example "Files found: 18, Space to free: 6.2 GB". If nothing matches, the app says "No matching files found". Tap **Delete Files** to delete them.

Handy for two jobs: **Larger than 500 MB** finds forgotten videos, and **Smaller than 20 KB** finds tiny thumbnails and broken pictures that clutter a folder.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓ • All Files
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
1280x720 • 00:08 • 5.22 MB
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
1280x720 • 00:47 • 1.16 MB
Delete by Size..
Smaller than
Larger than
500
MB
Cancel
Analyze
1600x1200 • 47.31 KB
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB



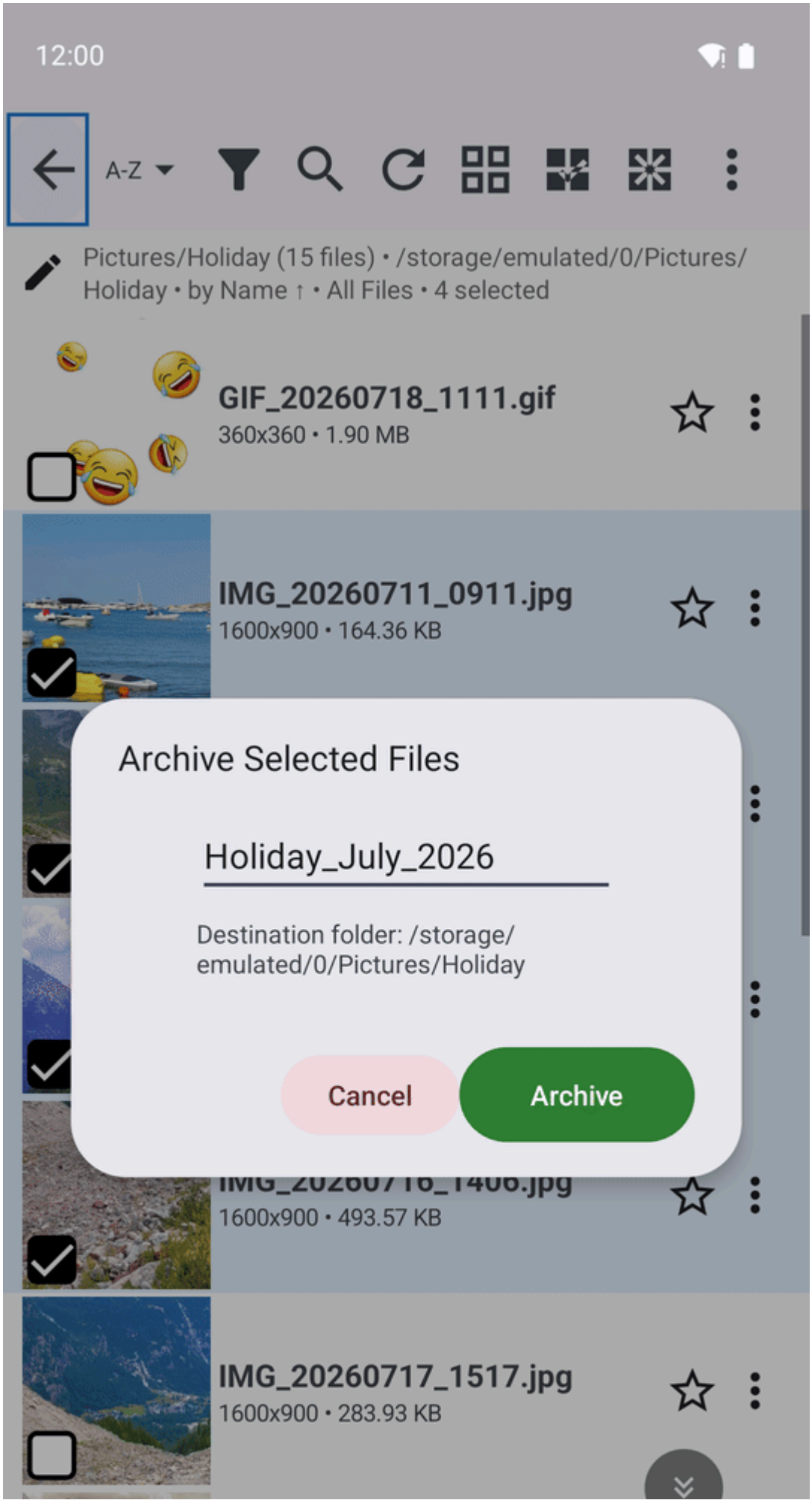
Choose the size limit, then Analyze.

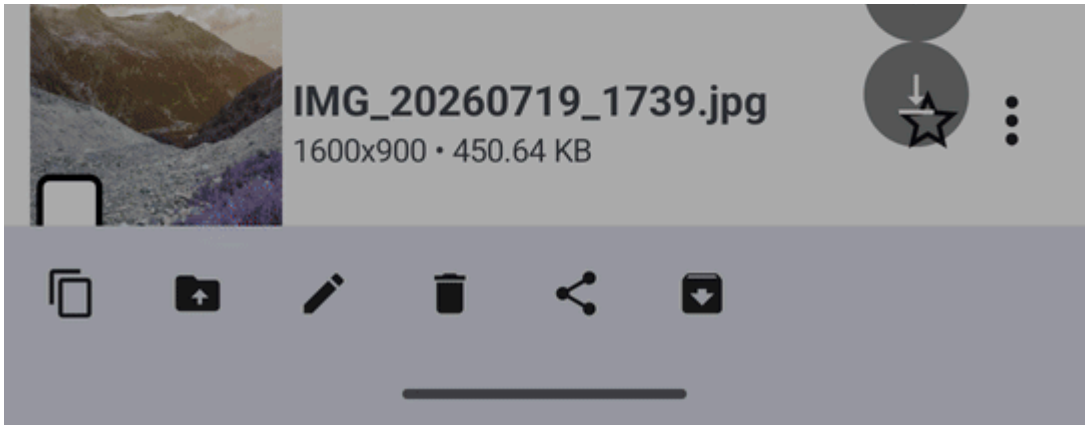
5 Pack files into a ZIP archive

In a folder on this device, select the files you want to pack (long-press the first one, then tap the others). Open the three-dots menu and tap **Archive**. The item is shown but grayed out until at least one file is selected.

The **Archive Selected Files** window suggests a name - the first file's name, or today's date. Change it if you like (without `.zip`, the app adds it) and check the line **Destination folder** - the archive is saved in the folder you are looking at. Tap **Archive**.

A progress window counts the files ("12 of 40: IMG_2031.jpg") and can be canceled; a canceled archive is removed, so no half-made file is left behind. At the end you see "Archive created: holiday.zip (40 files)". If an archive with that name already exists, the new one is named `holiday_1.zip` rather than replacing it.


12:00
A-Z
Pictures/Holiday (15 files) • /storage/emulated/0/Pictures/Holiday • by Name ↑ • All Files • 4 selected
GIF_20260718_1111.gif
360x360 • 1.90 MB
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg
1600x900 • 164.36 KB
Archive Selected Files
Holiday_July_2026
Destination folder: /storage/emulated/0/Pictures/Holiday
Cancel
Archive
1600x900 • 493.57 KB
IMG_20260717_1517.jpg
1600x900 • 283.93 KB



Name the archive and tap Archive.

What You Get

The same photo is kept once instead of three times, the forgotten giant videos are gone, and the scans of old documents travel as one ZIP file. The storage bar on your phone has room again.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Duplicates between the phone and a network folder** can be found too - tick both resources. Expect it to take longer, because the network files have to be read.
- **Archives from network or cloud files** are not possible: 'Archiving is only supported for local files.' Copy the files to the phone first.
- **See how much you have already freed**: with statistics collection on, the **Freed space** card adds up every byte your deletions gave back - see Usage statistics.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Copying, moving and deleting files

Everyday file work, the trash and Undo.

STORAGE

Running file jobs on a schedule

Let the app clean up or move files by itself every night.

PROGRAMS

Usage statistics

See how many files you sorted and how much space your deletions freed.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #09

Running File Jobs on a Schedule

Let the app copy, move or delete files by itself on a schedule - for example copy new camera photos to the home computer every night - and read the run history to see what was done.

Why You'll Love This

Every evening you plug in the phone and think: "I should copy today's photos to the computer." And every evening you forget. A scheduled operation does it for you: you describe the job once - what to take, where to put it and how often - and the app runs it in the background, even when it is closed.

Typical jobs: copy new camera photos to a network folder every night, move downloaded videos to the memory card every few hours, or empty a folder of temporary screenshots once a day.

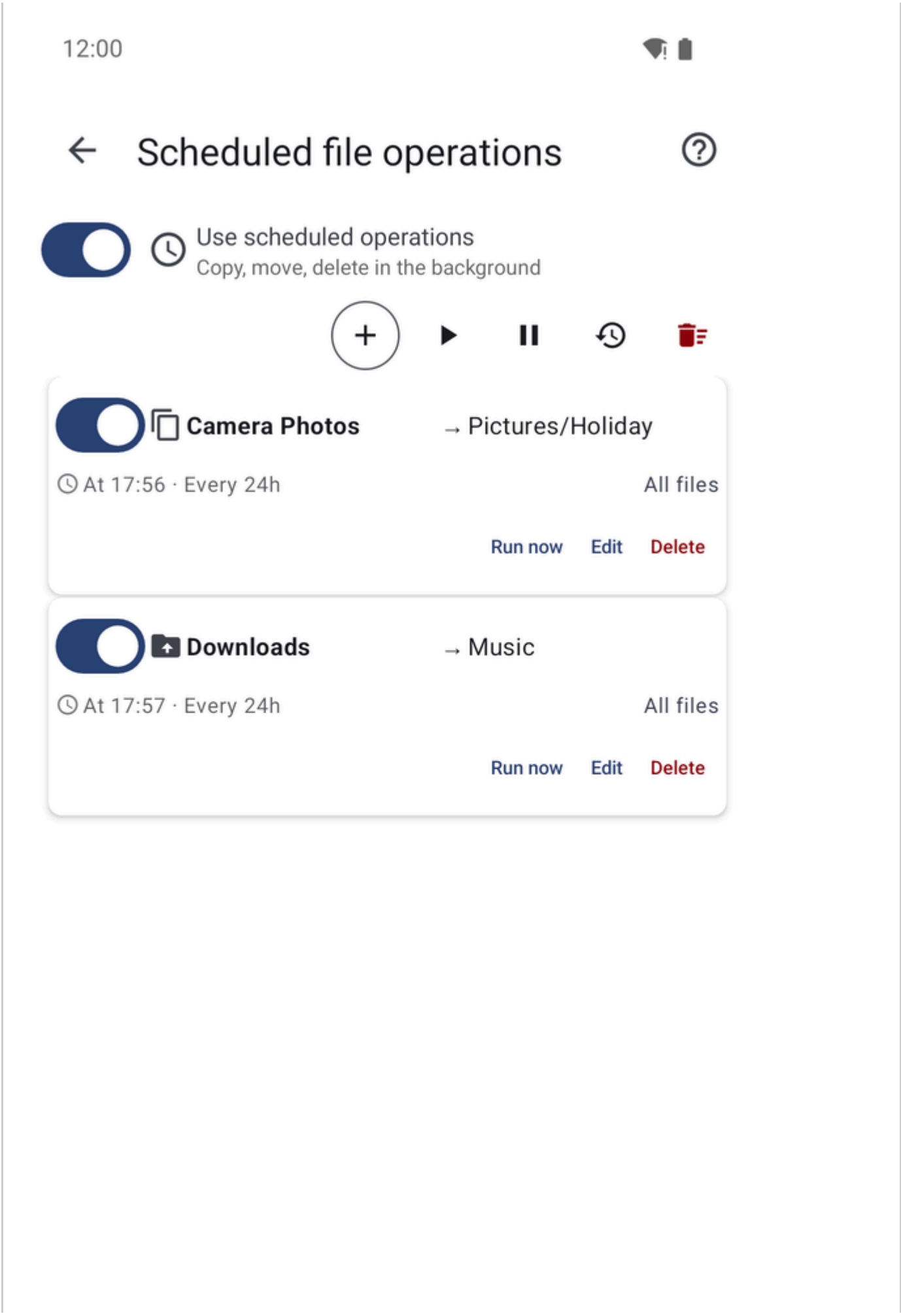
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition .
- The source: a resource or any folder on this device.
- For copy and move: a destination , or any folder on this device.
- The phone switched on at the scheduled time. Android decides the exact moment, so a job may start a few minutes late.

1 Open the scheduled operations screen

There are several doors to the same **Scheduled file operations** screen:

- **Settings**, the **Management** tab, the row **Scheduled file operations** - "Manage operations and the run history".
- The programs menu and the quick-access panel, where the scheduled operations program sits among the other programs.
- The **Scheduled Operations** widget on the Android home screen.
- In the file browser: the three-dots menu, **Automation..** - the screen opens with the folder you are in already set as the source.
  At the top of the screen, **Use scheduled operations** - "Copy, move, delete in the background" - switches the whole feature on or off.

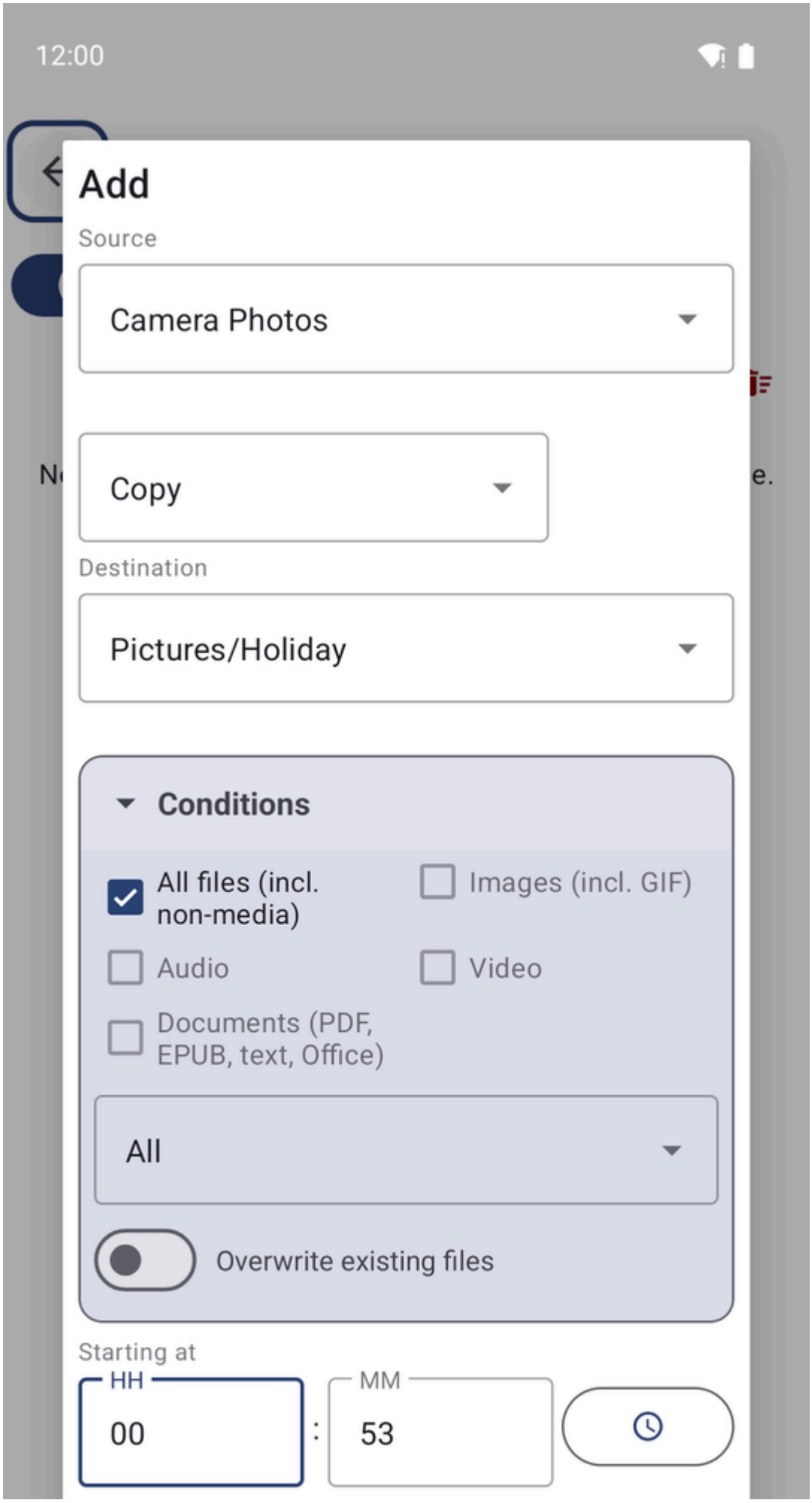

12:00
Scheduled file operations
Use scheduled operations
Copy, move, delete in the background
Camera Photos
→ Pictures/Holiday
At 17:56 · Every 24h
All files
Run now
Edit
Delete
Downloads
→ Music
At 17:57 · Every 24h
All files
Run now
Edit
Delete

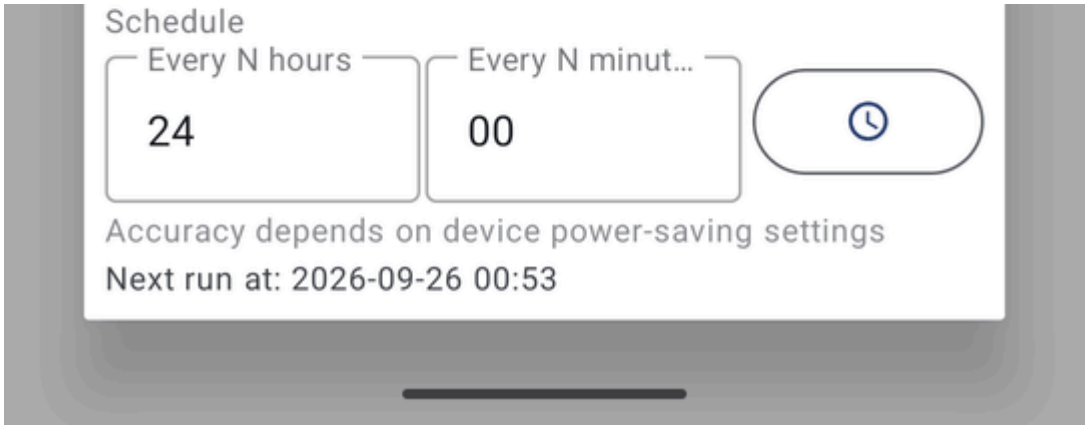
The Scheduled file operations screen.

2 Say what to take and where to put it

Tap **+** (**Add**). In the new operation:

- **Source** - pick one of your resources, or the first item **Local Folder** to choose any folder in Android's folder window. Such a folder is used only by this job and does not appear on the main screen.
- **Operation** - **Copy**, **Move** or **Delete**.
- **Destination** - for copy and move: one of your destinations, or **Local Folder** again for any folder on the device. If you have exactly one destination, it is filled in for you.
  If the source is read-only, the app allows only **Copy** and says "Source is read-only".


12:00
Add
Source
Camera Photos
Copy
Destination
Pictures/Holiday
Conditions
All files (incl. non-media)
Images (incl. GIF)
Audio
Video
Documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)
All
Overwrite existing files
Starting at
HH
00
:
MM
53



Describe the job once.

3 Choose which files and when

- **File types** - **All files (incl. non-media)**, **Images (incl. GIF)**, **Audio**, **Video** or **Documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)**. Ticking **All files** unticks the others. At least one must stay ticked.
- **Time filter** - **All**, **New since last run**, **New in last hour** or **New in last day**. **New since last run** is the one for "copy only what appeared since yesterday".
- **Starting at** - the time of the first run.
- **Every** - how often to repeat, in hours and minutes. The default is every 24 hours. The shortest interval is 15 minutes; a 0-hour, 0-minute interval is corrected to 1 hour.

Below, **Next run at:** shows when the job will start, updated as you change the time.

4 Set the last details and save

- **Overwrite existing files** - when a file with the same name is already at the destination, replace it. Off means such files are skipped.
- **Suppress notifications** - run quietly, without a notification.

Tap **Save operation**. The first time, the app may ask to **Allow background activity**: "On some devices the system may stop background tasks. For reliable scheduled operations, allow this app to run without battery optimization." Tap **Open settings** and allow it - otherwise some phones stop the job while the screen is off.

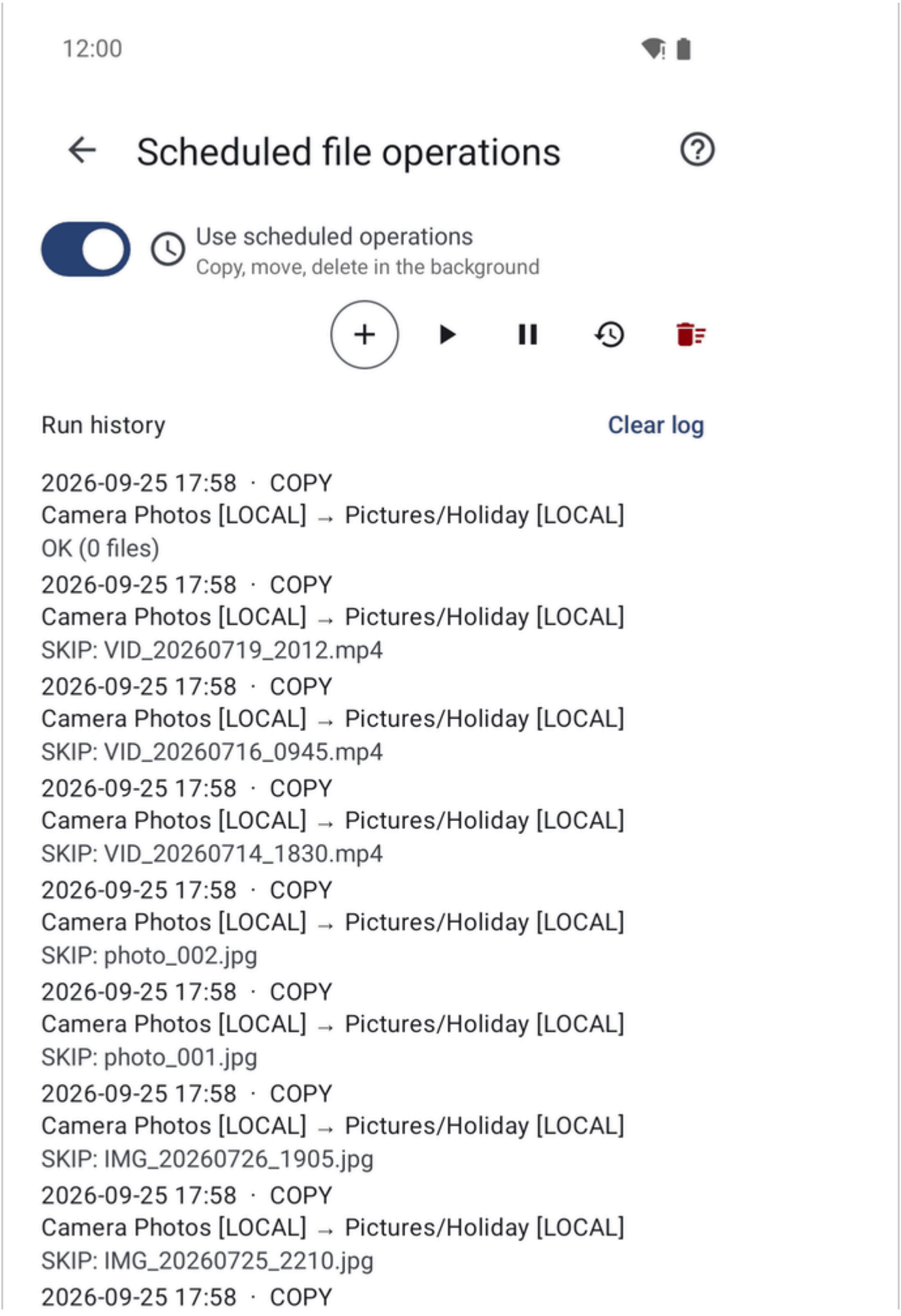
> **Move and delete need full access**
>
> To remove the original files after a move or a delete in the background, the app needs access to all files. If it is missing, you get the notification 'Scheduled operation needs permission' - tap it and allow the access.

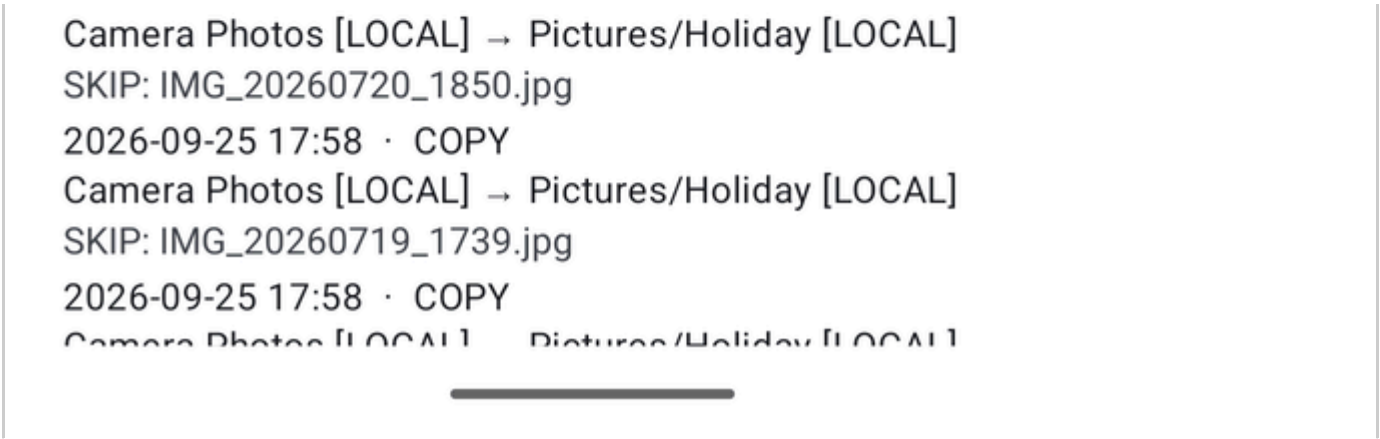
5 Pause, run now and read the history

Each operation in the list shows its source, destination and schedule ("At 23:00 · Every 24h") with its own switch to pause it, and **Run now** to start it at once. For all of them together use **Run all now**, **Pause all** and **Resume all**.

Tap **Log** to open the **Run history**: when each job ran, how many files it handled and what went wrong, if anything. An operation whose last run failed is marked - "Last run failed. Tap Log for details." You can clear the history at any time.

The job runs by itself even after the phone restarts. If the folder you are looking at in the file browser was changed by a job in the meantime, the list updates the moment you come back to it - no files that were already moved away are left in view.


12:00
Scheduled file operations
Use scheduled operations
Copy, move, delete in the background
Run history
Clear log
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
OK (0 files)
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: VID_20260719_2012.mp4
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: VID_20260716_0945.mp4
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: VID_20260714_1830.mp4
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: photo_002.jpg
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: photo_001.jpg
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: IMG_20260726_1905.jpg
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY
Camera Photos [LOCAL] → Pictures/Holiday [LOCAL]
SKIP: IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
2026-09-25 17:58 · COPY



The run history.

What You Get

Your photos land on the home computer every night without you lifting a finger, the downloads folder stays tidy, and the run history tells you in the morning what was done.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The main switch follows the list.** On the **Scheduled file operations** screen, the switch for scheduled operations turns off by itself when the list is empty and on again as soon as the list has an operation.
- **Start with Copy.** Try a new job as a copy for a day or two; switch it to Move once you trust it.
- **A network destination must be reachable** at the scheduled time - for a home computer, choose an hour when it is on.
- **Not sure it will work?** Tap **Run now** once and look at the Log.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Sorting files into destinations

Set up the destinations your scheduled jobs will fill.

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage

Add the home computer as a place for nightly copies.

PROGRAMS

Built-in utilities

The other programs you can open from the same menu.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #10

Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR (Quick Recorder widget - Standard and Legacy)

Taking Photos, Videos and Voice Notes Straight into a Folder

Take a photo or a video, or record a voice note, from inside a folder so it is saved right there - on the phone, on a network folder or in the cloud - and use the Quick Recorder widget and the clipboard for even faster notes.

Why You'll Love This

You are sorting receipts into a "Taxes 2026" folder and one receipt is still on paper. Normally you would take a photo with the camera app, find it in the camera roll and move it. Here you take the photo from inside the folder, and it lands exactly there - even when the folder is on the computer at home or in your Google Drive.

The same works for short videos and for voice notes, and a home-screen widget records a voice note with one tap without opening the app at all.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

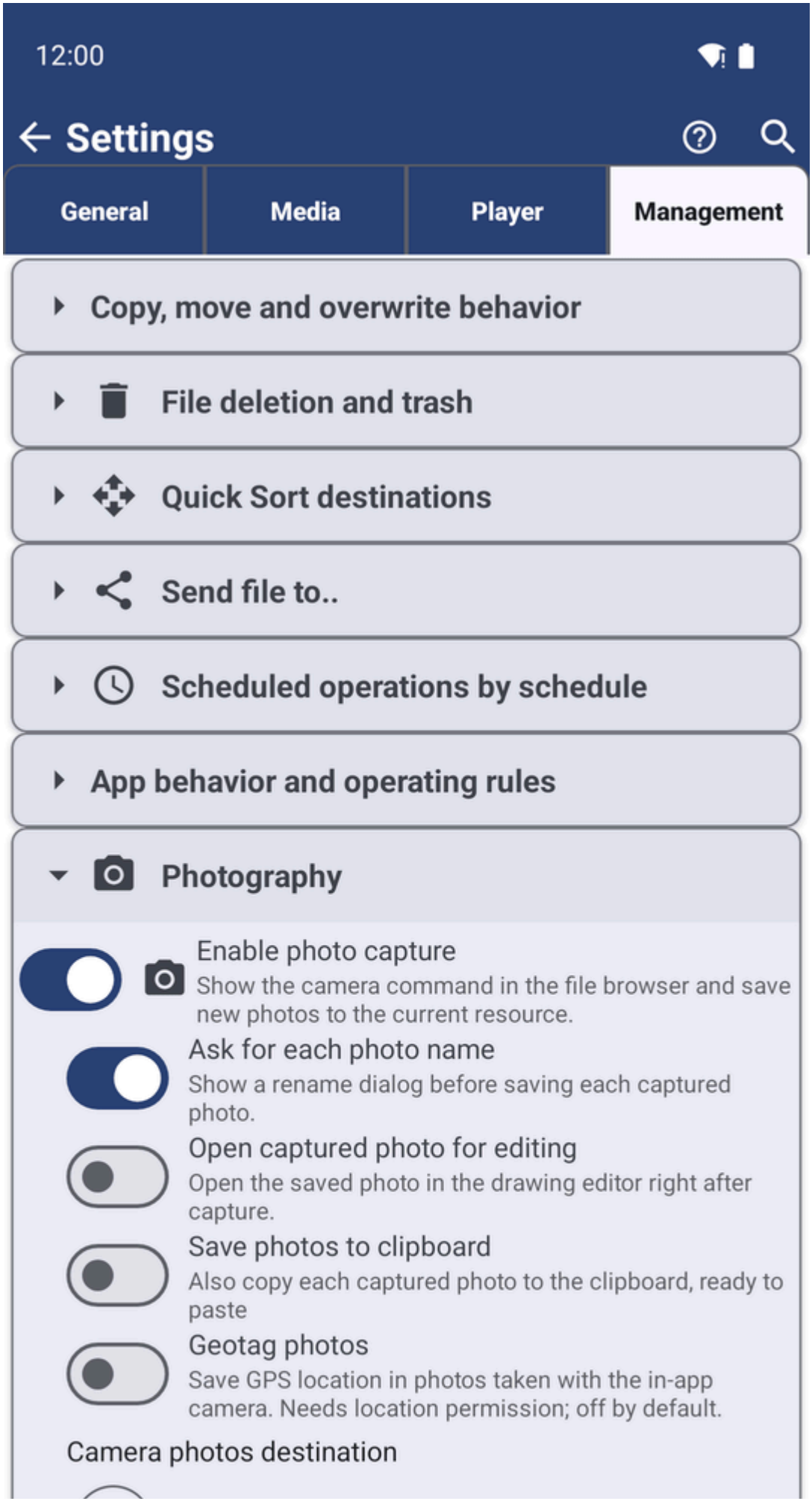
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR editi on. The Quick Recorder widget exists in the Standard and Legacy editions.
- Permission to use the camera, and for voice notes the microphone. The app asks when you first use them.
- A reso urce you can write to, or nothing at all - without a chosen place, photos go to the phone's camera folder and voice notes to Downloads.

1 Switch the commands on

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab:

- Under **Photography** turn on **Enable photo capture** – "Show the camera command in the file browser and save new photos to the current resource."
- Under **Video recording** turn on **Enable video recording**.
- Under **Voice recorder** turn on **Enable microphone recording**. If the app has no microphone permission yet, Android asks for it first.

  Each group also has a **Select resource…** button. The place you choose there is used when there is no folder to save into – for example for the Quick Recorder widget.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Copy, move and overwrite behavior
File deletion and trash
Quick Sort destinations
Send file to..
Scheduled operations by schedule
App behavior and operating rules
Photography
Enable photo capture
Show the camera command in the file browser and save new photos to the current resource.
Ask for each photo name
Show a rename dialog before saving each captured photo.
Open captured photo for editing
Open the saved photo in the drawing editor right after capture.
Save photos to clipboard
Also copy each captured photo to the clipboard, ready to paste
Geotag photos
Save GPS location in photos taken with the in-app camera. Needs location permission; off by default.
Camera photos destination

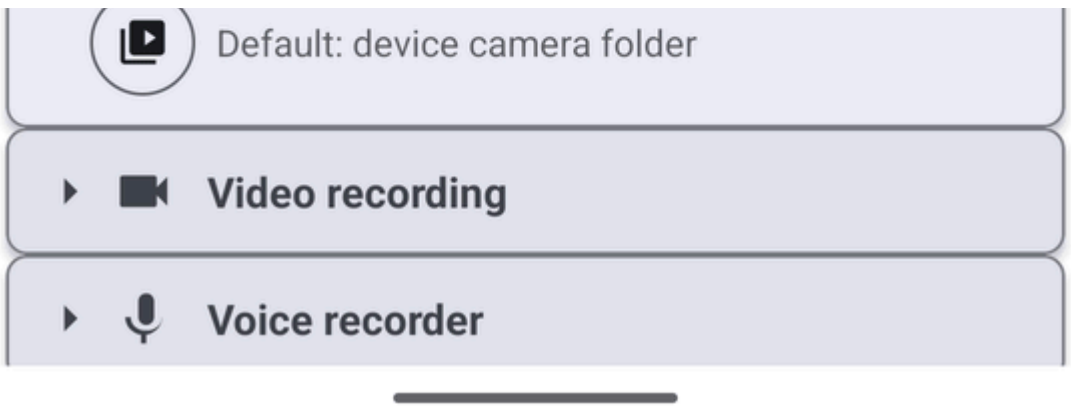


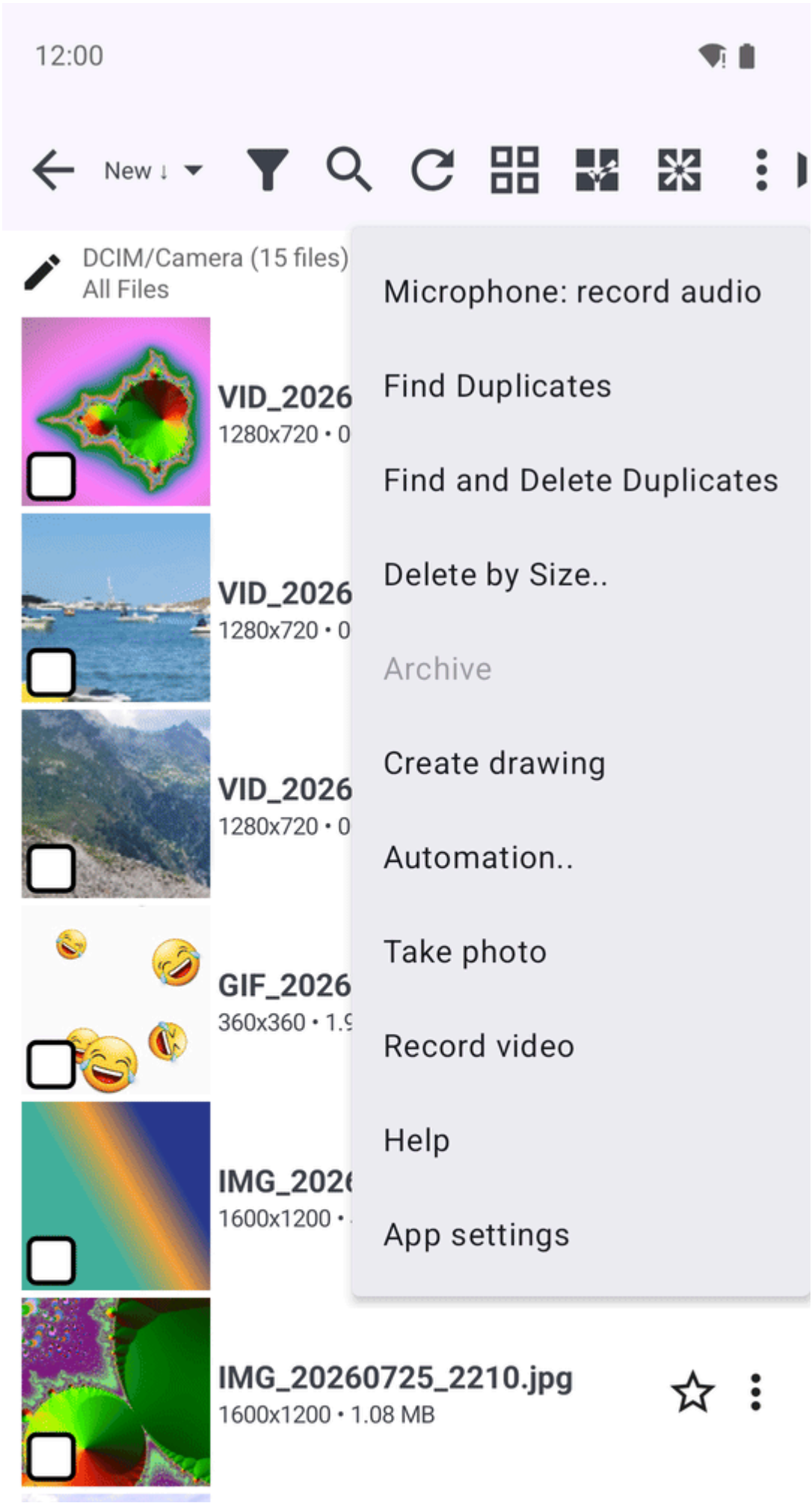
Photo settings in the Management tab.

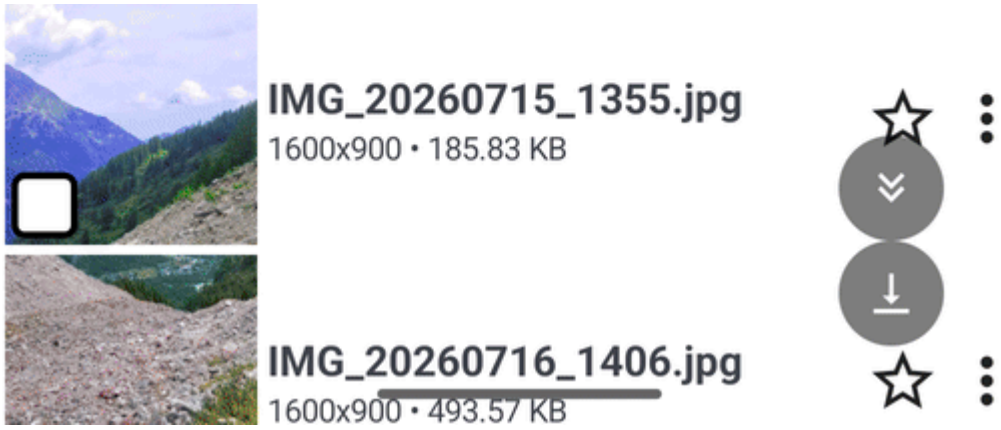
2 Take a photo into the folder you are in

Open the folder in the file browser, open the three-dots menu and tap **Take photo**. Take the photo. It is saved in this folder:

- In a folder on the phone - directly into it.
- In a network folder or in cloud storage - it is uploaded there.
- In a ready-made collection such as **Camera Photos** or **All Images** - into the phone's camera folder.

  With **Ask for each photo name** on, you name the photo before it is saved. With **Open captured photo for editing** on, the photo opens in the drawing editor right away, so you can circle the important part. **Geotag photos** stores where the photo was taken; it needs the location permission and is off by default.


12:00
New ↓
DCIM/Camera (15 files)
All Files
VID_2026
1280x720 • 0
VID_2026
1280x720 • 0
VID_2026
1280x720 • 0
GIF_2026
360x360 • 1.9
IMG_2026
1600x1200 •
IMG_20260725_2210.jpg
1600x1200 • 1.08 MB
Microphone: record audio
Find Duplicates
Find and Delete Duplicates
Delete by Size..
Archive
Create drawing
Automation..
Take photo
Record video
Help
App settings



Take photo in the folder's menu.

3 Record a video the same way

In the same menu tap **Record video**. The finished video is saved into the folder you are in, following the same rules as photos. With **Open recorded video in player** on, it starts playing right after recording, so you can check it at once.

4 Record a voice note

In the file browser press and hold the microphone button (**Record audio**, "Hold to record") and speak. Let go to stop. If the button does not fit on a narrow screen, it moves into the three-dots menu as **Record audio** - there one tap starts recording.

With **Ask for filename** on, the **Save Recording** window lets you name the note first. You then see "Recording saved: ..". The note is saved as an `.m4a` file into the place chosen under **Voice recorder**, or into the folder you are in, or into Downloads.

A hold that was too short is not saved - you see "Recording canceled". A phone call or another app taking over the sound also stops the recording.

5 One tap from the home screen - the Quick Recorder widget

Standard and Legacy editions.

Add the **Quick Recorder** widget to your Android home screen: long-press an empty spot, choose **Widgets**, find FastMediaSorter and drag **Quick Recorder** out. Its description says it all: "Tap to start a voice recording; tap again to stop and save".

While it records, a notification "Recording.." with a **Stop** button stays at the top of the screen. Stop from the widget or from the notification. The note is saved into the place chosen under **Voice recorder** in Settings, or into the phone's audio folder, and you see "Recording saved to ..".

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Quick Recorder widget**
Home screen with the Quick Recorder widget placed, a recording running.

6 Paste a new photo straight into a message

Turn on **Save photos to clipboard** under **Photography** - "Also copy each captured photo to the clipboard, ready to paste". Every photo you take with the app's camera is then also put on the clipboard, in full quality. Switch to your messenger, long-press the text field and choose **Paste** - the photo is attached. The photo is still saved in its folder as usual.

7 When the folder cannot be reached

A photo, a video or a voice note is never lost because the network folder or the cloud is out of reach. If the upload fails, the app saves the file on the phone instead - photos in the camera folder, videos in Movies, voice notes in the audio folder - and tells you where: "Saved to DCIM/Camera - Home PC is unavailable". While the app is open you see a short message; in the background it is a notification. Copy the file to its intended place later, when the connection is back.

What You Get

The receipt photo sits in "Taxes 2026", the video of the leaking tap is in the "Flat repairs" folder on the home computer, and the idea you had while walking is a voice note in your notes folder - without a single trip through the camera roll.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Sort as you shoot.** Open the target folder first, then capture - you will never have to find and move the file later.
- **The camera app has more to it** - modes, a timer and text recognition are described in Taking quick photos and video snaps.
- **A copy on the clipboard is not a backup.** The clipboard holds only the last photo; the saved file is the one that stays.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

CAMERA

Taking quick photos and video snaps

Everything the app's camera can do.

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage

Save photos straight to the home computer or the cloud.

STORAGE

Running file jobs on a schedule

Move the day's photos and notes to their place every night.

SOURCES, DESTINATIONS & FILE OPERATIONS | All editions | RECIPE #11

All editions (containers in the cloud - all except Lite and FOSS)

Protecting Files with a PIN and Encryption

Lock a resource with a PIN, and turn a single file into a password-protected .fd-sec container that you can view without unpacking and unpack again - on the phone, on a network folder or in the cloud.

Why You'll Love This

Your children borrow the phone to watch cartoons, and you would rather they did not wander into the folder with scanned passports. Or you keep a copy of a contract on the home computer and want it unreadable to anyone who opens that computer.

FastMediaSorter has two locks for this. A PIN closes a whole resource inside the app. An encrypted container turns one file into a sealed `.fd-sec` file that nobody can open without the password - not in this app, not on a computer.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Containers next to files in cloud storage work in the editions that have cloud storage: Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR.
- For containers: a file in a folder the app can write to.
- Optional: the FileDO program for Windows, which opens the same `.fd-sec` containers on a computer.

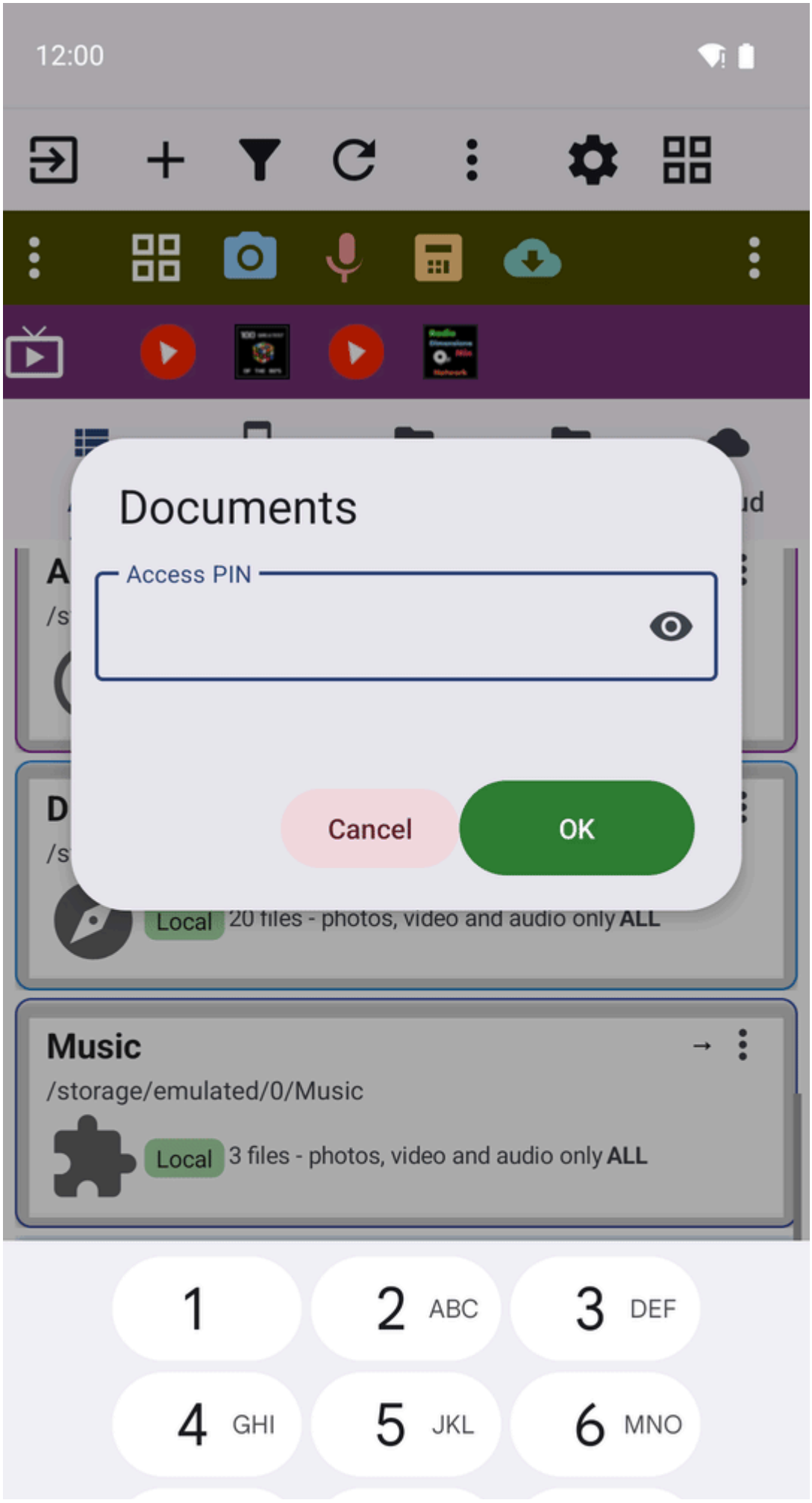
⚠ There is no "forgot my PIN"

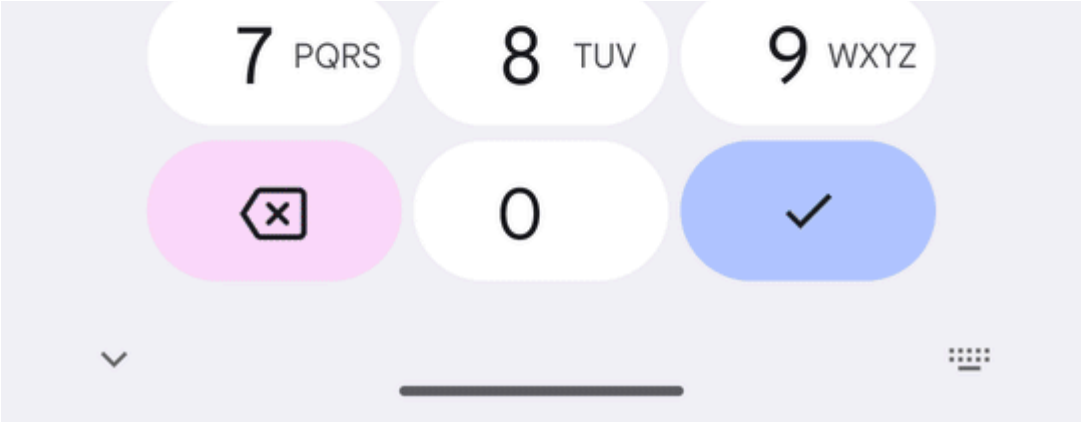
The app cannot recover a forgotten PIN. If you forget it, remove the resource and add the folder again - your files are not affected. A PIN protects the resource inside FastMediaSorter only; other apps and a computer still see the folder.

1 Lock a resource with a PIN

On the main screen long-press the resource and choose **Edit**. In the field **PIN Code (Optional)** - "4–6 digits to protect this resource" - type a code of 4 to 6 digits and save.

From now on, opening the resource, starting its slideshow or opening its settings first asks for the PIN in a small window titled with the resource's name. A wrong code shows "Incorrect PIN" and nothing opens. To remove the PIN, open **Edit** (you will be asked for the current PIN), clear the field and save.


12:00
Documents
Access PIN
Cancel
OK
Local 20 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
Music
/storage/emulated/0/Music
Local 3 files - photos, video and audio only ALL
1
2 ABC
3 DEF
4 GHI
5 JKL
6 MNO



The PIN window before a protected resource opens.

2 Switch on the encryption commands

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and turn on **FileDO encryption operations**. It adds **Encrypt with FileDO** and **Decrypt with FileDO** to the operations menu of every file. Opening an existing `.fd-sec` file works even with this switch off.

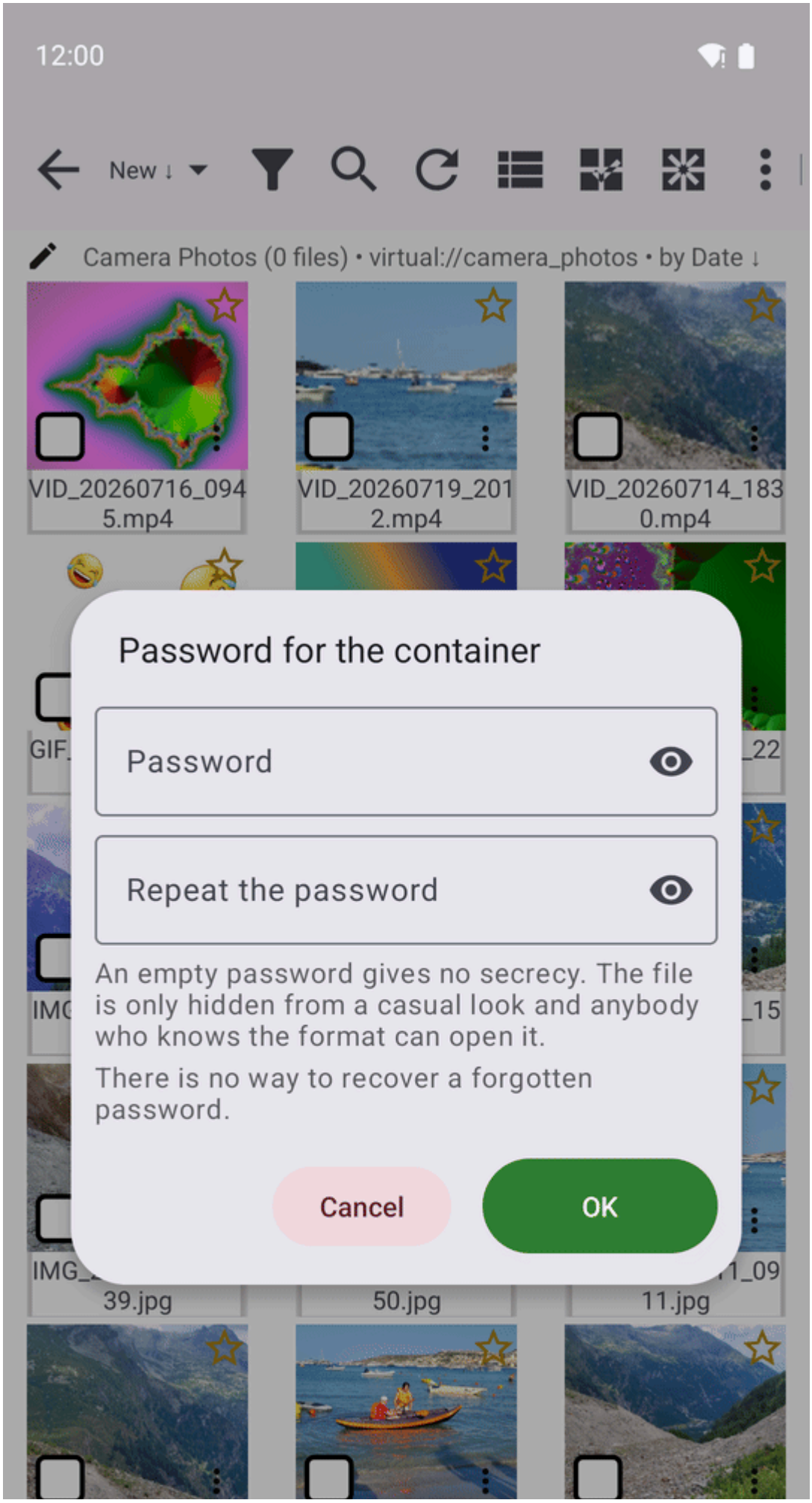
⚠ Delete the original yourself

The original file stays where it was, readable as before. Once you have checked that the container opens, delete the original if it should be secret. And remember the password: 'There is no way to recover a forgotten password.'

3 Seal a file into a container

In the file browser open the three-dots menu of a file and tap **Encrypt with FileDO**. In the window **Password for the container** type the password twice. If the two do not match, the app says "The two passwords differ".

The app writes a new file next to the original: `passport.jpg` becomes `passport.fd-sec`. If that name is taken, the new one is called `passport-1.fd-sec` - nothing is ever overwritten. You see "Container written. The original is untouched."


12:00
New ↓
Camera Photos (0 files) • virtual://camera_photos • by Date ↓
VID_20260716_0945.mp4
VID_20260719_2012.mp4
VID_20260714_1830.mp4
Password for the container
Password
Repeat the password
An empty password gives no secrecy. The file is only hidden from a casual look and anybody who knows the format can open it.
There is no way to recover a forgotten password.
Cancel
OK
39.jpg
50.jpg
11.jpg

Choose the container's password.

4 A word about an empty password

You may leave the password empty, and the app says honestly what that means: "An empty password gives no secrecy. The file is only hidden from a casual look and anybody who knows the format can open it." Use it only to keep a file out of photo galleries, never for real secrets.

5 Look at a container without unpacking it

A `.fd-sec` file is shown in the file browser when the resource shows all files (**All Files** mode). Tap it and type its password. The app unpacks it into a private place only it can reach, opens it in the right viewer, and deletes that copy as soon as you close the viewer.

Tick **Remember the password and try it on every .fd-sec file** if you use one password for all your containers. Next time the app tries it by itself and opens the file without asking. If the saved password does not fit a container, the app forgets it and tells you: "The saved password did not open this file and was forgotten. Enter the password for this file." The password is kept in the phone's protected key store.

6 Unpack a container for good

Open the three-dots menu of the `.fd-sec` file and tap **Decrypt with FileDO**, then type the password. The original file comes back next to the container under its original name, and you see "File restored."

7 Containers on a network folder or in the cloud

Encrypt with FileDO and **Decrypt with FileDO** work on files in a network folder, on an FTP or SFTP server, and in Google Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive too. The app downloads the file into its private space, seals or unseals it there, uploads the result next to the original, reads it back to check that every byte arrived, and only then gives it its final name. The original in the cloud is never changed.

8 If a container does not open

- "Could not open the file: the password is wrong, the file was never a container, or it has been tampered with. These three cannot be told apart." - try the password again, carefully.
- "The container is damaged: it is truncated or its contents do not match what it seals." - the file was cut short or changed, for example by an interrupted copy. Use another copy.
- "This container uses a format version this app does not read." - update the app.
- "This container holds a program or a script. It is not opened." - for your safety the app never starts programs or scripts that come out of a container.

What You Get

The children's cartoons are one tap away, while the passports folder asks for a PIN. Your contract sits on the home computer as a sealed `.fd-sec` file that opens only with your password - in this app on the phone, and in FileDO on the computer.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Same format on the computer.** Containers made here open in the FileDO program for Windows, and the other way round.
- **A PIN travels with the resource** when you export your resources to a file - see Sharing and backing up your resources.
- **Other privacy settings**, such as a lock for the whole app, are described in Privacy controls, passcodes and network security.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Privacy controls, passcodes and network security

Lock the whole app and control what it sends over the network.

STORAGE

Sharing and backing up your resources

Move resources, PINs included, to another phone.

STORAGE

Copying, moving and deleting files

Delete the original after you have sealed it.

…k Folders and Clouds

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #01

Network folders (SMB) - every edition except Lite. Finding a computer automatically, listing its shares, testing the connection and the quiet speed tuning - Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR (not Lite, not FOSS).

Connecting SMB/Windows Shares

Share a folder on Windows, find it from the app with a network scan, sign in and test the connection before committing, and read what a "cannot connect" message actually means - the full walk-through behind adding a network folder as a resource.

Why You'll Love This

Adding a network folder as a resource takes a few taps when everything lines up: the computer is awake, the password is right, the share name is spelled the way the server expects. This page is for the rest of the time - you are not sure of the computer's address, you typed the share name wrong last time, or the folder that worked yesterday says it cannot connect today.

It also starts one step earlier than the overview: a folder has to be shared on the Windows side before the app can find it at all.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition except Lite - see The seven editions .
- A Windows PC or NAS with a folder already shared on it, or a few minutes to share one - step 1 below.
- The phone and the computer on the same Wi-Fi or network.
- The user name and password of the shared folder (on a home PC this is usually your own Windows account).

1 Share a folder on Windows first

The app can only see a folder that Windows has already offered to the network. On the PC, right-click the folder, open **Properties**, go to the **Sharing** tab and share it with a specific user or with everyone on the network. Microsoft's own walk-through covers every version of Windows: File sharing over a network in Windows ↗.

A NAS box shares folders the same way, from its own web interface instead of Windows - the wording differs by brand, but the idea (pick a folder, give it a name, decide who may open it) is identical.

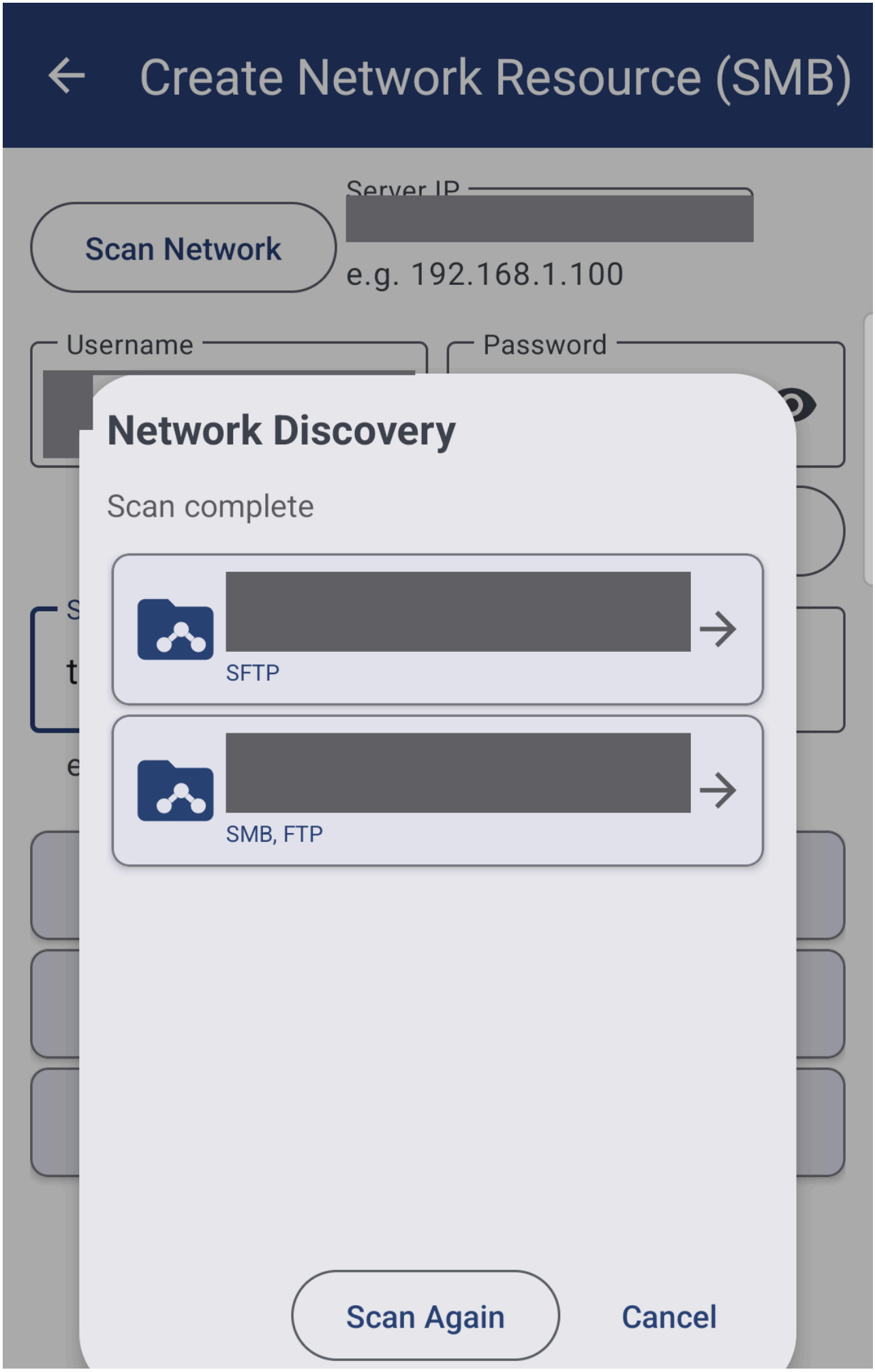
Prefer not to touch Windows sharing at all?

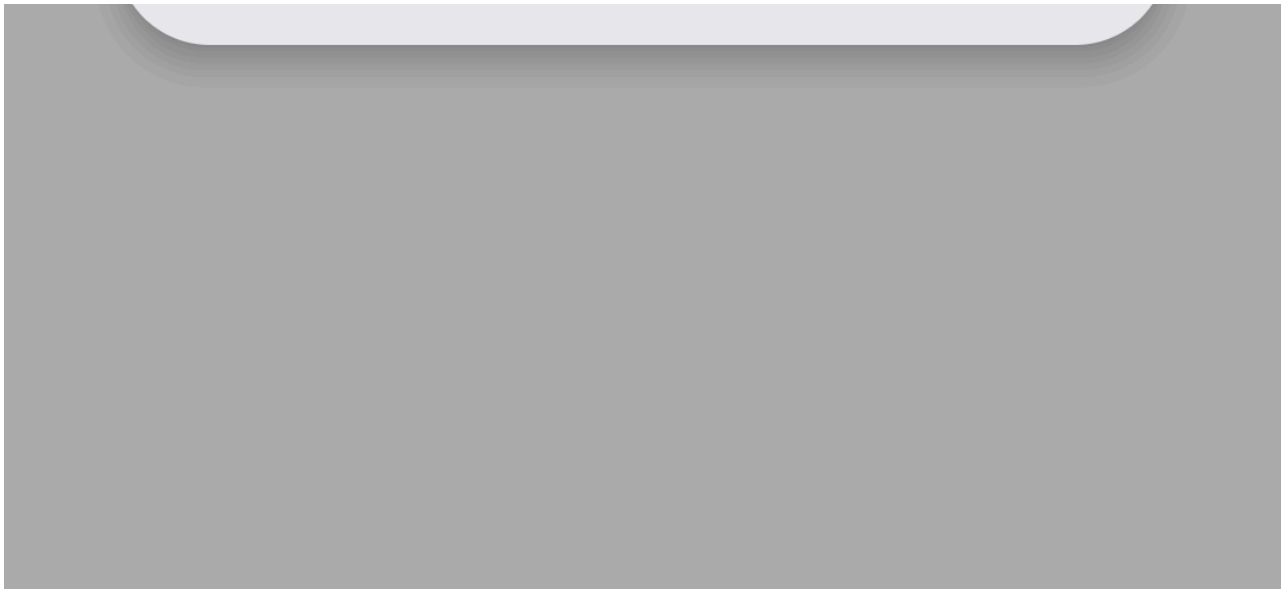
Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows shares chosen folders in a couple of clicks and pairs by QR code, without turning on Windows' own network sharing. See Sharing PC folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows.

2 Find your computer and add the shared folder

On the main screen tap **Add**, then **Network Folder** - "Add SMB network shares". On the **Create Network Resource (SMB)** screen tap **Scan Network**: the app scans your network subnet for SMB, FTP and SFTP hosts while "Scanning local subnet.." shows, then "Scan complete" and a list of the devices it found. Tap yours.

With the **Server IP** field filled in (or typed by hand, for example `192.168.1.100`), enter **Username** and **Password**, then tap **Scan host**. The app lists the shared folders under "Shares on " - tick the one you want. If nothing turns up, "No shares found on this server. Close this message and enter the share name manually." tells you exactly what to do next; if the scan itself fails, "Couldn't scan the shares. Try again." means just that - no shares were read yet, nothing is wrong with the folder itself.


Create Network Resource (SMB)
Scan Network
Server IP
e.g. 192.168.1.100
Username
Password
Network Discovery
Scan complete
SFTP
SMB, FTP
Scan Again
Cancel



Scan Network finds computers on your Wi-Fi for you.

3 Or type everything by hand

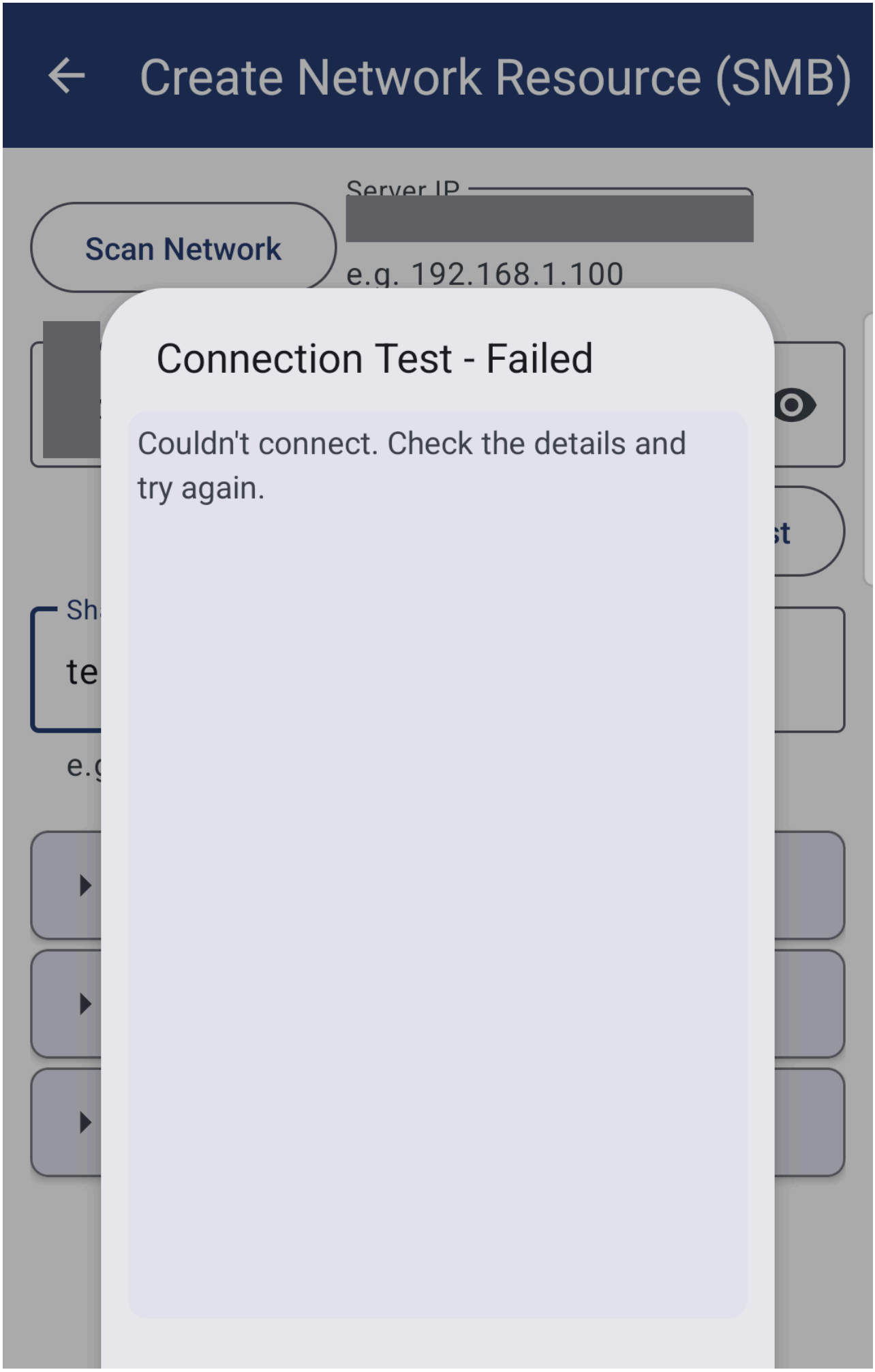
Scanning needs the phone and computer on the same network segment, and it is not offered in the FOSS edition, where every field is filled in yourself. Either way the fields are the same:

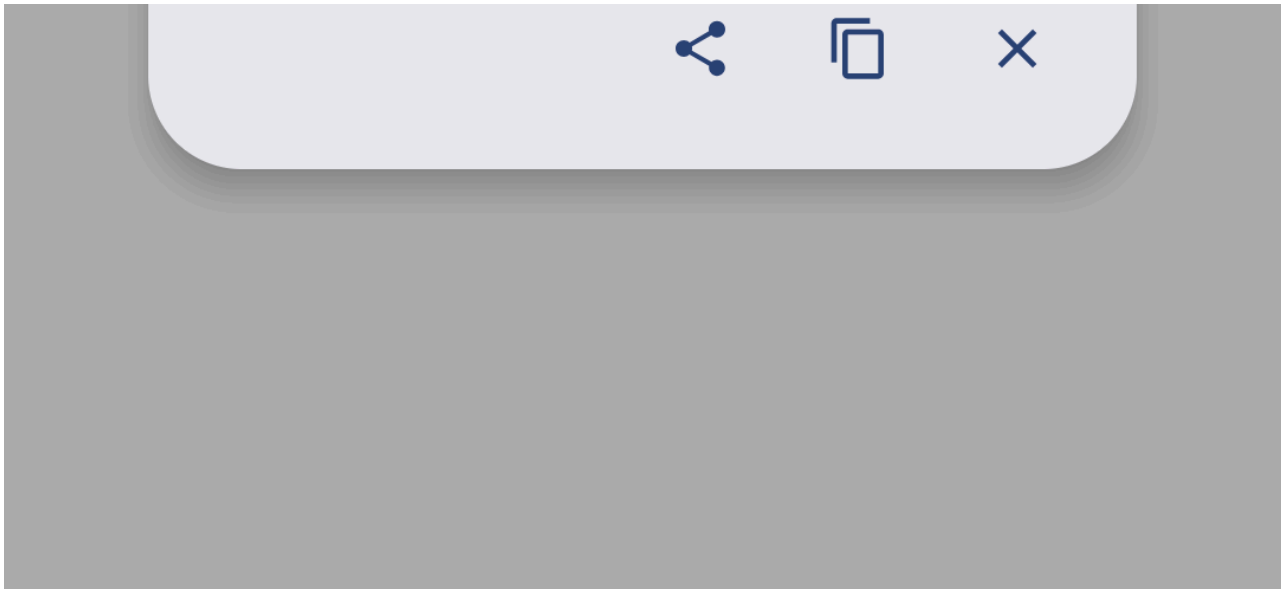
- **Server IP** - the computer's address, for example `192.168.1.100`.
- **Username** and **Password** of the shared folder, and **Domain (optional)** only if your network uses one ("Leave empty if not needed").
- **Port** - leave it at its default (`445`) unless you were told otherwise.
- **ShareName/subfolder** - the exact name Windows gave the share, for example `Common` or `Photos`.
- **Resource Name** - what the folder is called on your main screen; leave it empty and the app names it for you.

4 Test the connection before you commit

Test connection checks the address, user name and password without adding anything, and answers in a moment - it does not just say "yes" or "no". A wrong password reports "authentication failed", a wrong or missing share name reports "share not found", and a computer that simply cannot be reached reports a timeout - three different problems, three different fixes, instead of one flat error.

When everything checks out, tap **Add This Resource** to add it to the list below, or add several shares from the same computer before tapping **Add to Resources** once for all of them.


Create Network Resource (SMB)
Server IP
Scan Network
e.g. 192.168.1.100
Connection Test - Failed
Couldn't connect. Check the details and try again.



A failed test tells you so before the resource is added.

5 Why you never have to tune transfer speed by hand

Right after a network folder is added, the app quietly measures how fast it can read and write to it and picks the number of parallel transfer threads and the buffer size that suit that particular computer – nothing to watch, nothing to tap. A fast NAS on a good connection gets more parallel threads; a slow or congested one gets fewer, so copying does not choke it. You can still set the number of threads by hand in **Settings**, but there is normally no need to.

6 When a shared folder cannot be reached

Opening a file from a resource that has gone offline no longer stops you with a raw error. It shows **Resource unavailable**: " is on a resource that is not responding right now. Check the connection and try again." with **Retry** and **Cancel** - the computer is probably asleep or the phone left the home Wi-Fi. If the server itself says the file no longer exists, the dialog says **File is gone** instead, with an option to remove it from favorites - the app never offers to remove a resource just because it is temporarily unreachable.

A share whose name contains a space, for example `My Photos`, opens and closes cleanly too, the same as one without.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Resource unavailable dialog**
Player screen, file open attempted while the SMB resource is offline, Resource unavailable dialog shown.

7 How SMB compares to FTP and SFTP, in plain terms

SMB is what Windows and most NAS boxes speak natively - you share a folder, and any computer or phone on the same network can browse it, no server address to remember beyond the computer's own name or IP. It only works on your local network, though: point it at a server on the internet and it will not connect.

FTP and SFTP reach a server by its address instead of a share name, and they work just as well over the internet as on a home network - useful for a server that lives outside your house, or a NAS with FTP turned on instead of SMB. SFTP encrypts everything it sends; plain FTP does not, so use it only where SFTP is not offered. The full walk-through, including signing in with an SSH key, is in Connecting SFTP and FTP servers.

What You Get

The computer or NAS shows up on your main screen the moment you scan for it, a wrong password or a missing share tells you exactly what to fix, transfer speed tunes itself, and a resource that briefly drops off the network says so calmly instead of throwing an error at you.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Windows asks you to sign in and you are not sure with what.** Use the same user name and password you use to log into that Windows PC, not your Microsoft account email, unless you specifically created a separate share user.
- **The share works from a computer but not from the phone.** Confirm both are on the same Wi-Fi network, not one on Wi-Fi and one on mobile data, and that the PC has not gone to sleep.
- **Want the caching and background-refresh details?** They are the same for every kind of network resource - see Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources.
- **Sharing your whole resource list, passwords included, with another phone?** See Sharing and backing up your resources.
- **Want to reach your own storage from outside your home?** The media exchange portal walks through the home network way step by step and says what works today.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Connecting SFTP and FTP servers

Server addresses, SSH keys, and pinning a server's identity.

NETWORK

Sharing PC folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

Share PC folders without touching Windows' own network sharing at all.

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources

The overview - what kinds of places you can add, and how the app keeps them quick.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #02

SFTP and FTP - every edition except Lite. Signing in with an SSH key, pinning the server and sharing or importing access files - Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR (not Lite, not FOSS); the watch's own connection test - Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.

Connecting SFTP and FTP Servers

Add an FTP or SFTP server by address, sign in with a password or an SSH key, let the app confirm the server's identity once and re-check it on every visit, and hand a folder to someone else - or receive one from them - as a single shared file. Testing the same kind of resource from a paired watch is covered too.

Why You'll Love This

A home NAS with SMB turned off, a server that only opens once you are outside your own house, a friend's computer whose folder they want to hand you without reading out a password over the phone - these are jobs for FTP or SFTP rather than SMB. Unlike a shared Windows folder, an FTP or SFTP server is reached by its address from anywhere, which is exactly what makes it worth setting up carefully: with SFTP, the app can also confirm it is still talking to the same server every single time, not just the first.

If you have not decided between SMB and SFTP yet, Connecting SMB/Windows shares has a short comparison at the end.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition except Lite - see The seven editions .
- The server's address and port, and either a user name with a password or an SSH key.
- For key sign-in: the private key file, and its passphrase if it has one.
- To share or import access to a folder: any app that can send a file, such as Telegram or email.

1 Add a server by address

On the main screen tap **Add**, then **SFTP / FTP** - the **Add S/FTP Resource** screen opens. Under **Select Protocol:** choose **SFTP (port 22)** or **FTP (port 21)**; the **Port** field fills itself in, with a hint of "SFTP: 22, FTP: 21" if you change your mind. Enter the **Host** (the server's address) - the field itself explains it wants a "Server IP address", though a domain name works too.

SFTP encrypts the whole conversation; plain FTP does not, so pick FTP only when a server does not offer SFTP at all.

Add S/FTP Resource

Import from file

Import by barcode

How to publish PC folders to Android

Select Protocol:

(•) SFTP (port 22) ( ) FTP (port 21)

Host [redacted]

Server IP address

Port: 22

Sign-in method

(•) Password ( ) SSH Key

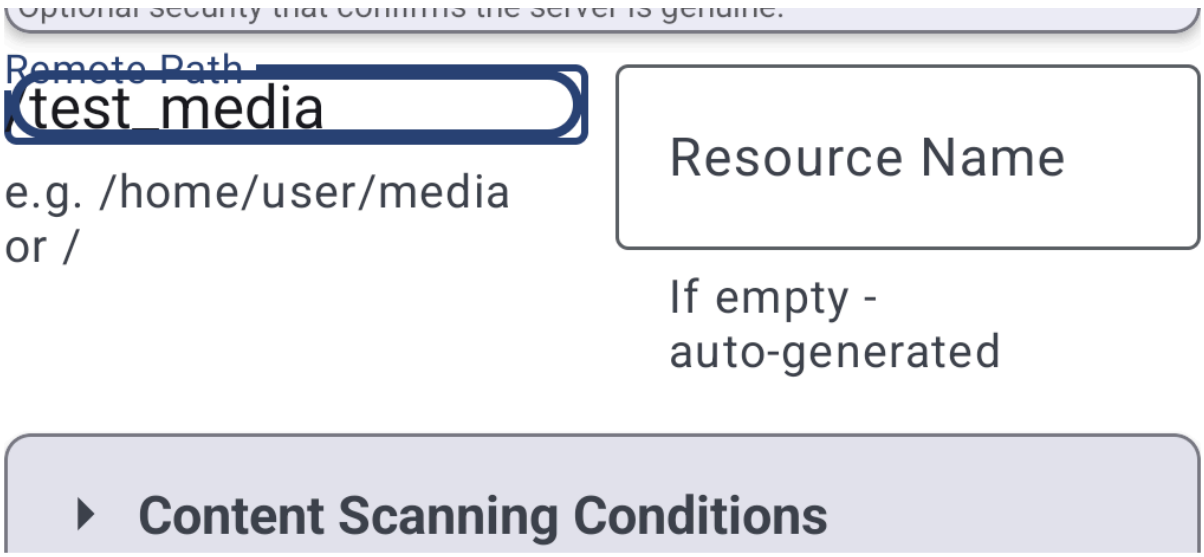
Username [redacted]

Password: ••••••••••••••••••

Test Connection

▸ Server verification (optional)

Optional security that confirms the server is genuine



Pick a protocol, then the server's address.

2 Sign in with a password or an SSH key

Under **Sign-in method** choose **Password** or **SSH Key**. Password sign-in just needs **Username** and **Password**, the same as any other account.

For **SSH Key**, paste the key into **Private SSH key** or tap **Load File** to pick the file from storage, and fill in **Key Passphrase (optional)** if the key itself is encrypted - leave it empty otherwise. A key that will not parse says "Invalid SSH private key format" right away, before you waste a connection attempt on it. If your device already came with some server folders pre-configured through a bundled setup file, those can use a key the same way, with nothing left for you to type.

Add S/FTP Resource

SFTP (port 22)

FTP (port 21)

Host

Server IP address

Port

22

Sign-in method

Password

SSH Key

Private SSH key

Load File

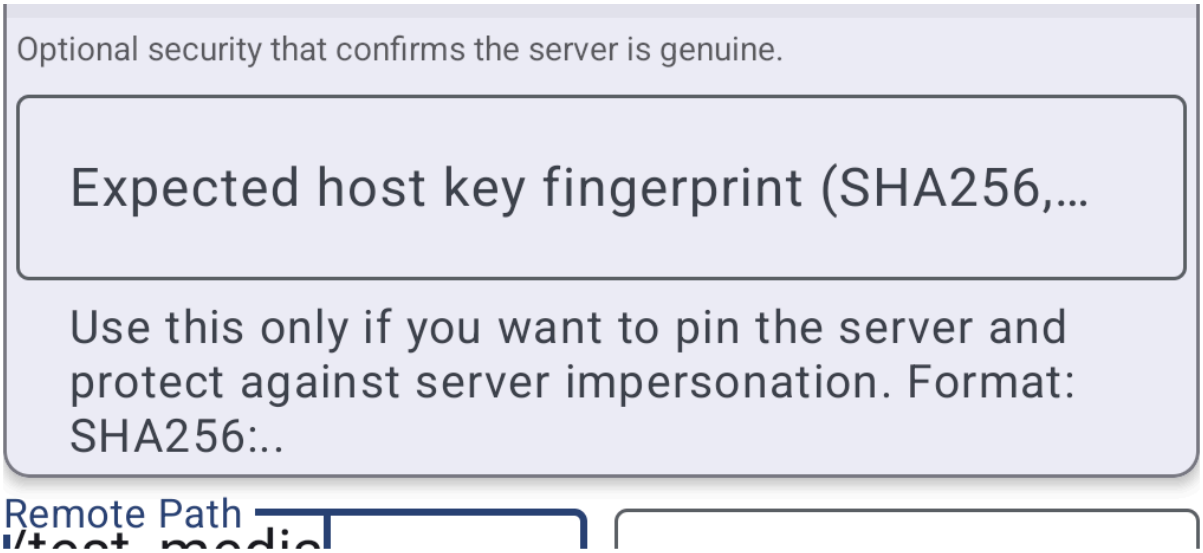
Paste the key or choose a file.

Key Passphrase (optional)

Leave empty if the key is not encrypted.

Test Connection

Server verification (optional)

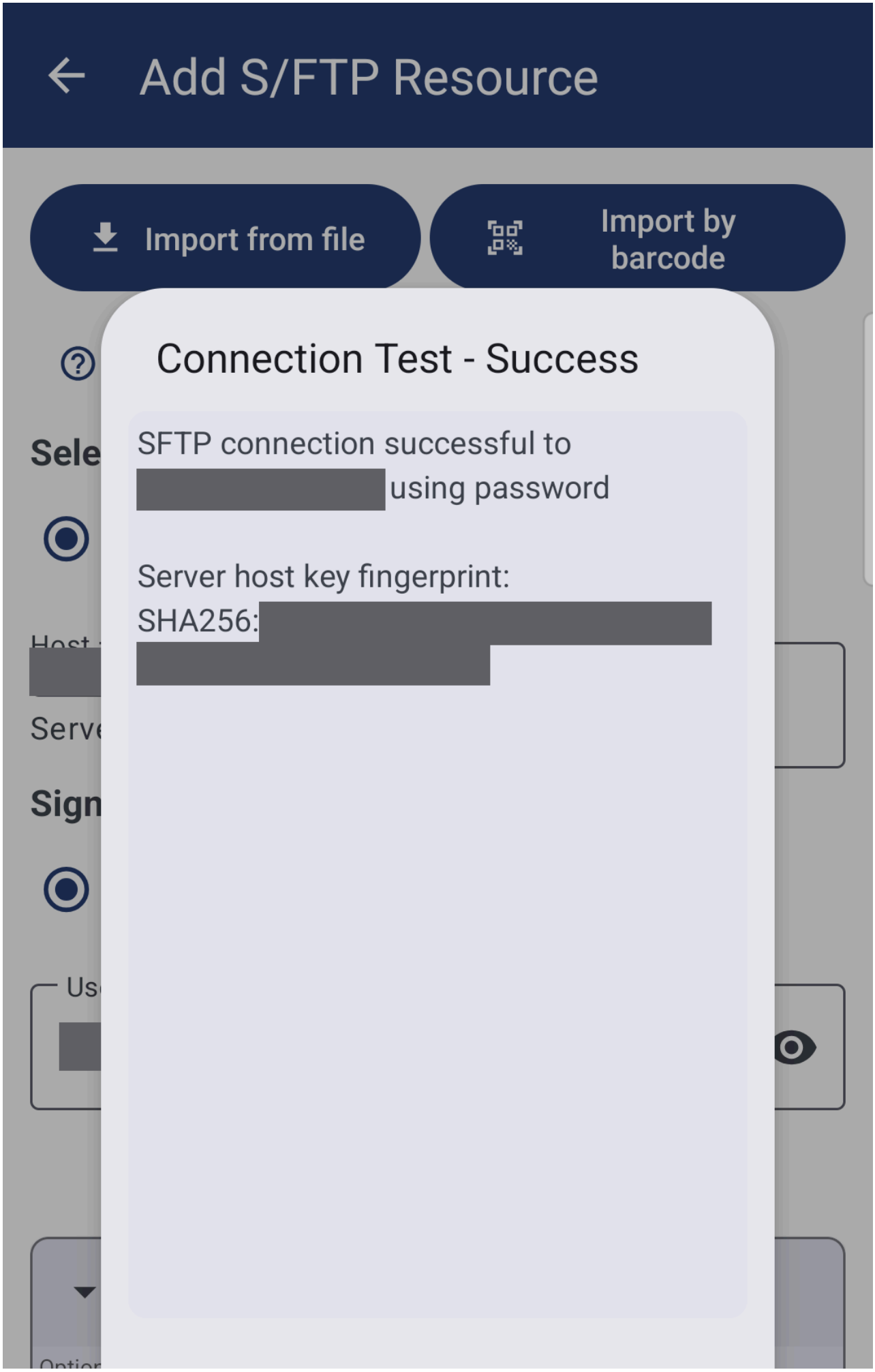


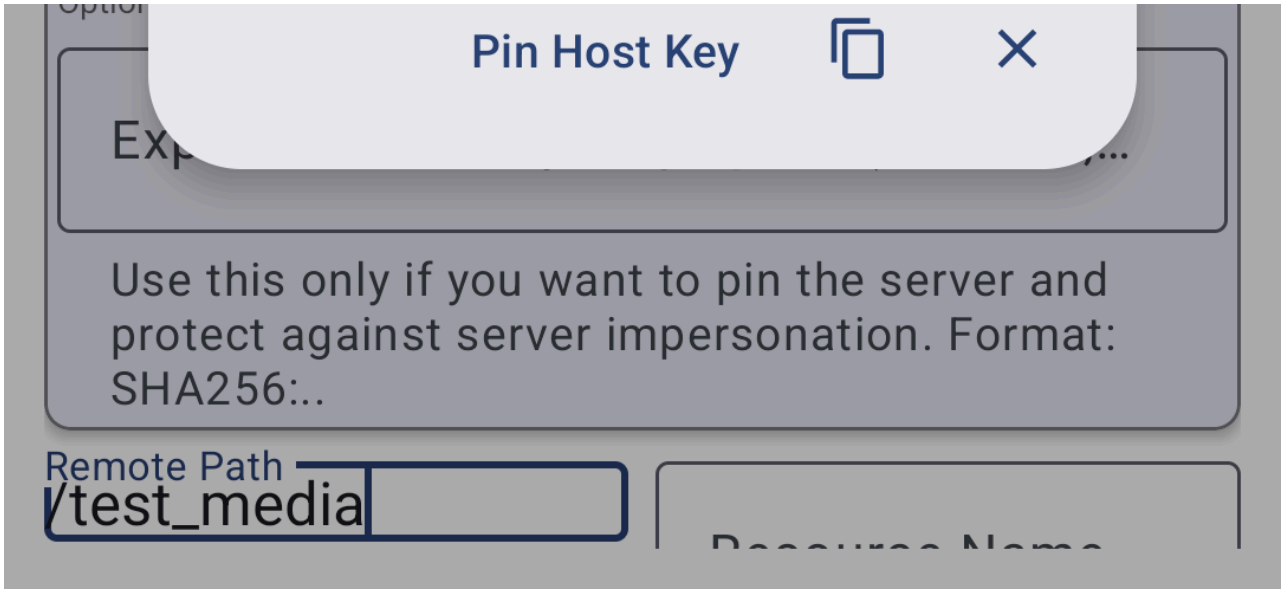
Paste a key or load it from a file.

3 Test the connection, and let the app remember this server

Tap **Test Connection**. The first time an SFTP server answers, its identity is worth pinning: open **Server verification (optional)** – "Optional security that confirms the server is genuine" – where the app can show "Server host key fingerprint: " with a **Pin Host Key** button, or you can paste one yourself into **Expected host key fingerprint (SHA256, optional)** if you already know it. Pinning it means "Server host key fingerprint pinned" and the app will only ever trust that one key for this resource from now on.

This step is optional by design – most people can skip it and just add the resource – but it is the one thing that turns "probably the right server" into "definitely the right server."


Add S/FTP Resource
Import from file
Import by barcode
Connection Test - Success
SFTP connection successful to
using password
Server host key fingerprint:
SHA256:



Pin the server's identity once, on the first connection.

In plain words, what a host key fingerprint is

Every SFTP server has its own private identity key, and the fingerprint is a short code computed from it. Pinning it is like remembering a face instead of just a name - if someone else's server later answers under the same address, the fingerprint gives it away.

4 The server's identity is checked every time, not just once

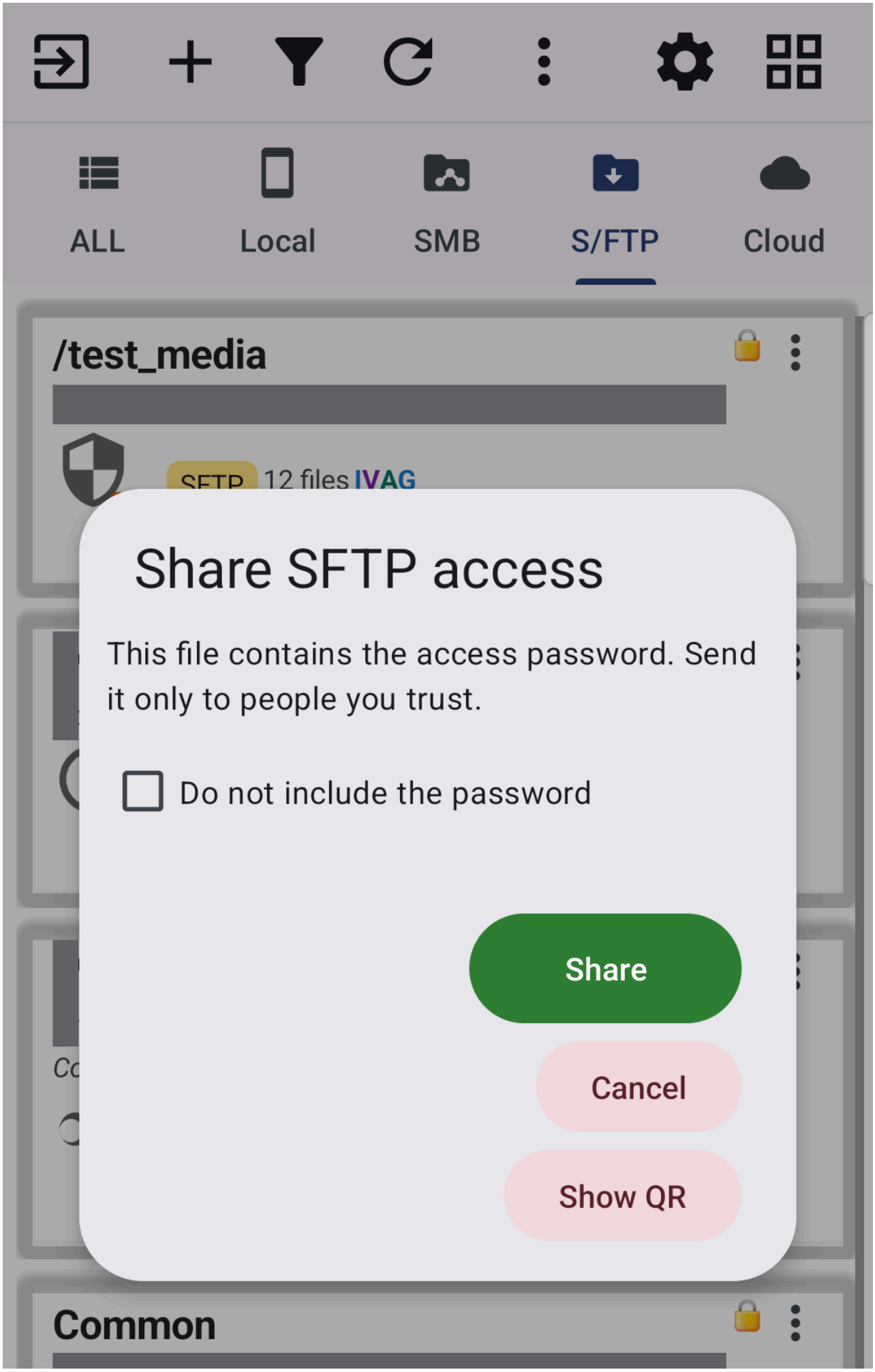
A pinned host key is verified on every connection this resource makes from then on - browsing, thumbnails, playback and its reconnects alike, not only when you press Test Connection. If a server ever answers with a different key than the one you pinned, the app refuses it outright: "This shared folder's server looks different from the one you paired with. Nothing was loaded, to keep you safe." That is what a genuine man-in-the-middle attempt looks like from the inside, and it is also exactly what happens, harmlessly, if a server was reinstalled and issued itself a new key - re-pin it once you are sure it is really the same place.

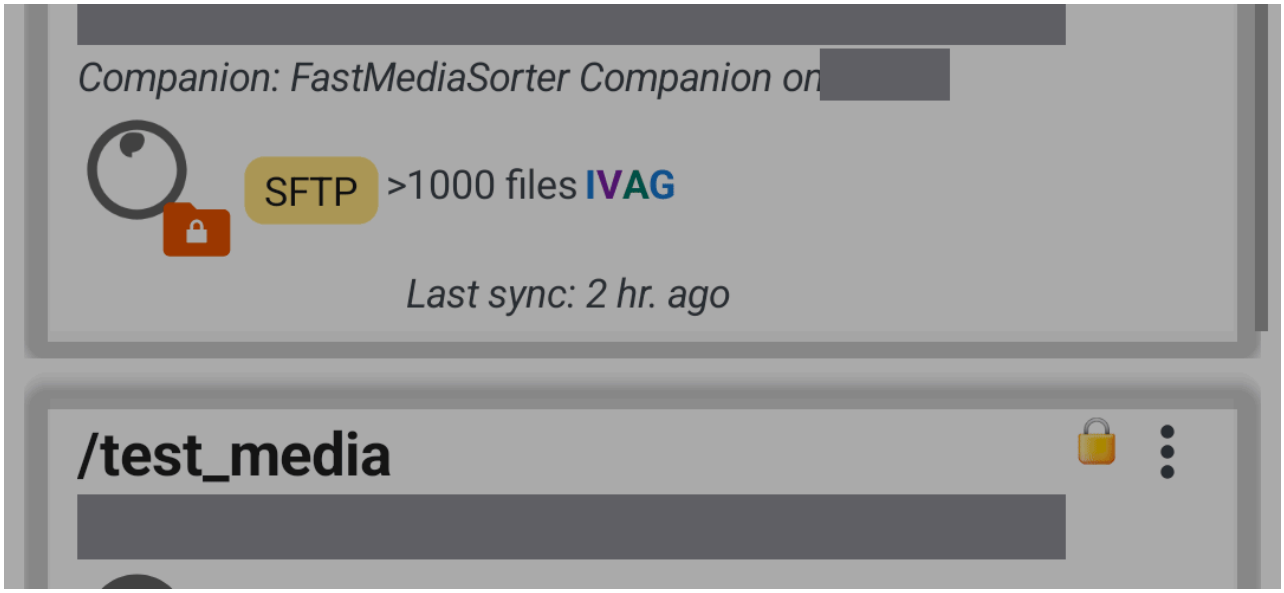
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Host key mismatch**
Opening an SFTP resource whose server key differs from the pinned one.

5 Send someone access to a folder you already added

Open an SFTP resource's menu and tap **Share access…**. On the **Share SFTP access** screen, "This file contains the access password. Send it only to people you trust." – tick **Do not include the password** to leave it out and tell the other person separately instead. If the server only answers on your home network, the screen adds "This server is on your local network – the recipient can connect only from the same network."

Tap **Share** and the system share sheet opens – send the file over Telegram, email, or anything else installed on your phone.


ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
/test_media
SFTP 12 files IVAG
Share SFTP access
This file contains the access password. Send it only to people you trust.
Do not include the password
Share
Cancel
Show QR
Common

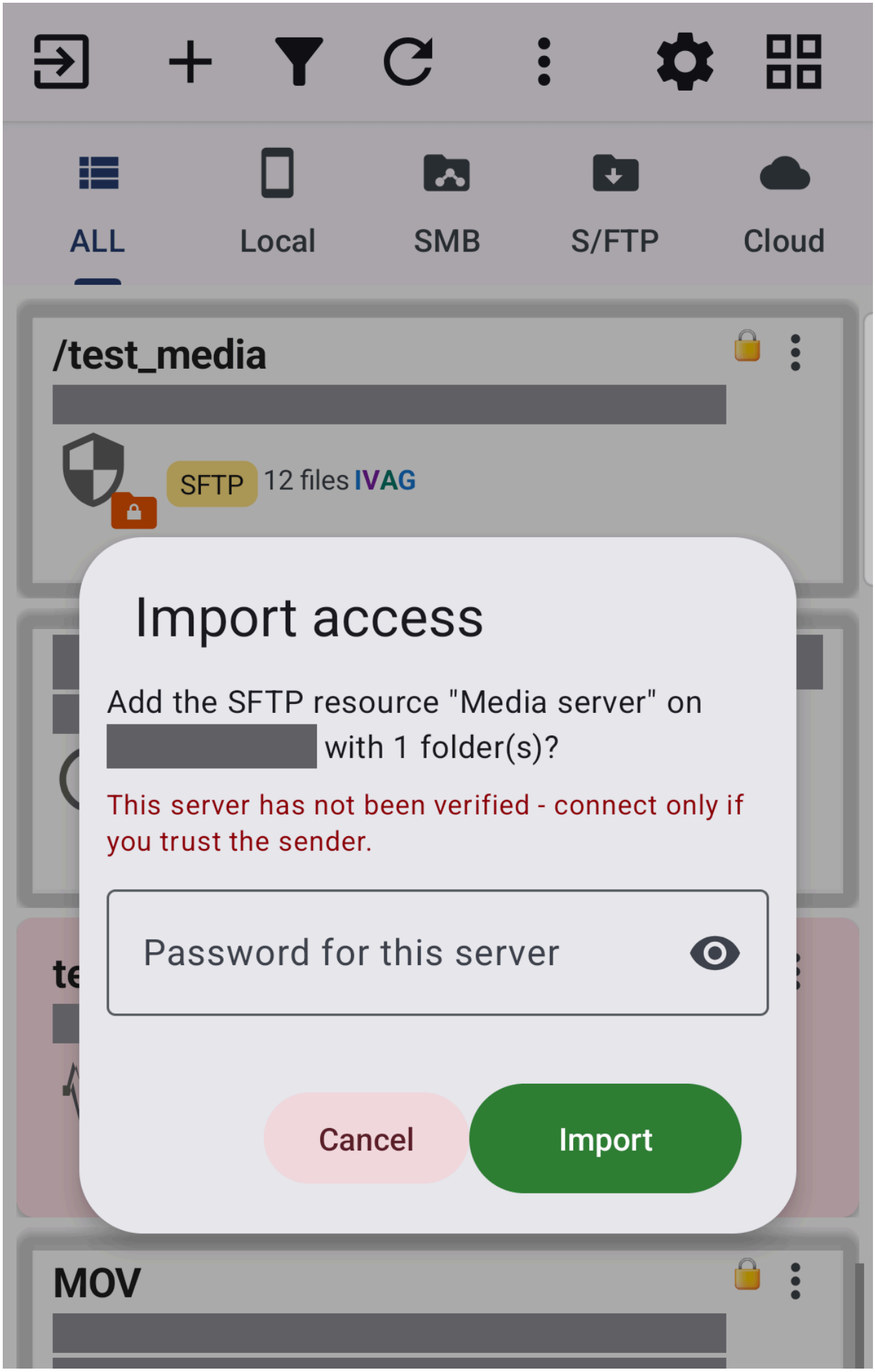


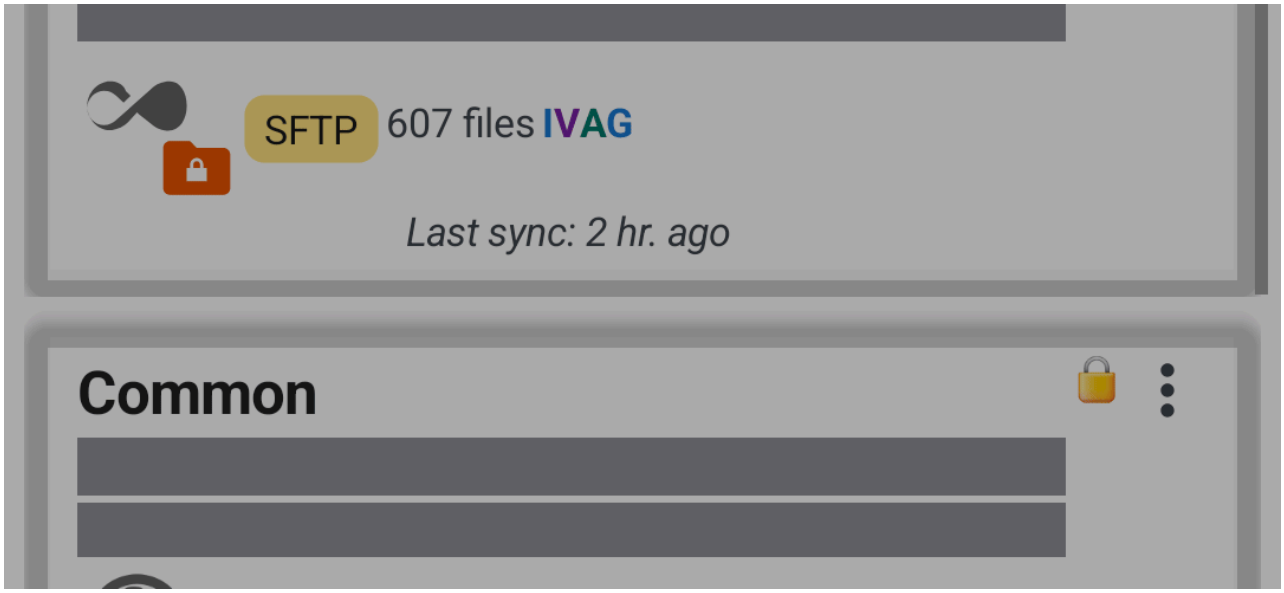
Share access to a folder, password optional.

6 Add a folder someone shared with you

Tap a received access file, in Telegram or in an email attachment, and **Import access** opens on its own, asking to add the SFTP resource with however many folders it carries; if the file left the password out, you are asked for it there. Tap **Import** and the resource is ready to open, no address or key to type by hand.

You can start the same import deliberately, too: the Add Resource screen and the SFTP form itself both offer **Import from file** next to the usual resource cards, and **Import by barcode** to scan a QR code with the camera instead, when there is no file to open.


ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
/test_media
SFTP
12 files
IVAG
Import access
Add the SFTP resource "Media server" on
with 1 folder(s)?
This server has not been verified - connect only if you trust the sender.
Password for this server
Cancel
Import
MOV



One tap on a received file adds the resource.

This is also how a shared PC folder arrives

A folder shared from Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows uses the same file format and the same import dialog - see Sharing PC folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows.

7 A few things the app handles quietly

- **A folder scan that cannot finish says so.** Scanning an SFTP folder ends in bounded time even when the network changes mid-scan or a connection goes half-open - "The folder is taking too long to load. Check your network and try again." instead of a spinner that never stops.
- **A server that was just unreachable is not retried the hard way every time.** For a short cooldown after a failed connection, the app answers fast instead of making every thumbnail or file wait through a full connection timeout again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Folder load timeout**
Browse on an SFTP resource after the network dropped mid-scan.

What You Get

A server you reach by address - on your own network or anywhere on the internet - opens with a password or a key, its identity is confirmed once and checked on every visit after that, and handing someone else access to a folder, or receiving access to theirs, is one shared file away.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Not sure whether you need SMB or SFTP?** Connecting SMB/Windows shares compares the two from a user's point of view.
- **Want the phone to be the server instead?** See Turning the phone into an SFTP server.
- **Testing an SFTP or FTP resource from your watch?** The watch's own **Test** button really connects and reports the server's actual reason on failure - see Opening the phone's and network folders on the watch.
- **Everything in one move to a new phone.** Resources added here, including keys and pinned fingerprints, travel in the same backup as the rest of your resources - see Sharing and backing up your resources.
- **Want to reach your own storage from outside your home?** The media exchange portal walks through the home network way step by step and says what works today.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Connecting SMB/Windows shares

Share a folder from Windows and see how SMB compares to SFTP and FTP.

NETWORK

Turning the phone into an SFTP server

Share folders from your own phone instead of connecting to someone else's.

NETWORK

Sharing PC folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

The PC-side companion that publishes folders as ready-made SFTP resources.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #05

Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR - not Lite, not FOSS. Needs a Google account.

Google Drive Integration

Sign in to Google Drive once and it opens folders as resources, backs up your settings, and moves files and settings between your own devices through a private Drive queue - all from the same Google Account connection, which keeps working across app updates.

Why You'll Love This

Half your photo library already lives in Google Drive, and you would rather browse it from the same app you use for everything else instead of switching to a separate Drive app. Sign in once, and Drive folders open next to your local ones - and the same sign-in quietly does more than open folders: it backs up your settings and lets your phone and your tablet swap files through your own private corner of Drive.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR editi on - not Lite, not FOSS. See The seven editions.
- A Google account, and a browser installed that can handle the sign-in window (any everyday browser does).

1 Sign in and add a Drive folder

On the main screen tap **Add**, then **Cloud Storage** - "Tap on a provider to authenticate and select folders" - and choose **Google Drive** on the **Select Cloud Provider** screen. A sign-in window opens for your Google account; approve it, and the app shows "Signed in: " with your address.

Tap **Select Folder** and pick the Drive folder you want to see in the app. Each folder you choose becomes a resource of its own, sitting on the main screen exactly like a folder on the phone. If the sign-in window is closed or canceled, the app says so plainly and nothing is added; if a later check fails, it reports "Connection failed: " with the reason instead of a bare error.

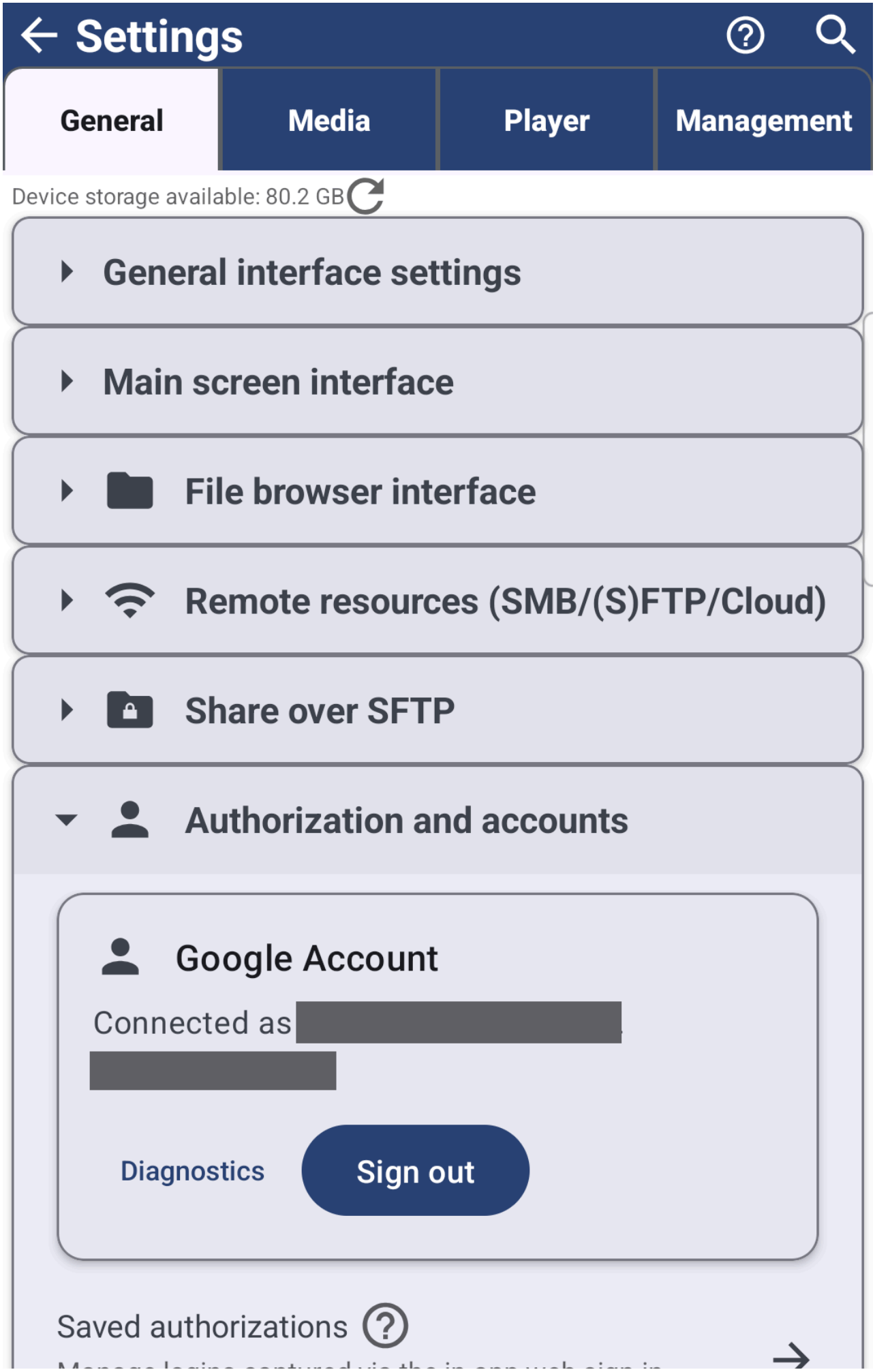
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Google Drive Select Folder**
Add Resource, Cloud Storage, Google Drive chosen and signed in, Select Folder screen open with a folder tree, one subfolder highlighted.

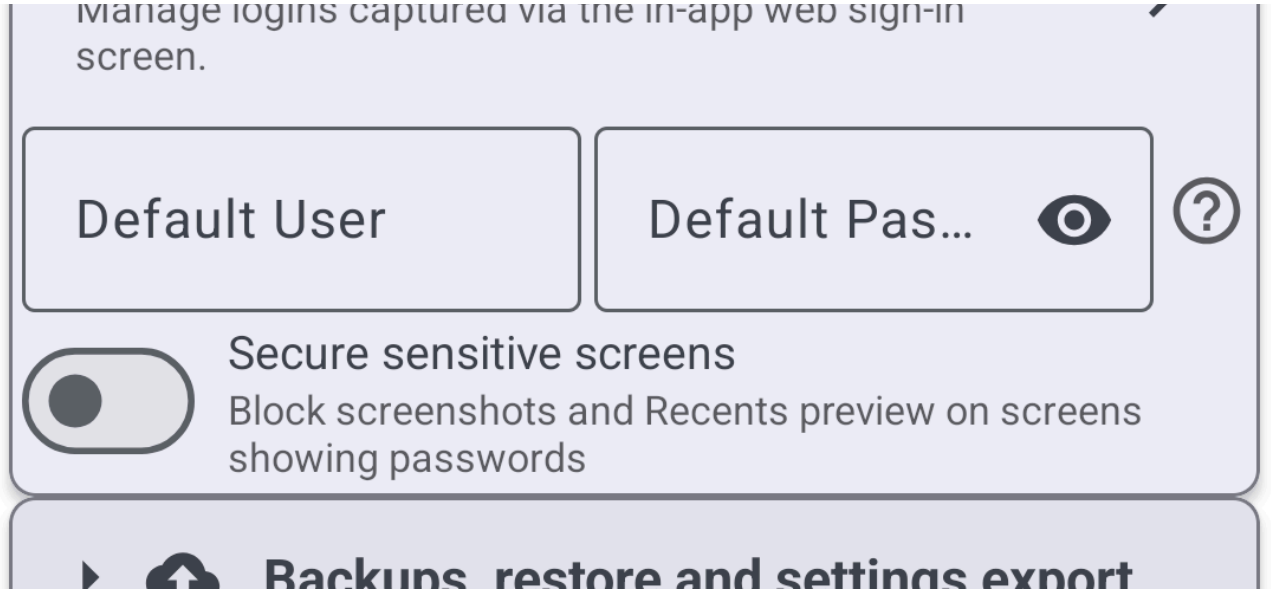
2 One sign-in, in one place

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and find the **Google Account** card, just above **Saved authorizations**. Signed out, it explains itself - "Sign in once to use Google Drive backup and add Drive folders without re-entering your account" - with a **Sign in to Google** button. Signed in, it reads "Connected as " and offers **Sign out**.

If the connection ever needs refreshing, the card asks you to **Reconnect** instead of starting over, and if your phone has no browser Google's sign-in can use, it says so directly rather than failing silently. This account is shared by every Drive folder you add and by Drive backup below - sign in here once, and both are ready.

The connection also survives an app update: it does not quietly drop just because a new version arrived, so you are not sent back to sign in again for no reason.


Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Device storage available: 80.2 GB
General interface settings
Main screen interface
File browser interface
Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)
Share over SFTP
Authorization and accounts
Google Account
Connected as
Diagnostics
Sign out
Saved authorizations



One Google Account card for Drive folders and Drive backup alike.

3 Back up your settings to the same account

Once you are signed in, the same **Settings**, **General** tab gains **Backup settings to Google Drive** and **Restore settings from Google Drive**, in the **Backups, restore and settings export** card - a full copy of your settings, resources and Favorites, kept in your own Drive and restorable on any device signed in to that account. The full walk-through, including what exactly gets backed up, is in Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync.

4 Send files and settings to your other devices

Still in the **Backups, restore and settings export** card, **Pending device transfers** opens a private queue that runs entirely through your own Google Drive - nothing is shared with anyone else. From another one of your devices, sending a file (its action sheet's **Send to my device (Drive)** button) or settings (the queue's own **Send to my device (Drive)** button) uploads it there; open the same screen on this device and it is waiting for you.

Each item can be picked up two ways: **Receive and keep in cloud** leaves the uploaded copy in Drive for a while longer, **Receive and delete from cloud** removes it once taken. A packet nobody picked up is dropped automatically after seven days, or right away with **Remove expired packets**.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Pending device transfers**
Pending device transfers dialog open, one packet listed, Send to my device (Drive) and Remove expired packets buttons visible.

What You Get

Your Drive folders sit on the main screen like any other, one Google Account card covers both adding folders and backing up settings, the connection keeps working across app updates, and your own devices can hand files and settings to each other through a private queue in your Drive - nothing more, nothing shared with anyone else.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Canceled a sign-in by mistake?** The app says so in plain words and adds nothing - just tap Google Drive again to retry.
- **Looking for Dropbox or OneDrive instead?** See Dropbox and OneDrive.
- **Want the full backup and restore picture?** Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync covers the file-based backup too, not only Drive.
- **Adding network folders and cloud storage in general** is covered from the top in Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources.
- **Want one shared box for all your own devices?** The media exchange portal shows how Google Drive, Dropbox and OneDrive sit next to the other ways of moving media between your devices.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Dropbox and OneDrive

Sign in and add folders from the other two cloud providers.

SETTINGS

Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync

The full backup and restore picture, file and Google Drive alike.

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources

The overview of every kind of place you can add as a resource.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #06

Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR - not Lite, not FOSS. Needs a Dropbox and/or Microsoft account.

Dropbox and OneDrive

Sign in to Dropbox and OneDrive to add their folders as resources next to your local and Google Drive ones, with the same simple sign-in, sign-out and plain-spoken error messages for both cloud providers.

Why You'll Love This

Work files live in OneDrive, personal photos are backed up to Dropbox, and you would rather browse both from inside FastMediaSorter than juggle two more apps. Sign in to either one, or both, and their folders sit on the main screen next to everything else.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR editi on - not Lite, not FOSS. See The seven editions.
- A Dropbox account, a Microsoft account for OneDrive, or both.

1 Add a Dropbox folder

On the main screen tap **Add**, then **Cloud Storage**, and choose **Dropbox** on the **Select Cloud Provider** screen. Dropbox's own sign-in window opens; approve it there, and the app shows "Signed in: " with your account. A folder picker - Dropbox's own - opens next so you can choose the folder to add.

Each folder becomes its own resource on the main screen. Tap **Dropbox** again later, once you are already signed in, and a dialog offers **Select Folder** to add another one or **Sign out** to end the session; **Cancel** just backs out.

2 Add a OneDrive folder

Tap **Add**, then **Cloud Storage**, and choose **OneDrive**. Microsoft's sign-in window opens; approve it, and the app shows "Signed in: " with your account. Tap **Select Folder** and pick the OneDrive folder you want - it opens as a resource of its own, exactly like a Dropbox or Google Drive folder does.

The same already-signed-in dialog appears if you tap **OneDrive** again: **Select Folder** for another one, **Sign out** to end the session.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: OneDrive Select Folder**
Add Resource, Cloud Storage, OneDrive chosen and signed in, Select Folder screen open with a folder tree, one subfolder highlighted.

3 What the app says when a sign-in does not go through

Close the sign-in window before finishing and the app says "Dropbox authentication canceled" or "OneDrive authentication canceled" - nothing is added, and you can just try again. A sign-in that fails outright is reported as "Dropbox authentication failed" or "OneDrive authentication failed" rather than a bare error, and if a folder you already added stops answering, the app names it: "Connection failed: " with the reason.

What You Get

Dropbox and OneDrive folders sit on the main screen next to your local and Google Drive ones, sign-in and sign-out work the same simple way for both, and a canceled or failed sign-in tells you plainly instead of leaving you guessing.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Moved to a new phone?** OneDrive keeps its sign-in in a place the app cannot carry over automatically, so you sign in to OneDrive once more there - see the new-phone notes in Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources.
- **Looking for Google Drive?** It gets its own page, with account binding and the cross-device transfer queue that rides on it - see Google Drive Integration.
- **Adding network folders and cloud storage in general** is covered from the top in Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources.
- **Want one shared box for all your own devices?** The media exchange portal shows how Google Drive, Dropbox and OneDrive sit next to the other ways of moving media between your devices.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Google Drive Integration

Sign in to Google Drive, plus the settings backup and cross-device queue it unlocks.

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources

The overview of every kind of place you can add as a resource.

SETTINGS

Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync

The full backup and restore picture for your settings and resources.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #07

Background sync - Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR, not Lite, not FOSS. Video playback priority for thumbnails - Standard only.

Keeping Network Folders Up to Date

Turn on a background schedule so network and cloud folders stay current on their own, preload their thumbnails ahead of time, and let a playing network video keep the full connection to itself while previews wait their turn.

Why You'll Love This

Someone else keeps adding photos to the shared folder on the home NAS, and you would rather the file list was already current when you open it than pull down to refresh every single time. FastMediaSorter can check your network and cloud resources for changes by itself, on a schedule you set, and get their thumbnails ready in the background too - so opening one feels instant.

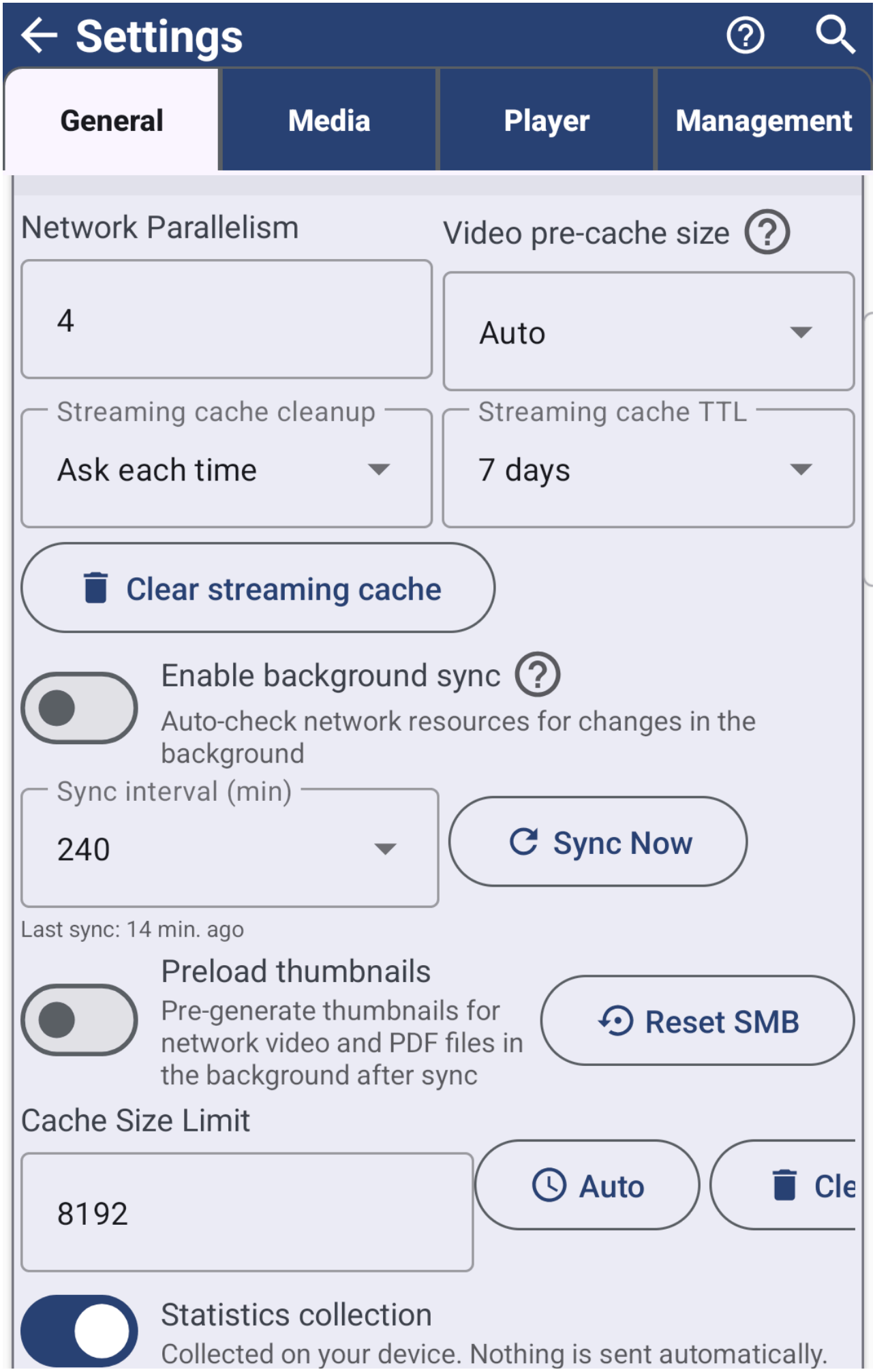
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

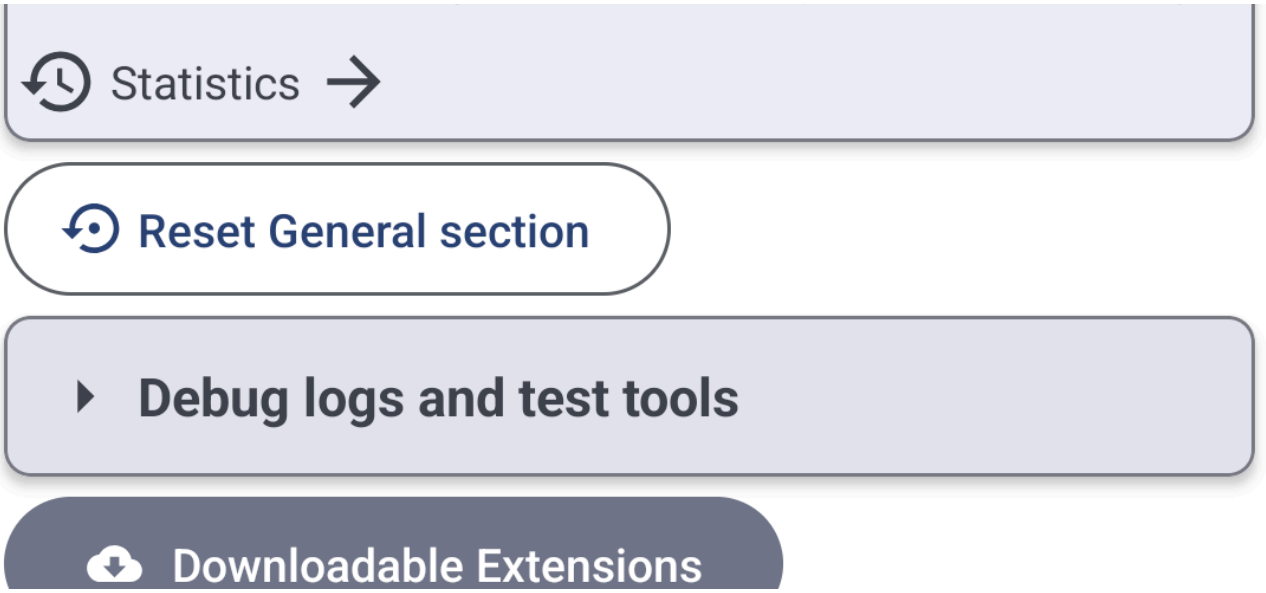
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR edition for background sync - not Lite, not FOSS. See The seven editions.
- At least one network folder or cloud storage resource already added - see Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources.

1 Let the app check for changes by itself

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and find **Background sync, network and cache**. Turn on **Enable background sync** - "Automatically check network resources for file changes in the background" - and set **Sync interval (min)** to how often it should run.

Want it done right now instead of waiting? Tap **Sync Now**. The row shows "Syncing.." while it works, then something like "Synced 5 resources successfully" once it finishes, or "Couldn't finish the sync. Try again." if it did not. Underneath, the app always shows when it last managed it - "Last sync: " or "Never synced" the first time.


Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Network Parallelism
4
Video pre-cache size
Auto
Streaming cache cleanup
Ask each time
Streaming cache TTL
7 days
Clear streaming cache
Enable background sync
Auto-check network resources for changes in the background
Sync interval (min)
240
Sync Now
Last sync: 14 min. ago
Preload thumbnails
Pre-generate thumbnails for network video and PDF files in the background after sync
Reset SMB
Cache Size Limit
8192
Auto
Cle
Statistics collection
Collected on your device. Nothing is sent automatically.



Set how often the app checks your network folders by itself.

2

Have thumbnails ready before you open the folder

In the same section, **Preload thumbnails** - "Pre-generate thumbnails for network video and PDF files in the background after sync" - gets previews ready right after each sync instead of only when you scroll to a file. If you would rather this only happens on Wi-Fi, turn on **Wi-Fi only preload** too, so it never spends mobile data quietly generating previews you have not asked to see yet.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Preload thumbnails**
Settings, background sync, network and cache section, both preload switches on.

3 A playing network video always gets the bandwidth

Standard edition. While a video from a network folder is playing, the app pauses loading previews for the files around it in the background, so the video gets the connection to itself instead of sharing it with a dozen thumbnails at once. The moment playback ends, preview loading picks back up by itself, and those paused previews load correctly rather than getting stuck as if they had failed.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Network video playing**
Video from an SMB resource playing in the player, controls visible.

What You Get

Network and cloud folders stay current on their own, on the schedule you chose, their thumbnails are often ready before you even open them, and a playing network video never has to fight background preview loading for bandwidth.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Wondering how the app keeps network folders fast in the first place?** Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources explains the file-list and thumbnail caches this sync feeds.
- **Streaming cache is a separate setting.** How long a played video is kept ready for offline resume lives in the same overview page, not here.
- **Connecting the folders themselves?** See Connecting SMB/Windows Shares and Connecting SFTP and FTP Servers.
- **Not sure which way of connecting your own devices fits you?** The media exchange portal compares the home network, the exchange server and live broadcast, and shows which program does what on each device.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources

What kinds of places you can add, and how the app's caches keep them quick.

NETWORK

Connecting SMB/Windows Shares

The full walk-through for shared folders on Windows and NAS.

NETWORK

Checking Your Connection with Network Monitor

See the connection itself when a sync or a stream is not behaving.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #03

Import by file - Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy, VR (not Lite, not FOSS). Import by QR scan and the in-app setup guide - the same list minus VR, since scanning needs a camera. Following the PC between networks, finding it on the local network by itself, and importing a folder as writable - Standard only.

Sharing PC Folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows publishes PC folders so this app opens them with no server address to type - bring them in with a file or a QR scan, and the connection follows the phone off the home network and back.

Why You'll Love This

Family videos live on the PC under the TV, not on the phone, and setting up a shared folder by hand - server address, username, password, port - is exactly the kind of chore you'd rather skip. Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows is a small program for that PC: point it at a folder, and this app opens that folder with nothing more to type in.

This page covers the companion side of things: bringing a shared folder in, keeping the connection working as you leave the house, and what the app tells you when it cannot reach the PC. Setting up a server folder by hand instead is Connecting SFTP and FTP servers; the reverse direction - sharing folders from this phone instead - is Turning the phone into an SFTP server.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- This app in any edition except Lite and FOSS - see the narrower notes on each step below.
- Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows installed on the PC, with at least one folder already shared from it.
- Either the config file it saved, or its QR code and a phone with a camera.
- To reach the folder away from home: the PC's owner has already set up port forwarding on the router, or turned on the companion program's own internet access.

1 Meet Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows is a program for the PC, not for the phone: its whole job is picking a folder or two and publishing them so this app can open them, no NAS and no typing a server address by hand. The first-time welcome wizard's Network sources page already mentions it, with a short note - "Media on a Windows PC? Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows shares those folders here in a couple of clicks - no server setup needed." - next to a **Get the Windows app** button that opens its site.

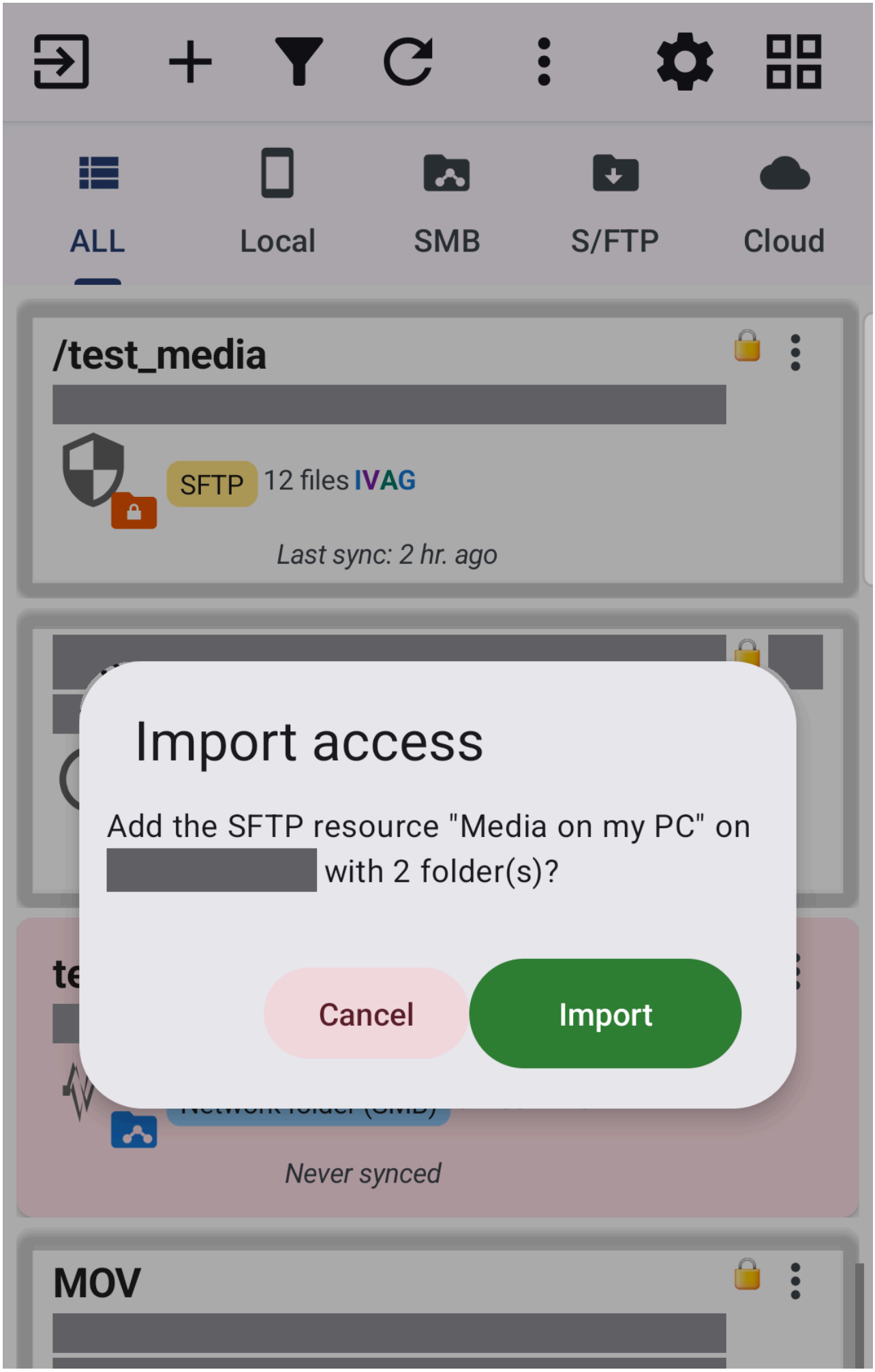
Whatever it shares arrives here as an ordinary SFTP resource, read-only or writable, sitting on the main screen next to everything else - there is no separate "companion folder" type to learn.

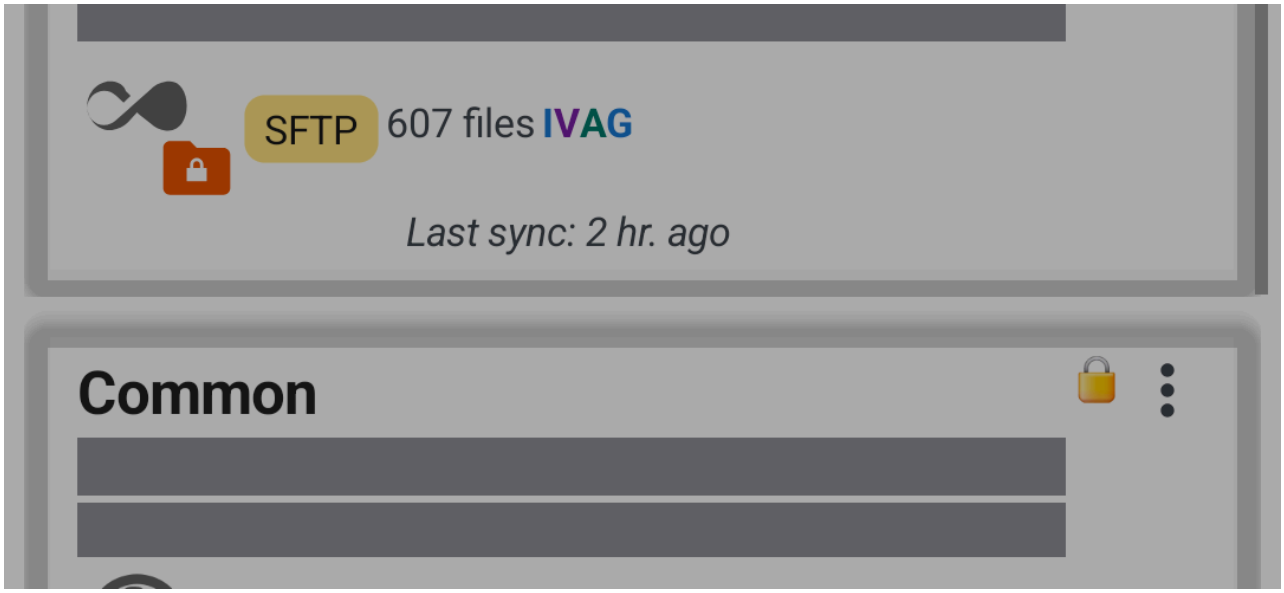
2 Bring in a shared config with one tap

On the main screen tap **Add** to open **Add Resource**. Two buttons sit above the four resource-type cards, and the same pair repeats inside the **SFTP / FTP** card's own header: **Import from file** and **Import by barcode**.

Tap **Import from file** and pick the config the companion program saved on the PC (send it to the phone however suits you - a cable, a chat message, a cloud folder). The **Import access** dialog asks to confirm, for example "Add the SFTP resource "Living Room PC" on 192.168.1.20 with 2 folder(s)?", and if the config carries no password it asks for one first ("Password for this server"). The first time a given PC is imported, and it has not been verified yet, the dialog also warns "This server has not been verified - connect only if you trust the sender." - connect only if you recognize where the file came from.

Tap **Import** and a message confirms what changed: "Added: Family Photos" for one new folder, "Added 2 resources" for several at once, or "Resources already up to date" when you import the same file again and nothing was different.


ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
/test_media
SFTP
12 files IVAG
Last sync: 2 hr. ago
Import access
Add the SFTP resource "Media on my PC" on
with 2 folder(s)?
Cancel
Import
Never synced
MOV

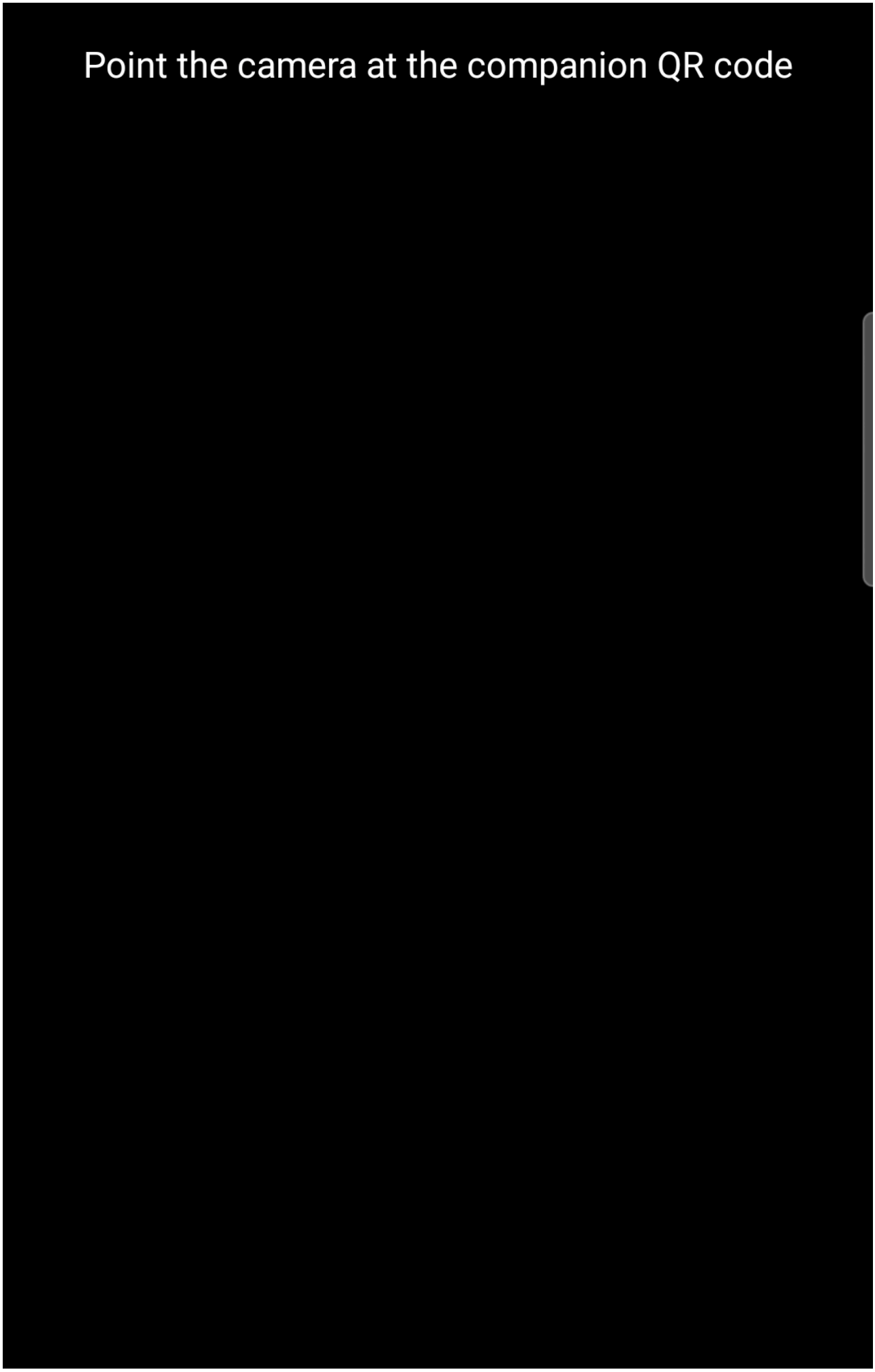


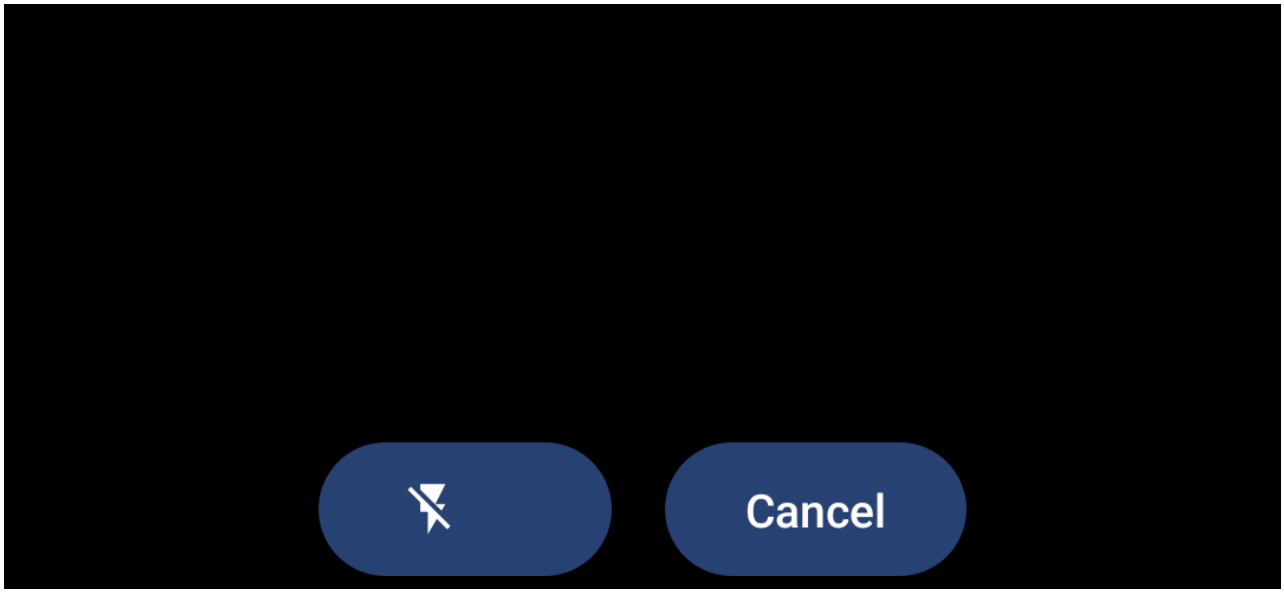
Confirming a companion import before it creates anything.

3 Scan the pairing QR code instead

No file at hand? Tap **Import by barcode** in the same places as **Import from file**. The camera opens with the hint "Point the camera at the companion QR code" and a **Flash** button for a dim room; point it at the QR code the companion program shows on the PC screen. The result is the same **Import access** dialog as the file, since both roads end at the same import.

Scanning needs the camera, so the app only asks for it here: "Scanning a companion QR code needs the camera." This button is hidden on devices with no camera and on the VR edition - a headset has none CameraX can use - and on those, **Import from file** is the only route in.


Point the camera at the companion QR code



Scanning the companion's QR code instead of picking a file.

4 Read the PC-side setup guide, right from the phone

Nothing shared yet, or not sure the PC side is set up right? Tap **How to publish PC folders to Android** - it sits right in the **SFTP / FTP** form's header on **Add Resource**, and again in **Settings**, so it is just as reachable when there is nothing to import yet. Both open the companion program's own setup guide in your browser.

This link shows up on the Standard, noLegal, Photos and Legacy editions. Where it is missing, the two import buttons above still work once the PC side is set up.

5 Why the folder keeps opening, wherever you are

A companion folder remembers more than one way to reach the PC - the address on your home Wi-Fi, and, once the PC's owner set up port forwarding or the companion program's own internet access, an address that works from anywhere. The app always tries the nearby one first and only reaches further when it has to, so the same folder keeps opening as the phone moves between home Wi-Fi and mobile data - no re-adding it, no rescanning a code.

Standard edition. The phone also listens for the companion program announcing itself on the local network. If the PC changed address, or the QR code you scanned was out of date, the app still finds it - matched by the same host key it already trusts, not by an address that may have moved.

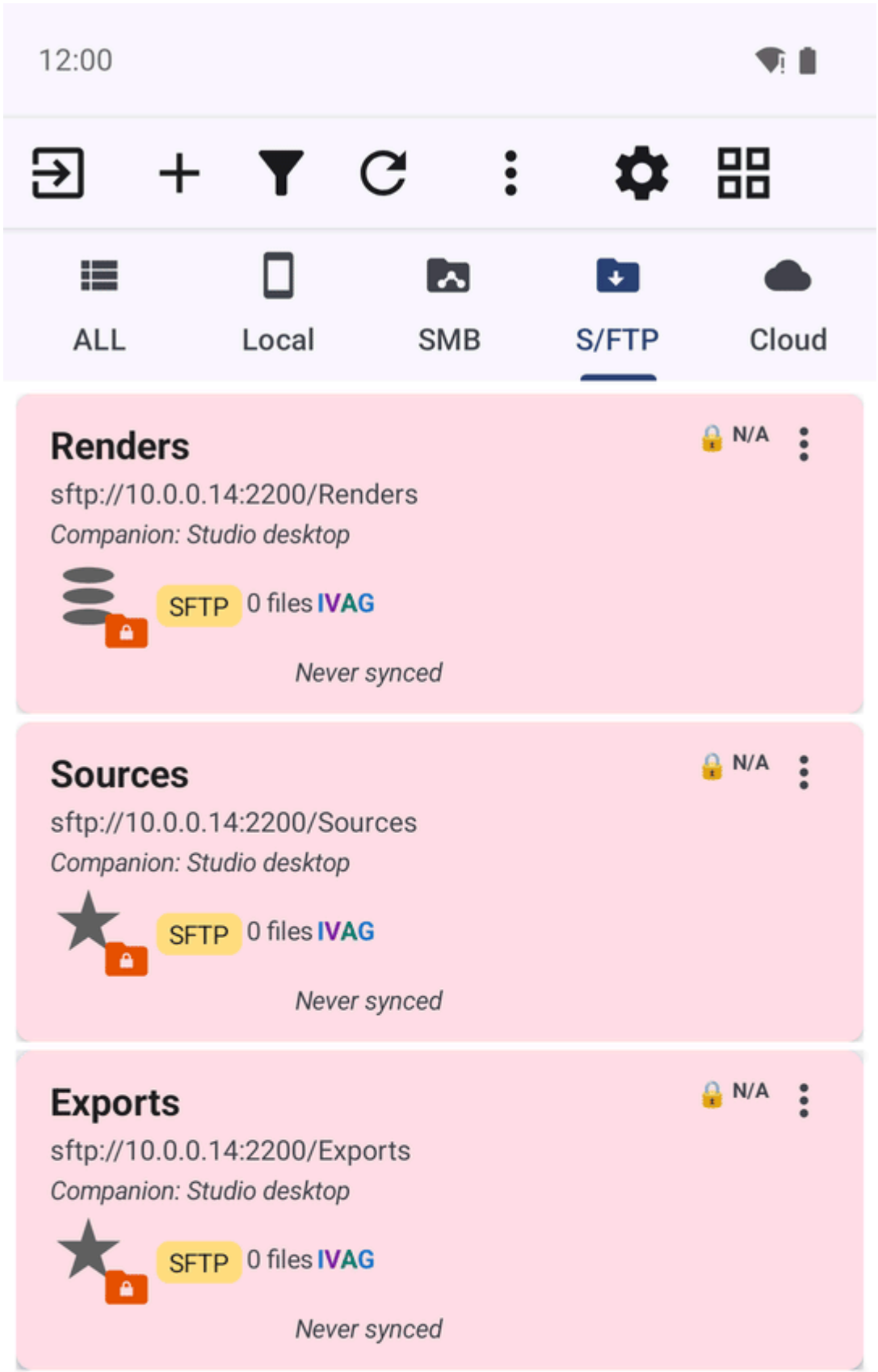
6 When you can add and delete too, not just look

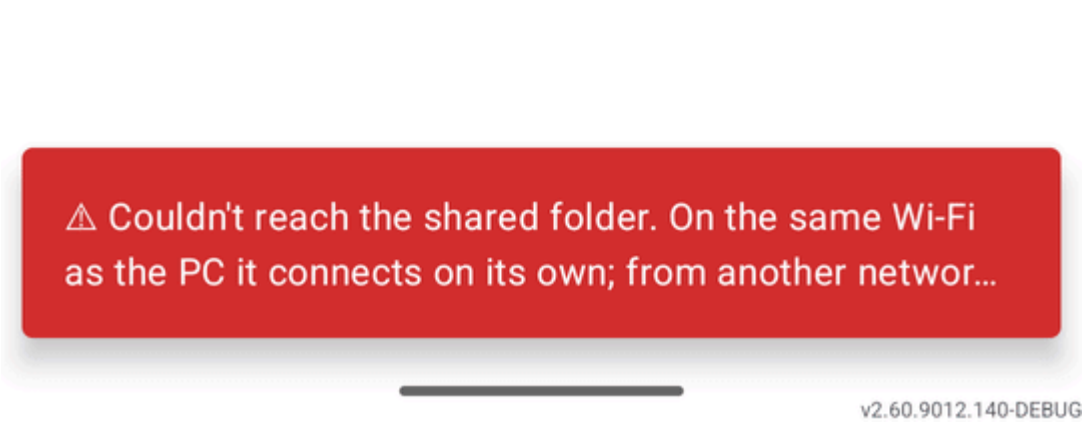
Standard edition. A folder can be shared from the companion program as writable. When it is, this app can upload into it, rename things, delete them and move files into it, exactly like any other network resource. A folder shared without that flag, or shared by an older version of the companion program, stays view-only, as before.

7 If the shared folder cannot be reached

When a companion or network SFTP folder cannot be reached, the message you see reflects the connection right now, not a note written down back when the folder was first shared - available on every edition that can hold a network or SFTP resource (all except Lite).

Standard edition. The message spells out what to try: "Couldn't reach the shared folder. On the same Wi-Fi as the PC it connects on its own; from another network the PC must allow access - set up port forwarding on the router or the internet access in the companion app."


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
Renders
N/A
sftp://10.0.0.14:2200/Renders
Companion: Studio desktop
SFTP
0 files
IVAG
Never synced
Sources
N/A
sftp://10.0.0.14:2200/Sources
Companion: Studio desktop
SFTP
0 files
IVAG
Never synced
Exports
N/A
sftp://10.0.0.14:2200/Exports
Companion: Studio desktop
SFTP
0 files
IVAG
Never synced



A plain reason, not a bare timeout.

What You Get

PC folders sit on the main screen next to everything else, added by picking a file or scanning a code instead of typing a server address, and they keep opening whether you are on the home Wi-Fi or out with mobile data. When one cannot be reached, the app says why instead of just timing out.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Setting a server up by hand instead?** Connecting SFTP and FTP servers covers entering a host, username and SSH key yourself.
- **Want to share from the phone instead?** Turning the phone into an SFTP server covers the other direction - this phone as the one being connected to.
- **A companion folder is still a network resource underneath.** The overview in Adding network folders and cloud storage as sources covers the caches and thumbnails that keep any network place quick.
- **Sharing a PC's folders with your phone?** The media exchange portal says what the Windows program does for exchange and how a phone pairs with it.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Connecting SFTP and FTP Servers

NETWORK

Turning the Phone into an SFTP Server

Add a server folder by hand, with a password or an SSH key.

Share folders from this phone instead, paired by a QR code of its own.

STORAGE

Adding Network Folders and Cloud Storage as Sources

The overview of every kind of network and cloud place this app can open.

NETWORK & CLOUD | Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #04

All editions except Lite; needs Android 8.0 or newer.

Turning the Phone into an SFTP Server

Share folders straight from this phone over SFTP - pick them with the folder picker, sign in with a password or an SSH key, and pair another FastMediaSorter in one scan instead of typing an address.

Why You'll Love This

Usually this app reaches out to a folder somewhere else - a PC, a NAS, a cloud account. Sometimes it is the other way around: the photos worth sharing are on the phone, and it is another device that should reach in and get them. Turn on the phone's own SFTP server, pick the folders to share, and any device that speaks SFTP - including another phone running this app - can open them.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- This app in any edition except Lite, on Android 8.0 (Oreo) or newer.
- The folders you want to share, picked through the system's own folder picker.
- Either a password (the app can generate one) or the public half of an SSH key from whoever will connect.
- For pairing another FastMediaSorter with a scan: a camera on the connecting device.

1 Turn the server on

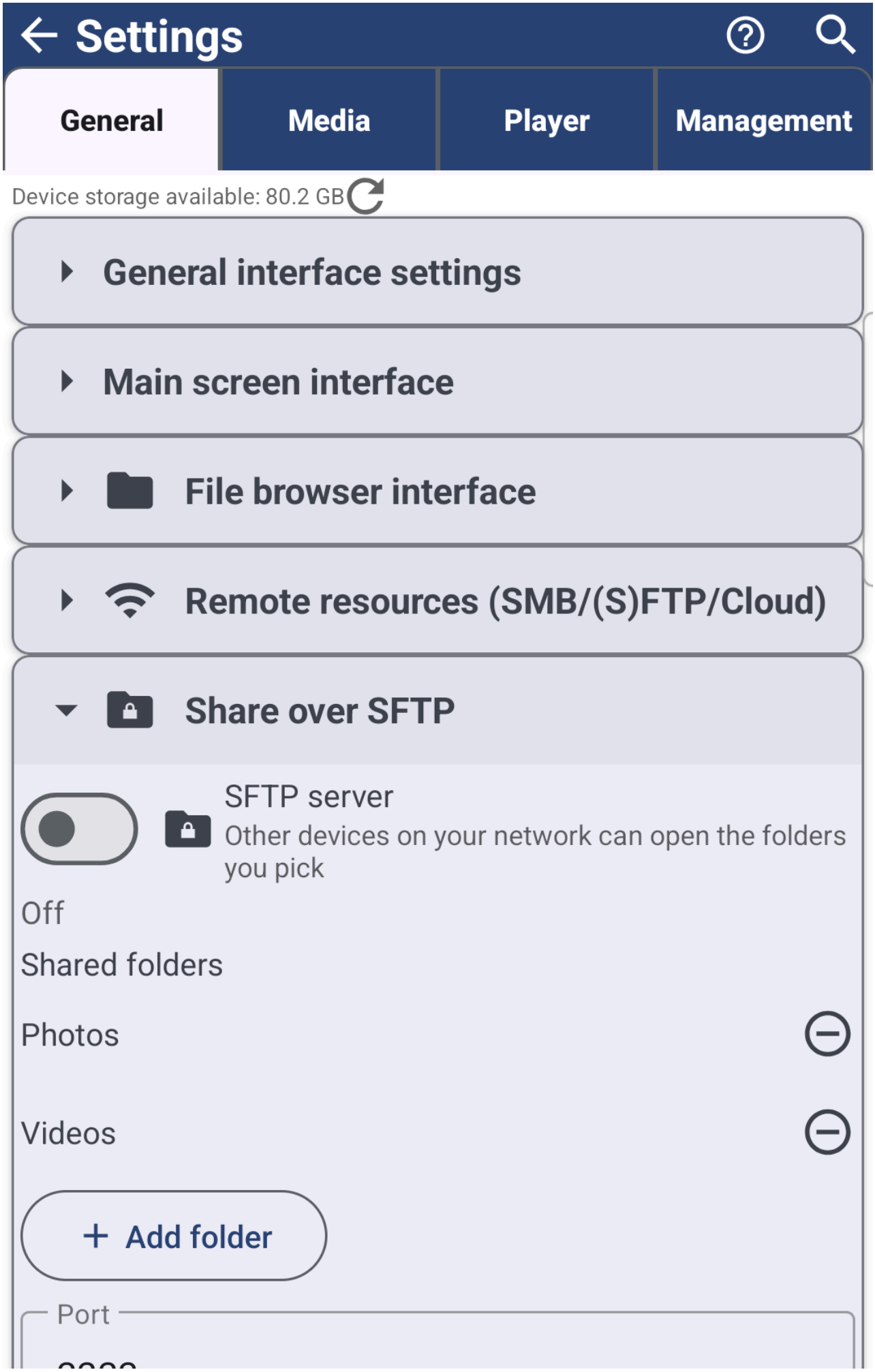
Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and find the **Share over SFTP** card. Switch on **SFTP server** - "Other devices on your network can open the folders you pick" - and the status line below moves from **Off** to **Starting..** and then to **Running at 192.168.1.42:2222**, its address and port. Turning it on with nothing shared yet, or with no way to sign in configured, is caught before it starts: "Add at least one folder to share, then turn the server on" or "Add a public key or switch to password login, then turn the server on."

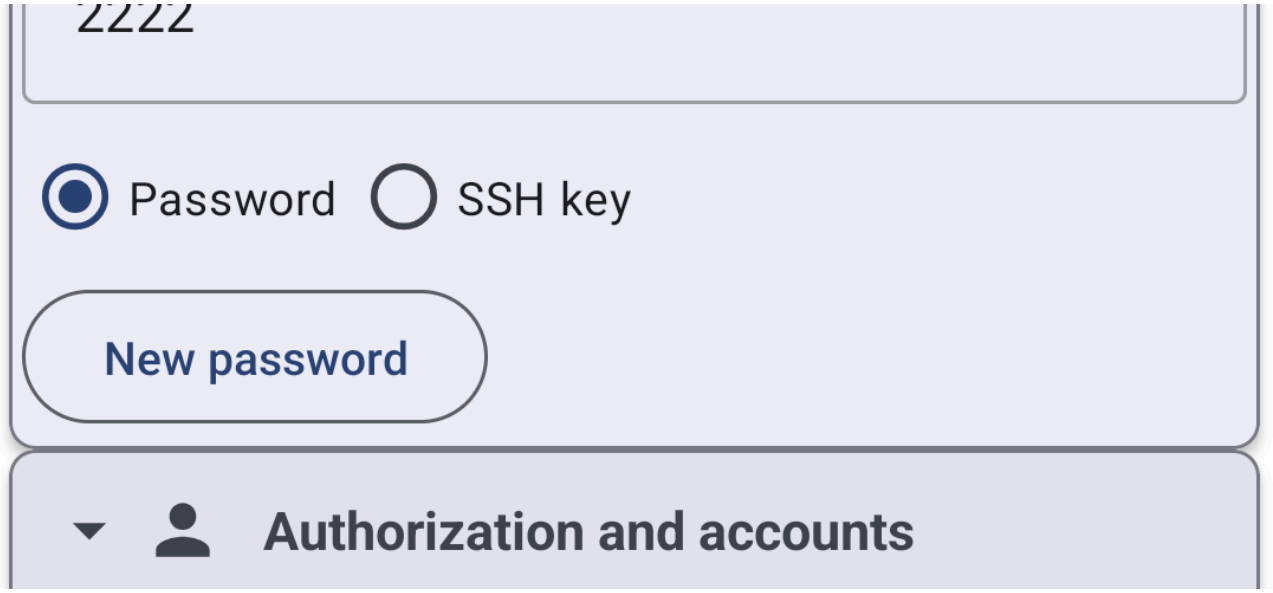
A phone with no Wi-Fi connection can still switch the server on, but it says so plainly: "Running, but the phone is not on Wi-Fi - other devices cannot reach it yet." A foreground notification, "SFTP server is on", stays up the whole time with the address to connect to and a one-tap **Stop** button.

2 Choose which folders to share

Under **Shared folders**, tap **Add folder** to open the system's own folder picker and choose a folder on the phone or its memory card. Until you add one, the section simply reads "No folders yet - add one to share it." Each folder you add gets its own row with a remove button next to it, and the grant survives a restart, so the same folders are still shared after the phone reboots.

A folder you add while the server is already running joins it immediately - no need to turn the server off and on again for a new folder.


Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Device storage available: 80.2 GB
General interface settings
Main screen interface
File browser interface
Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)
Share over SFTP
SFTP server
Other devices on your network can open the folders you pick
Off
Shared folders
Photos
Videos
+ Add folder
Port

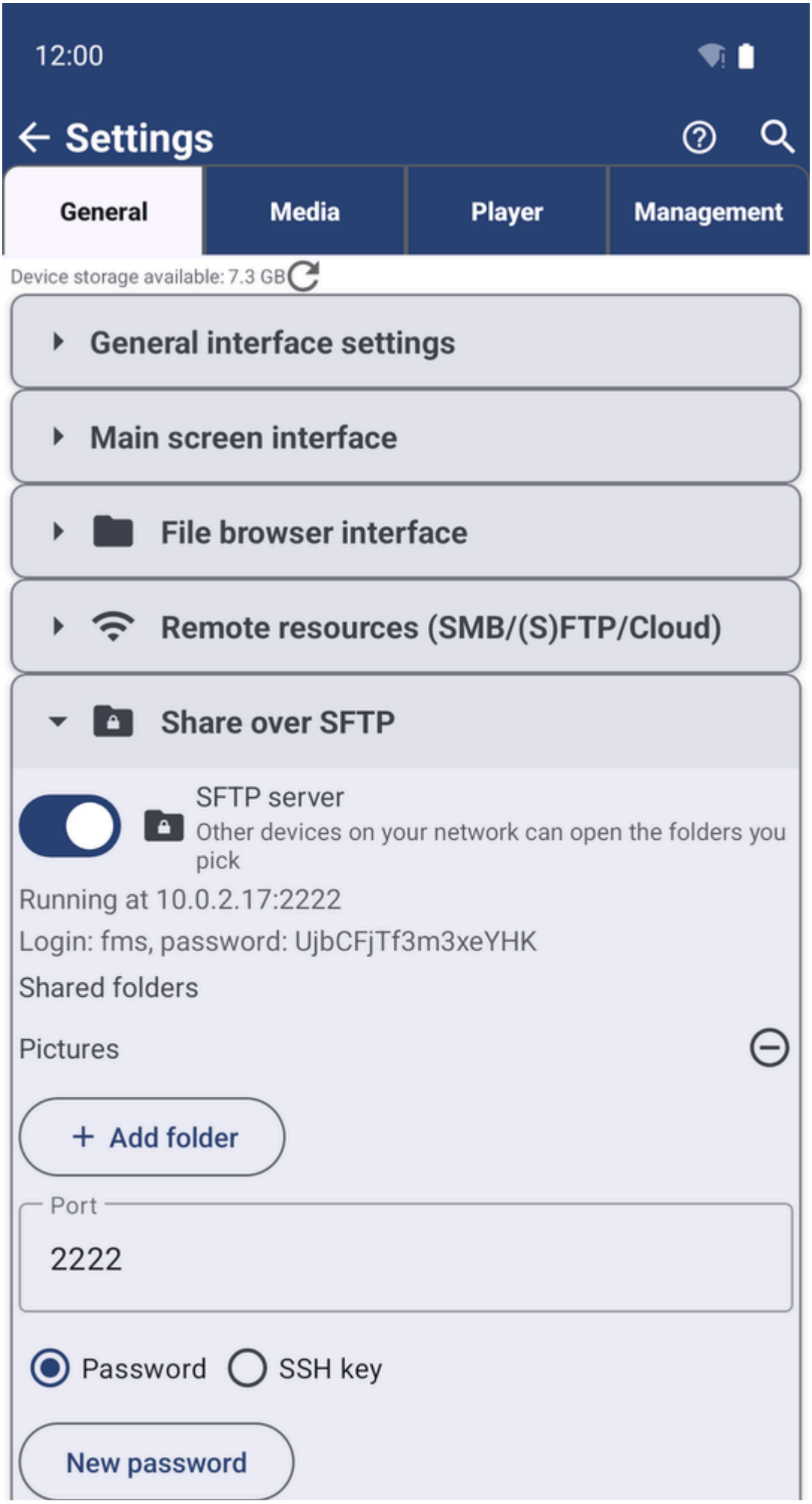


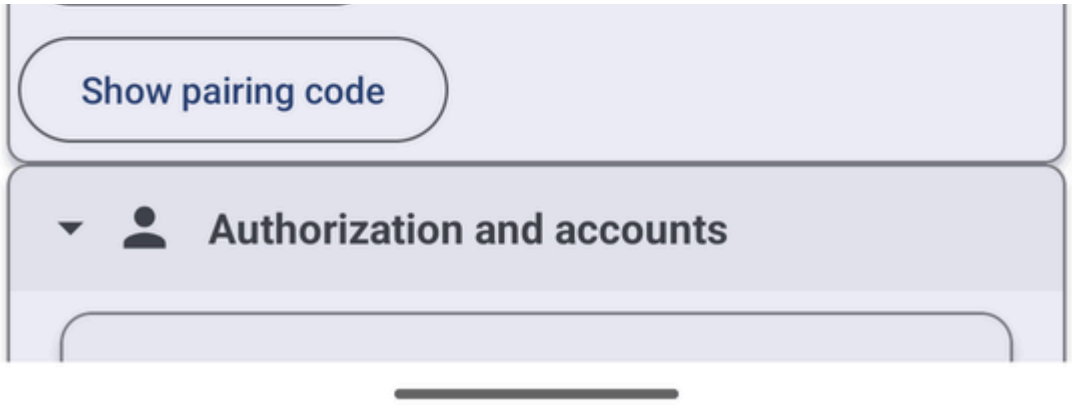
Picking which folders the server shares.

3 Decide how people sign in

Right below the folder list, choose **Password** or **SSH key**. With **Password**, the app already generated one; tap **New password** any time to replace it. With **SSH key**, paste the public keys of whoever should connect into **Public keys, one per line** - the phone never needs their private key, only what proves it.

While the server is running, the current sign-in details are shown right there: "Login: fms, password: 7f3kQ2mN" or "Login: fms, sign in with your SSH key" - so you can read them off to whoever is connecting without hunting for them elsewhere. The login name itself is fixed; only the password or the accepted keys change.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Device storage available: 7.3 GB
General interface settings
Main screen interface
File browser interface
Remote resources (SMB/(S)FTP/Cloud)
Share over SFTP
SFTP server
Other devices on your network can open the folders you pick
Running at 10.0.2.17:2222
Login: fms, password: UjbCFjTf3m3xeYHK
Shared folders
Pictures
+ Add folder
Port
2222
Password
SSH key
New password



Password sign-in, with the current password shown while the server runs.

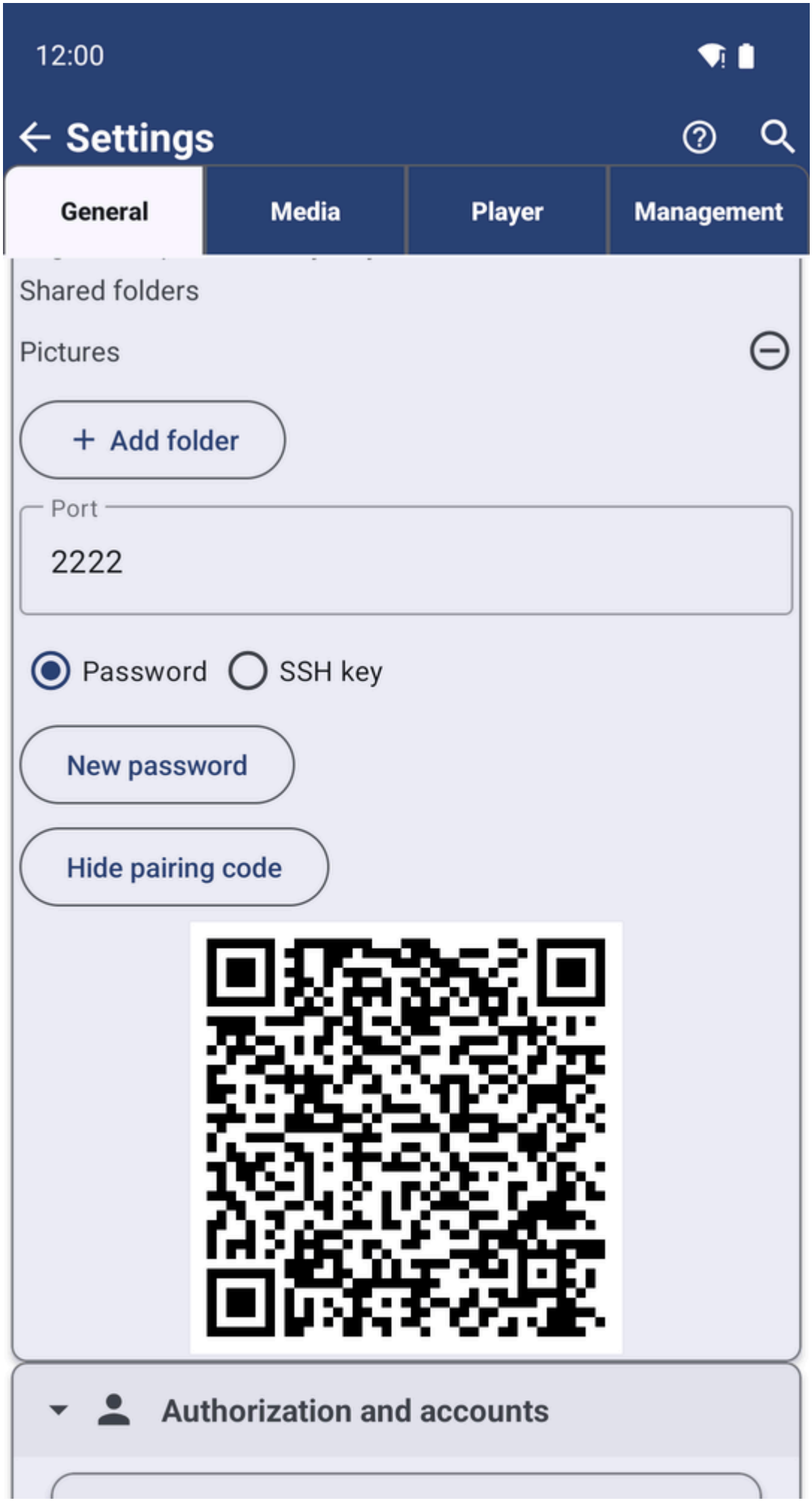
4 Change a setting without losing the connection

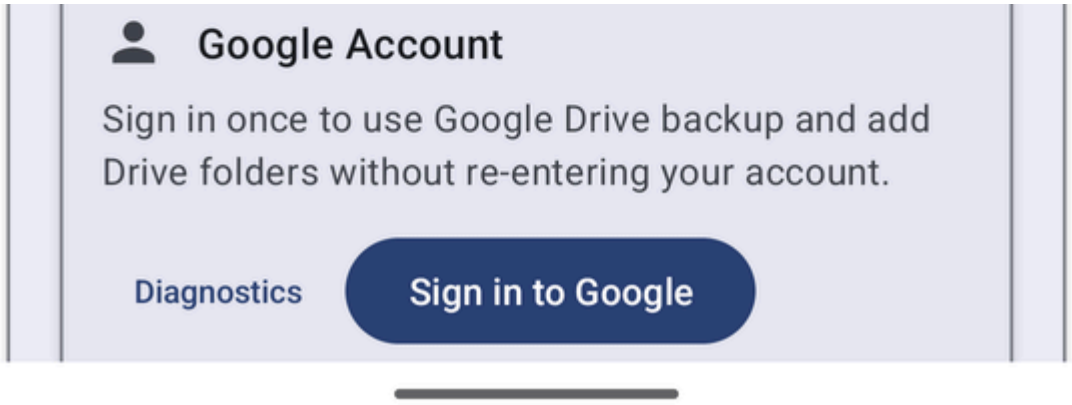
The **Port** field defaults to a free one and can be changed - a port already used by another app is refused, for example "Port 2222 is taken by another app - choose another port", and a value outside the allowed range with "Use a port from 1024 to 65535." Changing the port, the sign-in mode or the keys while the server is already running does not restart it on its own: "Turn the server off and on again to apply the change" - so a client already connected is not dropped by a setting you are still adjusting.

5 Pair another FastMediaSorter with a scan

While the server is running, tap **Show pairing code** to reveal a QR code - "Pairing code: scan it in FastMediaSorter on another device" - and **Hide pairing code** to put it away again. The code is rebuilt fresh every time you show it, so it always carries the server's current address and password.

On the other device, open **Add Resource**, the **SFTP / FTP** card, and tap **Import by barcode** - the same scanner that reads a Windows companion code also recognizes this one. A message confirms the form was filled in: "Connection details filled in from the pairing code - check them and save," with the host, port, username, password or key and the server's host key already in place, suggested as "Device server 192.168.1.42." Review it and save - the host key is pinned from that first scan, so a later attempt from a different machine using the same address is refused rather than silently accepted. A damaged or incomplete code is called out too: "This code is not a complete FastMediaSorter pairing code - show it again on the server phone and rescan."


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Shared folders
Pictures
+ Add folder
Port
2222
Password
SSH key
New password
Hide pairing code
Authorization and accounts



The pairing code, ready to scan from another device.

6 Reach the phone from another network

In the same card, the **Access from anywhere** section can register the phone's server on an exchange server, so devices on any network reach it without a VPN or port forwarding. Switch on **Exchange server** - "Reach this server from any network through your exchange server" - fill in the **Exchange server address**, the **Exchange server port** and the **Exchange server password** (at least 10 characters with upper- and lower-case Latin letters and digits), and tap **Save server**. The status line moves from "Only reachable on the local network" to "Reachable from anywhere through" and the server's name once the exchange server accepts the phone. The section is off by default.

A pairing code shown afterwards carries the exchange server too: a phone that scans it falls back to the relayed connection when no direct address answers, still checking the same host key. **New access link** makes every code shared earlier stop opening this server. No public exchange server is running yet; what works today instead is on the media exchange portal.

Signed in to Google Drive on both devices? Switch on **Share access through Google Drive** in the same card - it is off by default. While the server runs, the phone then keeps its current address and sign-in details in the app's private space of your Drive, so another device on the same Google account opens the paired share at its new address after a network change, without scanning the code again - as long as it can reach the phone at all.

What You Get

The phone shares exactly the folders you picked, with everyone else needing either a password or an accepted SSH key to get in, and pairing another FastMediaSorter takes one scan instead of typing an address by hand. A tap on Stop, in the app or the notification, ends it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Bringing in a PC's folders instead?** Sharing PC folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows covers the same pairing idea from the other side.
- **Setting up a server by typing its address yourself?** Connecting SFTP and FTP servers covers that manual route, on either end of the connection.
- **New to SSH keys?** The OpenSSH ↗ project's own documentation explains how a key pair works if the wording here is unfamiliar.
- **Want to reach your own storage from outside your home?** The media exchange portal walks through the home network way step by step and says what works today.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

NETWORK

Sharing PC Folders with Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

The same idea in reverse - a Windows PC sharing folders to this phone.

NETWORK

Connecting SFTP and FTP Servers

Add an SFTP or FTP server folder by hand, with a password or an SSH key.

STORAGE

Adding Network Folders and Cloud Storage as Sources

The overview of every kind of network and cloud place this app can open.

NETWORK & CLOUD Standard and noLegal RECIPE #08

Checking Your Connection with Network Monitor

Switch on the opt-in Network Monitor, read its summary and its Wi-Fi, Mobile, Bluetooth and Satellites sections with their live charts, ping or trace a single address in Tools, measure one resource's real speed, and carry the same readings to a home-screen widget, a launcher gadget and your watch.

Why You'll Love This

A video keeps stalling, a shared folder takes forever to open, or you just want to know why the bars on your phone look fine while nothing loads. Network Monitor is the app's own diagnostic panel for exactly that moment - your connection, your signal, your addresses and your speed, all in one place, without guessing which of the phone, the Wi-Fi or the server is at fault.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- Standard or noLegal edition . See The seven editions .
- Network Monitor switched on as a program in Settings - see Built-in programs .
- Location permission for the Wi-Fi details and the Satellites section: the app explains what it is for before it asks.

1 Turn Network Monitor on

Network Monitor is off until you switch it on - it is an opt-in program, not something running quietly from the first install. Its own description in Settings reads "Adds a diagnostic program showing the connection, the signal and the network details." Once it is on, it appears in the same places every other program does - the programs menu, the programs panel, the launcher desktop. The full switch-on steps, and where a program shows up afterwards, are in Built-in programs.

2 Read the summary at a glance

Open **Network Monitor** and it lands on its summary screen: **Active connection** at the top - or "Nothing is connected. Turn on Wi-Fi or mobile data to get online." if you are offline - then a row of tiles that each open their own screen with their own live reading: **Wi-Fi**, **Mobile**, **Bluetooth**, **Satellites**, **Internet**, **History**, **Tools** and **Resource Speed**.

Two details on the summary itself are worth knowing. **External IP** stays hidden behind **Tap to find out** until you ask for it - the app has to reach a public service on the internet to learn it, and it says so first: "Your address goes to another service." And the live speed number shown here has a twin: the same reading also sits in the launcher's own status bar as **Transfer speed** - see The status area and notifications.

Network Monitor

Active connection

Wi-Fi - [redacted] - Internet works

Local IP [redacted]

External IP Tap to find out

Speed: ↓ 0 B/s ↑ 0 B/s

Wi-Fi

[redacted] - 650 Mbps

Available

Mobile

Nothing connected right now

Bluetooth

Paired: 2

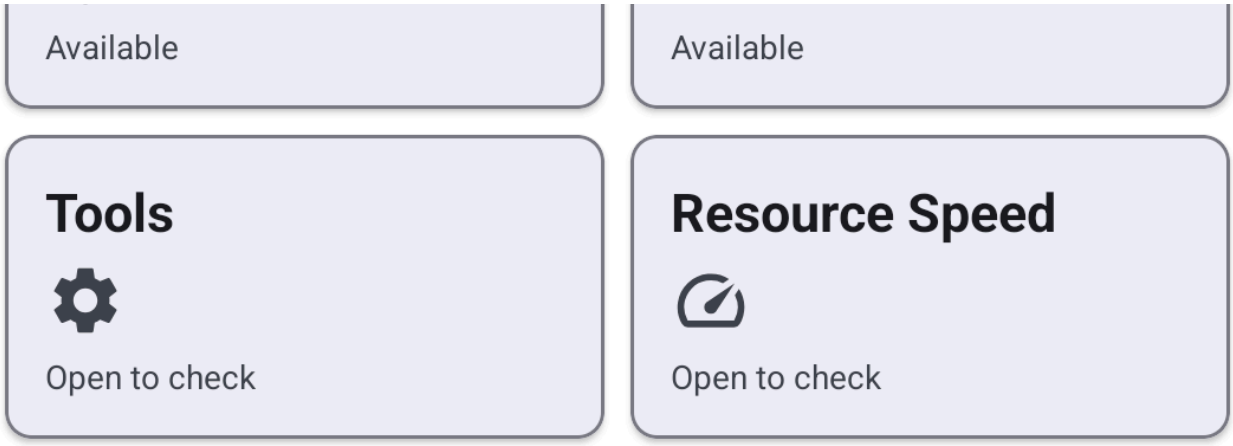
Available

Satellites

Open to check

Internet

History



The summary, with every section one tap away.

3 Wi-Fi and mobile signal, charted live

Wi-Fi lines up **Network**, **Frequency**, **Link speed** and **Wi-Fi standard**, with a **Signal** chart underneath tracking the strength in dBm over time - now, minimum, maximum and whether it is rising, falling or steady. **Mobile** does the same per SIM, and where Android leaves the app no choice it says so plainly: "Android does not let an app switch mobile data or a SIM. Only the system settings can." - with an **Open system network settings** button right there instead of a dead end.

A single bad reading can skew a chart for the rest of the session. Tap the chart itself and it restarts, collecting fresh from that moment: "Chart restarted. Collecting from now."

4 What is connected over Bluetooth right now

Bluetooth separates what is actually connected from what is merely paired: a **Connected now** list on top, naming every profile Android will report - headset, speaker, hearing aid, even a paired watch - and a **Paired, not connected** list below it. Nothing connected shows a plain "Nothing is connected right now" instead of an empty gap.

Pick a connected device with **Chart a connected device** and its own **Device signal** chart starts, restartable the same way as the Wi-Fi and mobile ones above.

5 Satellites, position, and a track that stays put

Satellites lists what is in view and what actually counts toward your position, each one naming its constellation, signal strength and whether it is "counted in position" or "not counted." Below that sits **Position** - latitude, longitude, accuracy, fix time - with its own signal-strength chart while a fix is found.

Record the track on this device turns the section into a simple trail recorder, and it says exactly where the points go: "The track stays on this device and is written only while this screen is open. Nothing is sent anywhere." It never leaves the phone on its own - only **Share the track file**, tapped by you, hands it to whichever app you choose.

6 Ask one address directly - Tools

Tools points the app at a single address instead of the network at large. Under **Host diagnostics**, type an **IP or host name**, then tap **Ping** or **Traceroute** - nothing runs until you tap it. Both write into a scrolling **Console output**: a ping answers back with each hop's time, a traceroute walks the path outward and reports how many hops it took to arrive, or where it stopped answering. **Clear** wipes the console, **Copy** takes it to the clipboard for a support message.

Network Monitor

Tools

Host diagnostics

IP or host name

example.com

example.com ×

Ping | Traceroute

Subnet scan

From

192.168.1.1

To

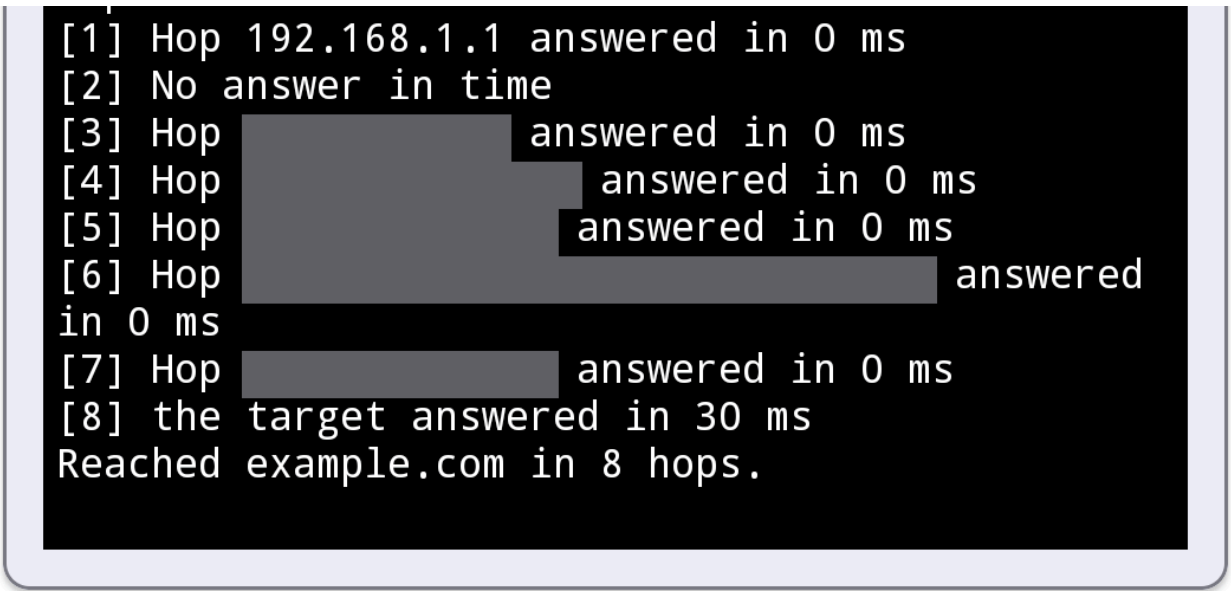
192.168.1.254

Scan the local network

Console output

Copy | Clear

```
--- Traceroute example.com ---
Tracing the route to example.com, up to 30
hops..
```



Ping or trace a single address, on demand.

7 How fast one resource really is

Resource Speed turns the same idea toward one of your own resources rather than the internet in general: pick one under **Target Resource**, run the test, and **Speed Results** reports its read and write throughput - useful for telling a slow shared folder from a slow phone. A resource that only allows reading says so plainly, **(Read-only resource)**, instead of pretending a write test ran.

8 The same readings on your home screen and desktop

You do not have to open the app to see one number. The **Network monitor** widget sits on the Android home screen, resizable, and shows a single reading of your choice; **Choose what to show** offers **Local address**, **Wi-Fi**, **Bluetooth**, **SIM**, **Signal level**, **Live speed**, **External address**, **Last speed test**, **Saved resource**, **Satellites** or **Hotspot state**. Tap it and it opens Network Monitor straight on that reading's own section - see FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen.

The launcher desktop offers the same set as a gadget: place it, pick a reading the same way when you do, and tapping it opens the matching section too - see Desktop gadgets.

9 The same check, on your wrist

With a paired watch in the Standard or noLegal edition, Network Monitor comes along: swipe to **Programs** on the watch app and tap **Network Monitor** for a summary sized for the round screen - the active link, your addresses, and the same sections arranged to fit with far less scrolling than a full-width list would take. The full walk-through and a screenshot of the watch screen are in Wrist programs, timers and tools.

What You Get

A slow load stops being a guess: the summary says at a glance whether you are online at all, Wi-Fi, Mobile, Bluetooth and Satellites each get their own live reading and a restartable chart, Tools and Resource Speed let you point straight at one address or one resource, and the same numbers follow you to the home screen, the launcher desktop and the watch.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A speed test warns before it spends your data.** It moves about 20 MB in total, and on a mobile plan that traffic is billed - the app says so and lets you cancel before it starts, or stops it mid-test at any time.
- **History keeps a record of what you checked.** Past speed tests, resource checks and traceroutes stay in **History** until you tap **Export** to save them or **Clear** to remove them - clearing them cannot be undone.
- **A resource that will not answer says why.** A speed or connection check against a resource that no longer exists or refuses to answer names the reason instead of a bare failure.
- **Not sure Network Monitor is even switched on?** Built-in programs covers every program's switch in one place, including this one.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Adding Network Folders and Cloud Storage as Sources

How a network folder, an FTP/SFTP server or a cloud folder becomes a resource in the first place.

PROGRAMS

Built-in Programs

Where every program's switch lives, and where a switched-on program shows up.

WATCH

Wrist Programs, Timers and Tools

Network Monitor and the rest of the watch's built-in toolbox.

…nd the Player

VIDEO & MEDIA PLAYER | Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #01

All editions except Photos; saving frames and color controls in Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR

Watching Videos - Controls, Gestures and Saving Frames

Play videos full screen or with the command panel, move between them with taps and swipes, zoom in, resume where you stopped, save still frames as pictures and sort your videos while you watch.

Why You'll Love This

Most video players are made for one film on a Friday evening. FastMediaSorter's video player is also made for the other job: a folder with two hundred clips from the phone, a holiday, a dashcam or a security camera, where you want to look at each one for a few seconds, keep the good ones and throw the rest away.

So the player does two things at once. It plays the video with everything you expect - full screen, speed, resume - and it keeps your sorting tools one tap away: next, previous, copy, move, delete.

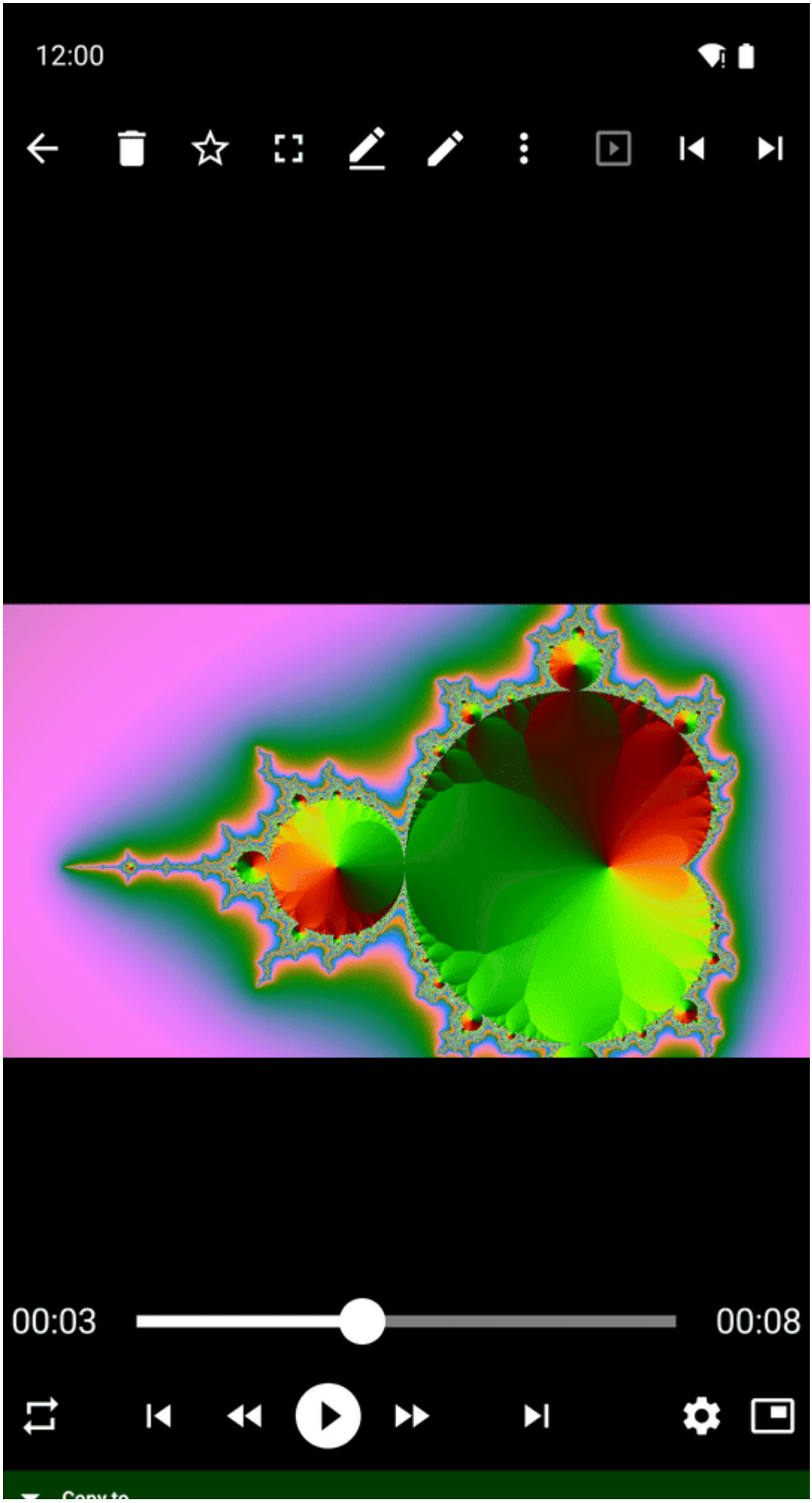
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR or FOSS editi…on. The Photos edition does not play video.
- A resour…ce with videos, for example the All Videos collection, a folder on the phone or a network folder.
- Optional: a T…V box or a car head unit with a remote - everything here works with a D-pad too.

1 Open a video

Tap a video in the file browser. It opens straight into full screen: the picture fills the display and nothing else is in the way. If you prefer to start with the buttons visible, turn off **Open video files in fullscreen mode** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Video and player settings**.

The player handles the usual formats (MP4, MKV, WebM, AVI and more) and also Blu-ray `.m2ts` files copied from a disc. When the phone's own video decoder cannot handle a file, the player quietly tries a second engine, and for VP9 videos it has a software decoder of its own, so fewer files end with an error.


12:00
00:03
00:08

The video player with the command panel.

2 Switch between full screen and the command panel

The player has two faces. In **full screen** only the picture is visible. With the command panel you also see the playback buttons – **Play/Pause**, **Rewind 10 seconds**, **Forward 10 seconds**, **Previous file**, **Next file**, **Control** – and the file buttons such as copy, move and delete.

- To leave full screen, tap the **Exit fullscreen** button that stays in the corner, or swipe the Android system bars back in from the edge.
- To go full screen again, choose **Fullscreen mode** in the three-dots menu.
- Turn the phone sideways and the player goes full screen by itself; turn it back upright and the command panel returns. The video keeps playing.

While a video plays, the top buttons hide together with the bottom playback controls. Tap the picture to bring them back. This works in portrait and landscape, both inside the app and when opening a video from another app. Change the embedded player's delay with **Player panel auto-hide duration (s)** in **Settings**, the **Player** tab – anything from 1 to 600 seconds.

A file another app hands over does not open alone: the player reads the folder it lies in, so next, previous, random and the slideshow carry on through the files next to it.

3 Tap and swipe instead of hunting for buttons

In full screen the picture is divided into nine invisible touch zones, three by three. A tap in each one does something different:

1. top left - back to the file list;
2. top middle - copy the file to a destination;
3. top right - rename;
4. middle left - previous file;
5. centre - pause or play;
6. middle right - next file;
7. bottom left - open the command panel;
8. bottom middle - delete;
9. bottom right - start or stop the slideshow.

Swiping left and right also moves to the next and previous video. To see the grid while you learn it, turn on **Always show touch zones overlay** in **Settings**, the **Player** tab, section **Touch zones and on-screen hints**.

Nine zones too many? Turn on **Disable 9-zone tracking** in the same tab. Then the screen has three zones - previous, zoom, next - and a tap on the left edge opens the command panel for file actions. With the command panel open, the picture always works as three zones: left for previous, right for next.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Touch zones overlay**
Landscape fullscreen video with the 3×3 touch zones overlay visible.

4 Zoom, volume and brightness

Put two fingers on the picture and spread them to zoom in, for example to read a number plate in a dashcam video; pinch them together to zoom out. Zoom ranges from 1× to 5× and works while playing or paused, in both players and orientations. Drag with one finger to move the enlarged picture. Opening another video or changing the player size resets the zoom. The buttons and subtitles keep their normal size.

With a keyboard, use **+** and **−** to zoom and **0** to reset. With a mouse, hold **Ctrl** and turn the wheel.

Volume and brightness sit one tap away: tap **Control**, then **Volume** or **Light**. In portrait the sliders stand upright, so you move them with your thumb from bottom to top.

5 Pick up where you left off

The player remembers how far you watched every video. Open the same video later and it continues from there, with a short message such as "Resumed from 12:40".

It even survives a restart of the phone: with **Resume playback on next launch** turned on (**Settings**, the **Management** tab, section **App behavior and operating rules**; on by default), the app reopens the last video on start, including a video from a network or cloud folder. If that folder is not reachable any more, the app says "Cannot resume playback - resource unavailable or session expired" instead of waiting forever.

6 Speed, repeat and the sound

Tap **Control** to open the Control window: there you set the speed, the volume, the soundtrack, subtitles and colors - all explained in subtitles, audio tracks and 3D. The speed slider includes **0.1×** and **0.3×** for very slow playback.

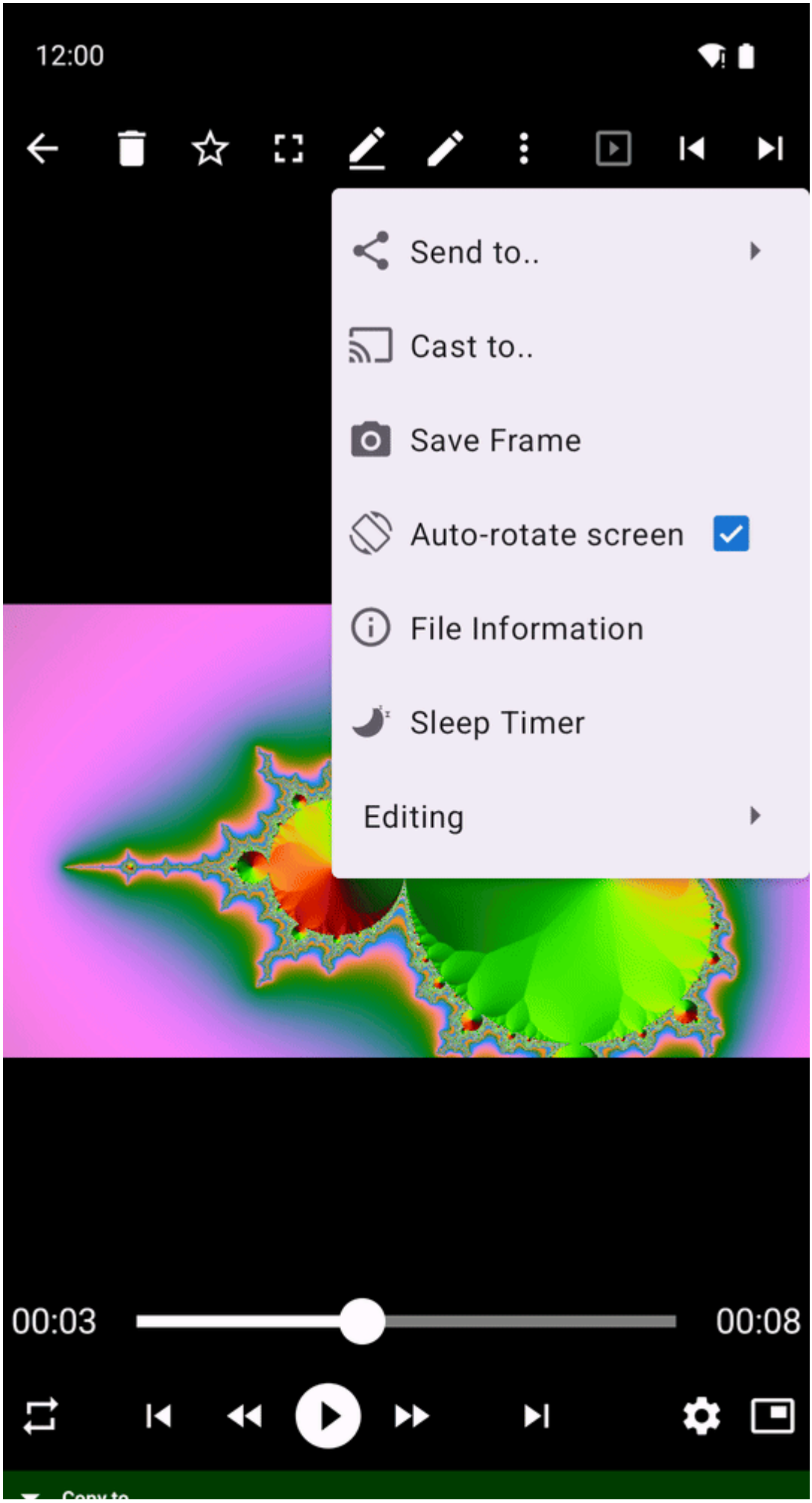
To watch one video over and over, tap the **Playback order** button on the command panel and choose **Repeat one**. The other choices are **Loop list**, **Play through** and **Shuffle**.

7 Save a still frame as a picture

Pause on the moment you like and choose **Save Frame** in the three-dots menu. The frame is saved as a picture named after the moment you saved it, for example `video_frame_260924_203015.jpg` for 24 September 2026 at 20:30:15, and a short message tells you where it went.

Where and how it is saved you choose in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Video and player settings**:

- **Resource for saving frames** - the folder for the pictures. When none is chosen, they go to Downloads.
- **Frame file type:** - **PNG** or **JPG** (the default).
- **Save video frames to clipboard** - also puts each frame on the clipboard, ready to paste into a chat.


12:00
Send to..
Cast to..
Save Frame
Auto-rotate screen
File Information
Sleep Timer
Editing
00:03
00:08

Save Frame turns the paused picture into a photo.

8 Sort your videos while you watch

The **Copy to..** and **Move to..** button groups under the command panel, the touch zones and **Delete** copy, move, rename and delete the video you are watching. A deleted or moved video leaves the list at once, so **Previous file** takes you to the video before it, not to an error. More in moving, copying and deleting files.

Send to.. in the three-dots menu hands the video to another app or person. It works for videos in network and cloud folders too: the app fetches a temporary copy first.

9 Keep the screen the way you want

- **Keep screen on while player is active** (**Settings**, the **Management** tab, section **Operating system interaction**) stops the screen going dark during a film.
- **Rotate player screen with OS auto-rotate** (**Settings**, the **Player** tab) makes the player follow the Android rotation lock; when it is off, the player turns with the phone. On a device without a rotation sensor the option is hidden.
- **Show clock and status while dimmed** shows a large clock, the date and the battery level when the screen is dimmed during playback. The picture shifts a little now and then so it does not burn into the screen; tap once to bring it back after it fades. You find the switch in the **Screens and wallpaper** window - see wallpapers and live backgrounds.

10 Videos opened from other apps

When you open a video from a messenger, a file manager or a download, Android can let FastMediaSorter play it in a separate, simpler player window (not in the Lite edition). It keeps the picture and the sound through a screen rotation, keeps your pause when you switch apps and come back, and continues where it was when the file is renamed.

The same simple window opens pictures, music, documents and text from other apps. Its **Copy to** and **Move to** buttons file the item straight into one of your destinations; copying keeps the window open, moving closes it. For pictures it can also **Print**. **Open in FastMediaSorter** switches to the full app. To make FastMediaSorter the default player, see first launch and setup.

What You Get

You can watch a whole folder of videos without reaching for tiny buttons: tap or swipe to move on, zoom into the details, save the best moments as pictures, and file each video away as you go - and the player remembers where you stopped.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The controls are there when you open a video.** The player shows its buttons as soon as a video opens, and a tap in the middle of the picture brings them back after they hide.
- **Using a TV box or a car screen?** Every button can be reached with the arrow keys of a remote. See keyboard, D-pad and TV control.
- **Video from a network folder stutters?** The player keeps a buffer suited to each kind of connection, and if playback stalls it notices and restarts the stream on its own. A slow Wi-Fi is the usual cause - see offline caching for remote files.
- **Network folder switched off?** When a type of network connection is disabled in the settings, the player tells you so instead of trying to connect.
- **Screen reader users:** the player does not flood TalkBack with announcements during playback.
- **Want a book read aloud? Read Aloud** in the document viewer stops when you leave it - see viewing PDF and EPUB documents.
- **Watching on a headset?** A VR badge in this same controls row opens stereo and 360° videos in the immersive player - see spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback and the controls once you are inside.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VIDEO

Subtitles, audio tracks and 3D

Soundtrack language, subtitles, balance and speed.

VIDEO

Picture-in-picture and background play

Keep watching in a small window.

VIDEO

Chromecast casting and live broadcast

Play the video on your TV.

VIDEO & MEDIA PLAYER | Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #02

All editions except Photos; the 3D choice in the Control window only in VR and noLegal

Subtitles, Audio Tracks, Sound Balance and 3D

Pick the soundtrack and subtitles of a film, make them readable, balance the sound between your ears, change speed and colors, and watch 3D films on an ordinary screen.

Why You'll Love This

A film downloaded from the internet often carries several soundtracks - the original language, a dubbed one, a commentary - and several sets of subtitles. The phone does not know which one you want. This recipe shows where to pick them, how streams pick your language by themselves, and a few extras that live in the same window: loudness, the balance between the ears, the playback speed, colors and 3D.

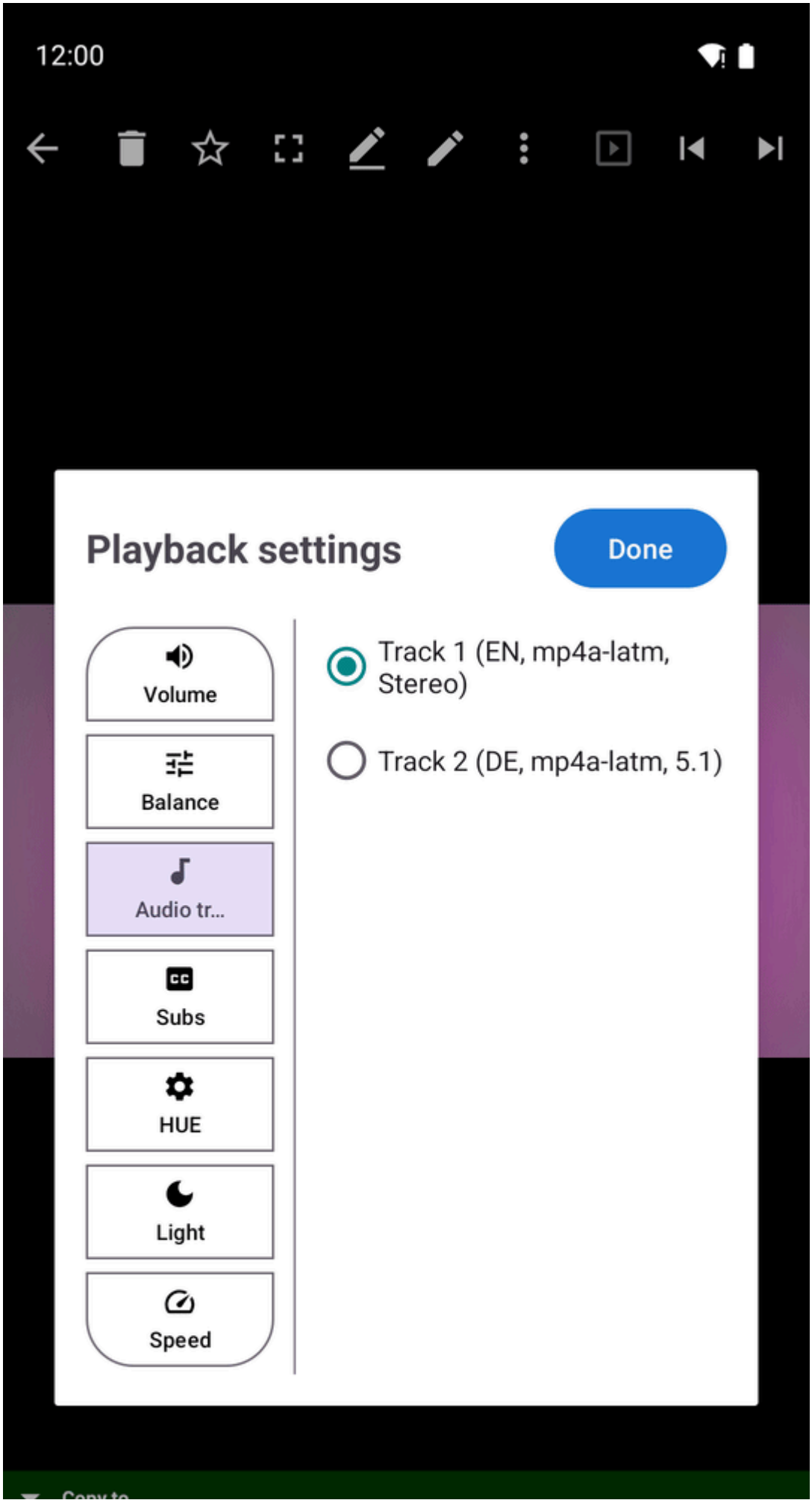
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

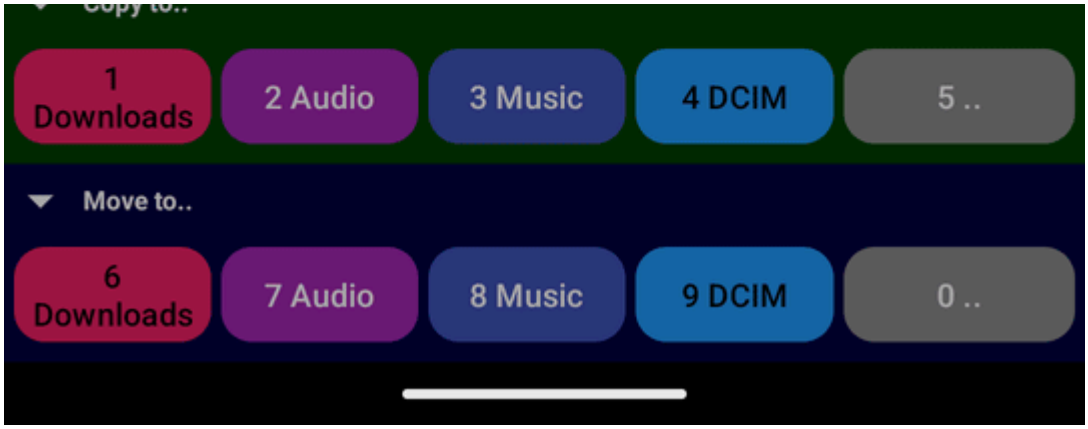
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR or FOSS editi on. The Photos edition does not play video.
- A video with more than one soundtrack or with subtitles - for example an MKV film.
- Color controls (HUE and Light) are in Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR.

1 Open the Control window

Start a video in the video player and tap **Control** on the command panel. A compact window opens over the video. Its sections are listed along the side in portrait and along the top in landscape: **Speed**, **Volume**, **Audio track**, **Subs**, **Balance**, **HUE**, **Light** and, in some editions, **3D**.

The window shows only what makes sense for this video. A file with one soundtrack has no **Audio track** section, a file without subtitles has no **Subs**. For internet streams the color sections disappear, and for live broadcasts the speed does too, because a live picture cannot be sped up. Tap **Done** to close the window; **Reset** returns the section you are in to normal.


12:00
Playback settings
Done
Volume
Balance
Audio tr...
Subs
HUE
Light
Speed
Track 1 (EN, mp4a-latm, Stereo)
Track 2 (DE, mp4a-latm, 5.1)



The Control window collects everything about sound and picture.

2 Switch the language of the soundtrack

Open **Audio track**. Every soundtrack is listed with its language, its format and the number of channels, for example "English, AC3, 5.1". Tap the one you want; the sound switches at once without restarting the film.

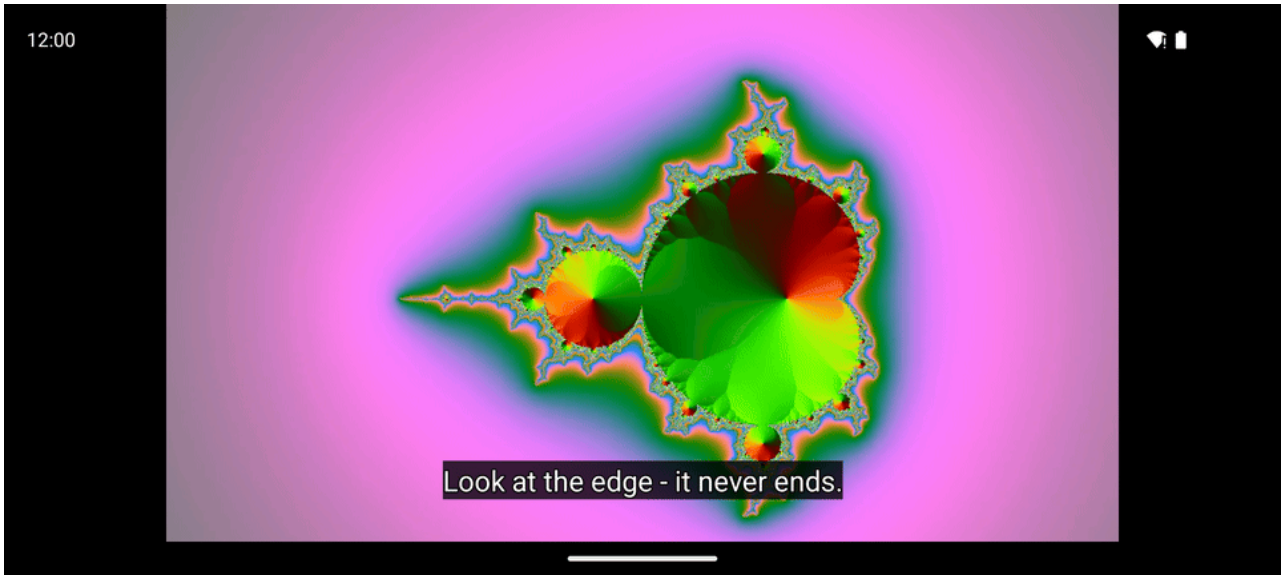
Some formats cannot be played by every phone. Such tracks are marked in the list. If none of the soundtracks can be played, the film plays without sound and the app says so once - "Audio format not supported - playing without sound" - so you know the file is fine and it is the phone that cannot decode that sound. For Blu-ray files the message also names the formats it found.

For streams the app can pick your language by itself: set **Audio language for streams** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Streams**. When a stream offers a soundtrack in that language, the player chooses it, and a track you pick for one channel is remembered for that channel.

3 Turn subtitles on and make them readable

Open **Subs** and pick a language, or **Off** to hide them. If the file has none, the section says "No subtitles available".

Subtitles share their lettering with the text the app recognizes in pictures. To make them bigger or change the typeface, go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Translation, digitization (OCR)**, and set **OCR Font Size** (from **Minimum** to **Huge**) and **OCR Font Family** (for example **Default**, **Serif** or **Monospace**). The player applies them to every video, whether it plays full screen or with the command panel. Both settings stay available even when OCR is off or your device cannot run it.



Subtitles at a comfortable size.

4 Loudness and the balance between the ears

Volume sets how loud this player is, separately from the phone volume: **Mute**, **50%** or **MAX**, or anything in between with the slider.

Balance moves the sound between the left and right ear: **50/50** is even, **30/70** favors the right, **70/30** the left. It helps with one weak earbud or a hearing difference, and it applies everywhere the app plays sound - videos, music and background listening. A file with a single sound channel (mono) plays normally; there is nothing to balance, and the section says "Mono audio - no channels to balance".

5 Speed and colors

Speed has quick buttons **0.5×**, **1.5×** and **2×**, and a slider from 0.1× to 3×, including 0.3×. The player remembers the last speed and uses it for the next video.

HUE turns all the colors of the picture around the color wheel, **Light** makes the picture brighter or darker. Both change only what you see, never the file, and the player remembers them for next time.

6 Watch 3D films on an ordinary screen

A 3D film stores two pictures, one for each eye, side by side (SBS) or one above the other (OU). On a normal screen that looks like a double image. FastMediaSorter recognizes such films: when the file itself says it is 3D, the player trusts that label; otherwise it guesses from the shape of the picture, and ordinary widescreen films are not mistaken for 3D.

With **Show 3D content from one eye** turned on (**Settings**, the **Player** tab; on by default) a 3D film shows the picture of one eye, filling the screen.

In the VR and noLegal editions, with 3D and VR switched on in the settings, the Control window has a **3D** section where you can choose the format yourself: **Auto-detect**, **Side-by-Side (SBS)**, **Over-Under (OU)** or **Mono (Disabled)**, plus the 360° and 180° formats. For the full headset experience see spatial 3D and 360 cinema.

What You Get

The film plays in your language with subtitles you can read from the sofa, the sound sits where your ears want it, and 3D films look right on the phone.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Want the stream's language instead?** Streams have their own **Audio language for streams** and **Subtitle language for streams** - see live streams.
- **Silence with a film that plays on a computer?** The film probably carries only soundtracks your phone cannot decode, often DTS-HD or TrueHD. A converted copy with AAC sound will play.
- **Speed buttons missing?** You are watching a live stream. Recorded videos always have them.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VIDEO

Watching videos - controls and gestures

Fullscreen, touch zones, resume and saving frames.

VIDEO

Chromecast casting and live broadcast

Play the film on your TV.

VR

Spatial 3D and 360 cinema

Watch 3D and 360 video in a headset.

VIDEO & MEDIA PLAYER | Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #03

All editions except Photos; background listening not in Lite; watch controls in Standard and noLegal

Picture-in-Picture and Background Play

Keep a video going in a small floating window, choose what happens to the sound when you leave the player, and decide how the phone player and your watch work together.

Why You'll Love This

A message arrives in the middle of a film. You want to answer it without losing your place, and ideally without stopping the picture. Picture-in-picture shrinks the video into a small window that floats over everything else, so you can reply, check a map or look up the actor and keep watching.

The same page explains what happens to the sound when you leave the player, and how FastMediaSorter shares the stage with other apps that want to play sound.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition that plays video: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR or FOSS.
- For picture-in-picture: Android 12 or newer, and a phone or tablet whose maker allows floating windows.
- For the watch step: a Wear OS watch paired with the phone, and the Standard or noLegal edition.

1 Switch picture-in-picture on

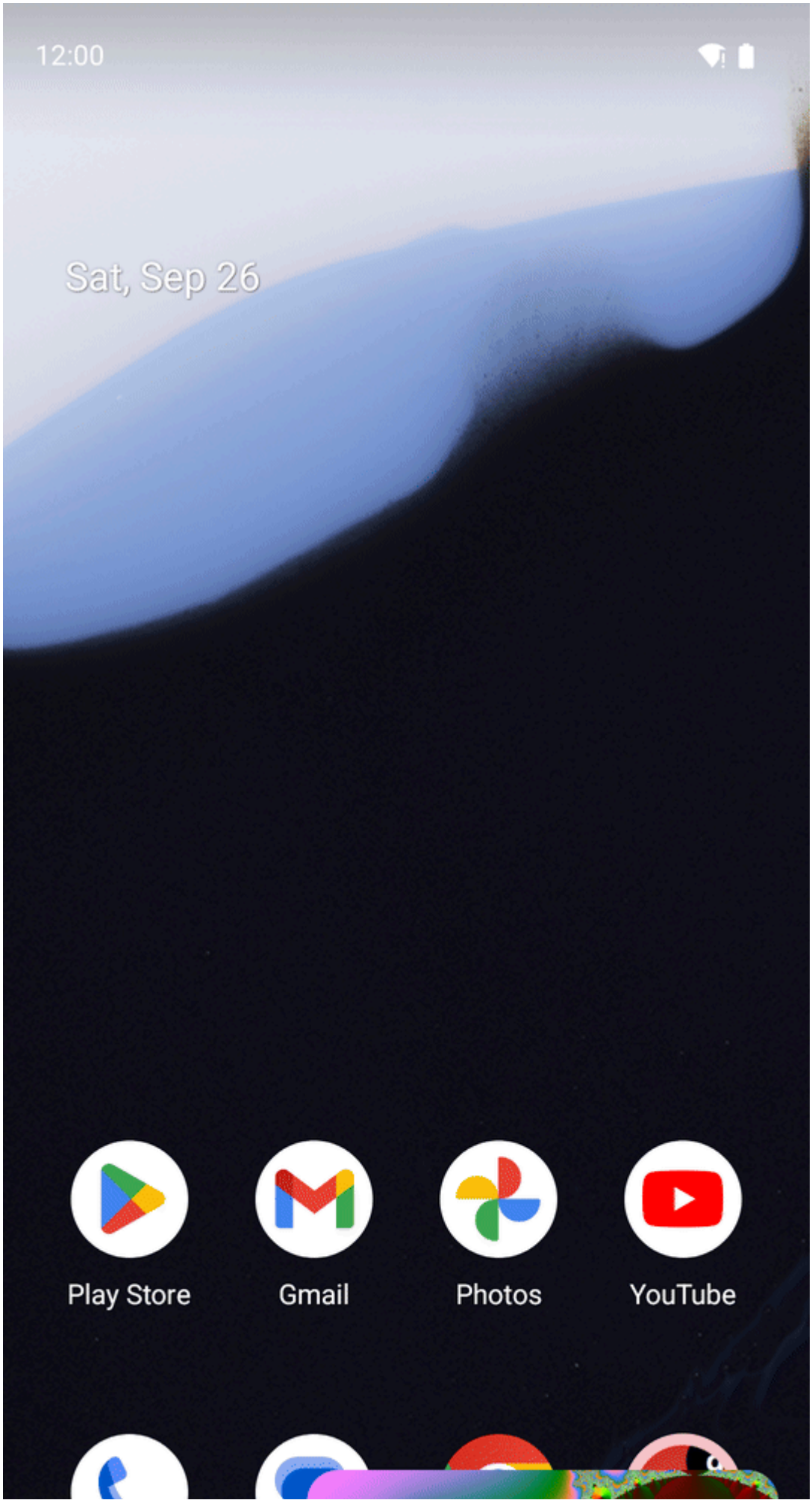
Go to **Settings**, the **Player** tab, section **Player interface and commands**, and turn on **Enable Picture-in-Picture**. From now on the video player shows a **Picture in Picture** button, and pressing the Home button during a video moves it into the floating window by itself.

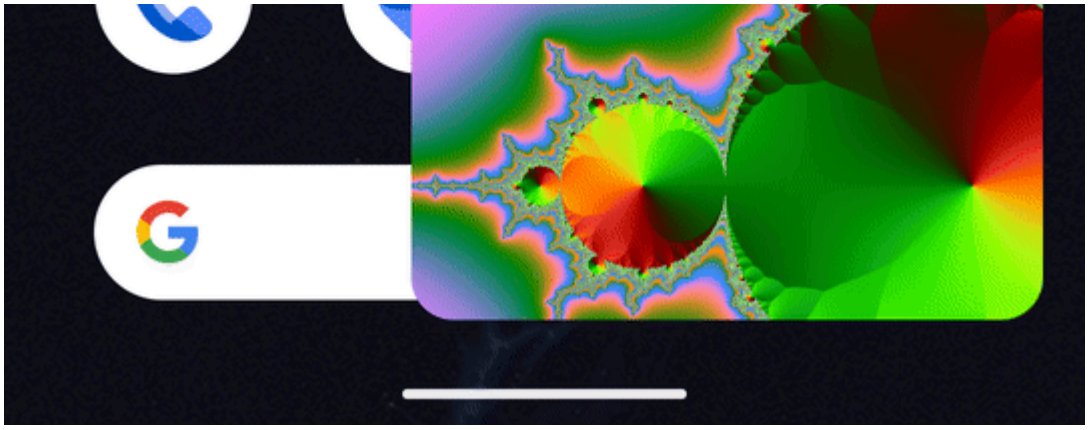
2 Keep watching in a small window

While a video plays, tap the **Picture in Picture** button or simply press Home. The video shrinks into a small window in the corner of the screen. You can:

- drag the window to another corner;
- tap it once to see **Play** and **Pause**;
- tap the expand icon in the window to return to the full player - the buttons and panels come back exactly as you left them.

  Picture-in-picture works for videos opened from your resources, for streams opened from the launcher home screen, and for videos another app asked FastMediaSorter to play. If your phone refuses a floating window here, the app says "Picture-in-picture is not available here" instead of doing nothing.


12:00
Sat, Sep 26
Play Store
Gmail
Photos
YouTube



The video keeps playing in a small window while you use other apps.

3 Decide what happens to the sound when you leave

Leave the player with the Back button while a video or a track plays, and the app asks whether to keep the sound going or stop it. To answer once and for all, go to **Settings**, the **Player** tab, section **Background audio playback**:

- **Background Playback** keeps the sound playing when you leave the app or lock the screen.
- **When leaving player or streams** offers **Ask every time (default)**, **Always stop** and **Always keep playing**.
  The details, and the controls in the notification and the Now Playing bar, are in playback order, sleep timer and listening in the background. The Lite edition stops the sound when you leave the player.

4 Share the sound with other apps

FastMediaSorter behaves politely when another app needs the speaker. A navigation voice or a short notification makes it quieter for a moment; a phone call or another music app pauses it. This applies everywhere the app plays sound: the player, music during a slideshow, sounds in the file browser and streams. It also keeps playing when you use two apps side by side in split screen and close the other one - see split-screen and foldable devices.

5 The phone player and your watch

When the phone plays a video or music, Wear OS normally shows its own media-control screen on the watch. If you would rather keep your watch face, go to **Settings**, the **Management** tab, section **Wear Companion**, and turn on **Suppress media control on watch**.

The watch app also has its own player for files on the watch and on the phone:

- The controls fit the round screen and scroll into view, so none of them is cut off. **Favorite** and the screen-off button share the second row.
- Turning the bezel moves through the current track; in the audio player it changes the volume with a short readout on screen, and a position bar you can drag shows where you are.
- Shuffle is remembered after the watch restarts.
- The screen-off button blanks the display while the sound keeps playing.
- A track without its own cover shows a picture downloaded from the internet when **Album art** is on in the watch settings, otherwise the app's waves-and-particles background. The play button takes the color of the media type.

More in music on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch player controls**
Wear round screen, media player with playback row and secondary row visible.

What You Get

Your video keeps going in a small window while you do something else, the sound behaves the way you chose when you leave the player, other apps get a quiet moment when they need it, and your watch shows either its own player or nothing at all - your choice.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **No Picture in Picture button?** Check **Enable Picture-in-Picture** in Settings, Player. On Android 11 and older the button does not appear.
- **Opened a video from another app?** Picture-in-picture works there too, and the small window shows the video itself, not a black box.
- **Want a clock on a dimmed screen while music plays?** See the dim-screen clock in watching videos - controls and gestures.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VIDEO

Watching videos - controls and gestures

Fullscreen, touch zones, speed and frames.

AUDIO

Playback order, sleep timer and background listening

Notification controls and the Now Playing bar.

WATCH

Music on the watch

Play and control music from your Wear OS watch.

VIDEO & MEDIA PLAYER | Standard, noLegal, Lite and Legacy | RECIPE #04

Chromecast - Standard, noLegal, Lite and Legacy; Live Broadcast - Standard, noLegal and Legacy

Chromecast Casting and Live Broadcast

Send the video you are watching to a TV with Chromecast, or turn your phone into a small live sound or camera station that others open with a QR code.

Why You'll Love This

A phone screen is great in your hand and small for a room full of people. This recipe covers the two ways FastMediaSorter sends what is on your phone somewhere else.

Chromecast plays the video you are watching on a TV. The phone becomes the remote control. **Live Broadcast** goes the other way round: your phone's microphone, or its camera and microphone, become a live channel that other people open on their own devices - a baby monitor, a talk in the next room, a view of the garden.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- Chromecast: FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Lite or Legacy edition, and a Chromecast or a TV with Chromecast built in on the same Wi-Fi network as the phone.
- Live Broadcast: the Standard, noLegal or Legacy edition. The phone and the people who watch must be on the same Wi-Fi network.
- Live Broadcast asks for access to the microphone, to the camera when you send a picture, and to notifications so the broadcast keeps running while the screen is off. See understanding app permissions.

1 Play a video on your TV with Chromecast

Open a video in the video player. Open the three-dots menu and tap **Cast to…**. Pick your TV from the list. The video starts on the TV, and the phone keeps the play, pause and position controls.

The phone does not need the internet for this: it hands the file to the Chromecast itself over your home Wi-Fi. That is why videos from your network folders and cloud folders can be cast too.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Chromecast device list**
Video player with the Cast to device chooser open, one Chromecast listed.

3D films on a normal TV

A side-by-side 3D film looks like two pictures next to each other on an ordinary TV. With **Show 3D content from one eye** turned on (**Settings**, the **Player** tab), the app sends only one eye's picture, the same one the phone shows. It prepares that picture before casting starts, so playback begins after a short wait. Very long films and live streams are cast whole. More about 3D in subtitles, audio tracks and 3D.

2 Open Live Broadcast

First switch the feature on: **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Broadcast**, turn on **Enable live broadcasting**. It also adds the shortcuts below.

Then open **Live Broadcast** in any of these ways:

- from the programs panel;
- from the **Live Broadcast** tile in the Android Quick Settings panel;
- from the **Live Broadcast** widget on your home screen;
- by touching and holding the app icon and choosing the **Broadcast** shortcut.

3 Choose what to send and which camera

The live broadcast screen opens with a live picture from the camera, so you can see what each lens shows before anything goes out. Under **Broadcast mode** choose:

1. **Audio only** - sound from the microphone, like a small radio station.
2. **Camera + audio** - picture and sound.
3. **Camera only** - picture without sound.

Under **Camera** pick **Back**, **Front** or **External**. The app remembers your lens for next time; if that camera is gone, it takes the default one. Tap **Start broadcast** when you are ready.

Broadcast Control

Broadcast mode

Audio only | ✓ Camera + audio | Camera only

Camera

✓ Back 1x | Front 1 | Front 2

Enable live broadcasting

Allow live audio stream broadcasting and show shortcuts

Broadcast title

Phone Broadcast

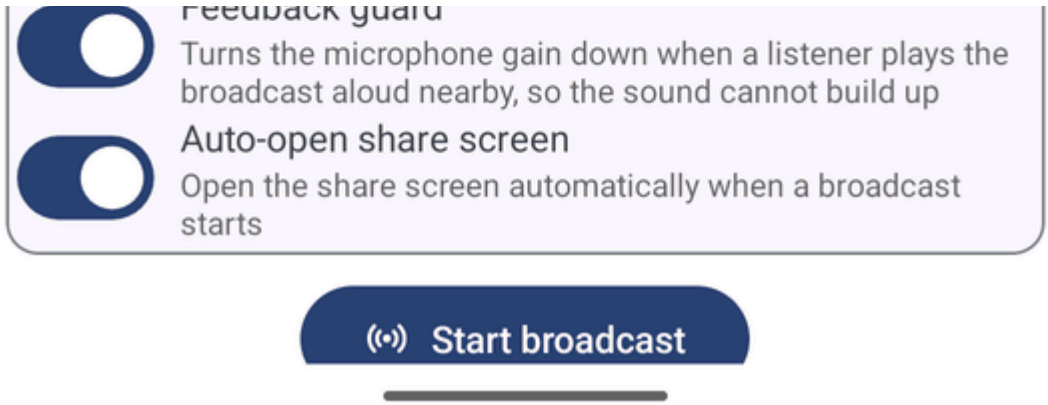
sdk_gphone64_x86_64

Bit rate 128 kbit/s >

Port 8768

Audio format 44.1 kHz / Mono >

Microphone gain 100% >



Choose the mode and the camera while you watch the preview.

4 Invite people to watch or listen

As soon as the broadcast starts, the share panel shows a QR code and three buttons:

- **Copy Link** - copies the address to paste into a message.
- **Export File** - saves a small file that describes the broadcast.
- **Send to** - sends the link through any messenger or mail app.

Another phone with FastMediaSorter scans the QR code to add the broadcast as a channel - see live streams. **Send to watch** sends it to your paired watch. The **How to watch this** link opens a page that explains to the other person, in their language, how to open the broadcast on an Android phone, a Wear OS watch or a Windows computer.

The broadcast is published under your phone's name, so listeners know whose it is. You can change it in the broadcast settings with **Broadcast title**.

Broadcast Control

0 listeners

Broadcast mode

Audio only | ✓ Camera + audio | Camera only

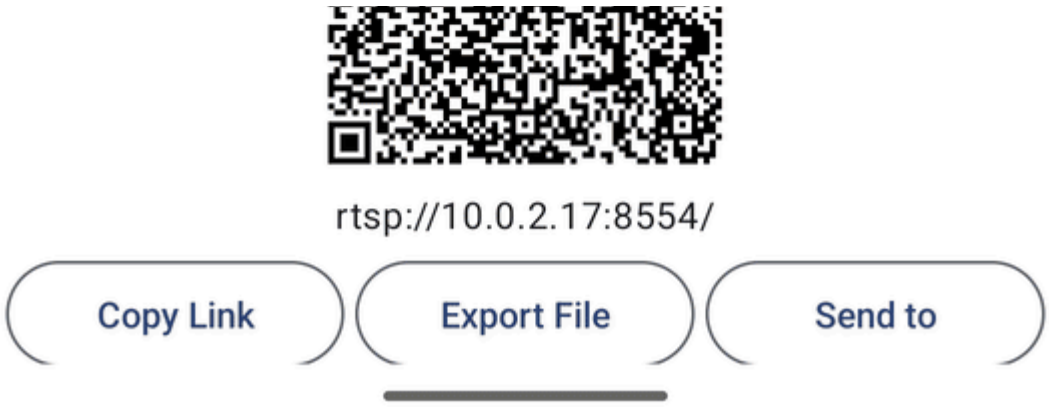
Camera

✓ Back 1x | Front 1 | Front 2

Camera ON | Microphone ON

Switch Camera | Blank screen

■ Stop Broadcast



Share the broadcast with a QR code or a link.

5 While you are live

The screen shows how many listeners are connected. Someone who joins a video broadcast halfway through sees the picture at once, without waiting for the image to build up. The buttons switch the camera and the microphone on and off, change the camera, turn the screen off or cover it with a black screen while the broadcast keeps running, and **Stop Broadcast** ends it. The broadcast also keeps its own notification with a **Stop** button.

The settings button on the same screen opens the broadcast settings in place: title, port, bit rate, audio format, microphone gain and **Auto-open share screen**. The same settings are in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Broadcast**, and a settings backup keeps them - see backing up and restoring settings.

6 When the sound starts to howl

If someone listens to the broadcast out loud in the same room, their speaker can feed back into your microphone and the sound grows into a howl. FastMediaSorter notices this and turns the microphone down until the howl stops, then slowly gives the volume back. While it holds the sound down, the screen says: "Sound turned down: a listener's speaker is feeding back into the microphone. Move the listening device away or lower its volume." So a quieter broadcast does not mean the microphone is broken.

This protection is called **Feedback guard**. It is on by default; you can turn it off in the broadcast settings.

What You Get

Your video plays on the big TV with the phone as a remote, or your phone sends a live sound or camera picture that family and friends open on their phones, watches or computers with one scan of a QR code.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Chromecast not in the list?** The phone and the TV must be on the same Wi-Fi network. Guest networks often keep devices apart.
- **Nobody can connect to the broadcast?** Check that everyone is on the same Wi-Fi. Some routers block devices from talking to each other - look for an option called client or AP isolation.
- **Music on a Chromecast** works the same way from the audio player - see playing and organizing music files.
- **Want to record the screen instead?** See recording the screen with audio.
- **Want a phone or a watch to go on air for your other devices?** The media exchange portal explains the routes between devices and marks what is not available yet.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VIDEO

Watching videos - controls and gestures

Everything about the video player itself.

STREAMS

Playing live streams

Open the broadcast of another phone as a channel.

VIDEO

Picture-in-picture and background play

Keep watching in a small window.

, Audio and Slideshows

IMAGES, AUDIO & SLIDESHOW | Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #04

Playing and Organizing Music Files

Play music straight from the folders where it lives - on the phone, a memory card or another computer. The audio player finds missing covers, shows lyrics, casts to a Chromecast and lets you sort tracks while you listen.

Why You'll Love This

Your music does not live in one neat library. Some albums are on the phone, some on a memory card, some on the computer in the next room. FastMediaSorter plays music straight from the folders where it already is - no importing, no library to build - and lets you sort a messy download folder while you listen.

The same audio player finds missing album covers, shows song lyrics, and fills the screen with a calm animation when a track has no picture.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

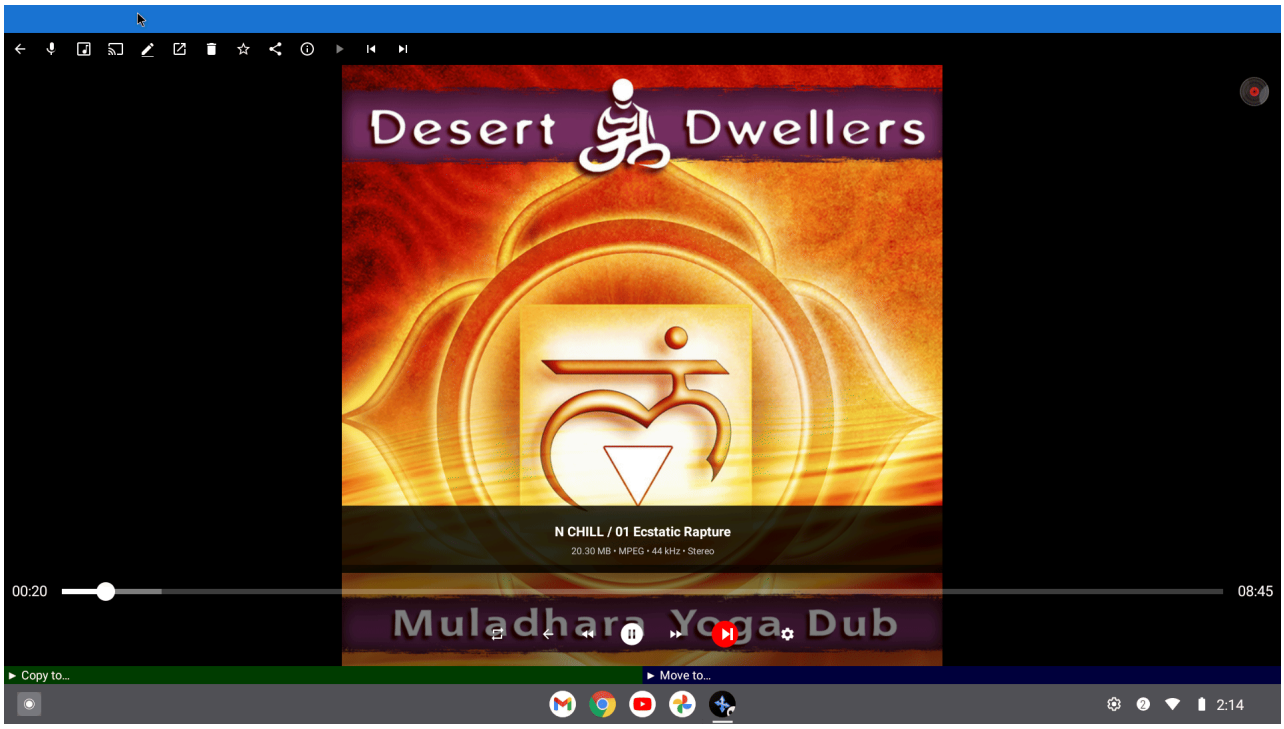
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR or FOSS editi on. The Photos edition does not play audio.
- Music files in any common format: MP3, FLAC, AAC, M4A, OGG, Opus, WMA, WAV, ALAC and more. MIDI files (MID, MIDI) play too.
- A resou rce that holds your music - for example the ready-made All Musi c collection, a folder on this device, or a network folder.
- For covers and lyrics from the internet: an internet connection.
- For Chromecast: a Chromecast on the same Wi-Fi network, and any edition except VR and FOSS.

1 Open a track

Open a resource with music on the main screen and tap a track in the file browser. The audio player opens and starts playing.

The screen shows the album cover, the track name and details such as size, format and sample rate, a progress bar you can drag, and the playback buttons. A small spinning vinyl record in the corner tells you at a glance that music is playing; it stops when you pause.

When the track ends, the player moves on to the next audio file of the same folder. Swipe left or right, or use the next and previous buttons, to skip.

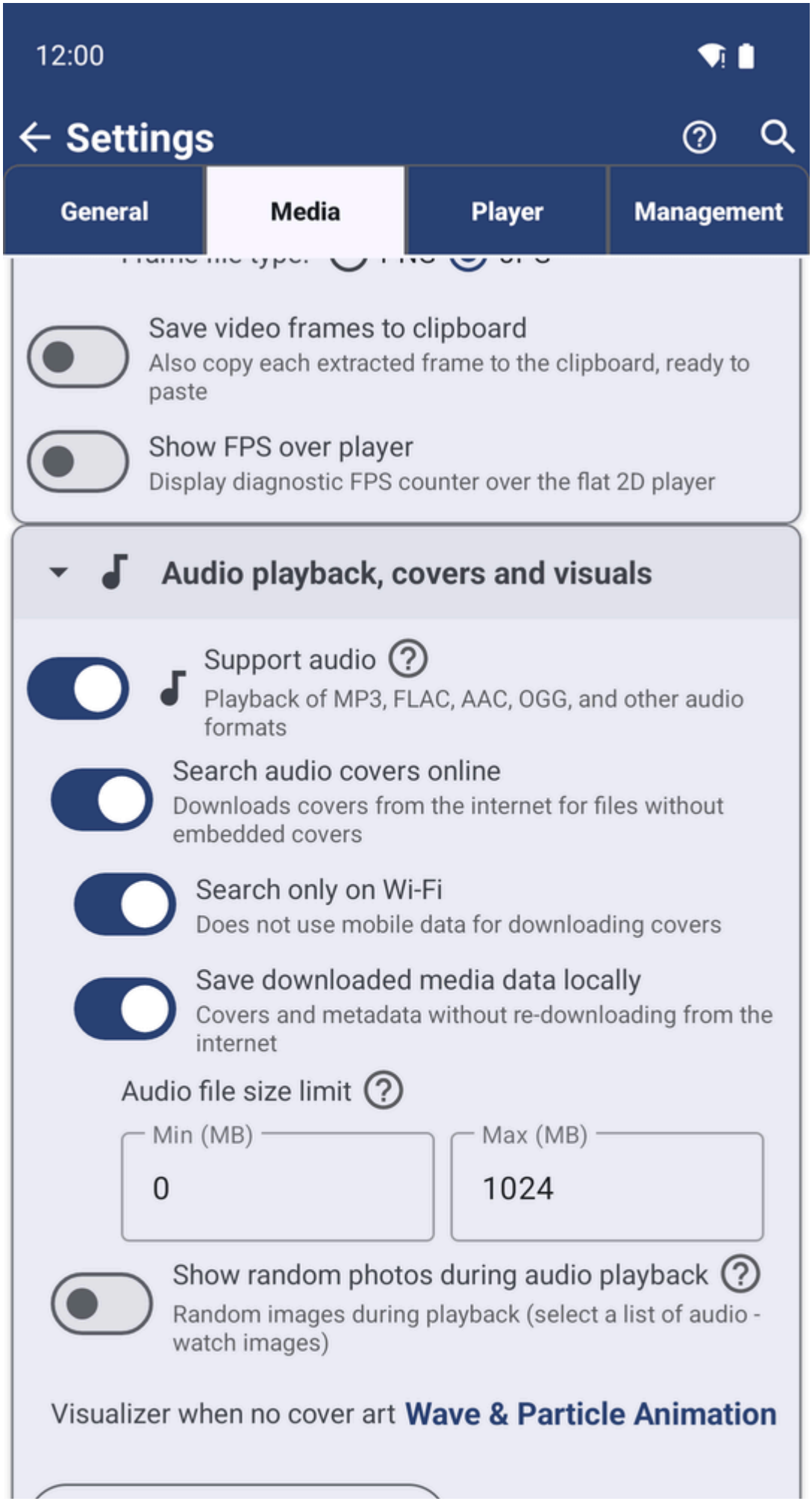


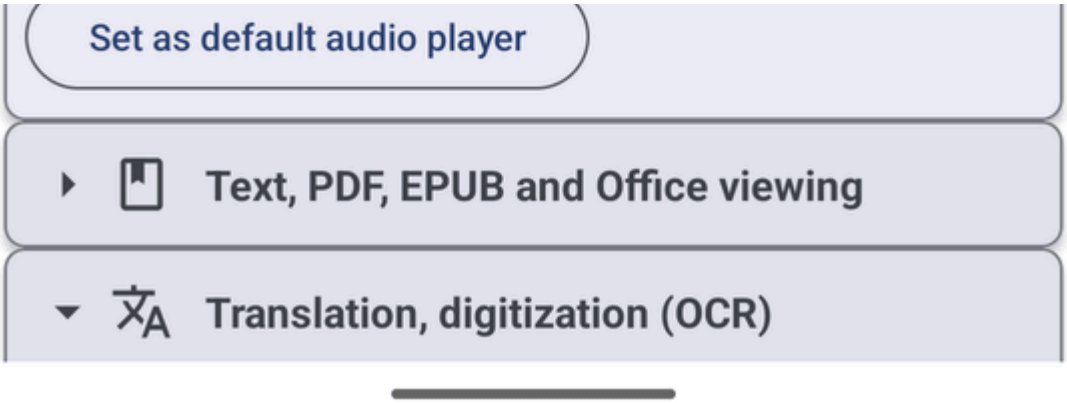
The audio player with an album cover and the spinning vinyl record in the corner.

2 Get missing album covers from the internet

Most music files carry their own cover picture, and the player shows it right away. For files without one, the app can look the cover up online. Go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Audio playback, covers and visuals**, and turn on **Search audio covers online**. It is off until you turn it on.

The app then asks three free music catalogs in turn - iTunes, Deezer and the Cover Art Archive - and shows the first good cover it finds. Two more switches appear below: **Search only on Wi-Fi** (on by default, so no mobile data is used) and **Save downloaded media data locally** (on by default, so each cover is fetched only once).


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Save video frames to clipboard
Also copy each extracted frame to the clipboard, ready to paste
Show FPS over player
Display diagnostic FPS counter over the flat 2D player
Audio playback, covers and visuals
Support audio
Playback of MP3, FLAC, AAC, OGG, and other audio formats
Search audio covers online
Downloads covers from the internet for files without embedded covers
Search only on Wi-Fi
Does not use mobile data for downloading covers
Save downloaded media data locally
Covers and metadata without re-downloading from the internet
Audio file size limit
Min (MB)
0
Max (MB)
1024
Show random photos during audio playback
Random images during playback (select a list of audio - watch images)
Visualizer when no cover art Wave & Particle Animation



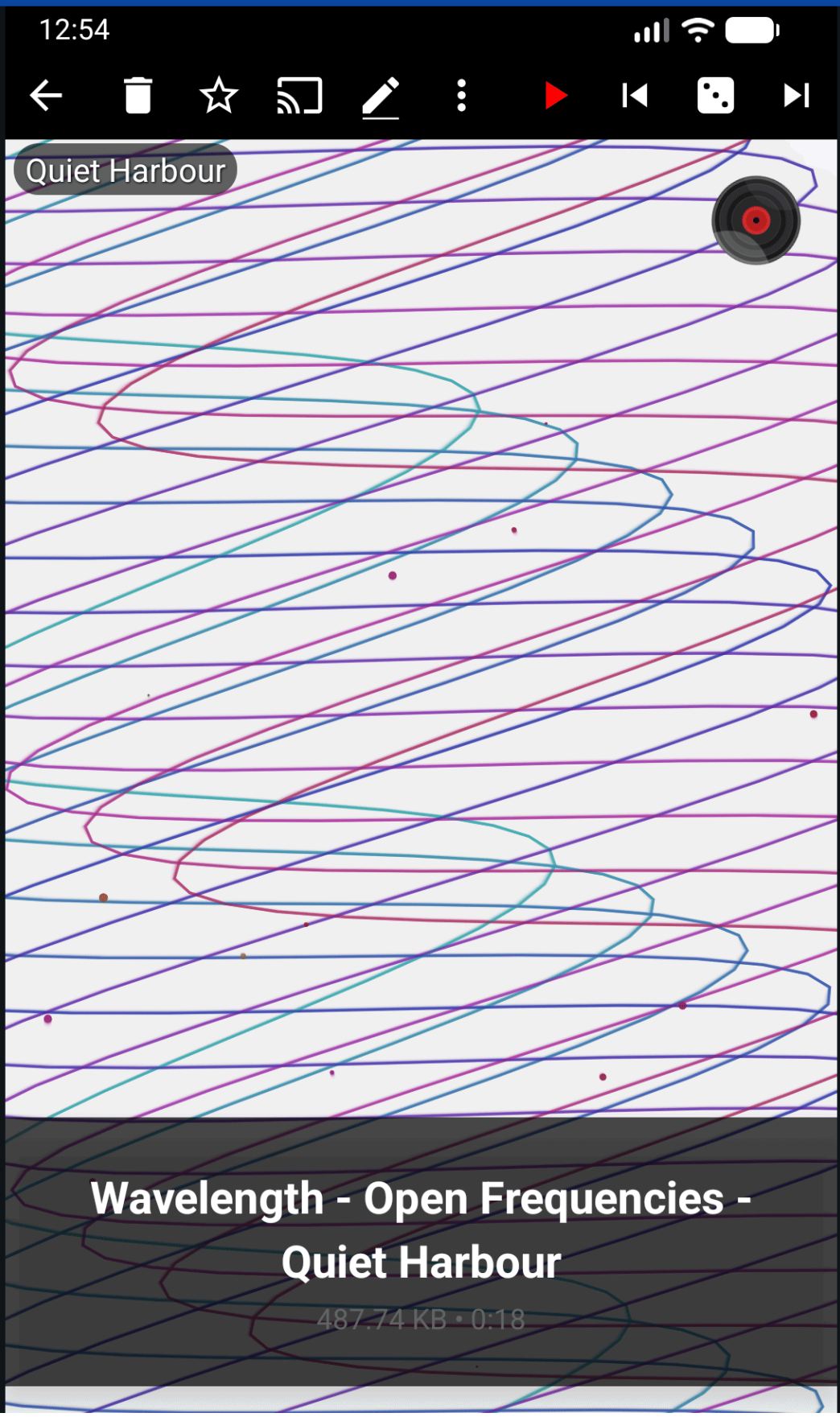
Online cover search in Settings.

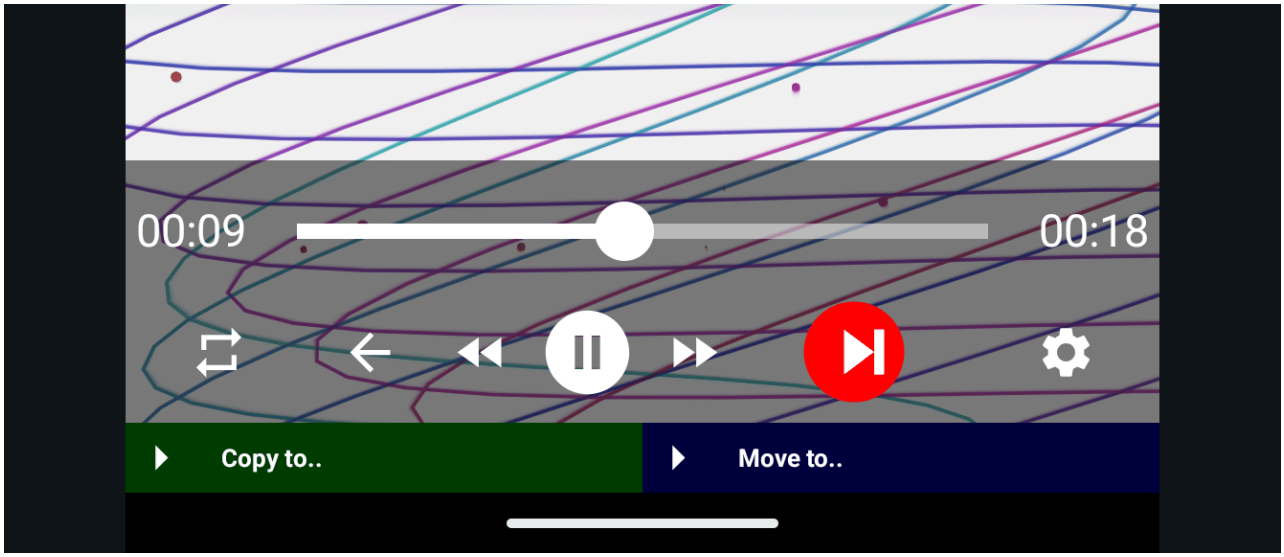
3 Pick a background for tracks without a cover

When no cover can be found, the screen does not have to stay empty. In the same settings section tap **Visualizer when no cover art** and choose one:

- **Black background** - nothing moves.
- **Music note + pulse rings** - a music note with rings pulsing around it.
- **Breathing bars (15)** - soft colored bars rising and falling like an equalizer.
- **Wave & Particle Animation** - flowing waves with drifting particles.
- **Visualization (MP4)** - one of several looping video clips. The clips are not part of the app; the first time you choose this, the app offers to download them.
  Instead of an animation you can also show your own photos: turn on **Show random photos during audio playback**, tap **Select Photos Source** and choose a resource with pictures. A different photo from it appears for each song. See Creating photo slideshows to let the photos change during a song.

Audio with live visualizers





Wave & Particle Animation behind a track without a cover.

4 Read the lyrics or find the song on YouTube Music

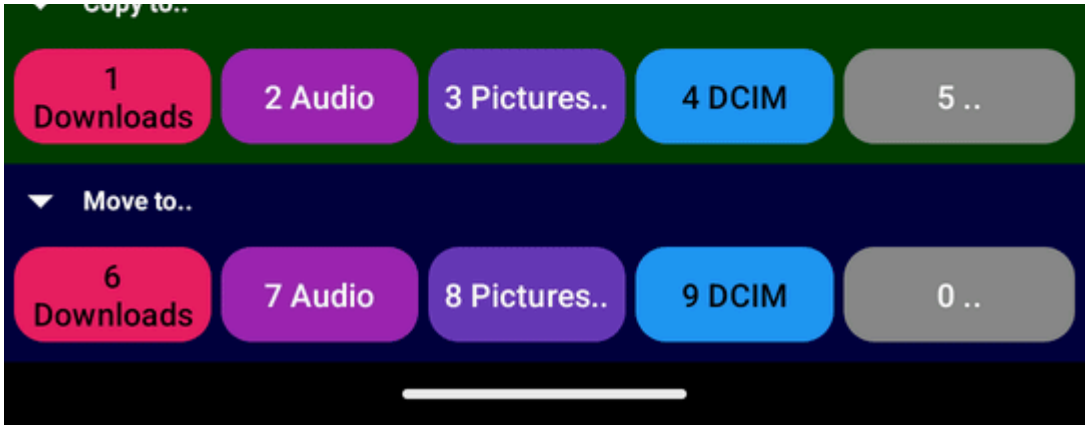
Open the three-dots menu and tap **Lyrics**. The app searches the internet for the words of the song, using the artist and title stored in the file or its file name, and shows them full screen. Tap the close button to return to the player. The text size follows the **Text Settings** you use for translations.

To hear another version of the song or explore the artist, tap **In YouMusic** on the command panel or in the three-dots menu. The YouTube Music app opens with a search for the current track. If YouTube Music is not installed, a short message tells you so.

Traditional - Hymns - Amazing Grace

Amazing grace, how sweet the sound
That saved a wretch like me
I once was lost, but now I'm found
I was blind, but now I see
'Twas grace that taught my heart to fear
And grace my fear relieved
How precious did that grace appear
The hour I first believed
Through many dangers, toils and snares
I have already come
'Tis grace hath brought me safe thus far
And grace will lead me home
When we've been there ten thousand years
Bright shining as the sun
We've no less days to sing God's praise
Than when we've first begun

Copy to



Lyrics shown full screen.

5 Play on a Chromecast

Tap the cast button **Cast to..** on the command panel and pick your Chromecast or smart TV from the list. The music plays on it, and the phone becomes the remote control. The same button sends photos, GIFs and videos too; see casting and broadcast.

Files from a network folder or cloud storage are first copied to the phone and then sent to the Chromecast, so the first seconds may take a moment. The phone and the Chromecast must be on the same Wi-Fi network.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Cast device list**
Cast route chooser dialog over the audio player, one device listed.

6 Sort tracks while you listen

A download folder full of unsorted songs is easiest to clean up by ear. While a track plays, tap **Copy to..** or **Move to..** at the bottom of the player and pick a destination folder - for example "Keep", "Car" or "Delete later". The player continues with the next track, so you can sort a whole folder in one listening session.

How destinations are set up is explained in Copy, move and delete files.

What You Get

Your music plays from wherever it is stored, with covers found automatically, lyrics one tap away, a calm animation or your own photos when there is no cover, and a Chromecast when you want the big speakers. A messy folder gets sorted while you listen.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A WAV file opened a menu instead of playing?** Current versions open WAV files in the audio player directly. Update the app if you still see the menu.
- **Covers do not appear?** Check that **Search audio covers online** is on, and that you are on Wi-Fi if **Search only on Wi-Fi** is on. Very rare recordings may simply not be in the catalogs.
- **Cast button missing?** The VR and FOSS editions do not include Chromecast support. Also check that Wi-Fi is on.
- **Want the music to keep playing after you leave the player?** See Playback order, sleep timer and listening in the background.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

AUDIO

PHOTOS

Creating photo slideshows

Playback order, sleep timer and listening in the background

Shuffle, repeat, fall asleep to music and control playback from the notification.

Let photos change on screen while your music plays.

WATCH

Music on the watch

Play and control music from your Wear OS watch.

IMAGES, AUDIO & SLIDESHOW | All editions | RECIPE #01

Viewing Photos, GIFs and Zoom Gestures

The image viewer shows one picture at a time on the whole screen. Swipe to move between photos, pinch to zoom, turn a sideways photo for a moment and pause animated pictures – all without changing your files.

Why You'll Love This

You come back from a trip with four hundred photos and want to look through them quickly, one after another, on the whole screen. Or a friend sends you a funny animated GIF and you want to stop it on the best frame. The image viewer is made for exactly this: one picture at a time, a swipe to the next one, and nothing in the way.

Nothing on this page changes your files. Zooming, turning a photo for a moment and pausing an animation only change what you see right now.

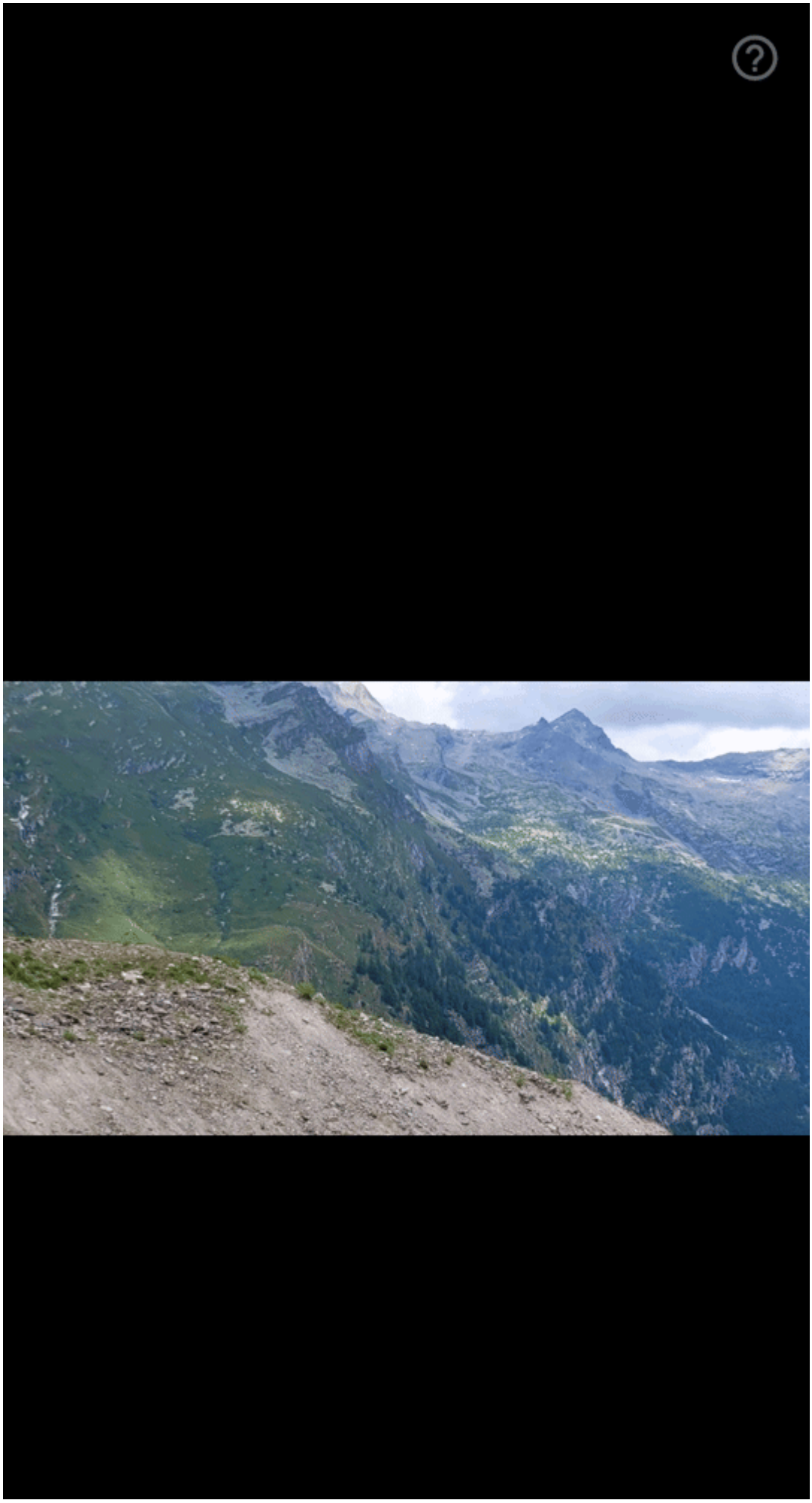
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed. The image viewer is part of every edition: Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- At least one resource with pictures in it, for example the All Images collection or a folder you added yourself.
- For HEIC and HEIF photos (the format many phones use for camera shots): Android 9 or newer. For AVIF pictures: Android 12 or newer.

1 Open a photo full screen

Open a resource on the main screen, then tap any picture in the file browser. The picture opens in the image viewer, filling the screen.

The viewer shows JPG, PNG, WebP, BMP and GIF pictures, animated WebP and APNG, and HEIC, HEIF and AVIF photos. If your Android is too old for HEIC or AVIF, the viewer does not fail silently: it tells you which Android version the picture needs, for example "requires Android 9 (API 28) or newer".



A photo opened full screen in the image viewer.

2 Move to the next or previous photo

Swipe from right to left to see the next picture in the folder, and from left to right to go back to the previous one. The order is the same as in the file browser, so if you sorted the folder by date, you walk through your photos by date.

You can also tap the screen instead of swiping. The screen is divided into invisible touch zones: a tap on the right side of the middle row opens the next file, a tap on the left side opens the previous one.

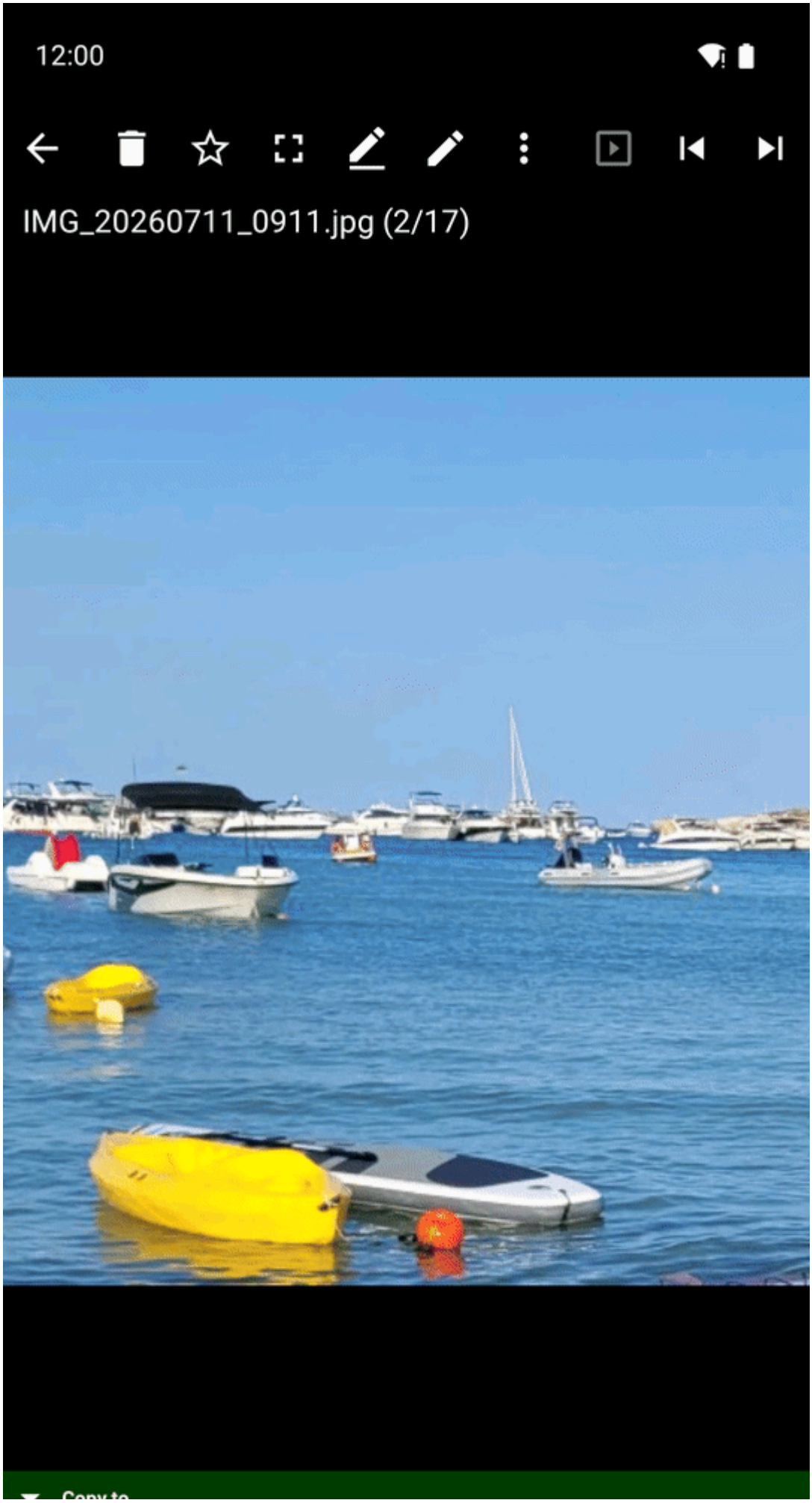
Keyboard and remote control

On a tablet with a keyboard, or on a TV box with a remote, the left and right arrow keys move between photos too. See keyboard, D-pad and TV navigation.

3 Zoom in to see the details

Put two fingers on the picture and spread them apart to zoom in; pinch them together to zoom out. While zoomed in, drag with one finger to look around the picture.

By default the viewer loads a lighter copy of each picture, about 1920 pixels wide, so large photos open quickly. To see every pixel of a 50-megapixel photo when you zoom in - and to zoom while the command panel is open - go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, the **Images, GIFs and slideshow** section, and turn on **Load images at full resolution**.

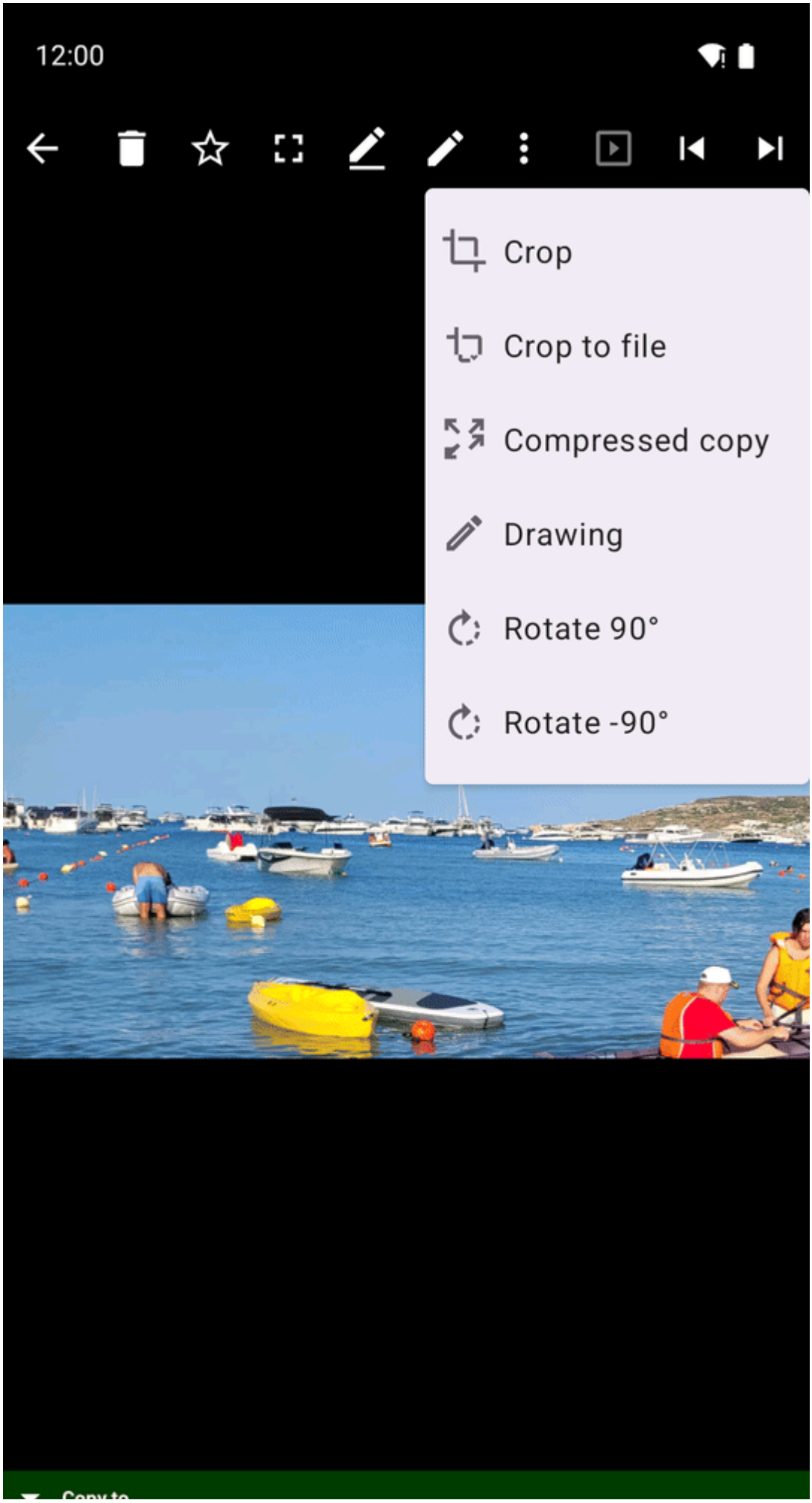

12:00
IMG_20260711_0911.jpg (2/17)

Pinch to zoom in on a photo.

4 Turn a sideways photo for a moment

Some photos are shown lying on their side. To look at one upright without changing the file, open the three-dots menu and tap **Rotate 90°** (turn clockwise) or **Rotate −90°** (turn counter-clockwise). Each tap turns the picture by a quarter; four taps bring it back.

This turn lasts only while you look at the photo. The file itself stays exactly as it was, and the phone's own screen rotation is not touched. To turn the photo for good, use the editing tools described in Editing photos: rotate, crop, colors and GIF tools.


12:00
Crop
Crop to file
Compressed copy
Drawing
Rotate 90°
Rotate -90°

Rotate 90° and Rotate -90° in the three-dots menu.

5 Play and pause animated GIF, WebP and APNG pictures

Animated pictures start moving as soon as you open them, just like in a messaging app. This works for GIF files and also for animated WebP and APNG pictures.

To stop on a frame, tap the play and pause button on the control bar. Tap it again and the animation continues from where it stopped. When you move to another file and come back, the viewer remembers whether you left this animation playing or paused.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Paused GIF**
A GIF open in the player, paused, control bar visible with the play button.

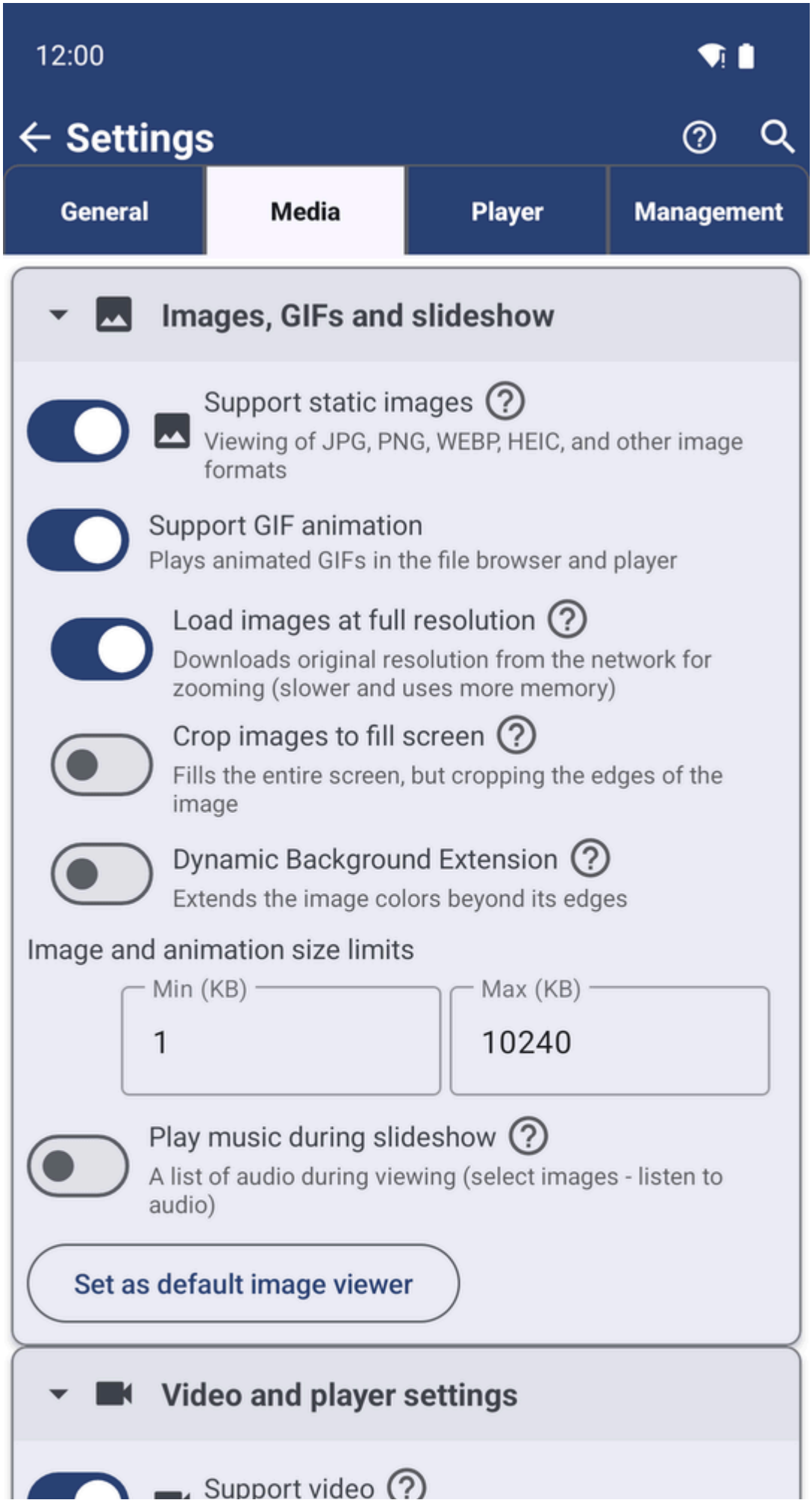
More you can do with an animation

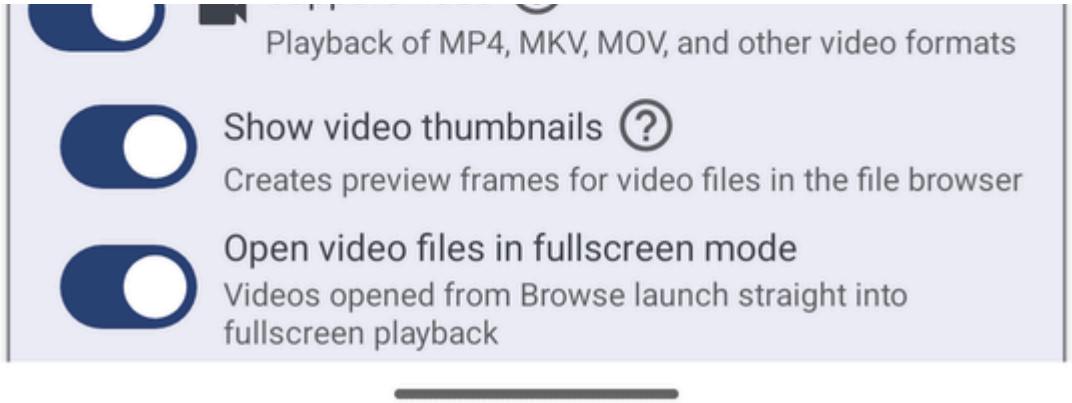
Speed an animation up or slow it down, save its first frame as a picture, or cut it into separate frames - all of this is in Editing photos: rotate, crop, colors and GIF tools.

6 Choose between the whole picture and a full screen

A photo rarely has exactly the shape of your screen. By default the viewer shows the whole picture and leaves thin empty bars at the edges, so nothing is cut off.

If you prefer the picture to cover the entire screen, go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, the **Images, GIFs and slideshow** section, and turn on **Crop images to fill screen**. The edges of the picture that do not fit are then hidden. The same choice applies to the slideshow.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Images, GIFs and slideshow
Support static images
Viewing of JPG, PNG, WEBP, HEIC, and other image formats
Support GIF animation
Plays animated GIFs in the file browser and player
Load images at full resolution
Downloads original resolution from the network for zooming (slower and uses more memory)
Crop images to fill screen
Fills the entire screen, but cropping the edges of the image
Dynamic Background Extension
Extends the image colors beyond its edges
Image and animation size limits
Min (KB)
1
Max (KB)
10240
Play music during slideshow
A list of audio during viewing (select images - listen to audio)
Set as default image viewer
Video and player settings
Support video



The Crop images to fill screen switch in Settings, Media, Images, GIFs and slideshow.

What You Get

You can walk through a whole folder of photos with a swipe, zoom into any detail, straighten a sideways shot for a moment and freeze an animation on the frame you like - without changing a single file.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Zoom looks blurry?** Turn on **Load images at full resolution** in Settings, Media, Images, GIFs and slideshow. The viewer then loads the original picture instead of a lighter copy.
- **A HEIC or AVIF photo shows a notice instead of a picture?** Your Android version cannot draw that format. The notice names the Android version the picture needs. You can still copy, move and share the file.
- **Sort while you look.** The same full-screen player can copy, move or delete the photo you are looking at. See Copy, move and delete files.
- **Let the photos change by themselves.** Start a slideshow and the viewer moves to the next picture on its own.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PHOTOS

Editing photos, rotate, crop, colors and GIF tools

PHOTOS

Creating photo slideshows

Turn a photo for good, crop it, change its brightness and colors, or change the speed of an animated GIF.

Let your photos change by themselves, with a countdown and background music.

BROWSING

Grid and list views

Find the photo you want faster with thumbnails, sorting and filters.

IMAGES, AUDIO & SLIDESHOW | All editions | RECIPE #02

Editing Photos - Rotate, Crop, Colors and GIF Tools

Turn, mirror and crop a photo, make a small copy to send, brighten a dark picture or give it a black-and-white look, and change the speed of an animated GIF - right in the image viewer, without a separate editor.

Why You'll Love This

A photo of a receipt came out sideways, a holiday picture has a stranger at the edge, an old scan is too dark, or you want a tiny copy of a big photo to send by message. You do not need a separate photo editor for these everyday fixes: the image viewer has them built in, one tap away from the picture you are looking at.

The same place also holds a few tools for animated GIF, WebP and APNG pictures: make an animation faster or slower, keep its first frame as a normal picture, or take it apart frame by frame.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition : Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS.
- A picture you are allowed to change. Pictures in a folder the app can only read are saved as a new file in your Downloads folder instead.
- Pictures in a network folder can be edited too, in the editions that can open network folders (all except Lite).
- For cutting animated WebP or APNG pictures into frames: Android 9 or newer. GIF files work on any Android version.

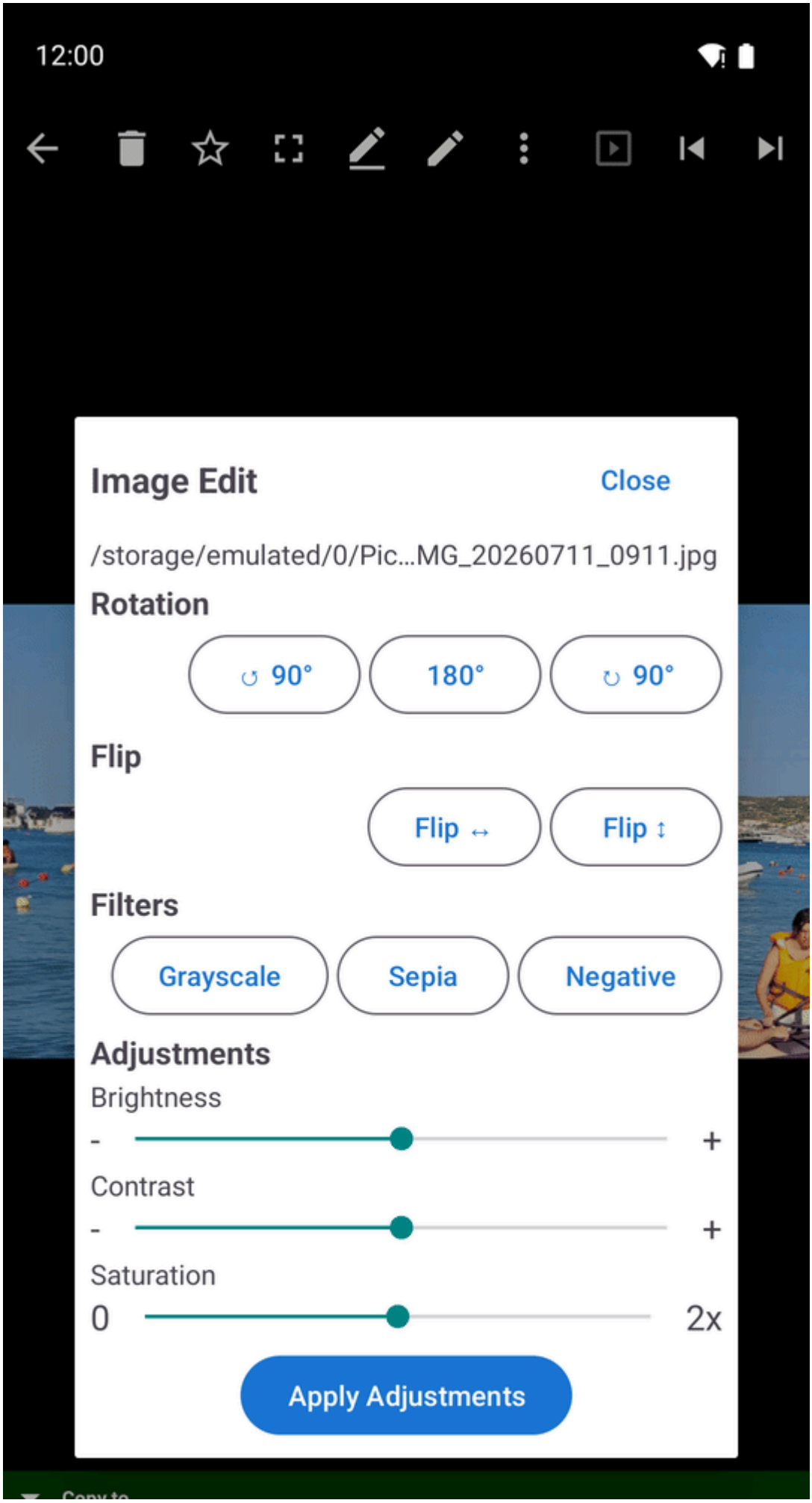
⚠ These changes are saved to the file straight away

Every button in the Image Edit window changes the original picture at once - there is no separate Save step and no confirmation. If you want to keep the original, copy the file first (see Copy, move and delete files) or use **Crop to file** and **Compressed copy**, which always make a new file.

1 Open the editing tools

Open the photo in the image viewer. Then either tap the pencil button **Adjust** on the command panel, or open the three-dots menu and tap **Adjust**.

For an ordinary photo this opens the **Image Edit** window with four groups: **Rotation**, **Flip**, **Filters** and **Adjustments**. For an animated GIF, WebP or APNG picture it opens the **GIF Editor** instead (see step 6).


12:00
Image Edit
Close
/storage/emulated/0/Pic...MG_20260711_0911.jpg
Rotation
↺ 90°
180°
↻ 90°
Flip
Flip ↔
Flip ↕
Filters
Grayscale
Sepia
Negative
Adjustments
Brightness
-
+
Contrast
-
+
Saturation
0
2x
Apply Adjustments

The Image Edit window.

2 Turn or mirror a photo for good

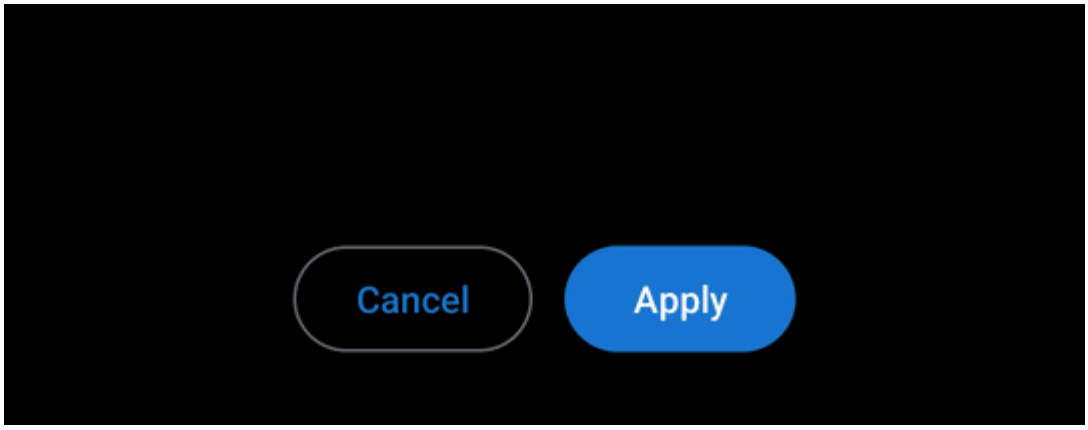
In the **Rotation** group tap ↺ **90°** to turn the photo a quarter to the left, ↻ **90°** to turn it a quarter to the right, or **180°** to turn it upside down. In the **Flip** group tap **Flip** ↔ to mirror it left to right or **Flip** ↕ to mirror it top to bottom.

The photo is rewritten on the spot while "Rotating image.." is shown. Its date, camera details and other information stored inside the file are kept, and the turn is stored in the picture itself, so it looks right in every other app too.

3 Crop away what you do not want

Open the three-dots menu and choose one of two commands:

- **Crop** - cuts the photo and replaces the original file.
- **Crop to file** - keeps the original and saves the cut part as a new file.
  A frame with handles appears over the photo. Drag the corners and edges until the frame holds only the part you want to keep, then confirm with **OK**. For **Crop to file** you are asked for a file name; the suggested one is the original name plus `_crop-` and the date and time, for example `beach_crop-260924-1530.jpg`. The new file goes into the same folder, or into Downloads when the folder cannot be written to.



Drag the handles, then tap OK.

4 Save a smaller copy to send

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Compressed copy**. The app saves a lighter JPEG copy of the photo next to the original (or in Downloads, if that folder is read-only), named like `beach_compress-260924-1530.jpg`. The original is not touched.

A compressed copy is handy when a messenger or an e-mail refuses a large photo. The copy looks the same on a phone screen but takes much less space.

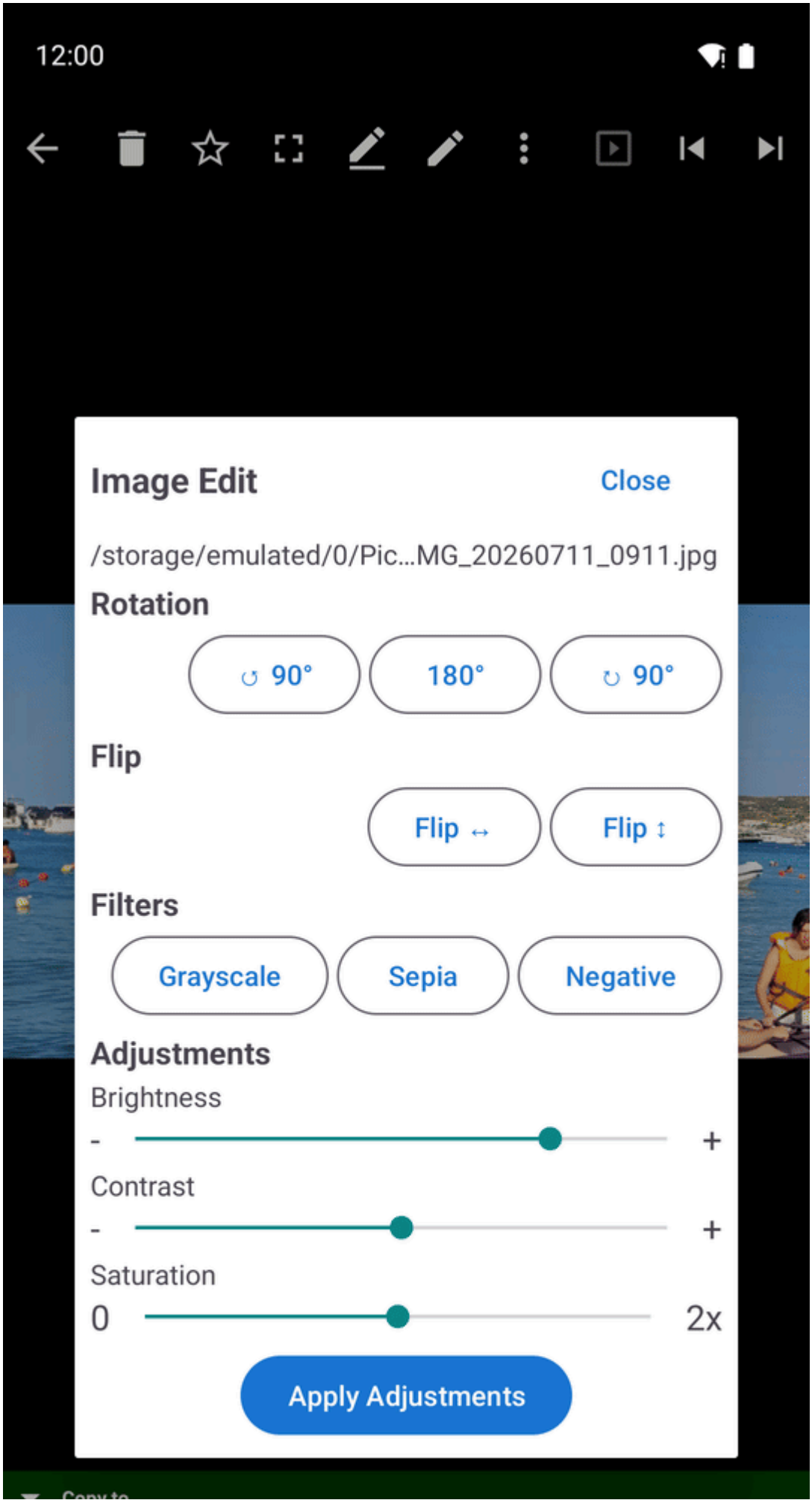
5 Fix brightness and colors, or add a filter

In the **Adjustments** group move the sliders:

- **Brightness** - from -100 (much darker) to +100 (much lighter); 0 leaves it as it is.
- **Contrast** - from 0× (flat and gray) to 2× (strong); 1× leaves it as it is.
- **Saturation** - from 0× (black and white) to 2× (vivid colors); 1× leaves it as it is.

Tap **Apply Adjustments** to save the result into the photo.

The **Filters** group changes the whole picture with one tap: **Grayscale** makes it black and white, **Sepia** gives it the warm brown look of an old print, and **Negative** swaps every color for its opposite.


12:00
Image Edit
Close
/storage/emulated/0/Pic...MG_20260711_0911.jpg
Rotation
↺ 90°
180°
↻ 90°
Flip
Flip ↔
Flip ↕
Filters
Grayscale
Sepia
Negative
Adjustments
Brightness
-
+
Contrast
-
+
Saturation
0
2x
Apply Adjustments

Brightness, Contrast and Saturation sliders.

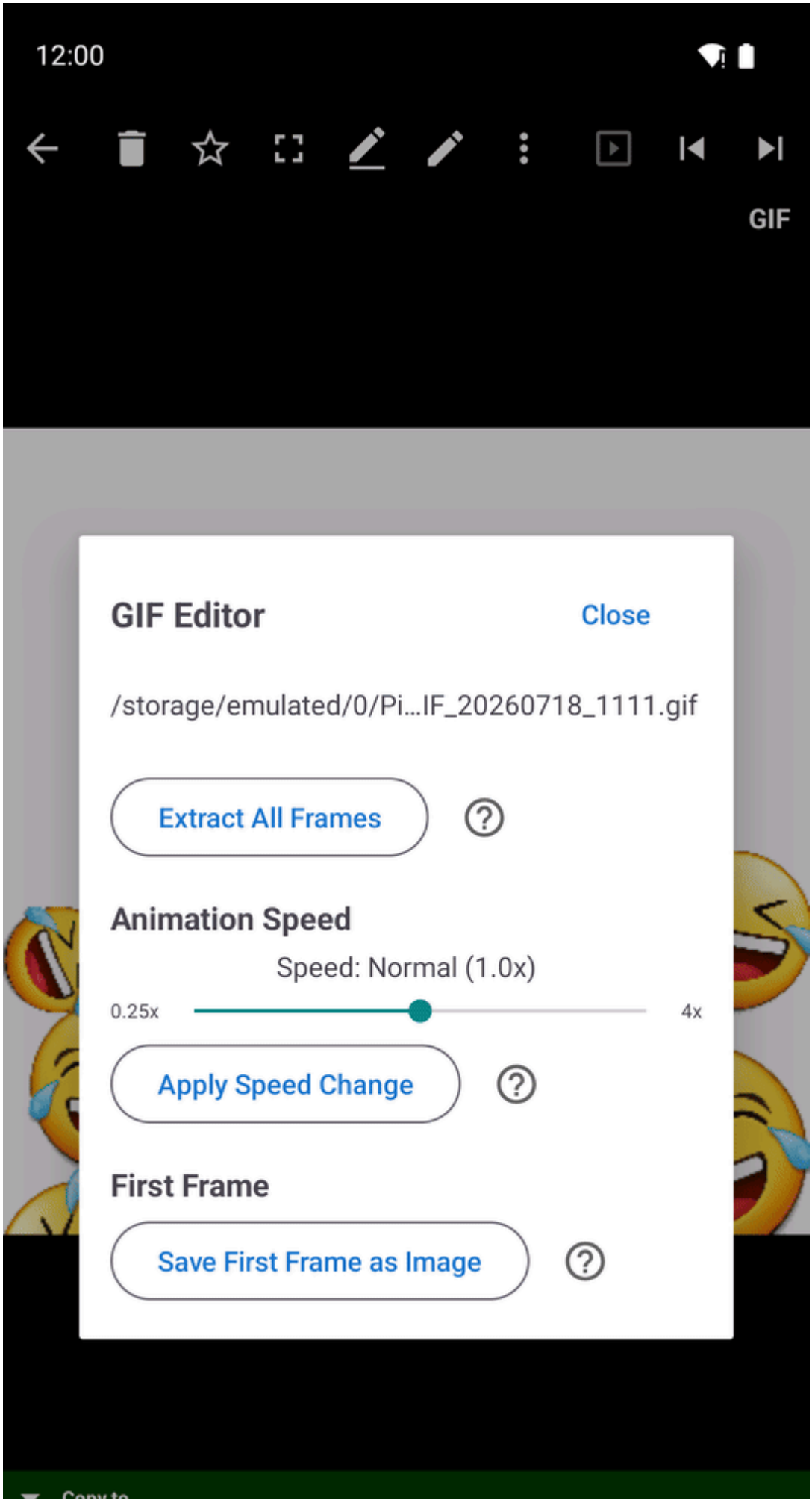
Pictures on another computer

When the photo is in a network folder, for example a shared folder on your home computer (see Windows network shares), the app downloads it, makes the change and uploads it back to the same place. It takes a little longer, but you do not have to copy anything by hand.

6 Change the speed of a GIF, keep its first frame, or cut it into frames

Open an animated picture and tap **Adjust**. The **GIF Editor** window offers three tools:

- **Animation Speed** – move the slider between **0.25×** (four times slower) and **4×** (four times faster), then tap **Apply Speed Change**. For a GIF on this device the original file is rewritten with the new speed; for a GIF in a network folder a new file such as `party_speed_2_0x.gif` is saved to Downloads.
- **Save First Frame as Image** – saves the first picture of the animation as a still PNG in Downloads, named like `party_first_frame.png`.
- **Extract All Frames** – saves every frame as a separate PNG picture: `party_frame_001.png`, `party_frame_002.png` and so on. For a file on this device they go into the same folder; for a file in a network folder, into Downloads.


12:00
GIF
GIF Editor
Close
/storage/emulated/0/Pi...IF_20260718_1111.gif
Extract All Frames
Animation Speed
Speed: Normal (1.0x)
0.25x
4x
Apply Speed Change
First Frame
Save First Frame as Image

The GIF Editor window.

7 Edit in a separate window on a large screen

On a Chromebook, a tablet or a headset the player can open a picture in its own window beside other apps: open the three-dots menu and tap **Open in new window**. If you do not see this item, turn on **Allow new windows** in **Settings**, the **General** tab, **Interface** (see multi-window and foldables).

In the separate window the three-dots menu groups every editing command under one **Editing** section: **Adjust**, **Crop**, **Crop to file**, **Compressed copy**, **Drawing**, **Rotate 90°** and **Rotate −90°**. The same menu also lets you rename the file and switch **Screen autorotate** on or off.

What You Get

Sideways photos stand upright in every app, unwanted edges are gone, dark pictures are brighter, and you have small copies ready to send. Animated pictures play at the speed you like, and any frame of them can become an ordinary picture.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Keep the original.** Crop, rotate, flip, filters and adjustments overwrite the file. Only **Crop to file**, **Compressed copy**, **Save First Frame as Image** and **Extract All Frames** always create new files.
- **Just want to look at a sideways photo?** Use **Rotate 90°** in the three-dots menu of the viewer. It turns the picture on screen only and leaves the file alone - see Viewing photos, GIFs and zoom gestures.
- **Want to draw or write on a photo?** That is a separate tool - see drawing and image markup.
- **A new file landed in Downloads?** That happens when the photo's folder cannot be written to, for example a folder the app may only read. Move the file where you want it afterwards.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PHOTOS

Viewing photos, GIFs and zoom gestures

Swipe through photos, zoom into details and pause animations.

PHOTOS

Creating photo slideshows

Let your freshly edited photos play one after another by themselves.

TOOLS

Drawing and image markup

Draw, write and mark up on top of a picture.

IMAGES, AUDIO & SLIDESHOW | All editions | RECIPE #03

Creating Photo Slideshows

A slideshow moves from one photo to the next by itself. Choose how long each photo stays, add background music, and let the app keep the screen on – a phone or tablet becomes a photo frame in a minute.

Why You'll Love This

Relatives are visiting and you want to show the holiday photos on the TV without swiping every few seconds. Or an old tablet on the shelf could become a photo frame that shows a new family picture every minute. A slideshow does exactly that: it moves to the next photo by itself, after the number of seconds you choose, and can play music in the background.

A slideshow is only a way of looking. It never creates a video and never changes your files.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. In the Photos edition the slideshow shows pictures only, because that edition does not play video or audio.
- A resource with photos, for example a folder on this device or a network folder on your home computer.
- Optional: a second resource with music, if you want background music.

1 Start the slideshow

Open the first photo of the folder in the image viewer and tap **Slideshow** on the control bar. The button turns red while the slideshow runs. Tap it again to stop.

There is also a shortcut on the main screen: some resources show a small **Start slideshow** icon on their card, which opens the folder and starts the slideshow in one tap.

The slideshow walks through the folder in the same order as the file browser. The next photo replaces the previous one at once, without fades or other effects.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Slideshow running**
Player showing a photo, control bar visible, Slideshow button active (red).

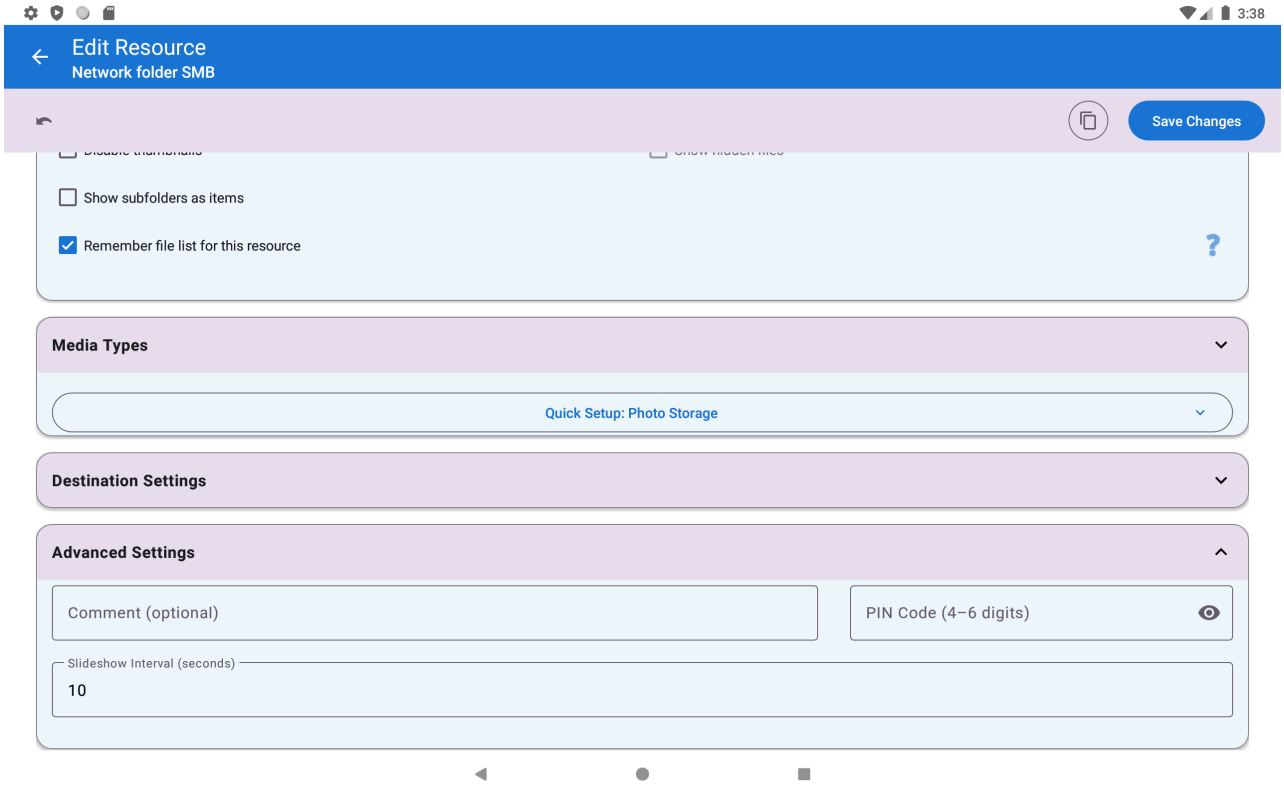
The screen stays on by itself

While the slideshow runs, the screen does not go dark - you will see the message "Screen will stay on during slideshow". When you stop it, your usual screen timeout comes back.

2 Choose how long each photo stays

Each photo stays on screen for 10 seconds unless you choose otherwise. You can set a different time for every resource: on the main screen open the resource for editing, expand **Advanced Settings** and type the number of seconds into **Slideshow Interval (seconds)**. Anything from 1 second to 3600 seconds (one hour) works. Tap **Save Changes**.

The default for new resources is in **Settings**, the **Player** tab, section **Sorting, slideshow and playback order**, field **Slideshow (s)**.



The Slideshow Interval field in the resource editor.

3 Watch the countdown

A few seconds before the next photo appears, a small countdown - 3, 2, 1 - shows in the corner. It tells you the photo is about to change, so you can stop the slideshow in time if you want to look longer. The countdown appears whenever a photo stays longer than three seconds.

2..

The countdown before the next photo.

4 Change the slideshow on the fly

Press and hold the **Slideshow** button. The **Slideshow Settings** window opens:

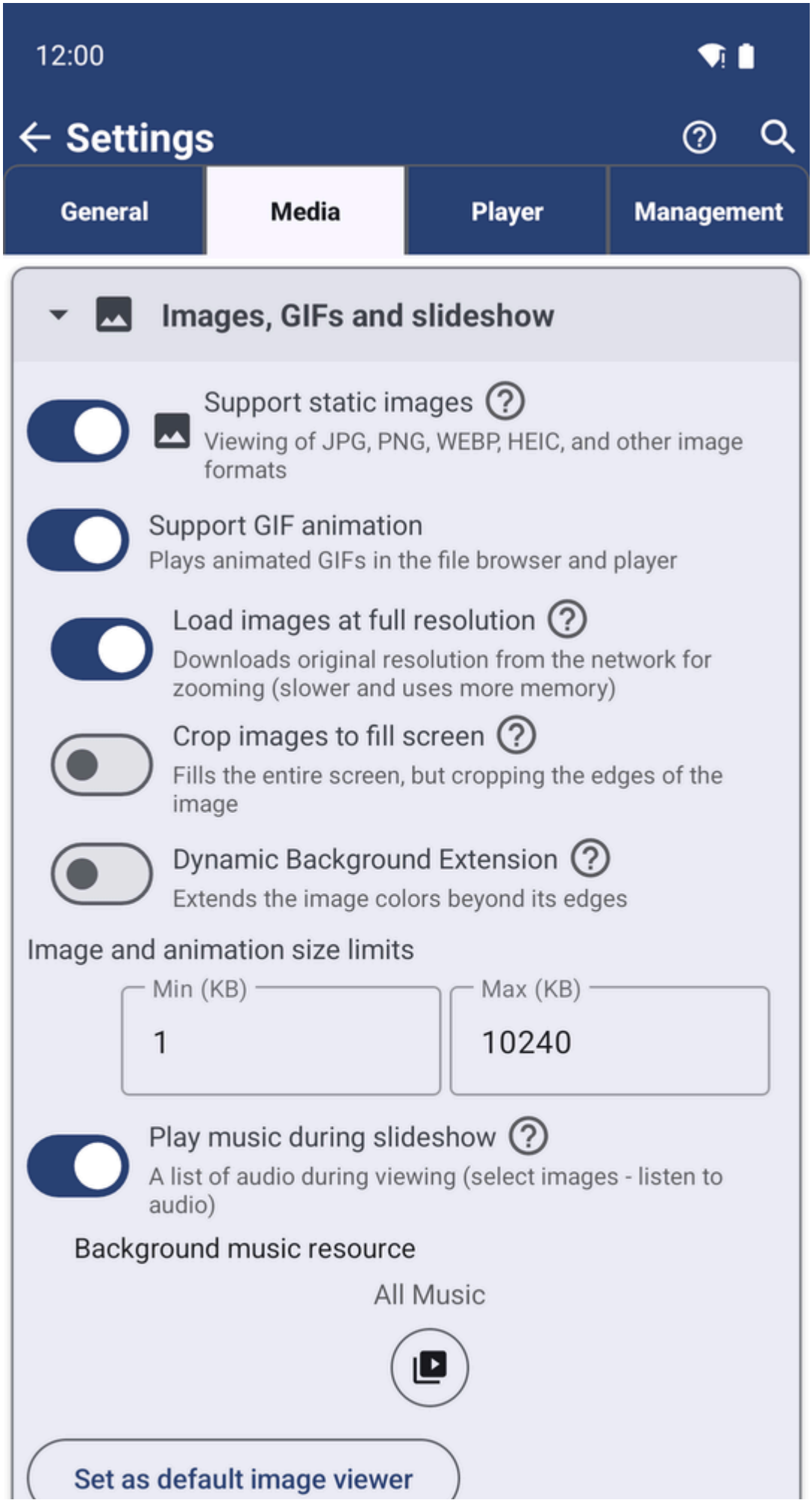
- **Default slideshow (sec.)** - a slider from 1 to 60 seconds for the current session.
- **Play videos/audio to end** - when this is on, a video or a song in the folder plays to its end before the slideshow moves on, and no countdown is shown for it.
- **Background Music** - tap to pick one music file from your phone to play during this slideshow; the name of the chosen track is shown below, and a clear button removes it.

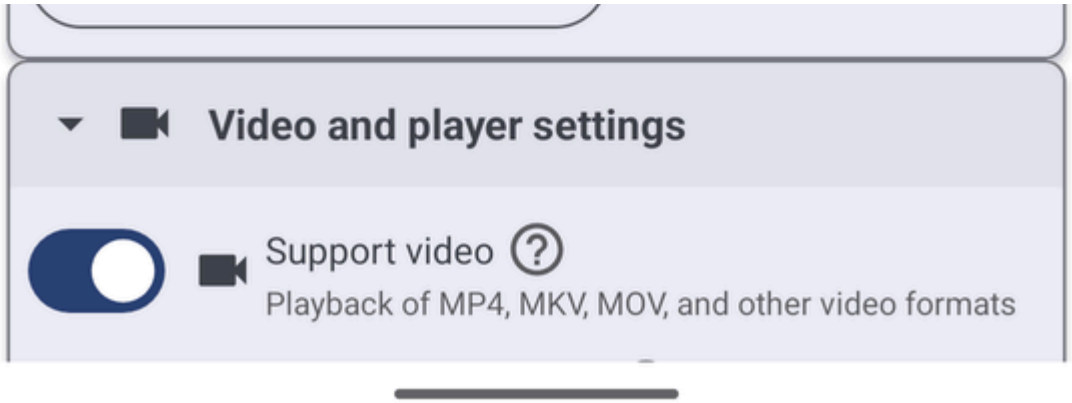
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Slideshow Settings window**
Slideshow Settings dialog over a photo, interval at 5 s, play-to-end on.

5 Play music from a whole music folder

For a slideshow with music every time, go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Images, GIFs and slideshow**, turn on **Play music during slideshow**, tap **Select Music Source** and choose the resource that holds your music. From now on every slideshow of photos and GIFs plays the tracks of that resource in random order.

You can mix places freely: photos from a network folder and music from this device, or the other way round.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Images, GIFs and slideshow
Support static images
Viewing of JPG, PNG, WEBP, HEIC, and other image formats
Support GIF animation
Plays animated GIFs in the file browser and player
Load images at full resolution
Downloads original resolution from the network for zooming (slower and uses more memory)
Crop images to fill screen
Fills the entire screen, but cropping the edges of the image
Dynamic Background Extension
Extends the image colors beyond its edges
Image and animation size limits
Min (KB)
1
Max (KB)
10240
Play music during slideshow
A list of audio during viewing (select images - listen to audio)
Background music resource
All Music
Set as default image viewer



Play music during slideshow in Settings.

6 Show photos while music plays

It also works the other way round: listen to music and let photos change in the background. Go to **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Audio playback, covers and visuals**, turn on **Show random photos during audio playback** and pick the resource with your photos.

Now open a song in the audio player and tap **Slideshow**. The music controls step aside and a full-screen photo appears, replaced by another random photo at every slideshow interval. More about backgrounds for music is in Playing and organizing music files.

What You Get

Your photos change by themselves at the pace you chose, with a short countdown before each change, music in the background if you want it, and videos and songs that play to the end. The screen stays on for as long as the show runs.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The slideshow stopped with "Connection to .. was lost"?** The network folder became unreachable, for example the computer went to sleep or Wi-Fi dropped. Start the slideshow again when the connection is back.
- **The slideshow stopped with "No access to .."?** Three files in a row could not be opened. Check that the folder is still there and that the app may still read it.
- **Videos interrupt your photo show?** Turn off **Play videos/audio to end**, or limit the resource to pictures in its settings.
- **Photos are cut at the edges?** Turn off **Crop images to fill screen** in Settings, Media, Images, GIFs and slideshow - see Viewing photos, GIFs and zoom gestures.
- **The slideshow does not start for a music or video library?** Resources set up with the Audio Library or Video Library resource profile play their files one after another on their own and do not use the slideshow timer.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PHOTOS

Viewing photos, GIFs and zoom gestures

Swipe, zoom and pause animations in the image viewer.

AUDIO

Playing and organizing music files

Play music in the background, with covers, lyrics and animated backgrounds.

SETTINGS

Display and appearance settings

Keep the screen on, choose colors and tune how the app looks.

IMAGES, AUDIO & SLIDESHOW | Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #05

All editions except Photos; background listening not in Lite

Playback Order, Sleep Timer and Listening in the Background

Decide in which order the tracks of a folder play, let the sleep timer stop the music gently, and keep listening while you use other apps - with controls in the notification, a Quick Settings tile and the Now Playing bar.

Why You'll Love This

Music rarely has your full attention. You listen while you cook, walk, read the news or fall asleep. This recipe covers everything that happens around the tracks: in which order they play, how to stop the music by itself after half an hour, and how to keep it going while you do something else.

There is no separate playlist to build. The queue is simply the audio files of the folder you opened, in the order the folder is sorted. To change what plays, open a different folder or sort this one differently.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

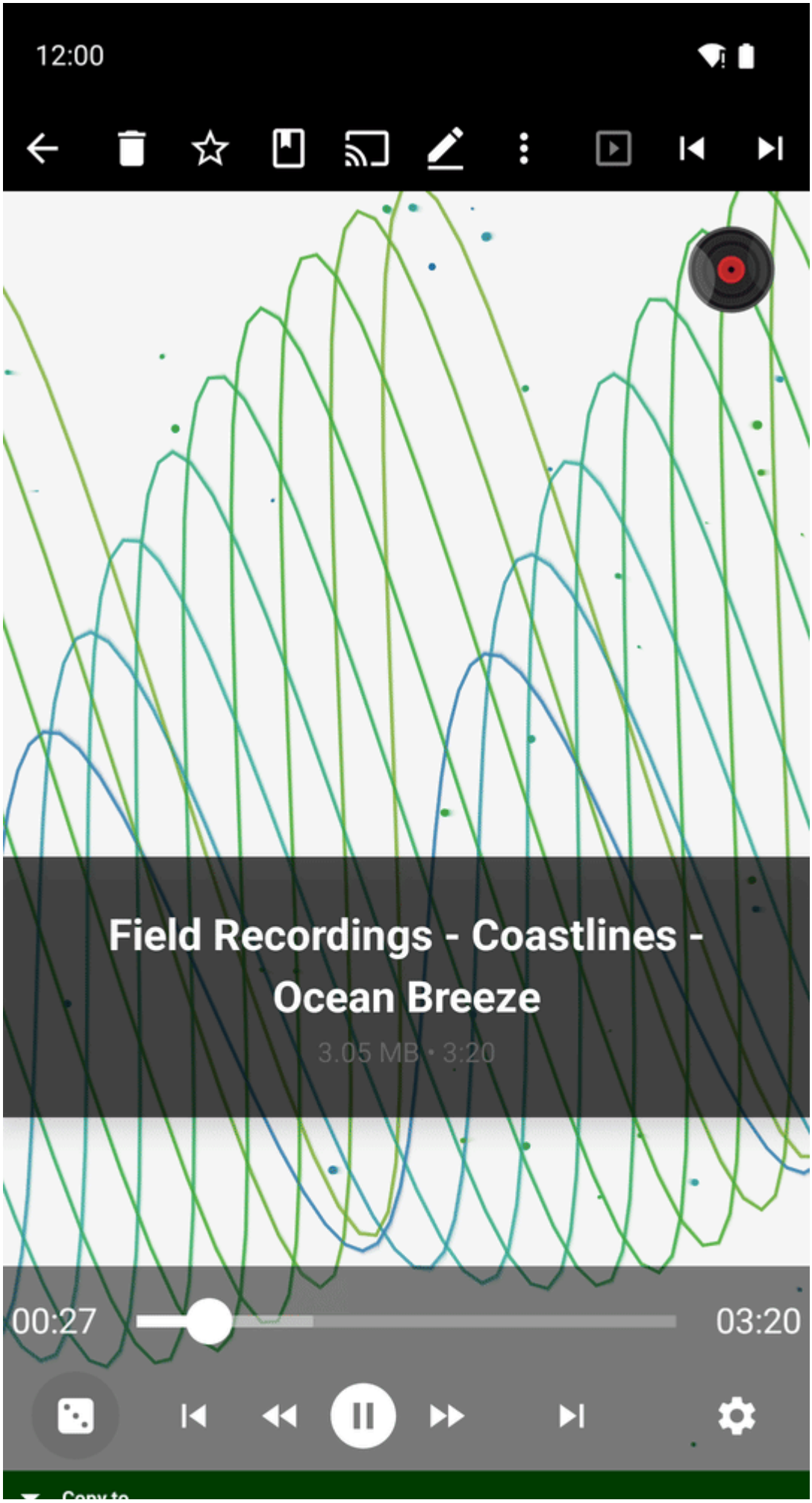
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Lite, Legacy, VR or FOSS edition. The Photos edition does not play audio.
- Listening in the background, the notification controls and the Quick Settings tile: Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR and FOSS. In the Lite edition the music stops when you leave the player.
- A folder with a few tracks, opened in the audio player as described in Playing and organizing music files.

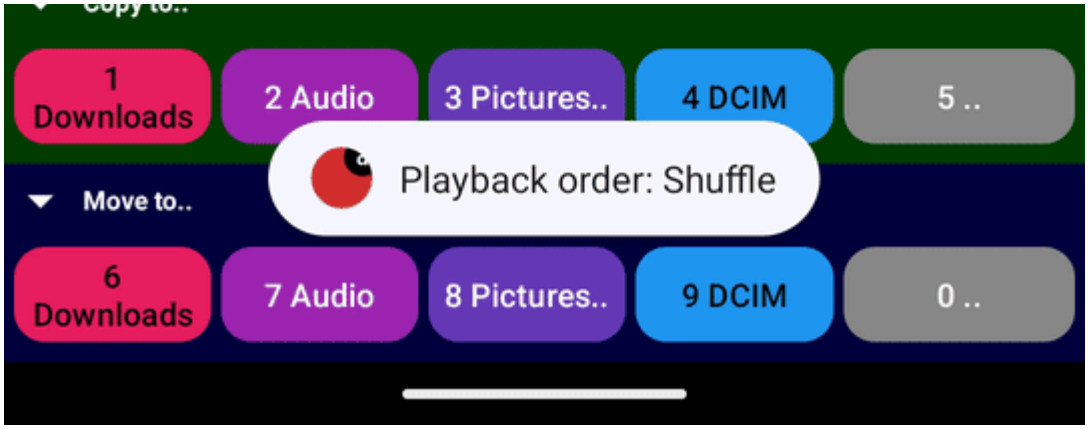
1 Choose the playback order

Tap the repeat button at the left of the playback buttons. Each tap switches to the next mode, and a short message confirms it, for example "Playback order: Shuffle":

1. **Loop list** - plays the folder from top to bottom, then starts again.
2. **Play through** - plays the folder once and stops at the end.
3. **Shuffle** - plays the tracks of the folder in random order.
4. **Repeat one** - plays the current track again and again.

After **Repeat one** the next tap brings you back to **Loop list**.


12:00
Field Recordings - Coastlines - Ocean Breeze
3.05 MB • 3:20
00:27
03:20

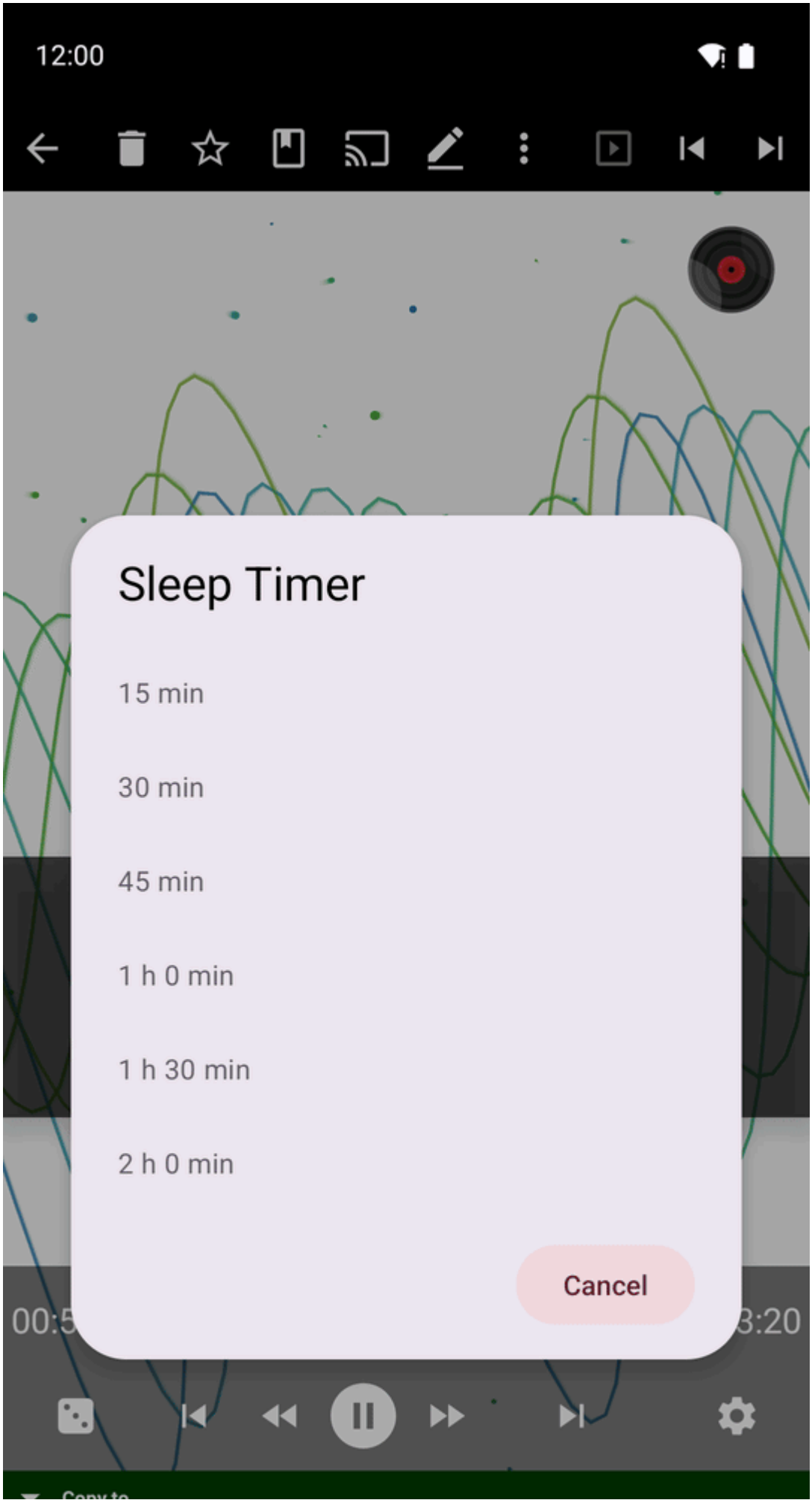


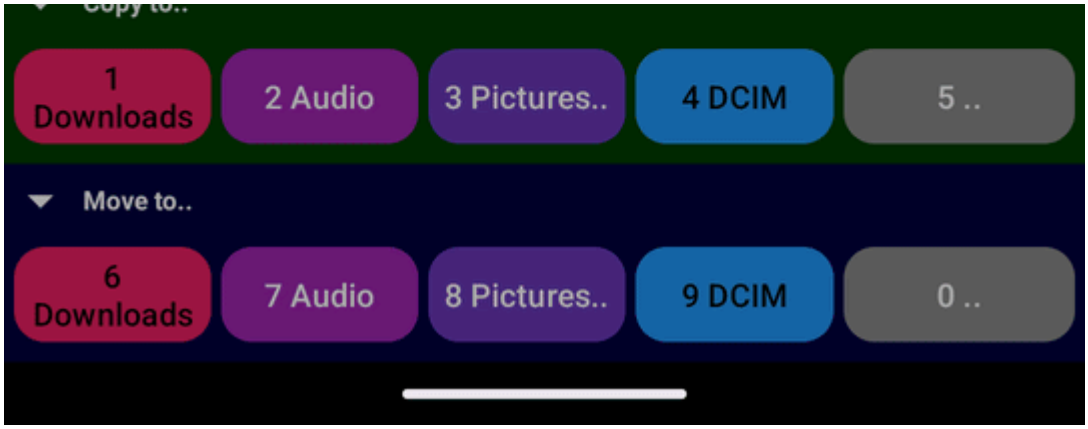
One button cycles through the four playback orders.

2 Fall asleep to music with the sleep timer

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Sleep Timer**. Choose 15, 30, 45, 60, 90 or 120 minutes. A small badge in the player shows how much time is left, for example "25m" or "1h 10m".

When the time runs out, the music does not stop abruptly: it fades out gently over ten seconds and then pauses. To cancel a running timer, open **Sleep Timer** again and choose **Off**.


12:00
Sleep Timer
15 min
30 min
45 min
1 h 0 min
1 h 30 min
2 h 0 min
Cancel

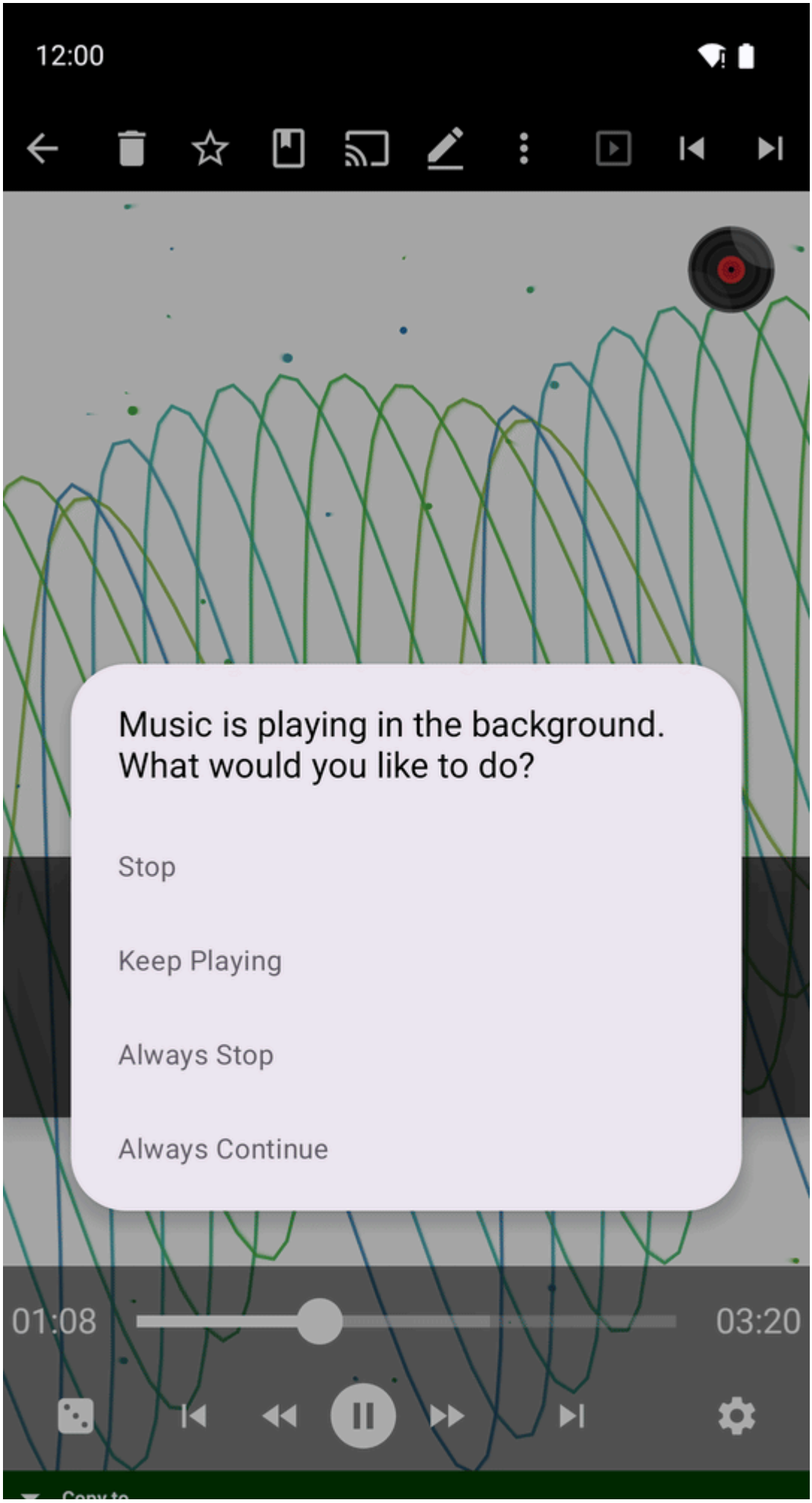


Choose when the music should stop.

3 Keep listening while you use other apps

Leave the player with the Back button while a track plays. The first time, the app asks "Music is playing in the background. What would you like to do?" - tap **Keep Playing** to go on listening, or **Stop**. The same window offers **Always Continue** and **Always Stop** if you do not want to be asked again.

You can change that choice later in **Settings**, the **Player** tab: **When leaving player or streams** offers **Ask every time (default)**, **Always stop** and **Always keep playing**.


12:00
Music is playing in the background.
What would you like to do?
Stop
Keep Playing
Always Stop
Always Continue
01:08
03:20

The app asks what to do with the music when you leave the player.

4 Control the music from anywhere

While music plays in the background you have several remote controls:

- **The Now Playing bar** - a small bar at the bottom of the other screens of the app, for example while you look at photos. It shows the track name and its cover; a slowly turning music note replaces the cover when there is none, and it stops turning when you pause. Tap the bar to open Now Playing with the full controls. The bar can be switched off with **Show now-playing panel** in **Settings**, the **Player** tab.
- **The notification** - pull down the Android notification shade to see the track and the play, pause and skip buttons. The same controls appear on the lock screen and work with Bluetooth headphones.
- **The Quick Settings tile** - add the **FMS Audio** tile to your Quick Settings panel (pull the shade down twice, tap the pencil and drag the tile in). One tap pauses or resumes; when nothing is playing it starts your music.

12:00
IMG_20260715_1355.jpg (4/17)
Amazing Grace

The Now Playing bar while you browse other files.

5 Calls and other apps

When a call comes in or another app starts playing sound, FastMediaSorter pauses the music at once. It does not start again by itself when the call ends - press play when you are ready. If another music app takes over for good, the player stops.

6 On a Wear OS watch

The watch app has its own audio player. The current volume is always shown as a bar along the left edge of the screen; it brightens while you turn the bezel to change the volume and dims afterwards. In the **Actions** menu, the playback mode entry switches between **Sequential playback**, **Shuffle playback** and **Loop playback** with each tap, without closing the menu. More in music on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch audio player**
Wear round screen, audio player playing, volume bar bright after a bezel turn.

What You Get

Your tracks play in the order you like, the music fades out by itself when you fall asleep, and you can leave the player, answer a call or use other apps while keeping the music under control from the notification, the Now Playing bar, the Quick Settings tile or your watch.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Want a specific set of songs?** Put them in one folder (or copy them there with **Copy to..**) and open that folder. Sort it by name to choose the order.
- **Music stops when you leave the player?** Check **When leaving player or streams** in Settings, Player. In the Lite edition background listening is not available.
- **Music did not resume after a call?** That is intentional - press play. It avoids music starting loudly at a bad moment.
- **Playlists of online radio stations** are a different thing - see custom M3U playlists.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

AUDIO

Playing and organizing music files

Covers, lyrics, animated backgrounds and Chromecast.

VIDEO

Picture-in-picture and background play for video

Keep a video playing in a small window or in the background.

WATCH

Music on the watch

Play and control music from your Wear OS watch.

ents and the Text Editor

DOCUMENTS & TEXT EDITOR | Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #01

Reading PDF Documents - Pages, Search, Night Mode and Export

Open a PDF with one tap, turn pages by swiping, find a page by its picture, read at night in dark colors, copy, search, listen to and translate the text, and save the pages as pictures or print them - all in the built-in reader.

Why You'll Love This

A bank statement, a user manual, a train ticket, a school handout - so many things arrive as PDF files. You do not need a separate PDF app for them: tap the file in FastMediaSorter and it opens in the built-in reader, page by page, sharp enough to zoom into the small print.

The reader remembers where you stopped, can show a whole document as one long scroll, dims the page for reading at night, finds a word on the page, reads the text aloud and even translates it without the internet. When you need the pages somewhere else, it saves them as pictures or sends the document to a printer.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in an edition with the reader: Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR or FOSS. The Lite and Photos editions do not open documents.
- A PDF file – on this device, in a network folder or cloud storage. Files from a network or the cloud are downloaded first, so the first page may take a moment.
- **Support PDF documents** switched on in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents**. It is on from the start.
- For tapping links inside a PDF and for picking the exact word under your finger: Android 15 or newer.
- For translation: an edition with translation (all of the above except FOSS) and **Enable Translation** switched on in **Settings**.

1 Open a PDF

In the file browser tap the PDF file. It opens in the reader on the page where you stopped last time - or on the first page, if you have never opened it before. PDF files in the file browser show a small picture of their first page, so you can tell them apart before opening.

You can also open a PDF that another app hands over, for example an attachment in your e-mail: choose FastMediaSorter in the **Open with** list. It opens in a separate reader window with the same tools. To have every PDF open in FastMediaSorter straight away, switch on **Set as default document viewer** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents**.

To see all your PDFs, books and text files in one list, add the All Documents resource on the main screen.

The Small Garden Planner

A season-by-season guide for balconies, patios and backyard beds

1. Choosing a spot

Most vegetables need at least six hours of direct sun a day. Watch your space for a full day before you plant: note where the morning light falls, where the afternoon shade begins and which corners stay damp after rain.

A sheltered wall that faces the sun stores warmth and releases it in the evening, which tomatoes, peppers and herbs love. Leafy greens such as lettuce and spinach are happier in a spot with light afternoon shade.

> Tip: start small. Two or three well-kept containers give more pleasure, and more food, than a large bed that gets away from you in July.

2. Soil and containers

Good soil is loose, dark and crumbly. Mix garden soil with compost in equal parts for beds, and use a fresh potting mix for containers. Every pot needs drainage holes; standing water rots roots faster than drought dries them.

A PDF open in the reader.

2 Turn pages and jump to any page

There are several ways to move through a document - use whichever is handier:

- Tap the arrows at the bottom of the screen for the previous or the next page.
- Swipe the page up for the next page and down for the previous one. A slow, calm drag with one finger is enough - no quick flick needed.
- When you have zoomed in, swipe up or down with **two fingers** together. Spreading or pinching the fingers still zooms and does not turn the page.
- Tap the page counter, for example **3 / 12**. In the **Go to page** window type the page number and tap **Go**.
- Use the buttons at the edges of the bar to jump to the first or the last page. The jump-to-start button sits a little apart from the back arrow, so you will not lose your place by a slip of the finger.
- With the app in Arabic or Urdu, the page arrows point the other way, because the next page of a right-to-left document lies to the left. The same goes for the chapter arrows of the EPUB reader and the page arrows of the text viewer.

Zoom in with two fingers as in any photo. When you turn the page, the reader keeps the same zoom and position, so a narrow column of small print stays readable page after page.

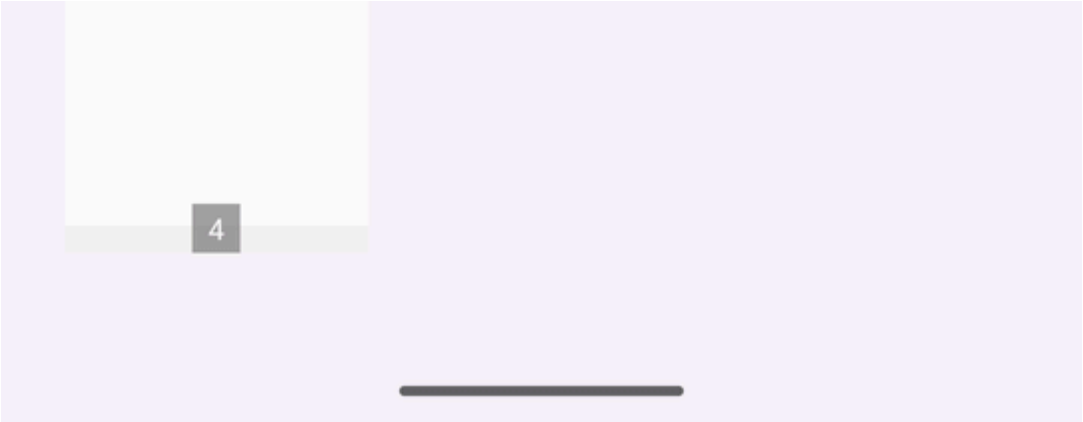
A single-page PDF

A PDF with only one page shows no arrows and no page counter - there is nowhere to turn.

3 Find a page by its picture

In a long document it is often quicker to find a page by its look - a table, a diagram, the start of a chapter. Open the three-dots menu and tap **Page Thumbnails**. A panel slides up with small pictures of all pages; its title shows how many there are. Tap a picture to open that page.

12:00
The Small Garden Planner
A season-by-season guide for balconies, patios and backyard beds
1. Choosing a spot
Most vegetables need at least six hours of direct sun a day. Watch your space for a full day before you plant: note where the morning light falls, where the afternoon shade begins and which corners stay damp after rain.
A sheltered wall that faces the sun stores warmth and releases it in the evening, which tomatoes, peppers and herbs love. Leafy greens such as lettuce and spinach are happier in a spot with light afternoon shade.
Tip: start small. Two or three well-kept containers give more pleasure, and more food, than a large bed that gets away from you in July.
Page Thumbnails (4)
1
2
3



Page Thumbnails: tap a picture to jump to that page.

4 Read in one long scroll, or in night and sepia colors

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Scroll Mode**. The pages now follow one another in a single long strip, like a web page – just scroll with your finger. Tap **Scroll Mode** again to go back to one page at a time. The reader remembers your choice for every PDF.

For reading in the dark, tap **Night Mode** in the same menu. Each tap switches to the next look:

- **Night** – white pages turn dark and the text turns light, which is easy on the eyes in a dark room.
- **Sepia** – a warm, yellowish paper tone for long reading.
- **Normal** – the original colors of the document.

The chosen colors work in both page mode and scroll mode and are kept for the next time.

12:00
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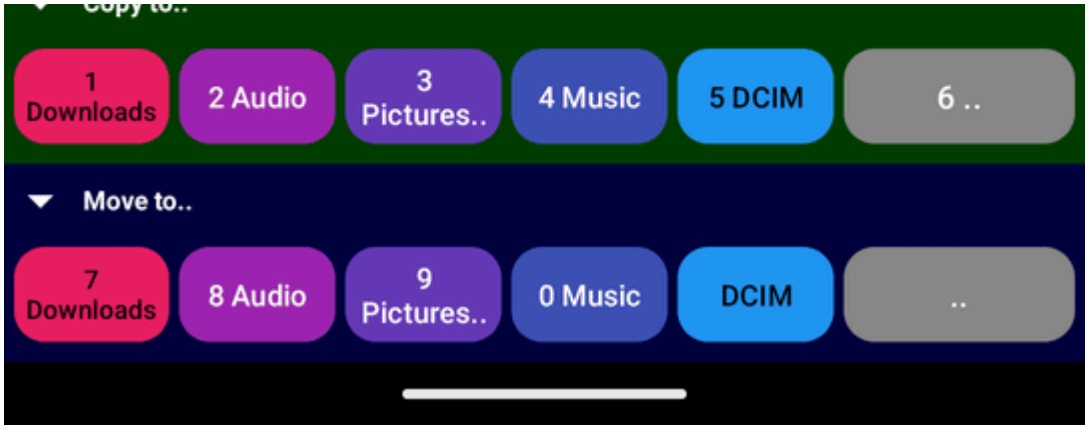
Tip: start small. Two or three well-kept containers give more pleasure, and more food, than a large bed that gets away from you in July.
2. Soil and containers
Good soil is loose, dark and crumbly. Mix garden soil with compost in equal parts for beds, and use a fresh potting mix for containers. Every pot needs drainage holes; standing water rots roots faster than drought dries them.
1 / 4
TXT



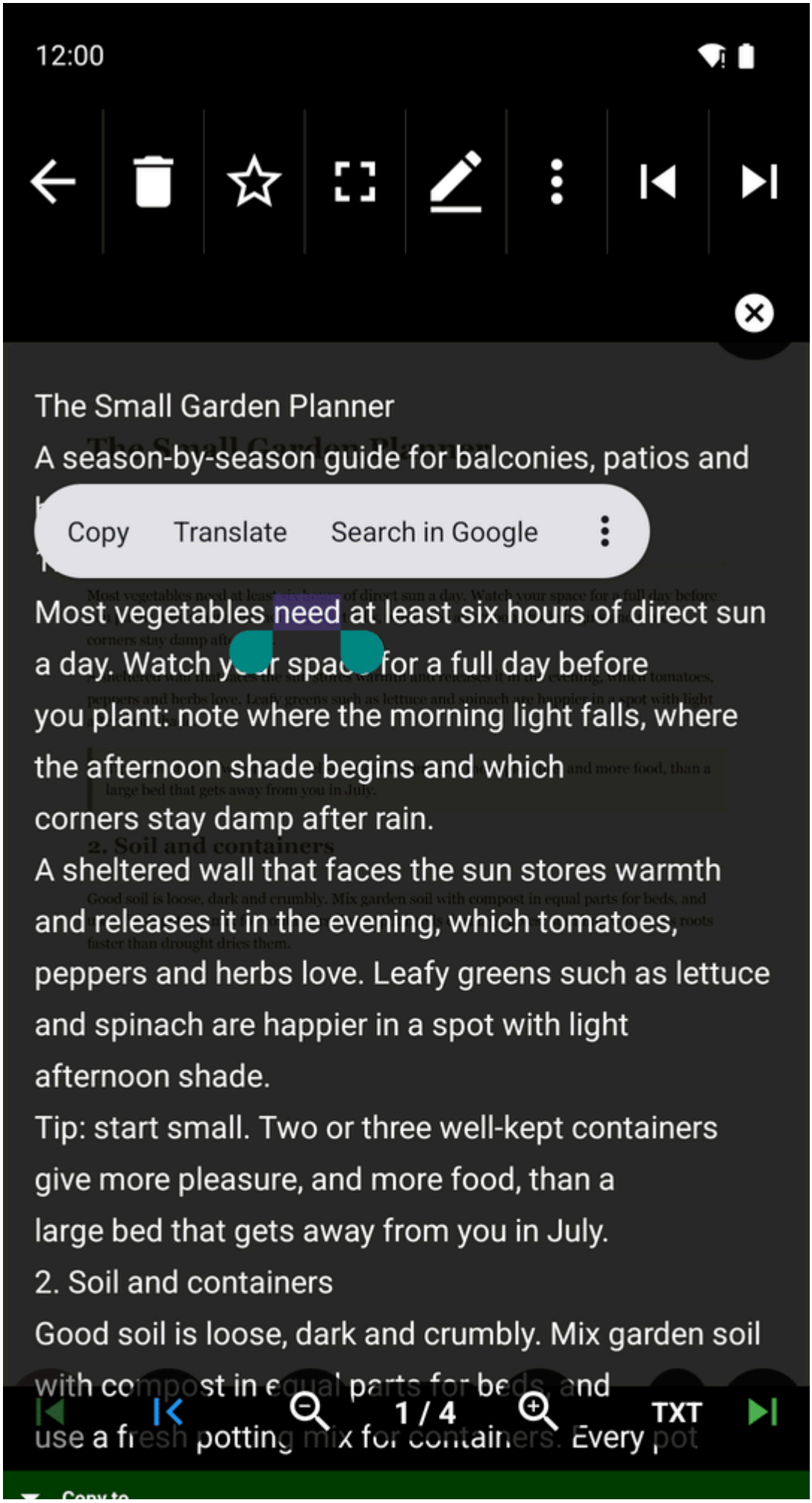
Night colors for reading in the dark.

5 Select and copy text from a page

Touch and hold a word on the page. The text of the page opens in a selection layer with that word already marked; drag the handles to take more, then tap **Copy**. You can also tap the **Text selection** button in the bottom bar to open the same layer without a word marked.

On Android 15 or newer the reader reads the text straight from the PDF, instantly, and marks exactly the word you pressed, even if the same word appears several times on the page. On older Android versions it first recognizes the text on the page (you will see "Extracting text.."), and when a word repeats, the first one on the page is marked – just drag the handles to the one you need.

The selection menu also offers **Translate** and **Read Aloud** for just the marked piece.


12:00
The Small Garden Planner
A season-by-season guide for balconies, patios and
Copy
Translate
Search in Google
Most vegetables need at least six hours of direct sun a day. Watch your space for a full day before you plant: note where the morning light falls, where the afternoon shade begins and which corners stay damp after rain.
A sheltered wall that faces the sun stores warmth and releases it in the evening, which tomatoes, peppers and herbs love. Leafy greens such as lettuce and spinach are happier in a spot with light afternoon shade.
Tip: start small. Two or three well-kept containers give more pleasure, and more food, than a large bed that gets away from you in July.
2. Soil and containers
Good soil is loose, dark and crumbly. Mix garden soil with compost in equal parts for beds, and use a fresh potting mix for containers. Every pot
1 / 4
TXT

Selected text with the selection menu.

A scanned page with no text?

If the page is a photo of paper with no text inside, you will see "No text found on this page". For such pages use text recognition - see recognizing text on pictures.

6 Find a word on the page

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Search** (in landscape the search button sits right on the bar). Type the word. The matches on the current page are highlighted and the counter shows, for example, **2/5**; use the arrows to go from one match to the next.

The search looks only at the page you are on, and it does not care about capital letters. To search a whole book, open it as an EPUB - see reading EPUB books.

7 Open a link from the document

Many PDFs contain web links - a website address, a "read more" line. On Android 15 or newer, tap the link on the page and it opens in your web browser. This works in page mode; switch **Scroll Mode** off first if a link does not react. If the browser cannot open the address, you will see "Could not open that link."

8 Have the page read aloud

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Read Aloud**. Your phone's own speech voice reads the text of the current page. Tap **Read Aloud** again to stop. Reading stops when you leave the reader.

The voice and its language are the ones set in Android: **Settings**, **Accessibility** or **System**, **Text-to-speech output** (the exact place depends on the phone).

9 Translate a page without the internet

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Translate** (in landscape the button is on the bar). After "Translation started.." a card with the translated text appears over the page. Everything happens on the phone itself, so it works offline and the text never leaves the device.

Tap the card to switch it between a small card in the corner and the full screen. The cross on the card closes it. A word translated from the selected text opens in the same card.

If you switch on **Translation result in blocks** in the **On-screen translation** settings, the translation is laid over the original lines instead, and the buttons on the bar make that text smaller or larger. More about languages and options: translating text on screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: translating a PDF page**
PDF page in a foreign language with the offline translation card open in compact size.

10 Save pages as pictures, send a page to Google Lens, or print

- **Save every page as a picture.** Open the three-dots menu, tap **PDF Tools** and then **Export pages as JPG**. After "Exporting pages.." every page is saved as a JPG picture in your **Downloads** folder, inside **FastMediaSorter_Exports** and a folder named after the document - for example `Downloads/FastMediaSorter_Exports/manual/manual_page_1.jpg`. At the end you see how many pages were saved. This works for PDFs in network folders and cloud storage too.
- **Look up a page in Google Lens.** Tap **Google Lens** in the three-dots menu to send the current page to Google Lens, which can find similar pictures, copy the text or translate it. The item is there only when **Allow sending to Google Lens** is switched on in the settings - see sharing and exporting files.
- **Print.** Tap **Print** in the three-dots menu and pick a printer, or save the document as a new PDF. Printing also works in the separate reader window you get from **Open with** in another app, so an e-mail attachment can go to the printer without being saved first.

12:00
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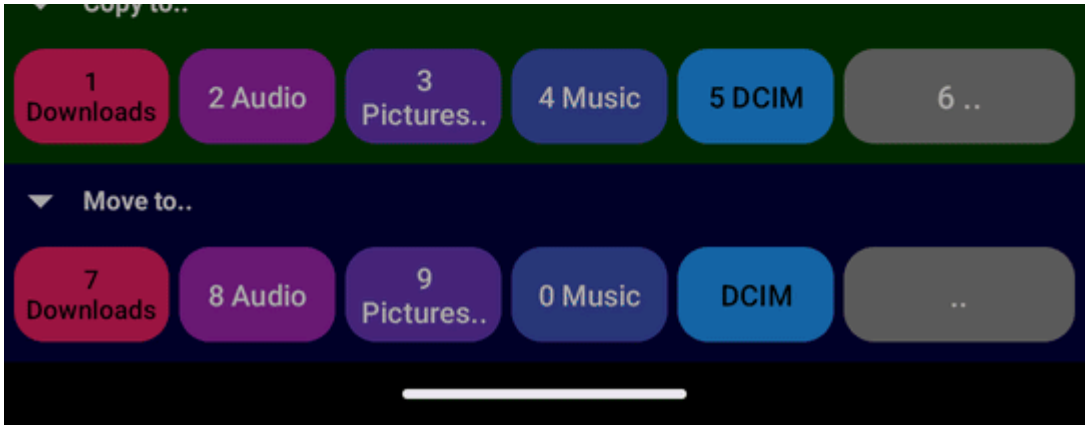
PDF Tools
Export pages as JPG
Cancel
1 / 4
TXT



PDF Tools: save every page as a picture.

What You Get

Your PDFs open in the same app as your photos and videos, right on the page where you stopped. You can read them in comfortable colors, find and copy the words you need, listen to them, understand a document in another language, and turn its pages into pictures or paper when you need to.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Links and text inside a PDF.** In the PDF viewer opened from another app, tap a link in the document to open it, and long-press to select text on the page; in the older viewer, swipe up and down to turn the pages.
- **Paging through many documents from another app?** The separate reader window lets you move from one PDF, book or Office file to the next as long as you like - it cleans up after each document, so it stays quick.
- **Previews for very large PDFs.** Switch on **Large PDF Thumbnails (slow)** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents** to get page pictures for big PDF files in the file browser too. They take a little longer to appear.
- **Copy text from a picture instead of a PDF?** Use recognizing text on pictures.
- **Want the reader to hide PDF files?** Switch off **Support PDF documents** in the **Documents** settings; PDF files then no longer show up in the file browser.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

DOCUMENTS

Reading EPUB books and Office documents

Change the font and colors of a book, jump between chapters and search a whole book.

DOCUMENTS

Built-in text and Markdown editor

Read and edit notes, lists and other text files right in the app.

TOOLS

Translating text on screen

Choose languages and the look of offline translation.

DOCUMENTS & TEXT EDITOR | Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #02

Reading EPUB Books and Office Documents

Read EPUB books with the font, size, colors and margins you like, jump between chapters, search a whole book, listen to it or translate it - and open Word, Excel and PowerPoint files with one tap, in the way your edition offers.

Why You'll Love This

E-books from a library or a bookshop often come as EPUB files, and letters, reports and presentations as Word, Excel or PowerPoint files. FastMediaSorter keeps them next to your photos and music: tap a book and it opens in the built-in reader, set up the way you like to read - large letters, a dark page at night, wide or narrow margins.

For Office files the app picks the best way your edition offers: it either shows the document itself or passes it to an office app you already have.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in an edition with the reader: Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR or FOSS. The Lite and Photos editions do not open documents.
- An EPUB book without copy protection. Books locked by a shop's copy protection (DRM) open only in that shop's app.
- **Support EPUB e-books** and **Support Office documents** switched on in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents**.
- For Office files in Standard, Legacy and VR: an office app installed on the phone.
- For translation: an edition with translation (all of the above except FOSS) and **Enable Translation** switched on in **Settings**.

1 Open a book

In the file browser tap the EPUB file. EPUB books show their cover in the file browser, so a shelf of books is easy to recognize. The book opens in the reader at the chapter where you stopped last time.

Books from a network folder or cloud storage are downloaded first and then open the same way. To collect all your books, PDFs and notes in one list, add the All Documents resource on the main screen.

If a book is protected, you will see "This file is protected and cannot be opened inside the app." – open it in the app of the shop you bought it from.

A picture missing from the book, or one that cannot be read, shows as a picture sign with the book's own description of it instead of a broken box.

Chapter 1. Winter: The Long Nights

The lamp was lit at four in the afternoon in December, and it burned until nearly nine the next morning. Tom climbed the hundred and twelve steps three times a night to trim the wick and wind the clockwork that turned the great lens. Between the climbs he sat by the stove in the little kitchen and listened to the sea. On the calmest nights he could hear the bell buoy two miles out, a slow, patient note that seemed to keep time with the beam sweeping over the water. He wrote the weather in the log every four hours: wind, sea, visibility, and the ships he saw. Most nights there were none.

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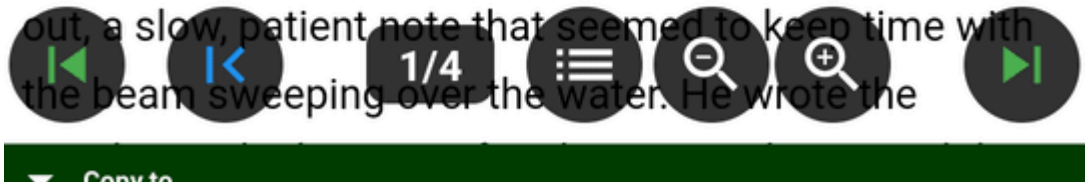


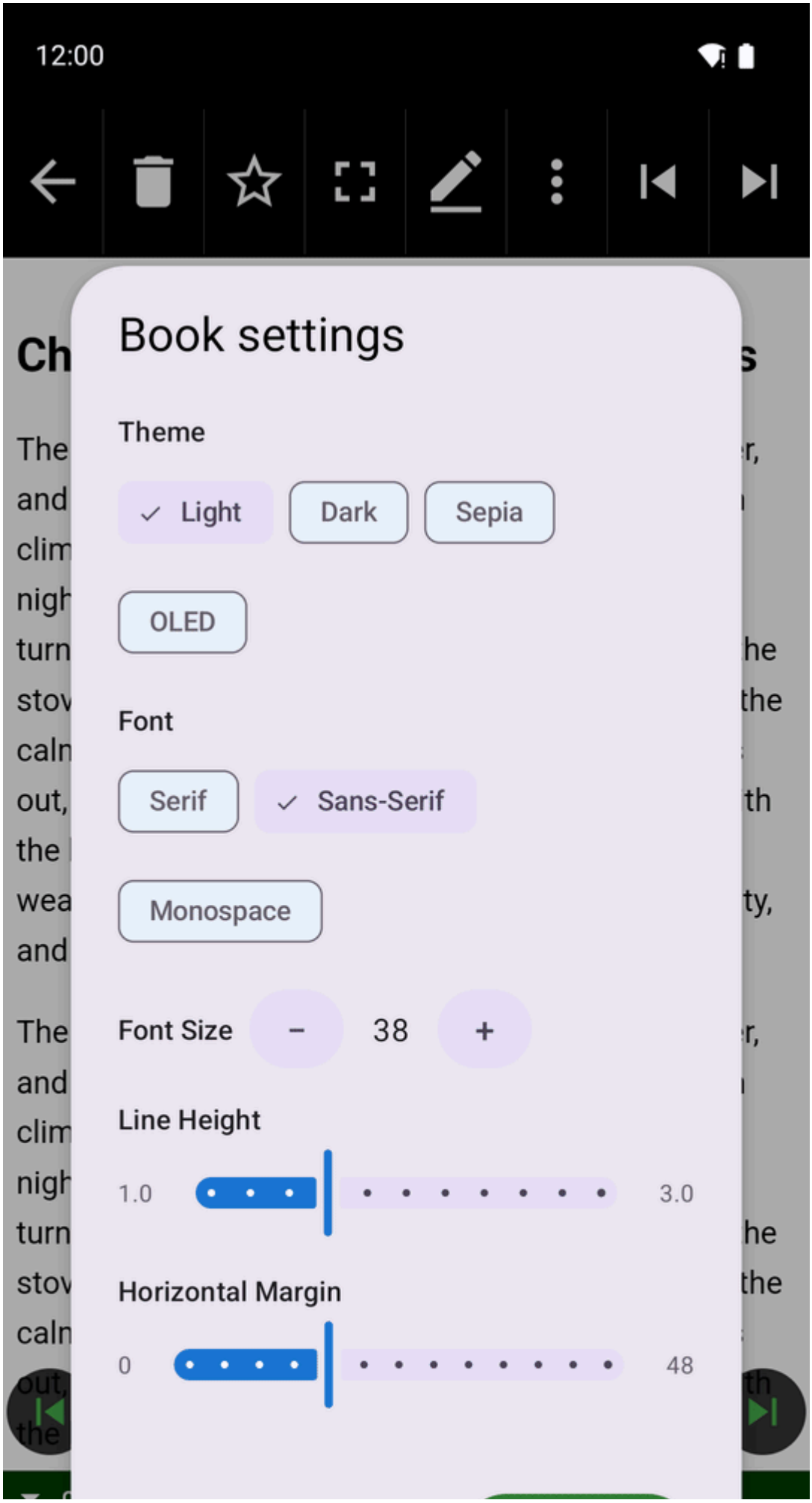
An EPUB book in the reader.

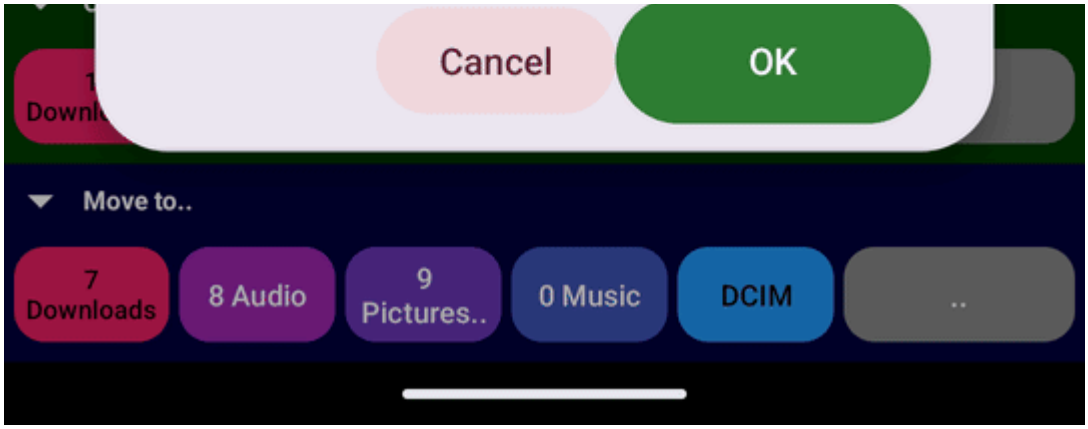
2 Make the page comfortable to read

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Reader Settings**. The window has everything that changes how the text looks:

- **Theme** - **Light**, **Dark**, **Sepia** (warm paper tone) or **OLED** (pure black, which saves battery on phones with an OLED screen).
- **Font** - **Serif** (letters with small feet, like a printed book), **Sans-Serif** (plain letters) or **Monospace** (every letter the same width).
- **Font Size** - tap **–** and **+** to make the letters smaller or larger, in small steps, from tiny to very large.
- **Line Height** - move the slider to put more or less space between lines, from tight (1.0) to very airy (3.0).
- **Horizontal Margin** - move the slider to widen or narrow the empty border at the left and right of the text.

  You see the change on the page at once. The reader keeps your settings for every book.


12:00
Book settings
Theme
Light
Dark
Sepia
OLED
Font
Serif
Sans-Serif
Monospace
Font Size
38
Line Height
1.0
3.0
Horizontal Margin
0
48



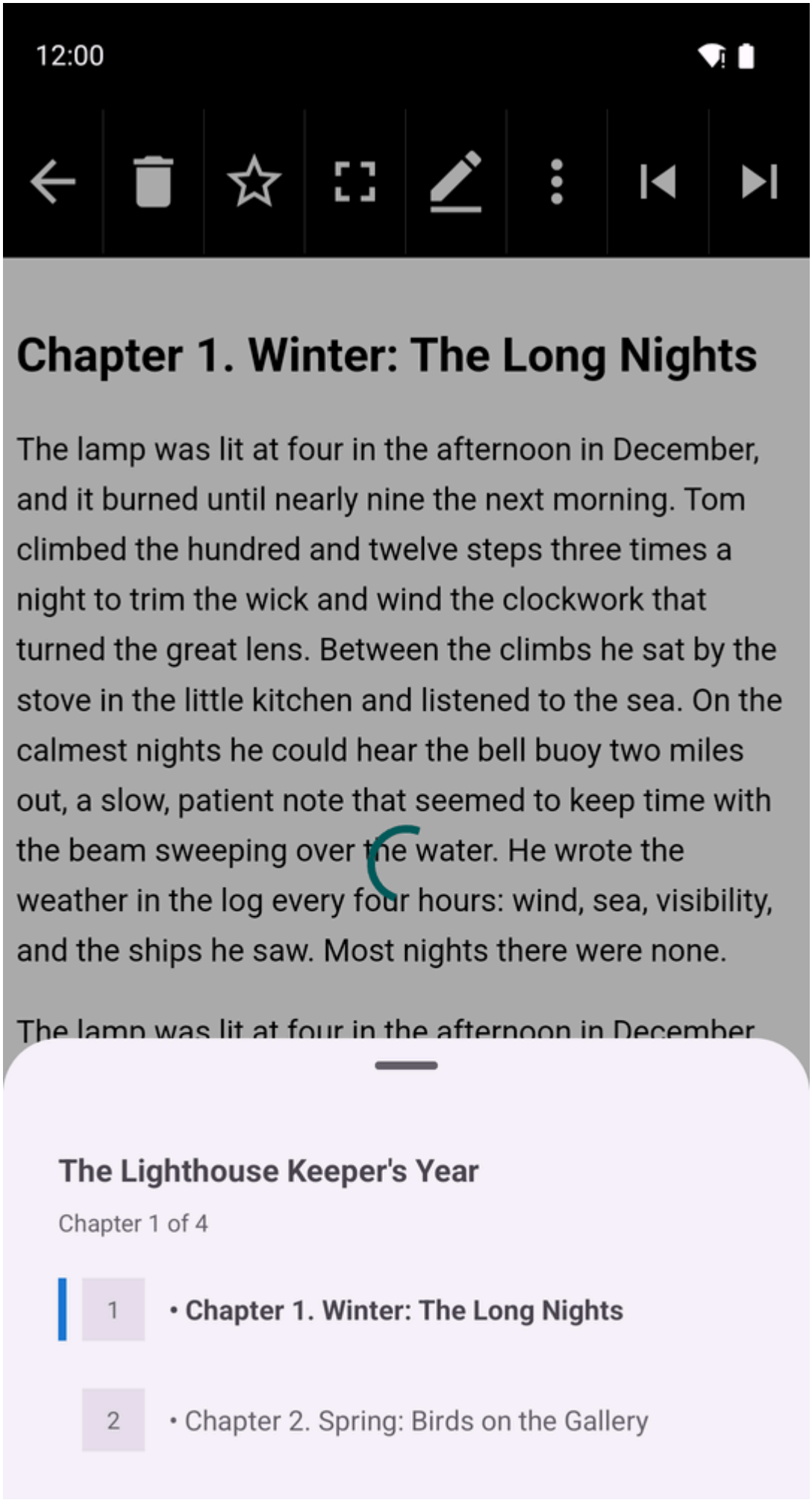
Reader Settings: theme, font, size, line height and margins.

3 Move between chapters

Scroll down to read a chapter. At its end tap **Next chapter** at the bottom of the screen, or swipe to the side; **Previous chapter** takes you back. A book with only one chapter shows no chapter buttons.

To jump further, open the three-dots menu and tap **Table of Contents**. A list of all chapters slides up - tap one to open it. If the book has no table of contents of its own, the list shows its chapters in order.

When you come back to the book later, it opens on the chapter you were reading.


12:00
Chapter 1. Winter: The Long Nights
The lamp was lit at four in the afternoon in December, and it burned until nearly nine the next morning. Tom climbed the hundred and twelve steps three times a night to trim the wick and wind the clockwork that turned the great lens. Between the climbs he sat by the stove in the little kitchen and listened to the sea. On the calmest nights he could hear the bell buoy two miles out, a slow, patient note that seemed to keep time with the beam sweeping over the water. He wrote the weather in the log every four hours: wind, sea, visibility, and the ships he saw. Most nights there were none.
The lamp was lit at four in the afternoon in December
The Lighthouse Keeper's Year
Chapter 1 of 4
1
• Chapter 1. Winter: The Long Nights
2
• Chapter 2. Spring: Birds on the Gallery

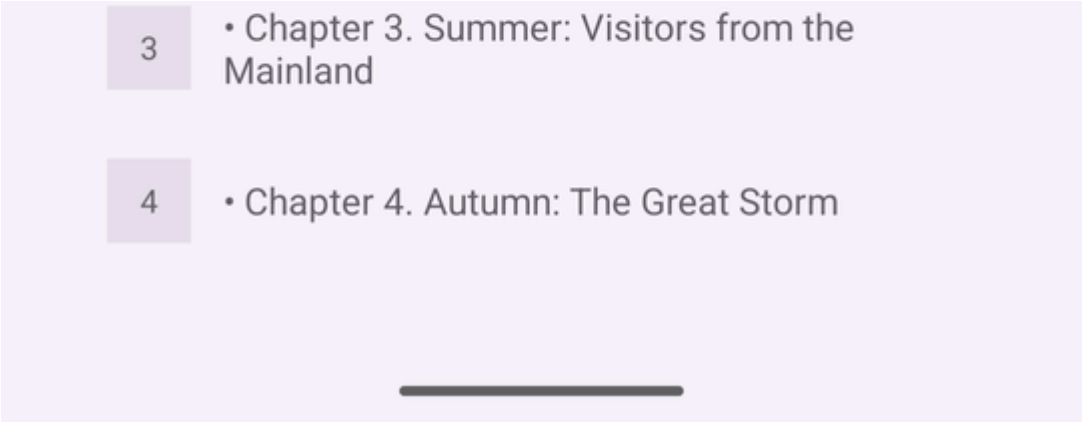


Table of Contents: tap a chapter to open it.

4 Search the chapter or the whole book

- **In this chapter** - tap **Search** on the bar and type a word. The matches on the page are highlighted and you can step from one to the next.
- **In the whole book** - open the three-dots menu and tap **Search All Chapters**. Type a word; after "Searching.." you see how many results were found and in how many chapters, each with a short piece of the text around it. Tap a result to open that chapter with the word highlighted.
  A search in the whole book lists up to 500 results - for a very common word, add a second word to narrow it down.

5 Select text, listen to a chapter, or translate it

Touch and hold a word to select it and drag the handles to select more. The selection menu lets you **Copy** the text, **Read Aloud** just that piece, **Translate** it, or open it in the calculator to work out a sum written in the text.

To listen to the whole chapter, open the three-dots menu and tap **Read Aloud**; your phone's own speech voice reads the chapter. Tap **Read Aloud** again to stop.

To read a chapter in your language, tap **Translate** in the three-dots menu. The translation appears in a panel over the text and is made on the phone itself, without the internet. The panel has its own text size, separate from the book's. See translating text on screen for languages and options.

6 Open a Word, Excel or PowerPoint file

Office files show a **DOC** badge in the file browser instead of a preview. What happens when you tap one depends on your edition:

- **Standard, Legacy and VR** - Word and text-document files (`.doc`, `.docx`, `.rtf`, `.odt`) are recognized as documents. Tap one and FastMediaSorter passes it to an office app on your phone, such as Word or Google Docs. If no such app is installed, you see "No app available to open this file" - install any office app from the Play Store and try again.
- **noLegal** - available only in the sideload version (see the noLegal edition). It also recognizes Excel and PowerPoint files and their OpenDocument cousins (`.xlsx`, `.xls`, `.pptx`, `.ppt`, `.ods`, `.odp`), and it shows `.docx`, `.xlsx`, `.pptx`, `.odt`, `.ods`, `.odp` and `.rtf` files right inside the app as a read-only preview. The preview shows the text, tables and slides in a simple form - it is for reading, not for exact print layout. Older `.doc`, `.xls` and `.ppt` files open the window **This document can't be shown here**: choose **Open in another app** or **Share**.
- **FOSS** - Office files are not recognized; open them from another file manager.

While a document is open in the reader, **Text Settings** in the three-dots menu opens the options for text recognition and translation, the same as for PDFs and books.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Office preview**
noLegal debug build, a two-page DOCX with a heading and a table open in the internal Office preview.

Why the editions differ

The Google Play editions have no built-in office engine and pass Office files to an app that does this job well. The sideload noLegal edition carries a small preview of its own. Compare the editions in editions compared.

What You Get

Your books open on the chapter where you stopped, in the letters, colors and spacing that suit your eyes. You can find any word in a whole book, listen to a chapter on the go and read a foreign book in your own language. Office files open with one tap - in the app itself or in your favorite office app.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Reading in bed?** The **OLED** theme with a larger **Font Size** is the gentlest on the eyes in the dark.
- **Hide the formats you do not use.** Switch off **Support EPUB e-books** or **Support Office documents** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents**, and those files disappear from the file browser.
- **Opening books from another app?** Choose FastMediaSorter in the **Open with** list; the book opens in a separate reader window. You can move from one book, PDF or Office file to the next there as long as you like.
- **Need to write rather than read?** Text and Markdown files open in an editor - see the text and Markdown editor.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

DOCUMENTS

Reading PDF documents

Turn pages, read at night, search, copy, translate and export PDF pages.

DOCUMENTS

Built-in text and Markdown editor

Read and edit notes, lists and other text files right in the app.

EDITIONS

Editions compared

See which edition opens which kinds of files.

DOCUMENTS & TEXT EDITOR | Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR and FOSS | RECIPE #03

Built-in Text and Markdown Editor

Read text, Markdown and log files comfortably, fix them on the spot, find and replace words, create new text notes in any folder, and pass the text on to Google Keep, the calculator, a speech voice or a translator - without a separate editor app.

Why You'll Love This

A shopping list, a note with a Wi-Fi password, a README from a download, a log file from a router - plain text files are everywhere. In FastMediaSorter you can open them with one tap, read them comfortably and fix a line or two without looking for another app.

The same place is a small notebook: create a text note right in a folder, write it, save it - on the phone, on your home computer or in the cloud.

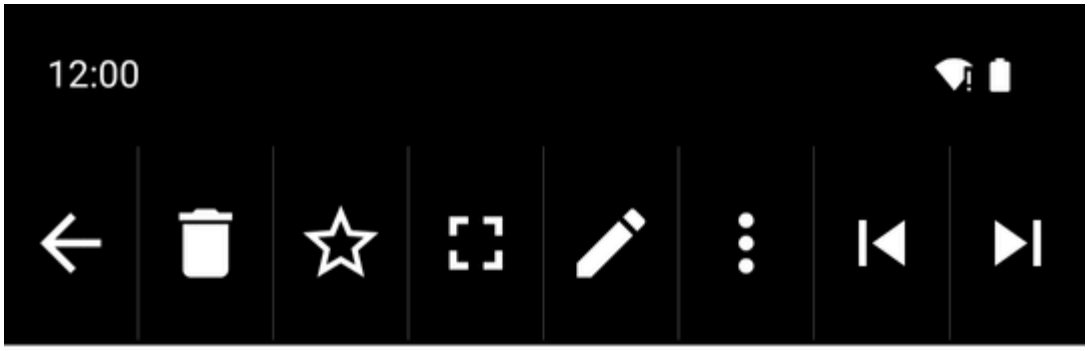
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in an edition with reader: Standard, noLegal, Legacy, VR or FOSS. The Lite and Photos editions do not open text files.
- **Support text files (.txt, .md, .log, .json, .xml)** switched on in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents**.
- A text file up to 100 MB: `.txt`, `.md`, `.log`, `.json`, `.xml`, `.csv`, `.conf`, `.ini`, `.properties`, `.yml` or `.yaml` - on this device, in a network folder or in cloud storage.
- To change a file: a folder you are allowed to write to.
- For translation: an edition with translation (all of the above except FOSS) and **Enable Translation** switched on in **Settings**. For **Send to Keep**: the Google Keep app.

1 Open a text file

In the file browser tap the text file. It opens in the reader as plain, easy-to-read text. A very long file is shown in parts: swipe up and down on the text to go to the next or the previous part.

Text files from other apps open too: choose FastMediaSorter in the **Open with** list, and the file opens in a separate window with the same tools. A file handed over by another app can be read there, but only a file stored in an ordinary folder you can write to can also be changed.

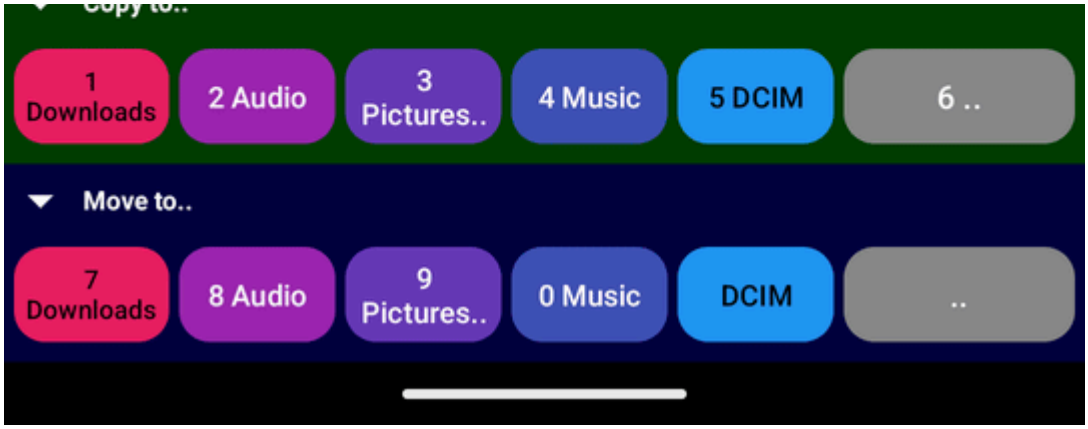


Weekend shopping list

Market
- tomatoes, 1 kg
- fresh basil
- two lemons
- olive oil
- sourdough bread

Hardware store
- garden twine
- a watering can with a fine rose
- seed trays (6)
- compost, 20 l bag

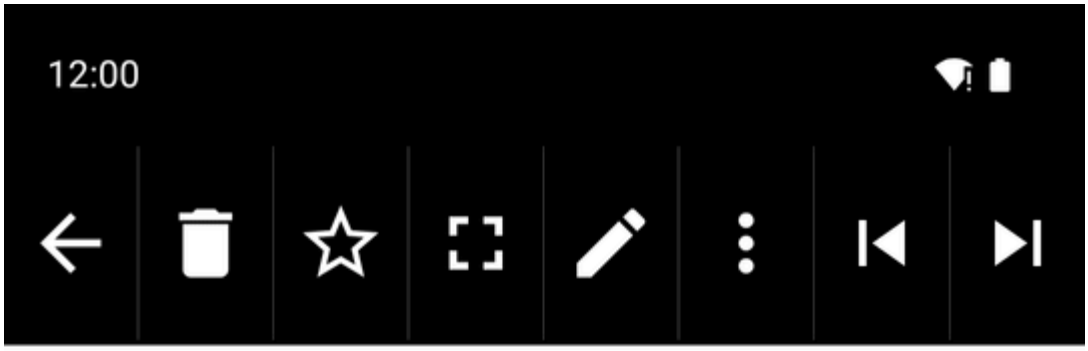
Remember: the market closes at 1 pm on Saturday.
Bring the canvas bags.



A text file in the reader.

2 Make it easy to read

- **Letter size** - swipe left or right across the text to make the letters smaller or larger.
- **Colors** - open the three-dots menu, tap **Reader Settings** and pick **Light**, **Dark** or **Sepia**. Until you pick one, the text follows the app's own theme.
- **Markdown** - a `.md` file is shown nicely formatted: headings, bold text, lists and links. Tap **Toggle Markdown** in the three-dots menu to see the plain source and tap it again to go back. JSON and XML files get colored keys and values so they are easier to follow.
- **Line numbers** - switch on **Number lines** in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, **Documents** to see a number in front of every line - handy when someone says "look at line 42".
- **Strange letters?** If the text shows question marks or odd symbols instead of letters, the file was saved in a different encoding. Open the three-dots menu, tap **Re-open with Encoding..** and choose another one in the **Select Encoding** window - for old Russian or Ukrainian text, for example, try **Windows-1251 (Cyrillic)** or **KOI8-R (Russian)**; there are also choices for Western, Japanese, Chinese and Korean text. The app guesses the right encoding by itself in most cases.



Weekend in the Mountains

A short plan for **two days** of easy hiking and good food.

Saturday

- Leave home at **7:30**, coffee on the way
- Park at the lower station and take the cable car
- Lake trail, about *two hours* at a relaxed pace
- Lunch at the mountain hut

Sunday

- Sunrise from the viewpoint above the village
- Short loop through the pine forest
- Drive back after lunch

Pack

- Rain jacket and a warm layer
- Water bottle, sun cream, hat
- **Map** - the phone signal is weak up there

A Markdown file shown formatted.

⚠ Very long files are read-only

A file that the reader shows in several parts cannot be edited - you will see "Editing is not available for files with multiple pages". Short and medium files, which is almost every note, can be edited.

3 Edit a file and save it

Tap **Edit** (the pencil) in the bottom bar. The text becomes editable and the keyboard opens. While you type, the line and column of the cursor are shown, for example **Ln 12, Col 5**.

When you are done, tap one of the buttons of the editor:

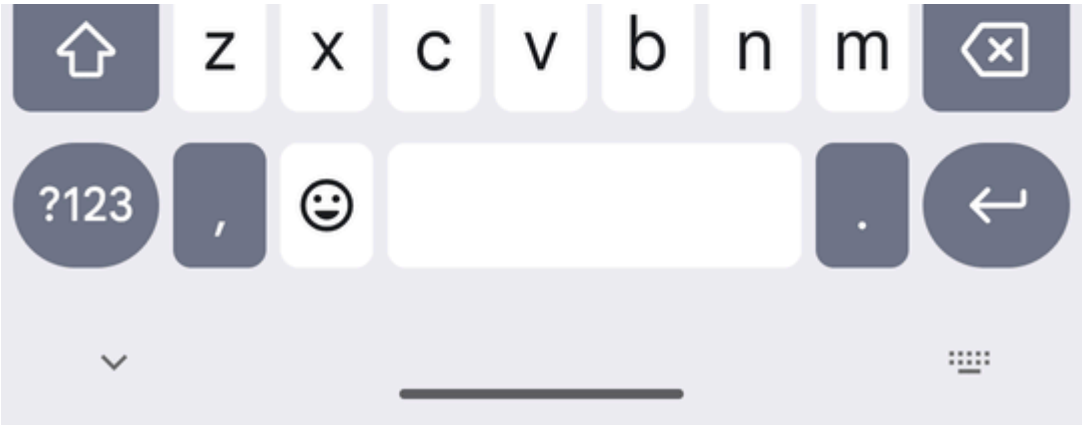
- **Save** - saves the changes and keeps the editor open.
- **Save & close** - saves and goes back to reading.
- **Save & send** - saves and opens the send menu, so you can pass the file to another app or person.
- **Cancel** - leaves the editor without saving.

  Before saving, the **Save note** window shows the **File name**, so you can keep it or give the file a new name. A file in a network folder or cloud storage is saved on the phone first and then uploaded back; if the upload fails, you see "Saved on this device, but couldn't upload the file back to the server." and your text is not lost.

```
Weekend shopping list

Market
- tomatoes, 1 kg
- fresh basil
- two lemons
- olive oil
- sourdough bread

Hardware store
- garden twine
- a watering can with a
fine rose
- seed trays (6)
```



Editing a text file.

4 Undo mistakes, find and replace words

- **Undo** and **Redo** in the editor bar take your last changes back or bring them again - up to 50 steps.
- **Find** looks for a word in the text: type it in the **Find..** field, and the counter shows, for example, **2 / 7**; use the arrows to go from one match to the next. Capital letters do not matter.
- **Find and Replace** adds a **Replace with..** field: tap **Replace** to change the current match or **Replace All** to change every one at once. You then see how many places were replaced.
  If a word is not in the text, you see "No results. The search came back empty-handed."

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Find and Replace**
Find and Replace panel open in edit mode, query found 3 times, counter "1 / 3".

5 Do not lose your text

While you edit, the app quietly keeps a draft of your text every 15 seconds when something has changed. If the app is closed before you save - the battery runs out, a call comes in, Android closes the app in the background - open the same file and tap **Edit** again: you see "Draft restored. Tap Save to keep changes." Tap **Save** to keep what you had written.

The draft is only a safety net. Leaving with **Cancel** or the back button does not ask for confirmation, so save before you leave.

6 Create a new text note

Open the folder where the note should live, open the three-dots menu of the file browser and tap **Create text note**. On a wide screen the button is right on the bar. An empty note opens straight in the editor.

Write your text and tap **Save**. The suggested file name is the date and time, for example `26-09-24_15-30.txt`; change it if you like. If you leave out the ending, `.txt` is added for you. The file appears in the folder only when you save it for the first time.

Notes can be created in any folder you may write to - on the phone, in a network folder or in cloud storage. In the All Documents list a new note goes into the phone's **Documents** folder. If the folder cannot take a new file, you see "Couldn't create the note here. Please try a different folder."

7 Send the text to Keep, calculate, listen or translate

- **Send to Keep** - in the editor, this button sends the text to Google Keep as a new note, so you have it on all your devices. It is shown only when Google Keep is installed.
- **Calculator** - in the editor, select a sum written in the text, for example `12*7+5`, and tap **Calculator** in the selection menu. The calculator opens with it; the result is put back into the text where the cursor was.
- **Read Aloud** - in the reader, tap **Read Aloud** in the three-dots menu, and your phone's speech voice reads the part of the text on the screen. Tap it again to stop. You can also select a piece of text and choose **Read Aloud** from the selection menu.
- **Translate** - in the reader, tap the **Translate** button to see the text in your language in a side panel, made on the phone without the internet. Swipe left or right on the panel to change its letter size. Selected text can be translated from the selection menu too. More in translating text on screen.

What You Get

Any text file opens with one tap and reads comfortably - in large letters, dark colors, with formatting or with line numbers. You can fix it on the spot, find and replace words, start new notes in any folder, and send the text on to Keep, the calculator, a voice or a translator.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Keep a copy of important files.** Saving replaces the old text. To keep the original, copy the file first - see copying, moving and deleting files.
- **Working with notes on your computer?** Create and edit them in a network folder on your home computer - see Windows network shares.
- **Need a PDF instead?** See reading PDF documents.
- **Only want to read, never edit?** Just do not tap **Edit** - nothing in the file changes while you read, swipe or search.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

DOCUMENTS

Reading PDF documents

Turn pages, read at night, search, copy, translate and export PDF pages.

DOCUMENTS

Reading EPUB books and Office documents

Read books in your favorite font and colors, and open Office files.

PROGRAMS

Built-in programs

The calculator and the other small tools that come with the app.

Streams: Channel Catalog

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #01

Browsing the Channel Catalog

The catalog is how Streams goes from empty to thousands of channels worth browsing: download it, keep it fresh, then find your way around with filters, curated collections, sorting and a list that remembers exactly where you left it.

Why You'll Love This

A hand-typed list of radio stations is fine when you have three of them. FastMediaSorter's built-in catalog can hand you thousands of channels at once - curated stations, community radio, public webcams - and a list that size is only useful if you can bring in what you want, tell it apart from what you do not, and find your way back to the same view every time you open Streams.

This page covers the catalog end to end: getting it onto the device, keeping it fresh, and browsing what is in it with filters, collections and sorting. It stops short of what each channel actually looks like on screen and how you pin your favorites - those are their own pages, linked below.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

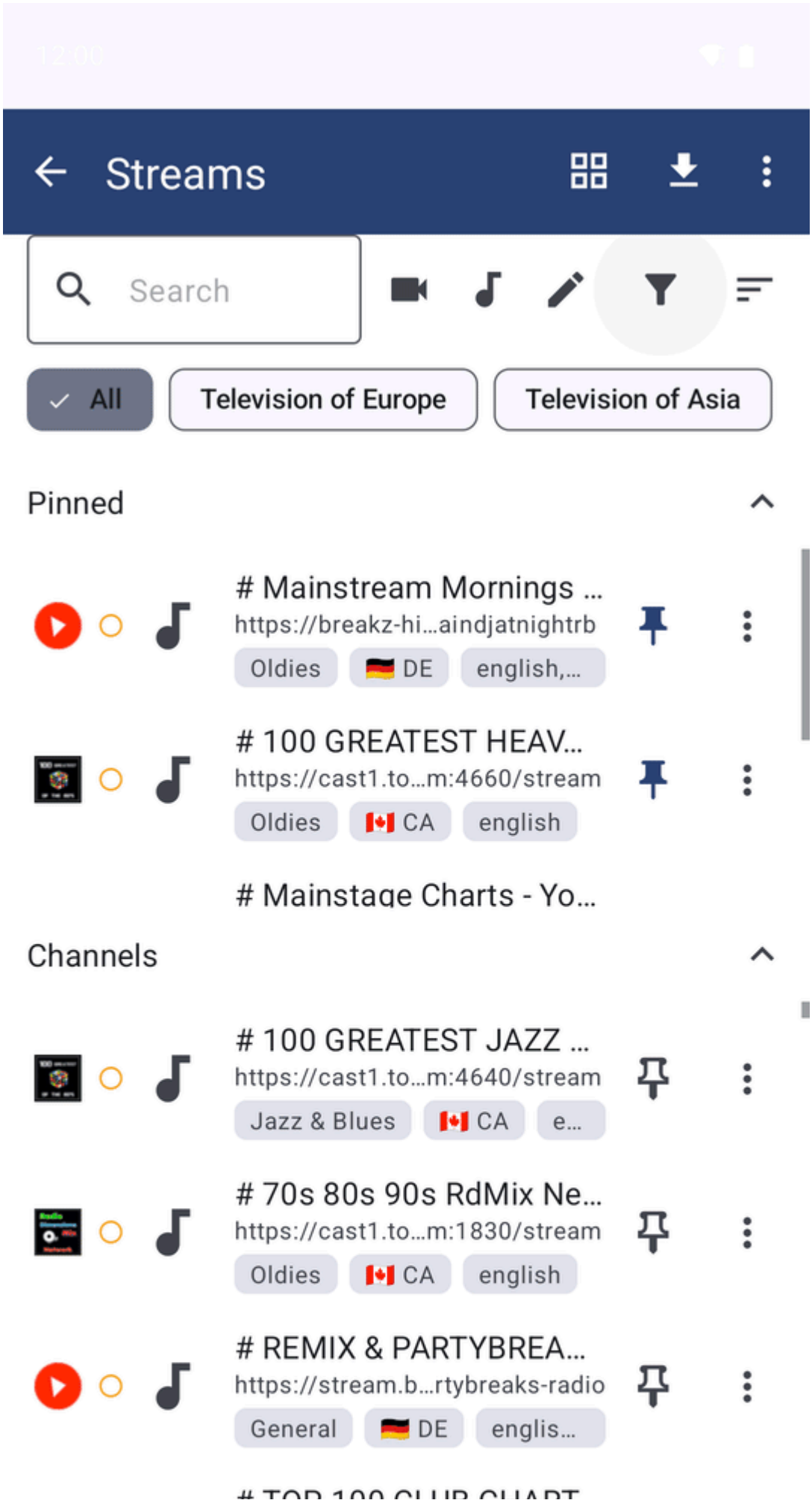
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition, with Streams turned on. Streams and its catalog do not exist in the Lite, Photos or FOSS editions.
- An internet connection to bring the catalog in the first place. Once channels are on the device, browsing, filtering and sorting all work from what is already there.
- A few channels in the list already - your own, or from the catalog - so there is something to filter, sort and manage. See step 1 if the list is still empty.

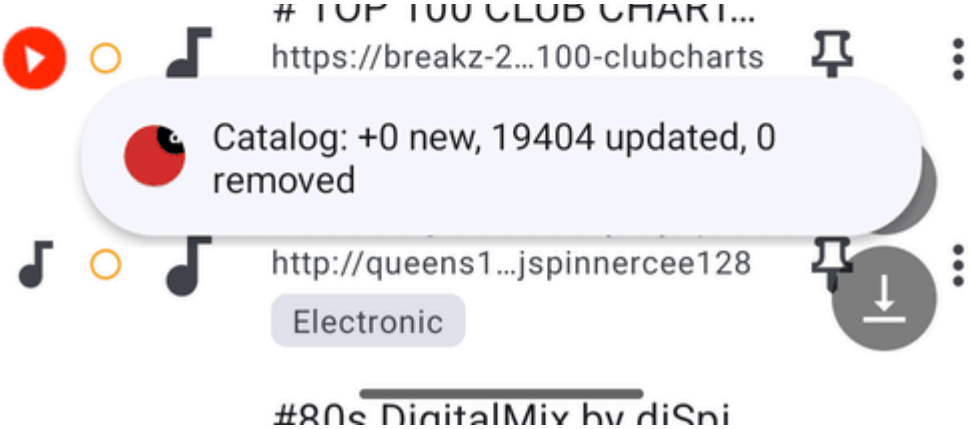
1 Turn Streams on and bring in the catalog

Turn Streams on in **Settings**, the **Media** tab, the **Streams** toggle. A device profile can do this for you too: switching Streams on during the first-launch wizard starts the catalog download by itself, showing **Downloading..** under the row while it works. Turning the row back off mid-download cancels it, and opening a device that already has a catalog stored does not download anything extra.

Once Streams is on, **Update catalog** sits directly in the toolbar - no overflow menu to hunt through. Tap it and FastMediaSorter reports what changed, something like "Catalog: +48 new, 12 updated, 3 removed". If a catalog source turns out to be dead or painfully slow, the import now fails fast with a clear message instead of leaving the spinner turning.

Left the list for a while? A banner offers **Update the channel list?** with an **Update** button, and it clears itself once you act on it. Decide how eager that banner should be in **Settings**, the **Streams** section, **Updating the channel list**: **Only when I ask**, **Suggest when I open**, or **Automatically on Wi-Fi**.


Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...



Update catalog, right there in the toolbar.

2 What is actually in the catalog

The catalog is more than one curated list. Alongside FastMediaSorter's own picks, it folds in private community radio and public webcams from open, keyless directories - laut.fm, the Xiph Icecast directory, WebRadioDB, Radio Paradise, iptv-org's weather and nature cams, AKC live cams, and Transport for London traffic cameras, the last marked as short clips rather than live streams.

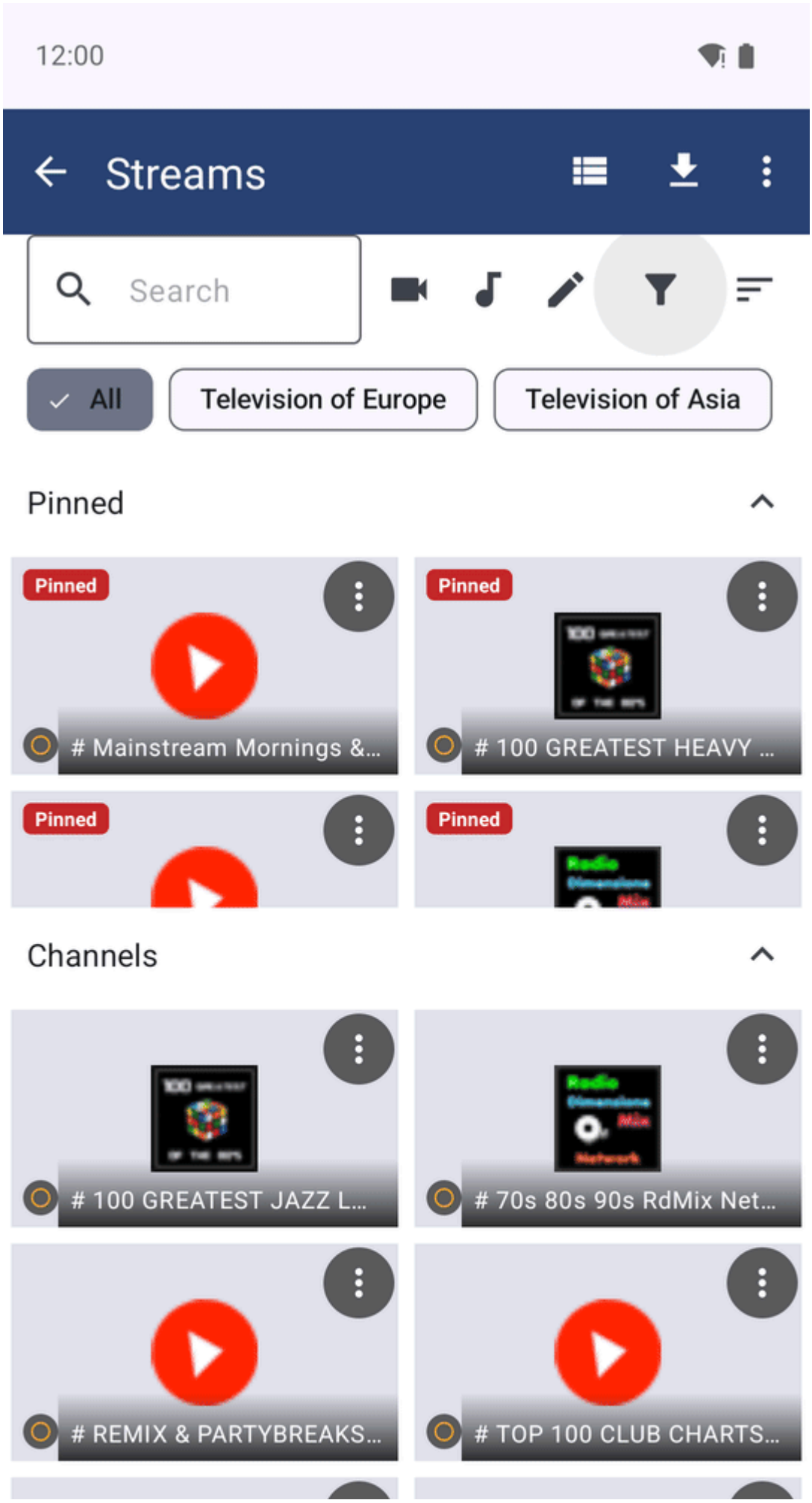
Every name has been cleaned up at the source. Entries that used to show as "(null)", a bare dash, raw HTML codes instead of accented letters, or hundreds of stations all called "Online Radio" now arrive readable, with a nameless station listed by its own address instead. Nothing was dropped to get there - the only rows that left were exact duplicates, the same station filed once under http and once under https. A title of the form "Name (Name)" also collapses to plain "Name"; a parenthetical that actually says something different, such as a region or a quality, stays as it is.

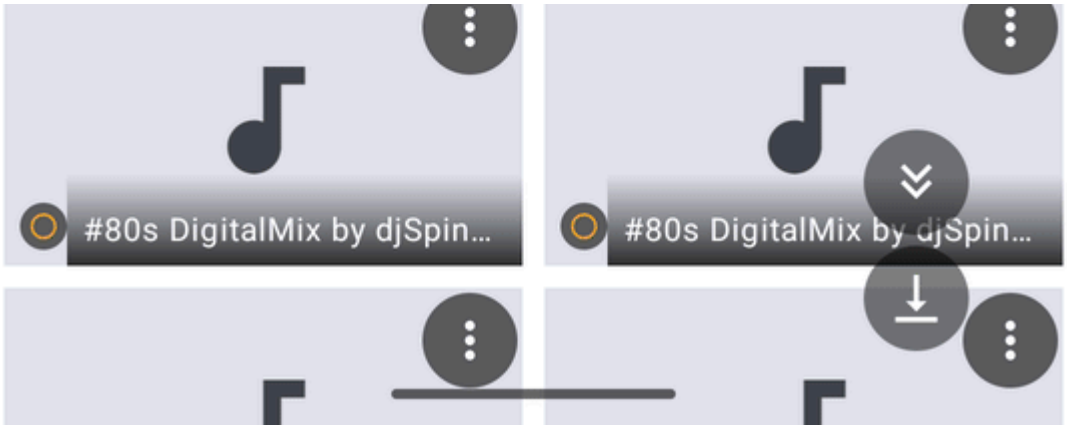
Every channel carries one of 31 rubrics instead of a loose, free-text topic, shown in whichever language the interface is running in - things like News, Jazz & Blues or Webcam. Sorting by rubric follows the alphabet of that language.

3 Grid tiles or a scrolling list

Switch the whole catalog between grid view, a picture tile for every channel, and list view, one line per channel with more room for text - the same **Grid view / List view** toggle you already know from Browse. In landscape, list view grows extra columns on its own and works the count out again whenever you rotate the device.

What each tile or row actually shows - a live frame, a logo, a flag or a plain icon - is its own page: see Channel pictures, logos and badges.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings &...
Pinned
100 GREATEST HEAVY ...
Pinned
Pinned
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ L...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Net...
REMIX & PARTYBREAKS...
TOP 100 CLUB CHARTS...

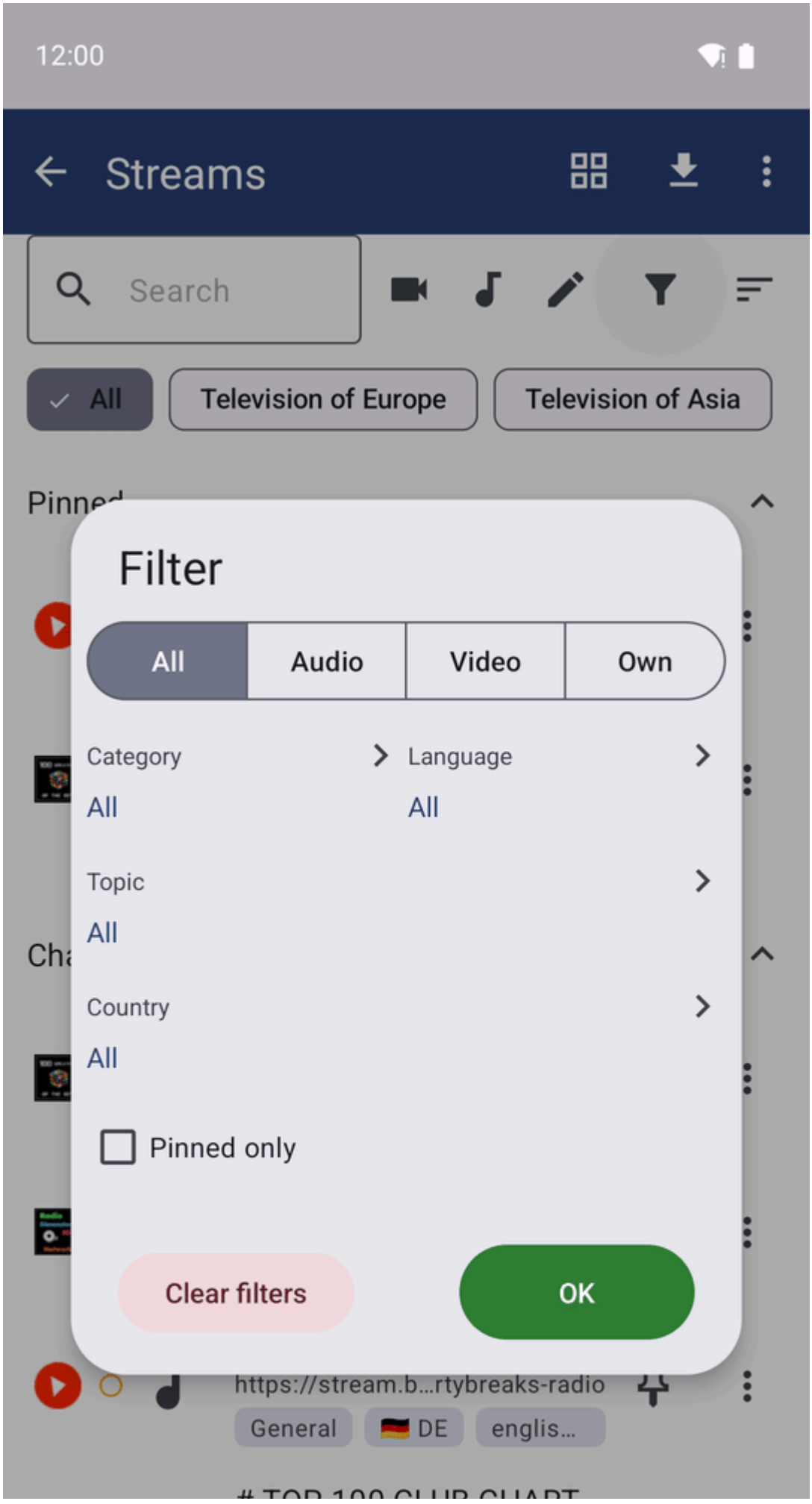


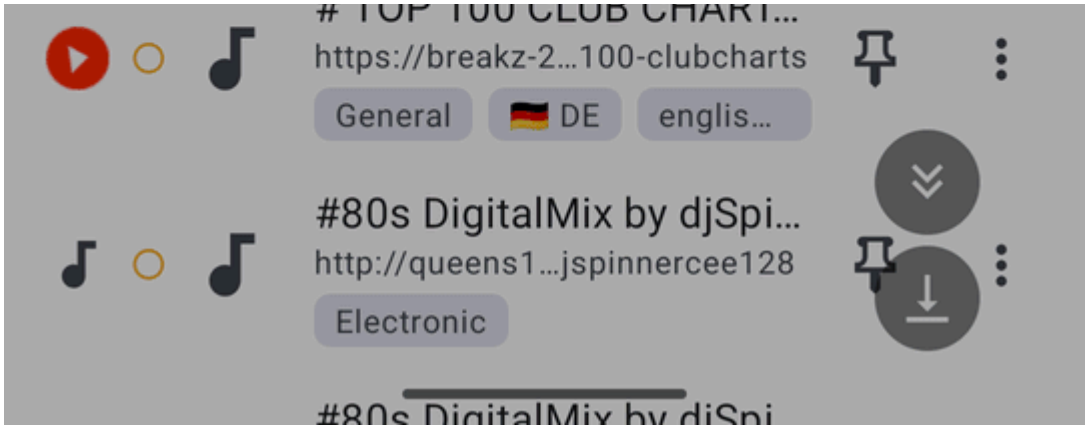
The channel catalog in grid view.

4 Narrow it down with filters

Tap **Filter** to open rows for **Category**, **Language**, **Country** and **Topic** - Topic only shows up when the catalog actually carries topics. Language and Country open a type-to-filter searchable picker with flags: the language picker pins English, Russian and Ukrainian to the top, and a country's flag-and-code chip sits before its language chip in the list. The Language list holds only real languages, one entry each however the catalog spells them - regional variants and typos fold into one. The Country list holds only real countries, by full name with a flag, in alphabetical order, with the countries of your interface language first. A filter you saved earlier whose value no longer exists goes back to **All**.

Two small icons beside the search box split the list by media kind in one tap - **Audio**, **Video**, or **Own** for channels you added yourself - and agree with whatever the Filter dialog already has selected. The filter button carries a **Filter active** mark when something is on; **Clear filters** in the dialog drops it all at once.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Filter
All
Audio
Video
Own
Category
All
Language
All
Topic
All
Country
All
Pinned only
Clear filters
OK
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...



The filter dialog - category, language, country, topic and media kind.

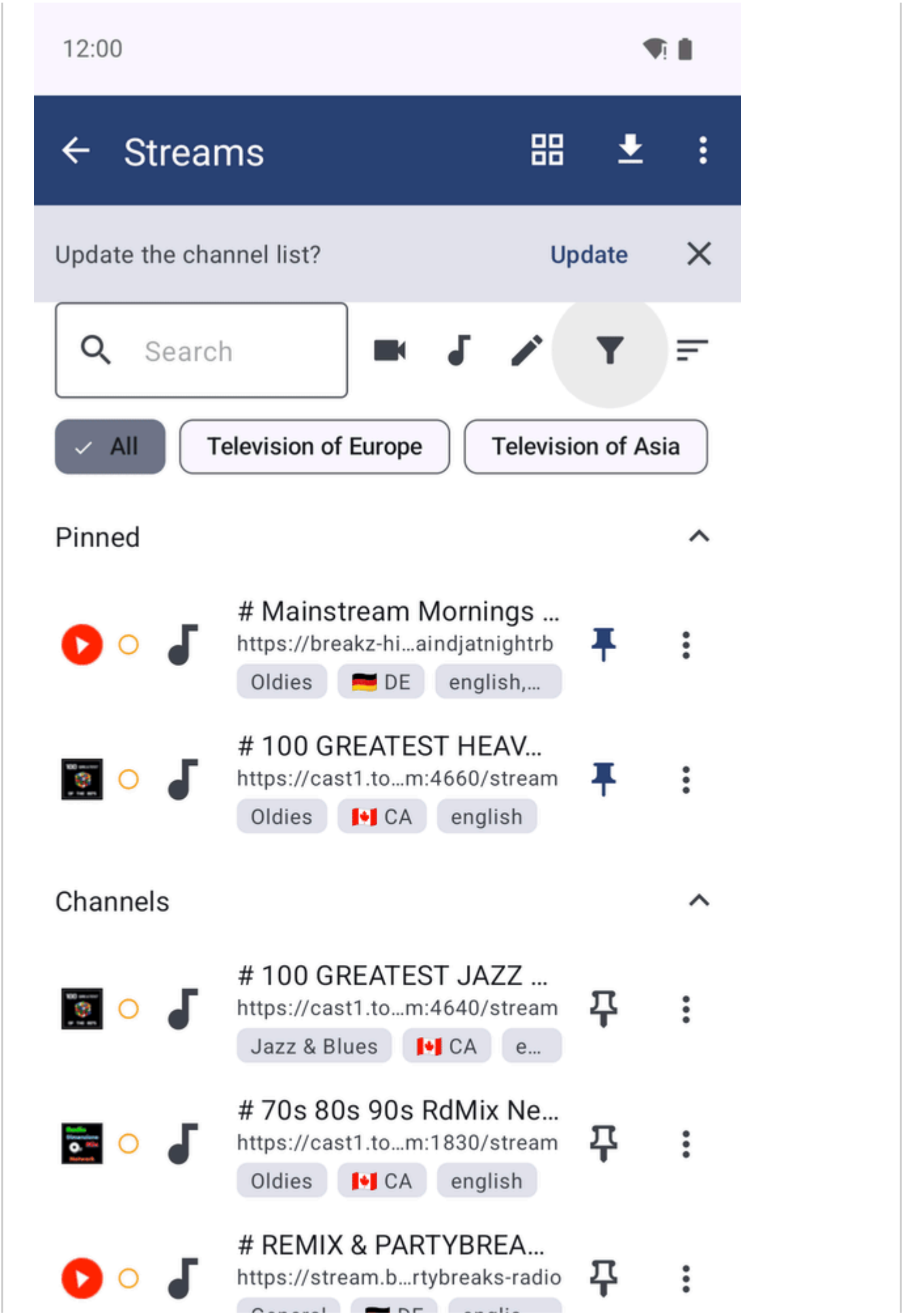
5 Sort it your way

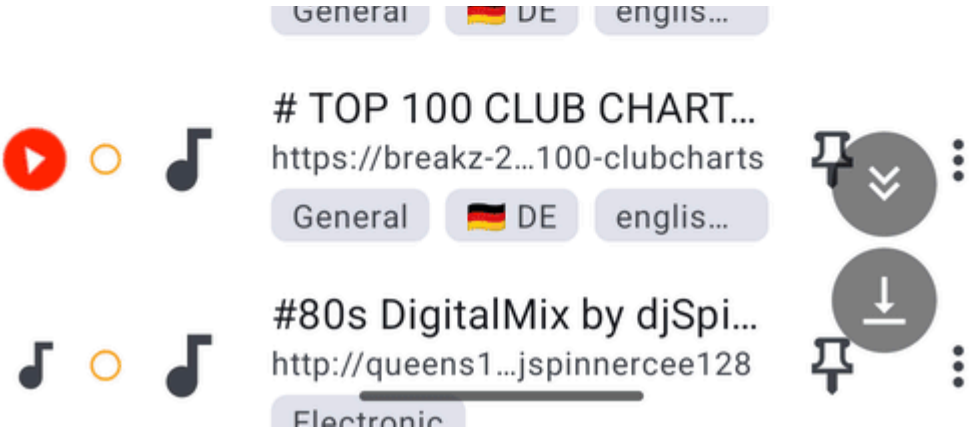
Tap **Sort** and pick **By name**, **By topic**, **By language**, **By country** or **Recently added**. Set a default order and a default media kind for every new visit in **Settings**, the **Streams** section, fields **Default order** and **Show by default**.

Whatever you land on - filter, media kind, sort and search text alike - is restored the next time you open Streams, and the list even opens back at the same channel you last scrolled to.

6 Jump into a curated collection

When the catalog carries them, named collections such as Russian TV, radio of the former USSR, African TV or a regional set show up as a chip strip under the toolbar, with an **All** chip to leave it. Pick one and the list narrows to its members in the curator's own order, while search, sorting and your other filters keep working right alongside it. A channel can belong to more than one collection, and the strip stays out of the way entirely when the catalog has none.


12:00
Streams
Update the channel list?
Update
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio

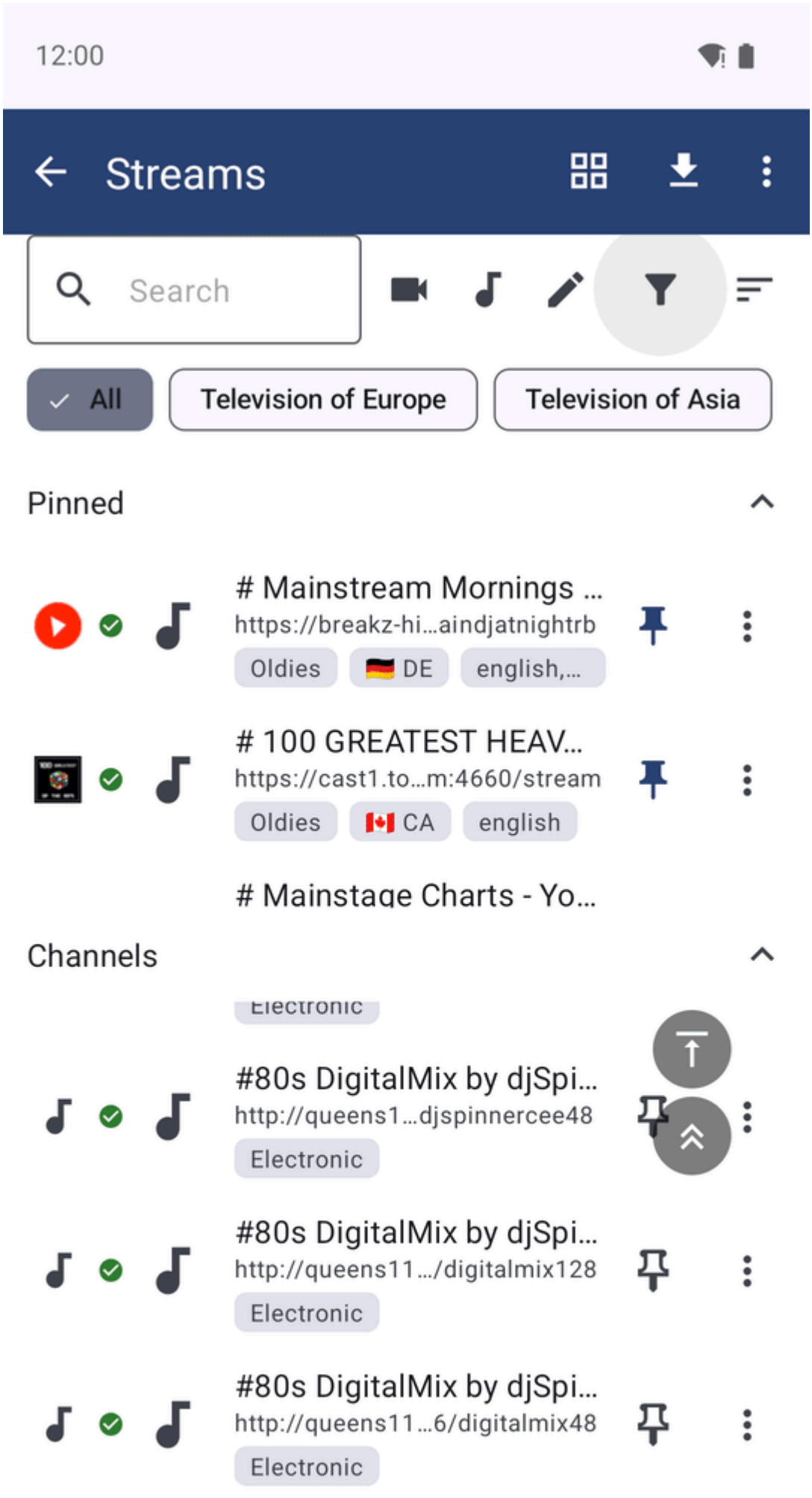


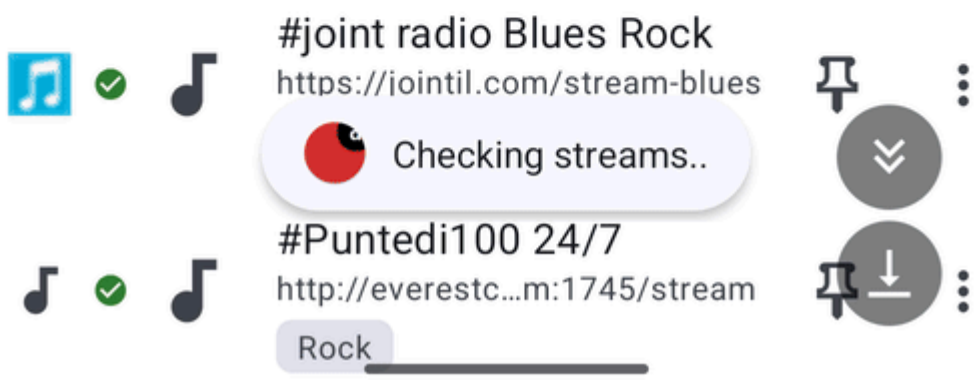
Curated collections, as a chip strip under the toolbar.

7 See which channels are alive before you tap one

Refreshing the list does more than fetch new rows: FastMediaSorter checks every visible channel for reachability while it works, showing **Checking streams…** and marking each one green or red as the answer comes in - a channel that fails shows **No signal**. Touching the screen stops the probe where it is, and video tiles get a fresh thumbnail out of the same pass.

The marks are informational, not permanent - clear them any time with **Settings**, the **Streams** section, **Clear play marks**; the channels themselves stay exactly where they were.

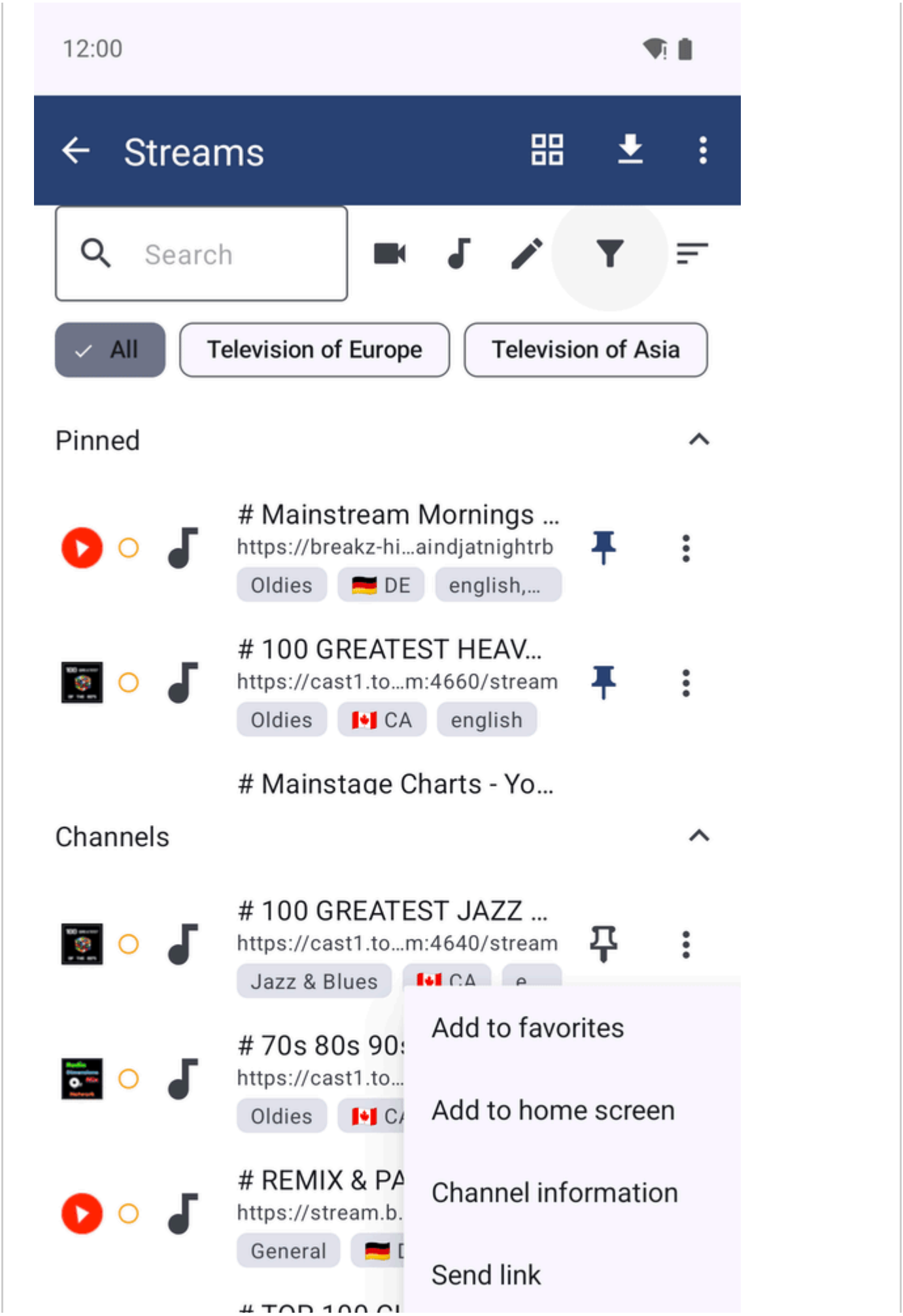

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens1...djspinnercee48
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11.../digitalmix128
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11...6/digitalmix48
Electronic

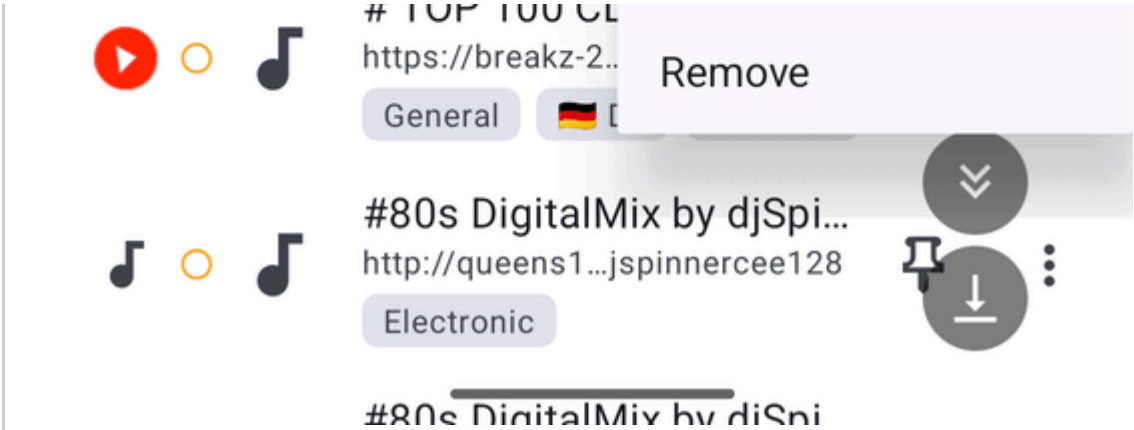


Checking streams.. - green for reachable, red for No signal.

8 The three-dot menu on every card

Every card, in grid or list, carries a three-dot **More actions** button of its own: **Edit** for a channel you added by hand, **Send link**, and **Remove**. Where FastMediaSorter's launcher is set up, **Add to home screen** is there too - no long-press or hidden gesture needed for any of it.

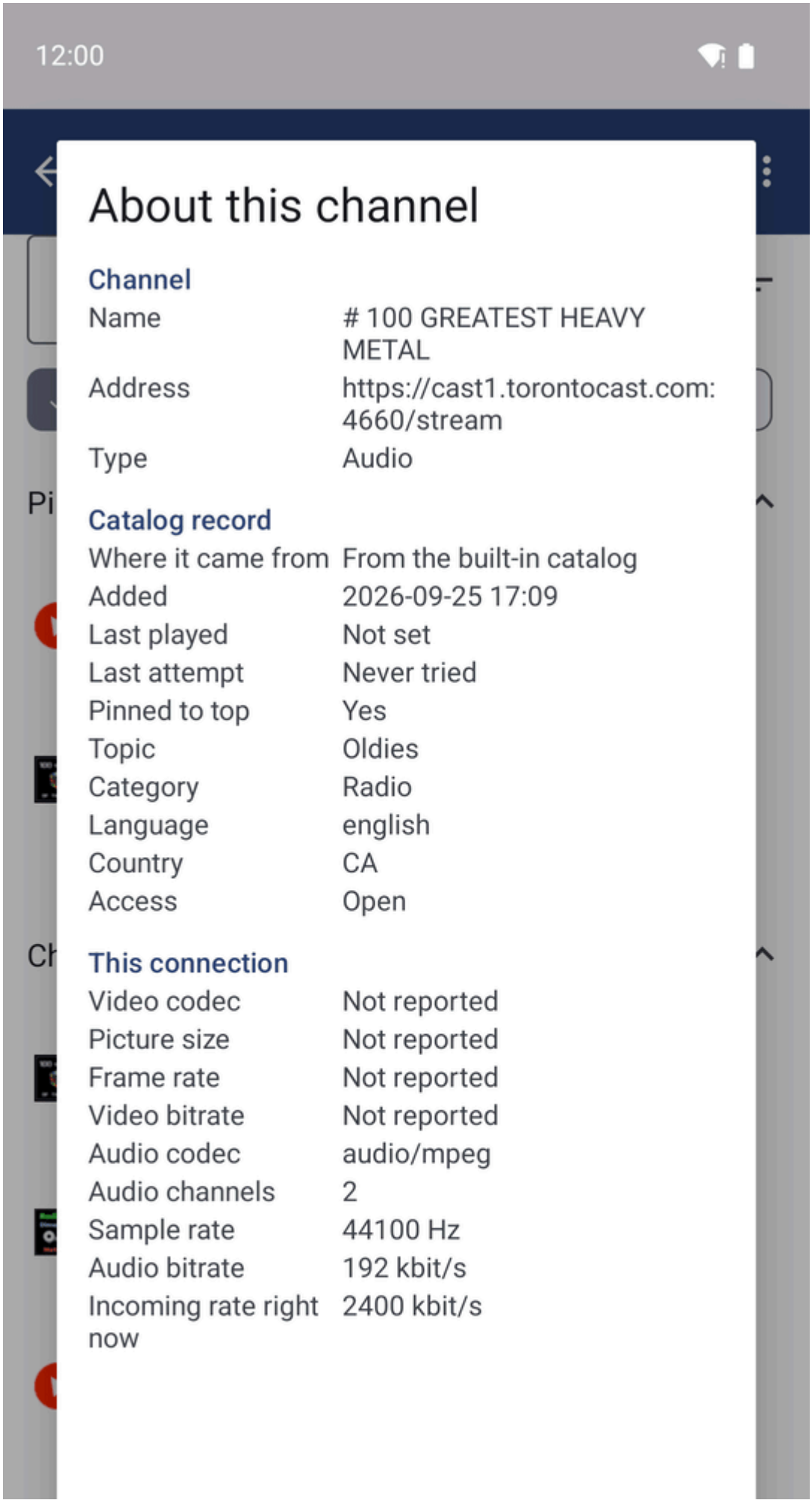

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
70s 80s 90
https://cast1.to...
Oldies
REMIX & PA
https://stream.b...
General
Add to favorites
Add to home screen
Channel information
Send link



The three-dot menu on a channel card.

9 About this channel: what the app knows, right now

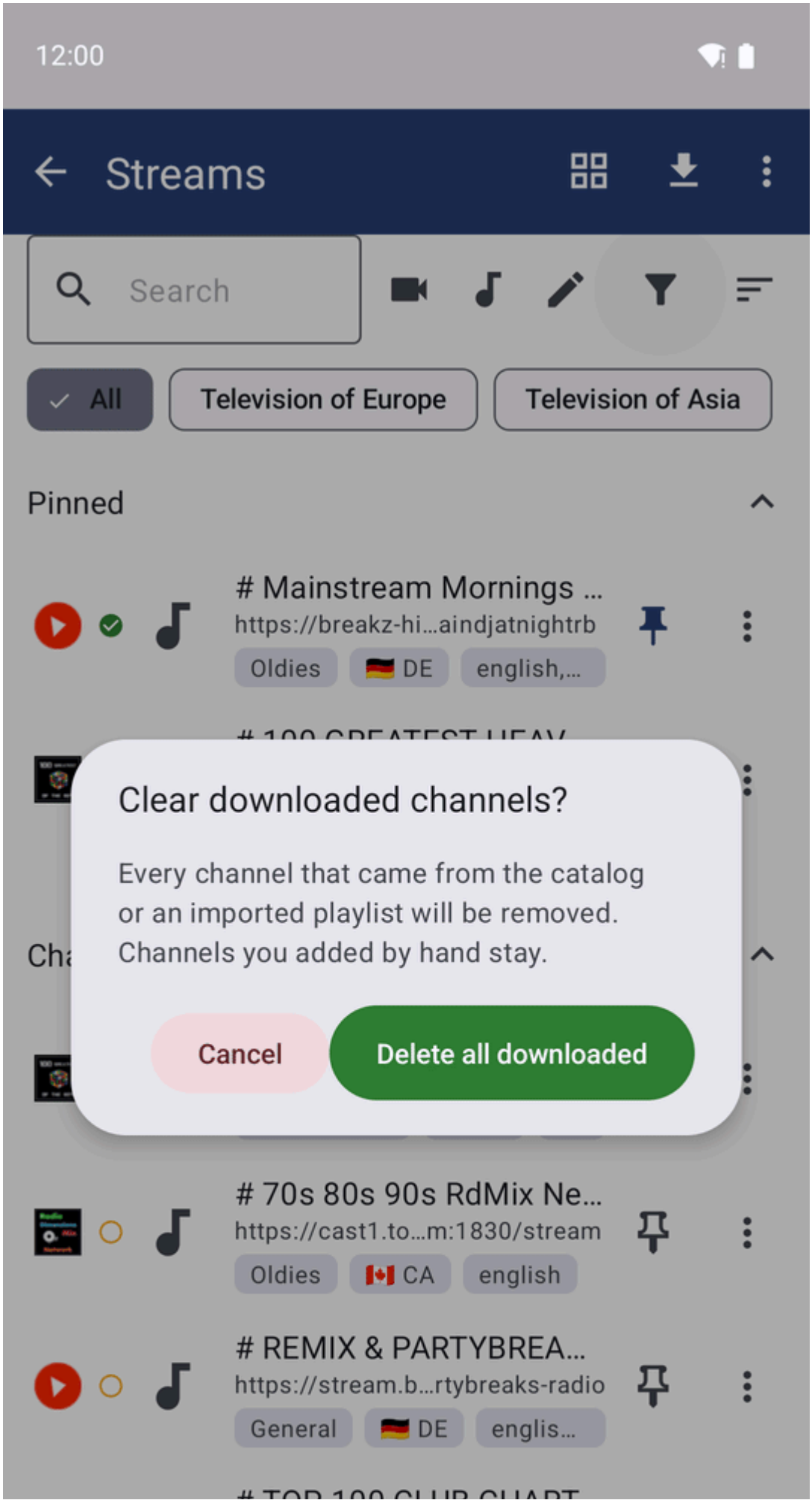
Open **About this channel** from a card's menu, in either view, or from the player's own menu while a stream plays - a channel already on screen is read straight off the running player instead of being opened a second time. It lays out what the list stores about the channel next to what its transmission is actually carrying: codecs, picture size, frame rate, bitrates and the incoming data rate, all measured the moment the window opens. **Copy all** puts the whole readout on the clipboard as plain text.

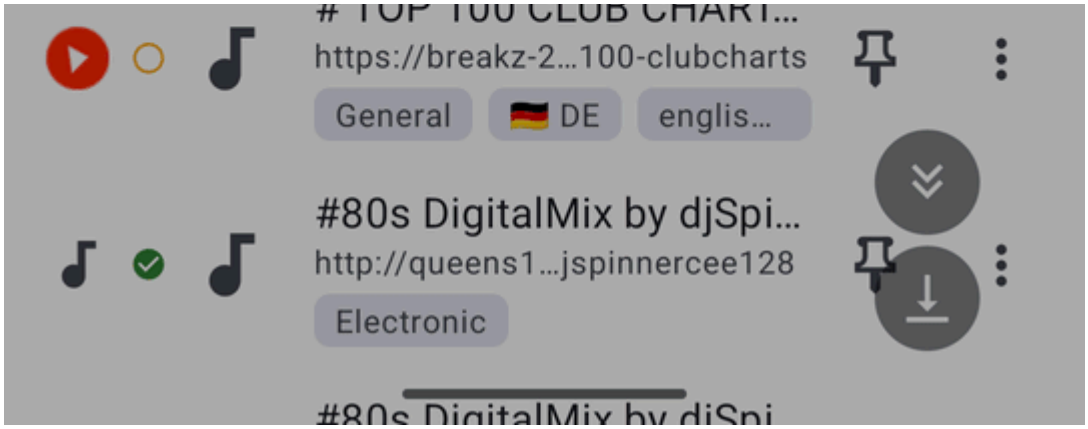

12:00
About this channel
Channel
Name
100 GREATEST HEAVY METAL
Address
https://cast1.torontocast.com:4660/stream
Type
Audio
Catalog record
Where it came from
From the built-in catalog
Added
2026-09-25 17:09
Last played
Not set
Last attempt
Never tried
Pinned to top
Yes
Topic
Oldies
Category
Radio
Language
english
Country
CA
Access
Open
This connection
Video codec
Not reported
Picture size
Not reported
Frame rate
Not reported
Video bitrate
Not reported
Audio codec
audio/mpeg
Audio channels
2
Sample rate
44100 Hz
Audio bitrate
192 kbit/s
Incoming rate right now
2400 kbit/s

About this channel - what the app knows, and what it is measuring right now.

10 Starting fresh - clear every downloaded channel

Tap **Clear all downloaded** to remove, in one confirmed action, everything that came from the catalog or an imported playlist. Channels you typed in by hand are never touched. FastMediaSorter counts what it removed when it is done, so you know the clean-up actually happened.

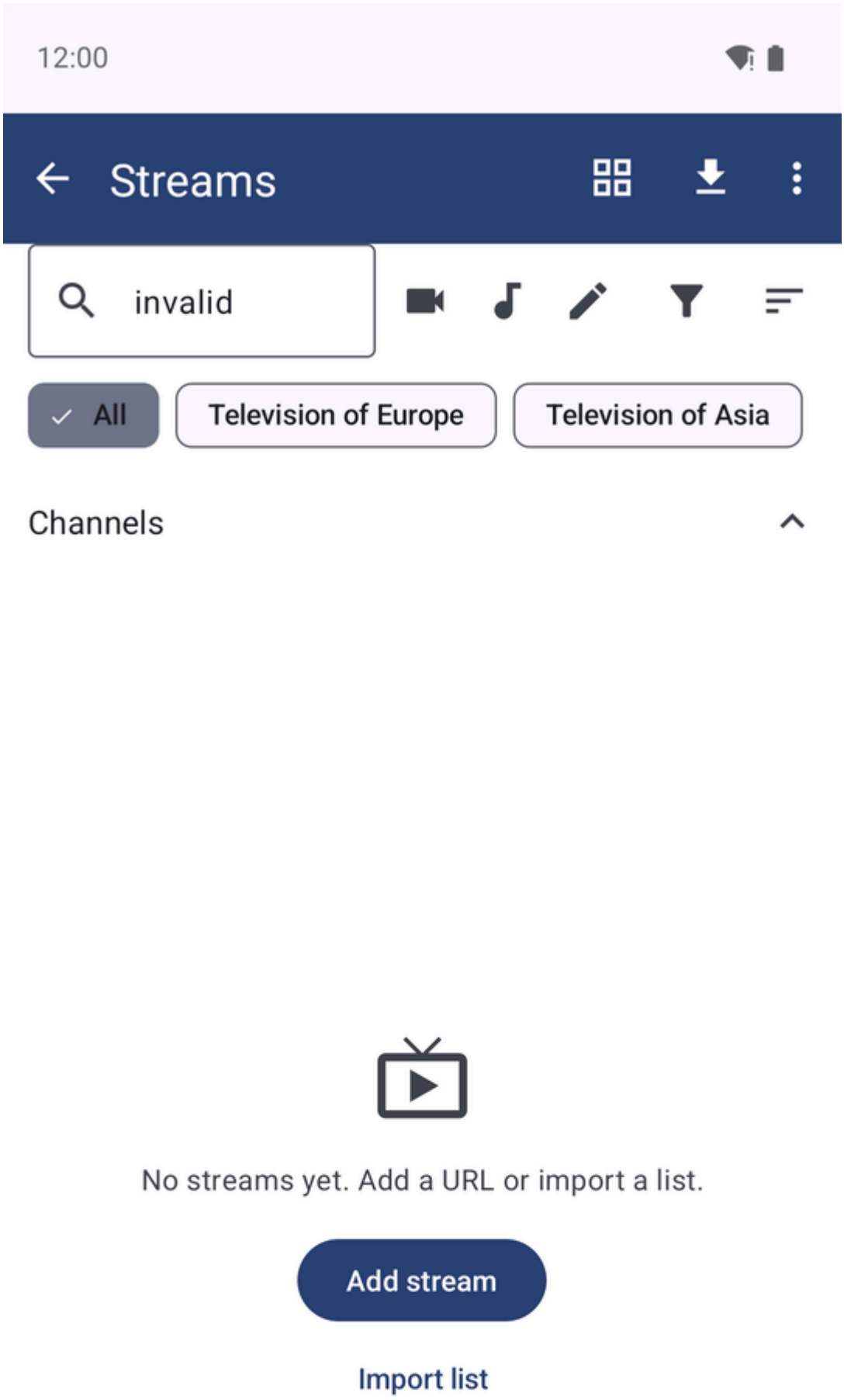

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
Clear downloaded channels?
Every channel that came from the catalog or an imported playlist will be removed. Channels you added by hand stay.
Cancel
Delete all downloaded
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...



Clearing every downloaded channel, hand-added ones kept.

11 An empty list that helps you start

A Streams screen with nothing in it says so plainly - "No streams yet. Add a URL or import a list." - with **Add stream** and **Import list** buttons built right into that message. Both open the exact same dialogs as their toolbar counterparts, so getting started never means hunting for the right icon first.


12:00
Streams
invalid
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Channels
No streams yet. Add a URL or import a list.
Add stream
Import list

An empty list with a way straight back in.

12

In the player - flip channels, keep your chosen tracks

Open a video channel and the previous/next buttons at the top of the fullscreen player move you to the previous or next video channel in the catalog's own order, re-sourcing the player each time instead of stepping through unrelated files. The title bar and the filename overlay both show the channel's real name instead of a raw address, falling back to a name built from the URL for anything the catalog does not recognize.

Video channels also remember the audio and subtitle track you picked, per channel. Set a general default in **Settings** - **Audio language for streams** and **Subtitle language for streams** - and override it for one channel at a time in that channel's own edit dialog, fields **Audio language**, **Subtitle language** and a **Subtitles** switch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Player channel navigation**
Fullscreen video stream player, previous/next channel buttons visible at top, channel name in the title bar.

What You Get

You can turn Streams on and let the catalog fetch itself, keep it fresh on your own schedule, tell grid from list and get extra columns in landscape, narrow thousands of channels down with filters and curated collections, sort them your way, trust the green and red health marks before you tap play, manage a channel from its own menu or the About window, clear everything downloaded and start over, and keep flipping channels and your chosen tracks without leaving the player.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A fresh start every visit.** Leave the streams screen and come back, and the search box and the filter are cleared - the full list is shown again.
- **Want fewer surprises when you open Streams?** Set Updating the channel list to Only when I ask in Settings, the Streams section, and nothing changes until you tap Update catalog yourself.
- **A channel already playing looks unfamiliar?** Open About this channel from the player's own menu - it reads live measurements off the channel that is already on screen instead of opening it a second time.
- **Curious what a tile's logo, flag or status dot actually means?** See Channel pictures, logos and badges.
- **Want your own station in the list, not just the catalog's?** See Importing M3U/IPTV playlists for adding a channel or a whole playlist by hand.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

Channel pictures, logos and badges

What a live frame, a logo, a flag or a plain icon on a channel tile actually means.

STREAMS

Importing M3U/IPTV playlists

Add your own channels by typing a URL or importing an M3U playlist.

STREAMS

Pinned and favorite channels

Keep your favorite channels at the top, independent of any filter or sort.

STREAMS

Playing live streams and radio

What happens once you actually tap a channel and playback starts.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #03

Adding Your Own Streams and M3U Playlists

Bring your own channels into Streams: type a web address for a single stream, or import a whole station list from a remote M3U playlist. This page covers adding, importing, editing and the duplicate-address check that keeps one address from ending up in your list twice.

Why You'll Love This

The built-in channel catalog covers a lot of ground, but it will never have everything - your favorite small radio station, a work IPTV feed, or a camera link someone sent you. FastMediaSorter lets you add any of these yourself: one channel at a time by its web address, or a whole station list at once by importing a playlist.

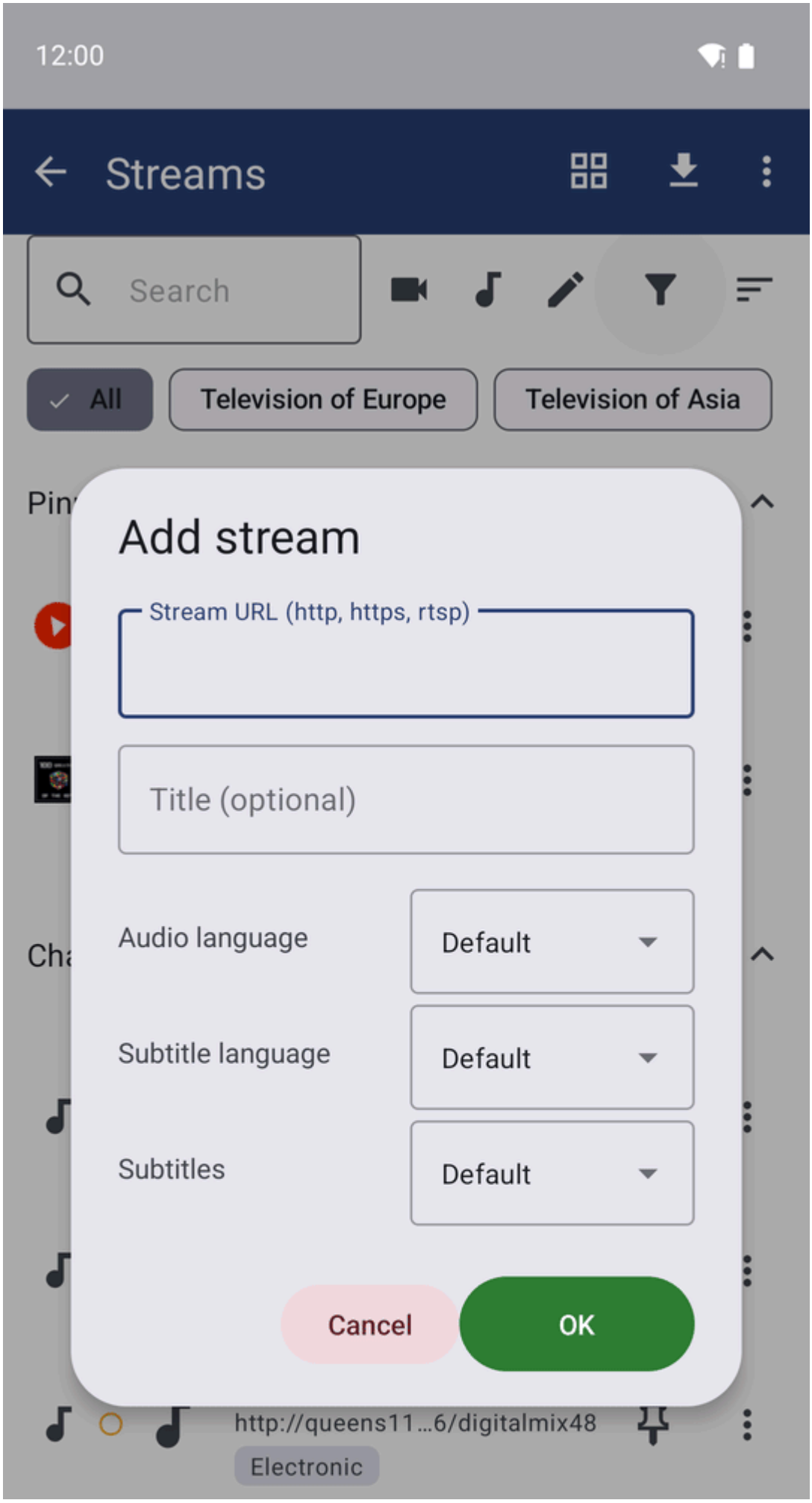
An M3U playlist is a plain text file that lists stream web addresses one after another, usually with a name next to each one - it is one of the oldest and most common ways radio and IPTV providers publish their channel lists. See M3U on Wikipedia ↗ for the full format. FastMediaSorter downloads and reads the file for you; you never need to open or edit it yourself.

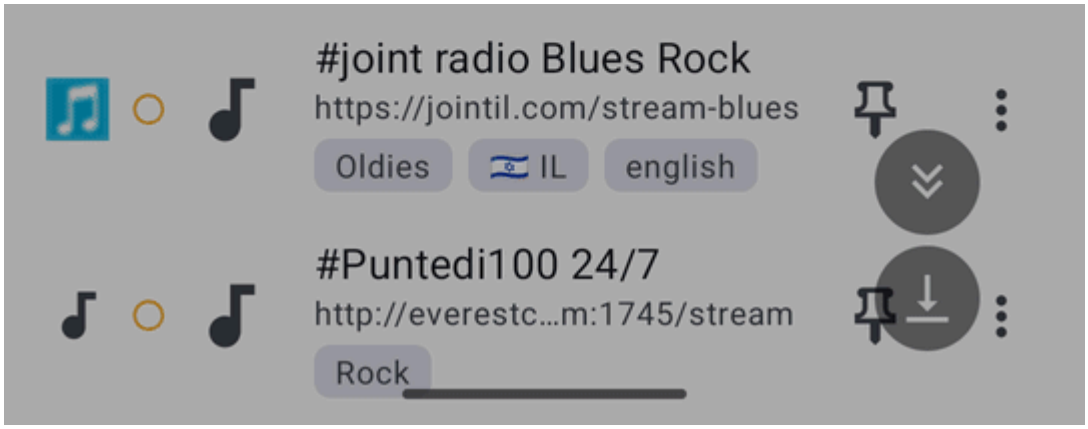
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed in the edition. Streams and everything on this page is Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR absent from Lite, Photos and FOSS.
- The Streams screen open.
- The web address of the stream, or of the M3U playlist, you want to add - copy it from wherever you found it.
- Browsing the built-in catalog instead of adding your own? See Browsing internet stream channels.

1 Add a stream by its web address

Open the Streams screen's overflow menu ⋮ and tap **Add stream**. Type the address into **Stream URL (http, https, rtsp)** – a plain http or https link, or an rtsp:// address for a camera or IPTV feed – and, if you like, a **Title (optional)** so the channel shows the name you chose instead of whatever the stream itself reports. Tap **OK** and the channel appears in your list right away.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Add stream
Stream URL (http, https, rtsp)
Title (optional)
Audio language
Default
Subtitle language
Default
Subtitles
Default
Cancel
OK
http://queens11…6/digitalmix48
Electronic

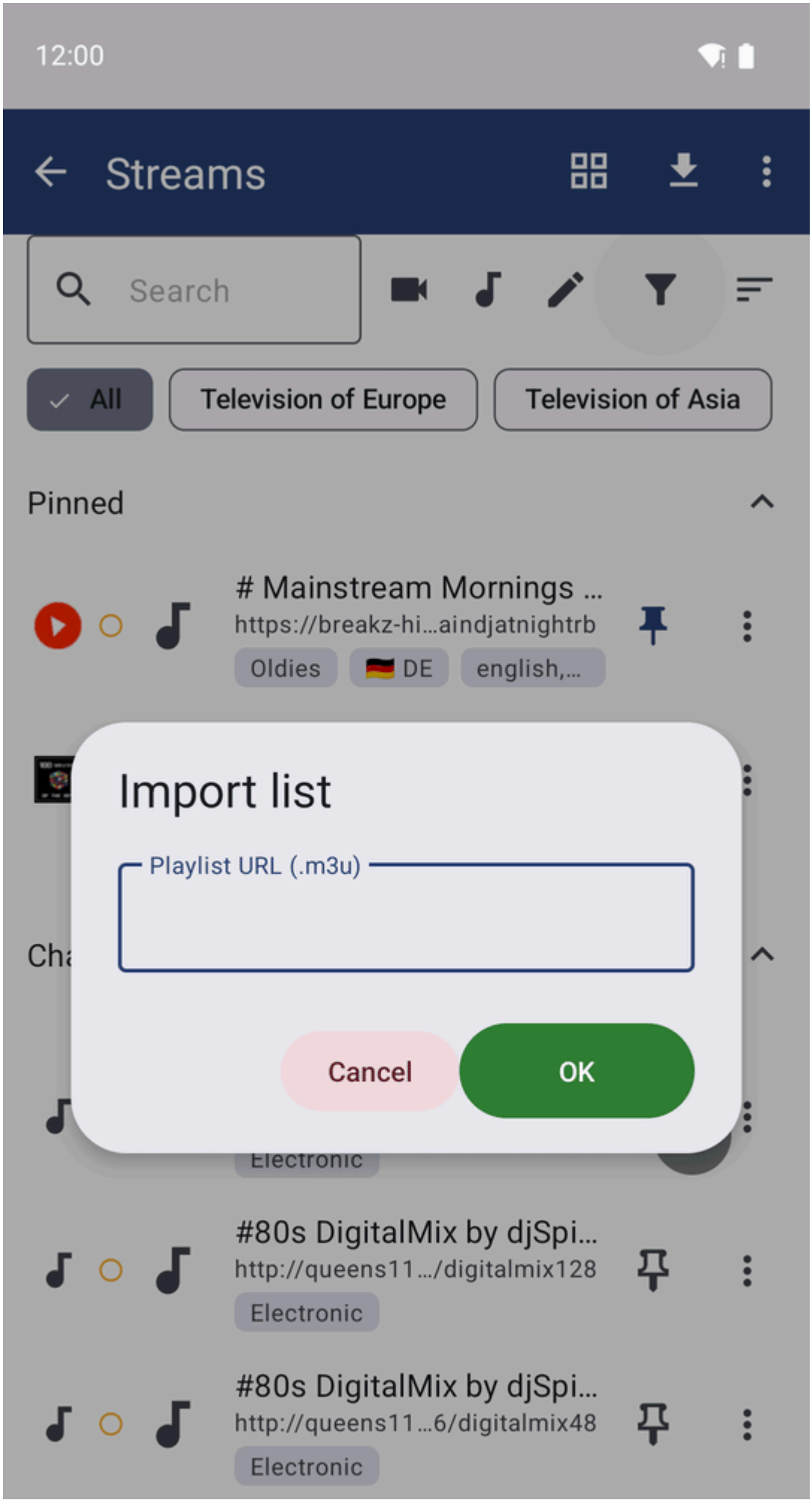


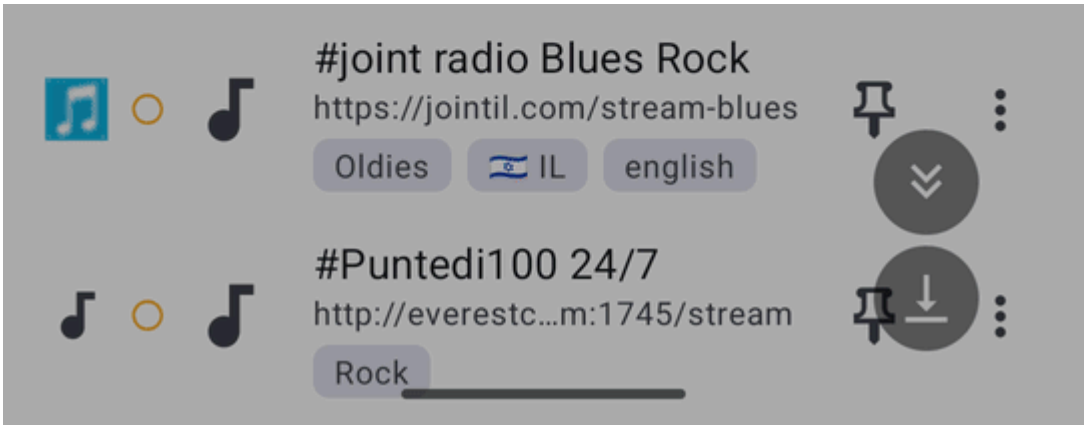
Add stream - a web address and an optional title.

2 Import a whole playlist from its web address

To bring in a whole station list at once, open the overflow menu and tap **Import from URL**. Paste the playlist's address into **Playlist URL (.m3u)** and tap **OK**. FastMediaSorter downloads the file and adds every channel it finds in it as its own entry in your list.

This is different from **Update catalog**, the toolbar button next to it - that one refreshes FastMediaSorter's own built-in channel list, not anything of yours. See Browsing internet stream channels for that side of Streams.

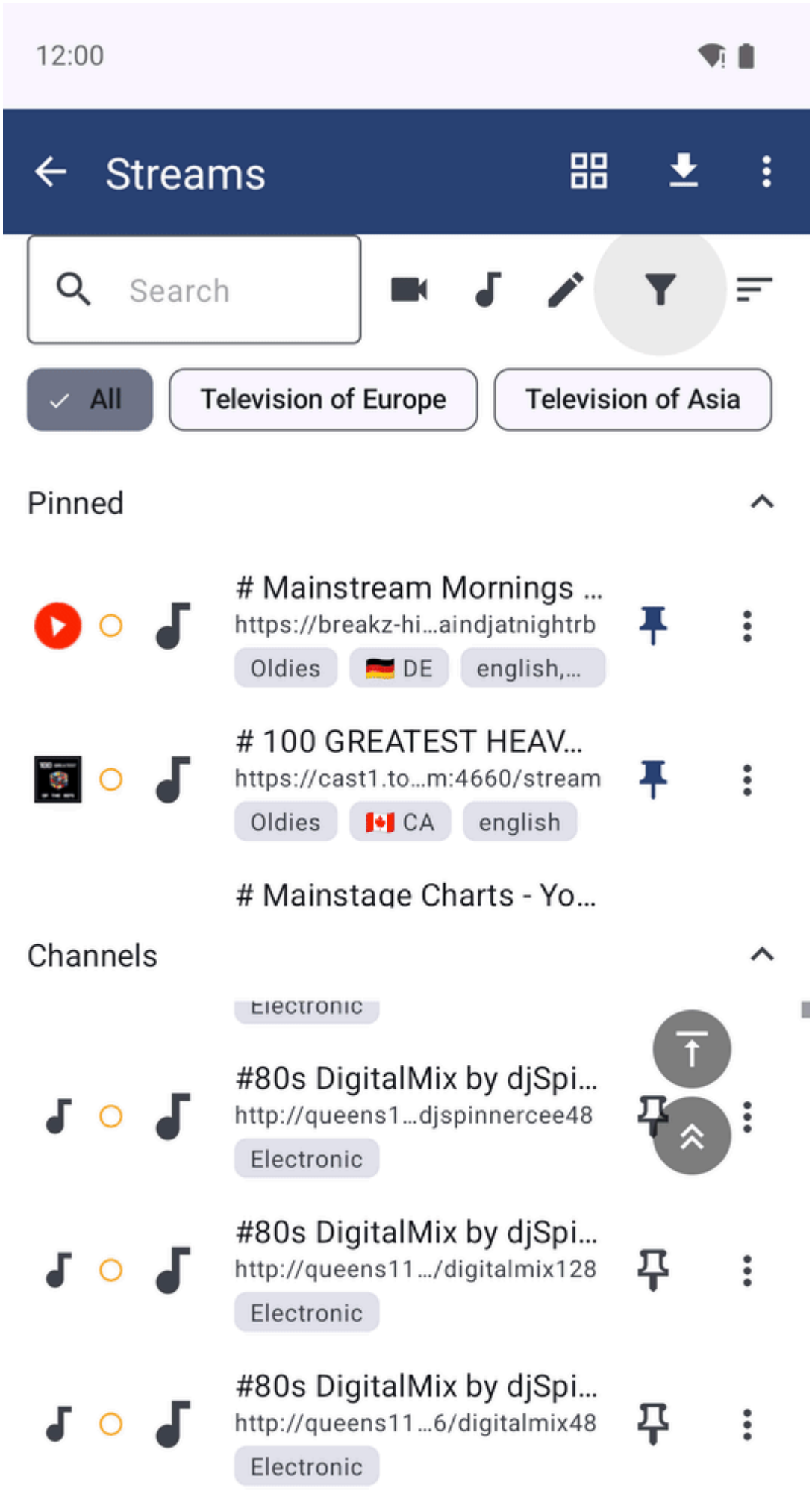

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
Import list
Playlist URL (.m3u)
Cancel
OK
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11.../digitalmix128
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11...6/digitalmix48
Electronic

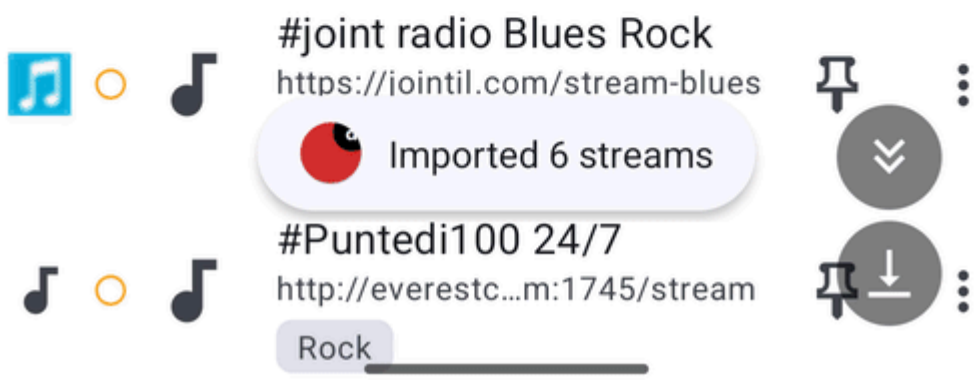


Import from URL - paste the playlist's address.

3 Importing the same playlist again only adds what is new

A moment after an import finishes, FastMediaSorter tells you how many channels it actually added - **Imported n streams**. Run the same import again later, after the station has updated its list, and only the new entries come in: anything already in your list is quietly left alone rather than added a second time. If every channel in the playlist is already there, you will simply see **Imported 0 streams**.

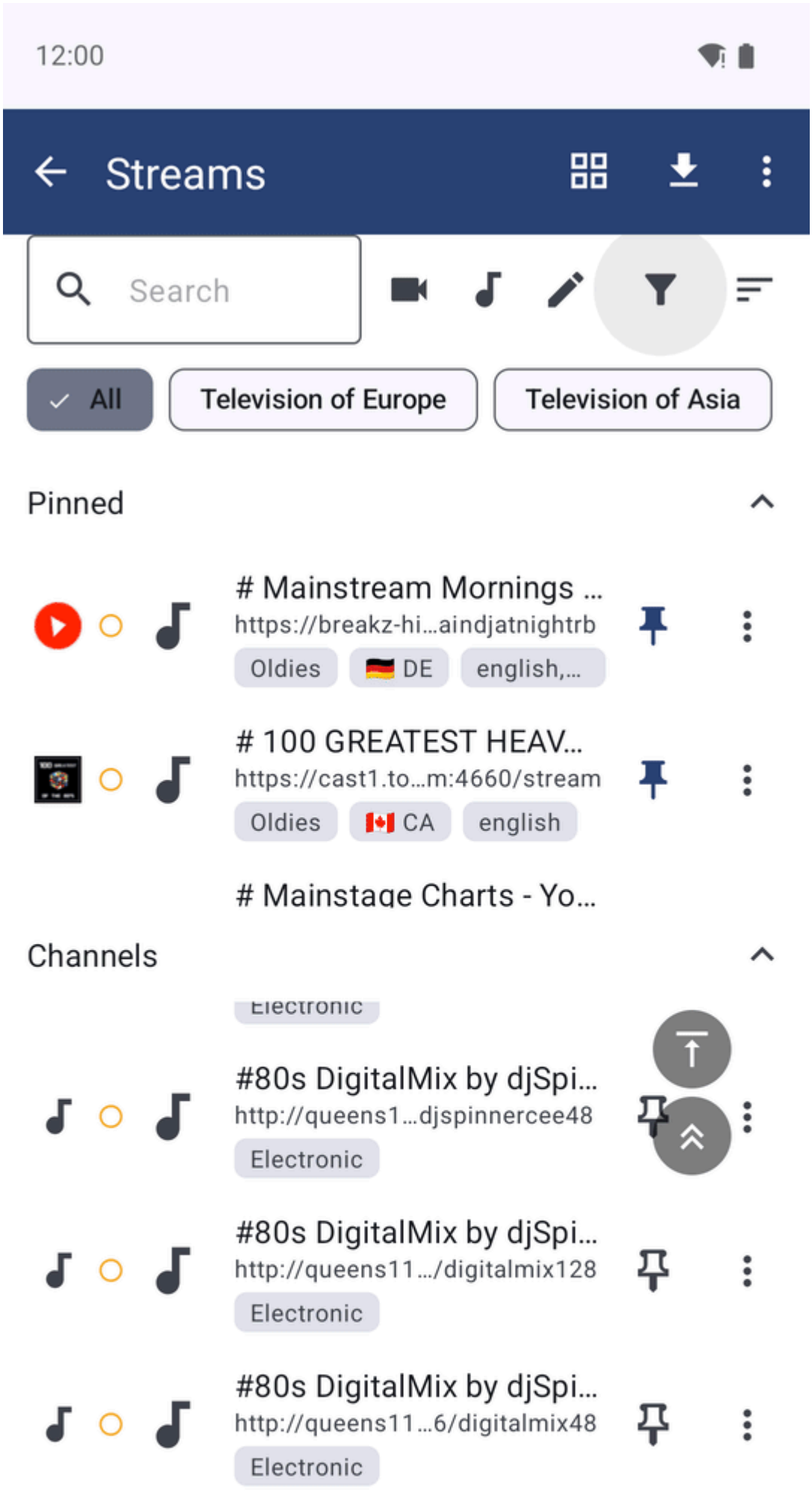

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens1...djspinnercee48
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11.../digitalmix128
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11...6/digitalmix48
Electronic

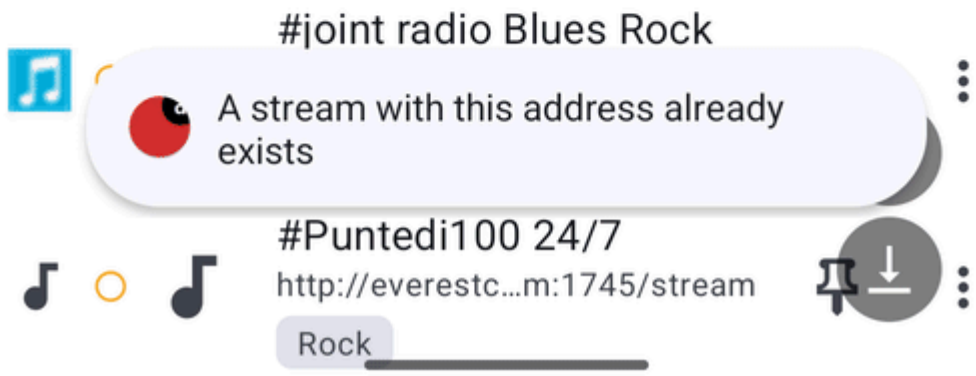


The import tells you how many channels it actually added.

4 Adding a stream you already have

Try to add a stream by hand whose web address is already in your list, and FastMediaSorter stops before it makes a copy: it shows **A stream with this address already exists** instead of adding the channel twice. Fix the address, or tap **Cancel** if you meant to open the existing one instead.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens1...djspinnercee48
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11.../digitalmix128
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11...6/digitalmix48
Electronic



Adding a URL you already have - no duplicate, just a clear message.

5 Edit a channel, and pin down its type

A channel you added by hand or brought in through an import can be edited afterwards - open its ⋮ menu, on the row or the tile, and tap **Edit**. The **Edit channel** dialog reopens with the same URL and title fields, plus a **Type** row with **Auto**, **Audio** and **Video** choices that settle how FastMediaSorter treats the stream when the address alone does not make it obvious.

Pick **Audio** or **Video** yourself if Auto guesses wrong, and FastMediaSorter remembers it: open Edit again later and your choice, not Auto, is what is still selected. Catalog channels do not offer Edit, since you did not set their address in the first place.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Edit channel dialog with Type row**
Edit channel dialog open, URL and Title fields filled in, Type row with Video selected.

What You Get

You can add any stream by hand, bring in a whole station list from an M3U playlist without doubling up what you already have, fix a wrong address or title afterwards, and lock in whether a channel plays as audio or video when FastMediaSorter would otherwise have to guess.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Addresses with a user name and password inside** - such as `http://user:password@host/stream` - sign in to the stream correctly instead of being reported as unreachable.
- **Not sure whether an address is http, https or rtsp?** Copy it exactly as the station or camera gave it to you - FastMediaSorter accepts all three in the same field.
- **Only channels you added yourself can be edited.** A channel from the built-in catalog keeps Edit off its menu; if you want a different title or type for one of those, add it again by hand with the address you want.
- **Want to keep your own channels within reach?** Pinning and Favorites work the same for a channel you added as for one from the catalog - see Pinned and favorite channels.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

Browsing internet stream channels

Filter, sort and search the built-in channel catalog to find stations without typing an address.

STREAMS

Pinned and favorite channels

Pin channels to the top of your list and star them into Favorites.

STREAMS

Channel Pictures, Logos and Badges

Why a channel shows a live frame, a logo, a flag or a plain icon, and what its status dot means.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #04

Pinned and Favorite Channels

Keep your everyday channels within reach two ways: pin them to the top of Streams in the order you choose, and star the ones you want in the shared Favorites list. This page covers pinning, reordering, the pinned-only filter, and adding a channel to Favorites.

Why You'll Love This

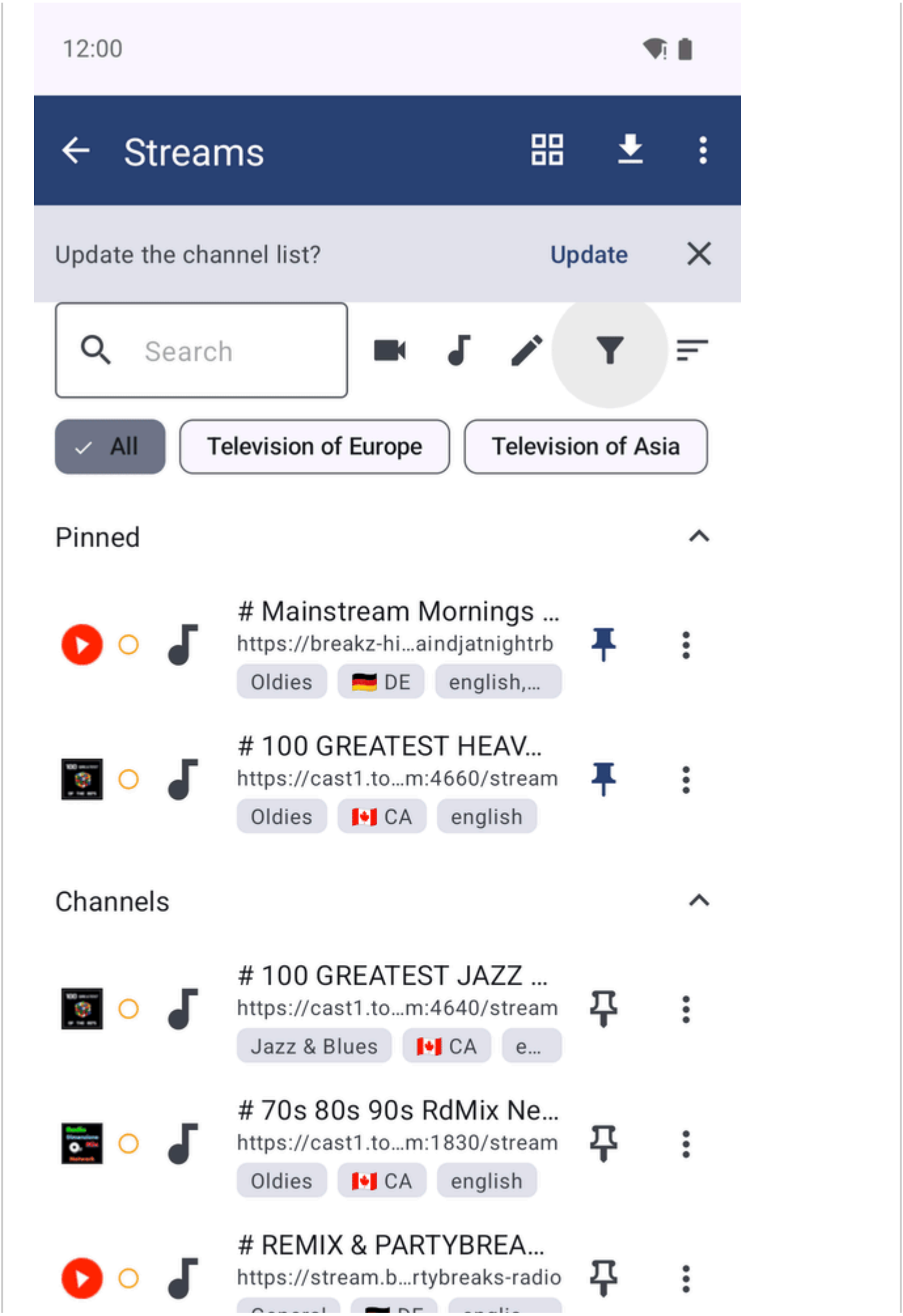
Once you have more than a handful of channels, the ones you actually check every day get buried among the rest. FastMediaSorter gives you two separate ways to keep track of them: pinning, which is local to the Streams screen and puts a channel at the top of your own list in whatever order you choose, and Favorites, the star-marked list shared across the whole app. Neither changes what a channel plays - both are just faster ways back to it.

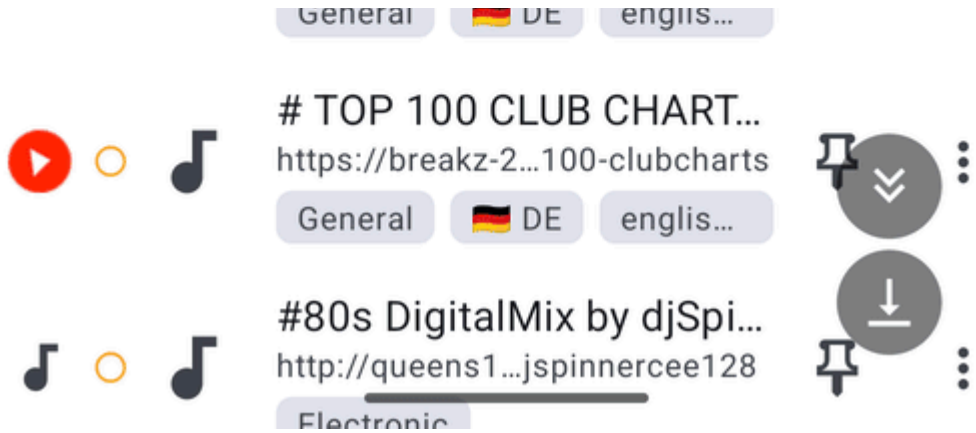
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition. Streams and everything on this page is absent from Lite, Photos and FOSS.
- The Streams screen open, with some channels in it - your own or from the catalog. See Browsing internet stream channels for how the catalog fills the list.
- For the Favorites steps: Favorites turned on in Settings (**Enable Favorites**).

1 Pin a channel to the top of your list

Long-press a channel's row or tile, or tap the small pin icon on a list row, and the channel jumps to a **Pinned** section at the top of Streams. The pin icon fills in and changes color once a channel is pinned, so you can tell pinned channels apart from the rest at a glance. Long-press again, or tap the same pin icon, to unpin it.

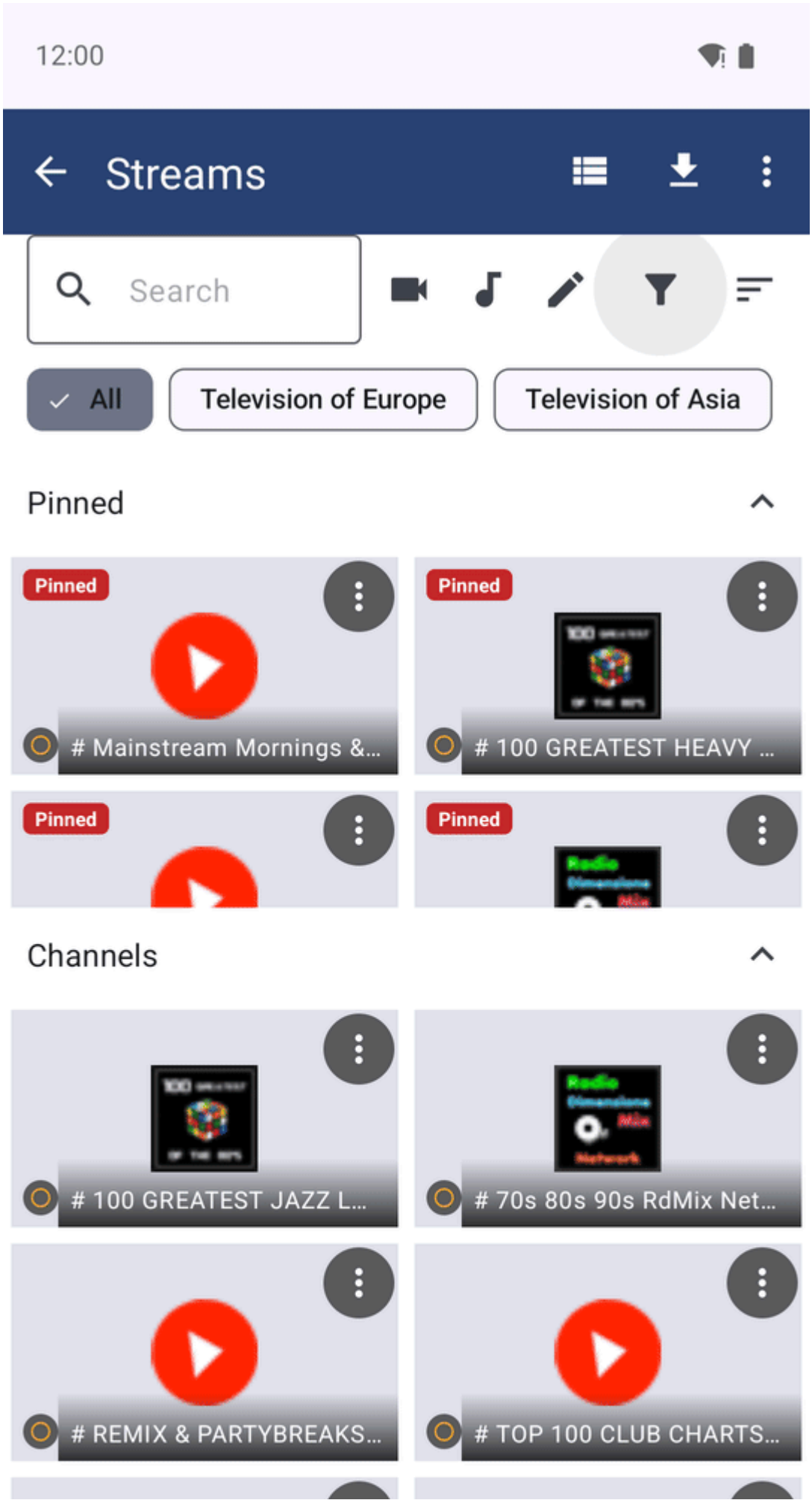

12:00
Streams
Update the channel list?
Update
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio

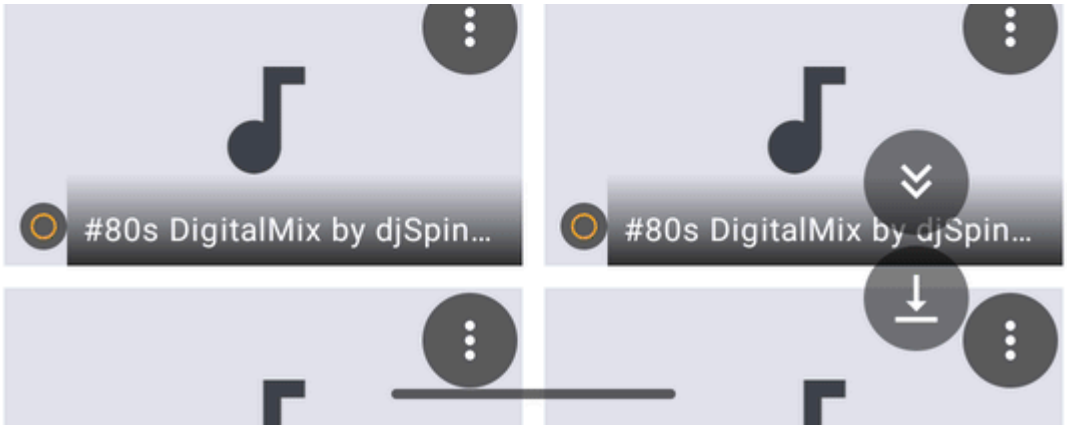


Long-press a channel, or tap its pin icon, to pin or unpin it.

2 Spot a pinned channel in grid view

Switch to grid view and a pinned channel carries a small red **Pinned** badge in the top-left corner of its tile. The badge itself is not tappable - you pin or unpin a tile from its ⋮ menu, which leads with **Pin** or **Unpin** depending on the channel's current state.

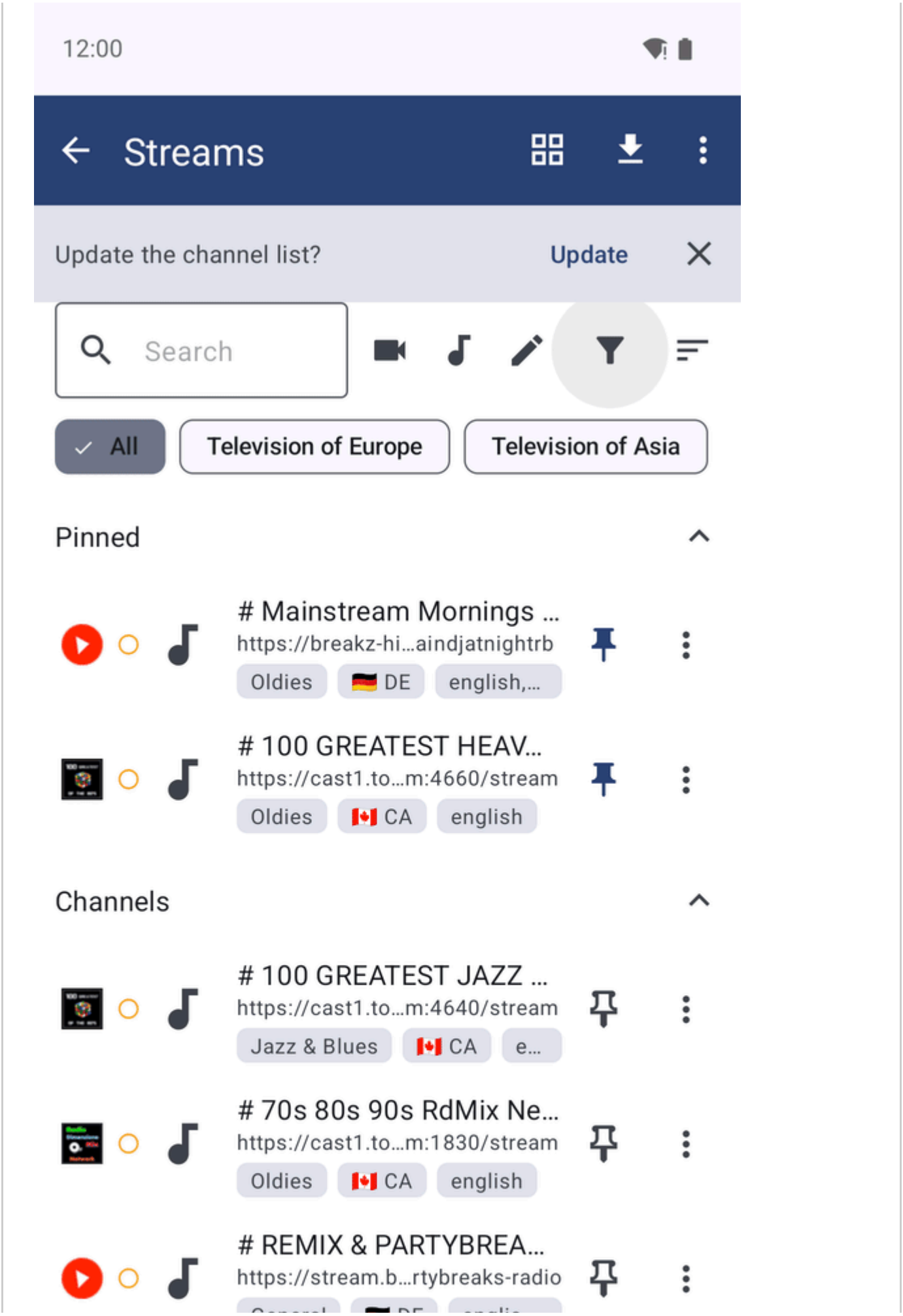

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings &...
Pinned
100 GREATEST HEAVY ...
Pinned
Pinned
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ L...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Net...
REMIX & PARTYBREAKS...
TOP 100 CLUB CHARTS...

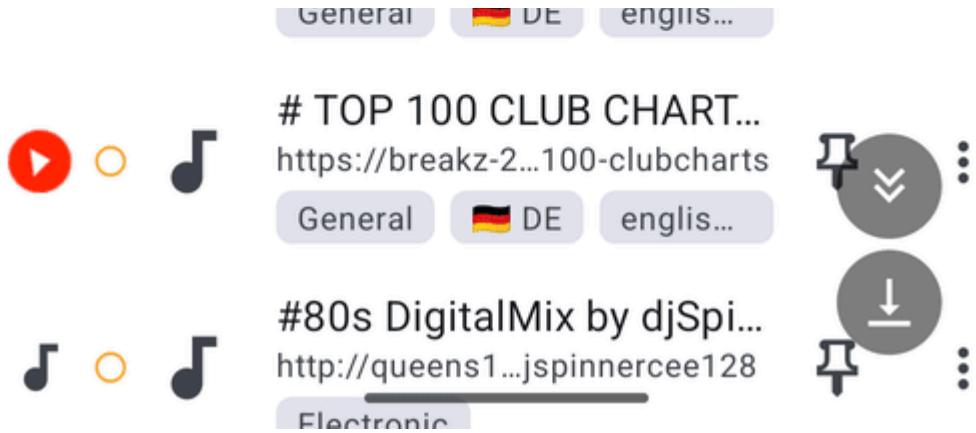


The red Pinned badge marks a pinned tile.

3 Pinned and everything else, as two sections

As soon as you pin your first channel, Streams splits into two independently scrolling sections: **Pinned** on top, **Channels** below, each with its own header. Tap a header to collapse that section and give the other the room - collapsing Pinned expands Channels and the other way round, so one of the two always stays visible. Unpin your last channel and the split goes away on its own.

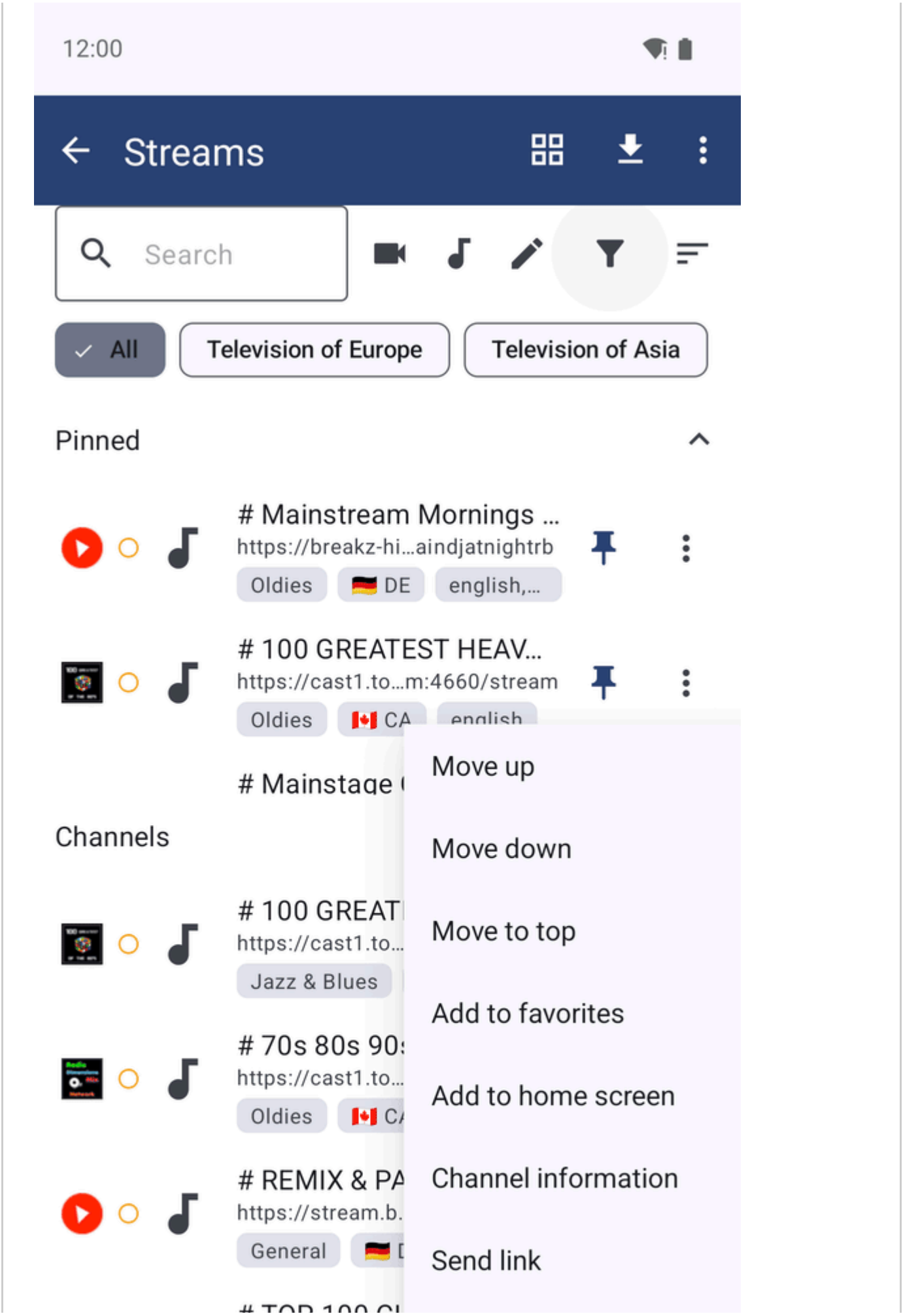

12:00
Streams
Update the channel list?
Update
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio

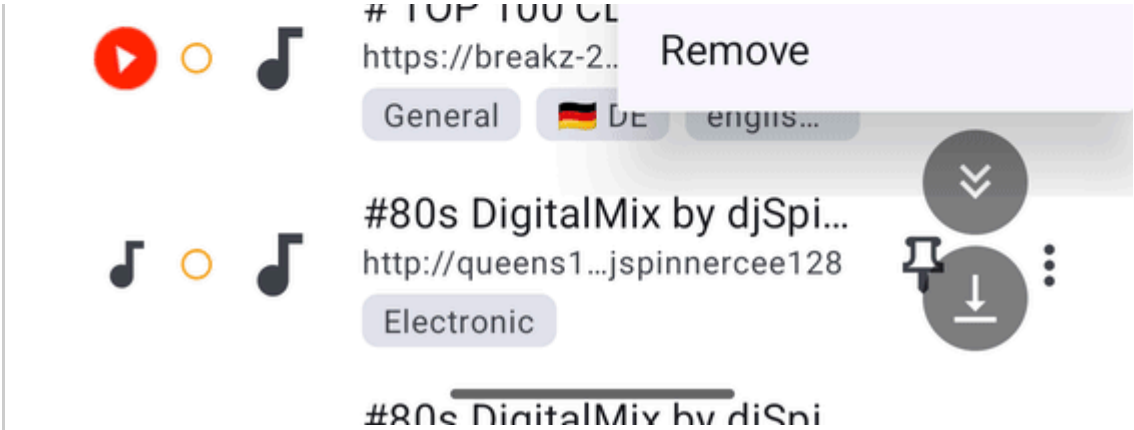


Pinned and Channels - two sections, each collapsible on its own.

4 Put your pinned channels in the order you want

With two or more channels pinned, each one's ⋮ menu gains three extra rows: **Move up**, **Move down** and **Move to top**. They move a channel only within the pinned block, and gray out at the ends - Move up and Move to top on the first pinned channel, Move down on the last - so there is never a row to tap that would not do anything. The order you set here is the same order the streams panel on the main screen plays your pinned channels in.

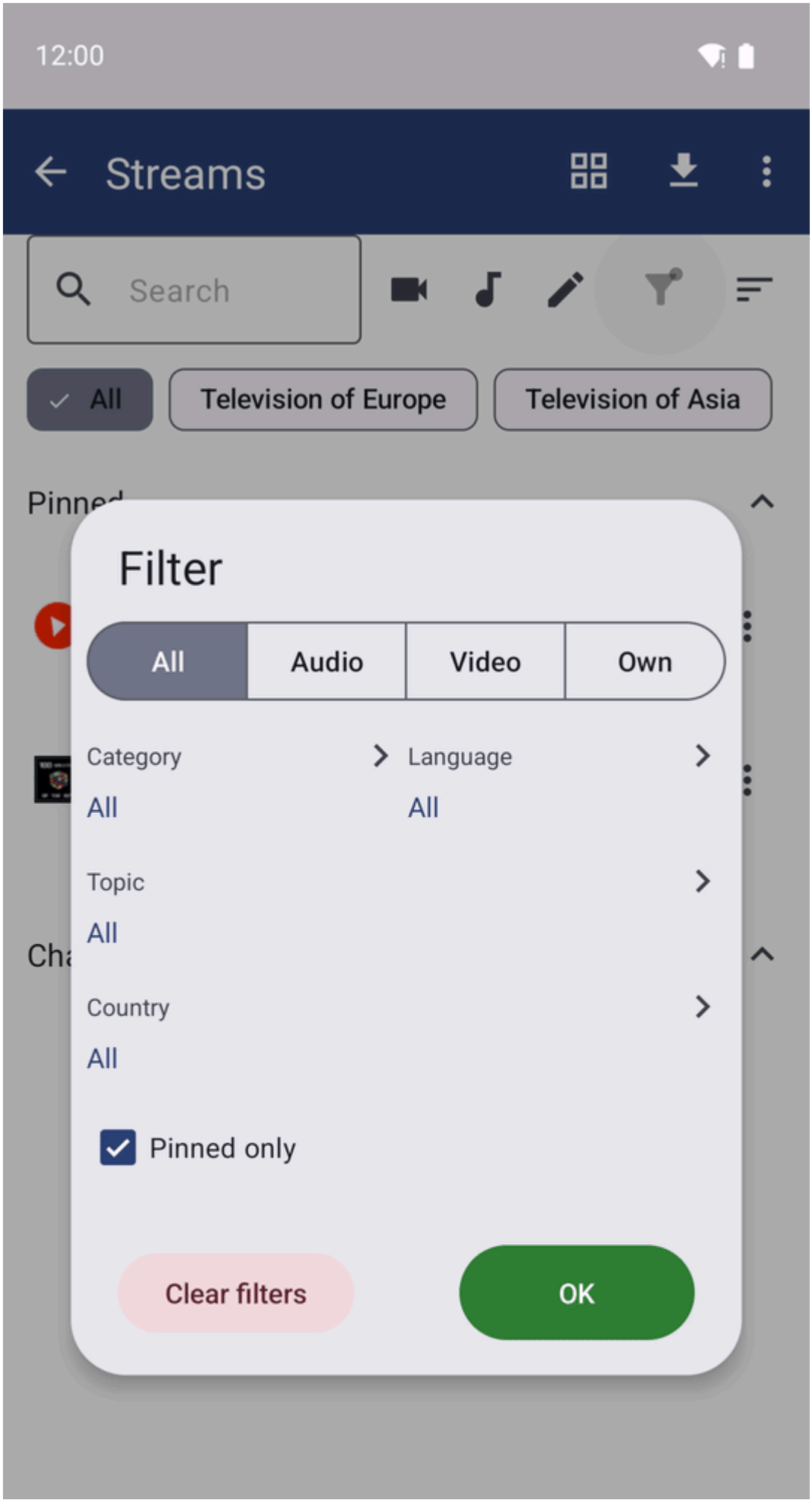

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage
Channels
100 GREAT
https://cast1.to...
Jazz & Blues
70s 80s 90s
https://cast1.to...
Oldies
REMIX & PA
https://stream.b...
General
Move up
Move down
Move to top
Add to favorites
Add to home screen
Channel information
Send link



Move up, Move down, Move to top - reordering the pinned block.

5 Show just your pinned channels

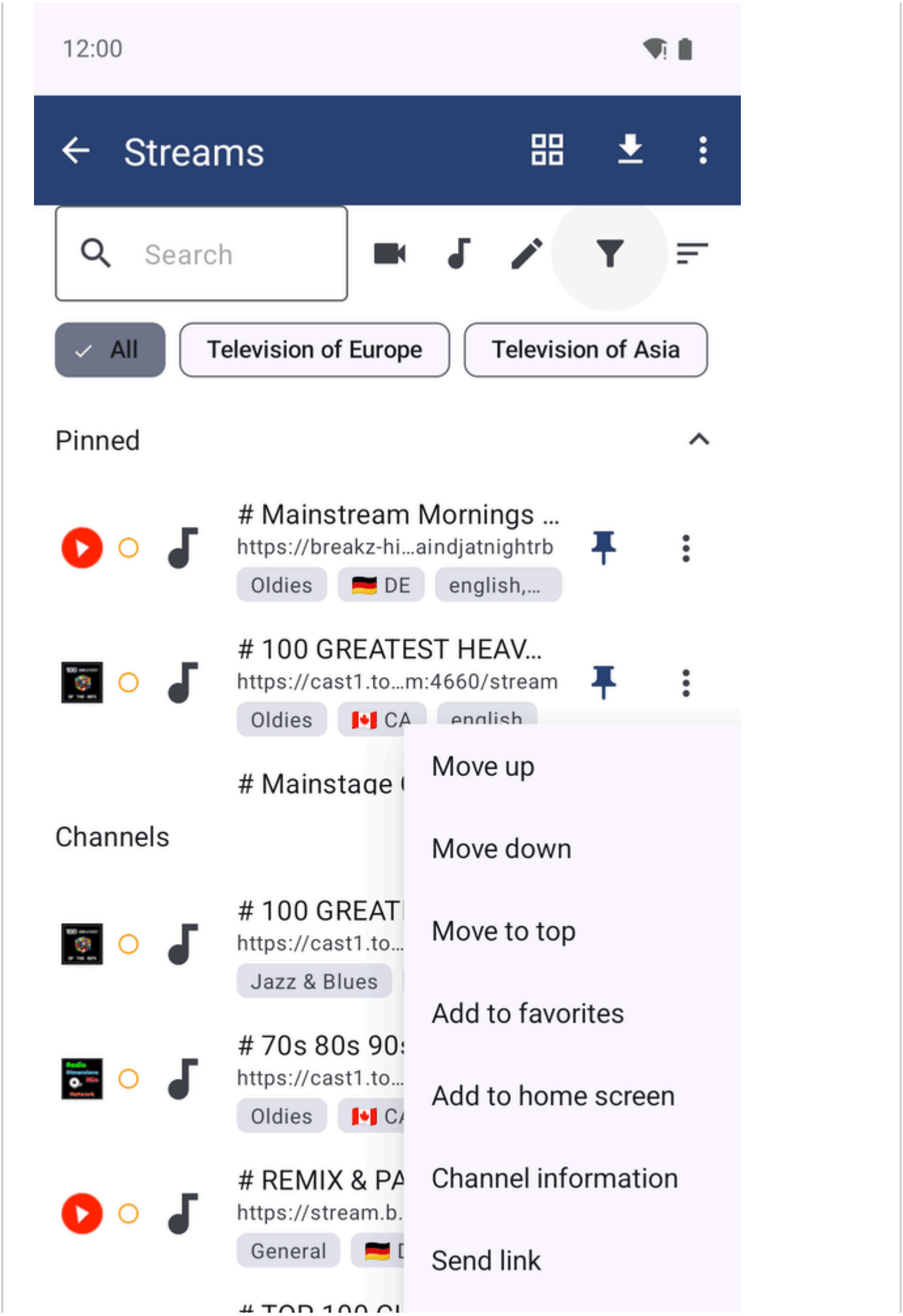
Tap **Filter** on the Streams screen and turn on **Pinned only** to hide everything else and see just the channels you pinned - handy once your list has grown past the ones you actually check every day. Turn the same switch off to see the whole list again.

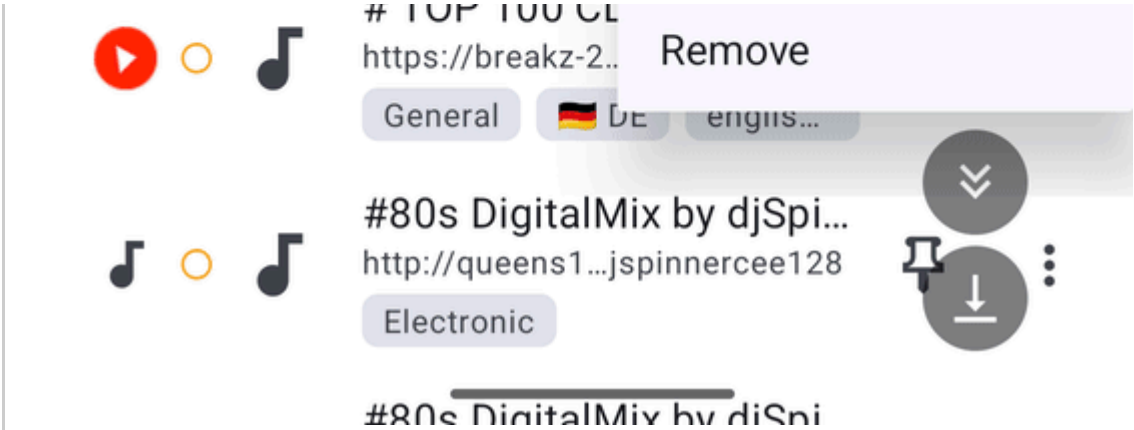

12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Filter
All
Audio
Video
Own
Category
All
Language
All
Topic
All
Country
All
Pinned only
Clear filters
OK

Pinned only, in the Filter dialog.

6 Star a channel into Favorites

Pinning only affects Streams; Favorites is the star-marked list shared across the whole app. Open a channel's ⋮ menu and tap **Add to favorites** and the channel joins Favorites by name, reachable from the Favorites tab exactly like a favorited file – independent of whether that channel is also pinned. Tap **Remove from favorites** the same way to take it off again.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage
Channels
100 GREAT
https://cast1.to...
Jazz & Blues
70s 80s 90s
https://cast1.to...
Oldies
REMIX & PA
https://stream.b...
General
Move up
Move down
Move to top
Add to favorites
Add to home screen
Channel information
Send link



Add to favorites, from the channel's own menu.

What You Get

You can pin the channels you check every day to the top of Streams in the order you want, tell a pinned channel apart at a glance in either view, narrow the list down to pinned-only, and keep a separate, shared shortlist of favorite channels alongside your favorite files.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A channel's pin, its place in the pinned order, its favorite star and its play history all survive small address changes.** When the catalog republishes a channel under a cosmetically different address - https instead of http, a trailing slash added, the port spelled out - FastMediaSorter still recognizes it as the same channel, so none of that resets.
- **Tapping the favorite star again never creates a second entry.** It always toggles the one Favorites entry you already have for that channel, even after an address like the above changes underneath it.
- **Favorites row missing from a channel's menu?** Turn on **Enable Favorites** in Settings first - the row only appears once Favorites itself is on.
- **Want to know why a tile looks the way it does?** Pinning and favouriting never touch a channel's picture - see Channel Pictures, Logos and Badges.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

STREAMS

Adding Your Own Streams and M3U Playlists

Add a channel by its web address, or import a whole station list from an M3U playlist.

Browsing internet stream channels

Filter, sort and search the built-in channel catalog.

STREAMS

Playing Live Streams and Radio

What happens when you tap a channel, on the streams panel and in the full player.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #02

Channel Pictures, Logos and Badges

Every channel in Streams always shows something - a live frame, a downloaded logo, a small favicon, a flag, or a plain icon - and a small dot and badge next to it tell you whether it is worth a tap. This page explains what each picture and badge means and where the channel picture packs come from.

Why You'll Love This

Radio and TV channels do not come with a photo attached the way a video file does, so FastMediaSorter has to find or capture a picture for each one - a live frame, the station's own logo, a small site icon, or failing all of that, just a flag or a generic symbol. None of this is random: every tile always shows something, and what it shows tells you a little about that channel before you even press play.

The same channels also carry two kinds of small labels: a play-status dot that remembers whether a channel worked last time, and an access badge that warns you a channel might not play from where you are. Knowing what these mean saves you a wasted tap on a channel that is unlikely to work.

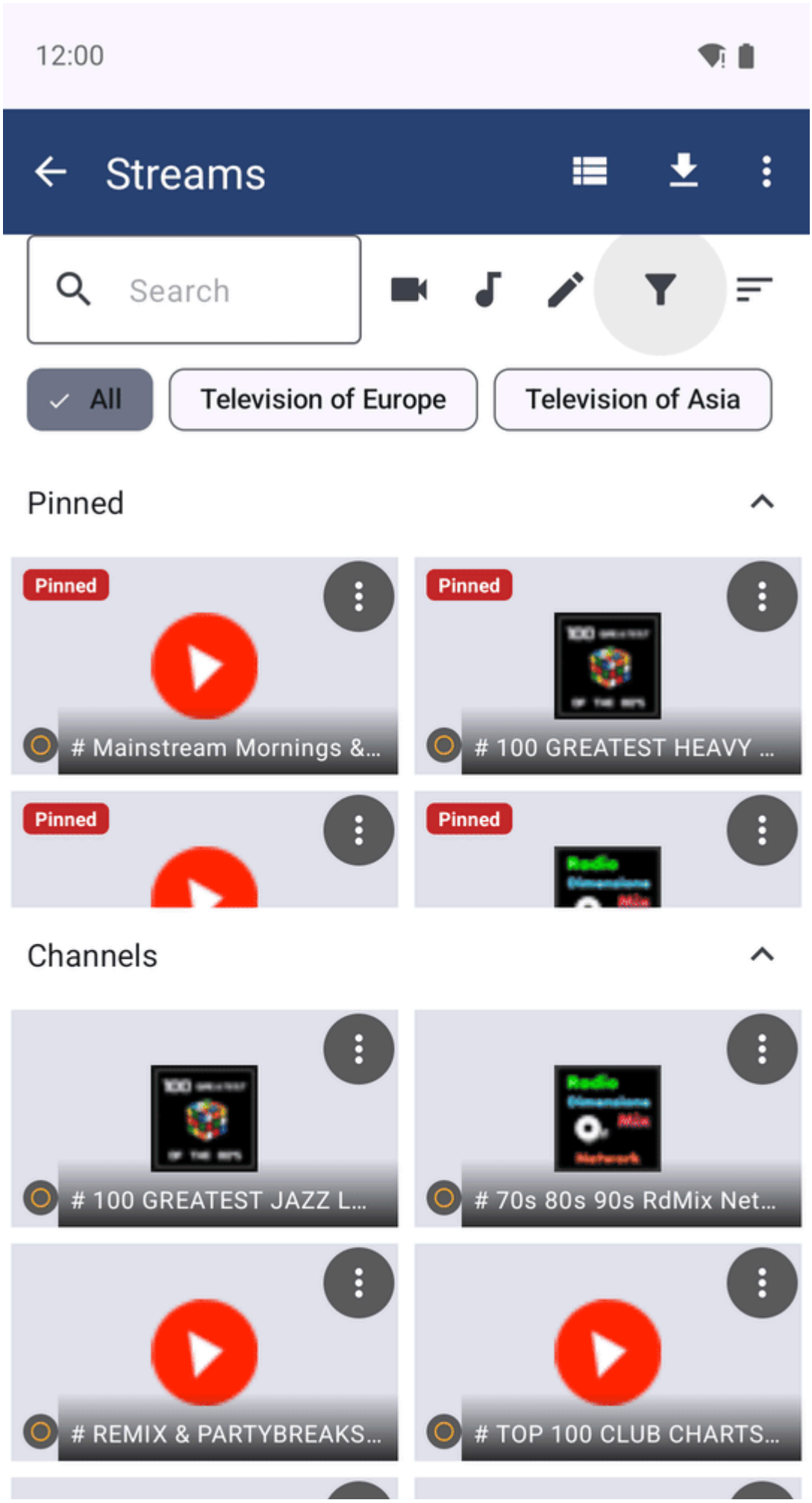
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

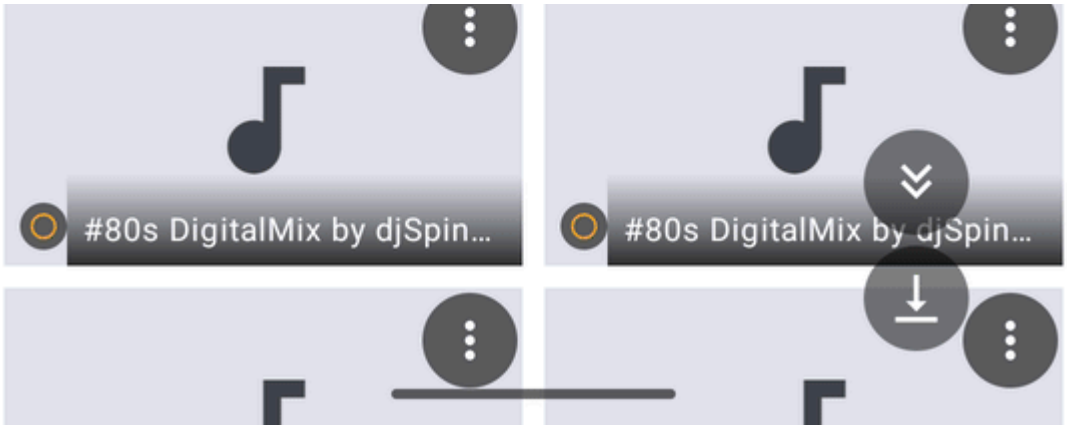
- FastMediaSorter installed in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition. Streams and everything on this page is absent from Lite, Photos and FOSS.
- The Streams screen open, with some channels in it - your own or from the catalog. See Browsing internet stream channels for how the catalog fills the list.
- An internet connection the first time you want the picture packs - after that, everything on this page works from what is already on the phone.

1 See channels come to life in grid view

Switch Streams to grid view and video channels start filling in with a real picture: a frame captured from the live feed itself, refreshed while you browse. FastMediaSorter keeps that frame on the phone, so the next time you open Streams the channel already shows it instead of a blank tile while a fresh one is captured in the background.

Every tile in the grid fills in at once when the screen opens, rather than one picture trickling in after another while you wait.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings &...
Pinned
100 GREATEST HEAVY ...
Pinned
Pinned
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ L...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Net...
REMIX & PARTYBREAKS...
TOP 100 CLUB CHARTS...



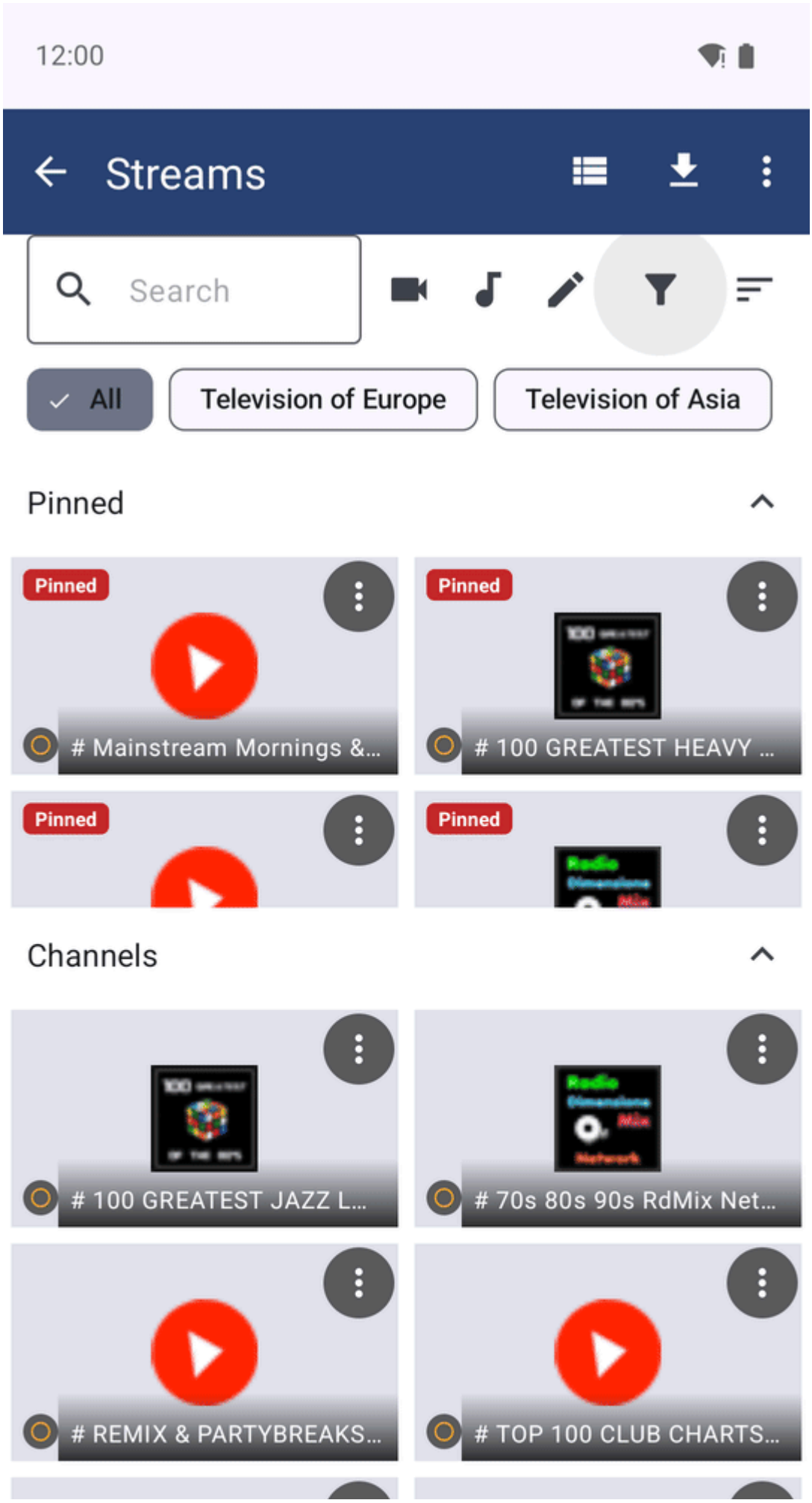
Grid view: live channels show a captured frame as soon as it is available.

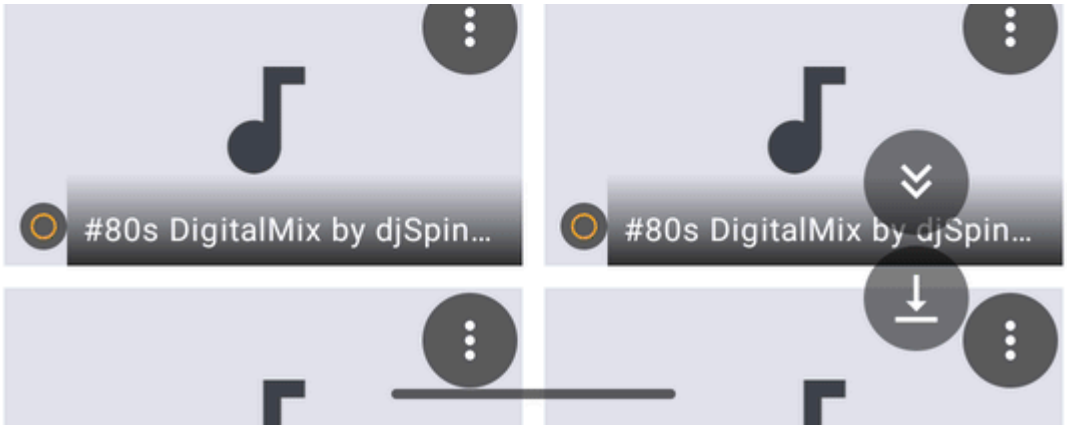
2 How FastMediaSorter picks a picture when there is no live frame

Not every channel has a frame to show - radio has no picture at all, and a video channel only gets one after it has been reachable. For those, FastMediaSorter tries a fixed order of pictures, stopping at the first one it can supply:

1. A tile from the downloadable **Channel preview atlas** - a still picture for a video channel, shown before you have watched it even once.
2. The channel's own **station logo**, from the downloadable **Station logos** pack - this is the only picture a radio station can get, since it has no video to capture from.
3. A small **favicon** - the site icon for that channel, bundled with the channel catalog itself, no separate download needed.
4. The channel's **country flag**, when none of the above is available.
5. A plain audio or video icon, when even the country is unknown.

So a logo means the station has its own artwork in the pack; a flag means FastMediaSorter knows the channel's country but has no picture for it; a plain icon means neither is available yet. Every tier keeps trying quietly in the background, so a tile that starts as a flag can still turn into a proper logo moments later.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings &...
Pinned
100 GREATEST HEAVY ...
Pinned
Pinned
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ L...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Net...
REMIX & PARTYBREAKS...
TOP 100 CLUB CHARTS...

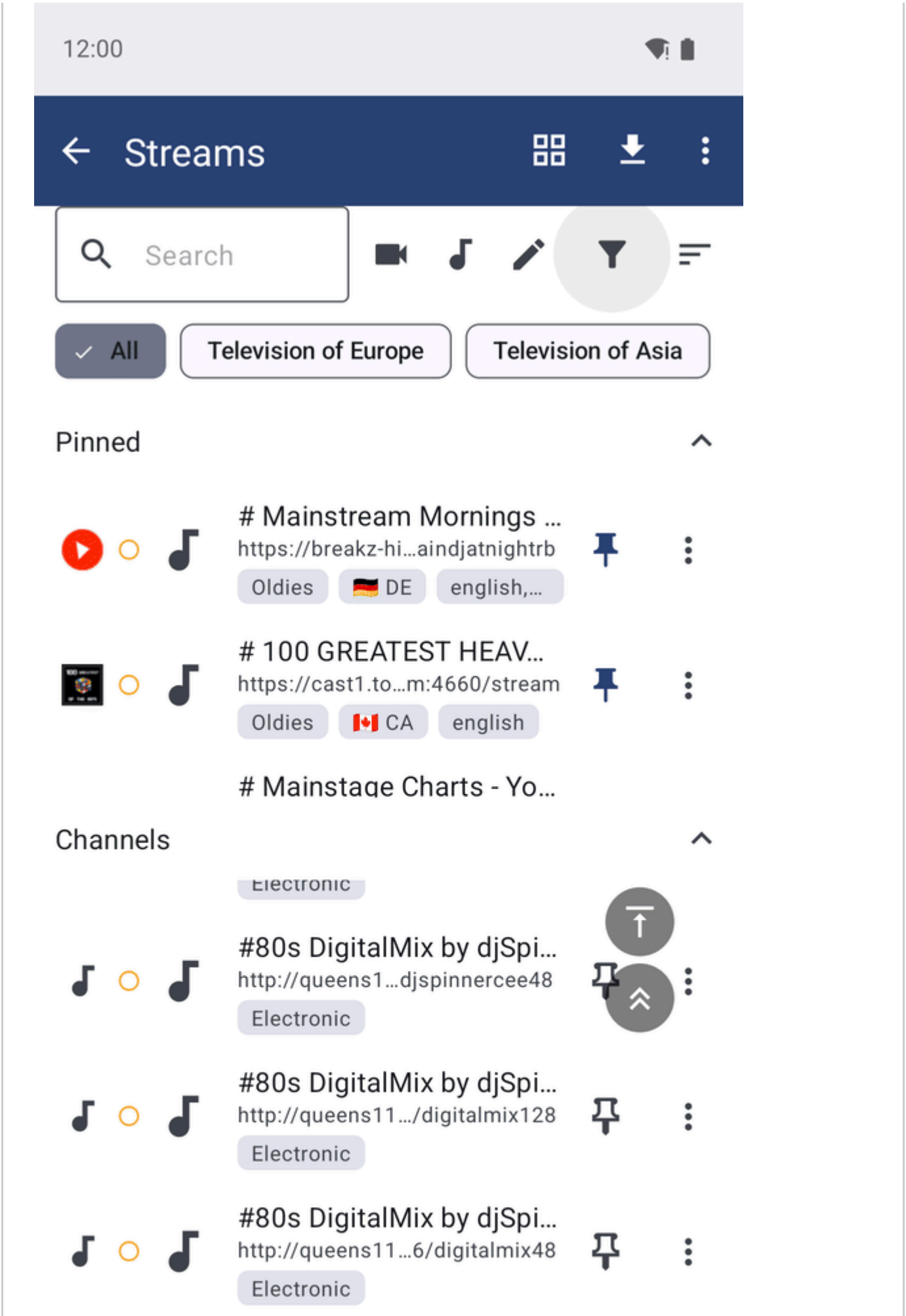


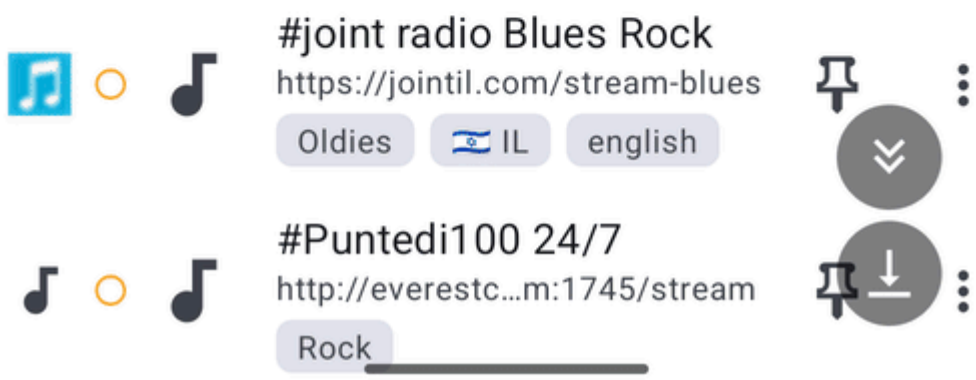
Four channels, four fallback pictures - logo, favicon, flag, plain icon.

3 Favicons and flags in list view

Switch to list view and each row keeps a small leading icon instead of a full tile. It shows the channel's favicon when the catalog has one, or the country flag in the same spot when it does not - the row never collapses or leaves an empty gap either way. A channel with neither shows the plain audio or video icon, same as in grid view.

Favicons in list view come from the same bundle as the catalog itself, so they are already there the moment you import channels - no extra download needed for this one.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens1...djspinnercee48
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11.../digitalmix128
Electronic
#80s DigitalMix by djSpi...
http://queens11...6/digitalmix48
Electronic

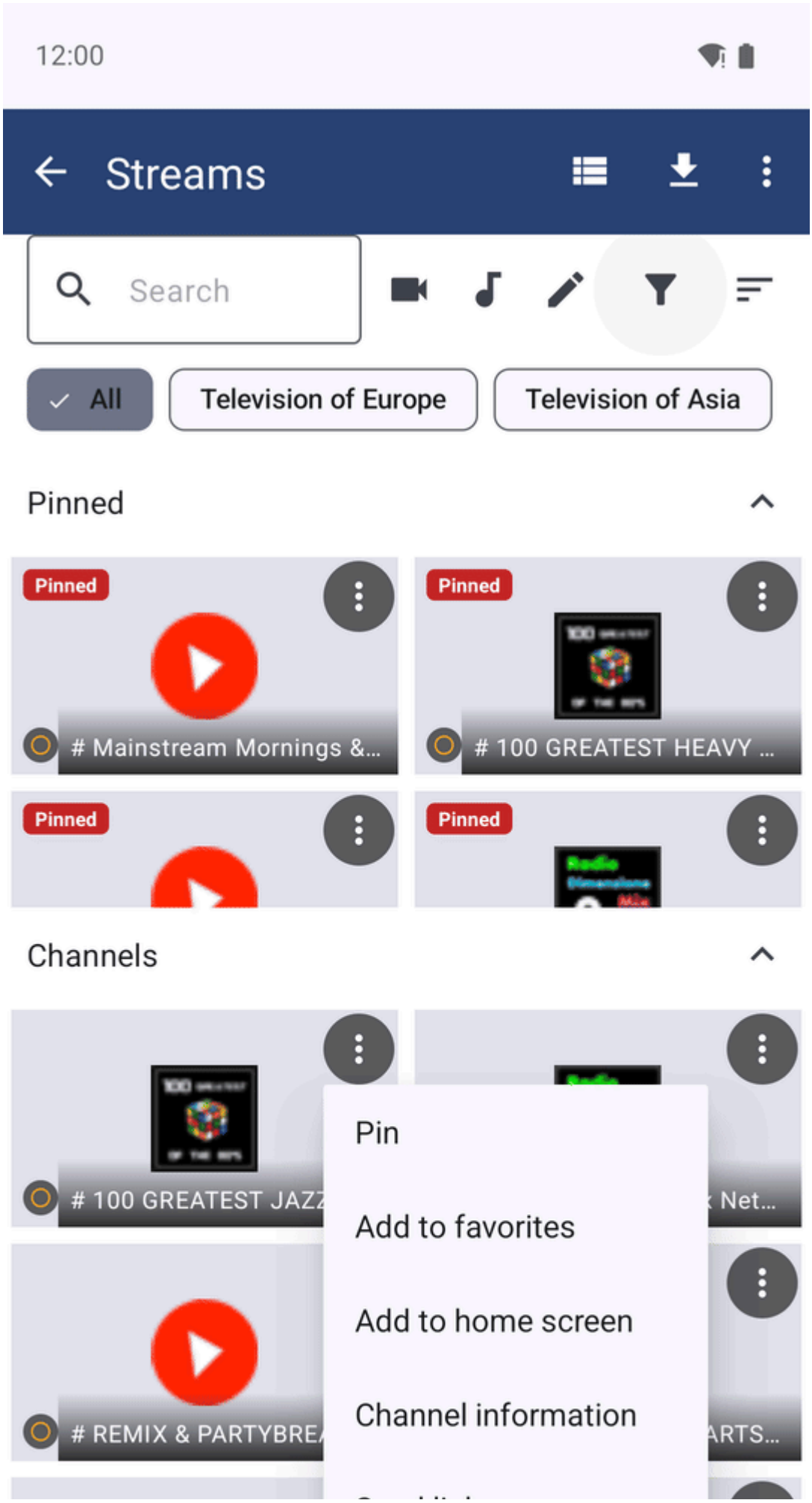


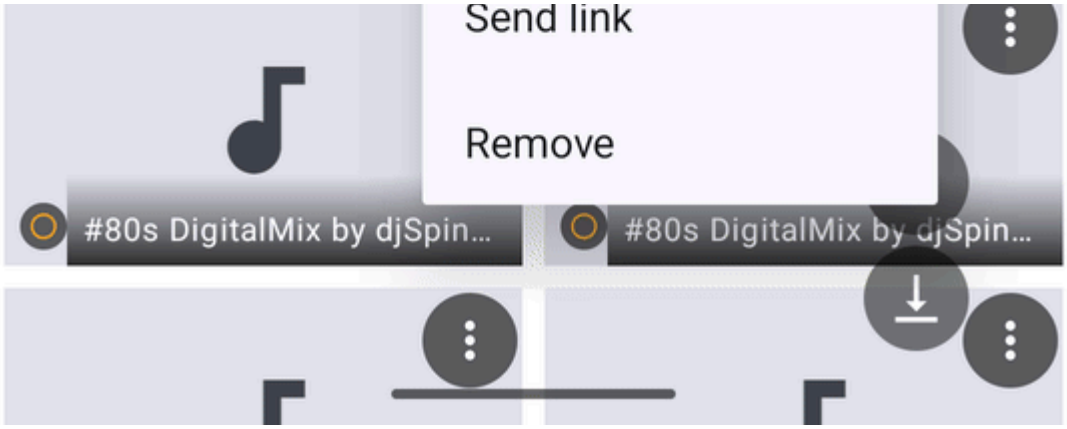
List view: a favicon, or a flag when there is none.

4 Read the grid tile's status dot and open its menu

Every grid tile carries a small dot in the bottom-left corner: a hollow ring means the channel has not been played yet, a check mark means it played back fine last time, and an exclamation mark means the last attempt failed. Shape and color both change, so the meaning still comes through in black and white.

Tap the three-dot button in the top-right corner of a tile to open its menu - the same commands as the list row's overflow menu, including editing, sharing the link and removing the channel.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings &...
Pinned
100 GREATEST HEAVY ...
Pinned
Pinned
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ
Net...
Pin
Add to favorites
Add to home screen
Channel information
REMIX & PARTYBREA
ARTS...



The status dot, bottom-left; the tile menu, top-right.

5 Understand the region and access badges

Some channels in the catalog carry a badge next to their name in list view. A **Region-locked** badge means the channel answered with an access error during the catalog's own checks and may not play from your location - it is kept in the catalog because it can still work for someone in its home region. A **Restricted** badge covers any other access limit the catalog found, without naming a specific reason.

Neither badge means the channel is broken everywhere - only that it is worth trying with that in mind. Tap the channel to open **About this channel** for the same information spelled out in full.

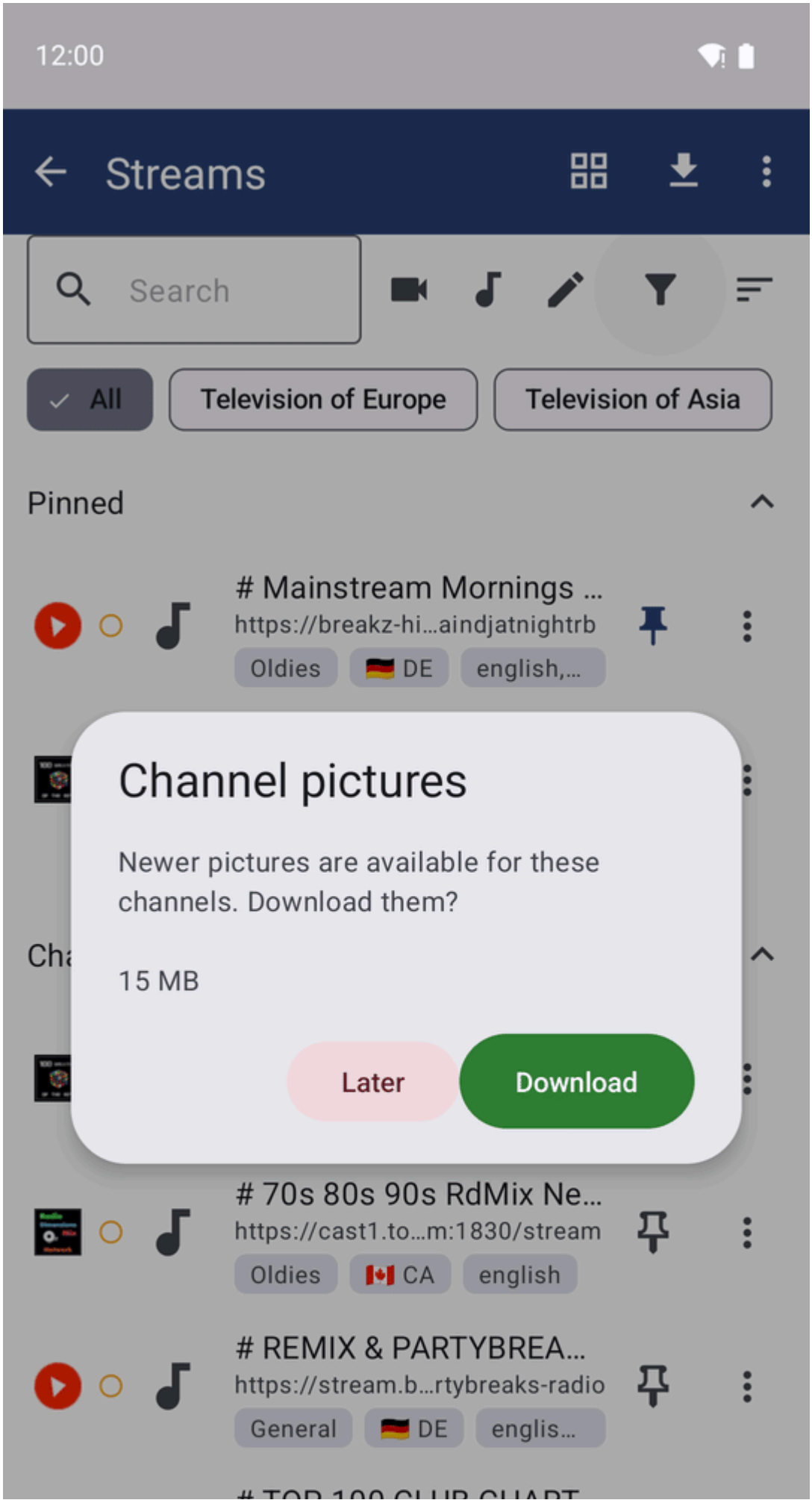
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Access restriction badges**
Streams list view, one row with the Region-locked badge, another with the generic Restricted badge.

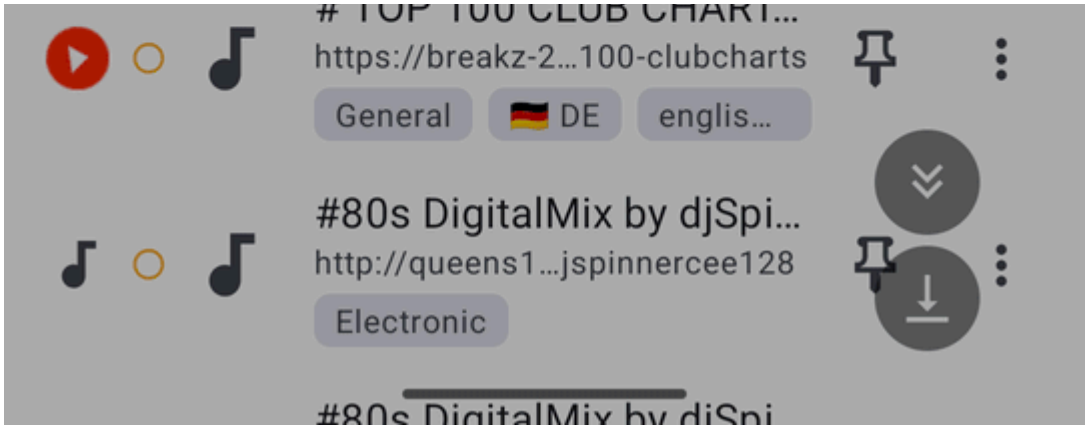
6 Get the channel pictures and station logos

The **Channel preview atlas** and **Station logos** are downloadable picture packs, not part of the app itself - they are extensions, like the channel catalog they ride along with. After a catalog refresh finds new channels, FastMediaSorter offers each pack by name, states its download size in megabytes up front, and lets you say **Download** or **Later**.

New pictures reach an installed pack as soon as they are published on the server - you do not have to wait for an app update to see them. If the pack you already have is out of date, the next catalog refresh offers a smaller update instead of the whole pack again.

You can also manage both packs by hand any time from the Downloadable Extensions screen - see Downloadable extensions for how to install, update and delete them there.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
Channel pictures
Newer pictures are available for these channels. Download them?
15 MB
Later
Download
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...



The offer to download channel pictures, size included.

7 Thumbnails keep themselves fresh

Watching a video channel updates its own tile: the frame you were just looking at becomes its thumbnail, so the grid shows what you actually saw last, not an older capture. This works whether you stop by pressing Back or by leaving the fullscreen player.

An unreachable channel is not hammered with repeated capture attempts - FastMediaSorter backs off and tries it less often instead, and a status change repaints only the dot, so scrolling the grid never flickers. None of this needs a network connection to stay calm: with no connectivity the grid simply waits rather than timing out every visible tile, and previews pick back up on their own once the connection returns.

The pictures themselves are kept in a small on-disk cache with its own size budget, cleared out automatically as needed - there is nothing to configure or clean up by hand.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Thumbnail refreshed after watching**
Streams grid view after returning from fullscreen playback, the played channel's tile showing the freshly captured frame.

What You Get

You can tell at a glance why a channel shows a live frame, a logo, a flag or a plain icon, what its status dot and access badges mean, and how to fetch the channel preview and station-logo packs so more channels get their own picture.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A tile still shows a flag or a plain icon after a while?** That channel is not in the current picture pack yet, or you have not downloaded the pack - see step 6 above.
- **Want to know exactly why a channel is badged?** Open its **About this channel** window from the tile or row menu for the full explanation.
- **Only care about the channels you already trust?** Pinning keeps your favorites at the top regardless of pictures or badges - see Pinned and favorite channels.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

Browsing internet stream channels

Filter, sort and search the channel catalog to find the stations you want.

STREAMS

Importing M3U/IPTV playlists

Add your own channels by typing a URL or importing an M3U playlist.

EDITIONS

Downloadable extensions

Install, update and delete the channel preview atlas, station logos and other downloadable extras by hand.

Streams: Playback

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #05

Playing Live Streams and Radio

Tap a channel and it plays: radio inside the list with the current song in view, TV and video full screen with only the controls that make sense for a live picture, and music that keeps going when you leave the app.

Why You'll Love This

Some things are never saved as a file: the morning show on your favorite radio station, the news channel, a webcam looking at a harbor. A stream is that kind of live feed, and FastMediaSorter plays it straight from its web address.

This recipe is about the moment after you have found a channel: tapping it, listening while you do something else, watching a video channel full screen, and knowing what the app is doing when the sound goes quiet. Radio plays right inside the Streams list, so you can keep scrolling and pick the next station while the current one plays.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition. Streams do not exist in the Lite, Photos or FOSS editions.
- Streams turned on: **Settings**, **Media** tab, **Streams** section, **Enable Streams**. A device profile chosen in the welcome wizard may have turned it on already, and the wizard has its own Streams page. The list of catalog sources can also be downloaded from the **Extensions** screen.
- At least one channel in the list - from the catalog or added by you. See browsing the channel catalog and adding your own streams.
- An internet connection: Wi-Fi or mobile data.
- For listening with the screen off: permission to show notifications. See understanding app permissions.

1 Open Streams

When Streams is turned on, a **Streams** item appears in the main menu of the main screen, and the welcome wizard offers it too. Turning **Enable Streams** off hides the item again; your channels stay stored and come back when you turn it on.

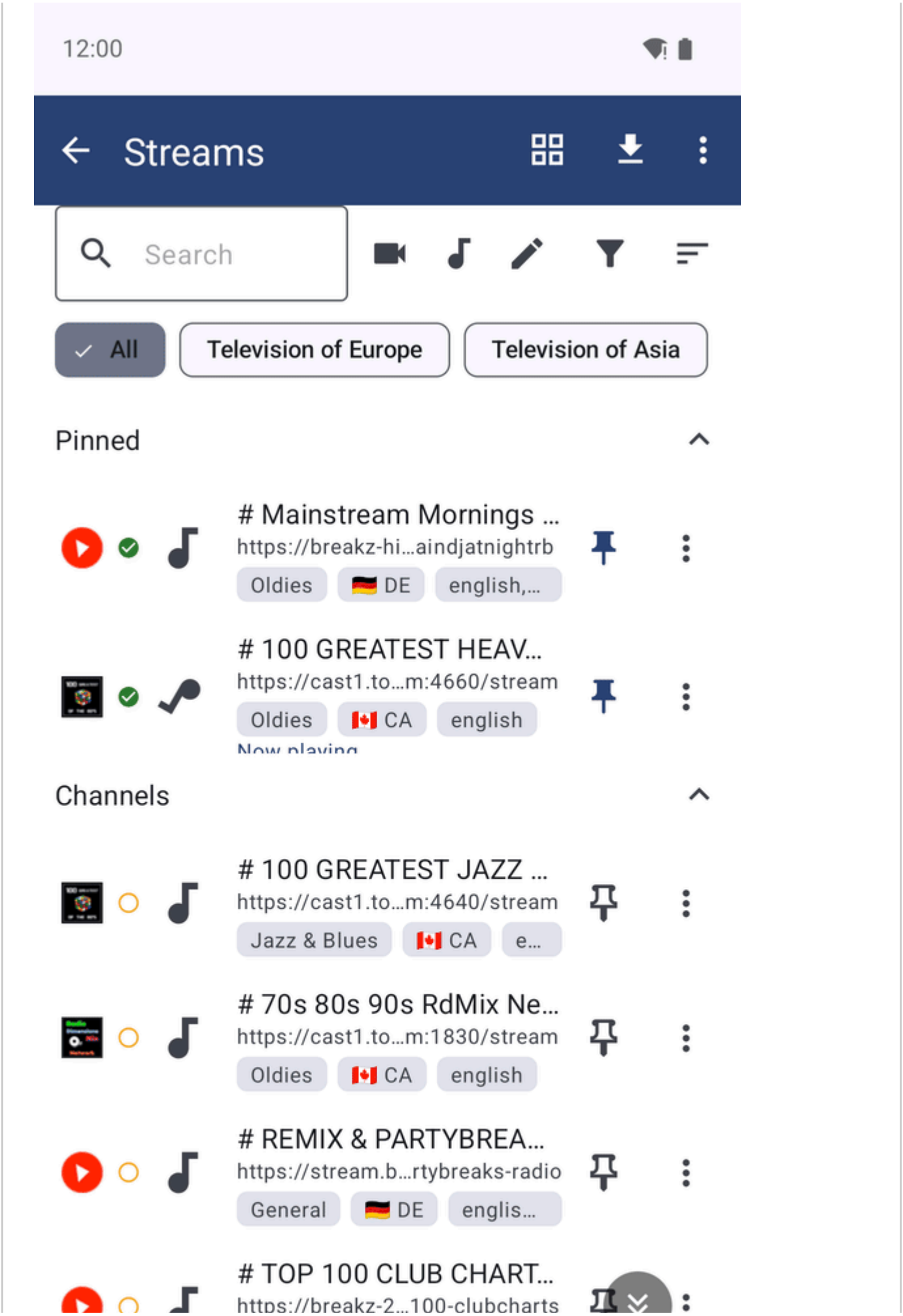
You can also open Streams from the streams panel above the resource list - see streams on the home screen and the main screen.

2 Listen to a radio station without leaving the list

Tap an audio channel. It starts playing at once, and a small bar appears at the bottom of the screen: **Now playing**, the channel name, the song that is on air right now and a **Stop** button. The list stays in view, so you can keep scrolling, searching and filtering while you listen.

To stop, tap **Stop** - or simply tap the same channel again. One tap starts it, the next tap stops it, even if you tap twice quickly while the station is still connecting.

Many stations send the artist and title of the song that is playing. FastMediaSorter shows it in the bottom bar, in the notification, on the lock screen and on the channel's tile while it plays. This is the now-playing information.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Now playing
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...
TOP 100 CLUB CHART...
https://breakz-2...100-clubcharts

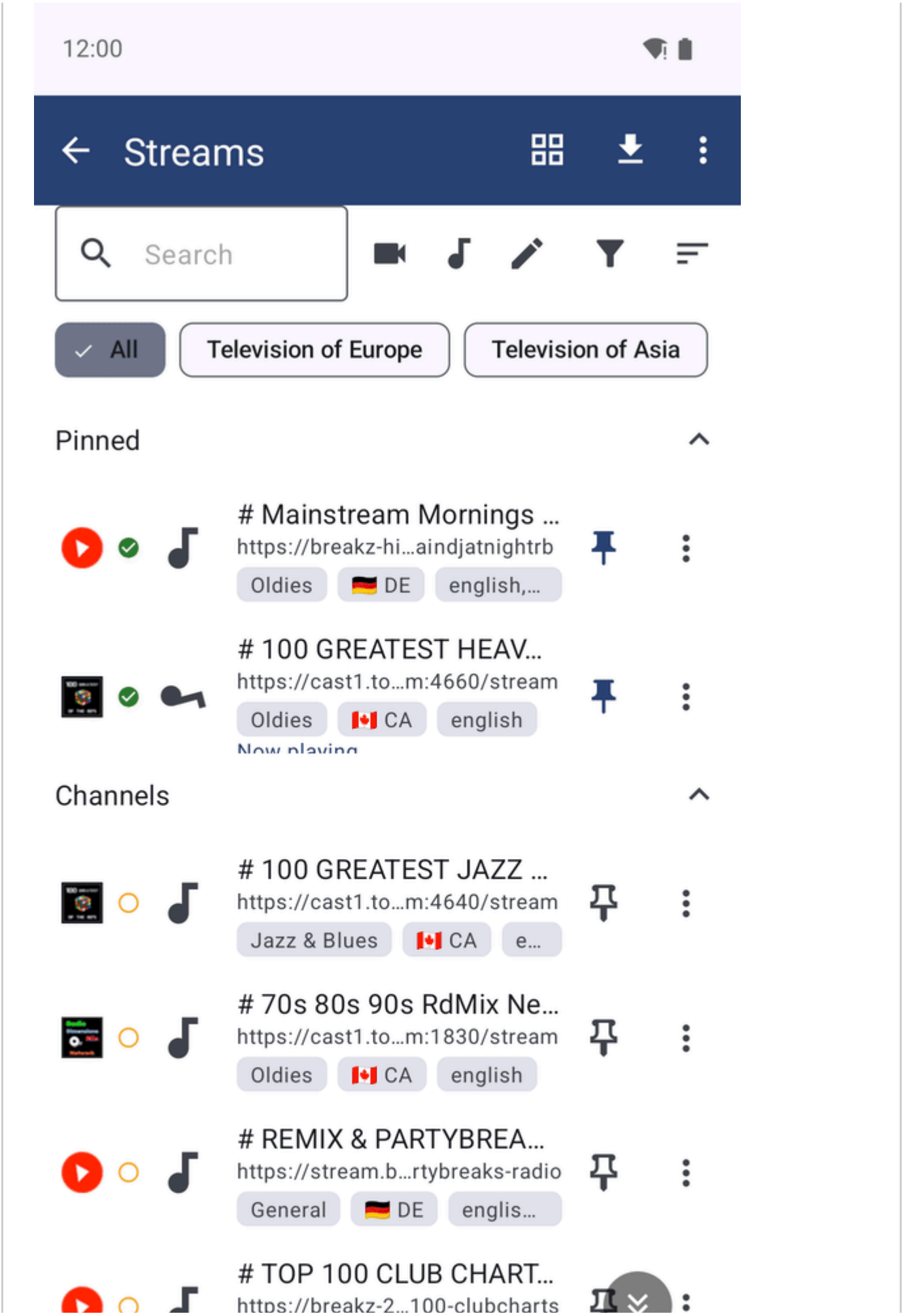
Radio plays inside the list; the bar at the bottom shows what is on air.

3 Read the small mark on each channel

Each channel row carries a small mark that tells you how it went the last time you played it on this phone:

- a green check – **Verified online**: it really played here;
- a red exclamation mark – **Last playback failed**: the last attempt did not start, for example because the address is gone or the server refused;
- a hollow amber circle – **Not played yet**: you have never tried it on this device.

The marks differ in shape, not only in color, and a screen reader says them aloud. They are kept after a restart. To start with a clean slate, use **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Streams**, **Clear play marks**; the channels themselves stay.


12:00
Streams
Search
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Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Now playing
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
CA
e...
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...
TOP 100 CLUB CHART...
https://breakz-2...100-clubcharts

Played here, failed last time, never tried.

4 Watch a TV or video channel full screen

Tap a video channel. It opens straight into the full-screen video player, with nothing on top of the picture. Tap the picture once to show the controls; they hide again by themselves after a few seconds, together with the close button in the top-right corner.

A live channel has no beginning and no end, so the player shows only what makes sense for it: play and pause, the video control window, picture-in-picture, full screen, rotation, saving the current frame, file information, Chromecast and **Send to**. Actions meant for files - delete, rename, edit, copy, move, slideshow, favorites, sleep timer, the seek bar and next or previous file - are hidden. Ordinary video and music files keep all their controls.

Send to shares the channel's web address as text, so you can paste it into any messenger, mail or SMS. The live picture itself is not downloaded.

When the channel sends the name of the show that is on air, the player shows it over the picture.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Live channel in the video player**
Full-screen player on an HLS video channel, controls visible after a tap, show name shown, no seek bar.

Remote control, keyboard and mouse

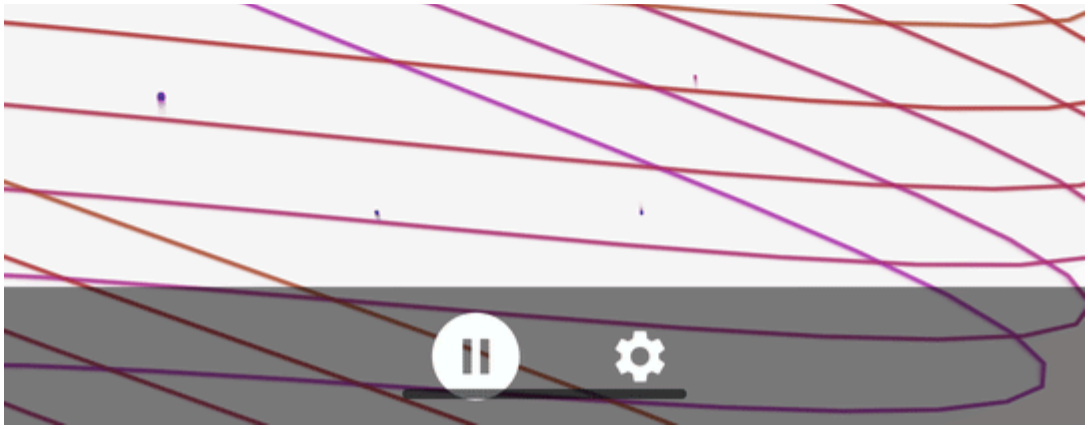
The whole Streams screen works without touching it. On a TV remote or a keyboard, the D-pad moves between the search field, the filter and sort buttons, the list and the **Stop** button; **Enter** confirms a dialog and **Escape** closes it. With a mouse, a right click on a channel opens its menu. More in keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

5 Turn radio into a full-screen music show

If you like to watch something while you listen, switch on **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Streams**, **Visualize audio streams as music**. Now a tap on a radio station opens a full-screen player instead of the bottom bar.

The player draws moving waves and particles to the music and shows the current song. From there you can open the song's lyrics, which refresh by themselves when the next song starts, open **About this channel** to see the address, format and the speed of the connection, set a sleep timer, and share the channel's link. The sleep timer works the same way as for music files - see playback order, sleep timer and background listening.

12:00
100 GREATEST HEAVY METAL



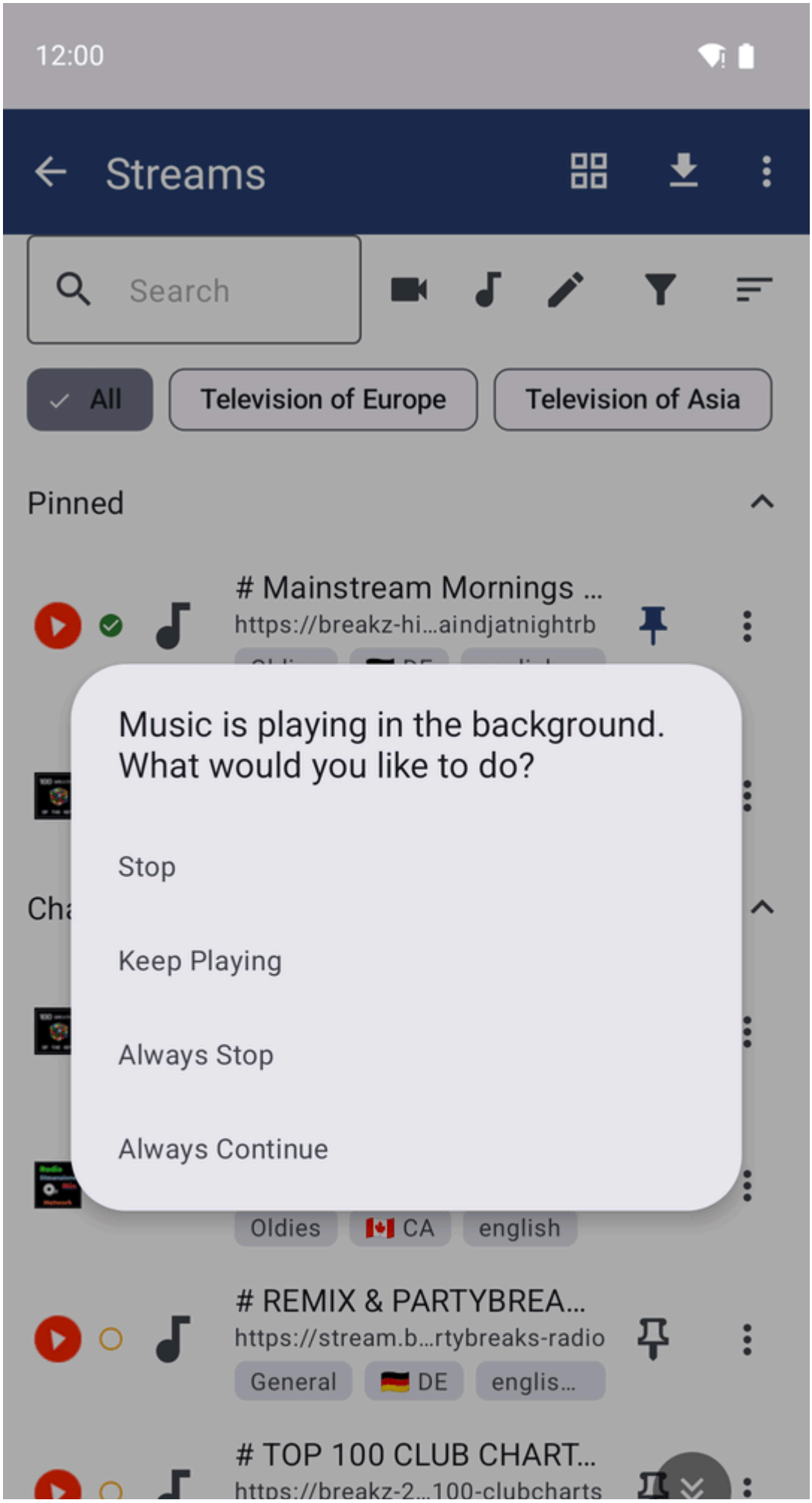
Radio with the full-screen visualization turned on.

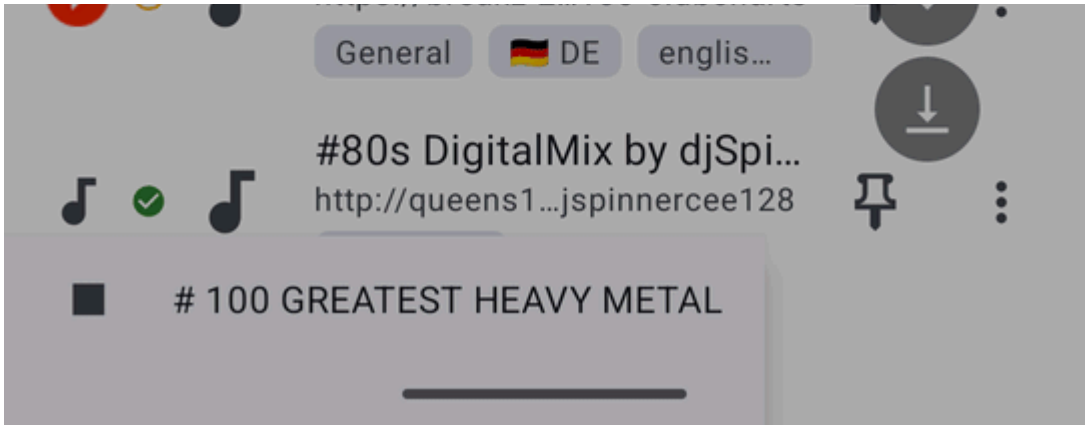
6 Keep listening when you leave the app

Radio does not have to stop when you switch to another app or lock the screen. This is controlled by **Settings**, the **Player** tab, group **Background audio playback**, switch **Background Playback**. In the Standard and noLegal editions it is on from the start.

- **On**: the station keeps playing and you control it from the notification and the lock screen. The notification shows the song that is on air.
- **Off**: the station stops as soon as you leave or minimize Streams.
  When you go back from Streams while a station plays, the app asks: **Music is playing in the background. What would you like to do?** - **Stop**, **Keep Playing**, **Always Stop** or **Always Continue**. The last two remember your answer. You can change that answer later in the same group, row **When leaving player or streams**: **Ask every time (default)**, **Always stop** or **Always keep playing**. It is the same question the music player asks - see picture-in-picture and background play.

  While a station plays in the background, a slim bar on the main screen shows what is on and has a **Stop** button in its left corner.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Music is playing in the background.
What would you like to do?
Stop
Keep Playing
Always Stop
Always Continue
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...
TOP 100 CLUB CHART...



Leaving Streams while the radio plays.

7 Pick up where you left off

If a radio station was playing when you closed the app, it starts again the next time you open FastMediaSorter - handy for a station you listen to every morning. A video channel, or a Streams screen with nothing playing, leaves nothing to resume.

What You Get

Radio plays inside the list with the current song in view, video channels fill the screen with only the controls that make sense for live TV, and the music carries on in your pocket until you stop it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Nothing happens and a message says there is no network?** FastMediaSorter checks the connection before it starts a stream. With no Wi-Fi and no mobile data it says so at once instead of spinning. Connect and tap the channel again.
- **The station stops when the screen turns off?** Check that **Background Playback** is on and that the app may show notifications. Some phones also stop background apps to save battery; allow FastMediaSorter to run without battery restrictions in the Android settings.
- **A channel keeps spinning or shows a failure dialog?** See when the connection is weak for what the app does by itself and what the dialogs mean.
- **Want the details of a channel?** Its menu has **About this channel**: the address, where the channel came from, when it last played and, while it plays, the picture size, codecs and the incoming speed. **Copy all** copies it as text.
- **A channel from an old playlist with an unusual type** is played according to its address, so it behaves the same everywhere in the app.
- **Want a phone or a watch to go on air for your other devices?** The media exchange portal explains the routes between devices and marks what is not available yet.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

When the connection is weak

Buffering, reconnecting, picture quality and the failure dialogs.

STREAMS

Streams on the home screen and the main screen

Start your favorite station with one tap.

STREAMS

Streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset

Cast a channel, send it to the watch, open it in VR, or tune in to a friend's broadcast.

STREAMS

Pinned and favorite channels

Keep the channels you play most at the top.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #07

Your Stations One Tap Away - Shortcuts, the Stream Widget and the Streams Panel

Your everyday stations, one tap away: a shortcut or the **Stream** widget on the Android home screen, or the streams panel with your pinned channels on the FastMediaSorter main screen.

Why You'll Love This

You probably come back to the same two or three stations every day. Opening the app, finding Streams and scrolling to the station each time is three steps too many.

FastMediaSorter gives you three ways to skip them. A shortcut or a widget on the Android home screen starts a station without opening any screen at all. The streams panel puts your pinned channels right on the app's main screen, above your resources.

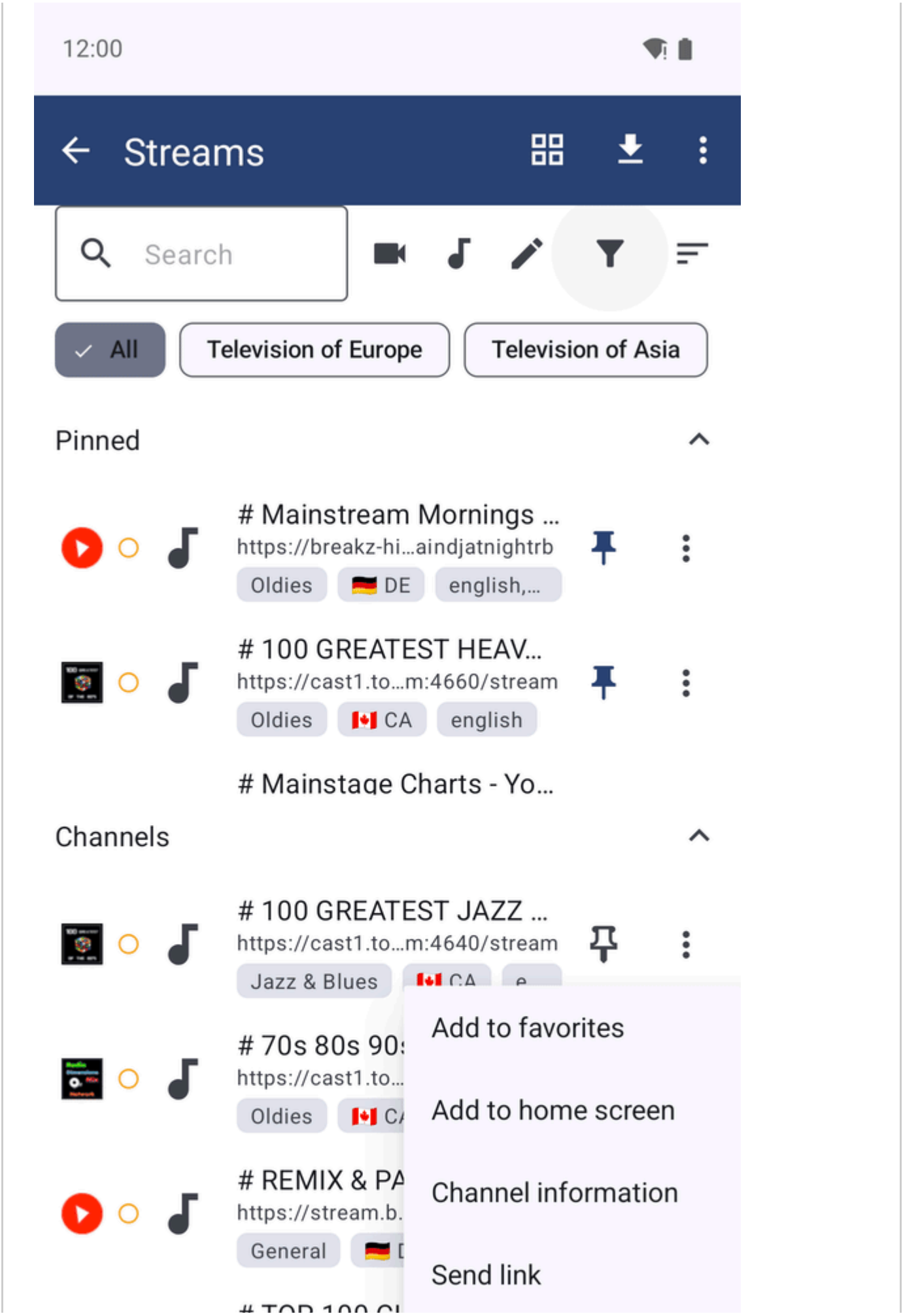
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

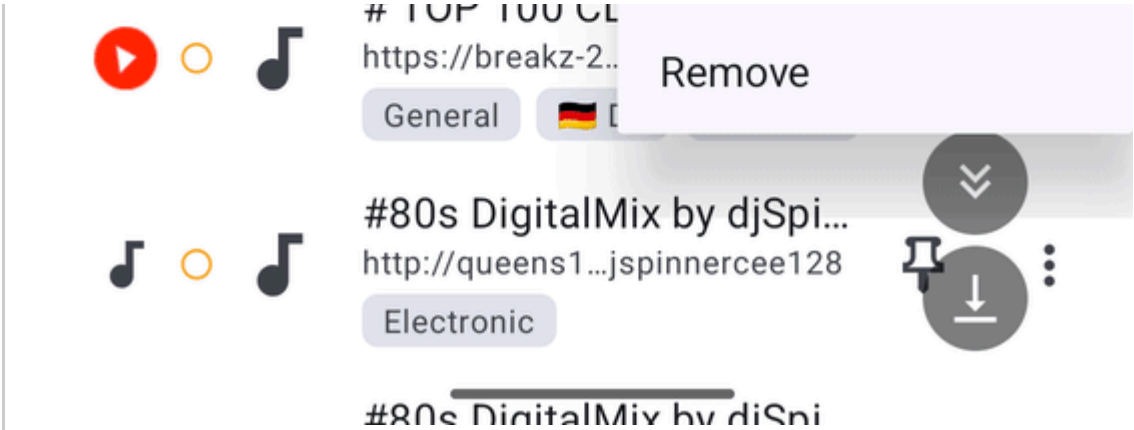
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR editio n, with Streams turned on.
- The channels you want at hand. For the streams panel they must be pinned - see pinned and favorite channels.
- For shortcuts and widgets: a home screen app that supports them. Almost every Android home screen does.

1 Put a station on the home screen

In Streams, open the menu of the channel - touch and hold it, or tap its **More actions** button - and choose **Add to home screen**. Android asks where to place the icon; confirm, and a shortcut with the channel's name appears on your home screen.

If your home screen cannot hold shortcuts, the app tells you: **Your launcher does not support home-screen shortcuts**.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
Television of Europe
Television of Asia
Pinned
Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
english,...
100 GREATEST HEAV...
https://cast1.to...m:4660/stream
Oldies
CA
english
Mainstage Charts - Yo...
Channels
100 GREATEST JAZZ ...
https://cast1.to...m:4640/stream
Jazz & Blues
70s 80s 90
https://cast1.to...
Oldies
REMIX & PA
https://stream.b...
General
Add to favorites
Add to home screen
Channel information
Send link



Add to home screen is in the channel's own menu.

2 Tap the shortcut to play, tap again to stop

Tap the shortcut of a radio station, and it simply starts playing - no screen opens, you stay on your home screen. The ordinary media notification shows that it plays and lets you control it. Tap the same shortcut again to stop the station.

The Streams screen opens instead when:

- the channel is a video channel - a picture needs a screen;
- background playback is switched off (**Settings**, the **Player** tab, **Background Playback**);
- there is no network, so the screen can tell you so.
  If the channel has been removed from your list meanwhile, you see **This stream is no longer in your list**. Shortcuts made with an older version of the app are brought up to date by themselves on the next start.

3 Add the Stream widget

A widget does the same job and lets you pick the channel right on the home screen:

1. Touch and hold an empty spot of the home screen and choose **Widgets**.
2. Find FastMediaSorter and drag the **Stream** widget – **Open a saved channel from the home screen** – onto the screen.
3. A picker opens. Type a few letters of the channel name; radio and video channels are listed separately. Tap the one you want.
   From now on one tap on the widget starts that channel – a radio station plays in the background the same way as a shortcut, a video channel opens. How to place and resize widgets in general is described in placing Android widgets.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stream widget channel picker**
Stream widget configuration screen, a search typed, radio and video sections visible.

4 Turn on the streams panel on the main screen

Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, and switch on **Show streams panel on the main screen**. It is off until you turn it on, and it appears only while Streams is enabled.

A horizontal bar appears above the resource list. It starts with the **Streams..** button, which opens the Streams screen, followed by your pinned channels in the order you pinned them. Each channel shows its logo, its short name or both - whatever fits the width of your screen.

Nothing pinned yet? The panel then shows a small hint, **Pin streams to see them on this panel.**, which disappears as soon as you pin the first channel.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Streams panel on the main screen**
Main screen, streams panel on, the Streams.. button and four pinned channel chips with logos and short names.

5 Play a station from the panel

Tap a radio channel on the panel. It plays right on the main screen: a bar at the bottom shows the channel name, the current song and a **Stop** button, and you keep browsing your files. Tap the same channel again to stop it.

A video channel opens the Streams screen and plays there.

6 Fold, hide or switch off the panel

Touch and hold the **Streams..** button on the panel. Its menu offers:

- **Collapse panel** - folds the panel to take less room;
- **Hide panel** - removes only the panel; Streams stays on and its button moves back to the programs panel and the menu;
- **Disable** - turns the whole Streams feature off.

To bring a hidden panel back, switch on **Show streams panel on the main screen** in **Settings**, the **General** tab, again.

What You Get

Your everyday stations start with one tap from the home screen or the main screen, radio plays without opening anything, and the panel shows only when you want it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A shortcut opens Streams instead of playing?** Check that **Background Playback** is on and that you are online; video channels always open a screen.
- **Want the panel in a different order?** It follows the order of your pinned channels. Reorder them in Streams - see pinned and favorite channels.
- **Using the FastMediaSorter home screen?** A channel can also sit on its desktop. See desktop grid and icons.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

Playing live streams and radio

STREAMS

Pinned and favorite channels

Everything that happens after the tap.

Choose which channels appear on the panel.

STREAMS

Streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset

Take a station to your wrist or a channel to the TV.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #08

Chromecast - Standard, noLegal and Legacy; watch - Standard and noLegal; VR player - noLegal and VR; Live Broadcast - Standard, noLegal and Legacy

Streams on a TV, a Watch or a VR Headset, and Tuning In to a Live Broadcast

Take a live channel to the TV with Chromecast, to your watch or into a VR headset, and add a friend's Live Broadcast to your Streams with a QR code, a link or a file.

Why You'll Love This

A football match deserves the big TV, the morning radio fits on your wrist during a run, and a nature webcam looks best all around you in a headset. A live stream in FastMediaSorter can go to each of them.

It works the other way round, too: when a friend or a family member starts a Live Broadcast on their phone - a baby monitor, a talk in the next room, a view of the garden - you add it to your Streams like any other channel and open it whenever it is on air.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter with Streams turned on. Each step names the editions it needs; see the edition list at the top of this page.
- For the TV: a Chromecast or a TV with Chromecast built in, on the same Wi-Fi as the phone.
- For the watch: a Wear OS watch paired with the phone, with the watch app installed, and the Wear companion turned on - see installing the watch app and pairing.
- For VR: a VR headset such as Meta Quest with the noLegal or VR edition installed.
- For a Live Broadcast: the other phone and yours on the same Wi-Fi network.

1 Show a live channel on the TV

Editions: Standard, noLegal and Legacy.

Open a video channel so it plays full screen, tap the picture to show the controls and tap the Chromecast button (**Cast to..**). Pick your TV. The channel starts on the TV right away: FastMediaSorter hands the channel's address to the Chromecast, which then plays the live broadcast by itself. Nothing is downloaded first, and the phone is free again.

This works for the common TV formats (HLS, DASH and ordinary web video). RTSP cameras cannot be cast; the app then says **This stream can't be cast to Chromecast**. Casting files works the same way - see Chromecast casting and live broadcast.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Casting a live channel**
Full-screen player on a live HLS channel, the Chromecast chooser open with one TV listed.

2 Send a channel to your watch

Editions: Standard and noLegal.

The watch gets its own list of channels from the catalog. A channel that you added yourself can join it: in Streams, open the channel's menu and choose **Send to watch**. The item is there while the Wear companion is turned on (**Settings**, the **Management** tab, section **Wear Companion**).

The phone tells you how it went: **Stream sent to the watch**, **Stream updated on the watch** if it was there already, or **Watch is not reachable – stream not sent** if the watch is out of range. Your channel stays on the watch even when the watch refreshes its catalog.

3 Start a channel on the watch from the phone

Editions: Standard and noLegal.

Choose **Open on watch** in the channel's menu. The watch saves the channel and, if the watch app is on its screen, starts playing it: the phone says **Playing on the watch**.

If the watch app is closed, the phone says so honestly: **Saved to the watch – open the watch app to play it**. Android does not let a phone wake an app on the watch, so open the watch app and the channel is waiting there. The watch then shows the logo of the channel you played last on its stream shortcut. Listening on the watch itself is described in streaming radio on your wrist.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Open on watch**
Streams list after Open on watch, confirmation message at the bottom of the screen.

4 Open a live video channel in VR

Editions: noLegal and VR, on a VR headset.

On a headset with 3D VR playback turned on, the menu of a video channel has **Open in VR**, and the player shows a VR badge you can tap as well. The channel opens in the immersive VR player - see VR cinema playback. Because it is live, the controls in the headset leave out the seek bar and the previous and next buttons.

A few kinds of channels cannot open in the VR player yet. The app then says: **This channel uses a transport the VR player cannot open yet. It still plays in the normal player.**

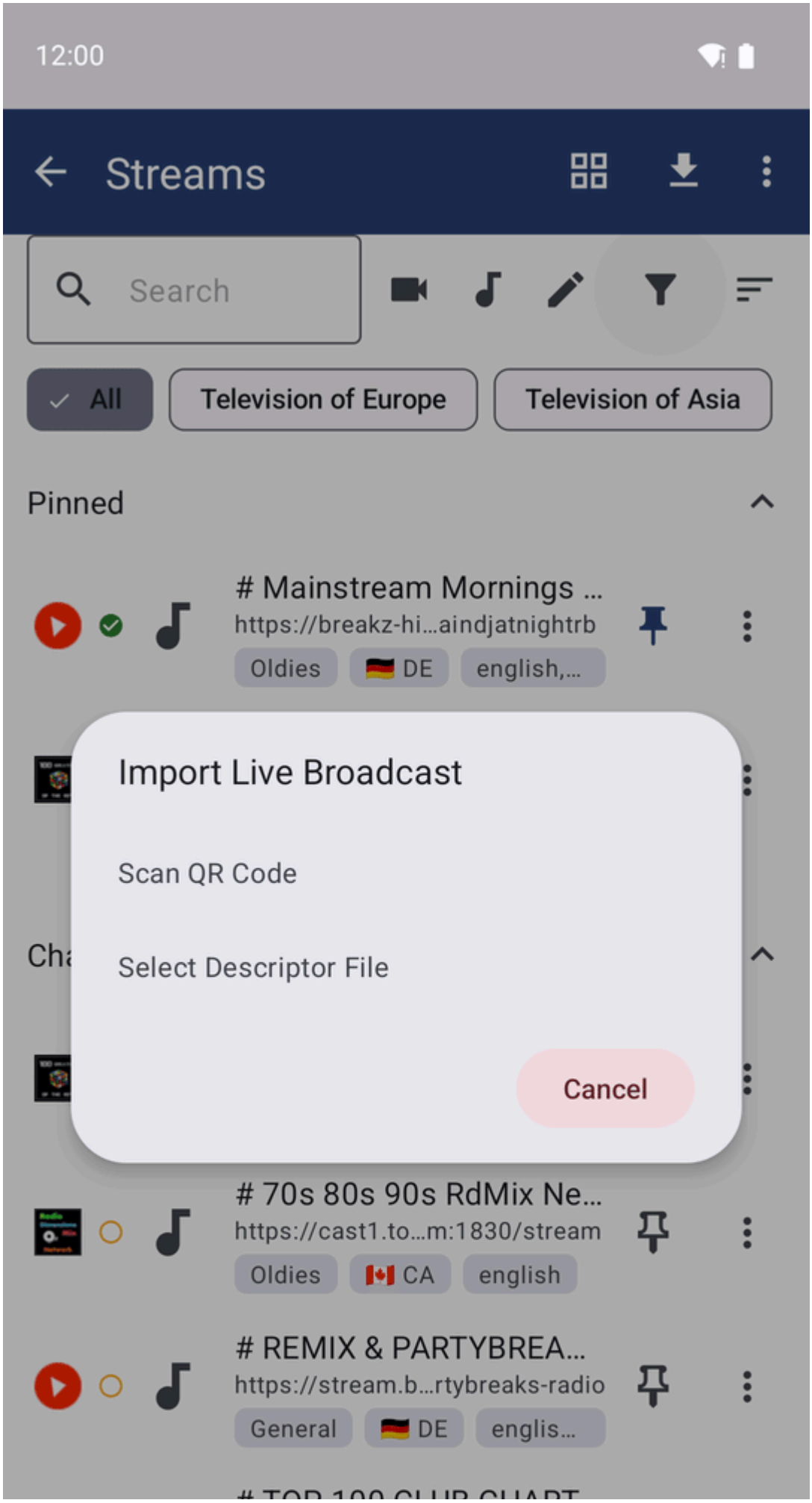
5 Tune in to someone's Live Broadcast

Editions: Standard, noLegal and Legacy.

When someone starts a Live Broadcast on their phone, their screen shows a QR code with the broadcast's address printed under it. Add it to your Streams in whichever way is easiest:

- **Scan it**: in Streams, open the three-dots menu, choose **Import Broadcast (QR / File)** and then **Scan QR Code**, and point the camera at their screen.
- **Tap a link**: if they sent you the link, tap it - FastMediaSorter opens straight into the Streams import. On a phone without the app, the link opens a web page that offers to install it and to open the broadcast afterwards.
- **Open a file**: if they sent a broadcast file (it ends in **.fmsbcast**), tap it in any file manager, or choose **Select Descriptor File** in the same menu.
- **Type it**: a phone without a camera can add the address printed under the QR code by hand, as described in adding your own streams.

You see **Broadcast channel added**, and the broadcast appears in your list. It is marked as live, and the player keeps close to the live moment, so what you hear is what is happening now. If the broadcasting phone later gets a new address on the network, adding it again updates the same channel: **Broadcast updated with its new address**.


12:00
Streams
Search
All
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Television of Asia
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Mainstream Mornings ...
https://breakz-hi...aindjatnightrb
Oldies
DE
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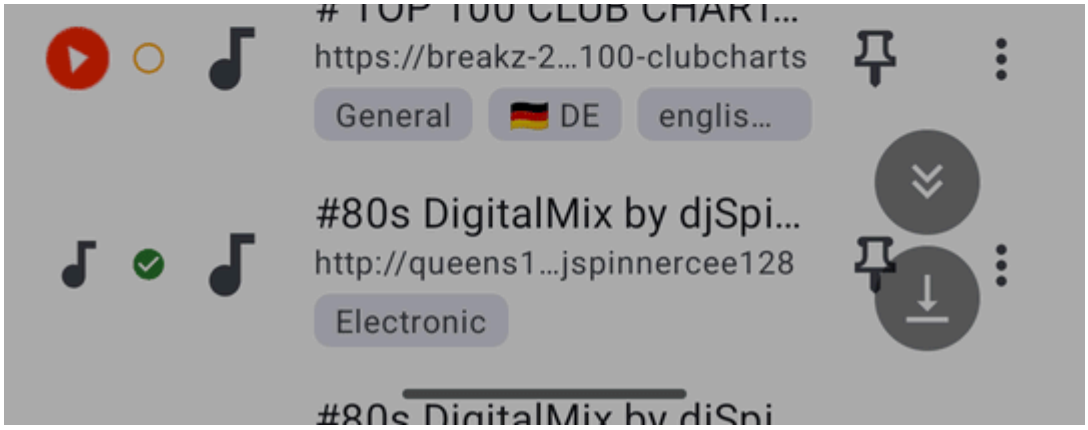
Import Live Broadcast
Scan QR Code
Select Descriptor File
Cancel
70s 80s 90s RdMix Ne...
https://cast1.to...m:1830/stream
Oldies
CA
english
REMIX & PARTYBREA...
https://stream.b...rtybreaks-radio
General
DE
englis...



Add a Live Broadcast with a QR code or a file.

6 Start your own broadcast

Editions: Standard, noLegal and Legacy.

Your phone can be the station too. How to start a Live Broadcast is a recipe of its own: Chromecast casting and live broadcast. A few things there help the people who tune in:

- The share screen prints the address under the QR code, labeled and selectable, so you can read it out to someone whose device has no camera. It stays there even if the QR code cannot be drawn.
- You choose the camera lens before you start and can switch it while you are on air. Turning the camera off keeps your listeners connected, and **Stop** in the notification ends the broadcast.
- The settings button on the broadcast screen opens title, port, bit rate, audio format, microphone gain and **Auto-open share screen** in place, without leaving the screen.
- **Send to watch** on the broadcast screen sends the running broadcast to your paired watch and asks it to start playing at once (Standard and noLegal editions).
- While you broadcast, the live mark on the main screen counts the time from the moment you started, even after you come back to the main screen from somewhere else.

What You Get

A live channel plays on the TV, on your wrist or all around you in a headset, and a friend's broadcast sits in your Streams list, ready to open whenever they go on air.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Chromecast not in the list?** The phone and the TV must be on the same Wi-Fi network; guest networks often keep devices apart.
- **Send to watch and Open on watch are missing?** Turn on the Wear companion, and check that your edition is Standard or noLegal.
- **A broadcast does not play?** You and the broadcasting phone must be on the same Wi-Fi. Some routers keep devices apart - look for an option called client or AP isolation.
- **Open in VR is missing?** It appears only on a headset with 3D VR playback turned on and only for video channels. Headset setup is described in setting up the headset.
- **Want a phone or a watch to go on air for your other devices?** The media exchange portal explains the routes between devices and marks what is not available yet.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VIDEO

Chromecast casting and live broadcast

Cast files, and start a broadcast from your own phone.

WATCH

Streaming radio on your wrist

Listen to stations on the watch itself.

STREAMS

Playing live streams and radio

The basics of playing a channel on the phone.

INTERNET STREAMS | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #06

When the Connection Is Weak - Buffering, Reconnecting and Picture Quality

A weak connection does not have to spoil a live stream: FastMediaSorter buffers, reconnects, catches up with live TV and adjusts the picture quality on its own, and tells you plainly when it is your connection and when it is the channel.

Why You'll Love This

A train goes into a tunnel, the Wi-Fi at the cottage comes and goes, the hotel network is slow in the evening. A live stream feels all of it, because it arrives piece by piece while you watch or listen.

Most of the time you do not have to do anything: FastMediaSorter keeps a small supply of the stream in reserve, reconnects quietly, and chooses a picture quality your connection can carry. This recipe explains what you see on screen while that happens, which switch makes radio more patient, and how to tell a weak connection from a channel that has really gone.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR edition with Streams turned on.
- A channel you want to play. Everything on this page happens by itself; only step 2 has a switch.

1 Read the caption under the spinner

While a stream is loading, a spinner turns in the middle of the screen, and a short caption under it tells you which kind of wait it is:

- **Buffering..** - the connection works; the app is filling its reserve so the playback does not stutter.
- **Reconnecting..** - the connection dropped; the app is building it again.

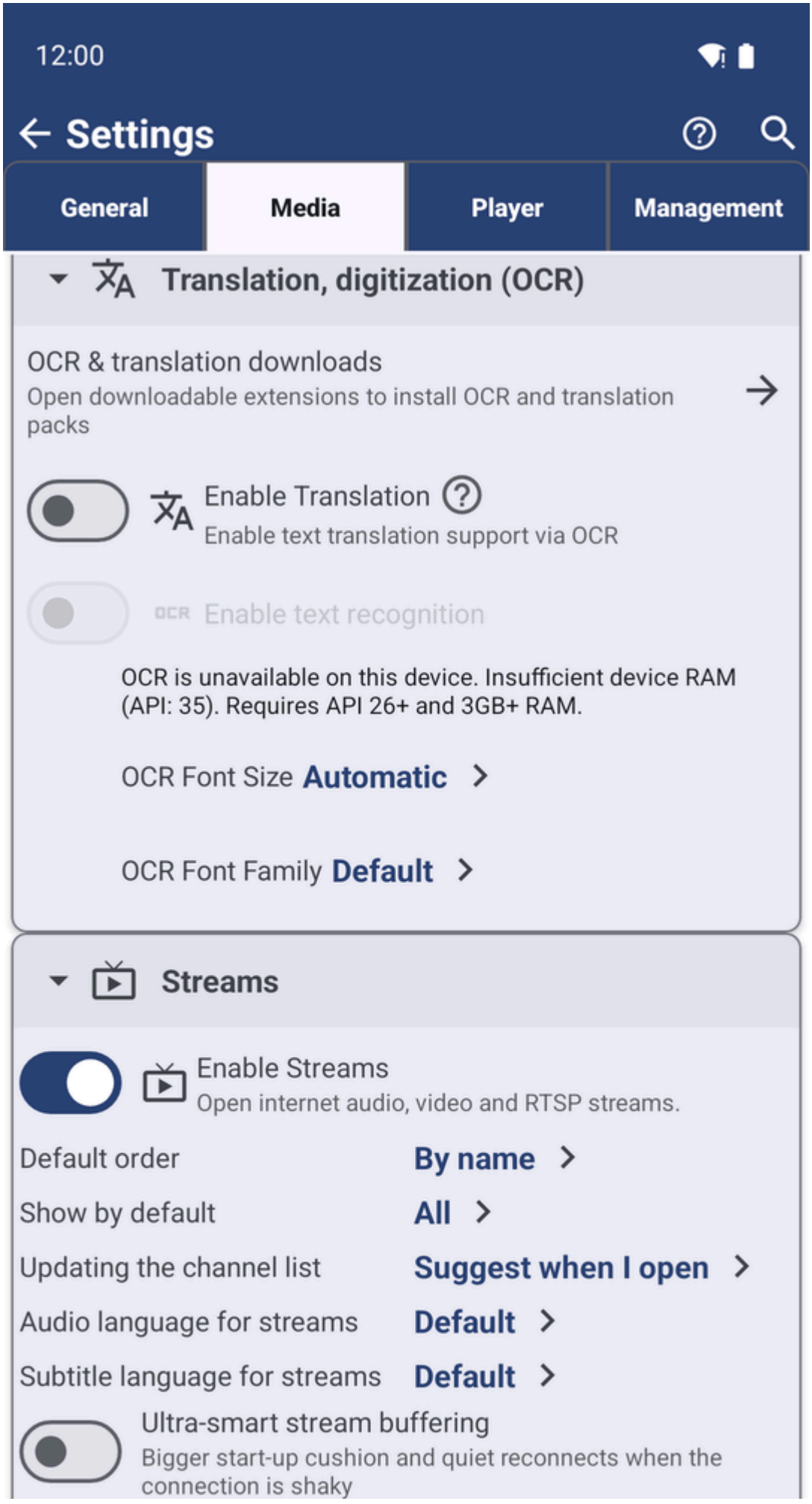
So a spinner is never a silent mystery: **Buffering..** usually ends in a few seconds, **Reconnecting..** means it is worth checking the Wi-Fi or mobile data.

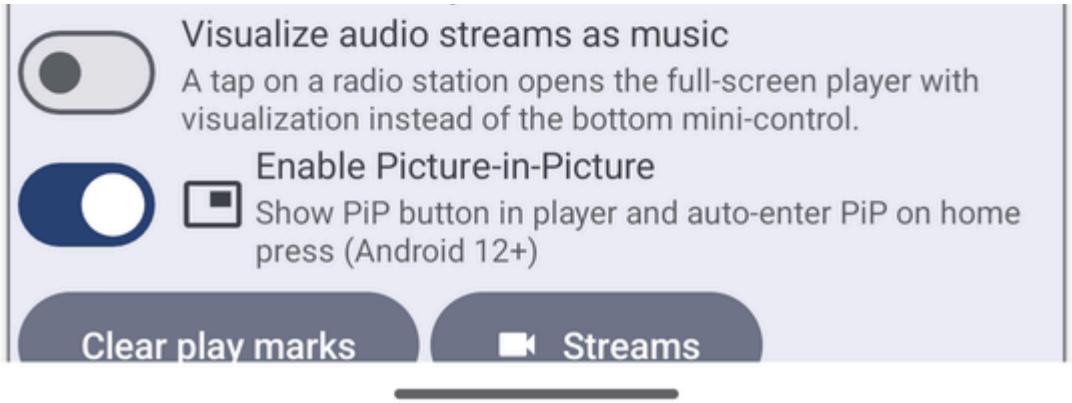
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Buffering caption**
Full-screen player on a video channel during loading, spinner with the Buffering.. caption.

2 Make radio more patient on a shaky line

The player measures how fast your connection really is and sizes its reserve to it: on a weak or unsteady line it keeps a deeper supply, so a short dip passes unnoticed, and on a good line it stays small so the channel starts quickly.

For radio you can ask for even more patience: **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **Streams**, switch **Ultra-smart stream buffering**. The station then waits a few seconds longer before it starts, to fill a bigger reserve, and after a short signal drop it reconnects quietly instead of stopping. Turn it off for plain standard playback.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Translation, digitization (OCR)
OCR & translation downloads
Open downloadable extensions to install OCR and translation packs
Enable Translation
Enable text translation support via OCR
Enable text recognition
OCR is unavailable on this device. Insufficient device RAM (API: 35). Requires API 26+ and 3GB+ RAM.
OCR Font Size Automatic
OCR Font Family Default
Streams
Enable Streams
Open internet audio, video and RTSP streams.
Default order By name
Show by default All
Updating the channel list Suggest when I open
Audio language for streams Default
Subtitle language for streams Default
Ultra-smart stream buffering
Bigger start-up cushion and quiet reconnects when the connection is shaky



Ultra-smart stream buffering in the Streams settings.

3

Live TV that falls behind catches up by itself

A live TV channel keeps only the last few minutes of its broadcast available. If a slow moment leaves the player too far behind, that part has already disappeared from the server. Instead of calling the channel dead, FastMediaSorter jumps back to the current moment of the broadcast and carries on. You may notice a small jump in the picture; there is no dialog and the channel keeps its green mark.

Short network drops and busy servers are treated the same way: the player tries again a few times, waiting a little longer each time, before it gives up. The picture follows the broadcast closely, so a live channel stays live.

4 Picture quality follows your connection

Many TV channels send the same picture in several qualities. If the picture stops to load again and again within two minutes, the player switches to a lower quality so it plays smoothly. A single pause now and then does not count, so a long evening in front of one channel does not slowly slide down to the lowest quality.

Every few minutes the player also tries the next quality up. It keeps it only if the picture really gets there and plays well for a while; if your line cannot carry it, the player tries again less and less often, up to about once an hour.

The app remembers for each channel the quality it settled on, for about a week. Next time you open that channel, it starts right there instead of stumbling through the same pauses again - even after you update the catalog. Channels with only one quality, and RTSP cameras, are left as they are.

5 When your phone itself is offline

If the phone has neither Wi-Fi nor mobile data, tapping a channel does not start an endless spinner. You see the message **No network. Connect to Wi-Fi or mobile data to play streams.** right away.

If the connection drops while a channel plays and does not come back, the dialog **No connection** appears: the channel stopped because your device is offline. The channel keeps its amber mark, because it was not the channel's fault, and the dialog does not offer to remove it.

6 When a channel really does not answer

If your connection works but the channel itself does not answer - the address has moved, the server refuses, the format is broken - the player does not wait long. The dialog **Stream unavailable** asks whether to remove the channel from your list, and the channel gets its red mark.

Removing is up to you. A station that is only down for maintenance may be back tomorrow; if you keep it, tap it again later.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stream unavailable dialog**
Stream unavailable dialog over the Streams list with the channel name and the remove and cancel buttons.

What You Get

Short drops pass without your help, live TV stays live, the picture quality suits your connection, and when something does go wrong the screen tells you whether it is your connection or the channel.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A stream that freezes silently recovers by itself.** When a live stream stops moving with no error at all, the app shows **Reconnecting…**, tries up to three times to start it again, and only then offers the dialog that the channel is not available.
- **Radio keeps cutting out in the car or on the train?** Turn on **Ultra-smart stream buffering**. The start takes a few seconds longer, and short gaps are bridged.
- **A channel is red but plays in a web browser?** Some channels play only in certain countries or networks; they are marked in the list. See channel pictures, logos and badges.
- **The picture got blurry?** The connection was slow for a while. The player tries a better quality again by itself; you do not need to reopen the channel.
- **Want to see the actual speed?** Open the channel's menu and **About this channel** while it plays: the section **This connection** shows the incoming speed, the picture size and the codecs.
- Curious how live TV streams work? The two common formats are HLS ↗ and MPEG-DASH ↗; both send the picture in short pieces and in several qualities.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STREAMS

Playing live streams and radio

Start, stop and control a channel.

STREAMS

Streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset

Take a channel to a bigger screen or to your wrist.

STREAMS

Browsing the channel catalog

Check channels in bulk and clean up the ones that no longer play.

and Screen Recording

CAMERA & SCREEN CAPTURE | All editions | RECIPE #1

All editions for the Quick capture menu and tap-to-focus; the fuller viewfinder with zoom presets, Send To and Camera settings needs Standard, Lite, Photos or Legacy; video, the Photo/Video switch and the Samsung-style gestures are Standard only; the watch live view needs Standard or noLegal

Taking Quick Photos and Video Snaps

Open the app's own camera from the Programs menu for a quick photo or video snap, get to know its viewfinder and gestures, record video with a timer and Pause/Resume, and even watch through your phone's camera from a paired watch.

Why You'll Love This

Your phone already has a camera app, so why does FastMediaSorter carry its own? Because a quick snap deserves to land straight in your Pictures folder without switching apps, and because the app's camera can do a few things the stock one never will - like showing you exactly what you're about to save before you save it, or letting your watch peek through it.

Open it from the Programs menu, take the photo or the clip, and you're back in the app a second later. This page is the tour of the viewfinder, the gestures, video recording and the watch trick. The deeper controls - lenses, zoom range, shooting profiles and the full settings dialog - are one page over, in Lenses, Zoom, Shooting Profiles and Camera Settings.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

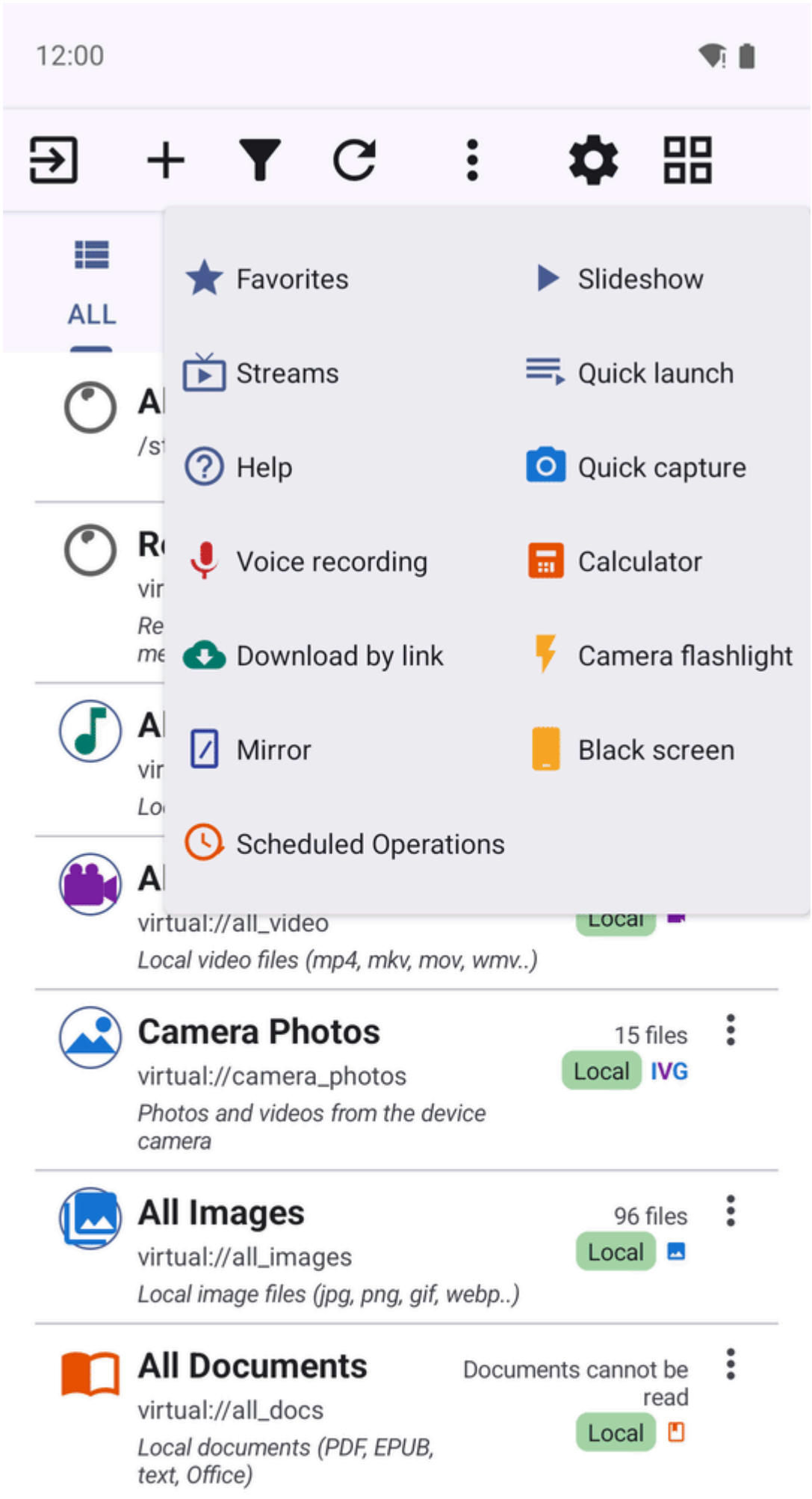
- FastMediaSorter in any edition. The fuller viewfinder (zoom presets, Send To, Camera settings) needs Standard, Lite, Photos or Legacy; video recording and the Samsung-style gestures need Standard.
- Camera permission, and microphone permission if you plan to record video with sound. Android asks the first time you need either.
- For the last step only: a paired watch and a phone on the Standard or noLegal edition.

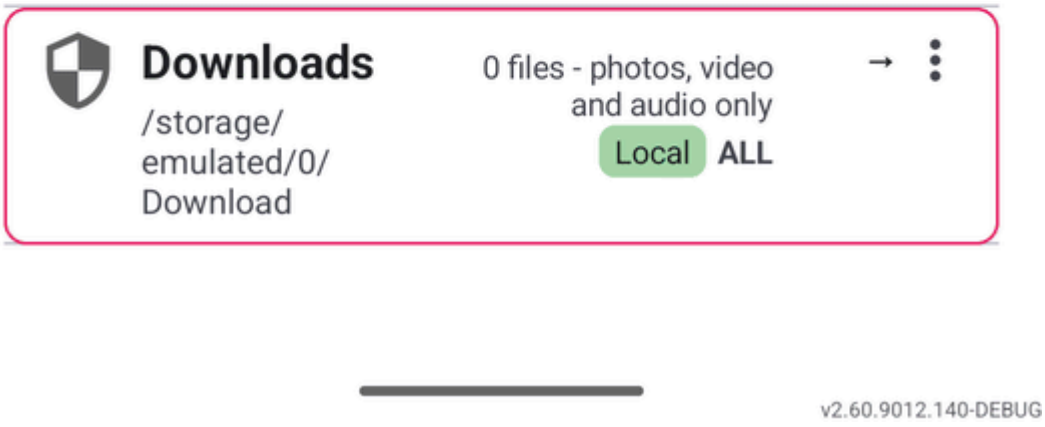
1 Open Quick capture from the Programs menu

On the main screen, open the Programs menu. Near the top you see **"Quick capture"** and **"Voice recording"** - tap either one and the camera or the recorder opens right away, no stutter while it starts up.

Photos, videos and voice notes each save straight into the phone's standard Pictures, Movies or Recordings folder. This is different from **Take photo** in the file browser's three-dots menu, which saves into whatever resource you have open instead - see Taking Photos, Videos and Voice Notes Straight into a Folder for that version.

Photo, video and voice capture are each their own switch in Settings, so an edition without video simply doesn't show that row. Press and hold a row to **Remove** it from the menu if you never use it.


12:00
ALL
Favorites
Slideshow
Streams
Quick launch
Help
Quick capture
Voice recording
Calculator
Download by link
Camera flashlight
Mirror
Black screen
Scheduled Operations
virtual://all_video
Local video files (mp4, mkv, mov, wmv..)
Local
Camera Photos
15 files
virtual://camera_photos
Local
IVG
Photos and videos from the device camera
All Images
96 files
virtual://all_images
Local
Local image files (jpg, png, gif, webp..)
All Documents
Documents cannot be read
virtual://all_docs
Local
Local documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)



Quick capture and Voice recording in the Programs menu.

2 Get to know the viewfinder

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions. Open the camera and the viewfinder appears immediately - it no longer needs a beat to warm up the lens first.

A zoom row sits under the frame with ready presets from 0.5× to 30× plus a slider you can drag for anything in between; at a lens's own maximum you see **"Zoom 3×, optical limit"** instead of a number that would just crop in digitally. The controls stay fixed in place while you turn the phone - only their icons rotate to match - and a small label tells you exactly where the shot is about to be saved.

If the app opened the camera for something specific, such as recognizing text, a line above the zoom row names the scenario, for example **"Text recognition"**. For a plain photo or video, nothing is shown there.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Camera viewfinder**
In-app camera open on a resource, zoom row and fixed controls visible, no dialog open.

3 Switch mode and move around with gestures

Standard edition. A **Photo** / **Video** switch sits right in the viewfinder, and the shutter itself changes shape depending on which mode you're in - and again once a recording starts - so it's always obvious what a tap will do.

The viewfinder reads gestures the way a modern phone camera does: pinch to zoom in or out, double-tap to jump between two zoom levels, swipe up or down to switch lens, and swipe left or right to switch between **Photo** and **Video**. While it swaps lenses you see **"Switching.."** for a moment.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Mode switch**
In-app camera, Photo/Video switch visible, Video side highlighted.

4 Tap to focus and set the exposure

Tap anywhere on the viewfinder and the camera focuses and meters exposure right at that spot, with a focus ring drawn exactly where you tapped - not somewhere near it. This works the same way in every edition.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Tap to focus**
In-app camera, focus ring shown at a tapped point off-center in the frame.

5 Record a video, with sound or without

Standard edition. Switch to **Video** and a **Microphone** toggle appears; turn it off and the control bar shows **"Recording without sound"** so you always know whether audio is being captured.

While recording, a timer counts up on screen with its own Pause and Resume, so a video call ringing in the middle of a shot doesn't force you to start over - stop, resume, and both halves land in the same file.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Video recording**
In-app camera, Video mode, recording in progress, timer and Pause/Resume control visible.

6 Shoot several photos in a row, accurately

Standard edition. The camera doesn't close after one shot the way many camera apps do - it stays open so a burst of photos is just tap, tap, tap. A thumbnail of your last shot appears on the control bar; tap **"View last capture"** and it opens in the app's player right away, so you can check focus and framing without leaving the camera.

Whatever the viewfinder shows at the moment you press the shutter is what gets saved - true at any zoom, even past a lens's own optical limit, and for every aspect ratio you pick, in every edition.

On Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy, when your chosen aspect is narrower than the full preview, a frame drawn over the viewfinder marks exactly what will be kept, so there's no surprise cropping later. Your aspect choice is remembered the next time you open the camera, and digital zoom is cropped into the saved video file itself, not just shown zoomed on screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Last capture thumbnail**
In-app camera, control bar with the last-capture thumbnail visible after a shot.

7 Send the shot on, or open Camera settings

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions. Tap **"Send to.."** to hand your latest capture to another app right from the camera, without hunting for it in a folder first.

The gear icon opens **Camera settings**: self-timer, grid, aspect ratio, resolution, exposure, white balance, manual ISO and shutter, and HDR - only the rows your phone's hardware actually supports. The full tour of that dialog, plus lenses and shooting profiles, is in Lenses, Zoom, Shooting Profiles and Camera Settings.

One more toggle lives in **Settings**, the **Management** tab, under **Photography**: **Geotag photos** - "Save GPS location in photos taken with the in-app camera. Needs location permission; off by default." It never holds up the shutter waiting for a GPS fix - if none is available yet, the photo just saves without one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Send To and settings gear**
In-app camera control bar, Send to.. and the settings gear icon both visible.

8 Look through the phone camera from your watch

Standard and noLegal editions, with a paired Wear OS watch. On the watch, open **"Phone camera"** - "Watch what your phone sees, over Wi-Fi" - and tap **Start**. The watch shows "Asking the phone.." while a notification titled "Your watch wants to see this camera" appears on the phone; tap **Allow** there.

The watch now shows the live picture from the phone, plus a **"Cameras"** list so you can switch between the phone's back and front camera without touching the phone at all. Tap **Stop** on either device to end the session.

If it can't connect, the watch says why instead of just hanging - for example **"Turn on Wi-Fi on the watch"**, **"This Wi-Fi is too slow for video"** or **"The request was declined on the phone"**. Pairing the watch itself is covered in Installing on Wear OS and Pairing with Phone.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Phone camera on the watch**
Watch screen, phone camera live view active, Cameras list and Stop control visible.

What You Get

The quick photo is already in your camera roll, the clip you recorded is in Movies, and you never had to leave FastMediaSorter to take either one. On the watch, you got a look through the phone's lens without picking the phone up at all.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Your files are already named for you.** Captures get a source prefix plus the exact time - `photo_260924_143210.jpg`, `screenshot_..`, `audio_..`, `video_..`, `screen_video_..` - and if two would land with the same name, the second one gets " (2)" added automatically. Nothing overwrites anything by accident.
- **The quick-access panel can start these too.** If you've set up the app's on-screen quick-access panel, quick photo capture, voice recording and screen recording can live there as one-tap tiles - see Screen-Edge Gestures and the Quick-Access Panel.
- **Want the shot saved somewhere specific instead of the camera roll?** That's the file browser's own **Take photo**, covered in Taking Photos, Videos and Voice Notes Straight into a Folder.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

CAMERA

Lenses, Zoom, Shooting Profiles and Camera Settings

Pick the right lens, dial in a shooting profile, and open the full Camera settings dialog.

CAMERA

Taking Screenshots and What Happens Next

Capture the screen itself and send it straight to editing, translation or another app.

CAMERA

Recording the Screen, Video and Sound

Record everything happening on screen, with microphone audio, from the Programs menu.

CAMERA & SCREEN CAPTURE | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #4

Recording the Screen, Video and Sound

Start a screen recording with sound from the Programs menu or a single edge-swipe, control it from a corner pill, its notification, or by repeating the gesture - and use the same gesture family for a quick camera video or a quick voice note.

Why You'll Love This

Showing someone how to do something on your phone is easier with a video than with words - a bug report, a game clip, a walkthrough for a relative. Screen recording captures everything on your screen with your voice over it, and starts the same way as taking a screenshot: from the Programs menu or with an edge gesture.

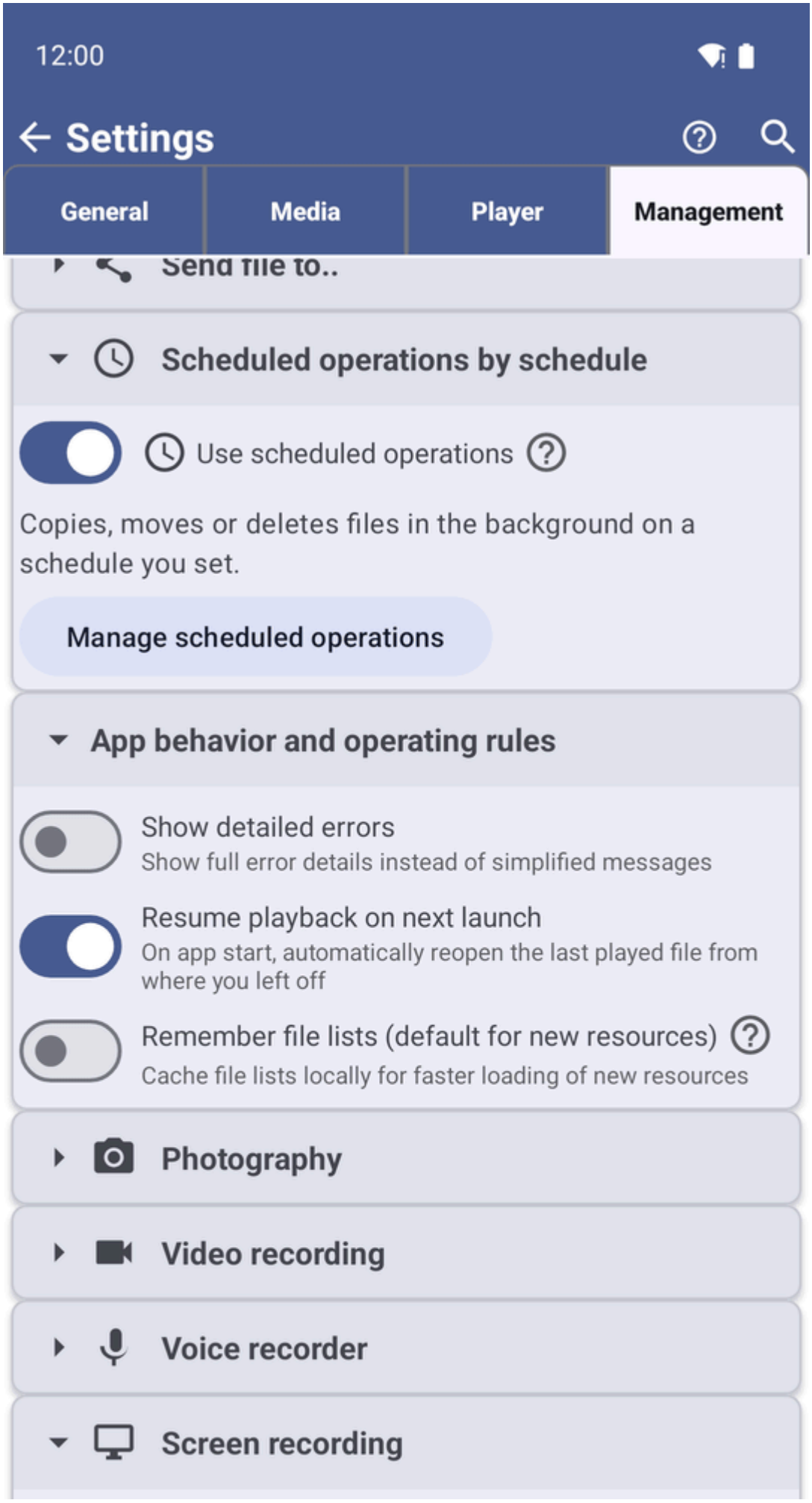
The same gesture family also gets you a plain camera video or a quick voice note in one move, without opening the camera app or a recorder screen first.

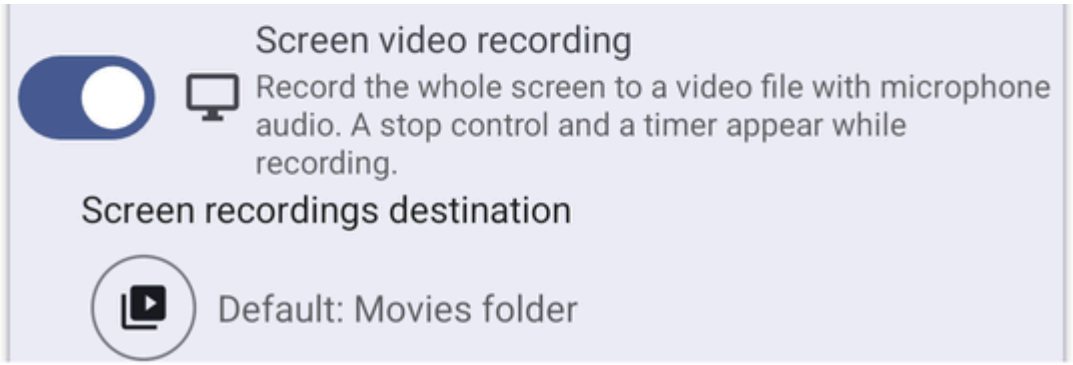
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard or noLegal editi on. Screen recording is not part of the Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS editions.
- The microphone permission for the sound track, and Android's own screen-recording consent at the start of every recording - this step can never be skipped, on either edition.
- On Android 13 and newer, the notifications permission, so the recording's controls have somewhere to live.

1 Turn on screen video recording

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and turn on **Screen video recording** – "Record the whole screen to a video file with microphone audio. A stop control and a timer appear while recording." This adds **Screen video recording** to the main window's Programs menu, alongside your other programs.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Send file to..
Scheduled operations by schedule
Use scheduled operations
Copies, moves or deletes files in the background on a schedule you set.
Manage scheduled operations
App behavior and operating rules
Show detailed errors
Show full error details instead of simplified messages
Resume playback on next launch
On app start, automatically reopen the last played file from where you left off
Remember file lists (default for new resources)
Cache file lists locally for faster loading of new resources
Photography
Video recording
Voice recorder
Screen recording



Screen video recording in the Management tab.

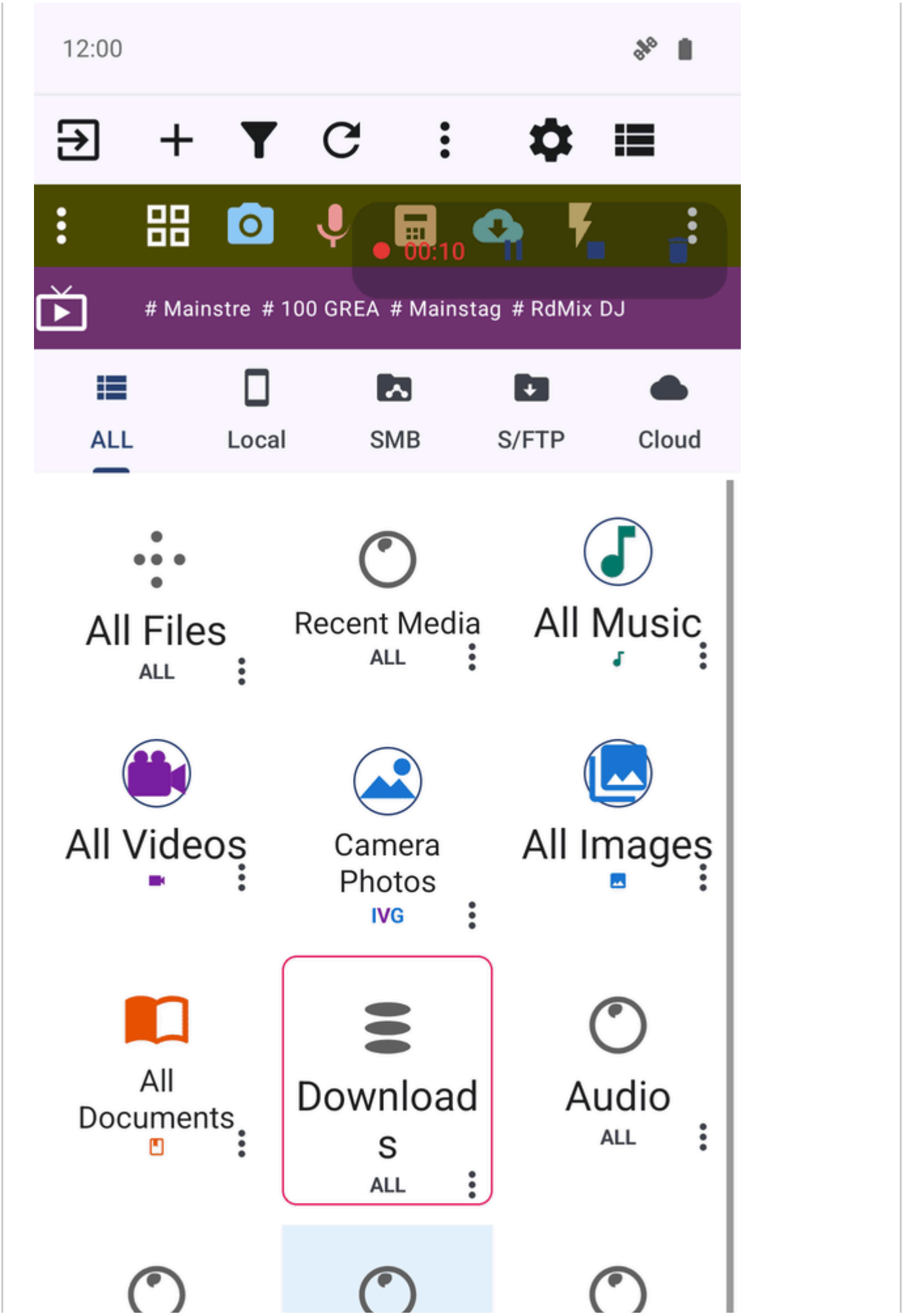
2 Start recording from the Programs menu

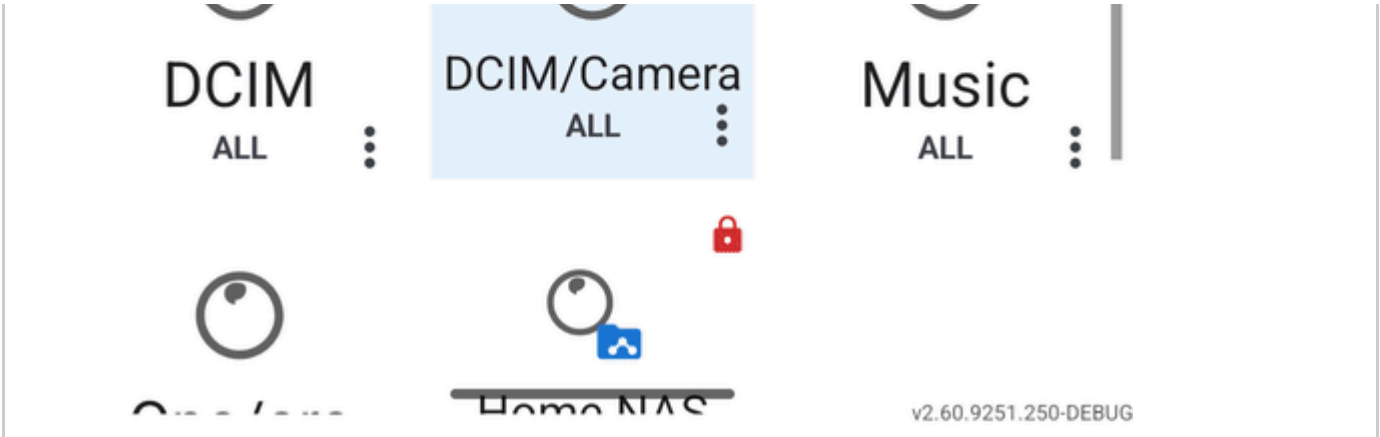
Open the Programs menu and tap **Screen video recording**. A one-time notice, **"Screen video recording"**, explains what is about to happen: "FastMediaSorter will record everything shown on your screen, including other apps, to a video file with microphone audio until you stop it. Recording continues in the background." Tap **Start recording**, then choose what to share with Android's own screen-recording prompt - this step cannot be skipped, and it appears at the start of every recording, not only the first.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Screen recording disclosure**
Screen video recording disclosure dialog, Start recording button visible.

3 Pause, resume or stop

While FastMediaSorter is the app in front, a small pill sits in the corner of the screen with a running timer, a pause/resume button and a stop button. Switch to another app and the pill disappears - the recording keeps running in the background - and control moves to the **"Recording screen"** notification, which carries its own **Pause recording** / **Resume recording** and **Stop** actions. Either way finishes and saves the same file.


12:00
00:10
Mainstre # 100 GREA # Mainstag # RdMix DJ
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
ALL
Recent Media
ALL
All Music
All Videos
Camera
Photos
IVG
All Images
All
Documents
Download
s
ALL
Audio
ALL



The recording indicator while FastMediaSorter is in front.

4 Start (and stop) with an edge gesture

Assign **Start screen recording** to a band and direction in **Configure gestures** - see Screen-edge gestures and the quick-access panel for how the bands work - and that one swipe both starts and stops the recording: swipe once to begin, then repeat the exact same gesture to stop and save. The notification's Pause, Resume and Stop controls still work in between.

5 Want a plain video instead of the screen? Open the camera in video mode

Start video recording is a different gesture action, for a different job: it opens the in-app camera already switched to video mode, ready for you to press record. The finished clip saves to the phone's public Movies folder, the same as recording from the camera directly. It is a fast way into camera video, not a screen recording - the two look similar in the gesture list but capture completely different things.

6 A quick voice note, the same way

Start audio recording toggles the quick voice recorder on and off with one gesture, no screen to open. While it runs, a small floating pill with a timer and a **Stop** button sits on top of whatever app is in front, so you never lose track of it - stop it from that pill, from its notification, or by repeating the gesture. This floating pill belongs to the quick voice recorder only: screen recording, above, always shows its controls in the corner card while FastMediaSorter is in front, or in its notification once you switch away.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Quick recorder floating pill**
Another app open in the foreground, the quick recorder's floating pill visible in the corner.

What You Get

A screen recording with your voice over it, started from the Programs menu or a single swipe, controllable from a corner pill, its notification, or by repeating the gesture - plus a one-swipe camera video and a one-swipe voice note for everything short of the whole screen.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The consent step is not a bug.** Android requires its own prompt at the start of every screen recording, in every app that offers the feature - FastMediaSorter cannot remove or shorten it.
- **One card, two jobs.** The corner card with pause/resume/stop is shared between screen recording and the in-app **Voice recording** menu item; only the widget- or gesture-started quick voice recorder gets the floating pill that follows you between apps.
- **One tap from the home screen.** The Quick Recorder widget starts the same quick voice recording without opening the app at all - see Taking photos, videos and voice notes straight into a folder.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GESTURES

Screen-edge gestures and the quick-access panel

Set up the bands and directions used to start and stop a recording.

STORAGE

Taking photos, videos and voice notes straight into a folder

The Quick Recorder widget, and saving straight into a chosen folder.

CAMERA

Taking quick photos and video snaps

Everything the in-app camera can do beyond a quick video gesture.

CAMERA & SCREEN CAPTURE | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #3

Taking Screenshots and What Happens Next

Turn on Gesture overlay, give a swipe a job, and a screenshot is one drag away from wherever you are - saved quietly, opened for editing, translated or sent on, exactly the way you set it up.

Why You'll Love This

A confirmation code, a boarding pass, a joke in a group chat - some things on your screen are worth keeping exactly as they look right now. FastMediaSorter turns a single swipe at the screen edge into a screenshot, and can immediately do something useful with it: open it for editing, translate the text on it, or send it on - without you opening the app first.

Screen capture is not a separate program you launch. It rides on the same edge gesture system used for quick photos and app shortcuts, so once it is set up, it works from inside any app.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard or noLegal editi on. Screen capture is not part of the Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS editions.
- Th e **Display over other apps** permission, so the gesture strip can sit on top of whatever you are looking at.
- Android's own on-screen confirmation before a capture - on Standard, before every one; on noLegal, only until you turn on the accessibility shortcut described below.

1 Turn on the gesture and give it a job

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and turn on **Gesture overlay** - "Show up to 4 thin gesture strips at the screen edges, over other apps." Tap **Configure gestures** to open the edge-gesture window, pick a band and a direction, and set its **Gesture action** to one of the screenshot options below. The bands, the directions, and everything else you can assign to them are covered in full in Screen-edge gestures and the quick-access panel.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture overlay setting**
Settings, Management tab, Gesture overlay section expanded.

2 Swipe to capture

Perform the swipe on the band you assigned - a short drag from a corner band that FastMediaSorter reads as **Up**, **Right** or **Down**, wherever exactly it started. The first time, a one-time notice explains what is about to happen - **"Screen capture needs your permission"**: "The app can capture the current device screen, including other apps, only after you confirm the Android system prompt.." Tap **Continue**, then confirm Android's own screen-capture prompt. This is the same Play-safe capture flow behind every screenshot action on this page; on Standard, that Android prompt appears before every single shot, since there is no way around it in a Play-published app.

3 Choose what happens to the shot

The action you assigned to that gesture decides what happens the moment the screenshot is saved:

- **Silent screenshot** - just saves it, nothing else.
- **Screenshot – view** - opens it in the player.
- **Screenshot for editing** - opens it in the drawing editor, ready to circle or write on.
- **Screenshot – OCR translation** - reads the text on the screen and translates it; see Extracting text with offline OCR and Translating extracted text.
- **Screenshot – send to..** - opens the Send To sheet with the shot already attached; see Sharing files to nearby devices and apps.
- **Screenshot – share** - hands it to the Android system share sheet.
- **Crop screenshot and share** - reopens the shot with a draggable crop frame, overwrites it with the cropped result, then opens Send To for the cropped picture.

Each of the four edge bands has its own **Up**, **Right** and **Down** slot, so different corners can run different actions - a quiet save on one, an editable copy on another.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture action picker**
Edge-gesture window, Gesture action dialog open over a direction row, screenshot options visible.

4 Skip the dialog every time (noLegal)

On Standard, Android asks you to confirm every single shot - a Play-published app cannot remove that step. The noLegal edition offers a second path on Android 11 and newer: an accessibility service that saves screenshots silently, with nothing to confirm each time. The first time you turn on **Gesture overlay**, a dialog titled **"Enable screen gestures"** offers **Open settings** to turn it on. If you would rather not, or your phone will not allow it, tap **Old method** to fall back to the same per-shot confirmation Standard uses - which is also what noLegal itself falls back to automatically on Android 8, 9 and 10, since the accessibility route needs Android 11 or newer.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Enable screen gestures dialog**
Enable screen gestures dialog, Open settings and Old method buttons visible.

5 Choose where screenshots are saved

By default a screenshot lands in the phone's screenshots folder, or Downloads if that is not available. Open **Configure gestures**, expand **General gesture settings**, and use **Save screenshots to..** to pick a resource instead - a network folder or a cloud folder works too. If that place cannot be reached at the moment a shot is taken, it falls back through Pictures/Screenshots, then DCIM/Screenshots, then Downloads, so a screenshot is never lost, only redirected.

Turn on **Save screenshots to clipboard** in the same group and every screenshot is also copied to the clipboard the instant it is saved, ready to paste into a chat - on top of whatever the gesture action already does with it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Screenshot destination and clipboard**
Edge-gesture window, General gesture settings group expanded.

What You Get

One swipe at the edge of the screen captures whatever is in front of you, on Standard with Android's own quick confirmation and on noLegal silently once you turn that on - and lands exactly where you told it to: open for editing, translated, on its way to someone, or just quietly saved.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Different corners, different jobs.** Assign a quiet **Silent screenshot** to one band and **Screenshot for editing** to another, so a plain capture and an annotated one are two different swipes.
- **A copy on the clipboard is not a backup.** It holds only the last screenshot; the saved file in your chosen place is the one that stays. The same idea applies to photos in Taking photos, videos and voice notes straight into a folder.
- **Nothing happens when you swipe?** Check that direction is not set to **Do not use**, and that **Display over other apps** is still granted - Android sometimes revokes it after a while.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GESTURES

Screen-edge gestures and the quick-access panel

Every band, every direction, and everything else you can assign to a swipe.

TOOLS

Drawing and image annotations

Circle, write and mark up a screenshot after you capture it.

TOOLS

Sharing files to nearby devices and apps

Where Send To and the system share sheet take a captured screenshot.

CAMERA & SCREEN CAPTURE | All editions | RECIPE #2

All editions for lenses, zoom range, shooting profiles, aspect ratio, per-lens memory and the hardware report; the zoom slider and the full Camera settings dialog need Standard, Lite, Photos or Legacy

Lenses, Zoom, Shooting Profiles and Camera Settings

Pick the lens, zoom range and shooting profile that fit the shot, open the full Camera settings dialog when you need manual control, and use the System information report to see exactly what your phone's cameras can do.

Why You'll Love This

A phone with three or four lenses can do more than one kind of photo. This page is about pointing the camera at the lens, zoom and settings you actually want - a wide shot with the ultra-wide, a close-up with macro, a properly exposed shot at night - instead of whatever a single default happens to pick, and about where to look when you want to know exactly what your phone's cameras can do.

If you haven't opened the camera yet, Taking Quick Photos and Video Snaps covers the viewfinder basics, gestures and video recording first.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition. The zoom slider and the full Camera settings dialog need Standard, Lite, Photos or Legacy.
- A phone with more than one rear lens gets the most out of this page, but a single-lens phone still gets shooting profiles, aspect ratio and the hardware report.
- Camera permission, already covered if you've used the camera before.

1 The lenses and zoom range are your phone's own

The camera reads what your phone's hardware can actually do and offers every physical lens it finds - front, ultra-wide, wide, tele, macro - with each lens's true zoom floor (including below 1× on an ultra-wide), a working macro mode, and photos at the sensor's full resolution. Nothing here is guessed or capped to a "safe" number.

When the lens you're using has no zoom range of its own - the ultra-wide is the usual case - the zoom row shows one pill per rear lens instead, in familiar values such as 0.5 / 1 / 3, so a tap switches you straight back to a lens you can zoom on.

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions. Above the shutter, a zoom row also offers ready presets from 0.5× to 30× plus a draggable slider for anything in between. Night mode used to have its own button here; it now lives in the Shooting profile menu, covered next.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Zoom and lenses**
In-app camera, zoom row with presets and slider, ultra-wide lens active showing rear-lens pills.

2 Pick a shooting profile

A button reads **"Shooting profile: Normal"**; tap it to open a menu of scenarios, each with its own icon: **Normal**, **Night**, **Portrait**, **Selfie**, **Macro**, **Sport** and, where the device supports it, **Document**. Only the profiles your phone can actually deliver are listed.

Choosing one is exclusive - tapping the active profile again turns it off and back to Normal. **Macro** jumps straight to the dedicated close-focus lens, **Selfie** flips to the front camera, **Night** and **Portrait** use the phone's own camera modes, and **Sport** keeps the exposure short so motion freezes; a warning notes that frames get darker in low light because of it. Changing lens manually while a profile is active returns the camera to Normal.

Document points the main back lens straight ahead at zoom 1× with the torch on - built for photographing flat pages and screens rather than a scene.

If you move exposure or white balance off automatic while shooting Normal, the button changes to read **"Manual"** instead, so you always know the camera isn't picking those for you anymore. On a phone with no profile menu at all, the plain settings button reads **"Camera settings – manual mode"** in the same situation.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Shooting profile menu**
In-app camera, Shooting profile menu open, Normal currently selected, all supported profiles listed with icons.

3 Choose the shape of the frame

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions. In **Camera settings**, **Aspect ratio** offers **4:3**, **16:9** and **Full screen**. Whichever you pick changes both the live viewfinder and the saved file together - it's not just a crop drawn over a wider preview. The choice is remembered the next time you open the camera, and the default is 16:9. For video, **Full screen** behaves as 16:9, since a video file needs a fixed shape.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Aspect ratio picker**
Camera settings dialog, Aspect ratio row expanded, 16:9 selected.

4 Open the full Camera settings dialog

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy editions. Tap the gear icon for **Camera settings**: **Self-timer**, **Grid**, **Aspect ratio**, **Resolution**, **Exposure**, **White balance** (with presets such as **Auto**, **Daylight**, **Cloudy** or **Fluorescent** where the phone supports them), **Manual ISO and shutter**, and **HDR**. Only the rows your hardware can actually deliver show up - there's nothing here to tap that will just fail.

You can rotate the phone, switch the app's theme or language, or change the system font size with this dialog open, and it comes right back exactly as you left it instead of closing on you.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Camera settings dialog**
Camera settings dialog open over the viewfinder, all hardware-supported rows visible.

5 Each lens remembers its own settings

Switch to the tele lens, dial in a warmer white balance and a touch of manual exposure, then switch to the ultra-wide and back - your tele settings, profile, white balance and manual ISO/shutter are exactly where you left them. Every lens keeps its own set, restored the moment you return to it, and the memory survives closing and reopening the app. If a lens disappears from your phone (a new device, for instance), its saved settings quietly go with it.

6 Look up exactly what your cameras can do

Open the Programs menu, then **System information**, then the **"Cameras"** section. For every camera the phone declares - including physical sub-lenses grouped under one logical camera - you get facing, focal length, sensor size, active array, zoom range, closest focus distance and the largest photo size available, in the phone's raw numbers.

Nothing is rounded off or simplified: the same raw values from two different phones sit side by side well enough to explain why one takes a better night shot than the other, and it's the fastest way to tell a real hardware limit from something worth reporting as a bug.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Camera hardware report**
System information screen, Cameras section expanded, one rear and one front camera listed with full detail rows.

What You Get

Whichever lens fits the shot - wide, ultra-wide, tele or macro - is one tap away, your settings for that lens are exactly as you left them next time, and System information can tell you in plain numbers what each of your phone's cameras can actually do.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Flattening a page or a screen?** The **Document** shooting profile sets the main lens, zoom 1× and the torch for you in one tap, instead of fumbling with exposure and zoom by hand.
- **Comparing two phones?** The hardware report's raw numbers are meant to be compared directly - focal length, sensor size and zoom range side by side tell you more than a marketing spec sheet.
- **New here?** Taking Quick Photos and Video Snaps covers opening the camera, the viewfinder, gestures and video recording.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

CAMERA

Taking Quick Photos and Video Snaps

The viewfinder, gestures, video recording and the watch's live view of the phone camera.

STORAGE

Taking Photos, Videos and Voice Notes Straight into a Folder

Take a photo or video from inside a folder so it saves right there instead of the camera roll.

CAMERA

Taking Screenshots and What Happens Next

Capture the screen itself and send it straight to editing, translation or another app.

CAMERA & SCREEN CAPTURE | All editions | RECIPE #5

All editions (the quick-access panel and its Quick Settings tile); Standard and noLegal for the edge gestures themselves and their screenshot, camera and recording actions

Screen-Edge Gestures and the Quick-Access Panel

Set up to twelve swipe gestures across four screen-edge bands for screenshots, the camera, recording and launching apps, and open the quick-access panel they can lead to - by gesture in the Standard and noLegal editions, or by its own Quick Settings tile in every edition.

Why You'll Love This

One short swipe from the side of the screen, over any app, can take a screenshot, snap a photo, start recording, launch another app, or open a grid of your own shortcuts. All of it is set up from the same screen, so getting comfortable with it once pays off for every other capture recipe on this site.

The quick-access panel it can open is worth knowing on its own: a pop-up grid of tiles for apps, Android settings and FastMediaSorter's own features, reachable by gesture or by its own Quick Settings tile - the one part of this page that works in every edition.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter installed. The quick-access panel and its Quick Settings tile are part of every edition; the edge gesture that opens it, and the screenshot, camera and recording actions behind it, need the Standard or noLegal edition.
- The **Display over other apps** permission for the gesture strip itself.
- For the screenshot, camera and recording actions: the same permissions used elsewhere in the app - camera, microphone, and Android's own capture consent where it applies.

1 Turn on the gesture strip

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and turn on **Gesture overlay** - "Show up to 4 thin gesture strips at the screen edges, over other apps." Tap **Configure gestures** below it to open the edge-gesture window.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture overlay setting**
Settings, Management tab, Gesture overlay section expanded.

2 Four bands, three directions each

The edge-gesture window has four tabs - **Left top**, **Left bottom**, **Right top** and **Right bottom** - one per band, each covering roughly the upper or lower stretch of its screen edge. A swipe on a band is read as one of three directions: up, inward (shown as **Right**, since it points right on the left edge and left on the right edge) or down. A small map at the top - "Edge gesture map: tap a zone direction to assign an action" - shows all twelve slots at a glance, and tapping one jumps straight to its tab.

Turn on a band's own **Show the gesture strip** switch and a faint gray guide appears along that stretch of the real screen edge - handy while you are still learning where a band starts and ends; leave it off once you know.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Edge-gesture window**
Edge-gesture configuration window, tabs and schema visible.

3 See what a swipe will do before you let go

Touch down on a live band and a small legend appears showing its three directions - up, right, down - each with its icon and the action it currently runs, and the one your finger is heading toward highlighted as you move. Let go over empty space instead of a direction and the gesture cancels with nothing happening, so trying a band out costs nothing.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture direction hint**
Edge gesture in progress, direction legend visible, one row highlighted.

4 Give each direction a job

In a band's tab, set **Down gesture action**, **Right gesture action** and **Up gesture action** independently, each opening the same **Gesture action** picker. The list covers a lot of ground: the screenshot actions from Taking screenshots and what happens next, camera actions (take a photo, and send it, edit it, or run OCR translation on it), starting or stopping screen recording or a quick voice note, launching a chosen app, opening the quick-access panel, and a long list of device shortcuts such as the flashlight, volume and brightness. Leave a direction on **Do not use** and that swipe does nothing.

Recording and audio in depth

Screen recording, video and voice-note gestures get their own walkthrough in Recording the screen, video and sound.

5 Bring FastMediaSorter forward without capturing anything

Set a direction to **Launch a chosen app** and pick any installed app - that swipe opens it, or brings it to the front if it is already running, with no screenshot and no consent prompt along the way. Leave no app chosen and the gesture opens FastMediaSorter itself instead.

6 Open the quick-access panel

Set a direction to **Open quick-access panel** and that swipe opens a fixed grid of large tiles - 3×5 in portrait, 5×3 in landscape - for one-tap launching, again with no screenshot or consent prompt. A tile you have not filled in yet shows **Empty – tap to add**.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Quick-access panel**
Quick-access panel open, grid of tiles visible, one empty slot.

7 Reach it without a gesture at all

Every edition, including the ones without screen capture, can add a **Quick launch** tile to the Android Quick Settings shade - pull it down, tap Edit, and drag it in. Tapping that tile opens the same quick-access panel as the gesture, so it works even where the edge gesture itself is not offered.

8 Fill the panel with your own tiles

Open the panel's **Edit** screen - or **Edit quick-access panel** in the edge-gesture window - and tap any tile, filled or empty, to add, **Move**, **Replace** or **Remove** it. A tile can point to an **Android app**, an **Android OS settings** screen (Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Display, Sound, Battery and more, whichever exist on your phone), a **FastMediaSorter feature** (the calculator, the mini-game, Camera OCR translation, Streams, Favorites and others), or a **FastMediaSorter** resource. The panel ships already filled in with the app's own features first and Android settings after, leaving the remaining slots open for whatever you add; **Reset panel** puts that starting layout back at any time.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Edit panel screen**
Edit panel screen, one tile selected, action row visible.

9 Your programs, on the panel too

Quick capture, **Voice recording**, **Screen video recording** and **Download by link** - the same items already in the main window's Programs menu - can sit on the panel as their own tiles, so a swipe or a Quick Settings tap reaches them directly. Screen video recording and Download by link still need the Standard or noLegal edition, the same as everywhere else on this page; the camera and voice tiles are not tied to screen capture and follow their own, wider set of editions.

What You Get

A swipe at the edge of the screen can now take a screenshot, snap a photo, start or stop a recording, launch an app, or open a panel of your own shortcuts - and that panel is one Quick Settings tap away in every edition, filled with exactly the apps, settings and features you put there.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Long lists are easy to pick from.** The pickers of the quick-access panel - an app, a feature, a system shortcut or a resource - have a search box for long lists, show an icon at the start of each row and let you choose one item the same way everywhere.
- **A swipe fired the wrong action?** The live legend from step 3 shows exactly what each direction is set to before you commit - touch and hold instead of swiping through.
- **One permission covers the whole strip.** Turning off **Display over other apps** for FastMediaSorter switches every band off at once; turning it back on does not re-enable them by itself - **Gesture overlay** does, and comes back on its own after a restart if it was on and the permission still holds.
- **Taking a photo without a camera screen?** The photo gesture actions, and everything else the in-app camera can do, are in Taking quick photos and video snaps.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GESTURES

Taking screenshots and what happens next

Every after-capture action a screenshot gesture can run.

GESTURES

Recording the screen, video and sound

Start and control a screen recording from the same gesture family.

CAMERA

Taking quick photos and video snaps

What the in-app camera can do once a gesture opens it.

cognition, Drawing and Sharing

OCR, DRAWING & SHARING | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #01

Extracting Text with Offline OCR

One tap turns a photo, a screenshot or a scanned page into text you can copy, search or save - read on the phone itself, with no picture ever leaving the device.

Why You'll Love This

A shop sign in another language, a recipe photographed from a magazine, a scanned contract page, a screenshot of an error message you want to search for - printed words trapped in a picture are everywhere. FastMediaSorter reads them for you with an on-device OCR engine, so the words become text you can select, copy, search or save. Nothing is uploaded anywhere: the recognition runs on the phone itself.

The engine is Tesseract, tuned here for strong Cyrillic support - so a Russian or Ukrainian sign is read as Russian or Ukrainian letters, not as the nearest-looking Latin ones.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in an edition with OCR: Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR. The Lite, Photos and FOSS editions do not read text from pictures.
- The **OCR Engines** extension, downloaded once from **Settings**, **General**, **Downloadable Extensions** - or turned on right on the setup wizard's functionality page. See first launch and setup and downloadable extensions.
- For better recognition of Cyrillic text: the **Russian OCR Model** or the **Ukrainian OCR Model**, downloaded the same way.
- A device with Android 8.0 (API 26) or newer and at least 3 GB of RAM. On an older or smaller device you will see "OCR is unavailable on this device."
- A picture with legible text: a photo already open in the app, a fresh photo from the camera, a screenshot, or a scanned PDF page.

1 Pull text out of a picture you are viewing

Open the picture in the image viewer or the reader, show the command panel, and tap the **OCR** button (its accessibility label is **Extract Text**). The recognized words open on a **Recognized Text** screen as plain, selectable text - copy all of it, copy a piece, or share it like any other text.

If the picture has no legible words - a blurry photo, a plain landscape - you will see "No text found in image".

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: recognized text panel**
A photographed sign open in the image viewer with the OCR result panel showing the recognized words as selectable text.

2 Snap a photo and get instant text

For a fresh subject - a menu, a poster, a business card - skip the gallery: open the **Camera OCR** program from the programs menu, drop a **Camera OCR** widget on your home screen, or use the **Capture & OCR** panel item, then point the camera and shoot.

After "Processing photo.." a crop frame appears over the photo. Drag its corners around the exact block of text, tap **Retry** to shoot again, or tap **OK** to continue. While "Extracting text and translating.." runs, the result screen opens with an **Original text** tab and a **Translation** tab, plus **Save as .txt** to write the text to a file and **Next photo** to shoot the next one without leaving the flow.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Camera OCR crop frame**
A just-taken photo of a shop sign with the Camera OCR crop frame open, corner handles visible, Retry and OK buttons at the bottom.

3 Turn a screenshot into text

Already looking at something with text on screen - a chat, a web page, a form - and would rather not leave the app? In the **Standard** and **noLegal** (sideload) editions, open the capture strip and tap **Screenshot – OCR translation**: the screenshot opens straight in the same crop-and-recognize screen as a photo, and only the cropped piece is kept in your gallery. The same strip's **Take a photo and OCR-translate** action does the same thing starting from the camera instead of the screen.

On Legacy and VR, where the capture strip is not available, the **Camera OCR** program and its widgets cover the same ground - recognition itself works the same wherever OCR is available.

4 Choose the right recognition language

Recognition quality depends on picking the right alphabet. Tap the **OCR language** or **Translation language** row - in the Camera OCR crop screen, or in the reader's **Text Settings** dialog - to open a searchable list of every language the engine currently supports, ordered by your interface language, with **Auto** available for the source language.

For the best result, pick the source language explicitly rather than leaving it on Auto, especially for Cyrillic text: guessing reads the picture with the English alphabet first, and a look-alike Latin letter can slip in where a Cyrillic one belongs. Choosing **Russian** or **Ukrainian** up front reads those letters correctly from the start.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: OCR language picker**
The searchable language picker open over the Camera OCR crop screen, search field focused, Russian highlighted as the current selection.

5 Recognize text on a scanned PDF page

A PDF made from a scanner or a photocopy has no text layer at all - the words are just part of the picture. Open the page in the reader and tap **Translate**; a picture-only page goes through the same offline OCR pass before its recognized words are shown. See reading PDF documents for finding the Translate button, and translating extracted text for what happens to the recognized words next.

6 Copy or save what was found

From the **Recognized Text** screen or the Camera OCR result, select all or part of the text and copy it like any other selection, or tap **Save as .txt** to write it to a timestamped text file in your chosen destination folder - you will see "Saved text to.." with the path when it lands.

What You Get

Text trapped in a photo, a screenshot or a scanned page becomes real, selectable words - copied, searched, or saved as a text file, entirely on the phone. Camera OCR turns a fresh photo into text in a couple of taps, the crop screen works the same way for a screenshot, and choosing the right language keeps Cyrillic text from turning into Latin look-alikes.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Text recognition works in the Google Play version too.** Its engine now ships inside the app, so a Play install no longer shows a misleading message that it is not available.
- **The crop frame is easy to grab.** The bottom handle of the crop frame stays clear of the buttons at the bottom of the screen, and the frame's border is drawn in full.
- **Want the translated text side by side, not just the original?** See translating extracted text.
- **Blurry photo or a loose crop?** OCR only reads what is actually printed - a steadier photo and a tighter crop around the text read better than a wide, blurry one.
- **Only want the language packs, not a tour of the whole extensions screen?** Jump straight to downloadable extensions and language models.
- **Setting up the app for the first time?** Turn OCR on right on the functionality page - see first launch and setup.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

TOOLS

TOOLS

Translating extracted text

Turn recognized words into your language, on the page or in a card.

Drawing and image annotations

Circle, underline or write over the picture you just recognized text from.

EDITIONS

Downloadable extensions and language models

Install the OCR engine and language-specific models, or remove them again.

OCR, DRAWING & SHARING | Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR | RECIPE #02

Translating Extracted Text

Recognized text, a PDF page, an EPUB chapter or a text file reads in your language with one tap, entirely on the phone - as a card of its own, or painted right over the original words.

Why You'll Love This

Once words are on the screen - recognized from a photo, printed on a PDF page, or sitting in an EPUB chapter - FastMediaSorter can turn them into your own language right there, using Google's on-device ML Kit translation. The internet is needed only to download each language model once from Google; the text you translate is translated on the phone and is never sent anywhere.

Two different starting points feed the same translator: a picture goes through OCR first so there is text to translate, while a PDF page, an EPUB chapter or a text file is already text and skips straight to translation.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in an edition with translation: Standard, noLegal, Legacy or VR. The Lite, Photos and FOSS editions do not translate text.
- **Enable Translation** switched on in **Settings** - or on the setup wizard's functionality page. The first time, this downloads the **Translation Module** extension; see first launch and setup and downloadable extensions.
- To translate a picture: the **OCR Engines** extension too, since a photo or a scan has to be read before it can be translated - see recognizing text on pictures.
- Something to translate: a picture open in the image viewer - see viewing photos and gestures - a PDF page, an EPUB chapter, or a text file.
- A phone, tablet, laptop, desktop or Chromebook. Translation is not offered on a TV, a car head unit or an XR headset - see the last step.

⚠ No overlay on a guessed language

If the source language was only guessed and most of what came back could not be trusted, no plate is drawn at all: "The text is in a script the recognizer was not set up for, so no translation is drawn over the picture. Choose the Original Language in the translation settings." Pick the language explicitly (next step) and try again.

1 Translate the text in a picture

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Translate** (in landscape the button may sit right on the command panel bar). After "Translation started.." the recognized lines come back translated, in one of two looks depending on the **Translation result in blocks** setting:

- **Off** - the translation appears in a card of its own, below or over the picture, kept separate from the original.
- **On** - each translated line is painted directly over the original words on an opaque plate, so the picture reads in your language in place. A line whose words sit far apart - text on both sides of a photo, separate speech bubbles - is split and translated as separate pieces instead of one strip across the picture. A plate that reaches the bottom of the screen grows upward instead of being cut off, and a translation taller than the whole screen shrinks its type first, so it is always fully drawn.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: translation painted over a picture**
A photographed shop sign with the translation overlay on, each recognized line replaced by an opaque plate with the translated words.

2 Translate a PDF page or an EPUB chapter

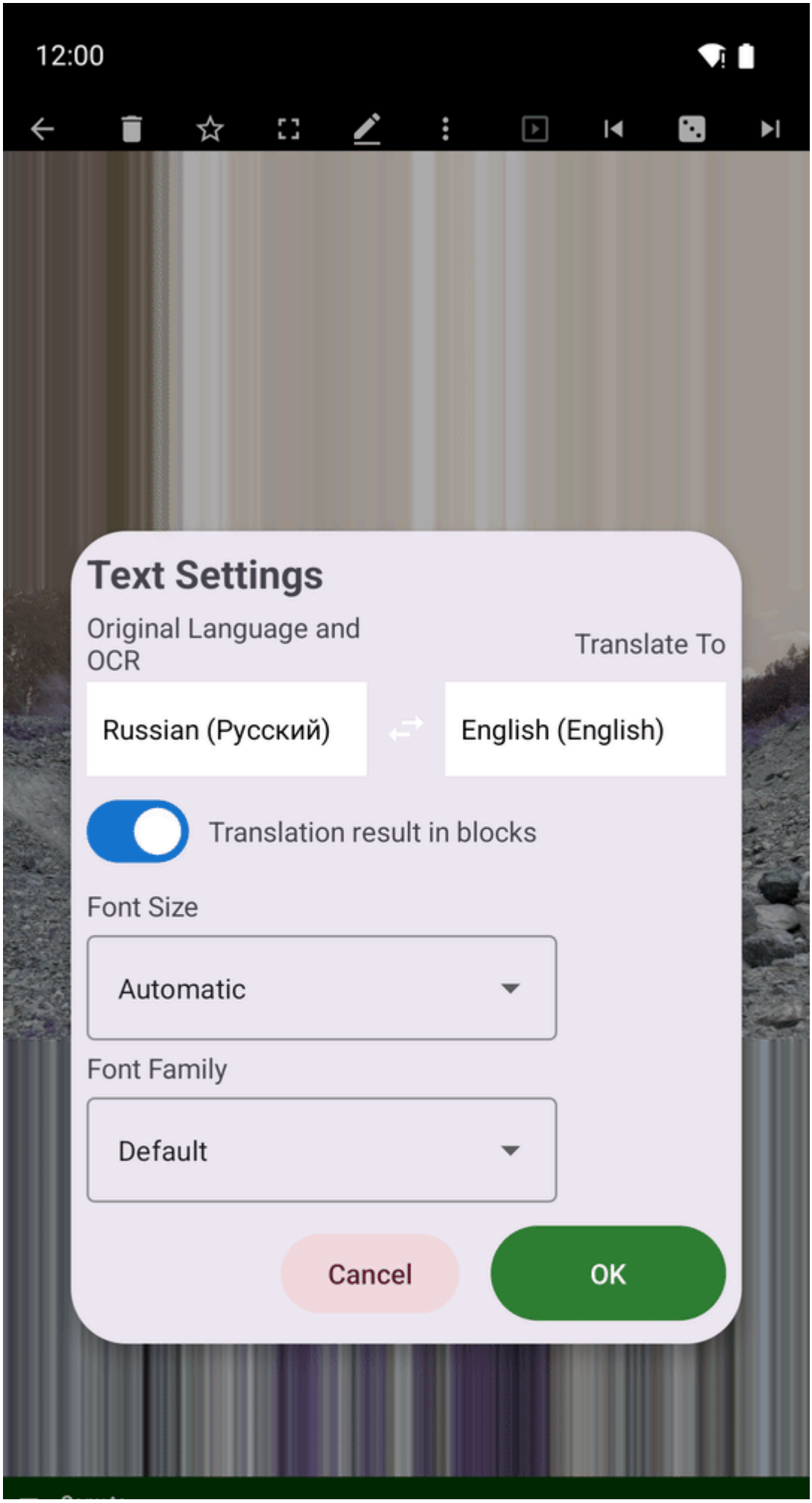
A PDF page - including a scanned one with no text layer, read through the same offline OCR pass - and an EPUB chapter both translate the same way: open the three-dots menu and tap **Translate**. A PDF page follows the card-or-overlay look from the step above; an EPUB chapter always opens in a resizable panel over the text, with its own font size separate from the book's. See reading PDF documents and reading EPUB books for turning pages and finding the button.

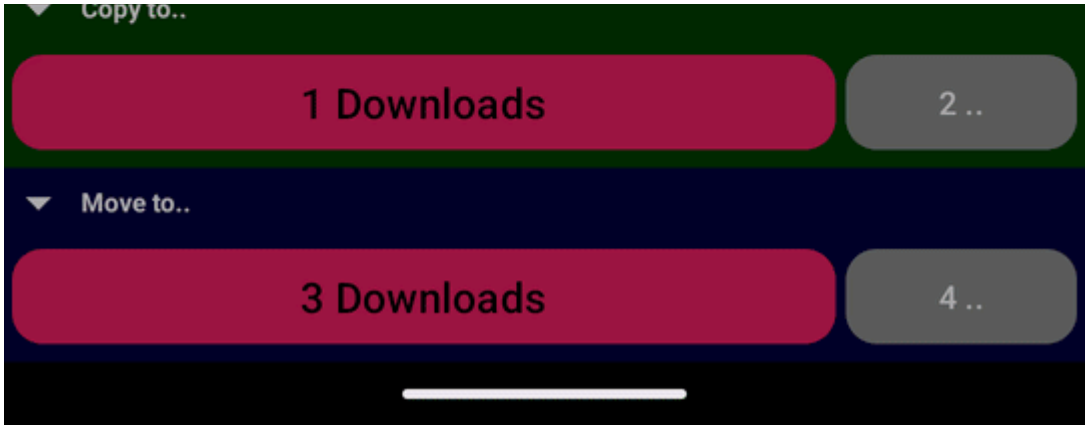
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: EPUB chapter translation**
EPUB book open, Translate tapped in the three-dots menu, target language set.

3 Open Text Settings and choose your languages

Open the three-dots menu and tap **Text Settings** to open the language and look dialog shared by images, PDFs, EPUB chapters and text files. Tap **Original Language and OCR** or **Translate To** to open a searchable language list ordered by your interface language, with **Auto** available as the source. A swap button next to the two rows exchanges the source and target language when the swap makes sense - handy when you translate back and forth between the same two languages.

The same dialog holds **Translation result in blocks** (the card-or-overlay switch from the first step), **Font Size** and **Font Family** for the translated text. Confirming the dialog also turns translation on, if it was off.


12:00
Text Settings
Original Language and OCR
Translate To
Russian (Русский)
English (English)
Translation result in blocks
Font Size
Automatic
Font Family
Default
Cancel
OK

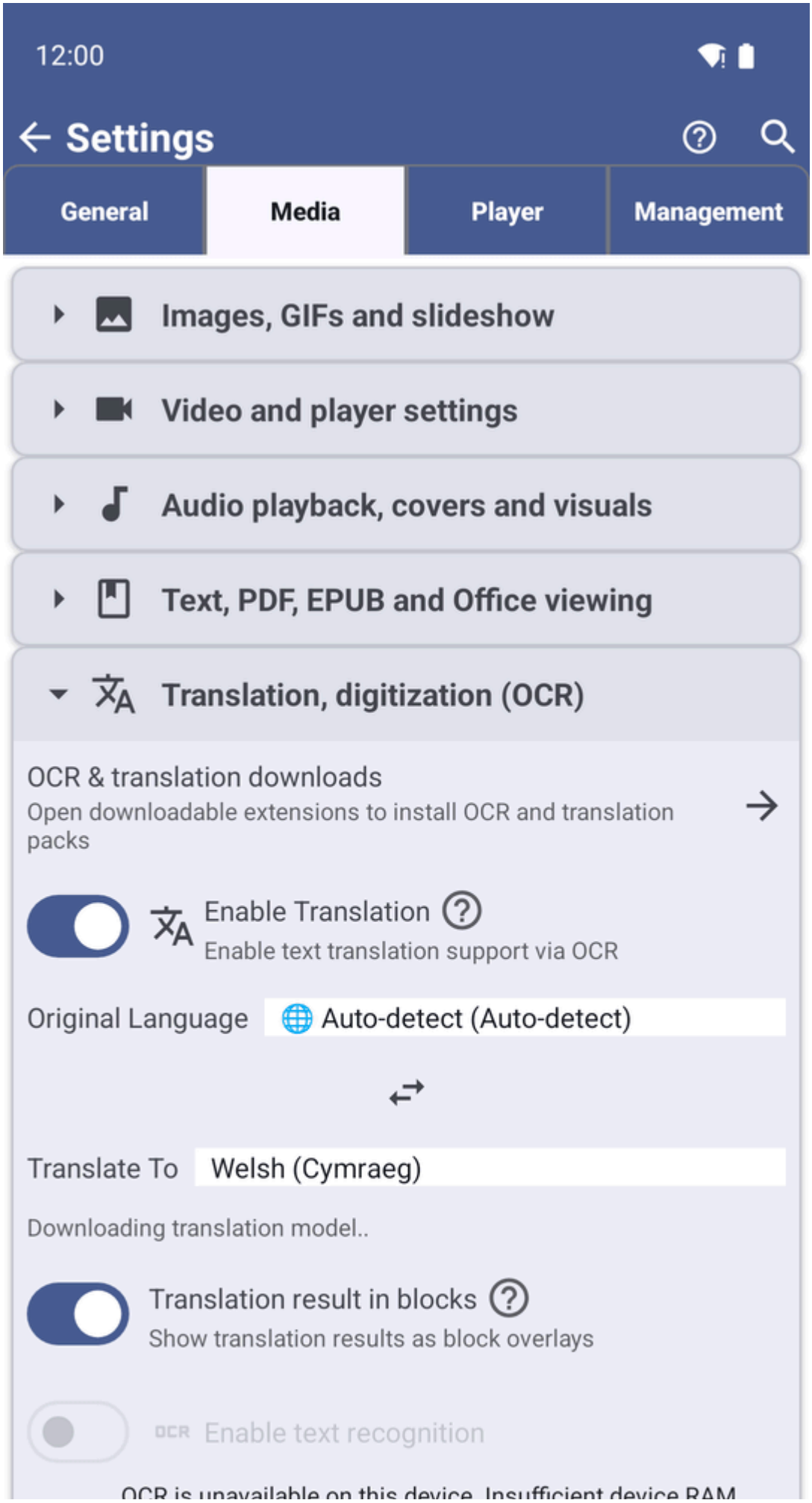


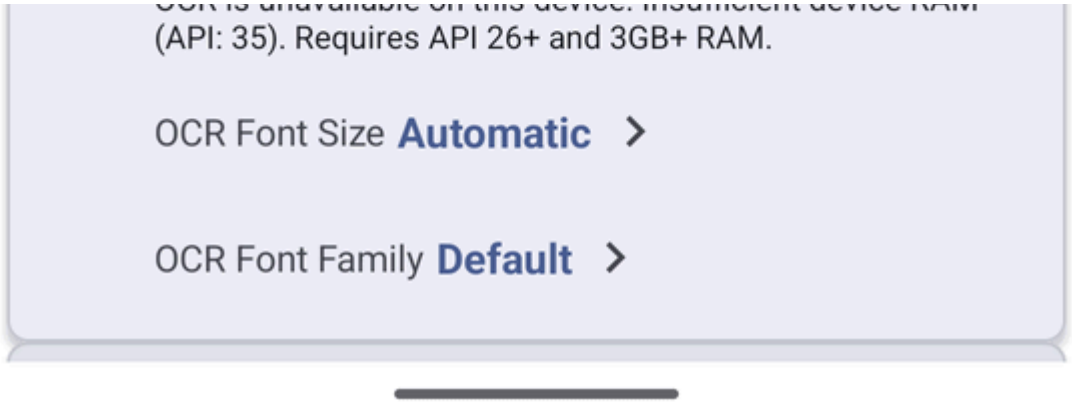
Text Settings: languages, look and font in one place.

4 Why the second translation is instant

The first time you pick a new target language, FastMediaSorter downloads its translation model in the background as soon as you choose it, not while you are waiting for a result - you may briefly see "Downloading translation model.." and then "Translation model ready.". A failed download shows "Couldn't download the translation model. Try again." with a **Retry** button.

A page or a picture you translate once stays translated in memory for the rest of the session: reopen the same page and the translation is already there, with no repeat recognition and no repeat download.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Images, GIFs and slideshow
Video and player settings
Audio playback, covers and visuals
Text, PDF, EPUB and Office viewing
Translation, digitization (OCR)
OCR & translation downloads
Open downloadable extensions to install OCR and translation packs
Enable Translation
Enable text translation support via OCR
Original Language
Auto-detect (Auto-detect)
Translate To
Welsh (Cymraeg)
Downloading translation model..
Translation result in blocks
Show translation results as block overlays
Enable text recognition
OCR is unavailable on this device. Insufficient device RAM



A new language's model downloads as soon as you pick it.

5 Where translation is not offered

On-device translation is licensed for phones, tablets, laptops, desktops and Chromebooks. On a TV, a car head unit or an XR headset, the **Translate** button stays visible but disabled, with "Translation is not licensed for this type of device" as the explanation, and the translator widget and launcher gadget are not offered on those devices at all.

A translated result carries a small, screen-reader-readable Google credit, since the translation itself comes from Google's on-device model.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Translation on a TV**
TV emulator, a picture open, the disabled Translate button focused.

What You Get

Recognized text, a PDF page, an EPUB chapter or a text file reads in your language without the internet - as a card of its own or painted right over the original words, in the font and size you like. Switching languages downloads what it needs quietly in the background, and translating the same page twice costs nothing the second time.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Haven't recognized any text yet?** Start with recognizing text on pictures.
- **Want to send the translated text to someone?** See sharing and exporting files.
- **Reading Cyrillic text that keeps coming out wrong?** Pick the source language explicitly instead of Auto - see the language step above, and recognizing text on pictures for why Auto can misread Cyrillic letters.
- **Only need the language pack, not a tour of the extensions screen?** Jump straight to downloadable extensions and language models.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

TOOLS

Extracting text with offline OCR

Recognize text from a photo, a screenshot or a scanned page before translating it.

DOCUMENTS

Reading PDF documents

Turn pages, read at night, search, copy and export PDF pages.

EDITIONS

Downloadable extensions and language models

Install the Translation Module and OCR language models, or remove them again.

OCR, DRAWING & SHARING | All editions | RECIPE #03

Drawing and Writing on Pictures

Open the drawing editor on any picture or a blank page, draw, write, erase, crop without leaving the session, save in place or as a new file, and send the result straight into the Send to.. menu.

Why You'll Love This

Blocking out a phone number in a screenshot, circling the thing you mean in a photo, adding an arrow and a short note before you send a picture along - these are two-second jobs that do not deserve a separate app. The drawing editor opens straight over the picture you are already looking at, with the same picture underneath while you work.

It also opens on an empty page, so a screenshot, a sketch or a diagram can start from nothing at all.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition : Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS.
- An image open in the image viewer, or a folder you are allowed to write to for a blank canvas.

1 Start a drawing

On a photo already open in the image viewer, open the three-dots menu and tap **Drawing**. The picture stays visible underneath while a toolbar appears at the bottom.

To start from nothing, go to the file browser, open the three-dots menu and tap **Create drawing** (on a wide screen the button sits right on the bar). A blank white page opens straight in the drawing editor - you name it later, when you save.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Drawing editor on a blank canvas**
Drawing editor opened from Create drawing, empty canvas, toolbar visible at the bottom, no strokes yet.

2 Pick a tool and a color

Tap the tool icon on the left of the toolbar to choose **Brush**, **Rectangle**, **Oval**, **Eraser**, **Text** or **Crop**.

Next to it are four color swatches: **black**, **white** and **red** are always there, and the fourth opens a color grid so you can pick any color you like - your choice becomes the new fourth swatch. The color and the tool you used last are remembered the next time you open the drawing editor.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Drawing tool selector**
Tool selector popup open over a photo in draw mode, six tools listed, red swatch active.

3 Draw, write and erase

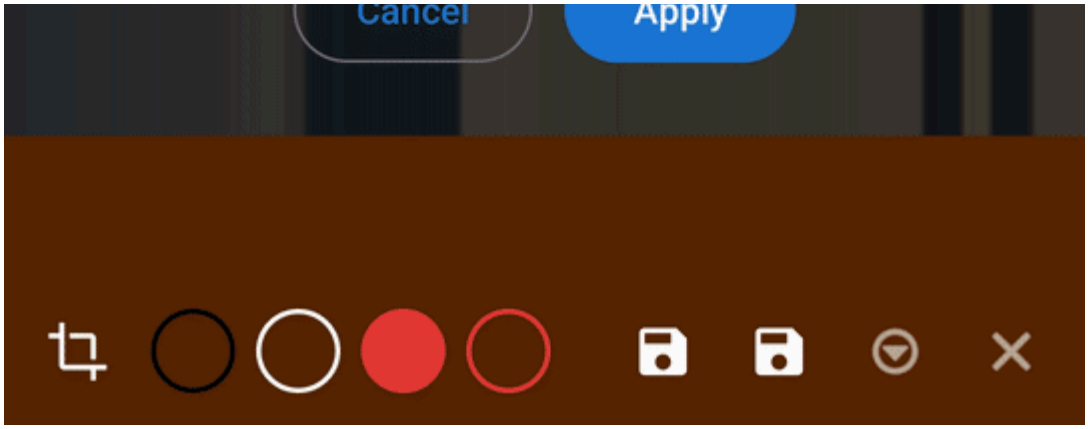
- **Brush** - drag your finger to draw a freehand line in the chosen color.
- **Rectangle** and **Oval** - drag from one corner to draw the shape; you see it grow as you drag.
- **Text** - tap where you want it and type; the text lands at that spot in the chosen color.
- **Eraser** - drag over a stroke to clear it, at twice the width of the current brush so mistakes are easy to catch.

  Everything you add stays a separate stroke or shape until you save, so a bad line does not ruin the ones before it - see **Undo** in step 6.

4 Crop without leaving the drawing

Pick **Crop** from the tool popup and a frame with corner handles appears over the picture, the same frame as the crop tool in the image viewer. Drag it to the part you want to keep and confirm.

The picture is cut down to that frame right there in the drawing session, so you can keep drawing on the cropped result before you save or send it - no need to crop first, save, and come back to draw.



Cropping inside the drawing editor.

5 Adjust brush size, opacity and text size

Open the overflow button ⋮ and tap **Settings** to open **Draw settings**: sliders for **Brush size** and **Opacity**, and a **Text size** choice of **Small**, **Medium** or **Large**. These, like your last color, are remembered for next time.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Draw settings**
Draw settings dialog open over the drawing editor, brush size slider near the middle.

6 Save your work

- **Save** - writes your drawing into the picture you started from (or, for a blank canvas, saves it for the first time) and keeps the editor open. The toolbar tints itself while there is anything unsaved, so you can see at a glance that you still have work to save.
- **Save & close** - the same, then takes you back to the picture.
- **Save as..** - in the overflow menu, asks for a file name (the suggested one is the original name plus `_draw-` and the date and time, for example `beach_draw-260924-1530.jpg`) and keeps the original picture untouched.
- **Cancel** ⊗ - leaves without saving; nothing changes.

> **Pictures on another computer**
>
> Drawing on an image in a network folder or cloud storage works the same way - the app saves the result back to the same place. If it cannot reach the folder you see "Couldn't reach the folder. Your drawing stayed on this device - try saving again.", and nothing is lost.

7 Undo, delete or send the result

The overflow button ⋮ also holds:

- **Undo last** and **Undo all** - step back through your strokes, or clear every one of them at once.
- **Delete file** - removes the picture you started from. Only shown when you opened an existing file, never for a blank canvas.
- **Send to..** - merges your drawing into the picture and hands the result to the same Send to.. menu used everywhere else in the app, so it can go straight to Google Keep, a messenger or any other receiver you have turned on.

What You Get

A photo, a screenshot or a blank page carries your brush strokes, shapes, text and crops, saved in place or as a new file, with your favorite color, brush size and text size waiting for you next time - and ready to send on without a detour through another app.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Every saved copy has a proper file type. Save as..** always writes a real file extension, so a saved screenshot, frame or edit opens in any other app too.
- **Just want to turn or trim the whole photo, no drawing?** That is the image viewer's own tools - see Editing photos.
- **Want to know exactly who a Send to.. receiver reaches and how to turn one on or off?** See Sending files with the Send to.. menu.
- **Working on a screenshot?** The screen-capture shortcut on Standard can open it straight in the drawing editor after you take it.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

IMAGES

Editing photos

Rotate, crop and adjust colors on the whole picture.

TOOLS

Sending files with the Send to.. menu

Every receiver in the Send to.. menu, and how to turn one on or off.

TOOLS

Extracting text with offline OCR

Pull the words out of a picture instead of drawing on it.

OCR, DRAWING & SHARING | All editions | RECIPE #04

All editions (details per step)

Sending Files with the Send to.. Menu

One Send to.. menu reaches every receiver the app knows - messengers, Google Keep, Lens, Print, your paired watch and your own resources - with a switch for each one, honest progress for network and cloud files, a shortcut to download by link, and a QR code to hand an SFTP server to another phone.

Why You'll Love This

Every app that can receive a picture or a file wants its own way in: a share button here, a copy-and-paste there, a different menu in every screen. FastMediaSorter keeps one list instead - the **Send to..** menu - and shows it from every screen where sending a file makes sense: the player, the file browser, the drawing editor.

It is the app's own address book of places a file can go, not a copy of Android's system share sheet - "Other apps" is simply one more entry on the same list, next to your messenger, Google Keep, the printer and your own resources.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition: the Send to.. menu itself is in all seven - Standard, noLegal, Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS.
- The apps you want to send to (Telegram, WhatsApp, Instagram, Google Keep, Viber, Messenger, a short-video app) installed on this phone, for their row to appear.
- For sending straight to a watch: the Standard or noLegal edition with a paired Wear OS watch and its app open.
- For downloading a file before sending it: Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR.
- For **Download by link** and sharing an SFTP resource as a QR code: see steps 6 and 7 for which editions carry each one.

1 Open the Send to.. menu

Wherever you see a share icon - the Share button in the player's command panel, the three-dots menu on a file in the file browser, the overflow menu of the drawing editor - it opens the same **Send to..** list.

If only one receiver can actually take the file, it is sent right away with no list to tap through. Otherwise a sheet lists every receiver that is turned on, available right now and able to handle that kind of file, always in the same order, ending with a permanent **Select resource..** row that copies the file to one of your resources instead of sending it anywhere.

On a narrow player screen the Share button sometimes does not fit the bar; tap the overflow ⋮ instead - the same receivers are there, one per row with its own icon.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Send to.. bottom sheet**
Send to.. sheet open over a photo in the player, several receivers visible, Select resource.. row at the bottom.

2 Meet the receivers

- **Other apps** - opens Android's own share picker; works with any file type and is always there.
- **Open in..** - opens the file directly in another app on this device.
- **Email** - attaches the file to a new email; offered once the phone has internet access.
- **Print** - sends images, GIFs, PDFs, text and office documents to Android's print system.
- **Telegram, WhatsApp, Viber, Messenger and a short-video app** such as TikTok - send straight to the installed app; each one is shown only when that app is actually on your phone, and falls back to Android's own picker if the direct hand-off fails.
- **Instagram** - takes one image, video or GIF at a time; picking several files sends the first one, with a note that it applies only to the first file.
- **Keep: image / Keep: text** - the two Google Keep receivers save a picture or a piece of text as a new Keep note; need the Keep app installed.
- **Google Lens** - opens the picture in Lens for a visual search; needs Google's own services.
- **Watch** - see step 4.
- **Select resource..** - the row at the end of every list; copies the file to a destination resource (or a folder you pick) instead of sending it anywhere.

  A receiver whose app is not installed, or that you have turned off, simply is not in the list - there is nothing to tap that will not work.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Receivers for a photo**
Photo open in the player, Send to.. opened and scrolled to the end, Google Lens switched on.

3 Turn a receiver on or off

Open **Settings**, the **Destinations** tab, and find the **Send file to..** card. Every receiver has its own switch and a short help note explaining what it does. Turn one off and it stops appearing in every Send to.. list across the app, even if the app it points to is installed. What each switch does is described in the settings reference.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Send file to.. settings**
Settings, Destinations tab, Send file to.. card expanded, several switches visible, Google Lens off.

4 Send a photo, video or track straight to your watch

Standard and noLegal editions, with a paired watch.

Pick **Watch** from the Send to.. list and whatever you have open - a photo, a GIF, a video or a track - opens on the watch itself, with no need to go looking for the same file on the small screen. A file kept on a network drive or in the cloud is downloaded first, with progress you can cancel by going back.

The watch app has to be open on the watch for the file to arrive, and the phone tells you exactly what happened: opened on the watch, the watch is not reachable, the watch did not answer, the watch app is closed, the watch cannot show that type of file, or the file is over the 32 MB the watch accepts. Documents, text and EPUB files never offer the watch as a receiver.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Sent to the watch**
Photo open in the player, a paired watch with the app open, Watch picked from Send to..

5 Sending a file that lives on a network drive or in the cloud

Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR.

Sending a file straight from a network folder or cloud storage works the same as sending a local one - the app just needs a local copy first. You see "Downloading file.." with a progress bar for a network folder, or a spinner for a server that does not report progress, and the receiver opens as soon as the copy is ready. Pressing back cancels the download; a failure shows "Could not prepare the file for sharing." and nothing is sent.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Preparing a network file**
Browse on an SMB resource, a video sent through Send to.., download about 40 percent done.

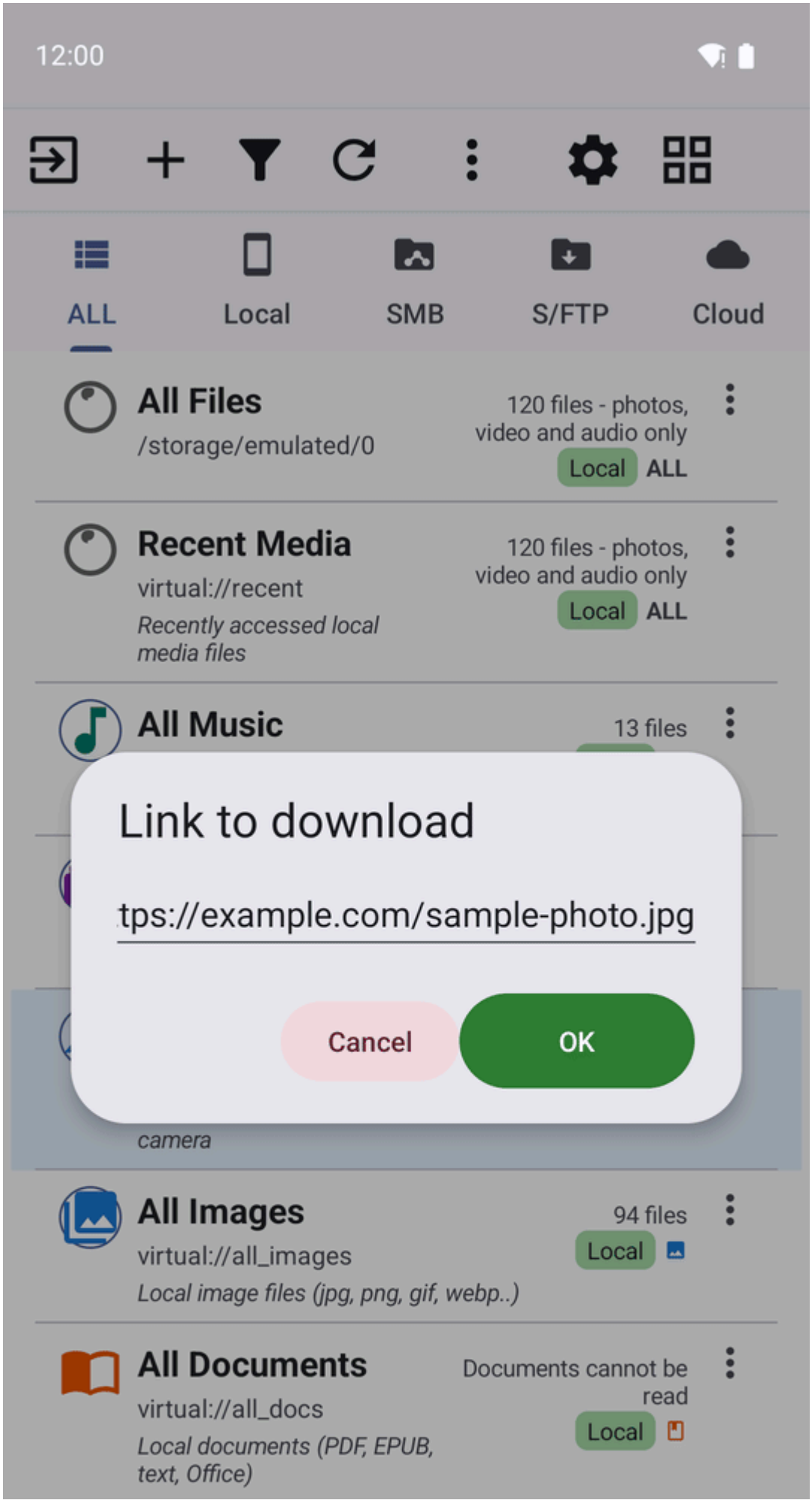
Where the progress goes for a bigger job

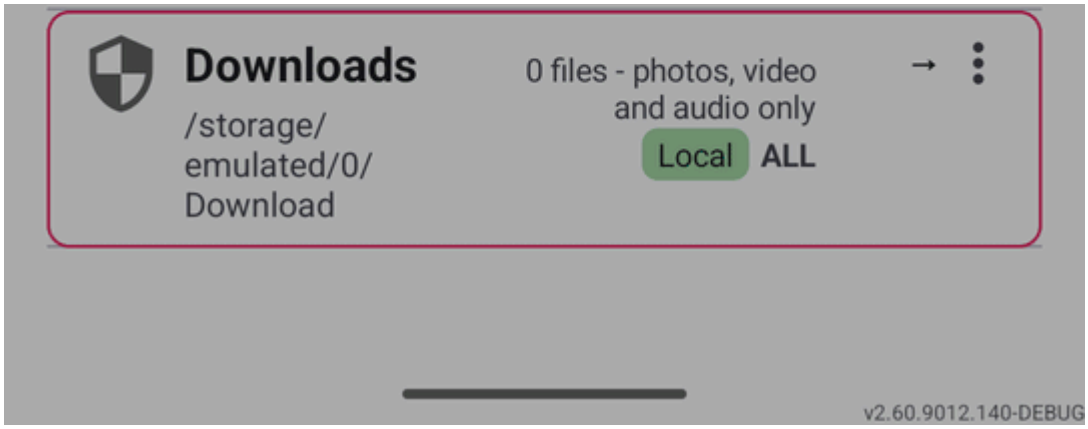
A single Send to.. download shows its own small dialog. Copying or moving a whole batch of files works the same way in the background - see Background transfers and their progress.

6 Grab a file from a link

Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy.

When link auto-download is switched on, the main menu shows **Download by link**. Tap it and a **Link to download** box opens, already filled in with whatever is on your clipboard - paste or type a different one if you need to. The file downloads the same way any link handed to the app does, straight into your chosen folder.


12:00
ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
All Files
/storage/emulated/0
120 files - photos, video and audio only
Local
ALL
Recent Media
virtual://recent
Recently accessed local media files
120 files - photos, video and audio only
Local
ALL
All Music
13 files
Link to download
tps://example.com/sample-photo.jpg
Cancel
OK
camera
All Images
virtual://all_images
Local image files (jpg, png, gif, webp..)
94 files
Local
All Documents
virtual://all_docs
Local documents (PDF, EPUB, text, Office)
Documents cannot be read
Local



The link from the clipboard is already filled in.

⚠ The file and the code both carry your password

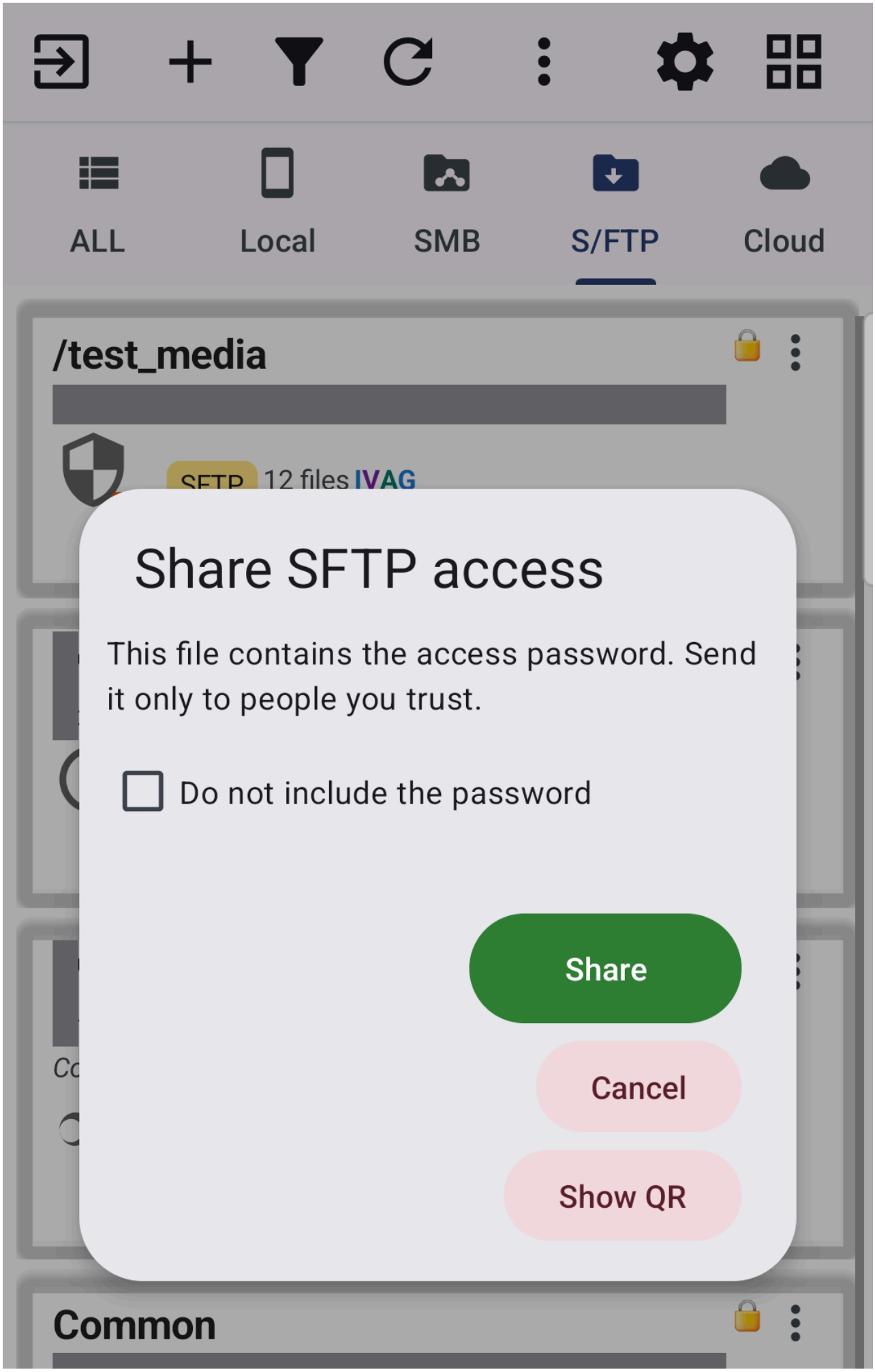
Unless you tick **Do not include the password**, anyone with the file or a photo of the code can open the server. If it is on your home network, the app also warns that only someone on the same network can actually connect.

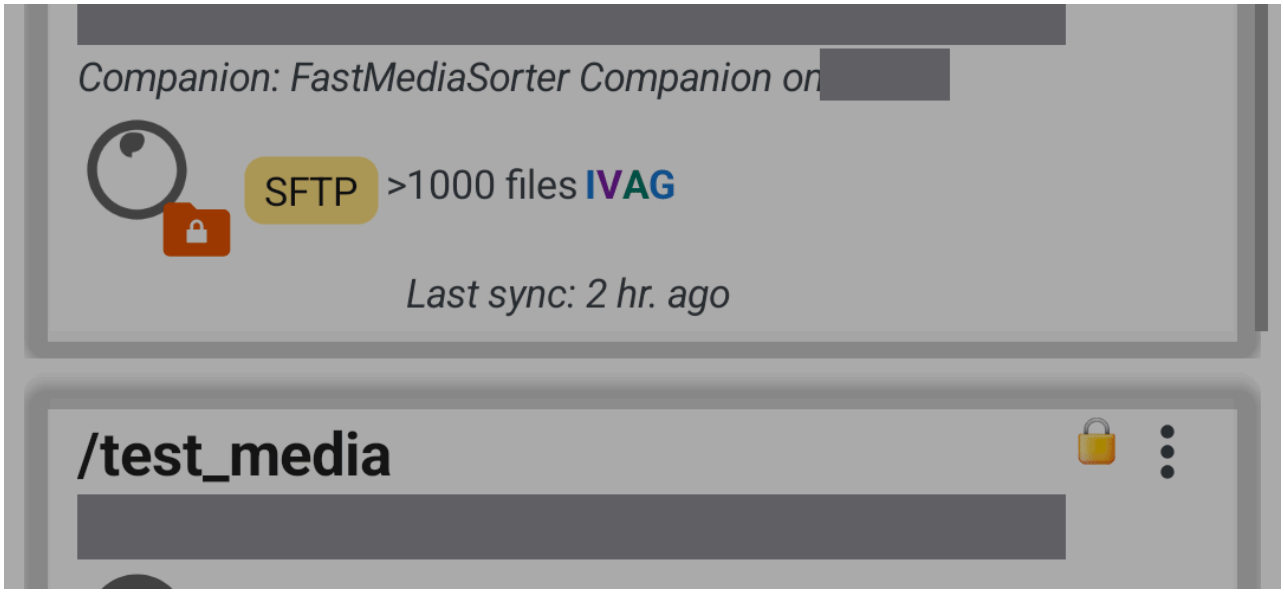
7 Share an SFTP resource as a QR code

Standard, Photos, Legacy and VR.

Open the three-dots menu of an SFTP resource - one you added yourself, or one shared by the Windows companion - and tap **Share access…**. The **Share SFTP access** window offers **Do not include the password**, then two ways to hand it over:

- **Share** - creates a small access file and opens the system share sheet with it, the same way you would send any file.
- **Show QR** - shows a QR code on screen instead: "Scan to add the resource", with the hint "In FastMediaSorter: Add resource -> Scan QR."
  On the other phone, tap **Add** on the main screen and, under **Import a ready configuration**, tap **Import by barcode** and point the camera at the code - the resource arrives fully set up, exactly like importing a Windows companion configuration.


ALL
Local
SMB
S/FTP
Cloud
/test_media
SFTP 12 files IVAG
Share SFTP access
This file contains the access password. Send it only to people you trust.
Do not include the password
Share
Cancel
Show QR
Common



Share access to a folder, password optional.

What You Get

One list, everywhere a file can be sent from, with every receiver named for what it really is, a switch to turn each one on or off, honest progress when a file has to come from the network or the cloud first, a shortcut to grab a file from a link, and a QR code to hand an SFTP server to another phone in seconds.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A shared link with auto-download on** opens the share screen and shows the download progress dialog properly - receiving such a link no longer closes the share screen with an error.
- **Want the full picture on backing up and restoring your whole resource list?** See Sharing and backing up your resources - it covers the Windows companion, Google Drive backups and moving everything to a new phone.
- **Sending something you just drew or annotated?** The drawing editor's own overflow menu opens this same Send to.. list - see Drawing and writing on pictures.
- **A receiver you expected is missing?** Check its switch in step 3 first, then make sure the app it needs is actually installed.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

TOOLS

Drawing and writing on pictures

Draw, write and crop on a picture, then send the result from here.

STORAGE

Sharing and backing up your resources

Move your whole list of resources to another phone, or back it up to Google Drive.

STORAGE

Background transfers and their progress

What a bigger copy, move or download looks like while it runs.

er: Desktop

LAUNCHER: DESKTOP | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #01

Your Launcher Desktop – the Starter Layout, Shortcuts and Gadgets

The FastMediaSorter desktop is a grid of squares where you keep what you use every day: apps, your media folders, radio channels, a clock and the weather. This page shows how to switch it on, what it holds from the first minute, and how to add your own things.

Why You'll Love This

An old tablet on the kitchen wall, a car head unit, or simply a phone you want to feel calmer: instead of pages of app icons you want the clock, the weather, your photo folders and the radio, all on the first screen. The FastMediaSorter desktop is made for this. It can be your device's home screen, or a start window inside the app that leaves your usual home screen alone.

You do not start from an empty grid. A fresh desktop arrives already filled with useful things, grouped under headings, and every square can be changed with a long press.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition. The launcher is not part of the Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS editions – see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter.
- A few minutes to look around. No root access and no extra app are needed.
- Optional: one or two resources you already added, so the desktop can offer your own folders.

1 Choose how the desktop opens

Go to **Settings**, the **General** tab, and tap **Primary startup window**. Three choices appear:

- **Device home screen** – FastMediaSorter becomes the home screen you see after unlocking. Android asks you to confirm: allow it, or on older Android versions pick FastMediaSorter and tap **Always** the next time you press Home.
- **Desktop as primary window** – the desktop opens when you start the app from its icon, but your usual home screen stays as it is. A good way to try the desktop without committing.
- **Main screen** – the app opens on its main screen with your resources, as before.

You can also choose this on the first page of the welcome wizard when you install the app.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Primary startup window**
Settings, General tab, the Primary startup window dialog open with its three choices.

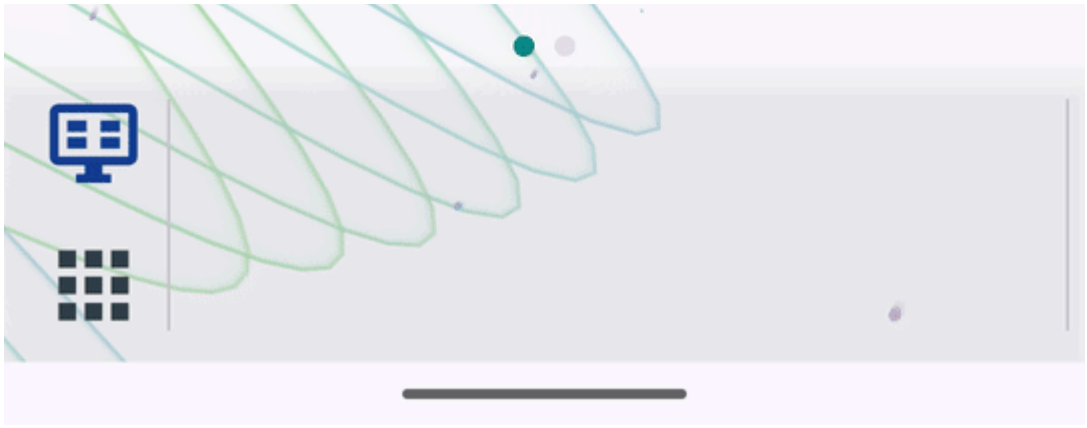
2 Look at what a fresh desktop already holds

The first time the desktop opens it is already arranged for you, in named sections - rows grouped under a heading:

- **Main** - a clock, a web search field, the weather and shortcuts to your media: all your pictures, videos, music and documents.
- **Gadgets** - small live blocks such as the translator and, on phones and tablets, a storage readout.
- **Resources** - your own folders, when you have added some.
- **Google** - the Google apps installed on the device, including Google Keep and Gemini when you have them.
- **Apps** - up to 25 of your other installed apps, from messengers to games. How many depends on the grid size, and no app appears twice.
- **App functions** - one tile for each program you have switched on: Streams, Quick Camera, Quick Voice, Calculator, Network Monitor, Camera OCR, Screen Recording, Link Download, Game, System Information and Wear Companion.
- **Settings** - the app's own settings, the launcher settings and quick ways into the Android system settings.

The layout is not the same on every device. The desktop looks at your device profile and the size and shape of the screen: a phone, a tablet, a TV or an e-reader each get their own section order, number of items and number of screens.

100
22:26:23
Search the web
Weather
Thu 10-08
Long press to choose a place
Gadgets
360° North
Location is of...
4.58 GB
4.58 GB free of 10.41 GB...
Resources
Recent Media
All Music
All Images
All Videos
All Documents
Camera Photos
All Files
Downloads
Add resource
App functions
Streams
Quick capture
Voice recording
Calculator
Download by link
Camera flashlight
Mirror
Black screen
Take a photo an...
Take a photo an...
Take a photo an...
Start video recording
Camera Photos
Camera
Scheduled Operations
All apps
Exit launcher ...
Favorites
Fast Media Sorter & ...
Settings
App settings
Launcher settings
Edit desktop c...
Android settings
WI-FI
Bluetooth
Display
Sound



A fresh desktop, grouped into sections.

3 Open things with one tap

Each square with an icon and a caption is a shortcut. Tap it and what it points to opens: an app starts, a folder opens in the file browser, a program appears, a system setting opens.

Captions sit on a light plate, so they stay readable over any wallpaper, and icons line up along the top of each row even when one caption takes two lines. Removing a shortcut never deletes the thing it opens.

The full list of your installed apps is always one step away in All apps: open the Start menu on the taskbar, then **All apps**. Apps there are shown as a scrollable grid of icons with their names. More about the list is in Using the desktop dock and taskbar.

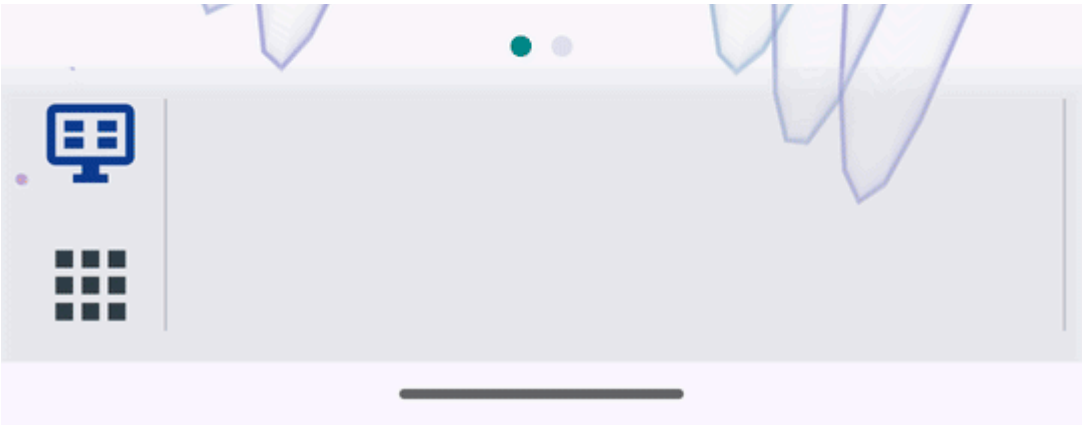
4 Put something new on an empty square

Touch and hold an empty square on the desktop. A short menu appears:

- **Add an item..**
- **Edit the desktop**
- **Wallpaper**
- **Launcher settings**
- **Lock changes**

  Tap **Add an item..** and choose what goes there: **App**, **App feature**, **My resource**, **Stream**, **Android setting**, **Gadget**, **Launcher action**, **Scheduled operation** or a new section. For one of your folders you then choose how it opens: **Browse**, **Slideshow** or **Play**. The new square lands exactly where you pressed.

22:35:54
Search the web
Weather
Long press to choose a place
Thu 10-08
360° North
Location is of...
4.58 GB
4.58 GB free of 10.41 GB...
Gadgets
Resources
Recent Media
All Music
All Images
All Videos
All Documents
Camera Photos
All Files
App functions
Streams
Download by link
Camera flashlight
Mirror
Take a photo an...
Start video recordina
Camera Photos
Exit launcher ...
Favorites
Fast Media Sorter & ...
Settings
App settinas
Launcher settinas
Edit desktop c...
Android settinas
WI-FI
Bluetooth
Display
Sound
Add an item..
Edit the desktop
Wallpaper
Launcher settings
Lock changes



The menu a long press on an empty square opens.

No empty square left?

Use **Edit the desktop** and the **+** button next to **Done** – it drops the new item into the first free place, or into a new row below everything. See Arranging the desktop.

5 Add live gadgets

A gadget is a small live block that shows fresh information. Choose **Gadget** in the add menu to see them all. Some that people use most:

- **Weather** - the current weather for a place you name. Touch and hold it to choose the place; no location permission is needed, and the data comes from Open-Meteo. Metric or US units follow **Unit system** in **Settings**, **General**.
- **Search** - a web search field. Type, press the search key, and the results open in your browser. Nothing you type is kept on the desktop.
- **Translator** - an offline translator. Its caption shows the language pair from the app's translation settings; tap the caption to change it, or swap the two languages for the moment. See Translating extracted text.
- **Audio window**, **Video window**, **Document window** and **Image window** - play or show something from one of your resources right inside the square.
- **YouTube** and **YouTube Music** - the web pages of these services inside a square.

A gadget can be moved, resized and removed like any other square. The full gadget catalog is in Desktop gadgets.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gadget picker**
The add-item picker switched to Gadget, list of gadgets visible.

6 Keep a radio or TV channel on the desktop

Choose **Stream** in the add menu and pick a channel from your list in Streams. Tap its square to start playing.

Touch and hold a channel square for its menu. **Edit** opens the same window as in Streams, where you change the address, the title, the type of media and the preferred audio and subtitle language. **Add window to desktop** places a live **Stream window** of this channel in the first free square; a short message says **Window added to desktop**, or **No free space on desktop**. More ways to keep stations close are in Shortcuts, the stream widget and the streams panel.

7 Bring in the app's widgets and other apps' shortcuts

The widgets FastMediaSorter offers for the Android home screen - calculator, camera, photos, reading, music, recorder, game, OCR, favorites, scheduled tasks and Now Playing - can sit on this desktop too, working the same way. Go to **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and tap **Add a gadget to the launcher desktop**; the chosen one goes into the first free place. The button is there only while the desktop is your home screen. Details are in Placing, resizing and styling gadgets and widgets.

Other apps can put their own shortcuts here, exactly as on any other home screen: when a browser or a messenger offers "Add to home screen", the shortcut lands on this desktop.

8 Put every installed app on the desktop at once

Open the launcher settings - from the long-press menu, from the Start menu, or through **Settings**, **General**, **System launcher settings**. In the **System** group tap **Import all installed apps**.

Every app gets a shortcut in one section called **Desktop**, in alphabetical order. The section grows as needed. Running the import again refills the same section rather than adding a second one. It cannot copy the layout of the launcher you used before - Android does not let any app read that.

What You Get

Your desktop opens the way you chose - as the home screen or as the app's start window - already filled with a clock, weather, search, your media and your apps, and you can put any app, folder, channel, gadget or setting on any square with a long press.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Switched a program on later?** Its tile appears in **App functions** by itself, in both the upright and the sideways layout, without a restart. A tile you removed by hand is not brought back, and switching a program off leaves its tile where it is.
- **Want the starter layout back? Reset launcher settings** in the **System** group of the launcher settings returns the desktop, the pinned icons and the wallpaper to their first state, after a confirmation.
- **On a VR headset** the choices that would make the app the headset's home screen are hidden, because the headset keeps its own.
- **The desktop disappeared after a restart of a car head unit?** Some head units force their factory home screen on every start. Choose FastMediaSorter again; if it does not stay, that device does not allow another home screen.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Arranging the desktop - sections, screens, swipes and the lock

Move, resize and fold, spread items over several screens and lock the layout.

LAUNCHER

Choosing a desktop wallpaper

Animated waves, a still frame, your own photo or a live camera picture.

LAUNCHER

Using the desktop dock and taskbar

The Start button, recent and pinned apps and the status tray.

LAUNCHER: DESKTOP | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #02

Choosing a Desktop Wallpaper - Animated Waves, a Still Frame, Your Photo or a Live Camera

The launcher desktop can draw six kinds of wallpaper, from the moving waves and particles of the FastMediaSorter brand to your own photo or a live camera view. This page shows how to choose one and tune it.

Why You'll Love This

The wallpaper is the first thing you see on the desktop, so it should suit the place: calm and still on a bedside tablet, lively on a kitchen display, a family photo on a photo frame, or even the view from the camera on a device standing by the window.

All wallpaper choices sit on one screen, each with a sentence saying what it does, and the app looks after the battery for you.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher desktop open - see Your launcher desktop.
- For your own wallpaper: a picture or an animated GIF on the device.
- For the camera wallpapers: a device with a camera, and your permission for the app to use it.

1 Open the Screens and wallpaper screen

Touch and hold an empty square on the desktop and tap **Wallpaper**. The **Screens and wallpaper** screen opens.

You can reach the same screen from the launcher settings: **Settings**, **General**, **System launcher settings**, the **Appearance** group, **Screens and wallpaper**.

Screens and wallpaper

Apply

on.

Show clock and status while dimmed
Clock and status on the dimmed screen

What is drawn

Waves and particles
Colored waves with drifting particles, animated all the time the desktop is open.

Striped wallpaper
The same waves, but frozen: one fresh frame is drawn each time you return to the desktop, and nothing moves after that.

Empty
No wallpaper at all - the desktop shows the flat color of the current theme.

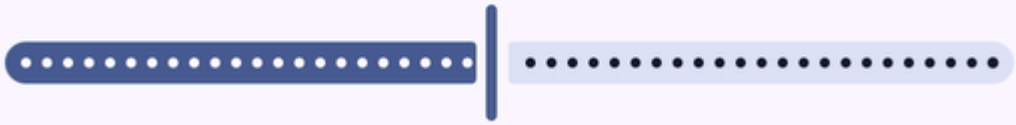
My image
Your own picture, still or animated, cropped to fill the screen.

Camera
A live picture from the camera, refreshed continuously. It costs the most battery of all the modes.

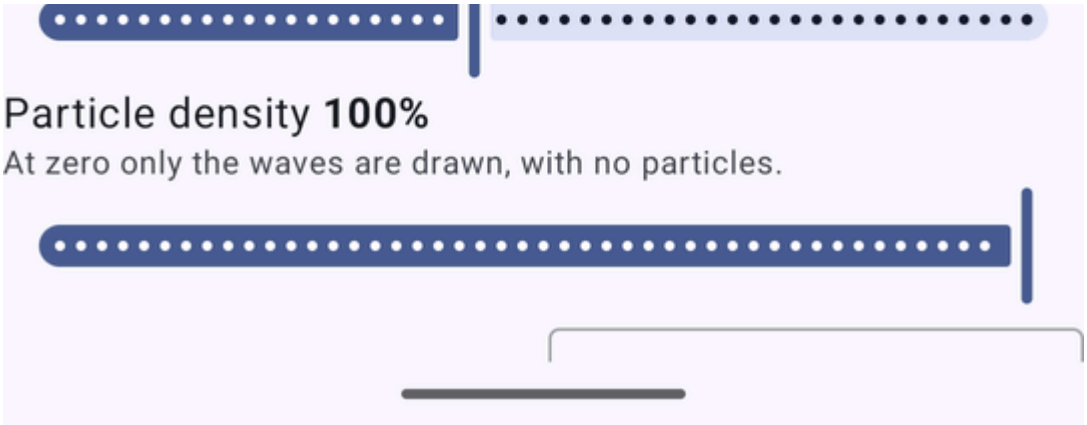
Instant photo
One photo taken by the camera each time you return to the desktop; the camera is released immediately afterwards.

Appearance

Brightness **56%**
How strongly the wallpaper is drawn. Lower values leave more contrast for icons and labels.



Animation speed **1.00×**



Screens and wallpaper, with the six modes.

2 Pick what is drawn

Under **What is drawn** choose one of six modes:

- **Waves and particles** – colored waves with drifting particles, moving the whole time the desktop is open. This is the starting choice.
- **Striped wallpaper** – the same waves, but frozen. A fresh frame is drawn each time you come back to the desktop, and nothing moves after that.
- **Empty** – no wallpaper at all; the desktop shows the plain color of your color theme.
- **My image** – your own picture, still or animated, cropped to fill the screen.
- **Camera** – a live picture from a camera, refreshed all the time. This mode uses the most battery.
- **Instant photo** – the camera takes one photo each time you come back to the desktop and is released straight away.

3 Use your own picture or animated GIF

Select **My image**, then tap **Choose** under **Source** and pick a picture. A preview shows what you chose.

The app keeps its own copy of the picture, so the wallpaper stays even if you later move or delete the original file. Animated GIFs keep moving on the desktop. If a file cannot be used, the screen says **Could not use this image** and the previous wallpaper stays.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Own picture wallpaper**
Launcher desktop with My image selected, a landscape photo as the wallpaper, portrait.

⚠ Battery

Camera keeps the camera running while the desktop is visible. On a device that runs on battery, **Instant photo** gives you a fresh picture at a fraction of the cost.

4 Show a live camera picture

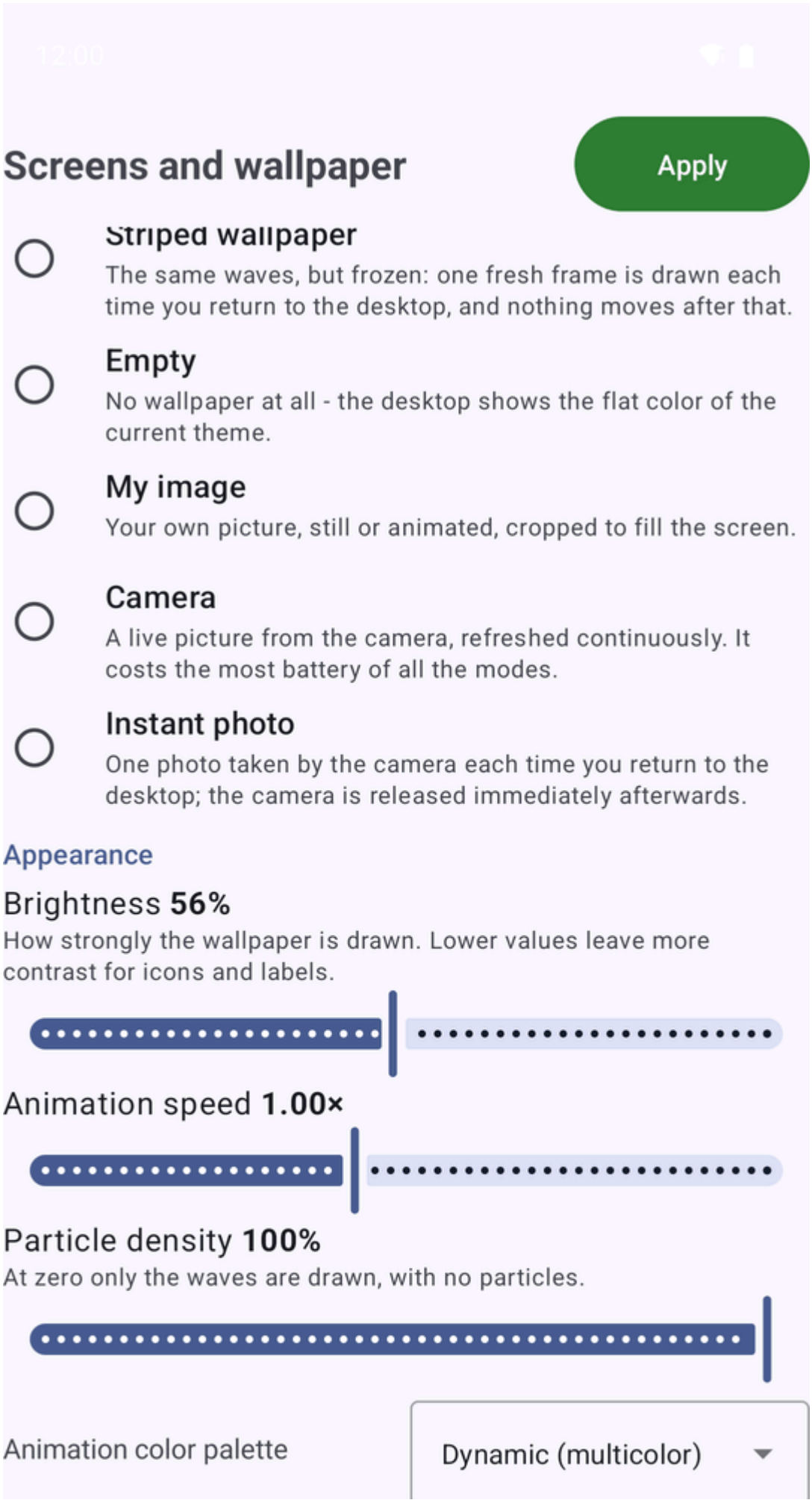
Select **Camera** or **Instant photo**. If the device has several cameras, a list **Choose a camera** appears so you can pick the lens; **Choose** under **Source** changes it later. The first time, Android asks whether the app may use the camera - allow it.

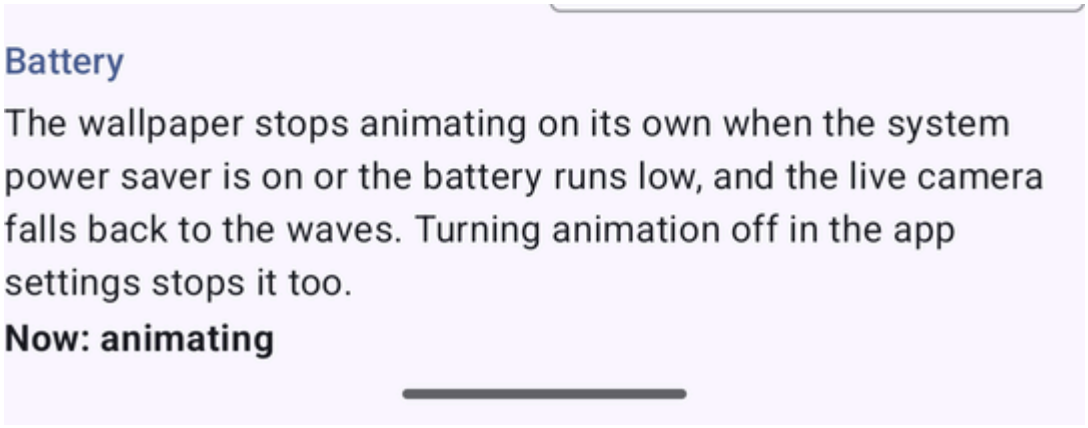
These two modes are offered only on devices that have a camera. The camera is released as soon as the desktop leaves the screen. If there is no camera or you decline the permission, the desktop quietly goes back to **Waves and particles**.

5 Tune brightness, speed, particles and colors

Under **Appearance** on the same screen:

- **Brightness** - how strongly the wallpaper is drawn. Lower values leave more contrast for icons and captions.
- **Animation speed** - how fast the waves move.
- **Particle density** - how many particles drift over the waves. At zero only the waves are drawn.
- **Animation color palette** - **Dynamic (multicolor)**, **Greenish**, **Pinkish** or **Blueish**. The same palette colors the animated background of the audio player.


12:00
Screens and wallpaper
Apply
Striped wallpaper
The same waves, but frozen: one fresh frame is drawn each time you return to the desktop, and nothing moves after that.
Empty
No wallpaper at all - the desktop shows the flat color of the current theme.
My image
Your own picture, still or animated, cropped to fill the screen.
Camera
A live picture from the camera, refreshed continuously. It costs the most battery of all the modes.
Instant photo
One photo taken by the camera each time you return to the desktop; the camera is released immediately afterwards.
Appearance
Brightness 56%
How strongly the wallpaper is drawn. Lower values leave more contrast for icons and labels.
Animation speed 1.00×
Particle density 100%
At zero only the waves are drawn, with no particles.
Animation color palette
Dynamic (multicolor)



Brightness, speed, particles and palette.

6

Let the wallpaper show through the squares

Shortcuts on the desktop have no card behind them: the wallpaper shows through the whole grid, and each icon and caption carries a thin outline so it stays readable over a bright, dark or busy picture. The whole square stays tappable.

Gadgets keep a light card. To make that card more or less solid, open the launcher settings, the **Appearance** group, **Widget backdrop opacity**, and pick from **0% (Transparent)** to **100% (Opaque)**; **25% (Default)** is the starting value. While you arrange the desktop every square shows a full card, so its edges are easy to see.

What You Get

The desktop shows the wallpaper that suits the place - moving, still, your own photo or the camera view - at the brightness and colors you like, with every icon still easy to read.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The waves stopped moving?** The wallpaper stops on its own when the system power saver is on or the battery runs low, and a live camera falls back to the waves. The **Battery** block at the bottom of the screen explains this and shows the current state: **Now: animating**, **Now: reduced to save power** or **Now: stopped to save power**.
- **Want motion without the battery cost? Striped wallpaper** looks like the animation but draws only one frame each time you return.
- **Your wallpaper choices travel with you.** They are part of the settings backup, so restoring a backup on a new device brings them back - see Backing up and restoring settings.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

LAUNCHER

Arranging the desktop - sections, screens, swipes and the lock

Move, resize and fold, spread items over several screens and lock the layout.

PHOTOS

Creating photo slideshows

Want many photos instead of one? Let them change by themselves.

LAUNCHER: DESKTOP Standard and noLegal RECIPE #03

Arranging the Desktop – Sections, Screens, Swipes and the Lock

Once the desktop holds the things you use, arranging them is a matter of a few long presses. This page covers moving and resizing squares, sections you can fold, several screens, the four swipes and the lock that keeps it all in place.

Why You'll Love This

A desktop is only comfortable when things are where your hand expects them. Maybe you want the radio in the top corner, the family photos on a second screen, and the rarely used apps folded away under a heading. And once it is right, you want nobody – including a curious child – to move anything by accident.

Everything on this page changes only the layout. No app, folder or file is ever deleted by rearranging the desktop.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

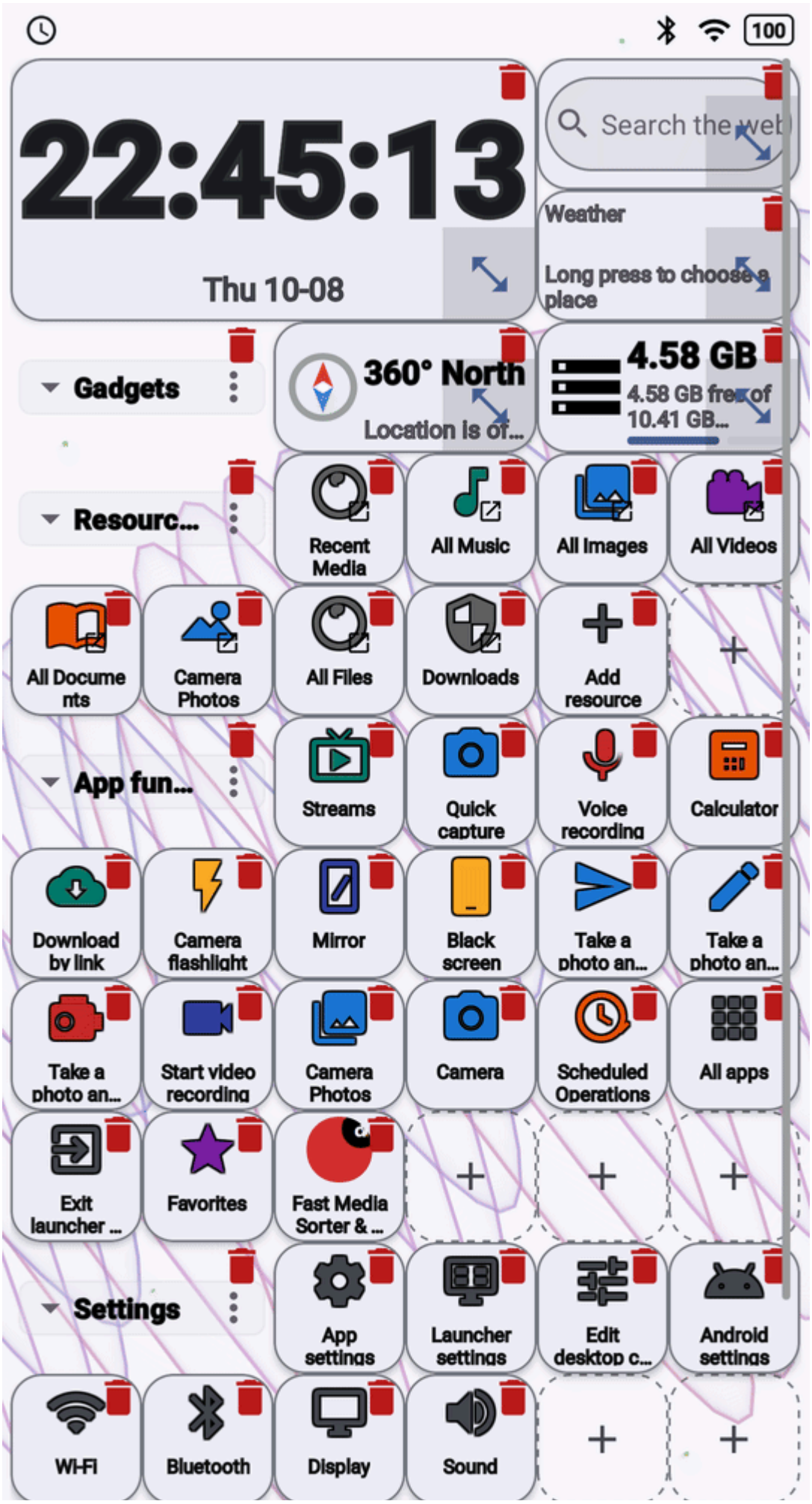
- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition, with the launcher open – see Your launcher desktop.
- A few squares on the desktop to move around.

1 Start arranging

Touch and hold an empty square and tap **Edit the desktop**. The same is in the Start menu on the taskbar as **Edit desktop contents**.

Every square now shows a card with clear edges, and the taskbar shows **Done** and a **+** button. While arranging:

- Touch and hold a square, then drag it to another place.
- Drag the corner handle of a gadget to make it bigger or smaller.
- Tap the remove mark on a square to take it off the desktop.
- Tap **+** to add something. It goes into the first free place, or into a new row below everything when the desktop is full.
- Tap **Done** when you are finished.
  The upright and the sideways screen keep separate layouts, so you can arrange each one the way it suits best.


100
22:45:13
Thu 10-08
Search the web
Weather
Long press to choose a place
Gadgets
360° North
Location is of...
4.58 GB
4.58 GB free of 10.41 GB...
Resourc...
Recent Media
All Music
All Images
All Videos
All Documents
Camera Photos
All Files
Downloads
Add resource
App fun...
Streams
Quick capture
Voice recording
Calculator
Download by link
Camera flashlight
Mirror
Black screen
Take a photo an...
Take a photo an...
Take a photo an...
Start video recording
Camera Photos
Camera
Scheduled Operations
All apps
Exit launcher ...
Favorites
Fast Media Sorter & ...
Settings
App settings
Launcher settings
Edit desktop c...
Android settings
WI-FI
Bluetooth
Display
Sound

Arranging the desktop: cards, remove marks, Done and +.

2 Move things further than the screen shows

When the desktop is longer than the screen, a scroll bar appears along its right edge. Swipe to scroll, or grab the bar and drag it to jump quickly.

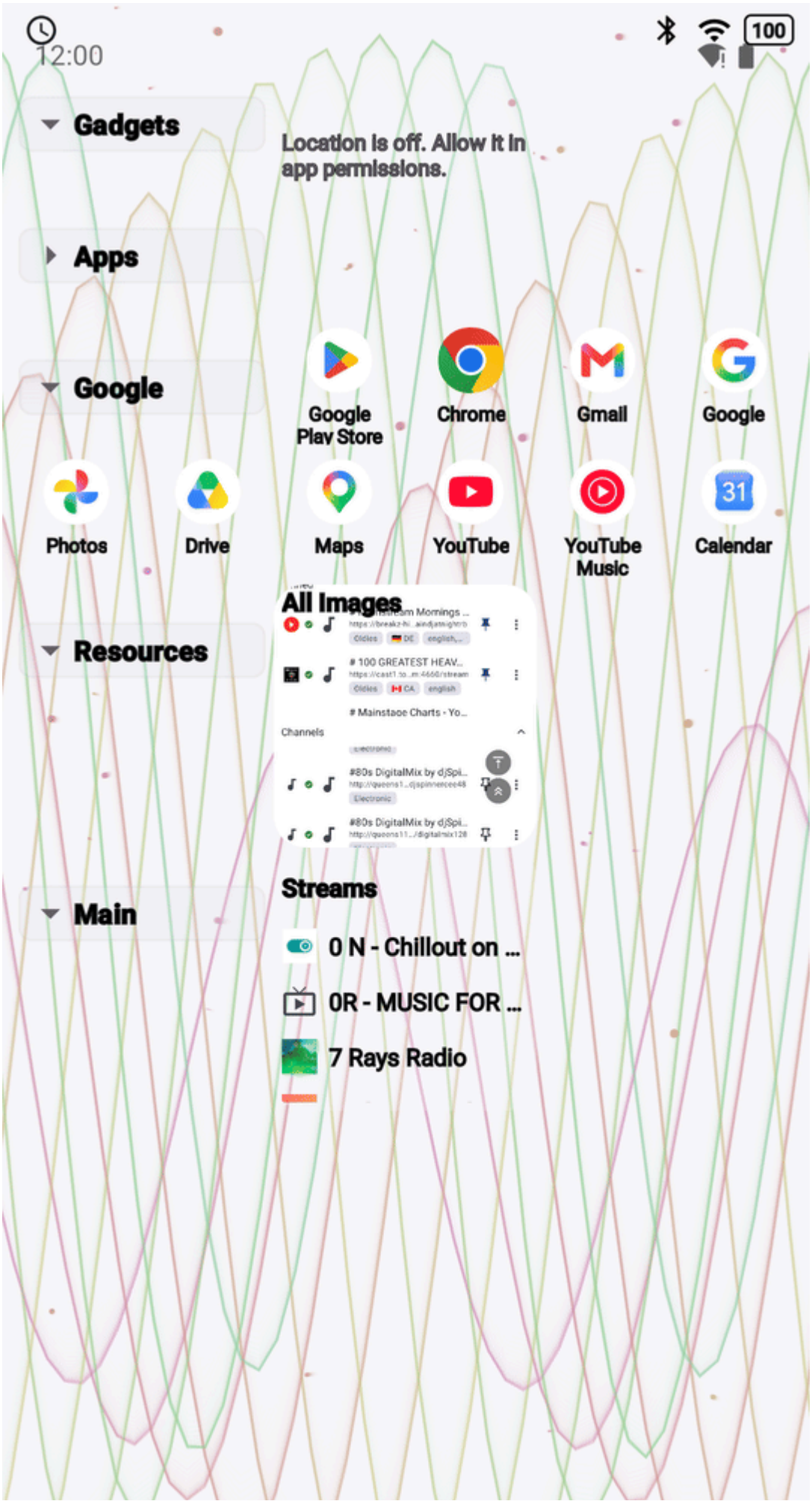
While you drag a square, hold it near the top or bottom edge and the desktop scrolls - the closer to the edge, the faster - so you can drop it in a row that was out of sight. Wide gadgets placed against the right edge are fitted inside the grid, so they never cover their neighbours.

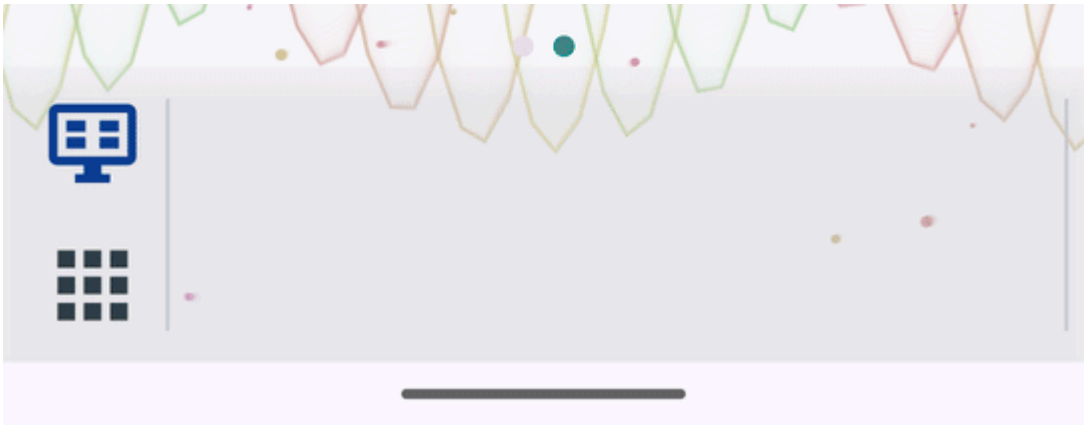
3 Group squares into sections and fold them

A section is a heading with the rows under it, such as **Main**, **Apps** or **App functions**. Tap a heading to fold its rows away; tap it again and every square comes back to exactly where it was. A small arrow beside the name shows whether the section is folded, so a folded section is never mistaken for an empty one. Folding is remembered separately for the upright and the sideways screen and survives a restart.

Touch and hold a heading to open **Section Actions**: **Rename Section**, **Re-sort Section** or **Delete Section**. Deleting asks first, and removes the heading together with the shortcuts under it - you can add them again later. While arranging, the same menu opens from the button on the heading, and holding the heading drags the whole section.

To start a new section, choose **Create a section..** when adding an item and give it a name, for example "Work".


12:00
100
Gadgets
Location is off. Allow it in app permissions.
Apps
Google
Google Play Store
Chrome
Gmail
Google
Photos
Drive
Maps
YouTube
YouTube Music
Calendar
Resources
All Images
Channels
Main
Streams
0 N - Chillout on ...
0R - MUSIC FOR ...
7 Rays Radio



A folded section - the arrow shows it is folded.

4 Spread the desktop over several screens

Touch and hold an empty square, tap **Wallpaper**, and under **Screens** set **Number of screens**. Swipe left and right to move between them. Turn on **Show screen number** to see which screen you are on while you page.

To move a square to another screen while arranging, tap it and choose **Move to screen 2** (or whichever screen you want). Or drag it to the left or right edge and hold it there a moment: the desktop turns to the previous or next screen and you drop the square where you like.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Move to screen**
Edit mode on a desktop with three screens, one shortcut tapped, the move menu open.

5 Choose what each swipe does

Open the launcher settings – **Launcher settings** in the long-press menu – and find the **Gestures** group. Tap **Swipe up**, **Swipe down**, **Swipe left** or **Swipe right** and pick an action from the list: the same actions the edge gestures offer, plus the launcher's own **All apps**, **Next screen** and **Previous screen**. For **Open app** or **Open URL**, the row **App to launch** below it asks which app or web address.

At the start, swiping up opens All apps – once you have reached the bottom of the desktop – and swiping down opens the Android notification shade. Left and right have no action, so on a desktop with several screens they turn the pages.

When swiping down opens the shade, where the swipe starts decides what you get: from the left half of the screen the notifications, from the right half Quick Settings.

A swipe works when it starts on an empty spot, on a shortcut, on a section heading or on the taskbar. On a gadget, the gadget keeps its own gestures – a map still pans and a list still scrolls. More gestures are in Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Desktop swipes**
System launcher settings scrolled to Gestures, Swipe up set to All apps, Swipe down to the notification shade.

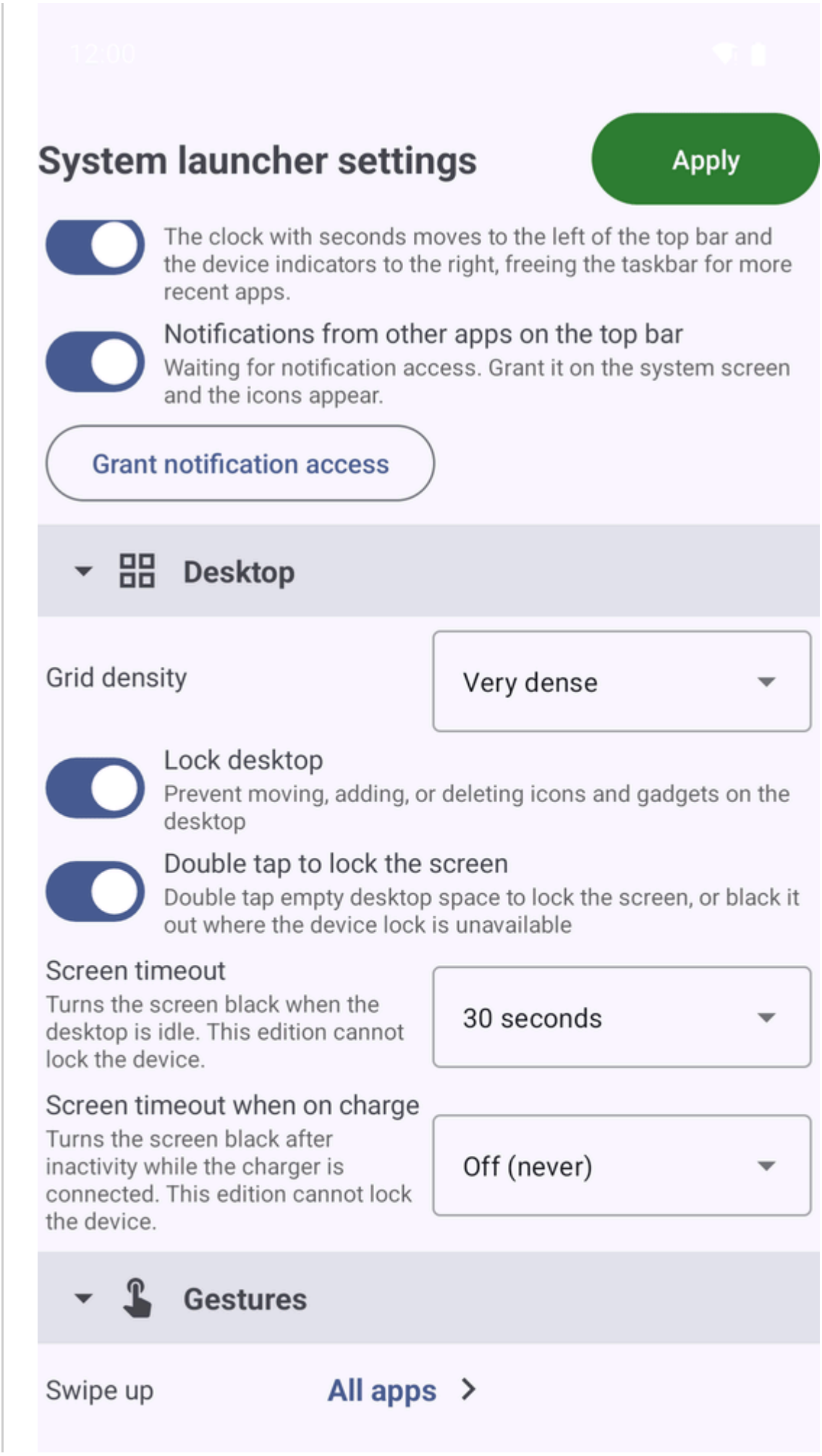
6 Make the squares bigger or smaller

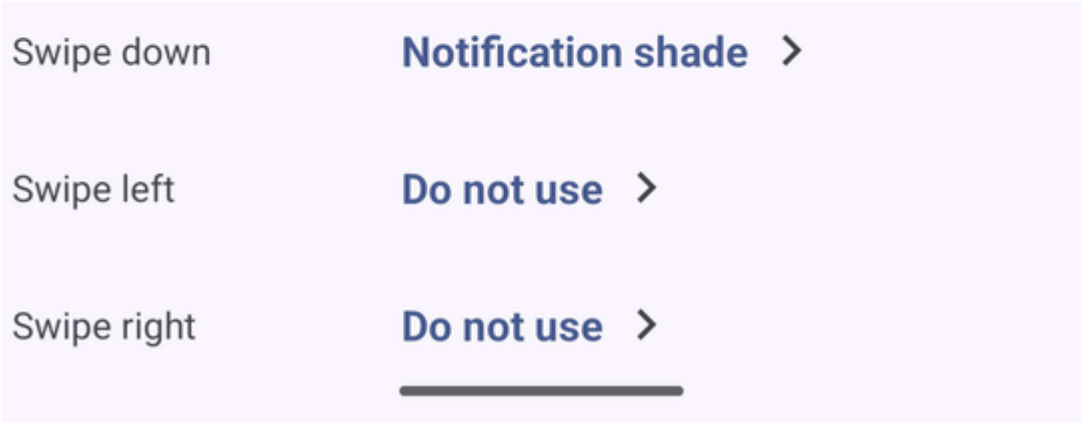
In the launcher settings, **Desktop** group, **Grid density** sets how many squares fit in a row: **Sparse**, **Standard**, **Dense** or **Very dense**. Sparse gives big squares, easy to hit on a car screen; very dense fits the most on a tablet.

7 Lock the layout

When the desktop is the way you like it, touch and hold an empty square and tap **Lock changes**. From now on a long press does not open the menu or start moving things. If someone tries, a short message says **The desktop is locked. Unlock it in launcher settings.**

To unlock, open the launcher settings, **Desktop** group, and turn off **Lock desktop**. The same switch locks it too. **Edit desktop contents** in the Start menu keeps working even while the desktop is locked, so you are never shut out of your own layout.


12:00
System launcher settings
Apply
The clock with seconds moves to the left of the top bar and the device indicators to the right, freeing the taskbar for more recent apps.
Notifications from other apps on the top bar
Waiting for notification access. Grant it on the system screen and the icons appear.
Grant notification access
Desktop
Grid density
Very dense
Lock desktop
Prevent moving, adding, or deleting icons and gadgets on the desktop
Double tap to lock the screen
Double tap empty desktop space to lock the screen, or black it out where the device lock is unavailable
Screen timeout
Turns the screen black when the desktop is idle. This edition cannot lock the device.
30 seconds
Screen timeout when on charge
Turns the screen black after inactivity while the charger is connected. This edition cannot lock the device.
Off (never)
Gestures
Swipe up
All apps



Lock desktop in the Desktop group.

What You Get

Every square sits where you want it, in sections you can fold, spread over as many screens as you need. Your swipes do what you chose, and a lock keeps the whole layout safe from accidental changes.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Double tap on an empty spot** locks the device screen, or blacks it out where the device lock is not available. Turn this off with **Double tap to lock the screen** in the **Desktop** group of the launcher settings.
- **Rotated the device and everything moved?** Nothing moved - the sideways screen simply has its own layout. Arrange the one you use, or both.
- **A section heading got removed while arranging?** Add it back with **Add an item..** like any other square.
- **Using a keyboard or a TV remote?** See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

LAUNCHER

Choosing a desktop wallpaper

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

Animated waves, a still frame, your own photo or a live camera picture.

LAUNCHER

Desktop context menus and fast actions

What a long press offers on apps, channels and gadgets.

er: Gadgets and Widgets

LAUNCHER: GADGETS AND WIDGETS | All editions | RECIPE #03

All editions - the set of widgets differs, see step 2

FastMediaSorter Widgets for Your Home Screen - Camera, Photo Frame, Music, Recorder and More

FastMediaSorter offers a set of widgets for the Android home screen: one-tap buttons for the camera, the recorder, random music and your folders, and larger windows for a photo frame, the player and your scheduled jobs. This page shows what each one does, in which editions it is available, and how to add and set it up.

Why You'll Love This

Some things you do many times a day: snap a receipt into the right folder, play something random while cooking, see a new family photo, pick up the book where you stopped. A widget puts that one action on your home screen, one tap away, without opening the app first.

The widgets work with any home screen - the one that came with your phone, or the FastMediaSorter launcher.

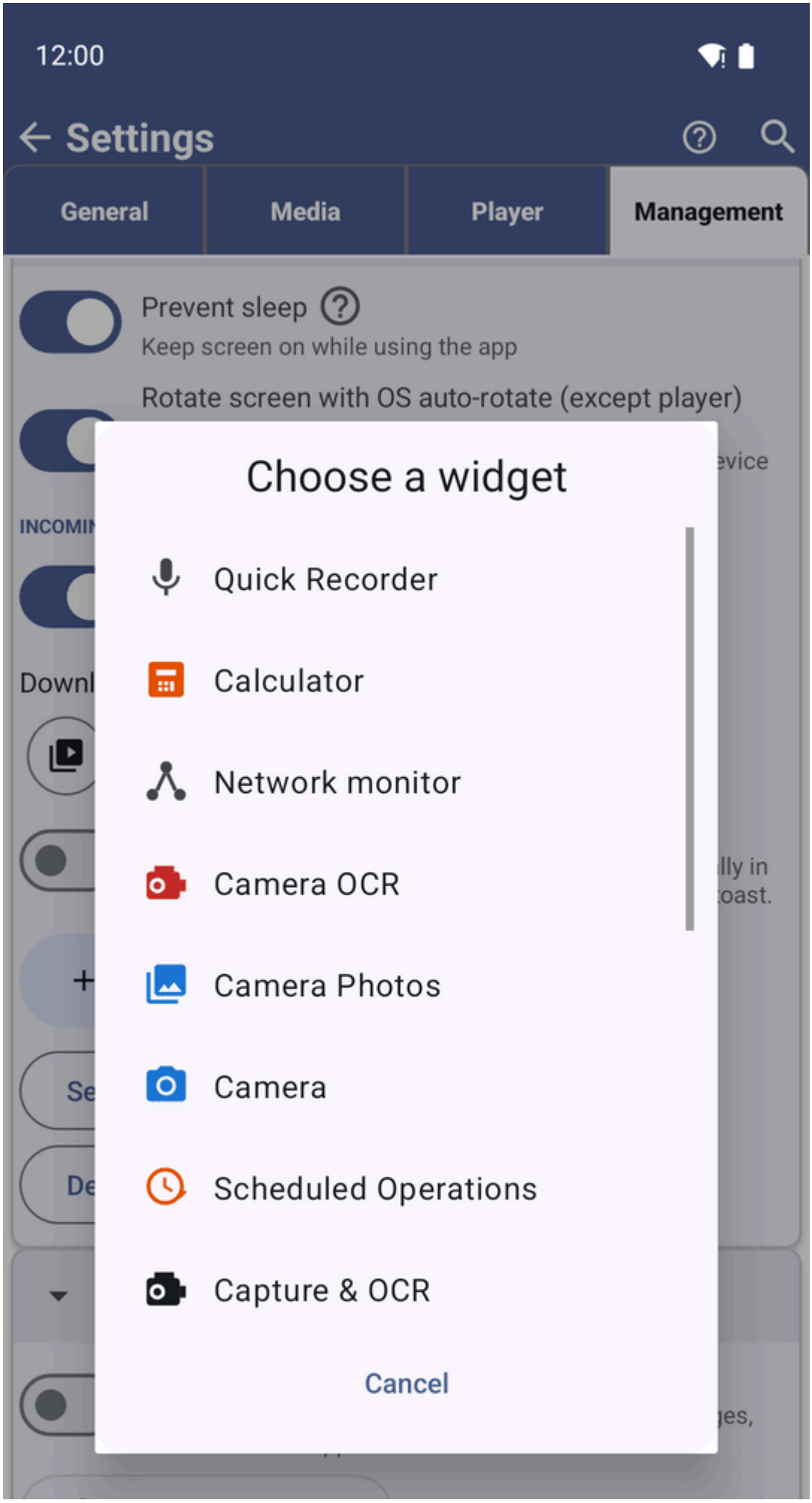
Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

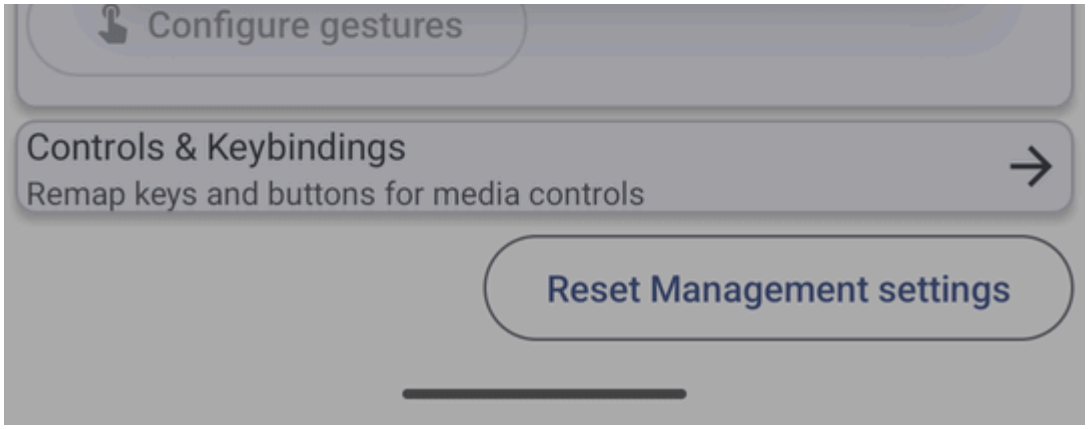
- FastMediaSorter in any edition. Which widgets each edition has is listed in step 2 - see also The seven editions of FastMediaSorter.
- A home screen with a free spot.
- For the photo frame, the music and the folder widgets: at least one resource added in the app - see Adding folders from your phone, memory card and USB drive.

1 Add a widget to the home screen

There are two ways:

- **From the app.** Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and tap **Add widget to the Android home screen...**. Pick a widget in **Choose a widget**, and confirm when Android asks where to put it.
- **From the home screen.** Touch and hold an empty spot on your home screen, tap **Widgets**, scroll to **FastMediaSorter** and drag the widget you want to its place. The exact words differ a little between phone makers - see Add apps, shortcuts and widgets to your home screens ↗.
  If the widget is already there, the app tells you: **Widget already added to home screen**.


12:00
Settings
General
Media
Player
Management
Prevent sleep
Keep screen on while using the app
Rotate screen with OS auto-rotate (except player)
Choose a widget
Quick Recorder
Calculator
Network monitor
Camera OCR
Camera Photos
Camera
Scheduled Operations
Capture & OCR
Cancel



Choose a widget.

2 Pick the widget for the job

One-tap widgets - a small square with an icon and its name written under it, like an app shortcut, so you always know which is which:

- **Camera** - opens the app's camera to take a photo or record a video; the pictures go to the usual photo folders of the device. All editions.
- **Quick capture** - takes a photo or records a video straight into a folder or resource you choose when you add it. It is hidden while capturing is switched off in the app. All editions.
- **Camera Photos** - opens your camera photos in the app. All editions.
- **Camera OCR** - points the camera at text, reads it and translates it - see Extracting text with offline OCR. Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR editions.
- **Quick Recorder** - one tap starts a voice recording, a second tap stops and saves it. Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR editions.
- **Random Music** - plays a random track from the resource you chose. Every edition except Photos.
- **Resource Launch** - opens one resource folder you chose. You can also add it from the resource itself: open the resource's three-dots menu on the main screen, or the resource editor. All editions.
- **Calculator** - opens the app's calculator. All editions.

Larger widgets - you can stretch these on the home screen:

- **Random Photo Frame** - shows a random photo from the resource you chose and changes it from time to time; stretch it in every direction. All editions.
- **Continue Reading** - picks up the slideshow where you last left it. All editions.
- **Audio Now Playing** - the track playing in the background, with play and pause, previous, next and a button to add it to favorites. Every edition except Lite and Photos.
- **Capture & OCR** - one panel with both **Camera Photos** and **Camera OCR**. Standard, noLegal, Legacy and VR editions.
- **Favorites** - a scrolling list of your favorite folders. Shown while favorites are switched on in the app. All editions.
- **Scheduled Operations** - the state of your scheduled operations with **Run All**, **Pause All** and **Resume All**. Shown while scheduling is switched on - see Running file jobs on a schedule. All editions.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Home screen widgets**
Stock Android home screen with six FastMediaSorter widgets, portrait.

3 Set up a widget that needs a choice

Random Photo Frame, **Random Music**, **Resource Launch** and **Quick capture** need to know where to look or where to save. A setup screen opens as soon as you place one: pick the resource or folder and confirm. Until it is set up, the widget says **Tap to configure**.

Each copy of a widget keeps its own choice - put two photo frames next to each other and let one show the holidays and the other the garden.

4 Use it

Tap a one-tap widget to do its job. On **Quick Recorder**, tap once to start and once more to stop and save. On **Audio Now Playing**, use the buttons as on a small player - see Playing and organizing music. On **Scheduled Operations**, the buttons act on all jobs at once.

What You Get

The actions you use most sit on your home screen - a photo into the right folder, a random song, a new family picture, the book where you stopped - each one tap away.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Using the FastMediaSorter launcher?** The same widgets can sit on its desktop too - see Placing, resizing and styling gadgets and widgets. There they keep settings of their own, separate from the copy on another home screen.
- **Looking for a widget that is not here?** The stream, stopwatch, flashlight, tourist, game and broadcast widgets are described with the features they belong to - for example Shortcuts, the stream widget and the streams panel, Built-in programs, The calculator and the stopwatch and The mini-game.
- **A widget vanished from the list?** Favorites, Scheduled Operations and Quick capture are offered only while their feature is switched on in the app.
- **The Voice recorder widget is gone.** Earlier versions had a separate voice recorder widget; **Quick Recorder** does the same job with one tap to start and one to stop.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Desktop gadgets

Clocks, weather, map, sensors and device status on the launcher desktop.

CAPTURE

Taking quick photos and video snaps

Everything the camera behind the Camera and Quick capture widgets can do.

PHOTOS

Creating photo slideshows

The slideshow that Continue Reading picks up again.

LAUNCHER: GADGETS AND WIDGETS | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #01

Desktop Gadgets - Clocks, Weather, Map, Sensors, Device Status and More

The launcher desktop can hold live gadgets: clocks for here and elsewhere, weather for several cities, sunrise and dew point, a map of where you are, a compass and speed charts, the battery, network, storage and memory of the device, and an offline translator. This page shows what each one does and how to set it up.

Why You'll Love This

A gadget is a live square on the desktop: it shows something fresh the moment you look at it, without opening an app. A kitchen tablet can show the time in large digits and the weather in two cities; a phone in a car holder can show the speed and the direction; a spare phone on a shelf can watch its own battery and free space.

Each gadget is added with one long press and knows what to do when you tap it - the clock opens your alarms, the map opens your map app, the weather opens your weather app.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition, with the launcher desktop switched on - see Your launcher desktop. The Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR and FOSS editions have no launcher - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter.
- An empty square on the desktop, or a moment to make one - see Placing, resizing and styling gadgets.
- For the map, the compass and the speed gadgets: permission for the app to know the location. For weather, world clock and sunrise: nothing extra, you type the place yourself.

1 Open the list of gadgets

Touch and hold an empty square on the desktop, tap **Add an item..** and choose **Gadget**. A list of every gadget your device can show appears.

A gadget whose sensor your device does not have is not offered at all - a tablet without a compass simply has no **Compass** in the list.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gadget list**
Add-item picker switched to Gadget, scrolled halfway, portrait.

2 Keep the time in view - Clock and World clock

Clock shows the local time in large digits with seconds. It starts four squares wide and two high, and you can shrink it down to two squares by one. **Tap** it to open your alarms; **touch and hold** it to open your calendar.

World clock shows the time in another place next to your local clock, not instead of it. When you add it, a searchable list of every time zone your device knows opens - type a city and pick it. The square is captioned with the city and how many hours it is ahead of or behind you. Tap it to open your clock app; touch and hold it to pick a different time zone. Add several to follow several places.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Clock gadgets**
Desktop with a 4×2 Clock and a World clock set to Tokyo, portrait.

3 Watch the weather and the sun - Weather and Sun and dew point

Weather shows the current weather for a place you choose. A new square says **Long press to choose a place**: touch and hold it and type the city. No location permission is needed, and the data comes from Open-Meteo. Metric or US units follow **Unit system** in **Settings**, **General**.

Add as many Weather squares as you like - each keeps its own city, even after a restart. Under the reading the square shows when it was last brought up to date (**Updated** and the time). Without a connection it keeps the last reading marked **Last known**, and if nothing arrives it says **Weather is unavailable right now**. Tap it to open your weather app; touch and hold it to change the place.

Sun and dew point shows today's **Sunrise** and **Sunset** and the **Dew point** for a place you pick from the same searchable list. The dew point uses the same temperature unit as Weather. **Tap** it to refresh the reading, and **touch and hold** it to change the place. Several squares can show several places.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Weather gadgets**
Desktop with two Weather gadgets and one Sun and dew point gadget, portrait.

4 See where you are - Map

Map draws your current position on an OpenStreetMap map and writes the town and country under it, or the coordinates when there is no name. Tap it to open the map app of your device.

The first time, Android asks whether the app may know the location - allow it. Without the permission the square says **Location permission is off**; without a connection it keeps the last picture it had, marked **Last known**. The map pieces are kept on the device, so a familiar area appears quickly. To find the place name, the app asks only about the centre of the map piece it already shows, never about your exact position.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Map gadget**
Desktop with a Map gadget, location allowed, portrait.

5 Measure the way – Compass, Speed and the charts

These gadgets use the sensors and the location of your device:

- **Compass** – the heading in degrees with the direction written out (for example **North**), and the height above sea level. If it asks you to **Wave the phone in a figure eight**, do it once to calibrate.
- **Speed** – how fast you are moving, in km/h.
- **Speed chart** and **Altitude chart** – how speed and height changed over time. Each chart collects readings since you last tapped its **Reset** button, and keeps them after a restart. The altitude chart also shows the distance travelled.
- **Altitude** and **Satellites** – the height alone, and how many satellites are used out of how many are visible.
- **Steps** – the steps counted by your device, from its own step counter. Only in the sideload version (the noLegal edition), because only that edition asks for the physical activity permission this square needs – see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter. While the device looks for a position, the square says **Waiting for a position…**. If you refused the permission, the square stays on the desktop and says **Location is off. Allow it in app permissions.** Location and steps are read only while the square is on screen, never in the background, and nothing is sent anywhere.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Sensor gadgets**
Desktop with Compass, Speed and Altitude chart gadgets during a walk, portrait.

6 Keep an eye on the device - Network, Battery, Storage and Resources

Four gadgets tell you how the device itself is doing:

- **Network** - the kind of connection, the Wi-Fi or mobile network name when Android shares it, and whether the internet is reachable: **connected** or **no internet**.
- **Battery** - the charge in percent and about how long it will last (**About 5 h left**), or **Charging**. The time is an estimate: Android does not report one of its own.
- **Storage** - free and total space on the device, and on the memory card when one is inserted.
- **Resources** - free memory and how long the device has been running since it was last switched on.

All four look the same, ask for no permission, and refresh only while they are on screen. A value the device does not give is shown as **Unknown**, never as zero. With TalkBack on, each square reads out both the number and what it means.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Device status gadgets**
Desktop with Network, Battery, Storage and Resources gadgets, Wi-Fi connected, portrait.

7 Translate a phrase on the spot - Translator

Translator is an offline translator right on the desktop. Its caption shows the language pair from the app's translation settings; tap the caption to change it, or swap the two languages for the moment. How languages are chosen and downloaded is in Translating extracted text.

The square is always at least two rows high, so the text field and the result both fit. The first time a language is used, its language pack is downloaded; when the first translation is ready the caption says **Translated by Google**.

8 Try the other gadgets

The list holds more squares that bring your own content to the desktop:

- **Search** - a web search field that opens the results in your browser.
- **Audio window**, **Video window**, **Document window** and **Image window** - play or show a file from one of your resources inside the square.
- **Stream window** - a live channel playing inside the square.
- **Playlist**, **Streams**, **Folder preview** and **Favorites** - your playlists, channels, a folder as a small show, and your favorites.
- **YouTube**, **YouTube Music**, **YouTube channel window**, **Google Maps Live Frame**, **Google Keep Live Frame** and **Google Calendar Live Frame** - the web pages of these services inside a square.

What You Get

Your desktop shows the clock, the weather, the way ahead and the state of the device at a glance, and each square opens the right app with one tap.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Numbers do not jump.** Changing values are drawn in digits of equal width and kept to the lower right corner, so a clock or a speed that changes every second stays still to the eye.
- **One gadget failed?** The rest of the desktop keeps working, and a short message names the square that could not start - see Placing, resizing and styling gadgets.
- **Want the card behind the gadgets lighter or heavier? Widget backdrop opacity** in the launcher settings changes it for every gadget at once.
- **Want the same kind of information on another home screen?** FastMediaSorter also offers widgets for the Android home screen - see FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Placing, resizing and styling gadgets and widgets

Put a gadget where you want it, make it bigger or smaller, and choose how solid its card is.

LAUNCHER

FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen

Calculator, camera, photo frame, music, recorder and more on any home screen.

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

LAUNCHER: GADGETS AND WIDGETS | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #02

Placing, Resizing and Styling Gadgets and Widgets on the Launcher Desktop

A gadget needs a good place and the right size. This page shows how to put gadgets and the app's widgets on the launcher desktop, let the desktop make room, resize them, choose how solid their card is, and start again with a fresh set.

Why You'll Love This

A gadget is only useful where your eye falls: the clock big and on top, the weather beside it, the battery small in a corner. This page is about the placing - where a gadget goes, how big it is, and how much of the wallpaper shows behind it.

The same steps work for the app's own widgets, which can live on the launcher desktop as well as on the Android home screen.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition, with the launcher desktop switched on - see Your launcher desktop.
- For the app's widgets on the desktop: FastMediaSorter set as the device home screen.

1 Put a gadget on the desktop

Touch and hold an empty square, tap **Add an item…**, choose **Gadget** and pick one. It lands where you pressed, at its starting size. What each gadget does is described in Desktop gadgets.

No empty square in sight? Tap **Edit the desktop** in the long-press menu, then the **+** button next to **Done** on the taskbar: the new item goes into the first free place, or into a new row below everything.

2 Let the desktop make room

A gadget often needs more than one square. When you add it to a spot that is too small, the squares below slide down to make room - nothing is covered and nothing is lost.

If there is truly no way to fit it, you are told so instead of nothing happening: **No room on the launcher desktop. Free a spot and try again.** Remove or move something, or add another screen - see Arranging the desktop.

3 Bring one of the app's widgets to the desktop

The app's widgets - calculator, camera, photo frame, music, recorder, favorites, scheduled operations and others - can sit on the launcher desktop too. Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and tap **Add a gadget to the launcher desktop**; the chosen one goes into the first free place and a short message says **Added to the launcher desktop**. The button is shown only while the launcher is on.

Some widgets need to be set up first. **Random Photo Frame** asks which resource to take photos from, and **Quick capture** asks which folder to save to. The square is placed only after you confirm; if you cancel, nothing is placed and nothing is left behind.

A widget on the desktop and the same widget on another home screen keep their own settings - two photo frames can show two different albums. Removing a square also forgets its settings. All widgets are described in FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Adding a widget to the desktop**
Settings, Management tab, scrolled to the two widget buttons, launcher on, portrait.

4 Make a gadget bigger or smaller

Tap **Edit the desktop** in the long-press menu. Every square now shows a card, and each gadget has a handle in its corner. Drag the handle to make the gadget bigger or smaller - from its starting size up to the whole screen. Tap **Done** when it looks right.

The size is remembered, also after a restart. A few gadgets keep a sensible minimum: **Clock** goes down to two squares by one, and **Translator** always stays at least two rows high so its text and result fit.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Resizing a gadget**
Desktop in edit mode, a Weather gadget mid-resize, portrait.

5 Choose how solid the gadget card is

Behind each gadget there is a light card. To make it lighter or heavier, open the launcher settings - from the long-press menu, from the Start menu, or through **Settings**, **General**, **System launcher settings** - and in the **Appearance** group tap **Widget backdrop opacity**. Pick from **0% (Transparent)**, which lets the wallpaper show through, to **100% (Opaque)**; **25% (Default)** is the starting value.

The choice stays after a restart. While you arrange the desktop every square shows the full card anyway, so its edges are easy to see.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Widget backdrop opacity**
Launcher settings, Appearance group, the opacity list open, portrait.

6 Start again with a fresh set of gadgets

In the **System** group of the launcher settings, **Reset launcher settings** returns the desktop to its first state after a confirmation. It asks how densely to lay the icons out (**Grid density**: **Sparse**, **Standard**, **Dense** or **Very dense**) and opens on the choice that suits your device profile.

The starter **Gadgets** section is filled for your kind of device too: a photo frame gets an **Image window**, an e-book reader a **Document window**, a VR headset a **Battery** square. The settings of widgets you had placed are cleared with the reset, so nothing is left behind.

What You Get

Every gadget and widget sits where you want it, at the size you chose, with as much or as little card behind it as you like - and it stays that way after a restart.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A gadget could not start?** The rest of the desktop stays usable, and a message names the square: for example **Map could not start. The rest of your desktop is available.** Remove that square and add it again, or leave it for now.
- **Want the layout to stay put?** Lock the desktop so a stray touch cannot move a gadget - see Arranging the desktop.
- **A gadget swallows your swipes?** Gadgets keep their own gestures: a map still pans and a list still scrolls. Start the swipe on an empty spot instead.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

LAUNCHER

Desktop gadgets

What each gadget shows - clocks, weather, map, sensors, device status and the translator.

FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen

Calculator, camera, photo frame, music, recorder and more on any home screen.

LAUNCHER

Arranging the desktop - sections, screens, swipes and the lock

Move, resize and fold, spread items over several screens and lock the layout.

er: Taskbar, Menus and Gestures

LAUNCHER: TASKBAR, MENUS AND GESTURES | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #04

Using the Desktop Dock and Taskbar

The taskbar is the one part of the launcher that never scrolls away. This page covers where it sits, pinning and managing the apps on it, the fastest ways back to your files, the quick-launch dock that opens from it, and a couple of switches that need no screen of their own.

Why You'll Love This

The desktop holds what you look at; the taskbar holds what you reach for. It is the one bar that stays on screen no matter which section, screen or gadget you are looking at, so the apps you use most, the way back to your files, and a couple of one-tap switches are never more than a glance away.

This page covers the taskbar itself - where it sits, what you can pin to it, and what a long press on one of its buttons offers - plus the quick-launch dock that opens from it.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher turned on - see Your launcher desktop.
- A few apps or programs worth keeping one tap away.

1 Choose which edge the taskbar sits on

Open the launcher settings - **Launcher settings** in the long-press menu - and in the **Taskbar** group tap **Taskbar position**. Pick **Top** or **Bottom**. The Start button, the pinned and recent apps, and the tray all move together as one bar, and the desktop takes whatever space is left.

Bottom is the default on every device profile except the car head unit, which starts at the top.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Taskbar position**
Launcher settings, Taskbar group, Taskbar position dialog open with Top and Bottom options.

2 Pin apps and manage what is already there

Touch and hold any app to pin it, or use **Pin to taskbar** from its menu. Touch and hold a pinned icon on the taskbar itself and a small menu offers **Launch** or **Unpin**.

The taskbar also keeps a strip of apps you opened recently, without you pinning anything. Touch and hold one of those and the menu offers **Open**, **Pin to taskbar** - so a recent app becomes a permanent one - or **Remove from taskbar**, which only drops it from the recent strip.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Recent app menu**
Launcher taskbar, a recent app icon long-pressed, context menu open with three actions.

3 Get to your files and back again

The **Start** button on the taskbar opens the Start menu - see The Start menu and the full app list for what is on it.

Tapping the FastMediaSorter app icon itself depends on one setting: **Settings**, **General**, **Primary startup window**, with **Device home screen**, **Desktop as primary window** or **Main screen** to choose from - the same choice the welcome wizard offers on first install, and it can be changed later at any time. Whenever the app is not set as your device's actual home screen, tapping its icon opens the main screen with your files and folders directly, instead of a second copy of the desktop.

And from anywhere the taskbar or desktop sent you, the system Back button brings you straight back to the desktop rather than leaving you stranded in whatever screen you reached.

4 Open the quick-launch dock

Wherever a gesture or a button opens the quick-access panel, it appears as the **Quick launch** dialog: a grid of your chosen apps and shortcuts, with an explicit close button (an X) beside the title, so a tap closes it as easily as Back or tapping outside.

Each built-in program on the grid - Calculator, Streams, Favorites and the rest - keeps its own accent color on its icon in the grid, in its edit picker and in the programs menu, so you can spot the one you want by color as well as by shape, in either theme. Monochrome icons such as Calculator or Settings stay legible on the light theme too, tinted to read against a bright background, while colored app icons keep their own colors.

The function picker for **Edit panel** also offers the same camera and video actions as the screen-edge gestures: **Take a photo and send to…**, **Take a photo and edit**, **Take a photo and OCR-translate**, and **Start video recording** - see Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts for the gestures themselves.

The dock itself also exists in the Lite, Photos and Legacy editions, even though the rest of this page is Standard and noLegal only.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Quick launch dock**
Quick launch dialog open, close X visible before the title, grid of app and program tiles with accent-colored icons.

5 Flip a switch without opening a screen

A **Wi-Fi** or **Bluetooth** tile on the desktop or in the quick-launch dock switches that radio directly - the system screen only opens if Android itself refuses the switch. The tile's icon always shows the current state, even when it was changed outside the app.

Camera flashlight works the same way from the programs menu, the quick-launch dock or a desktop shortcut: it turns the physical flash on or off without opening a camera screen. A device with no flash does not offer it, and if the torch is briefly unavailable the app says so and asks you to try again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: One-tap tiles**
Launcher desktop with Wi-Fi tile on, Bluetooth tile off and Camera flashlight tile, all shown together.

What You Get

The taskbar sits on the edge you picked, with the apps you use most pinned to it and your recent ones a long press away. The Start button, the app icon and Back all take you exactly where you expect, the quick-launch dock opens with one tap and closes with another, and a couple of switches never need their own screen.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Can't find Unpin?** It only shows on an icon that is already pinned - a recent app's menu offers Pin to taskbar instead.
- **Program colors look the same in both themes?** They are deliberately different per theme so they stay readable - only the neutral placeholders and third-party app icons stay plain.
- **Looking for the long-press menu on a desktop shortcut instead of the taskbar?** That is covered in Desktop context menus and fast actions.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

The Start menu and the full app list

Open every installed app, search it, sort it and swipe through it.

LAUNCHER

The status area and notifications

What the taskbar's clock, signal and battery icons show, and how other apps' notifications appear.

LAUNCHER

Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts

The screen-edge gestures behind the camera actions in the quick-launch dock.

LAUNCHER: TASKBAR, MENUS AND GESTURES | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #07

Customizing Navigation Gestures and Shortcuts

An edge gesture works from inside any app, and the launcher desktop adds its own swipes and taps on top. This page covers setting up both, plus the small gestures on the Clock gadget and the double tap that locks the screen.

Why You'll Love This

A swipe from the edge of the screen can take a screenshot, open the camera or launch your favorite app - from inside any app, not only from the desktop. Add the desktop's own swipes and taps on top of that, and most things you reach for often are one gesture away, with nothing extra to unlock or tap through first.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition, with **Gesture overlay** turned on in **Settings**, the **Destinations** tab. Turning it on asks for the **Display over other apps** permission, since edge gestures work over any app.
- The launcher desktop open for its own swipes and taps - see Your launcher desktop.

1 Open the gesture map

Go to **Settings**, the **Destinations** tab, and tap **Configure gestures**. A full-screen map shows the four gesture zones - gray where a zone is free, red where it already carries an action - and tapping a zone opens it straight away. Four tabs - **Left top**, **Left bottom**, **Right top** and **Right bottom** - each hold an **Up gesture action**, a **Down gesture action** and a **Right gesture action**, with the target row underneath. A fifth area, **General gesture settings**, holds what every zone shares - where screenshots are saved, whether they also copy to the clipboard, and the quick-access panel editor. Turn the device sideways and the map switches to two columns so both edges stay in view.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Edge gesture map**
Configure gestures dialog, zone map with tabs for the four edge bands, portrait.

2 Pick from the full list of actions

Each direction opens the same wide catalog, grouped by kind - **Screen capture**, **Camera**, **Launch**, **Device control**, **System** and **Utilities** - with a short line under every choice explaining what it does, from a silent screenshot to setting an alarm, muting the volume or opening the camera in video mode. A slot can also be switched off, listed under its own **Disabled** group.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture action picker**
Gesture action picker opened for one zone direction, groups expanded, explanation text visible under each row.

3 Point a gesture at an app or a web address

Choose **Launch a chosen app** and pick from the installed apps - each of the twelve gesture slots keeps its own choice. The row under the action names the app and clears it in one tap; with nothing chosen, or once the chosen app is gone, the gesture opens FastMediaSorter instead. Choosing **Open a web address** works the same way: a **Web address** row appears under the action, always ready to re-read, correct or clear, so a mistyped address is one tap away from fixed rather than a re-entry from scratch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Gesture target row**
One gesture direction set to Launch a chosen app, target row showing the chosen app and a clear affordance.

4 Where the gesture bands sit

The two bands per edge sit wherever the phone's own system bars leave the screen free - on the left and right in the usual layout, or across the top and bottom on a device whose bars run down both sides. Turning the phone does not move them by itself: the bands, the swipe directions and the map on screen all turn together, so **Up** still means up from where you are holding the phone.

5 Change your mind mid-swipe (sideload only)

In the noLegal edition, an edge gesture opens as a hint menu instead of firing the moment you touch the edge: the action runs only when you lift your finger, and dragging back to the spot you started from - the cancel target - runs nothing at all. This is only in the sideload (noLegal) version of the app.

6 Reach All apps or turn the page with a gesture

Assign **All apps** to a gesture slot the same way as any other action, and it brings the running desktop forward with the list already open, instead of starting a second copy. The desktop's own four swipes - set up in the **Gestures** group of the launcher settings - can do the same, plus **Next screen** and **Previous screen** for paging between desktop screens, and in edit mode you can tap a shortcut and send it straight to another screen. Both are covered in full in Arranging the desktop.

7 Swipe the clock to change how it looks

The **Clock** gadget answers its own swipes: hide or bring back the seconds, or swipe for a random dial color and time typeface, or swipe back to the theme color. The date keeps its own typeface while sharing whichever dial color you land on, and the choice survives a launcher restart.

8 Double-tap to lock the screen

A double tap on empty desktop space locks the device screen, or blacks the screen out with its own overlay where a real device lock is out of reach - any tap or key brings the desktop straight back. Turn it off with **Double tap to lock the screen** in the **Desktop** group of the launcher settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Double-tap lock**
Launcher desktop black overlay after a double tap, portrait, any tap brings the desktop back.

What You Get

Every edge gesture does exactly what you chose - a screenshot, an app, a system action - reachable from inside any app, and the desktop's own swipes, the clock and a double tap cover the rest without a single extra icon.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Nothing happens when you swipe from the edge?** Check **Gesture overlay** is on in **Settings**, the **Destinations** tab, and that the app still has the **Display over other apps** permission - Android sometimes revokes it after an update.
- **Wanted the screenshot side of gestures?** See Edge gestures and the quick-access panel.
- **Using a keyboard or a TV remote?** See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

LAUNCHER

Desktop context menus and fast actions

Arranging the desktop - sections, screens, swipes and the lock

Move, resize and fold sections, spread items over several screens and lock the layout.

What a long press offers on apps, resources, channels and contacts.

LAUNCHER

Using the desktop dock and taskbar

The Start button, recent and pinned apps and the status tray.

Desktop Context Menus and Fast Actions - What a Long Press Opens

A long press on the launcher desktop is rarely just one thing. This page walks through what each long press opens - on a resource, a channel, an app function - and through the squares that build or update themselves on their own: new resources, app shortcuts, contacts, a shared place, live channel windows and a few small helpers.

Why You'll Love This

A long press on the FastMediaSorter desktop rarely does just one thing. Depending on what you're holding, it can open a rich menu, start creating something new, or turn a shared contact, place or channel into a square that keeps itself current from then on.

This page is a tour of what each long press offers, and of the squares that build or update themselves on their own - so nothing on the desktop ever feels like a mystery.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or the noLegal edition, with the launcher desktop open - see Your launcher desktop.
- A few empty squares to try the menus and the new squares on.
- Optional: a contact, a channel, or a place shared from a map app, if you want to try those specific squares.

1 Long-press menus on cells

Touch and hold any square on the desktop and a menu opens that matches what you're holding.

A resource or channel square opens the same menu the main app offers for that item: for a resource, open it, play it, add another shortcut, edit it, copy it, export it, share access to it, rescan it or delete it; for a channel, pin it, add a shortcut, share its link, or remove it. Both menus come from one shared list the app keeps for each kind of item, so the desktop and the main window never drift apart, and the same confirmation guards a destructive action either way.

An App functions square - Streams, Quick Camera, Network Monitor and the rest - opens a shorter menu: **Open**, **Settings** where the feature has one, **Pin to taskbar**, and **Remove from desktop**.

Some squares reach further than opening themselves. A square pinned to a quick-access panel route opens that panel directly, and a square pinned to a scheduled operation asks you to confirm, then runs the job in the background - a backup you can start with one long press instead of digging through settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Cell action menu**
Launcher desktop, long press on a resource square, the full action menu open, portrait.

2 Resources straight from home

Starting a brand-new resource - a folder, a cloud account, a network share - no longer means leaving the desktop first.

Touch and hold an empty square and tap **Add resource**, or, while adding **My resource** from the ordinary add-item picker, tap **Add resource..** at the bottom of the list. Either opens the app's usual resource-creation screen; finish it and the new resource's shortcut lands on the desktop by itself. Cancelling leaves nothing behind, and on a home screen that won't accept a pinned shortcut the resource is still created - the app just says so.

Every resource you create this way, or from the main window, lands in the desktop's **Resources** section automatically, and that section keeps its own **Add resource** square at the end, so you're never short of an empty one to start the next.

A resource's square shows its real face on the desktop and the taskbar: the icon you picked for it, or its virtual-folder or cloud-provider glyph, layered with a small badge for how it connects - cloud, network or local - instead of one generic icon per resource type. Turn on a media type later, say All Images, and its own aggregate square appears in Resources by itself, without touching anything else you've arranged.

The App functions squares keep themselves current too: switching a feature on adds its square there at once, in both the upright and sideways layout, and switching it off removes that square again - one you removed by hand stays gone either way. Installing a real app adds one automatic square of its own to the desktop; uninstalling it removes only that automatic square, never one you placed yourself.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Resources section**
Launcher desktop, Resources section, two resource squares with composed logos and the Add resource square, portrait.

3 Squares for people

Share a contact with the launcher and it becomes a square that keeps working for that person, without asking for your address book up front.

Pin a contact from the add-item picker and choose what the square does: open their **Contact card**, **Call** them, **Send SMS**, or open **Message in an app** to jump straight into a messenger conversation. Call and SMS are hidden on a device with no telephony. The app reads the contact once, from the entry you pick in the system contact picker, and keeps a snapshot on the square - no contacts permission is needed just to pin one, and calling always goes through the number you actually chose. Until a photo is on file, or if you never grant the permission below, the square shows the person's initials over a color that stays theirs.

Pinning a messenger square first asks **Which app should open the chat?** so you pick the app before the person; an **Any app** row keeps the older order of person-then-app, and the question is skipped when only one messenger is installed. If the person turns out to have no chat in the app you picked, the square's error message says which app that was.

Want the square to stay current when someone changes their photo or gets renamed? Grant the contacts permission when the app asks, right as you pin the square. Refuse and the square keeps working from the snapshot taken at pin time, which also stands in if the contact is later deleted or can't be read.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Contact square**
Launcher desktop, a pinned contact square with a live photo next to one showing initials on a color block, portrait.

4 A place from the map

Share a location from any map app while the launcher is turned on, and **Add place to launcher** appears in the share sheet next to your other sharing choices. Tap it, and a square lands on the desktop that opens turn-by-turn navigation to that spot, ready to start driving the moment you tap it.

A shared short link is resolved to real coordinates while the square is created, so opening it later needs no network. When a link can't be resolved, the square is still created and simply shows the place as shared.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Add place to launcher**
Share sheet opened from a maps app, the Add place to launcher target visible, portrait.

5 Live windows onto radio, video and maps

A channel can sit on the desktop as more than a shortcut. Choose **Stream** in the add-item picker, or long-press a channel square and choose **Add window to desktop**, and you get a **Stream window**: a radio channel shows its name, icon and a play/pause button; a video channel gets a larger square, at least 3×2, with the picture itself paused on the last frame until you press play - nothing starts on its own.

Tap a playing video window and corner controls fade in for a moment: play/pause, mute, stop, fullscreen and picture-in-picture. Fullscreen and picture-in-picture both hand off to the full player, which can collapse back into a small floating window on request.

Adding a channel square before you've saved any channels opens **Settings**, Streams instead of an empty list, so there's always somewhere to go. Picking a channel for any of these squares stays quick even with a very long list: only the icons on screen get loaded, a big catalog asks for a search word or a topic first, and an empty result says so instead of leaving a spinner on screen. The same fast picker also serves the channel choosers of the Legacy and VR editions, which use it outside the launcher desktop.

YouTube channel window works the same idea for a channel you follow there: name it or paste its address, and its square - at least 3×2 - shows the channel name and the cover of its latest upload, silent until you tap it, then plays that video right inside the square through YouTube's own player. Where the device can't host that player, the square opens the channel in the YouTube app instead.

Google Maps Live Frame puts an interactive map, not a screenshot, on the desktop: pan and zoom it like the map app itself, right from the square.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stream window controls**
Launcher desktop, a 3×2 video Stream window square, overlay controls visible after a tap, portrait.

6 Helpers: translation, playback and weather

A few squares do small jobs well, right where you are.

The **Translator** square translates typed or pasted text fully offline, through the bundled engine; its caption shows the language pair and doubles as a button to change it. It says plainly when a language pack is still missing rather than failing quietly.

The Now Playing gadget starts out showing this app's own playback, the same as ever. Turn on notification access from a button on the gadget itself - behind a plain-language explanation of what that grants - and it follows and controls whatever is playing in any app instead, falling back to FastMediaSorter's own playback whenever nothing else is. It draws the cover art the playing app publishes, falls back to that app's icon when there is none, and a tap on the card opens whichever app is currently playing.

The weather square's **Unit system** - metric or US measurements - lives in **Settings**, **General**, and without you touching it the square already shows Fahrenheit on a device set to the United States, Liberia or Myanmar, and Celsius everywhere else, read from the device's region rather than its language. The city you picked for it is remembered on its own, so resetting the launcher to defaults brings the weather back already showing your city instead of asking again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Now Playing artwork**
Launcher desktop, Now Playing gadget showing an external app's cover art and controls, portrait.

What You Get

Every square on your desktop opens the right menu for what it holds, new resources and app squares add themselves as you create or install things, and people, places, channels and a handful of small helpers all turn into squares that stay live and current - without you hunting through settings first.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Interrupted while picking something for a new square?** If Android needs to close the app in the background while you're still in a picker - choosing a contact, an app or a resource - the square you started keeps its place. Finish the picker when you come back and it drops in exactly where you began.
- **Using a keyboard or a TV remote?** See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control for how to reach these same menus without a long press.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

LAUNCHER

Desktop gadgets

The full gadget catalog, clocks to weather to device status.

LAUNCHER

Using the desktop dock and taskbar

The Start button, recent and pinned apps and the status tray.

LAUNCHER: TASKBAR, MENUS AND GESTURES | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #10

Launcher Settings - Finding Your Way Around and Starting Fresh

Fourteen-odd rows of launcher settings are easier to use folded into a few groups than laid out in one long list, and a single **Reset launcher settings** button undoes an experiment without touching anything outside the launcher. This page covers both, plus how a fresh desktop is seeded and how its sections and icons stay readable.

Why You'll Love This

A dozen-odd settings are a lot to hunt through one at a time. Folded into a few groups they are quick to scan, and when the desktop stops feeling right - too many test shortcuts, an experiment that went wrong - one button puts it back exactly where it started, without touching your resources or favorites.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher desktop open - see Your launcher desktop.

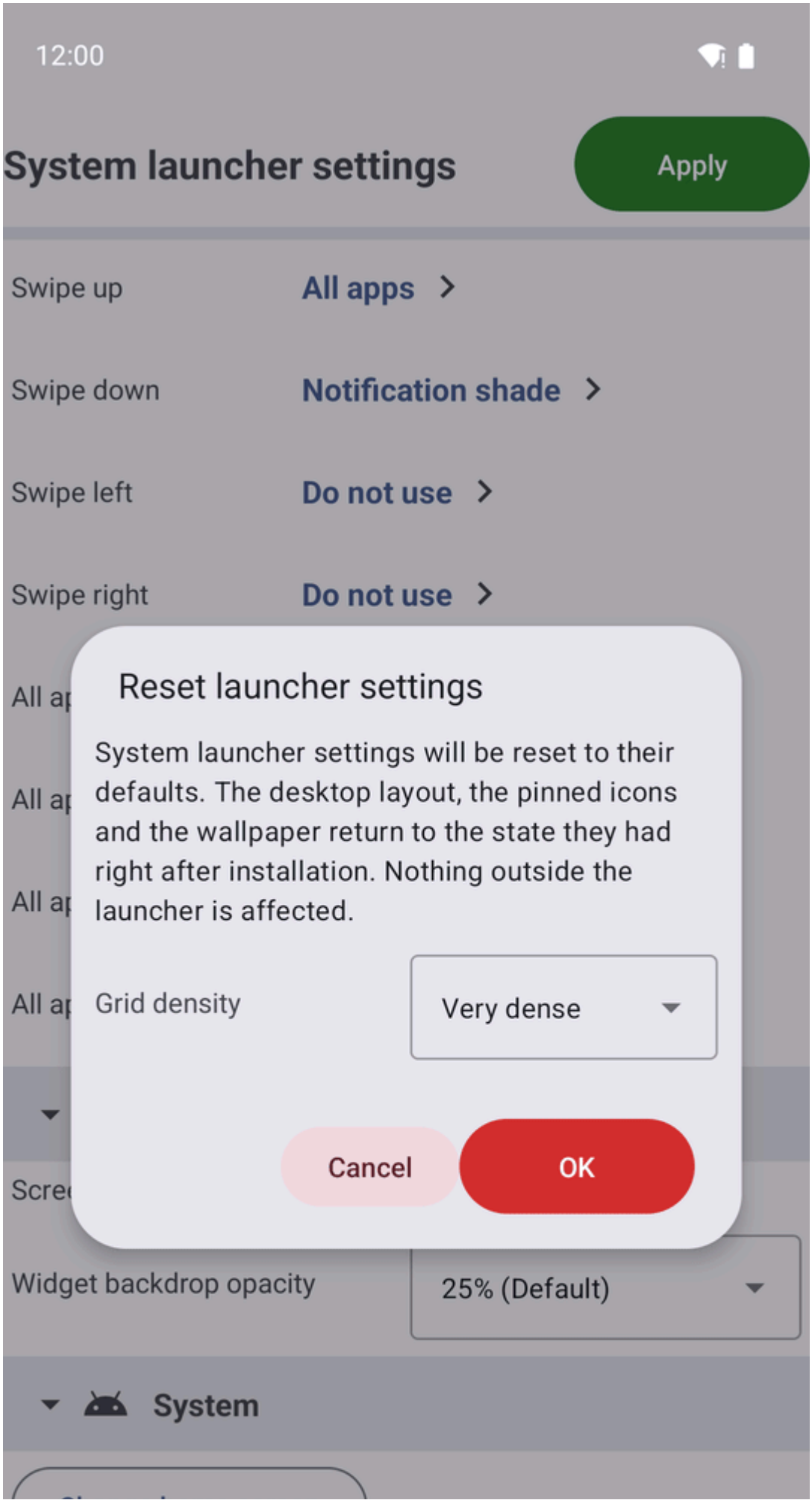
1 Find your way around the launcher settings

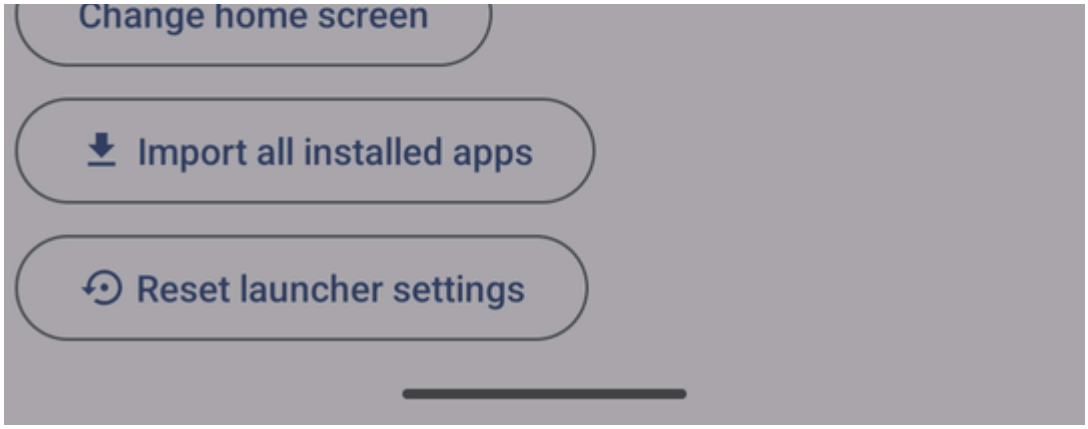
Open **Launcher settings** from the long-press menu, the Start menu, or **Settings**, **General**, **System launcher settings**. Its rows sit under collapsible groups - **Taskbar**, **Top bar**, **Desktop** and **System**, plus **Gestures**, **Appearance** and **System tray** for the more specialized rows - and whichever groups you leave open stay open the next time you visit.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Launcher settings groups**
System launcher settings dialog, several groups expanded and collapsed, scroll position near the top.

2 Start the desktop over

In the **System** group, tap the labeled **Reset launcher settings** button. After a confirmation, the desktop layout, the taskbar pins, the recent-apps history, every launcher setting and the wallpaper return to the state they had right after installation. Your resources, favorites and the app's general settings are never touched.


12:00
System launcher settings
Apply
Swipe up
All apps
Swipe down
Notification shade
Swipe left
Do not use
Swipe right
Do not use
Reset launcher settings
System launcher settings will be reset to their defaults. The desktop layout, the pinned icons and the wallpaper return to the state they had right after installation. Nothing outside the launcher is affected.
Grid density
Very dense
Cancel
OK
Widget backdrop opacity
25% (Default)
System



Reset launcher settings, in the System group.

3 What comes back on its own

A shortcut another app pinned to your desktop - through its own "Add to home screen" - reappears by itself after a reset, laid out after the starter set in both orientations, instead of you pinning it again one app at a time. A shortcut whose app is gone, or which no longer offers pinning, is simply left out. More on bringing in outside shortcuts is in Your launcher desktop.

4 How a fresh desktop is seeded for your device

The first desktop - and every reset - is laid out for the device profile FastMediaSorter detected: a car head unit, a tablet, a TV, a phone or a photo frame each get their own section order and item count, and a third-party app only gets a cell when it is actually installed. A fresh smartphone starts at icon density 1.5, a two-row taskbar and the top status strip on; other profiles start dense on a phone, sparse on a car head unit, tablet or TV, and standard elsewhere, and every section is auto-sorted right after the re-seed. Only a feature that is both built into your build and switched on gets a cell at first seed - turn one on later and its cell appears by itself, without another reset. On a device with Google Play services, a **Google** section carries the installed apps from an approved list - Play Store, Chrome, Gmail, Search, Photos, Drive, Maps, YouTube, YouTube Music, Calendar - placed after your content and before **App functions**; without Play services, no section appears at all. The very first group of widgets opens with one cell chosen for your device - an interactive Google Maps frame for a car head unit, or YouTube in its own group on a tablet.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Fresh desktop seed**
Launcher desktop right after a reset, phone profile, Google section and signature widget visible, portrait.

5 Sections stay tidy as they collapse

A section heading now takes up two grid cells instead of a whole row, so its own shortcuts can start in the same row right after it; collapsing it hides only the cells that shared its row and the rows below. Several collapsed sections in a row pack their headers together into one shared row instead of one each, shortening the desktop - a header is never split across rows, and a section still showing its content always ends the chain. While you are arranging the desktop, sections stay unpacked so a drop lands exactly where it looks like it will. Titles keep their own outline so they stay readable over a light wallpaper too.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Collapsed sections**
Launcher desktop, multiple sections collapsed and packed into one row, one section expanded below, portrait.

6 Move a whole section at once

While arranging the desktop, dragging a section heading moves the section and every cell under it together, one orientation at a time. The same **Section Actions** menu that offers **Rename Section**, **Re-sort Section** and **Delete Section** also carries **Move up** and **Move down**, for a keyboard, a D-pad or a screen reader. More on arranging sections is in Arranging the desktop.

7 Icons and surfaces that stay legible

Desktop icons, the gadget picker and the feature chooser keep their own light and dark versions, so nothing turns invisible when you switch the app's color theme. One **Widget backdrop opacity** setting, in the **Appearance** group, sets how see-through the card behind widgets, labels, section headers and the Start panel is - from **0% (Transparent)** to **100% (Opaque)**, defaulting to **25% (Default)**. Switching the system theme while you are arranging the desktop no longer interrupts you - edit mode stays exactly where you left it.

8 A guided tour online

An in-app link in the launcher settings opens an online walkthrough of the desktop, in your own language, with screenshots and - on a car head unit or a tablet - a tour built for that device.

What You Get

The launcher settings are a few taps to scan instead of a long list, a reset puts the desktop back to day one without touching your resources or favorites, and a fresh desktop already looks right for the device it is running on.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Reset removed a shortcut you added by hand?** Only automatic and pinned shortcuts come back on their own - add your own squares again the way you did the first time. See Your launcher desktop.
- **Section heading hard to read?** Titles are already drawn to stay legible over a light wallpaper; if a custom photo still fights with it, try a different **Widget backdrop opacity**.
- **Using a keyboard or a TV remote?** See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

LAUNCHER

Arranging the desktop - sections, screens, swipes and the lock

Move, resize and fold sections, spread items over several screens and lock the layout.

LAUNCHER

Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts

Edge swipes, the clock's own gestures, and the double tap that locks the screen.

LAUNCHER: TASKBAR, MENUS AND GESTURES | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #09

Screen Dimming and Timeout on the Launcher Desktop

The launcher desktop can turn its own screen off after a while of inactivity, warn you first with a dim, and show a readable clock even once it has gone dark. This page covers setting the timeout, reading the dim screen, keeping it lit while charging, and what each device profile starts with.

Why You'll Love This

A tablet left as a kitchen photo frame, a car head unit that should never go dark, or a phone on the nightstand you would rather not have glowing all night: the desktop's own screen timeout decides which of these you get, without you having to remember to lock the device yourself every time.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher desktop open - see Your launcher desktop.

1 Choose when the screen turns off

Open the launcher settings - **Launcher settings** in the long-press menu, or **Settings**, **General**, **System launcher settings** - and in the **Desktop** group find **Screen timeout**. Pick **Off (never)**, one of the presets from **5 seconds** to **300 seconds (5 min)**, or type your own number of seconds. Where the device supports it, the countdown locks the device the same way pressing the power button would, and a device with an Always On Display keeps showing it; where a lock is out of reach, the desktop instead falls back to its own black screen, and the setting's own subtitle says so. On by default, at 30 seconds.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Screen timeout**
System launcher settings, Desktop group, Screen timeout dialog open with presets from 5 to 300 seconds.

2 A brief dim before it goes dark

A few seconds before the countdown ends, the desktop dims instead of cutting straight to black, so a glance at the screen is enough to notice it is about to go, and a tap keeps it awake.

3 What the dimmed screen shows

While the screen is dimmed or already blacked out, it can still show the time: turn on **Show clock and status while dimmed**, in the **Desktop** group, to draw the clock together with the same status indicators the tray shows - SIM signal, network type and roaming, Bluetooth device count, transfer speed and Wi-Fi generation - folding extra notifications into a plain count once there are too many to fit. The whole face turns to landscape by the device's own sensor, and a larger tap ring with four compass sparks marks where to tap or swipe to wake the desktop.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Dim screen clock face**
Launcher dim screen, clock and status indicators visible, tap ring with four sparks, landscape orientation.

4 Keep it lit while charging

Screen timeout when on charge, in the same **Desktop** group, takes over for as long as a wired or wireless charger is connected, replacing the ordinary screen timeout while power stays attached. It ships **Off (never)**, so a charging device keeps its desktop lit unless you set a time for this row too.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Screen timeout when on charge**
System launcher settings, Desktop group, Screen timeout when on charge dialog open, Off selected.

5 Where each device profile starts

A car head unit or a photo-frame device profile starts with **Screen timeout** already set to **Off (never)**, since those devices are meant to stay lit and visible. Every other profile starts at the default 30 seconds. Change either default any time from the same **Screen timeout** row.

6 Lock it before the countdown ends

A double tap on empty desktop space locks the screen straight away without waiting out the countdown - the same decision point the idle timeout uses, so it locks the device where possible and blacks the screen out where it cannot. Audio you started earlier keeps playing either way. See Double-tap to lock the screen for how to turn the gesture off.

What You Get

The desktop turns off exactly when you want it to - never, on a fixed clock, or on its own schedule while charging - with a warning dim first and a clock you can still glance at once it goes dark.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Nothing on the dim screen?** Turn on **Show clock and status while dimmed** in the **Desktop** group - it is off until you switch it on.
- **Device without a real lock?** The subtitle under **Screen timeout** says so, and the desktop uses its own black overlay instead - any tap or key brings it back.
- **Want a gesture that locks it instantly?** See Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

Turn the desktop on and put apps, folders, channels and gadgets on it.

LAUNCHER

Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts

Edge swipes, the clock's own gestures, and the double tap that locks the screen.

LAUNCHER

Launcher settings and starting fresh

Find your way around the launcher settings, and reset the desktop back to its first state.

LAUNCHER: TASKBAR, MENUS AND GESTURES | Standard and noLegal | RECIPE #05

The Start Menu and the Full App List

Start is the short list, All apps is the long one. This page covers sizing the Start panel, opening the full app list, searching and sorting it, an app's own shortcuts from a long press, and the four swipes that move through the list without a single tap.

Why You'll Love This

The taskbar's **Start** button is the short list - pinned apps, recent ones, a few quick rows. When that is not enough, **All apps** is the long one: everything installed on the device, searchable, sortable, and reachable by letter.

Both grow with you: the Start panel can be made taller as your pinned row fills up, and All apps stays fast to open and fast to search even with a hundred apps on the device.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher turned on - see Your launcher desktop.
- The taskbar visible - see Using the desktop dock and taskbar.

1 Make the Start panel as tall as you need

Open the launcher settings and, in the **Taskbar** group, set **Taskbar rows**. A taller Start panel shows proportionally more recent apps, keeps the pinned icons in their own corner block, and stacks the tray indicators one above another instead of running them off the edge; the **Start** and **All apps** buttons themselves always stay one row tall, on the bottom row.

When the taskbar sits at the bottom, the Start panel opens as a sheet with a drag handle that respects the navigation bar and moves out of the way of the keyboard; with the taskbar at the top it opens as before. Its **Start** button and every row on it also keep enough contrast against the background to stay readable in both the light and the dark theme, under any color theme you pick.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Taskbar rows**
Launcher settings, Taskbar group, Taskbar rows control, Start panel preview two rows tall.

2 Open every app on the device

Tap the **All apps** icon button next to Start, or swipe up on empty desktop space while the desktop sits at the top of its scroll. The list opens from a cache the launcher keeps current on its own - through every install, update and removal - so it is ready even right after a restart.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: All apps button**
Launcher taskbar, Start button and the All apps icon button beside it, both highlighted.

3 Find one app fast

Type anywhere in the list to search - the **Search apps** field narrows the results as you type, matching the app's name or its package name. Tap **Sort order** to change how the list is arranged: **By name**, **By install date**, **By update date**, **By how often you open it** or **By category**, each with a **Reverse order** switch; the extra space under the letter tiles filled by a bigger preview instead of a fixed two rows.

Scroll without a search term and the apps are grouped alphabetically, each letter its own small heading with a short preview of what is under it - tap a letter and its group expands.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Searching All apps**
All apps screen, search field focused with a partial query, filtered results below, Sort order button visible.

4 Long-press an app for its own shortcuts

A long press on any app opens one menu with **Open**, **Put on desktop**, **Pin to taskbar**, **App info** and **Uninstall**, together with whatever quick actions that app itself publishes - a messenger's "New chat", say, or a browser's "New tab". An action that cannot work on this device is simply left out rather than shown greyed out. An app with no shortcuts of its own still opens normally on a plain tap.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: App long-press menu**
All apps screen, one app long-pressed, context menu listing launcher actions above the app's published shortcuts.

5 Swipe the list instead of tapping

In the launcher settings, open **All apps swipe action** and set **All apps: swipe up**, **swipe down**, **swipe left** and **swipe right** from the same list each direction offers: **Back to desktop**, **Expand all apps** (shows the full list instead of the letter groups), **Launch a chosen app**, **Lock screen**, or leave the direction unused. What each direction does is described in the settings reference; **Lock screen** only appears in builds that can actually lock the device.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: All apps swipe actions**
Launcher settings, All apps swipe action picker open, action list visible.

What You Get

The Start panel is exactly as tall as your pinned row needs, All apps opens instantly and finds anything by name, install date, use or category, a long press reaches an app's own shortcuts, and all four swipes do what you chose instead of nothing.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Picking an app to pin to the desktop or the taskbar?** The picker sheet used there is taller too, with more than one column in portrait, so you are not scrolling a single narrow list.
- **All apps looks different from the old Start menu list?** It replaced the expanding grid that used to live inside Start - the full list now has a screen of its own.
- **Using a keyboard or a TV remote?** See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

LAUNCHER

Using the desktop dock and taskbar

Where the Start button lives, pinning apps, and the quick-launch dock.

Customizing navigation gestures and shortcuts

The screen-edge gesture that can open All apps from any app.

LAUNCHER

Your launcher desktop

The starter layout the Start menu and All apps sit alongside.

The Status Area and Notifications

The taskbar's tray can carry as much or as little as you want. This page covers choosing between the launcher's own status area and Android's, picking indicators one by one, moving them to the top of the screen, and seeing other apps' notifications as a count you control.

Why You'll Love This

The clock, the signal bars and the battery number are small, but they are the things you check without thinking. This page is about making them yours: choosing whether they live in the taskbar or in Android's own status bar, picking exactly which ones show, and seeing at a glance when another app has something waiting for you - without opening it by accident.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the Standard edition or noLegal edition, with launcher turned on - see Your launcher desktop.
- The taskbar visible - see Using the desktop dock and taskbar.

1 Choose who owns the status area

Open the launcher settings, **Top bar** group, and turn on **Hide system status bar**. Off by default, so the Android status bar stays and the launcher's own tray simply drops whatever it would otherwise duplicate. Turn it on and the launcher takes over: it hides the system bar and draws its own clock, network and battery instead.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Status area owner**
Launcher settings, Top bar group, Hide system status bar switch shown off then on.

2 Pick which icons show, one by one

In the **System tray** settings, switch each indicator on or off by name: **Clock**, **Bluetooth**, **SIM 1 signal**, **SIM 2 signal**, **Network type**, **Battery**, **Wi-Fi Hotspot** and **Transfer speed**, drawn in that order. **Show status tray** turns the whole strip on or off at once.

An indicator the device cannot report simply stays absent instead of showing blank - a Bluetooth adapter that is off, a SIM slot with no card, or a phone-state permission you declined. Where the device can report more, it does: Wi-Fi shows its generation digit, Bluetooth shows how many devices are connected, a roaming SIM says so next to its data type, and Transfer speed adds live download and upload numbers, updated once a second.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Tray indicator switches**
Launcher settings, System tray section, list of indicator switches with some on and some off.

3 Move the clock and icons to the top

With **Hide system status bar** on, the **Top bar** group also offers **Top status bar**: turn it on and the clock, now showing seconds, moves to the left of the freed top strip while the device indicators move to the right - leaving the Start panel free to show more recent apps instead of the tray. Turn **Hide system status bar** back off and the indicators return to the taskbar on their own.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Top status bar**
Launcher desktop with Top status bar on, clock with seconds on the left of the top strip, indicators on the right.

4 Read the battery, and tap an icon for its settings

The battery number carries a lightning mark while charging, and its color says how: green from the mains, blue over USB, purple on a wireless pad - the low-battery warning color still wins below 15 percent. Tapping any status icon opens the matching Android settings screen directly: the battery icon opens battery settings, the network icon opens network settings, and so on for the rest of the row.

5 See other apps' notifications, without reading them

Turn on **Notifications from other apps on the top bar** and grant the notification access it asks for, and the bar adds one icon per app that currently has something waiting, with a count, placed after the app's own icons - a tap opens that app. Their title, text and attachments are never read; declining the access simply leaves the setting off.

The strip caps itself at five icons plus a counter for whatever does not fit, newest notification first, and every icon stays clear of the display cutout. To dismiss what you see without opening it, open **Active signals**: each row for another app's notifications carries its own **Dismiss** button, and **Dismiss all** clears every one of them at once - the app's own playback, transfer and background-work rows have no dismiss button, because there is nothing there to clear.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Active signals panel**
Active signals panel open, grid of signal rows, foreign-notification rows showing Dismiss buttons, Dismiss all in the header.

What You Get

The status area is exactly as full as you want it - Android's own bar, or the launcher's, with only the icons you chose, wherever you decided to put them. A tap on any of them takes you straight to its Android settings, and other apps' notifications show up as a quiet count you can clear with one tap, never as text you did not ask to read.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **An icon is missing and you did not turn it off?** The device itself may not be reporting that signal right now - a SIM slot with no card, Bluetooth switched off, or a permission not yet granted all show up as an absent icon rather than an empty one.
- **Dimmed screen still shows the time?** The dim screen keeps the same tray signals, folded and simplified - see Screen dimming and timeout.
- **Looking for the desktop weather or network gadgets instead of the tray?** Those live on the desktop itself, covered in Desktop gadgets.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

LAUNCHER

Using the desktop dock and taskbar

Where the tray sits, and the rest of what the taskbar offers.

LAUNCHER

The Start menu and the full app list

What moves into the Start panel when the top bar takes over the tray.

LAUNCHER

Screen dimming and timeout

What the same status signals look like on the dimmed screen.

...ns, Statistics and Diagnostics

PROGRAMS, STATISTICS AND DIAGNOSTICS | All editions | RECIPE #01

All editions; the notification-shade flashlight and the water flashlight need a phone with a camera flash, the mirror a front camera

Built-in Programs - Switching Them On, the Lights, the Mirror and the SOS Signal

FastMediaSorter comes with a set of small programs you switch on only if you want them. This page shows where to switch them on, where to open them, and how to use the front flashlight, the water flashlight, the flashlight in the notification shade, the lit mirror and the SOS emergency signal.

Why You'll Love This

FastMediaSorter carries a few small programs of its own: a calculator, a stopwatch, a mirror, three kinds of flashlight, an SOS signal and more. None of them needs a separate app, and none of them is in your way - every one is off until you switch it on.

A dark stairwell, a quick look at your face before a video call, hands wet in the rain, a lost path in the mountains at dusk - that is what the lights, the mirror and the SOS signal on this page are for.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter .
- For the camera flashlight and the water flashlight: a phone with a camera flash. For the mirror: a front camera.
- For the SOS signal on the watch as well: a paired watch with FastMedia Wear, in the Standard or noLegal edition - see Installing on Wear OS and pairing with the phone .

1 Switch on the programs you want

Open **Settings**, the **Management** tab, and find the group **Additional programs and scenarios**. Each program has its own switch, and each is off after installation:

- **Front flashlight** – the screen itself becomes a lamp.
- **Water flashlight** – the camera flash and the screen light together, and touch is locked.
- **Flashlight in the notification shade** – a permanent entry in the shade that lights the camera flash.
- **Mirror** – the front camera inside a bright field that lights your face. This one is on by default wherever the phone has a front camera.
- **SOS emergency signal** – a loud Morse siren and a strobing light.
- **Calculator**, **Stopwatch** and **Mini-game** – see The calculator and the stopwatch and The mini-game.
- **System information** – the report about your device, see System information and the debug log.
- Network Monitor, **Tourist** and Wear Companion – the connection check, the navigation dashboard and the watch window.

Switching a program off removes it from every menu, panel and widget list at once.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Program switches**
Settings, Management tab, Additional programs and scenarios expanded, several switches on, portrait.

2 Open a program

A program you switched on appears in several places at once:

- the programs menu, behind the three-dots button (**More actions**) in the command bar of the main screen;
- the programs panel, a bar above the resource list that shows the same programs as buttons. Turn on **Programs panel** in **Settings**, **General** - the three-dots button then gives its place to the panel. The panel's own menu has **Configure panel**, **Collapse panel** and **Hide panel**;
- the launcher desktop, in the Standard and noLegal editions - see Your launcher desktop;
- for the front flashlight, the water flashlight and the stopwatch, a one-cell widget for your home screen - see FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Programs menu**
Main screen, three-dots button tapped, menu with Front flashlight, Water flashlight, Mirror, Calculator, Stopwatch and SOS listed, portrait.

3 Light up a room with the screen - Front flashlight

Open **Front flashlight**. The whole screen lights up at full brightness and becomes a lamp. The time is shown in black a quarter of the way down.

- The large **Light color** button below the time picks another color - a warm yellow for reading, a red that keeps your eyes used to the dark. The color is remembered for next time.
- The strip of five steps beside it sets the brightness. Swiping up or down anywhere moves through the same five steps.
- A single tap anywhere closes the lamp.
  Only the brightness of this window is raised. When the lamp closes, your phone is exactly as bright as it was before.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Front flashlight**
Front flashlight open, warm color chosen, brightness step 4 of 5, portrait.

4 A light for wet hands - Water flashlight

A wet touch screen presses itself: rain or a shower can switch a normal flashlight off, or open something else. **Water flashlight** lights the camera flash and the screen at full brightness together, then locks the screen. Only the time and the reminder **Locked. Use the buttons** stay on it, and touching the glass does nothing at all.

- To turn it off, press a **volume button**.
- The notification shade and the navigation buttons are hidden and the screen is pinned, so water cannot pull the shade down or press Back.
- If you leave by a system gesture, the light goes out too - it never stays burning in your pocket.

  On a phone without a camera flash the lit screen is the light, and the lock still holds. This is not the water-lock mode some watches and phones have built in - no app can switch that one on.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Water flashlight**
Water flashlight running, screen pinned, system bars hidden, portrait.

5 The camera flash one tap away - Flashlight in the notification shade

Turn on **Flashlight in the notification shade**. A permanent entry appears in the shade: **Tap to switch the light on**. Tap it and the camera flash lights; the entry now says **The light is on. Tap to switch it off**.

It works with the app closed and over any home screen, and it comes back by itself after the phone restarts. If you switch the torch off from Android's own Quick Settings tile, the entry notices and shows the light as off. On Android 13 and later the app first asks for permission to show notifications - allow it, or there is no entry. Switching the setting off removes the entry and puts out a lit flash. Phones without a camera flash do not offer this switch at all.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Flashlight in the shade**
Notification shade expanded, flashlight entry visible, light off, portrait.

6 Check your face - Mirror

Open **Mirror**. The front camera fills the screen inside a bright white field that lights your face, like the lamp around a make-up mirror. The picture is flipped the way a real mirror flips it.

- The zoom buttons **1×**, **2×**, **3×** and **5×** sit in the lower left corner. The mirror opens at 3×.
- **Flip image** in the corner turns the mirror flip off and on.
- **Backlight** switches the bright field off and on without leaving the screen.
- **Take photo** and **Record video** save a picture, or a video with sound, into the folder you chose for the in-app camera, or into the phone's own Camera folder if you chose none - see Taking photos, videos and voice notes straight into a folder.
- **Close mirror** leaves it.

The zoom, the flip and the backlight are remembered for next time. Only this window gets brighter, never your phone's own brightness setting. On a device without a front camera the mirror says **This device has no front camera, so the mirror cannot open**. If camera capture is switched off in settings, the mirror is not offered.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Mirror**
Mirror open at 3×, backlight on, flip on, portrait.

7 Call for help - SOS emergency signal

Open **SOS emergency signal** from the programs menu, or tap **SOS signal** on the Tourist screen. Pick what it should do:

- **Sound and light** - a loud siren and a strobing light together;
- **Sound only** - for daylight, or when the light would blind someone;
- **Light only** - for a quiet night, or to be seen from far away.

The signal repeats the Morse SOS pattern - three short, three long, three short. The siren plays on the alarm sound channel, so it is loud even when the ringer is silent. It rises and falls several times a second, so the ear cannot tune it out, and it carries further than a plain beep. The rear flash and the whole screen strobe in the same rhythm.

While it runs, a notification says **Signal active** with the mode. Tap **Stop signal** to end it. After 30 minutes it stops by itself, so the battery and the flash last.

With a paired watch (Standard and noLegal editions), starting the signal on the phone starts it on the watch in the same mode, and stopping either one stops both. If the watch is out of range, each device still signals on its own. On the watch the screen is locked against touch while it signals, and only a hardware button ends it - see Wrist programs, timers and tools.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: SOS emergency signal**
SOS screen open, Sound and light selected, signal running, portrait.

What You Get

The programs you need sit one tap away in the programs menu, on the panel and on the home screen, and the ones you do not need stay out of sight. Your phone can be a lamp, a torch that water cannot switch off, a lit mirror and a loud distress beacon.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Want another program?** The calculator and the stopwatch are in The calculator and the stopwatch, the game in The mini-game, and the live microphone and camera broadcast in Chromecast casting and Live Broadcast.
- **A flashlight from the screen edge.** A swipe from the screen edge can switch the camera flash too - see Screen-edge gestures and the quick-access panel.
- **The SOS signal is loud on purpose.** Try it once with **Light only** so you know where it is before you need it.
- **Extra features you download.** Some parts of the app, such as more text recognition languages, are fetched only when you ask for them - see Downloadable extensions.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PROGRAMS

The calculator and the stopwatch

Everyday sums, a stopwatch for up to four people, and their widgets.

PROGRAMS

Usage statistics

See how many files you sorted, viewed and freed.

LAUNCHER

FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen

Put the flashlights and the stopwatch on your home screen.

PROGRAMS, STATISTICS AND DIAGNOSTICS | All editions | RECIPE #02

All editions; the watch calculator with FastMedia Wear in the Standard and noLegal editions

The Calculator and the Stopwatch

Two everyday programs come with FastMediaSorter: a calculator that shows the answer as you type and keeps a history, and a stopwatch for up to four people. This page shows how to open them, what each key and button does, and how to set them up.

Why You'll Love This

A shopping bill, a tip, a quick conversion - the calculator is there without leaving the app, and it keeps a history you can copy, send or save.

A children's race, laps around the stadium, a plank that must last two minutes - the stopwatch measures up to four people at once, plays music while it runs, and writes the result into a file you can send to the coach.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter.
- **Calculator** and **Stopwatch** switched on in **Settings**, the **Management** tab, **Additional programs and scenarios** - both are off after installation. See Built-in programs.
- For music during a run: some audio files on the phone.

1 Open the calculator

Open **Calculator** from the programs menu or the programs panel of the main screen, or put the **Calculator** widget on your home screen - see FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen. If the calculator is switched off, the widget says **Calculator is off** and offers **Open Settings**.

From the text editor you can also select a sum written in a note, such as `12*7+5`, and send it to the calculator - see Reading and editing text files.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Calculator**

Calculator open, 125 + 37 typed, live result 162 visible in the history, Normal keypad, portrait.

2 Count - and see the answer as you type

Type the numbers and the operations as on any calculator. While you type the second number, the running result already shows in the history above, so you see the answer before you press **=**.

If there is no answer yet - for example you are dividing and the divisor is still 0 - nothing is shown rather than an error. The error comes only when you press **=**: **Can't divide by zero.**

Tap the result to copy it. Tap the three-dots key for the menu: **Copy**, **Paste**, **Round**, **Function**, **Send result**, **Save history**, **Clear history** and **Calculator settings**.

3 Touch and hold a key for its second job

Each key carries a second action, written in small letters under its own symbol. Touch and hold the key to use it:

- **1** - 1/x, **2** - x^2, **3** - $\sqrt[3]{x}$, **4** - √x, **5** - x^y, **6** - n!;
- **7** - sin, **8** - cos, **9** - tg, **±** - ctg, **.** - π;
- **0** - types three zeros at once, handy for thousands;
- **+** - copy, **−** - paste, **×** - send the result, **÷** - round, **%** - save the history.
  Clear history is only in the menu, never under a key, so you cannot wipe it by holding a finger too long. Holding the three-dots key closes the calculator.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Calculator keys**
Calculator keypad close-up, small labels 1/x, x^2, √x, sin, cos, 000 visible, portrait.

4 Use the history and set the calculator up

Every result goes into the history. You can select any part of it and copy it. Pinch the history with two fingers to make its text bigger or smaller - five sizes, remembered for next time. **Save history** writes it into your Downloads folder: **History saved to Downloads**.

Calculator settings in the menu has three choices:

- **Group digits** - put a comma between every three digits, on both sides of the decimal point, so 1234567 reads as 1,234,567.
- **Result size** - a slider for the size of the result.
- **Keypad** - **Normal**, **Large keys** for easier tapping, or **Compact, bottom right** to reach every key with one thumb.

5 The calculator on your watch

FastMedia Wear on a paired watch has its own calculator. The **C** key sits in its own row below the keypad, with a gap above it, so you do not clear a sum by accident, and the result field is wide. Holding **0** types three zeros, holding the menu key leaves the calculator, and turning the crown on the history page makes the history text bigger or smaller. More about the programs of the watch: Wrist programs, timers and tools.

6 Open the stopwatch and choose the participants

Open **Stopwatch** from the programs menu, the programs panel or the **Stopwatch** home-screen widget. The widget starts and stops a measurement from the home screen; if the stopwatch is switched off it says **Stopwatch is off**.

Tap **Stopwatch settings** to set it up:

- **Participants** - how many people run at once, up to four. The screen is split into one area per person, **Participant 1** to **Participant 4**.
- **Play music while it runs** and **Track** - a track that loops for as long as a measurement runs. **Track** opens a list of the music on your phone only; with no music it says **No music found on this device**. **Music volume** sets how loud it plays.
- **Volume keys start and stop** - while the stopwatch is open, volume up starts or takes a lap and volume down stops, without first choosing an area. The phone volume does not change while you use them. Turn this off to give the keys back to the system.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stopwatch**
Stopwatch with four participants, all running, several laps recorded, portrait.

7 Measure, take laps and save the result

- **Start all** starts every visible participant at once, and the same button becomes **Stop all**. Each area also has its own **Start**, **Stop**, **Lap** and **Reset**; **Reset all** clears everyone.
- **Lap** records the time of each round; before the first one the area says **No laps yet – press Lap while it runs.**
- **Result** opens **Stopwatch result**: add a **Description** and a **Note**, check the **Preview**, then **Save to file** (it goes to Downloads: **Saved to Downloads**) or **Send** it to a chat or email. The result carries the date and time it was measured - **Measured at** - in the preview, the file and the sent text alike.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stopwatch result**
Stopwatch result for two participants with laps, description filled in, portrait.

What You Get

You count without leaving the app, keep a history you can reuse, and time a run for up to four people with a result you can save or send in one tap.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A calculator on the home screen.** The **Calculator** widget opens it straight away - no need to open the app first.
- **Timing with gloves on?** Turn on **Volume keys start and stop** and keep the phone in your hand: the side buttons do the work.
- **Want the stopwatch on the launcher desktop too?** Programs you switched on appear there as tiles - see Your launcher desktop.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PROGRAMS

Built-in programs

Switch programs on, and use the lights, the mirror and the SOS signal.

PROGRAMS

The mini-game

A small turn-based puzzle for a pause.

LAUNCHER

FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen

Put the calculator and the stopwatch on your home screen.

PROGRAMS, STATISTICS AND DIAGNOSTICS | All editions | RECIPE #03

All editions; the watch version with FastMedia Wear in the Standard and noLegal editions

The Mini-Game - Kryvavitsa and the Monster

Kryvavitsa and the Monster is a small turn-based puzzle built into FastMediaSorter. This page shows how to switch it on, the rules and the score, how to play with touch, keyboard, D-pad or gamepad, how to restart a level, the three looks and the watch version.

Why You'll Love This

Sometimes you wait - for a bus, for a long copy to finish, for the kettle. **Kryvavitsa and the Monster** is a small puzzle for those minutes: one move at a time, no hurry, no ads, nothing sent anywhere.

You lead a monster to the exit while its hunters close in. Every level is a little maze, and pushing a wall in the right place is often the whole trick.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter.
- **Mini-game** switched on in **Settings**, the **Management** tab, **Additional programs and scenarios**. It is off after installation - see Built-in programs.

1 Open the game

Once **Mini-game** is on, **Kryvavitsa and the Monster** appears in the programs menu, on the programs panel and, in the Standard and noLegal editions, on the launcher desktop. You can also put the **Kryvavitsa** widget on your home screen: it opens the game in one tap, and while the game is switched off it says **Enable in Settings** and is not offered in the widget list.

How to play? opens the rules and a legend of what each square is.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Mini-game board**
Game open at the start of level 3, Classic look, exit arrow visible, portrait.

2 Learn the rules

Reach the green exit with the blue Monster before enemies corner you.

- Each move takes the Monster one square. After every move the enemies move too.
- The red **Kryvavitsa** hunts the Monster. The purple lesser Kryvavitsas wander at random.
- Gray **walls** can be pushed into a free square to clear a path. The thick border around the board cannot be crossed.
- If any enemy reaches your square or a square next to it, the game ends: **Kryvavitsa caught you. Start a new game to try again.**
- Reaching the exit: **Exit reached. Start the next level when ready.** Tap **Next level**.

Score: each move costs 10 points, pushing a wall gives 10, crushing a purple enemy with a wall gives 50, and reaching the exit gives 1000. The counters show **Score**, **Level** and **Turns**.

At the start of every level an arrow points from the Monster to the nearest exit for about a second, so you find your way on a big board at once.

3 Move - by touch, keyboard, D-pad or gamepad

Use whatever you have in hand:

- **Touch** - swipe in a direction, or tap the board on the side you want to go;
- **Keyboard** - the arrow keys, W A S D, or the number keys 8, 4, 6 and 2;
- **TV remote or D-pad** - the four direction buttons;
- **Gamepad** - the direction pad; the **Y** button restarts the level.

R on a keyboard also restarts the level, and **Esc** goes back. See Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control for moving around the rest of the app the same way.

4 Stuck? Restart the level

If you have walked into a dead end, tap **Restart level** while the level is still being played. The level starts over, at the same price as being caught: 500 points are taken off the score. **New game** starts from level 1.

5 Choose how the game looks

The game mode button in the top bar opens **Game mode** with three looks. The rules are the same in all of them:

- **Classic** - abstract colored shapes: a blue Monster, red and purple enemies, gray walls and a green exit.
- **Kryvavitsa** - a light-gray field with black walls and people: you lead a man to the door, the woman with the machine gun hunts him and her helpers with knives stomp around at random.
- **Contrast** - every square drawn as a solid bright tile, easy to read on a small screen. A moved piece leaves a fading trace, so you always see which way it went.

Your choice is remembered, and **How to play?** describes the pieces of the look you chose.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Kryvavitsa look**
Game in Kryvavitsa mode, mid-level, Game mode picker closed, portrait.

6 Play on the watch

FastMedia Wear on a paired watch has the same game. The usual back arrow sits at the left middle of the round screen and a small **Skip turn** button at the right middle, so you can leave the game or spend a turn without moving without opening a menu. The score, the level and the turn count run along the bottom edge. More about the programs of the watch: Wrist programs, timers and tools.

What You Get

A quiet puzzle is always in your pocket: open it from the menu or the home screen, play with a finger, a keyboard, a remote or on the watch, and pick the look that is easiest for your eyes.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Plan two moves ahead.** The red Kryvavitsa always steps towards you; the purple ones do not. Put a wall between you and the red one first.
- **Too small to read?** Switch to **Contrast** - it was made for small screens.
- **Do not want it at all?** Switch **Mini-game** off: the game, its widget and its tiles disappear everywhere.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PROGRAMS

Built-in programs

Switch programs on, and use the lights, the mirror and the SOS signal.

PROGRAMS

The calculator and the stopwatch

Everyday sums and a stopwatch for up to four people.

LAUNCHER

FastMediaSorter widgets for your home screen

Put the game on your home screen next to the other widgets.

PROGRAMS, STATISTICS AND DIAGNOSTICS | All editions | RECIPE #04

All editions; the Sources section only in editions with network folders or cloud storage

Usage Statistics - What You Have Sorted, Viewed and Freed

FastMediaSorter keeps a private tally of what you do with it: files sorted and deleted, photos taken, videos watched, documents read. This page shows where to switch the tally on or off, how to read the Statistics screen, and how to save the summary or send it to the author yourself.

Why You'll Love This

After a few weeks of sorting it is nice to see the result: how many files you put in order, how many gigabytes the deletions gave back, how many hours of video and music you played. FastMediaSorter counts all of this on your phone and shows it on one screen.

The numbers never leave the device by themselves. If you want to help the author understand how the app is used, you send the summary yourself, from your own email app, and you see every line of it before it goes.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter .
- Some time spent in the app - a new install shows **No activity yet. Your stats will fill in as you sort, view and capture files.**
- For **Send to author** : an email app on the phone. For **Export** : any app that can save or send a file.

1 Check that statistics are collected

Open Settings, the **General** tab, and find **Statistics collection** in **General interface settings**. It is on after installation, with the note **Collected on your device. Nothing is sent automatically.** You can also turn it on or off on the first-run setup page - see Welcome and first setup.

Turning the switch off erases the detailed counters at once. Three facts are always kept, even with the switch off: how many times the app was launched, the date of the first launch and the version you first installed.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Statistics switch**
Settings, General tab, General interface settings, Statistics collection on, Statistics row visible, portrait.

2 Open the Statistics screen

While collection is on, a **Statistics** row appears next to the switch. Tap it. The row disappears the moment you switch collection off, because there is nothing new to show.

At the top four cards show your all-time totals:

- **Sorted (copied + moved)** - how many files you copied or moved into place;
- **Freed space** - how much space your deletions gave back;
- **Player time** - how long you watched video and listened to audio in the app, together;
- **Viewed** - how many files you opened to look at.
  If you open the screen right after a copy or a move, the new files are already counted - there is no moment where the card shows 0.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Statistics screen**
Statistics screen after some weeks of use, summary cards and By type bar visible, portrait.

3 See which kinds of files you work with - By type

Under the cards the **By type** bar splits the files you worked with into **Images**, **Video**, **Audio**, **Documents** and **Other**, each with its share in percent and its count. The bar appears only once there is something to show.

4 Open the sections for the details

Below the bar the details sit in sections you can fold and unfold with a tap on their title. A row that is still at zero is not shown at all, so each section lists only what you really did.

- **Operations** - **Copied**, **Moved**, **Deleted** with the space freed, **Renamed**, **Archived**, **Extracted**, **Folders created**, **Duplicate scans** and **Duplicates removed**, **Operations undone**, **Scheduled runs** and **Files processed on schedule**.
- **Capture** - **Photos taken**, **Videos recorded**, **Voice notes** and **Screenshots** made with the in-app camera, recorder and screen-edge gestures.
- **Viewing** - **Images viewed**, **Videos watched** and **Audio played** with the time spent, **Documents opened** with their pages, **Slideshows started** and **Slides shown**, **Audio streams played** and **Video streams played**, **Frames exported** and **GIF frames saved**, **Added to favorites** and **Removed from favorites**.
- **Editing** - **Drawings**, **Notes** written in the text editor, **Image edits** and **Text recognized** with text recognition.
- **Sources** - **Sources connected**: how many network and cloud folders you added, **Streams added** and **Imported from playlists**. Editions without network folders and cloud storage do not show this section.
- **Usage** - **App launches**, **First launch**, **First installed version**, and, while collection is on, **Sessions** and **Active time**.

  Each row uses the full width of the screen, so long values such as the installed version read on one line.

> Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Statistics sections**
> Statistics screen, Operations and Viewing expanded, Capture and Editing folded, portrait.

5 Save the summary or send it to the author

At the bottom the screen reminds you: **This data stays on your device. You send the summary to the author yourself, from your own email app.** Two buttons build the same short text report - the totals, the app version, the edition, the phone model and the Android version, and nothing that identifies you:

- **Send to author** opens your email app with the author's address, the subject **FastMediaSorter statistics** and the report attached. Read it, and send it only if you want to. If no app can send it, the app says **No app can send this – install a mail or sharing app and try again.**
- **Export** opens the Android share menu with the same report as a text file, so you can save it to a folder or send it anywhere.

What You Get

You know how much work the app has done for you - files sorted, space freed, hours played - and you decide yourself whether anyone else ever sees those numbers.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Starting from zero.** Switch **Statistics collection** off and on again: the detailed counters start over, and the launch count and first-launch date stay.
- **Why is a row missing?** A counter at zero is hidden. Do the thing once - take a photo, rename a file - and its row appears.
- **Freed space and cleaning up.** The biggest gains usually come from duplicates and old videos - see Cleaning up space.
- **Something went wrong in the app?** The statistics report does not help the author there; send the debug log instead - see System information and the debug log.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PROGRAMS

System information and the debug log

A full report about your device, and the log that helps the author fix a problem.

STORAGE

Cleaning up space

Find duplicates and large files and free space on the phone.

PROGRAMS

Built-in programs

Switch on the lights, the mirror, the SOS signal and the other programs.

PROGRAMS, STATISTICS AND DIAGNOSTICS | All editions | RECIPE #05

All editions; the watch report with FastMedia Wear in the Standard and noLegal editions

System Information and the Debug Log - Helping the Author Find a Problem

Two tools help when something in FastMediaSorter does not work as it should: the **System information** report about your phone and the app, and the **debug log** of what the app was doing. This page shows how to open, read, copy, save and send both, and how to read the exact build from the version number.

Why You'll Love This

When a video will not play or a network folder will not open, the author needs to know two things: what kind of phone it happened on, and what the app was doing at that moment. **System information** answers the first question, the **debug log** the second.

Neither is sent anywhere by itself. You create the file, you look at it if you like, and you decide where it goes.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition - see The seven editions of FastMediaSorter .
- An app that can send a file - email, a messenger or cloud storage - if you want to send a report.
- For the watch report: a paired watch with FastMedia Wear - see Installing on Wear OS and pairing with the phone .

1 Open System information

There are two ways:

- **As a program.** Switch on **System information** in Settings, the **Management** tab, **Additional programs and scenarios**. It then appears in the programs menu, on the programs panel and on the launcher desktop, next to the calculator and Network Monitor - see Built-in programs. It opens as a full screen.
- **From Settings. Settings**, the **General** tab, **About system**. This shows the same report in a window, with private values hidden.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: System information**
System information full screen opened from the programs menu, all sections folded, portrait.

2 Read the report

The report is split into sections you fold and unfold with a tap: **Device**, **User**, **OS**, **App**, **Hardware**, **Cameras**, **Battery**, **Memory**, **Storage**, **Network**, **Display**, **Locale**, **Time**, **System** and **Benchmarks**.

- **Cameras** lists every camera of the phone, including the separate lenses hidden behind one camera, with the direction it faces, the focal length, the sensor size, the zoom range and the **Active sensor area** - the part of the sensor a picture is really taken from. More about lenses: Lenses, zoom, shooting profiles and camera settings.
- **App** shows the app version and the build.

Touch and hold any line to copy just that value. The whole screen works with a keyboard, a TV remote or a D-pad as well: the line in focus is highlighted - see Keyboard, D-pad and Android TV control.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Cameras section**
System information, Cameras section expanded, rear camera with two physical lenses, portrait.

3 Copy, save or share the whole report

At the bottom of the full screen:

- **Copy** puts the whole report on the clipboard, ready to paste into a message.
- **Save** writes it as a text file into your Downloads folder, named with the date and time.
- **Share** opens the Android share menu with the report.

In the **About system** window from Settings, private values - the app signature, local network addresses, storage paths - are hidden. **Copy full report** includes them, but first asks: **Copy full report? The copy will include sensitive values (signature hash, local addresses, mount paths). Continue?**

4 Find out exactly which build you have

In **Settings**, the **General** tab, a line shows the version, the build number and the author's email address, for example **2.60.9240.148 | Build 260924014**. The same numbers are in the **App** section of System information.

The version number is the date and time the app was built: 2.60.9240.148 was built on 24 September 2026 at 01:48. When you write to the author, give this number – it tells exactly which build you are running, whether it came from a store or from an APK file.

5 Save or send the debug log

The app keeps a debug log - a diary of what it was doing, what went wrong and why. When something fails, do the thing once more so the log catches it, then open **Settings**, the **General** tab, the group **Backups, restore and settings export**:

- **Share Debug Logs** packs the log into one archive, `fastmediasorter_logs.zip`, and opens the Android share menu - pick your email app or messenger and send it to the author.
- **Save Debug Logs** saves the same archive to a folder you pick. If your device has no folder picker, the app offers to share the archive instead.

Touching and holding the version line on the same tab shares the log as well.

Passwords, keys and tokens are replaced by stars before a line is written, so they never reach the file, even for settings with new names. The log also carries what happened with live channels and audio - which stream quality was chosen, when it stepped down, which decoder played it - because that is where most playback problems hide. Each error is written once, with a single explanation, so the log stays short enough to read.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Debug log buttons**
Settings, General tab, scrolled to Backups restore and settings export, both log buttons visible, portrait.

6 Get a report from your watch

FastMedia Wear has its own **System information** screen in the list of watch programs, next to About. It shows the watch model, the Wear OS version, the app version, free memory and storage, and whether a phone is connected.

From that screen you can send the report to the phone. The phone then shows a notification, **Watch report received** - **Tap to open or send the report** - and keeps the report next to its own logs, so you can send both together. More about the watch programs: Wrist programs, timers and tools.

What You Get

You can tell the author in one message what phone you have, which build you run and what the app was doing when it went wrong - without giving away a single password.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Want the details in the error message itself?** Turn on **Show detailed errors** in **Settings**, the **Management** tab: error messages then add the technical code and context under the plain explanation.
- **Send the log right after the problem.** The app keeps only its last few log files and starts a new one as each fills up, so a log sent a week later may no longer contain the problem.
- **How much you use the app** is a different report - see Usage statistics.
- **Checking your connection** is the job of Network Monitor, another program you switch on in the same list.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

PROGRAMS

PROGRAMS

Usage statistics

How many files you sorted, viewed and freed - and how to send the summary.

Built-in programs

Switch on System information and the other programs.

GETTING STARTED

Understanding app permissions

What each permission is for, when a feature does not work.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION | All editions | RECIPE #01

All editions - full-text search and the online settings reference are in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy

Settings - Finding Your Way Around and Searching It

Settings is where you shape how FastMediaSorter looks and behaves, and it has grown into a lot of ground to cover - which is why it is organized into collapsible groups, searchable by keyword, and built from one consistent row pattern instead of a different one per screen. This page walks through finding your way around it and searching it; the individual settings themselves are covered on the pages that follow.

Why You'll Love This

Settings has grown into dozens of groups and well over a hundred individual rows. Folded into collapsible sections and searchable by keyword, it stays a screen you can scan in seconds instead of a list you scroll through by hand - and every row, whatever it controls, opens and reads the same way, so nothing has to be learned twice.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings** open.
- A wide screen or a rotated device to see the two-column layout mentioned below - it is not required for anything else here.

1 Find your way through collapsible groups

Settings is laid out as named groups - **General**, **Images**, **Video**, **Audio**, **Documents**, **Streams**, **Player**, **Destinations** and more, plus a **Launcher** and **Wear OS** section on builds that carry them. Each group header is one animated chevron row with an optional summary of what is collapsed inside it, and whichever groups you leave open stay open the next time you visit. A screen reader announces a group as expanded or collapsed, the same way, everywhere it appears - in Settings, in source editors, in player panels and in dialogs.

On a wide screen or a tablet held sideways, collapsed groups lay out in two columns instead of one long column; open a group and it spans the full width again while you read it. Every group header and every feature toggle also carries a small monochrome icon of what it controls - images, video, audio, documents, streams, network sources, gestures, scheduled operations and more - so a group is recognizable at a glance even when its label is short.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Settings groups**
Settings screen, landscape, several collapsed groups in two columns and one group expanded across the full width.

2 Search across every setting at once

Tap the search icon at the top of **Settings** to open a search overlay that matches any toggle or option by keyword, scrolls straight to it in the right group and highlights the row - instead of you opening group after group to hunt for it. In landscape the search button sits clear of the system navigation bar, so it opens the overlay instead of the row underneath it being dismissed by an accidental tap.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Settings search**
Settings screen with the search overlay open, a keyword typed, and the matched row highlighted in the list beneath.

3 Every row looks and behaves the same way

Whatever a row does, it follows one pattern: the value sits right next to the caption that names it, not stretched to the far edge of a wide or landscape screen, and adjacent rows in a block line up their values in one shared column sized to the longest caption. A row that opens a list of choices shows its selector arrow immediately after the text instead of a full-width stretch, and a simple value picker - a color, a size, a sort order - opens the same small tap-row-plus-list-dialog everywhere it appears, rather than a different pattern per screen. A dropdown row opens a modal option list that takes window focus, so you can walk the choices with a D-pad or arrow keys, confirm with Enter, and reach every option from a screen reader.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Settings row pattern**
Settings screen, a block of rows with aligned captions and values, one dropdown row open with its option list focused.

4 Some settings live in a dialog, not a row

Not every setting is a row in this list. The launcher configuration, the edge-gesture zones, default-app registration and the camera capture and OCR overlays each keep their own settings in a dialog reached from a button or a long press, rather than as more rows here. The full picture - every row and every dialog-hosted setting, in English, Russian and Ukrainian - is one page away: the settings reference linked from the website lists what each one does, generated straight from the app so it never drifts out of date.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Dialog-hosted settings**
Launcher settings dialog open from a Settings link row, illustrating a dialog-hosted settings surface.

5 Device profile changes tell you exactly what they touch

Changing **Device profile** says exactly how many settings it is about to overwrite, and a profile that changes nothing applies right away, with no confirmation to dismiss. A profile also seeds more than the obvious defaults: the reader's theme and layout, link-download behavior, player interaction, the Streams start-up view and, where the launcher ships, the desktop grid, taskbar and lock, so a car head unit, an e-reader or a photo frame starts out feeling different from a phone rather than identically. Whatever you change, the row updates the moment you pick a new value - it never flashes back to the old one for an instant while the write is still in flight.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Device profile confirmation**
Settings, General group, Device profile row with its confirmation dialog open showing the affected-settings count.

6 Typed numbers are kept, not dropped

Icon size for grid (pixels) and **Sync interval (min)**, both in **General**, keep exactly what you type into them: the value commits when you leave the screen or press the keyboard's action key, not only when focus quietly moves away. A grid size off the valid step snaps to the nearest allowed size instead of being thrown out, and a typed sync interval snaps to the nearest whole hour, with the stored value written back into the field so you see what actually took effect.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Typed numeric fields**
Settings, General group, Icon size for grid and Sync interval rows with the keyboard open over one of them.

7 Licenses, scheduled jobs and destination folders find their place

Open Source Licenses opens without a stutter, and an entry with nothing to say never shows a stray blank line. **Scheduled file operations**, in **Destinations**, is a single link row that opens the standalone scheduled operations screen instead of embedding the whole card in Settings; an old widget shortcut to the embedded card is redirected there automatically. The destination pickers for downloaded files and for screenshots use the same label-plus-value-plus-**Select** button pattern as the camera and video folder pickers, and any of them can point at a plain local folder picked straight from the system folder browser - kept out of your general resource list, used only as a write target for capture, screenshots, snapshots and auto-downloads.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Destination picker row**
Settings, Destinations group, a download or screenshot destination row with the label, value and Select button visible.

8 Dialogs, copy confirmations and rotation behave the same everywhere

A wide-layout screen triggers by available width as well as by orientation, so a large, high-resolution phone held upright gets the roomier layout instead of everything crowding into the top-left corner. Confirm-and-cancel button pairs across Settings dialogs use the same named button styles everywhere, instead of a one-off style per dialog, and copying text anywhere in the app shows one consistently worded confirmation - on Android 13 and later no message is shown at all, because the system already shows its own clipboard preview. Rotating the device while a settings screen is closing, or right after it opens, is safe, and the edge-gesture configuration dialog keeps its layout and the zone you had selected when the device turns.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Copy confirmation**
A Settings dialog with named confirm/cancel buttons and the unified copy-confirmation message shown after a copy action.

What You Get

Settings stays a screen you can scan and search instead of one you scroll through blind: collapsible groups with icons and summaries, a keyword search that jumps straight to a row, one consistent row pattern everywhere, and device-profile, license, scheduled-job and destination handling that all say clearly what they are doing.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Looking for a setting hosted in a dialog, not a row?** The settings reference covers dialog-hosted settings too, not only the rows in this list.
- **Changing themes, language or units next?** See Themes, colors, language and units.
- **Want the everyday behavior settings – screen, power, launcher and quick launch?** See Playback, power and everyday behavior.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Themes, colors, language and units

Color themes, the language picker, big buttons, compact mode and the app-wide unit system.

SETTINGS

Playback, power and everyday behavior

Keeping the screen on, auto-rotate, power saving, default apps, launcher mode and the quick-access panel.

SETTINGS

Privacy, passcodes and network security

PIN-protected resources, encryption and keeping remote sources safe.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION | All editions | RECIPE #02

All editions - color theme, custom accents, language, Big Buttons and Compact mode are in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy; the watch appearance rows need Standard or noLegal with a paired watch

Themes, Colors, Language and Units - Making the App Look and Read Like Yours

A theme, a language and a size that fit you make every other screen easier to use, and FastMediaSorter keeps all three in Settings, **General**, together with the icon and unit choices that follow from them. This page covers picking a color theme or an accent, reading the app in your own language, switching button size, turning decorative motion off, themed icons, the app-wide unit system, color-coded panels and how the same look carries over to the watch.

Why You'll Love This

The right look is not the same for everyone: a dark color theme at night, a bold accent by day, big controls on a car dashboard, a compact list on a small screen, your own language everywhere including on a locale that writes its own digits. FastMediaSorter keeps all of it in a handful of Settings rows instead of scattering it across screens.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings**, the **General** group, open. See Finding your way around Settings if you have not opened it before.
- Optional: a paired watch to see the appearance settings that reach it.

1 Pick a color theme, or one of the accent themes

Color theme, in **General**, switches the whole app between **Auto**, **Light** and **Dark**. Underneath it sit six custom accent themes - a dark and a light version each of green, blue and red - applied app-wide and kept across restarts. Secondary text adapts its color to whichever of the six you pick, so captions and hints stay readable against every accent instead of only the two plain themes.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Color theme picker**
Settings, General group, Color theme row with its picker dialog open showing the base and accent theme choices.

2 Read the app in your own language

Language/Язык/Мова, in **General**, opens a searchable list of every interface language. The app reads in thirteen of them: English, Russian and Ukrainian are complete, and Arabic, Bengali, Chinese (Simplified), French, German, Hindi, Italian, Portuguese, Spanish and Urdu carry roughly 98 percent of the text, edition-specific screens included. A caption with no translation yet falls back to English instead of showing blank, so no screen is ever half-empty, and the system's own per-app language picker offers the same thirteen. On a device set to a language that writes its own digits - Arabic, Bengali or Urdu - creating a resource works normally, and the icon picker grid fills in as expected.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Language picker**
Settings, General group, Language row with the searchable language list open.

3 Bigger buttons for a car dashboard, smaller elements for a busy screen

Big Buttons Mode, in **Player**, enlarges the player's control buttons and stretches them to the full width, with the toolbar showing five to nine buttons depending on how much room there is - built for a car head unit or anywhere you need larger targets. **Compact elements**, in **General**, goes the other way: it shrinks list rows and player controls to fit more on screen at once, and needs a restart to take effect.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Big Buttons and Compact elements**
Settings, Player group, Big Buttons Mode row, with the General group's Compact elements row shown alongside.

4 Turn off the decorative motion, keep the motion that means something

Disable animations, in **General**, stops screen transitions, group expanding and collapsing, settings-tab effects and image crossfades, plus the branded wave-and-particle backdrop behind the desktop when the app is used as a launcher and the same backdrop under every watch screen. Motion that carries meaning is kept on purpose: the audio visualizer under a playing track keeps moving, and a progress spinner keeps spinning, because a frozen one reads as a hang rather than as something being saved. With the switch on, the brand backdrop shows a still frame instead of going black after a rotation.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Disable animations**
Settings, General group, Disable animations row, brand backdrop visible behind it as a still frame.

5 Icons that match your wallpaper and stay recognizable

On Android 13 and newer, turning on the system's own **Themed icons** option - outside FastMediaSorter, in the device's own wallpaper and style settings - recolors the app icon to match your wallpaper the same way the built-in system apps do; below Android 13 the icon stays as it is. Everywhere an icon needs a color instead of just a shape - app shortcuts, the quick-access panel's program, resource and OS tiles - it sits on a flat circle of its own hue, the program's accent or the source's color, instead of a bare glyph on a plain white disc, so the same glyph reads consistently across every surface it appears on.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Themed and decorated icons**
Android home screen with the themed FastMediaSorter icon and a long-press shortcut menu showing decorated colored-circle icons.

6 One unit system for the whole app, phone and watch

Unit system, in **General**, lives in the main app settings and applies everywhere, in every edition, and syncs to a paired watch. It decides more than temperature: the metric system gives a 24-hour clock, year-month-day dates, kilometres per hour, metres and kilometres, while the US system gives a 12-hour clock with AM/PM, month-day-year dates, miles per hour, feet and miles - on every surface of the phone and the watch, desktop gadgets and home-screen widgets included, overriding the device's own clock-format switch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Unit system**
Settings, General group, Unit system row with its picker dialog open.

7 Panels get their own color, so you spot them at a glance

The collapsible panels on the main window - the programs panel, the streams panel, the resource-type filter - each carry their own accent background, shown both expanded and collapsed, with a recognizable icon on the collapsed chip. It is the same color logic behind the decorated icons in the previous step, just applied to a whole panel instead of one glyph.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Panel accent colors**
Main window with the programs and streams panels visible, one expanded and one collapsed, both in their accent colors.

8 The watch keeps the same look, fitted to a round screen

Every screen on the watch keeps content inside the visible glass of a round Wear OS display, shows the clock, and puts the scroll indicator beside the content instead of over it - the inset comes from the shape and size the watch itself reports, so it is correct on any model rather than tuned to one. In two-column settings cells at large font sizes, toggle captions wrap only at word boundaries.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Wear round-safe layout**
Wear OS settings screen, round watch face, content and scroll indicator kept inside the visible glass, toggle captions intact.

What You Get

The app looks and reads the way you want it to: a color theme or an accent that suits the time of day, your own language down to the icon picker, buttons sized for the situation, motion that only moves when it means something, icons that match your wallpaper, one unit system everywhere including the watch, and panels you can tell apart at a glance.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Switching a color theme did not seem to take?** Some accent changes apply immediately; the base Color theme choice needs a restart, which the app offers right away.
- **Want the search and row layout behind these settings explained?** See Finding your way around Settings.
- **Setting up default playback, power and the launcher next?** See Playback, power and everyday behavior.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Finding your way around Settings

Collapsible groups, keyword search and the consistent row pattern behind every setting.

SETTINGS

Playback, power and everyday behavior

Keeping the screen on, auto-rotate, power saving, default apps, launcher mode and the quick-access panel.

GENERAL

Keyboard, D-Pad and Android TV Control

Keyboard, D-pad and remote-control navigation across the app.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION | All editions | RECIPE #03

All editions - launcher mode and the quick-access panel's programs-menu entry are Standard and noLegal only; most other rows are in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy

Playback, Power and Everyday Behavior - Screen, Rotation, Default Apps and the Launcher

Beyond how Settings looks lies how the app actually behaves day to day - whether the screen stays on, whether it plays nicely with the battery, whether it answers when another app hands it a file, and how quickly your programs and resources are within reach. This page covers that everyday behavior, from screen and power to the launcher and the programs panel.

Why You'll Love This

The everyday defaults matter more than any single feature: whether the screen stays lit while you are actually looking at something, whether the battery is respected when it runs low, whether FastMediaSorter answers when another app hands it a file, and how quickly you reach your programs and resources. This page covers the Settings rows that shape that everyday behavior.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings** open. See Finding your way around Settings if this is your first visit.

1 Keep the screen on, and let it follow you, not the OS lock

Prevent sleep, in **General**, holds the display on across every screen of the app, including widget configuration, the Network Monitor and the transparent app launch panel. **Keep screen on while player is active** does the same job just for the player, useful when you leave the global option off. On the launcher desktop, an idle timeout raises the app's own black screen instead of letting the device lock, so the desktop dims without the system going to sleep; either hold stands down once power saving kicks in.

Rotate screen with OS auto-rotate (except player) makes every window but the player follow the system auto-rotate setting; **Rotate player screen with OS auto-rotate** is a second toggle that lets the player alone follow it while the first one is off. Both are hidden on a device with no accelerometer.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Screen and rotation settings**
Settings screen with Prevent sleep, program-wide auto-rotate and the player-only screen and rotation toggles visible.

2 The app quiets itself down when the battery runs low

Power saving mode, in **General**, turns the app quiet when the battery runs low: pick a threshold - off, always on, or below 10, 15, 20 or 30 percent - and below it every continuous animation stops, the audio visualizer freezes to a still frame, and the screen stops being held awake outside playback; a video still keeps the screen on. Turning on Android's own battery saver has the same effect at any charge level. The phone and the watch each judge their own battery, and the threshold set on the phone travels to the watch. Your own Disable animations choice is never overwritten by this - it returns exactly as you left it once the charge recovers, and both it and the screen hold come back the moment the device is put on charge, even while Android's own battery saver keeps its own effects off until you switch it off yourself. On a device that reports no battery level at all, the setting says so under its threshold options instead of leaving them silently inert.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Power saving mode**
Settings, General group, Power saving mode row with its threshold picker open.

3 Picture-in-Picture, and becoming the device's default player

Enable Picture-in-Picture appears in the Streams settings group as well as in the playback section - one setting shown twice, so flipping it in either place changes the other immediately, and playback behaves the same for a stream as for a local file. It is hidden, on either device generation, below Android 12.

Set as default, in **Destinations**, opens the Default app dialog, where buttons register FastMediaSorter as the device's handler for images, audio, video and documents - only the buttons for capabilities your edition actually has are shown.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: PiP and default apps**
Settings, Streams group, Enable Picture-in-Picture row, with the Destinations group's Default app dialog shown alongside.

4 Turn the app into your device's home screen

Primary startup window, in **General**, offers **Device home screen** among its choices: pick it, confirm it in the system chooser, and pressing Home opens a desktop you build yourself - a grid of shortcuts plus live gadgets, with a taskbar carrying a Start menu, recent launches, pinned apps and a tray. The first time you switch it on, the desktop is pre-filled to match your device profile, and you can always leave launcher mode and return to your previous home screen. More on the desktop itself is in Themes, colors, language and units and the launcher documentation.

Separately, the exit button at the top left of the main window minimizes the app - keeping background music, recording, scheduled file operations and the edge-gesture overlay alive - instead of closing it outright, whenever one of those is actually running; it only fully closes when nothing is active in the background, and a long press always force-closes after a brief "background stopped" message.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Launcher mode**
Settings, General group, Primary startup window row with the Device home screen choice selected.

5 Open something in its own window

Allow new windows, in **General**, turns on the "Open in new window" action offered from Browse and from the player. Choosing it opens as its own independent window, so multi-window on a VR headset or a desktop-class device (DeX, ChromeOS) genuinely opens a second window instead of staying inside the current one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Open in new window**
File browser with the Open in new window action selected, a second independent window opening beside it.

6 Switch remote source groups and Send-to targets on or off

Three toggles in **General** - **Local network (Ethernet) SMB**, **Computer on the internet (S)FTP** and **In cloud resources** - turn the network resource and cloud groups on or off; switching one off while it still has saved resources asks for confirmation first. **Send file to..**, in **Destinations**, builds one toggle per possible destination for the player's "Send file to.." menu; a target that is not installed shows a label saying so instead of just disappearing.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Remote sources and Send-to**
Settings, General group, the three remote-source toggles, with the Destinations group's Send file to.. toggles shown alongside.

7 Add a widget to the home screen, and reach the quick-access panel from the menu

Add widget to the Android home screen…, in **Destinations**, opens a picker of the widgets available for your edition and the settings you have on, filtered to what can actually be pinned, and starts the system's own pin request. **Edit quick-access panel**, also in **Destinations**, opens the editor for the quick-access panel - and that panel can be opened from the main window's programs (three-dots) menu too, alongside the edge gesture, the Quick Settings tile and the widget. Its own catalog of Android settings tiles includes Developer options, Battery saver, Auto-rotate, Accessibility, Wireless networks, Data usage, NFC and VPN - each one appearing only when its settings screen actually resolves on the device.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Quick-access panel entry point**
Main window programs menu open with a quick-access panel entry, Destinations settings Add widget row shown alongside.

8 A programs panel above your resources, with its own menu

Programs panel, in **General**, shows an optional horizontal strip above the resource list on the main window, mirroring the programs three-dots menu - icons only in portrait, icons with labels in landscape, with overflow for anything that does not fit; it hides the three-dots button while shown, and is off by default. Every item on the programs panel and the streams panel carries its own three-dots button, or a long-press menu where labels are hidden, to open it, open it in a separate window where multi-window is available, or remove it from the panel; a plain tap still opens or plays the item directly. That menu also carries a **Configure** entry that jumps straight into **Settings** on the relevant group, already expanded and scrolled into view.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Programs panel**
Main window with the programs panel shown above the resource list, one item's context menu open with Configure visible.

9 One list of programs, everywhere it's offered

The programs menu, the programs panel, the quick-access panel, the widget picker and the launcher desktop all read from one program registry, in one order - so the flashlight, the mirror and every other switched-on program are worded and drawn once and appear the same way on all of them; turning a program off in Settings removes it from all of them together. Long-pressing the app's own icon shows recently used programs and resources among the dynamic shortcuts, ranked by how recently you used them and capped by however many shortcuts the platform allows; Favorites and Slideshow stay as fixed shortcuts regardless. On the launcher desktop, the top signal strip caps itself at five icons plus a counter while **Top status bar** is on, or eleven plus a counter with it off - a narrow screen still shows only what actually fits.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: App-icon shortcuts**
Android home screen, long-press menu on the FastMediaSorter icon, recent programs and resources listed as dynamic shortcuts.

What You Get

The everyday behavior stays predictable: the screen stays lit where you need it and lets go where you do not, the battery is respected automatically, the app answers when handed a file, the launcher and its exit button behave the way you set them up, and every program you have switched on shows up the same way wherever you reach for it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Not sure which group a setting lives in?** The search overlay covered in Finding your way around Settings finds it by keyword.
- **Want the color theme and language settings first?** See Themes, colors, language and units.
- **Navigating with a keyboard, D-pad or remote?** See Keyboard, D-Pad and Android TV Control.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Finding your way around Settings

Collapsible groups, keyword search and the consistent row pattern behind every setting.

SETTINGS

Themes, colors, language and units

Color themes, the language picker, big buttons, compact mode and the app-wide unit system.

GENERAL

Backing Up and Restoring Settings

Exporting and restoring settings, resources and favorites, and keeping devices in step.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION All editions RECIPE #04

All editions - saved authorizations, unused credentials, secure sensitive screens, show detailed errors and the diagnostic report are in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy; watch log reports need Standard or noLegal with Wear Companion

Privacy, Saved Sign-ins and Error Reports - Staying in Control and Reporting Problems Well

Review and clear saved sign-ins and unused network credentials, keep password screens out of the Recents preview, read a masked diagnostic report before you ask for help, and send a crash report - automatically after a restart, by hand from any error dialog, or one that arrived from your watch. This page covers all of it, from Settings, **General**.

Why You'll Love This

A phone remembers more than you'd think on your own behalf - the sites it kept you signed into, the network passwords a deleted resource left behind, the exact reason the last screen crashed. This page is about staying on top of that: seeing who's still signed in and clearing what's gone stale, keeping a password field off the Recents preview, and sending a report that actually helps - without digging through logs by hand.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings** open. See Finding your way around Settings if this is your first visit.

⚠ Deleting unused credentials can't be undone

You'd have to enter that password or key again to reconnect. The confirmation lists every entry by address, port and user name first, so you can check before you commit.

1 Review your saved sign-ins, and clear credentials nothing uses any more

In **Settings**, **General**, expand **Authorization and accounts**. Tap **Saved authorizations** to open the list of sign-in sessions the in-app web browser keeps when it auto-downloads from a site that needs you signed in - review them, and remove the ones you no longer need.

Unused credentials sits right beside it, but only once it has something to show: a saved network password or key that belongs to no resource any more, once it has sat unused past the grace period, is counted here - the row reads, for example, "Unused credentials - 12." Tap it and you get a full list by address, port and user name, never the password, before anything is removed.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Authorization and accounts**
Settings, General tab, Authorization and accounts section expanded, Saved authorizations row and Unused credentials button visible.

2 Keep passwords off the Recents preview

Secure sensitive screens, in **Settings**, **General**, blocks screenshots and the Recents app-switcher preview, but only on the screens that could actually show a password - adding or editing an SMB or SFTP/FTP resource, the credentials editor in Settings, the sign-in web view and the credential QR code. Everywhere else - picking a resource type, browsing a local or cloud folder - stays screenshotable as usual.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Secure sensitive screens**
Settings, General tab, Secure sensitive screens row with its summary text, toggle on.

3 Ask for the technical detail behind an error

Turn on **Show detailed errors**, in **Settings**, **General**, and an error dialog stops summarizing - it shows the technical codes and context behind the message instead of the plain-language version. Leave it off for the friendlier message day to day, and switch it on when you need to describe a problem precisely, for example right before reporting it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Show detailed errors**
Settings, General tab, Show detailed errors row, toggle highlighted.

4 Pull a diagnostic report before you ask for help

About system, in **Settings**, **General**, under **Debug logs and test tools**, gathers a masked system report you can read right there in the dialog - version and device details, without the values that could identify or locate you. Tap **Copy full report** to copy that masked version; if whoever is helping you genuinely needs the sensitive values too - the signature hash, local addresses, mount paths - confirming the follow-up prompt copies the unmasked report instead.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: System diagnostic report**
About system dialog open with the masked report visible and the reveal confirmation dialog layered on top.

5 Send a crash report, automatically or on your own terms

If the app closes unexpectedly, the next launch offers to send one: "**Send crash report?** The app closed unexpectedly last time. Send a crash report with the app log to the author?" Say yes and your mail app opens with the details and the log already attached - if nothing on the device can send mail, the report simply stays saved locally instead of the offer going nowhere.

You don't have to wait for a crash to do the same thing: whenever an error dialog is showing a real exception rather than just a message, its **Email crash report to author** button sends the same package on demand.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Crash report prompt**
Send crash report dialog shown on app launch following a previous crash.

6 A watch's log report travels with the phone's own logs

Standard and noLegal editions, with Wear Companion. A log report your paired watch sends over lands beside the phone's own logs, and it stays reachable even after you dismiss its arrival notification: both **Share Debug Logs** and **Save Debug Logs**, in **Settings**, **General**, **Debug logs and test tools**, fold it into the archive they produce.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch logs in export**
Settings, General tab, Debug logs and test tools section, a watch-originated log report included alongside the phone's own logs.

What You Get

You know who's still signed in and what's gone stale, password screens stay out of the Recents preview, a diagnostic report is one tap away before you ask for help, and a crash report reaches the author - automatically after a restart or by hand from any error dialog, watch logs included.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Not sure which group a setting lives in?** The search overlay in Finding your way around Settings finds any of these by keyword.
- **Backing up more than one report?** Backing up and syncing your device covers exporting the whole settings picture, not just a single diagnostic.
- **Navigating this page with a keyboard, D-pad or remote?** See Controls and key remapping.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Finding your way around Settings

Collapsible groups, keyword search and the consistent row pattern behind every setting.

SETTINGS

Backing up and syncing your device

Exporting and restoring settings, resources and favorites, and keeping devices in step.

SETTINGS

Controls and key remapping

Remapping keys, D-pad and gamepad navigation, and the travelling focus frame.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION | All editions | RECIPE #05

All editions - Google Drive backup needs Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR with a Google account connected; Wear OS sync needs Standard or noLegal with Wear Companion

Backing Up Your Settings and Keeping Devices in Sync

Pack every setting into a file or a Google Drive backup, export and import just your Favorites, move exactly one kind of data with the unified menu, and keep a paired watch's settings and resources in step with the phone - synced both ways, with only the resources you chose along for the ride.

Why You'll Love This

Setting everything up the way you like it - sources, Favorites, every toggle - takes a while, and you don't want to do it twice. FastMediaSorter can pack the whole thing into a file or a Google Drive backup, move just one kind of data on its own, and keep a paired watch matching the phone without you tapping the same setting twice.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings**, the **General** group, open. See Finding your way around Settings if this is your first visit.
- For the Google Drive backup: a Google account connected in the app.
- For the watch steps: a paired watch with Wear Companion turned on.

1 Back up every setting to a file

In **Settings**, **General**, expand **Backups, restore and settings export**, then tap **Export All Settings to File**. It saves everything the app has stored - not a hand-picked subset - so restoring on an older or a newer version of the app still brings back everything both versions share. On another phone, or after a reinstall, tap **Import Settings from File** and pick the file; it replaces the current configuration.

A restore also carries your measurement system forward instead of quietly resetting it to metric, and, separately, the SOS program switch, the SOS mode it starts in and the launcher's taskbar row count - a backup taken before any of those existed simply leaves each one as the device already has it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Export and import settings**
Settings, General tab, backup card, Export All Settings to File and Import Settings from File buttons.

2 Keep a full backup in Google Drive

Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy and VR editions, with a Google account connected. In the same card, tap **Backup settings to Google Drive** and the app saves every setting, together with your resources and their network passwords and saved web sign-ins, your Favorites and your launcher desktop, straight to your Google Drive - reporting back with something like "Backed up 12 resources, 40 favorites and all settings to you@gmail.com." The card remembers the date of the last backup and the account.

Tap **Restore settings from Google Drive** to bring it back: settings are replaced, while resources and Favorites are added to what you already have, with exact duplicates skipped.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Google Drive backup**
Settings, General tab, Google Drive backup buttons, last backup date and account expanded.

3 Export and import just your Favorites

If you only want the starred list, not the whole settings file, the same card has its own pair: **Export Favorites** saves your starred files and channels to a file for sharing or safekeeping, and **Import Favorites** brings a list back in, asking whether to skip or overwrite anything that already exists.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Favorites export and import**
Settings, General tab, backup card, Export Favorites and Import Favorites buttons.

4 Move exactly one kind of data, to a file or to Drive

For anything more selective, tap **Import and export data** - "*Settings, favorites, pinned streams and resources - to a file or to Google Drive*." Choose what (**Settings**, **Favorites**, **Pinned streams** or **Resources**), which way (**Export** or **Import**), and where (**Device file** or **Google Drive**). A file that holds another kind of data, or comes from a newer app version, is refused cleanly and nothing changes. The Google Drive half needs a connected account; the pinned-stream option only appears where streams are supported and switched on. The full backup and export picture, in one place, is in Backing up and restoring settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Import and export data**
Import and export data menu open, data kind, direction and medium pickers visible.

5 Keep watch settings in step with the phone

Standard and noLegal editions, with Wear Companion. Open **Wear Companion** and tap **Sync settings**. Every watch setting can also be changed directly on the watch, and either side's **Sync settings** button brings both to the same state, keeping whichever side changed a given field most recently. Two settings always stay watch-only by design - auto rotation and voice note delivery - and the background picture always stays a phone choice. Both sides show when they last agreed, or "Never synced" if they haven't yet.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Wear settings sync**
Wear Companion settings screen, Sync settings button, Last synced label.

6 Choose which resources ride along to the watch

Resources don't sync automatically. Inside **Wear Companion**, tap **Push to Watch** and pick which of your registered resources should travel to the watch on the full-screen picker that opens. Leaving the selection empty sends nothing, and says so, instead of quietly pushing your entire resource list.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Push to Watch**
Push to Watch resource picker, several resources listed, some selected.

What You Get

Everything you set up travels with you: a settings file or a Google Drive backup that carries the whole configuration, a Favorites list you can move on its own, a menu that moves exactly the one kind of data you want, and a paired watch that stays in step - settings synced both ways, and only the resources you actually chose.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Not sure which group a setting lives in?** The search overlay in Finding your way around Settings finds it by keyword.
- **Back up before a big change.** A settings file or a Google Drive backup takes a few seconds; do one before resetting the phone or moving to a new one.
- **Looking for the resource side of sharing?** Sharing and Backing Up Your Resources covers exporting resources to a file, PINs included, and importing a ready configuration from the Windows companion.
- **Want one shared box for all your own devices?** The media exchange portal shows how Google Drive, Dropbox and OneDrive sit next to the other ways of moving media between your devices.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Privacy, saved sign-ins and error reports

Saved sign-ins, unused credentials, secure screens and sending a crash report.

SETTINGS

Controls and key remapping

Remapping keys, D-pad and gamepad navigation, and the travelling focus frame.

GENERAL

Backing up and restoring settings

Every backup and export option of the app on one page.

SETTINGS & NAVIGATION | All editions | RECIPE #06

All editions - remapping, D-pad and gamepad navigation, the focus frame and the automatic initial focus are in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy; the VR Only keybinding group needs a build with a VR runtime

Controls and Key Remapping - Keyboard, TV Remote and Gamepad, Your Way

Remap any command to a D-pad, gamepad, keyboard or mouse button, move fast through large grids, and always see where focus is with the travelling focus frame - plus readable VR gesture names and a Permissions screen, empty lists and custom views that all take D-pad focus the way the rest of the app does.

Why You'll Love This

Not everyone reaches for the screen with a finger - a TV remote, a car head unit's D-pad, a gamepad or a plain keyboard all need to move around the app just as directly. FastMediaSorter lets you remap what each button does, keeps you moving fast through a large grid, and always shows you exactly where focus is, so the remote is never guesswork.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter, any edition, with **Settings** open. See Finding your way around Settings if this is your first visit.
- Hardware: a TV remote, a D-pad, a gamepad, a physical keyboard or a mouse connected to the device.

1 Remap any command to your remote, gamepad, keyboard or mouse

Open **Settings**, **General**, and tap **Controls & Keybindings** to reach the key-binding screen for navigation and playback. Every command - grouped as **Playback**, **Navigation**, **Browser Actions**, **View & Zoom**, **Audio & Subtitles**, **Sorting Actions**, **System UI** and more - can be reassigned to a D-pad button, a gamepad button, a keyboard key or a mouse button. The **Browser Actions** group is remapped on its own, separate from the player's transport buttons, because the app reads which surface is active before deciding what a button does - the same physical button can browse a file list in one place and skip a track in another. Reset one group at a time from its own menu, or use the reset-all action to put every binding back to its factory defaults.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Controls & Keybindings**
Controls & Keybindings screen, command list with group headers, one binding highlighted for capture.

2 Faster D-pad and gamepad navigation in large grids

Hold a direction on the D-pad, remote or keyboard past a short repeat threshold in any large grid, and it jumps a whole page at a time instead of one cell. A gamepad's left stick works the same way, with its own dead zone and hold-to-accelerate; the right stick scrolls the active list, and the shoulder buttons page-jump too - the player keeps its own separate button mapping, so none of this changes how it behaves. If focus ever lands on an empty or bare scrollable area - after data loads late, for instance - the next directional key press moves it straight to the first real control instead of leaving it stuck nowhere.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: D-pad and gamepad grid navigation**
File browser grid view, focus frame visible, page-jump in progress under a held D-pad direction.

3 Always know where focus is

Under a remote, keyboard or gamepad, a single highlighted frame - or, on some controls, an accent outline drawn on the control itself - travels with focus across every screen, form and dialog, so you can always see where you are; it only appears under non-touch control, never while you're using your finger. Opening any screen puts focus on a real control straight away, so the first key press does something instead of just waking focus up. In the player, the outline steps aside: arrow keys move focus between the on-screen transport controls instead, and the video or artwork surface itself is never outlined.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Travelling focus frame**
Settings screen, D-pad focus frame around the active row, non-touch mode.

4 VR gestures, labeled so you can read them

On a build with a VR runtime, the same **Controls & Keybindings** screen carries a **VR Only** group for headset gestures. Its rows show a readable name - Swipe Left, Double Pinch and the rest of the named gestures - or a clean "VR N" for a code with no name yet, instead of the raw "VR[15]" form the codes arrive as. A build without a VR runtime never shows this group at all.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: VR Only keybinding group**
Controls & Keybindings screen scrolled to the VR Only group, readable gesture labels visible.

5 D-pad focus that stays where it belongs

The Permissions screen and its settings sub-fragments take D-pad focus correctly, so the remote always has something to move onto. An overlay fragment - permissions, extensions, licenses - keeps focus inside itself instead of letting a directional key slip through to the settings screen hidden underneath it. An empty file browser list handles arrow keys and next/previous-file commands without a problem. And the custom views that draw their own UI - the player, the mini-game, the launcher desktop and the gesture settings screen - all answer to the D-pad and the keyboard, and their colors follow the app's theme instead of staying fixed regardless of it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Permissions screen D-pad focus**
Permissions screen, focus frame on a row, non-touch input active.

What You Get

Every command answers to whatever you're actually holding: remapped keys on a D-pad, gamepad, keyboard or mouse, fast page-jumps through large grids, a focus frame that always shows where you are, readable VR gesture names, and a Permissions screen, empty lists and custom views that all take D-pad focus the way the rest of the app does.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- '**Reassigning a key already in use?** The capture dialog says so immediately - "Already bound to: .." - pick a different key, or finish the swap and reset the other command later.'
- **Using a TV remote for the first time?** See Keyboard, D-Pad and Android TV Control for the full rundown of moving around the app this way.
- **Want the everyday behavior settings next?** See Playback, power and everyday behavior.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Privacy, saved sign-ins and error reports

Saved sign-ins, unused credentials, secure screens and sending a crash report.

SETTINGS

Backing up and syncing your device

Exporting and restoring settings, resources and favorites, and keeping devices in step.

GENERAL

Keyboard, D-Pad and Android TV Control

Keyboard, D-pad and remote-control navigation across the app.

ge, Backup, Keyboard and TV

GENERAL, KEYBOARD & TV | All editions | RECIPE #01

All editions - backup and restore to a file work everywhere; the Google Drive backup needs Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR with a Google account connected

Backing Up and Restoring Settings - What Travels, What Stays and How to Find It

Your settings, Favorites and resources can all go into a backup and come back again. This page is about the backup itself: where its buttons are, what it carries, what it leaves behind on purpose, and how an old backup restores.

Why You'll Love This

A backup is only worth something if it gives you back what you had. You spent time on the color theme, the screenshot gestures, the swipe commands of the file browser, the launcher desktop and a dozen streams - and after a new phone or a reset you want all of it back, not half of it.

This page tells you exactly what a FastMediaSorter backup keeps, the handful of things it leaves behind on purpose and why, and what happens when you restore a backup made months ago by an older version of the app.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition, with Settings open on the **General** tab.
- For the Google Drive backup: the Standard, noLegal, Photos, Legacy or VR edition and a Google account connected in the app.
- For a backup to a file: a place to keep the file - a folder on the phone, a memory card or a cloud storage folder.

1 Find every backup button in one card

Open **Settings**, stay on the **General** tab and expand **Backups, restore and settings export**. Everything that saves or brings back your data is here:

- **Export All Settings to File** and **Import Settings from File** - every setting, to a file you keep yourself.
- **Backup settings to Google Drive** and **Restore settings from Google Drive** - settings, resources, Favorites and more, in your Google Drive.
- **Export Favorites** and **Import Favorites** - just your Favorites.
- **Export resources to file** and **Import resources from file** - just your list of folders and servers, ready to hand to another phone.
- **Import and export data** - one kind of data at a time: **Settings**, **Favorites**, **Pinned streams** or **Resources**, to a **Device file** or to **Google Drive**.
  The small help icon next to the card opens **Backup Information**, a short reminder of what a backup is for.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Backup card**
Settings, General tab, the Backups, restore and settings export card expanded with a Google account connected.

2 Or just search for it

Do not remember which group holds the card? Tap the search icon at the top of **Settings** and type **backup**, **restore** or **export**. The search opens the right tab, unfolds the group that holds the row and highlights it - backup and restore always lead to this card, not to an unrelated destinations tab, and there are no phantom results that lead nowhere.

The same search finds rows that open a list of choices too, such as **Language/Язык/Мова**, the color theme, the video pre-cache size, the default sort mode, the device profile, saved authorizations and statistics. In the Lite and Photos editions it hides the rows of features those editions do not carry - microphone recording, background audio, cloud sources, text recognition and translation, and the downloadable extensions screen - so every match you tap leads to a setting you can actually see. More about searching: Navigating and searching Settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Searching Settings for backup**
Settings with the search overlay open, the query backup typed, and the backup card unfolded with the matching row highlighted.

⚠ Keep the backup to yourself

A backup that carries resources carries their passwords too. Keep it in your own Google Drive or your own folder, and do not send it to anyone.

3 Know what a backup carries

A settings backup - to a file or to Google Drive - carries practically every setting in the app. Among them:

- the color theme and the look of every screen;
- the whole block of stream settings;
- the camera, microphone and screen recording options;
- both swipe commands of the file browser and your overrides of the **Send to..** menu;
- the sixteen swipe slots of the launcher, the network speed readout in its tray and the color palette of its animated waves and particles;
- all the fields of the screenshot gestures - every zone and every gesture you set up.

The Google Drive backup adds your resources with their network passwords and saved site sign-ins, your Favorites, your scheduled operations and your launcher desktop. Moving your list of places to someone else's phone is described step by step in Sharing and backing up your resources.

4 Know the few settings that stay behind - on purpose

Eight settings are deliberately not carried, because on another phone they would be wrong or even harmful:

- **Camera lens memory** - the exposure remembered for each lens belongs to that phone's cameras.
- **The step counter's reset point** - it belongs to that phone's sensor.
- **Your consent to screen capture and to screen recording** - Android wants you to give it again on each device, so the app asks again.
- **The last folder picked on the phone, the last opened resource and an old slideshow music setting** - they point at things that no longer exist after a restore, so carrying them would only lead nowhere.

Everything else comes back.

5 Restore a backup made by an older version

A backup made months ago, by an older version of FastMediaSorter, still restores. Settings that did not exist when it was made are simply not in the file - and for each of them the app keeps whatever your phone already has, instead of silently resetting it.

When the file has no value for a setting that it should have had, the app uses exactly the default a fresh install uses. Before, some settings could come back different from a fresh install - text recognition and translation switched on, picture-in-picture switched off, the trash switched on, or launcher values the app no longer ships. That no longer happens.

One safety rule is always respected: an old backup does not switch **Open downloaded file in player** back on. A file you download from a link is not opened by itself unless you switch that on again yourself.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Restore from Backup confirmation**
Settings, General, Restore settings from Google Drive tapped, the Restore from Backup confirmation open.

What You Get

You know where every backup button is, what a backup brings back - practically everything, from the color theme to the last screenshot gesture - what it leaves behind on purpose, and that even an old backup restores without quietly changing your settings.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Back up before a big change.** A backup takes seconds; do one before you reset the phone, move to a new one or try a very different device profile.
- **Keep two copies.** A file in your own folder and a copy in Google Drive protect you against losing either one.
- **Syncing a watch?** Keeping a paired watch in step with the phone is covered in Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

STORAGE

Sharing and backing up your resources

Hand your list of folders and servers to another phone in one file.

SETTINGS

Backing up your settings and keeping devices in sync

Settings to a file or Google Drive, Favorites on their own, and a watch in step with the phone.

GENERAL

Keyboard, D-pad and TV control

Moving around the app without touching the screen.

GENERAL, KEYBOARD & TV | All editions | RECIPE #02

All editions - keyboard and dialog control everywhere; the automatic first focus on a real control is in Standard, Lite, Photos and Legacy

Keyboard, D-Pad and Android TV Control - Using the App Without Touching the Screen

A remote, a keyboard, a game controller or a mouse - FastMediaSorter answers to all of them. This page shows how to move around, answer dialogs, use the shortcuts and select files without touching the screen.

Why You'll Love This

Not every screen is a phone in your hand. FastMediaSorter also runs on a TV box in the living room, on a car head unit, on a tablet with a keyboard cover and on a Chromebook with a mouse. On all of them you should be able to open a folder, look through photos and answer a question in a dialog without ever touching the glass.

This page shows how: the remote and its D-pad, the keyboard and its shortcuts, and the mouse with its buttons and wheel.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition .
- One of these: a TV remote, a game controller, a keyboard (Bluetooth, USB or a keyboard cover) or a mouse.
- For the TV: an Android TV or Google TV box. The app does not need a touchscreen.

1 Start the app on a TV

On an Android TV or Google TV box, FastMediaSorter appears in the TV's own app row with its own wide banner, like any app made for the big screen - no need to dig through the phone apps list. Open it with the center button of the remote.

A TV box needs no touchscreen, and the app does not ask for one. To make the app feel at home on the big screen from the start, pick the **TV / media box** device profile in the welcome wizard or later in **Settings** - it chooses sensible defaults for a remote.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: App banner on Android TV**
Android TV home screen, the apps row with the FastMediaSorter banner focused.

2 Move around with the D-pad or the arrow keys

Press the arrows to move the selection, and the center button or **Enter** to open what is selected. **Back** on the remote, or **Escape** on a keyboard, goes back.

As soon as a screen opens, the selection lands on the first real button or item - never on an invisible list container, where a press of an arrow would seem to do nothing. A frame shows where the selection is, but only when you use a remote or keys; when you touch the screen, the frame stays out of the way.

Each arrow press moves exactly one step, also in dialogs such as **Choose your device profile**, where a press once used to jump two rows at a time on a TV. Turn the screen or the tablet sideways and the order in which the selection moves stays the same as upright: dialogs and grids keep their order and their compact size in landscape too.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: D-pad selection in a grid**
File browser in grid view on a TV-sized screen, one thumbnail selected with the D-pad and outlined by the focus frame.

3 Answer every dialog from the keyboard

Every dialog and every panel that slides up from the bottom of the screen works the same way with keys:

- **Escape** closes it, like **Cancel**.
- **Enter** presses the main button, such as **OK**, **Save** or **Delete**.
- The arrows and **Tab** move from one control to the next.
- When the dialog opens, the selection is already on a sensible control, so one press of **Enter** is often all you need.

The buttons at the bottom of a dialog get a clear frame when they are selected with a remote, so on a TV you always see whether **OK** or **Cancel** is about to be pressed. Buttons are as wide as their words; in portrait, a long pair of buttons stands one above the other instead of squeezing its words. A dialog also closes by itself when the screen behind it goes away, so it never stays hanging over a screen that is no longer there.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Dialog button selected with the D-pad**
A confirm dialog, for example a delete confirmation, with the confirm button focused by the D-pad and showing its focus frame.

4 Use the keyboard shortcuts

With a keyboard attached, many commands have their own key. These are the defaults:

- **Space** - play or pause.
- **.** and **,** - one frame forward or back.
- **]** and **[** - jump 5 seconds forward or back; **Shift+Right** and **Shift+Left** jump 30 seconds.
- **Page Down** and **Page Up** - the next or the previous file.
- **Home** and **End** - the start or the end.
- **F** - full screen; **R** - rotate; **M** - sound on or off.
- **Ctrl+F** - search; **Ctrl+Z** and **Ctrl+Y** - undo and redo.
- **Ctrl+C**, **Ctrl+X**, **Ctrl+V** - copy, move and paste files; **Ctrl+R** - rename; **Ctrl+Shift+N** - a new folder; **Ctrl+S** - save; **Backspace** or **Delete** - delete.
- **Ctrl+B** - add to or remove from Favorites.
- **1** to **8** - the eight quick file operation buttons, in order.
- **Escape** - leave the current screen.

The media keys of a keyboard or a remote - play, pause, next, previous, fast forward and rewind - work too. Every one of these keys can be changed on the **Controls & Keybindings** screen - type *keybindings* into the Settings search to jump to its row; how to do that is in Controls and key remapping.

A key for a quick sort

The number keys **1** to **8** run the eight quick file operation buttons, so sorting a pile of photos into folders with quick sort becomes: look, press a digit, next.

5 Use a mouse

With a mouse, FastMediaSorter behaves like software on a computer:

- **Click** selects, a **double click** opens.
- **Right click** opens the menu of the item under the pointer.
- **Middle click** (pressing the wheel) adds the item to Favorites or removes it.
- **The wheel** scrolls.
- **The back and forward side buttons** go to the previous or the next file.
- A list item under the pointer lights up, so you see what a click will hit.

To select many files at once in the file browser or in the duplicate finder, press the mouse button on an item - or on the empty space next to it - and sweep over the others: everything you pass is selected, and the list scrolls by itself when you reach its top or bottom edge. On a touchscreen the same works with a finger once selection is already on: long-press one file to start, then slide sideways over the others. A slide that goes mostly up or down still scrolls the list as usual. More about selecting: Multi-selection and batch operations.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Selecting files with a mouse sweep**
File browser in list view on a tablet with a mouse, several rows selected by pressing and sweeping the pointer, the pointer over the last row.

6 Type with a keyboard or on the screen

A text field - the filter box, the Settings search, a name or an address - stays in view above the on-screen keyboard also on a wide screen or in landscape, where Android would otherwise cover the whole screen with the keyboard and hide the field you are typing in.

The small clear icon at the end of a field empties it at once, and you can tap straight back into the field to type again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Typing in landscape**
Phone in landscape, the filter dialog open with the on-screen keyboard shown and the filter text field visible above it.

What You Get

You can run FastMediaSorter from the sofa with a TV remote, from a desk with a keyboard and mouse, or from a car's D-pad: every screen starts with the selection on something useful, every dialog answers to Escape and Enter, and the most common commands have their own key.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Lost the selection frame?** Press any arrow key once - the frame appears on the current control.
- **Prefer other keys?** Change any of them in Controls and key remapping.
- **Watching videos with a remote?** The player's own keys and panels are in Watching videos.
- **Official help for your TV remote:** Google's Android TV help ↗ explains the buttons of Google remotes.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

SETTINGS

Controls and key remapping

Put any command on any key, button or mouse click.

GENERAL

Split-screen, freeform windows and foldables

The app next to another one, on a tablet or on an unfolded phone.

BROWSING

Multi-selection and batch operations

Select many files and act on all of them at once.

GENERAL, KEYBOARD & TV | All editions | RECIPE #03

All editions - split-screen, wide layouts and rotation everywhere; picture-in-picture where the video player is present

Split-Screen, Freeform Windows and Foldables - The App on Any Screen Size

FastMediaSorter fits the screen it gets: half of a phone in split-screen, a whole tablet, an unfolded foldable or a floating window. This page shows how to use each of them.

Why You'll Love This

Sometimes one app at a time is not enough. You sort photos while a chat is open next to them, you check a video while writing notes, or you unfold your phone and want the extra room to be used rather than wasted.

FastMediaSorter lets you do all of that: it shares the screen with another app, it spreads out on a wide screen, it can open a folder in a second window, and it keeps its layout in order when the device turns.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition.
- For split-screen or a freeform window: a phone, tablet or Chromebook whose Android supports it - most phones since Android 7 do.
- Optional: a tablet, a foldable phone, a Chromebook or a VR headset for the new-window feature.

1 Put the app next to another one

Open the recent-apps screen, tap the FastMediaSorter icon above its card and choose split-screen (on some phones the item is called **Split screen** or **Open in split screen view**), then pick the second app. FastMediaSorter resizes itself to its half and keeps working; drag the divider and it follows. On a tablet, a Chromebook or in desktop mode you can also drag it into a freeform window of any size.

Nothing restarts when the window changes size: the video keeps playing and the folder you were in stays open. How to start split-screen on your particular phone is explained in Google's split-screen help ↗.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Split-screen**
Phone in split-screen mode, FastMediaSorter's file browser in the upper half, another app in the lower half, the divider in the middle.

2 Let a wide screen give you more room

When the window is wide - a tablet, an unfolded foldable, a large phone, or any phone turned sideways - FastMediaSorter switches to its roomy layout: the main screen, the file browser and Settings spread out, and the collapsed groups of Settings stand in two columns. The switch depends on the width the app actually gets, not only on how the device is held, so a big phone held upright gets the roomy layout too, and a narrow split-screen half gets the compact one.

On the main screen, the buttons of the top bar, the programs panel, the streams panel and the resource type tabs line up along one left edge, in one column of finger-sized buttons.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Wide layout on a tablet**
Main screen on a tablet in landscape, wide layout, the top panels aligned to the same left edge.

3 Open a folder or a file in a new window

On a tablet, a Chromebook, a large display or a VR headset you can keep two places open at once:

1. Open **Settings**, the **General** tab, **General interface settings**.
2. Switch on **Allow new windows**. On a Chromebook, an Android XR device or a VR headset it is already on.
3. In the file browser or the player, choose **Open in new window**. The folder or the file opens in a separate Android window that you can place next to the first one.
   Switch the setting off and the action disappears; everything opens in the current window again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Open in new window**
File browser on a tablet with Allow new windows switched on, the menu open with the Open in new window action visible.

4 Keep watching in a small floating window

A video can shrink into a small window that floats over other apps while you do something else. Switch it on with **Enable Picture-in-Picture** and leave the player with the home gesture - the video keeps playing in the corner. The details are in Picture-in-picture and background play.

5 Turn the device without losing your place

Turning the device from upright to sideways and back keeps things where they belong:

- Dialogs and item grids keep their order for the D-pad and their compact size in landscape.
- **Compact elements** and **Sync interval (min)** in the General settings are there in both orientations - each of them used to be missing in one.
- In the **Management** tab, the two toggles that ask before deleting and before moving, and the two that make FastMediaSorter the phone's media handler and let it accept shared files, each stand as two full-width rows in portrait instead of two squeezed columns.
- The title of the player settings dialog no longer breaks into two lines in portrait, and its buttons sit in the usual place at the bottom.
- The edge bands of the screenshot edge gestures stay flush with the edges of the screen after a turn.
- Saving an account after signing in through the browser is safe even if the screen turns while the account is being stored.

The one screen that stays upright is the quick camera: it always shoots in portrait.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Settings rows in portrait**
Settings, Management tab, Destinations group in portrait, the confirm-delete and confirm-move toggles each on its own full-width row.

What You Get

FastMediaSorter shares the screen when you need two apps, spreads out when the screen is wide, opens a second window on a tablet or a Chromebook, floats a video over other apps, and keeps its layout in order whichever way you hold the device.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Use a mouse and a keyboard on a big screen** - see Keyboard, D-pad and TV control.
- **Want everything smaller to fit more on screen?** Switch on **Compact elements** in **General interface settings**.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GENERAL

Keyboard, D-pad and TV control

Using the app with a remote, a keyboard or a mouse.

PLAYER

Picture-in-picture and background play

Keep a video playing in a corner while you do something else.

GENERAL

Notifications, the startup splash and colors

How the app shows itself around the phone.

GENERAL, KEYBOARD & TV | All editions | RECIPE #04

All editions - each notification appears only in the editions that have its feature

Notifications, the Startup Splash and Colors - How the App Shows Itself

The startup splash, the notifications, the colors of content types and programs, private password screens and one language everywhere - the ways FastMediaSorter shows itself around the phone.

Why You'll Love This

An app does not live only on its own screens. It greets you when it starts, it tells you about a long copy in the notification shade, and it colors a photo differently from a song so you can tell them apart at a glance.

This page walks through all of these small meeting points, so you know what each one means and how to change it when you want it quieter.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in any edition .

1 Meet the startup splash

For the moment the app takes to start, the startup splash shows the FastMediaSorter logo and the name **Fast Media Sorter** fading in at the center, with a small author logo at the bottom center and a clock ticking below the logo - in the 24-hour or 12-hour style you chose for units. It disappears by itself as soon as the app is ready; tapping it does nothing, so a stray tap does not press anything behind it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Startup splash**
Phone, cold start of the app, the startup splash with the logo, the name, the ticking clock and the author logo.

2 Read the notifications - and silence the ones you do not need

Every FastMediaSorter notification carries the app logo in the status bar, so you always know where it came from - a file copy or a duplicate search no longer shows the music note of the audio player. Android groups the notifications into categories, and you can switch each category off separately. The categories are:

- **Audio Playback** - what is playing, with play, pause and skip buttons.
- **Scheduled operations** - progress of a scheduled operation.
- **Network Sync Settings** - background sync of a network resource.
- **Duplicate scanner** - progress of a duplicate search.
- **Link downloads** - files downloaded from a shared or pasted link; these pop up at the top of the screen.
- **Browse file transfers** - a copy or a move running in the background.
- **Element Downloads** - downloadable parts of the app, such as an extension.
- **Files from the watch** - a file received from the paired watch being saved.
- **Voice recording** - the quick voice recorder at work.
- **Save fallback** - a file could not be saved in the usual place and was saved elsewhere.
- **Flashlight shortcut** - a notification that turns the flashlight on and off.
- **SOS signal** - the SOS program is running.
- **SFTP server** - the app's own SFTP server is running.

To switch a category off, long-press any FastMediaSorter notification and tap the settings icon, or open the phone's **Settings**, **Apps**, **FastMediaSorter**, **Notifications**. Google's notification help ↗ shows the same on your phone model.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Notification categories**
Android Settings, Apps, FastMediaSorter, Notifications, the list of categories with switches.

Keep the progress ones

If you switch off the file transfer or scheduled operation categories, the work still runs - you just do not see its progress. Keep them on if you like to know when a big copy is done.

3

Recognize content by its color

Each type of content has one color, and it is the same everywhere: in the statistics chart, on the small badges of each row of the resource list and on the resource icons. Before, a screen could pick its own shade, so one type looked three different ways; now one color always means one type, and every color has a matching shade for the dark theme.

The same goes for programs: each has its own color and keeps it in the programs menu, the programs panel and its overflow, the quick-launch grid, the launcher desktop, the widget picker and the pinned widget on the home screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Content type colors**

Main screen, resource list with several resources, each row showing its colored media-type badges.

4 Hide password screens from the recent-apps list

Screens where a password may be visible - adding or editing a network or server resource, the stored-credentials editor in Settings, the sign-in page in the browser and the credentials barcode - show up blank in the recent-apps list and cannot be captured in a screenshot. The switch is **Secure sensitive screens** in **Settings**, **General**, **Authorization and accounts**, and it is on from the start. All other screens stay free to capture. More privacy settings: Privacy, passcodes and network security.

5 One language on every screen

The app speaks thirteen languages, and the one you choose is used on every screen - also on the few that used to follow the phone's language instead: the watch companion window, the screens that open from a widget, the barcode import from the Windows companion, the permission screens for camera and screen capture, the launcher's own screens and both VR screens. After a change, every cell and section title of the launcher desktop switches too, and the choice sticks - it does not slip back to the old language. Text that is not translated yet appears in English. In the same settings group, the **Unit system** row shows its value right next to its name, like every other row. How to pick the language and the units: Choosing the app language and units.

What You Get

You know what the startup splash, the notifications and the colors are telling you, how to quiet any notification category, and how password screens stay private.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Too many notifications?** Switch off just the categories you do not need - the work behind them keeps running.
- **Using the app on a TV?** See Keyboard, D-pad and TV control.
- **Backing up everything before a new phone?** See Backing up and restoring settings.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

GENERAL

Backing up and restoring settings

What a backup carries and how to restore it.

LANGUAGES

Choosing the app language and units

Thirteen languages, metric or US units, 24-hour or 12-hour clock.

GENERAL

Split-screen, freeform windows and foldables

The app next to another one, on a tablet or on an unfolded phone.

Setup, Companion and Sync

WEAR OS WATCH | FastMedia Wear | Watch | RECIPE #01

Phone side (Wear Companion) - Standard and noLegal; watch app - the Google Play version, or the full version installed from an APK

Putting FastMediaSorter on Your Watch - Installing, Pairing and the Wear Companion

Install the FastMediaSorter watch app, switch on Wear Companion on the phone, open its window, and add the watch to your resources - the first half of every watch feature.

Why You'll Love This

A watch on your wrist is closer than the phone in your pocket. With the watch app installed, you can play music, look at photos, open network folders and start the built-in programs right on the watch.

The watch app works on its own, but it gets much more useful once it knows your phone. The phone side of that link is Wear Companion - a program inside FastMediaSorter that connects to the watch and decides what the phone shares with it. This page gets both halves installed and talking to each other.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- A Wear OS watch built on Android 9 or newer - every Wear OS 3, 4 and 5 watch qualifies. Galaxy Watch 3, Galaxy Watch Active and Active 2 run Tizen, not Wear OS, and cannot install the app.
- The watch already paired with your Android phone in the watch maker's own app, such as Galaxy Wearable or Google Pixel Watch.
- FastMediaSorter on the phone in the Standard or noLegal edition. The other editions carry no Wear Companion.
- A few minutes and an internet connection on the watch or on the phone.

1 Pick the version of the watch app

The watch app comes in two versions, and they do not do the same things:

- **Google Play version** - a first, small release: Calculator, Stopwatch, the mini-game, the watch settings and the Programs tile.
- **Full version** - an APK you install yourself from the downloads page ↗. It carries everything described in this section: music, photos, network folders, the phone link, every tile and the watch face complications. It is the watch counterpart of the not-legal edition, so the parts marked *Sideload version only* on these pages need it. Both versions install under the same package name as the phone app, so the phone recognizes its watch partner either way. If Android shows a warning about the package, this page explains why and what to tap.

2 Install from Google Play

1. On the watch, open **Play Store** from the apps list.
2. Search for **FastMediaSorter** and tap **Install**.
3. Wait until the app appears in the watch's apps list.

   Typing on a small screen is awkward? Open Google Play on the phone instead, find the app and choose your watch as the device to install on - the watch downloads it by itself.

> Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Play Store on the watch**
> Watch Play Store, FastMediaSorter listing open, Install button visible.

3 Or install the full version from an APK

Sideload version only. A watch has no file manager to open an APK with, so the file travels from a computer over Wi-Fi with Google's free `adb` tool from the Android SDK Platform-Tools ↗:

1. On the watch, open **Settings**, then **System** or **About watch**, and tap **Build number** seven times to unlock **Developer options**.
2. In **Developer options**, turn on **ADB debugging** and **Wireless debugging**.
3. In **Wireless debugging**, tap **Pair new device**. On the computer run `adb pair : ` *with the address and code the watch shows, then* `adb connect :` *with the port from the main Wireless debugging screen. The two ports are different.*
4. Run `adb install -r FastMediaSorter_wear_release.apk`. The `-r` keeps your app data when you update later.
5. Turn **Wireless debugging** off again when you are done.

Google explains every screen of this in Debug a Wear OS app ↗. The computer and the watch must be on the same Wi-Fi network.

4 Switch on Wear Companion on the phone

The phone keeps its watch features out of sight until you say you own a watch.

1. On the phone, open FastMediaSorter and go to Settings, the **Management** tab.
2. Expand the **Wear Companion** group.
3. Turn on the **Wear Companion** switch – "Show the watch companion in the programs panel and menu".
   Below the switches, a line tells you whether the phone sees your watch right now: **Checking the link..**, then the watch's name followed by **– connected**, or **No watch on the link**. The same group holds the **How to install on a watch** button, which opens this documentation, and the **Wear Companion** button, which opens the companion window.

> Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Wear Companion in Settings**
> Phone Settings, Management tab, Wear Companion group expanded, switch on, paired watch line reads connected.

5 Open the Wear Companion window

Once the switch is on, Wear Companion behaves like the other built-in programs such as Calculator: it has its own entry in the programs panel and in the programs menu of the main screen. Tap **Wear Companion** there, or the button of the same name in Settings, and its window opens. It can also open in a new window, and you can take it off the panel like any other program.

The window has the usual title bar with a back arrow. On the right of the title bar sit the **Sync settings** button and a line that says when the phone and watch last agreed on their settings – **Never synced** on a fresh pair. Below come the **Watch operations** group with the things you do with the watch, then the watch settings groups, and at the very bottom two links: **All about the watch** and **How to install on a watch**.

Every group can be folded. A folded group shows a one-line summary of what is set inside it, so you can check the watch settings at a glance. On a wide screen or in landscape the buttons of **Watch operations** sit in two columns.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Wear Companion window**
Phone, Wear Companion window, toolbar with Sync settings and Last synced line, Watch operations expanded, Media types and Screen groups folded with summaries.

6 Make the watch one of your resources

In **Watch operations**, tap **Add or open the watch**. The first tap adds your paired watch to the resource list as a resource of its own – "Send files to the watch and pick up what it records" – so it appears on the main screen and in the lists where you pick a destination for copying and moving. Every later tap opens that same resource in the file browser; a second copy is never created.

If the watch is not reachable at that moment, the phone says **Watch not connected**.

7 Check that both halves see each other

Open the watch app on the watch. Its home screen lists the sections **Resources**, **Phone**, **Local**, **Streams** (when that section is on), **Apps**, then a row with the program you opened last and **Favorites** at the end.

Tap **Phone**: in the full version it shows the files of your phone, grouped the way the phone groups them. If the phone's Wear Companion switch is off, the watch does not pretend the phone is missing – it says exactly what to do: "The Wear Companion switch is off on your phone. Turn it on in FastMediaSorter settings, then retry."

Which network folders the watch gets, and how the two keep their settings in step, is the subject of syncing the phone and the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch home screen**
Round watch, FastMediaSorter home screen, section list Resources, Phone, Local, Streams, Apps visible.

What You Get

The watch app is on your wrist, Wear Companion is switched on and reachable from the programs panel, the phone shows the watch as connected, and the watch is a resource on the main screen that you can send files to.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Using a screen reader?** Every control of the Wear Companion window says what it is: each switch reads its name and state, the group headers announce whether they are expanded and can be opened and closed from TalkBack, and each button says what it does.
- **No Wear Companion group in Settings?** Your phone runs an edition without the watch link – Lite, Photos, Legacy, VR or FOSS. Install the Standard or noLegal edition to use a watch.
- **The watch says the phone is not connected?** Check the pairing in the watch maker's app first; the FastMediaSorter link rides on it.
- **Getting around on the watch:** every watch screen has a back arrow at the middle of the left edge, and a black-screen button (a phone with a dark screen) opposite it that blanks the screen. A double tap, a press and hold or the watch's own button brings the screen back.
- **Want the watch face too?** FastMediaSorter Watch Face ↗ is a separate, free watch face for Wear OS 6 and newer. Install it from Google Play on the watch – search for FastMediaSorter there, or use the Wear settings on the phone, which offer to open its page on the watch. Its round buttons appear together with the watch app.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Choose which network folders go to the watch and keep settings in step.

WATCH

Tiles and complications

Reach your favorite places on the watch in one swipe from the watch face.

WATCH

Playing music on the watch

Listen straight from the watch, with or without the phone.

WEAR OS WATCH | FastMedia Wear | Watch | RECIPE #02

Phone side - Standard and noLegal; sending network resources and syncing from the watch - the full watch version (sideload only)

Keeping the Phone and the Watch in Step - Network Folders and Watch Settings

Choose which network resources the watch gets, push them, read what the sync reports, and set the watch up from the phone's Wear Companion window - media types, slideshow, screen, color scheme, background and power saving.

Why You'll Love This

You already set up your NAS, your PC share or your home server on the phone - the address, the user name, the password. Typing all of that again on a screen the size of a coin is nobody's idea of fun.

Wear Companion sends those network resources to the watch for you, and it is also the comfortable place to set the watch up: which kinds of files it shows, how the screen looks, when it saves battery. Change something on either device, and the other one catches up.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and switched on - see installing and pairing the watch.
- At least one network resource on the phone: an SMB, FTP or SFTP folder. How to add one is in network and cloud sources.
- For sending resources: the full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- The watch and the phone near each other, with the watch awake.

1 Choose the resources for the watch

Open the Wear Companion window and, in **Watch operations**, tap **Resources for the watch**.

Only network resources can be sent - "Only network resources (SMB, FTP, SFTP) can be sent to the watch, so only those are listed. Tick the ones to send." Folders on the phone itself stay on the phone; the watch reaches those through its **Phone** section instead, and cloud storage never goes to the watch.

Tick the ones you want, or tap **Select all**. Nothing is ticked on your first visit: the phone never pushes your whole library by surprise. Your choice is remembered for the next sync.

No network resources yet? The list says so and points you back to the main screen to add one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Resources for the watch**
Phone, Resources for the watch screen, three network resources, two ticked, Select all button visible.

2 Push them to the watch

Back in **Watch operations**, tap **Push to Watch**. A short animation shows the resources flying over, and the result names what happened:

- **Sent 3 resource(s) to the watch** - they are now in the watch's **Resources** section, ready to open without the phone.
- **Removed 1 resource(s) from the watch** - you deleted a resource on the phone since the last push, and the watch let it go too. If you edited that resource on the watch after the phone deleted it, the watch keeps it and it is not counted.
- **Watch did not confirm. It may be off or out of range.** - wake the watch, bring it closer and push again.
- **No resources are marked for the watch yet.** - go back to step 1 and tick something.

The password travels with the resource, so the watch connects on its own the first time you open it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Push result**
Phone, Wear Companion, push finished, dialog shows sent and removed counts.

3 Or ask for them from the watch

Sideload version only. You can start the same exchange from your wrist. On the watch, open **Resources** and tap **Sync from Phone**. The watch waits up to ten seconds for the phone to answer; the back gesture works the whole time, so you are never stuck on a waiting screen.

If it cannot reach the phone, the watch tells you why: "No phone is connected. Pair your phone and install FastMediaSorter on it." or "Could not ask the phone. Try again." If the phone's Wear Companion switch is off, the watch names that switch instead of blaming a missing phone.

Resources you add on the watch travel the other way too. When they reach the phone, the Wear Companion window shows **Watch resources received** - for example "2 resources from Galaxy Watch" - with **Import** and **Dismiss**.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Sync from Phone**
Round watch, Resources section, Sync from Phone chip at the top, synced SMB and SFTP resources listed.

4 Edit on either side - the later edit wins

Changed the password of a resource on the watch, and the port of another on the phone? Both edits survive the next sync. Each device remembers when it last changed each resource, the sync allows for the two clocks not showing quite the same time, and the device that edited later wins. A resource that exists on only one side is added to the other, never deleted.

Your home server moved to another address? The phone sends every address it knows for a resource and marks the one that answers now, and the watch tries them in turn, so an SFTP share made on the phone keeps working on the watch.

Updated only one of the two apps? A sync between an older phone app and a newer watch app, or the other way round, still goes through: anything the older side does not know about is simply treated as not set, and every resource in the batch arrives.

5 Set up the watch from the phone

Below **Watch operations**, the window holds the watch's own settings, in the same four groups and the same order as the watch's **Settings** screen. Each switch row has the switch on the left, a title and a line that says what it changes on the watch; a **?** button next to some of them explains more.

- **Media types** - **Audio**, **Video**, **Images**, **Documents** and **Show streams**. Turn a type off, and the watch neither shows nor syncs files of that kind. Folded, the group lists the types that are on.
- **Slideshow** - whether photos move on by themselves, and the **Slideshow interval (seconds)**: 3, 5, 10, 15, 30, 60 or 120, or **Enter custom value**. Folded, it reads, for example, "On, every 5 s".
- **Screen** - **Home and Resources view** and **Files view** (**List**, **Grid 2** or **Grid 3**), **Watch background**, **Watch color scheme** and **Keep watch screen on**.
- **Other** - **Album art** (a cover picture for every synced song, which costs some watch storage), **Disable animations**, **Watch power saving**, **Keep playing in background** and **Player panel auto-hide duration (s)**.

Watch power saving offers **Off**, **Always on** and thresholds of 10, 15, 20 and 30 percent in one line you scroll sideways. The watch decides by its own battery, not the phone's.

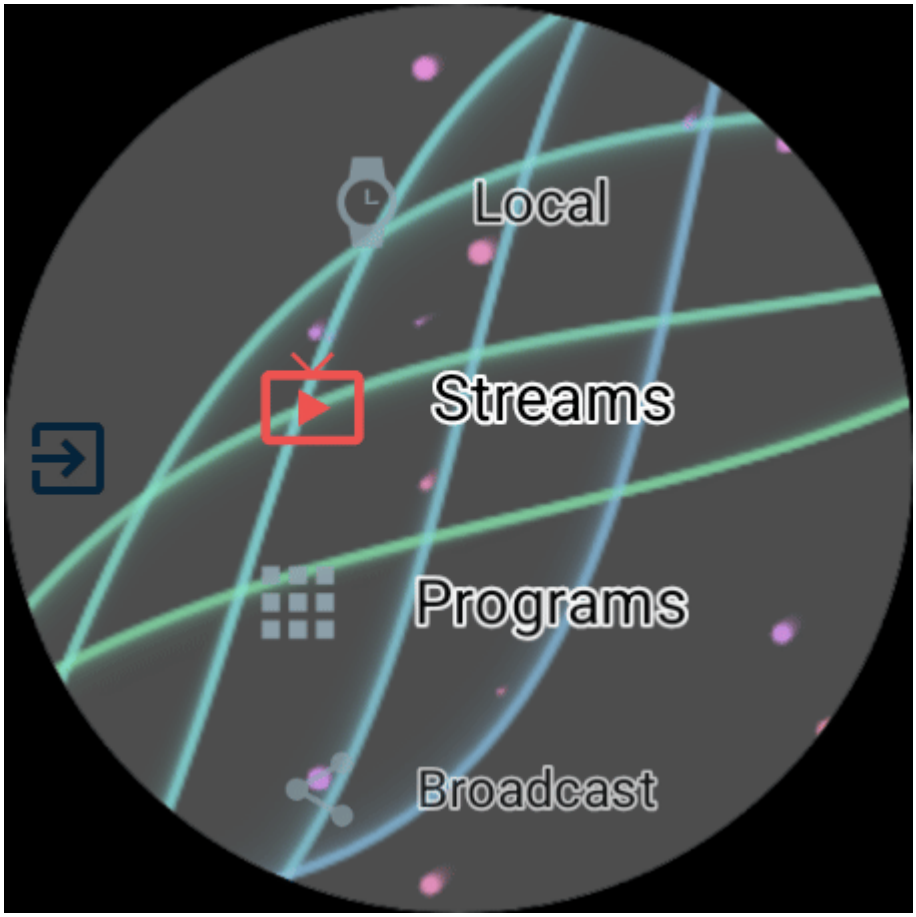
Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch settings on the phone**
Phone, Wear Companion, Media types expanded, five switch rows with descriptions, Slideshow and Screen folded with summaries.

6 Give the watch a color scheme and a background

In **Screen**, **Watch color scheme** offers eight schemes: **Dark**, **Light**, **Dark green**, **Dark blue**, **Dark red**, **Light green**, **Light blue** and **Light red**. They are the same families the phone app uses, so you can dress both devices alike. **Dark** is the starting scheme.

Watch background sets what is behind the lists on the watch: **Branded animation** (the moving waves), **Branded still**, **Your image** or **Empty (black screen)**. For **Your image**, tap **Choose image**, pick a photo, and the phone sends it over - "Sending the image to the watch..", then "Image is on the watch." A preview shows how it will look. The watch's settings screens always stay on a plain background, and a light scheme lightens the background too, so text stays readable.

You can pick both on the watch as well, in its **Settings**, **Screen**. A change on either device reaches the other.



The Light blue scheme on the watch.

7 Send the settings and check the sync

Tap **Sync settings** in the title bar. The phone sends the settings and waits up to fifteen seconds for the watch to report back what it applied. The line under the button - **Last synced:** with the date and time - moves only when the watch really answers, so a tap that reached nothing leaves the old time standing. If the watch stays silent, a message says: "The watch did not confirm the settings. It may be off or out of range."

After the first sync, **Watch operations** also names the watch app that answered, such as **Watch app: 2.62.0920.1415**. When the watch app and the phone app come from different days, the line reads **Watch app:** followed by both versions, the watch's and the phone's, in a warning color - a hint to update the older one. A watch app too old to report its version shows **Watch app: version unknown**.

On the watch, **Settings** shows the same sync line. When it has never synced, or the last sync is several days old, the line turns into the warning color and you can tap it to sync right there.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stale sync on the watch**
Round watch, Settings root, Sync settings button, Last synced caption several days old in error color.

What You Get

The watch holds exactly the network folders you picked, opens them without the phone, and looks and behaves the way you set it up - whichever device you set it up on.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **The watch lists a folder you deleted on the phone?** Push again: the result line tells you how many resources the watch removed.
- **Settings do not seem to arrive?** Look at the Last synced line - if it did not move, the watch did not answer. Open the watch app and tap Sync settings again.
- **Watch storage filling up?** Switch off Album art in the Other group; cover pictures are downloaded for every synced song.
- **Want one photo on the watch, not a whole folder?** Open it on the phone and send it with **Send to..** - see putting files on the watch.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Browsing files on the watch

Open the network folders you just sent, and the files of your phone.

WATCH

Tiles and complications

Pin a synced resource to a tile one swipe from the watch face.

WATCH

Installing and pairing the watch

The first steps, if the watch and phone do not see each other yet.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #03

Programs tile - both watch versions; Resource, Stream, Favorites and Sections tiles and all complications - the full watch version (sideload only)

One Swipe from the Watch Face - Tiles and Complications

Add the FastMediaSorter tiles to the watch's tile carousel, point a Resource or Stream tile at the place you want, and put the Last Resource, Favorites and Now Playing complications on your watch face.

Why You'll Love This

Opening an app on a watch means pressing the button, scrolling the apps list, tapping the icon and then finding your place inside. For the one server you listen to every evening, or the radio station you start every morning, that is too long.

Tiles and complications cut it to one gesture. A tile is a whole card you reach by swiping sideways from the watch face; a complication is a small spot on the watch face itself. FastMediaSorter offers five tiles and three complications, and each one opens the watch app exactly where you need it.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed - see installing and pairing the watch .
- For every tile except Programs, and for the complications: the full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal . edition
- For the Resource tile: at least one network resourc e on the watch - sent from the phone as described in syncing the phone and the watch , or added on the watch.
- A watch face that has complication slots, for the complications.

1 Add a tile to the carousel

1. On the watch face, swipe left to the tiles.
2. Swipe to the end of the tiles and tap **+** (**Add tile**), or touch and hold any tile to edit the carousel.
3. Pick one of the FastMediaSorter tiles: **Programs**, **Sections**, **Resource Tile**, **Stream Tile** or **Favorites Tile**.

The exact wording of the carousel editor comes from your watch maker; Google describes the standard steps in the Wear OS Help Center ↗. You can also add and arrange tiles from the watch maker's app on the phone.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Adding a tile**

Round watch, system Add tile list scrolled to the FastMediaSorter entries.

2 Programs and Sections - ready-made shortcut grids

These two need no setting up: add them, and they work.

- **Programs** shows the built-in programs of the watch - Calculator, Network Monitor, the mini-game, the voice recorder, system information and the others - as a grid of icons. One tap opens the program. It is the one tile the Google Play version carries too. While the stopwatch runs, the tile says so above the grid, and its **Open** chip takes you back to the running timing.
- **Sections** shows the sections of the watch app: **Resources**, **Phone**, **Local**, **Streams**, **Apps** and **Favorites**. **Streams** appears only while that section is switched on.

  A grid has room for seven icons. When there is more to show, the last cell reads **More** and opens the watch app, where the rest are listed.

The Programs tile.

3 Point a Resource or Stream tile at its target

Sideload version only. A freshly added **Resource Tile** says **No resource assigned**, and a **Stream Tile** says **No stream assigned**. Tap **Select Target** on the tile.

The watch app opens a list - **Select Resource** with your network resources, or **Select Stream** with your channels. Tap the one you want. From now on the tile shows its name, and one tap opens that resource or starts that stream, with or without the phone nearby.

If the list is empty, the watch says what to do: "No resources found. Add a network resource on watch or sync from phone." for resources, "No streams found. Add a stream or sync catalog from phone." for streams.

To change a target later, open **Settings** on the watch and then **Tile Targets**: it lists each tile with its current target, or **Not selected**, and lets you pick again. If a target is deleted, the tile says **Target no longer exists** until you choose a new one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Select Resource**
Round watch, Select Resource picker, three network resources listed.

4 Keep your favorites on a tile

Sideload version only. The **Favorites Tile** lists the files and channels you marked with the heart on the watch - your Favorites. Tap one to open it. Nothing marked yet? The tile says **No favorites marked**; tap the heart while a file plays to add it.

5 Put a complication on the watch face

Sideload version only. Touch and hold the watch face, tap **Customize** (or the pencil), move to the complication slots and tap the one to fill. Choose FastMediaSorter and one of its three complications:

- **Last Resource** - "Shortcut to open the most recently used media resource". Shows its name; a tap opens it.
- **Favorites** - "Shows favorites count and opens favorites list".
- **Now Playing** - "Shows currently playing or last played track". A tap brings you back to the player.

Which slots exist and how the editor looks depends on your watch face; the Wear OS Help Center ↗ describes the usual steps. The word "complication" appears only in that editor, never in the app itself.

On the separate FastMediaSorter Watch Face ↗, a free watch face for Wear OS 6 and newer, the up to eight round buttons are complication slots too: set each one in the face editor on the watch, or from the phone's Wear settings, and choose FastMediaSorter shortcuts or other watch data. The buttons appear together with the FastMediaSorter watch app.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Now Playing complication**
Round watch face with one complication slot filled by Now Playing, a track title visible.

What You Get

Your programs, your sections, the one network folder you use most, your favorite station and the track playing right now are each one swipe or one tap from the watch face.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A tile opens the home screen instead of the resource?** Update the watch app: tapping the Resource tile opens the pinned resource directly.
- **Tiles speak your language.** The Favorites tile and the grids follow the language of the watch app.
- **No Streams cell on the Sections tile?** Turn on **Show streams** in the **Media types** group - on the watch, or in the Wear Companion window on the phone.
- **Want a station on the phone's home screen too?** See shortcuts, the widget and the streams panel.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Streaming radio on your wrist

What happens after the Stream tile starts a station.

WATCH

Wrist programs and tools

Everything behind the Programs tile.

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Get the network resources a Resource tile can point at.

Media, Streams and Files

WEAR OS WATCH | FastMedia Wear | Watch | RECIPE #11

The full version of the watch app (sideload only). Copying music from the phone needs the phone app in the Standard or noLegal edition.

Playing Music on the Watch - With or Without the Phone

Put music on the watch, open a home server as music, check the volume before you tap, and play a track that keeps going with the screen off or the app closed - with the phone left at home.

Why You'll Love This

Going for a run, a swim or a walk to the shop, the phone is the first thing you'd rather leave at home. With a few albums on the watch itself, or a home server the watch can reach over Wi-Fi, the music comes along anyway: headphones paired to the watch, and nothing in your pocket.

This recipe is about getting music onto the watch and choosing it there. Once a track is playing, the controls are in players and viewers on the watch.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- Bluetooth headphones paired with the watch, or a watch with its own speaker.
- Music on the watch, or a network resource with music on it - SMB, FTP or SFTP.

1 Put your music on the watch

The simplest way is from the phone. On the watch, open **Phone**, then **Audio**, and play a track; open the track's menu and pick **Copy to watch**. The copy lands in the watch's own storage next to your other music, so it plays with the phone switched off and stays after you close the app. How copying works in detail - names already taken, not enough room, **Move to watch** - is in phone and network folders on the watch.

Everything that is on the watch shows up under **Local** on the home screen. Tap **Audio** there to see all your tracks at once.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Local music**

Round watch, Local section, Audio category open, a list of tracks stored on the watch.

2 Open a home server as music

A network resource on the watch can hold anything: holiday photos, films, albums. Tap it under **Resources** and the watch first asks what you'd like to browse, with **Video**, **Audio** and **Images** among the choices. Pick **Audio** and the list holds your tracks and nothing else.

The choices follow the kinds you have switched on under **Media Types** in the watch's settings. Leave only one switched on - just **Audio**, say - and the watch skips the question and goes straight to your tracks. If you switch every kind off, the list tells you so: **All content types are off in settings. Turn one on to see media here.**

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Pick a media type**
Round watch, Resources section, media type question after tapping an SMB resource, Video, Audio and Images rows.

3 See how loud the next track will be

A thin volume bar runs along the edge of the file list, showing the watch's media volume at the moment you open the screen. Glance at it before you tap a track, so a song doesn't blast into your ears in a quiet room.

The bar only shows the level; it doesn't change it. Turn the volume up or down in the player with the crown or rotary bezel, or with the watch's buttons.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Volume bar**
Round watch, Local Music list, volume side bar at the screen edge at about half level.

4 Play a track and let it carry on

Tap a track and the audio player opens with its cover art. When one track ends, the next one in the list starts by itself, and the list starts again from the top after the last one.

Want to put your wrist down and save battery? Tap **Screen off** in the player - the music keeps going. Switch on **Keep playing in background** in the watch's settings and a track keeps playing even after you leave the app, until you pause it. The watch then needs permission to show notifications; if it doesn't have it, it says **Turn on notifications to let playback continue in the background**.

Every button of the player is described in players and viewers on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Playing from the watch**
Round watch, audio player, local track playing, cover art and control row with Screen off.

What You Get

Your music lives on the watch or on your home server, and the watch plays it on its own - pick a track, check the volume, put your wrist down and go.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A server full of photos and music?** Keep only **Audio** switched on under **Media Types** and the watch stops asking every time.
- **Running low on space?** Music takes room fast - copy albums over one at a time, and delete what you've heard enough of (press and hold a track, then **Delete**).
- **Prefer the radio?** Live channels play on the watch too - see streaming radio on your wrist.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Streaming radio on your wrist

Find a live channel, pin it and listen right from the watch.

WATCH

Browsing files on the watch

Lists, grids and file actions for everything on the watch.

WATCH

Players and viewers on the watch

Every button of the watch's audio and video players.

WEAR OS WATCH | FastMedia Wear | Watch | RECIPE #12

The full version of the watch app (sideload only). Pins made on the phone and channels sent from the phone need the phone app in the Standard or noLegal edition.

Streaming Radio and TV on Your Wrist - Finding, Pinning and Playing Live Channels

Open the watch's own Streams screen, narrow thousands of live channels down with search, filters and sorting, pin the few you love, and play them on the watch alone - jumping back to the live moment after a pause.

Why You'll Love This

Internet radio is the perfect thing for a watch: no files to copy, no storage to fill, just a station and your headphones. The watch has its own catalog of live channels - radio and TV from all over the world - and plays them over Wi-Fi or mobile data without the phone.

The catch is size: many thousands of channels on a screen that shows four at a time. This recipe shows how to get from that to the two or three you actually listen to, in a couple of taps.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- A watch with Wi-Fi or mobile data, and headphones or a speaker on the watch.
- Optional: the phone app with the Companion switched on, to bring your phone's pinned channels and your own channels over.

1 Open Streams and let the catalog load

On the watch's home screen, tap **Streams**. The first time, the list is still being put together - the watch shows it loading until the catalog is ready, rather than flashing an empty screen at you. If the catalog was never downloaded, tap **Refresh catalog**; while it works you'll see **Updating streams..**, and if the network lets you down, **Could not update streams. Check your connection and try again**.

Don't see **Streams** on the home screen at all? Switch on **Show Streams** in the watch's settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Streams**

Round watch, Streams screen, toolbar with search, filter and sort, two-line counter, channel list.

2 Narrow thousands of channels down to a few

Three small buttons sit at the top: **Search streams**, **Filter streams** and **Sort streams**. They stay pinned in place while the channel list scrolls under them, and the first channel is never hidden behind them. Beside them, two small lines count the channels: how many your search and filters leave, over the size of the whole catalog.

- **Search** - type or speak part of a channel's name.
- **Filter** - first choose what kind of channel you want: **Video**, **Audio** or **Own** (channels you sent over from the phone). Tap the lit choice again to see everything. Below that, pick a **Topic**, a **Language** or one of the **Collections**. Topics and languages are shown in your own language, with the busiest ones first and the number of channels on each, and the chips wrap onto new lines so every name is readable.
- **Sort** - **Most used** (the default: channels you actually play on the watch rise to the top), **Name (A-Z)**, **Name (Z-A)** or **By media type**.

The watch remembers your filter and sort order when you leave the screen, restart the app or even reboot the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Filter streams**

Round watch, Filter streams screen, Video Audio Own rows, Topic chips with counts wrapping onto several lines.

3 When the filter leaves nothing

Narrow things too far and the list says so honestly: **No streams match the filter. Clear it to see the whole catalog.** One tap on **Clear filters** removes every narrowing at once - kind, topic, language and collection - and your channels are back.

This is different from an empty catalog. Downloading the catalog again wouldn't help here, so the watch doesn't suggest it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: No matches**

Round watch, Streams screen, filtered-empty message and Clear filters chip.

4 Play a channel

Tap a channel. A radio station opens in the audio player, a TV channel in the video player. For the time a stream plays, the watch asks for a fast network connection and lets it go again afterwards, so it doesn't drain the battery when you stop.

If the connection can't carry the stream, the watch tells you why instead of just going quiet:

- **Connection too slow for this stream. Move closer to Wi-Fi and try again.**
- **Watch is offline. Reconnect, then try again.**
- **Connection not verified yet. Playback may stop - try again if it does.**

If a station stops sending altogether, the watch stops playback to save the battery and says **The stream stopped sending. Playback was stopped to save the battery.**

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Connection too slow**
Round watch, stream player, message about a connection too slow for the stream.

5 The station line, and jumping back to live

A live stream has no beginning and no end, so where a song would show its seek bar and running time, the audio player shows the station's own details instead: its name, genre, the audio format and the bitrate, such as **128 kbps**. No bar you can't drag, no clock stuck at 0:00.

Paused for a phone call? When you press play again you'd normally hear the broadcast from where you left off, a few minutes behind everyone else. Tap **Jump to live** - right after the play and pause button - and the watch reconnects and plays what's on air at this moment.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Live station**
Round watch, audio player on a live radio stream, station line with name, genre, codec and bitrate, Jump to live button.

6 Pin the channels you love

While a channel plays, tap the pin in the player - **Pin stream**. The pin fills in, and from now on the channel sits at the top of the **Streams** list. Tap it again - **Unpin stream** - to let it go. The pin remembers the channel by its address, so it survives a fresh download of the catalog.

Channels you pinned on the phone come over to the watch too. The list then has three groups: channels pinned on the watch first, channels pinned only on the phone next, and everything else after them, each group in the sort order you chose. A channel pinned on both devices appears once, among the watch's own. Unpin a channel on the phone and it leaves the watch's phone group; a pin you made on the watch stays.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Pin stream**
Round watch, stream player, filled pin button after Pin stream.

What You Get

From a catalog of thousands you're down to a handful of pinned channels at the top of the list, playing on the watch alone, and always one tap away from the live moment.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Your own channels from the phone** are in the **Own** filter - send one over with **Send to watch** on the phone, as described in streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset.
- **Most used** learns as you go - after a few days, the stations you really listen to rise to the top on their own.
- **Pin on the phone, listen on the watch** - pins you make in the phone's **Streams** show up on the watch automatically.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Playing music on the watch

Put music on the watch and play it with the phone left at home.

STREAMS

Streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset

Send a channel from the phone to the watch and start it there.

WATCH

Players and viewers on the watch

Every button of the watch's audio and video players.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #10

The full version of the watch app (sideload only), with the phone app in the Standard or noLegal edition. Opening FileDO containers stored on a network resource - noLegal only.

Browsing and Managing Files on the Watch – Lists, Grids, File Actions and Locked Containers

Browse the watch's own files, your phone's media and your servers as a list or a grid, act on several files at once, see where each one landed on the phone, hand a file to the phone to open it there, and unlock FileDO containers on the watch.

Why You'll Love This

A watch screen is about the size of a postage stamp, so a file browser on it has to earn every pixel. On the watch, FastMediaSorter shows the same kinds of files in the same way wherever they live - on the watch itself, on your phone or on a network resource - and lets you do the everyday chores right there: pick a few files, send them to the phone, tidy up a name, delete what you no longer need.

And when a file is simply too much for a small round screen - a PDF, a long text, an archive - one tap hands it to the phone, which opens it in the right viewer.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- For anything that talks to the phone: the phone Wear Companion app in the Standard or noLegal edition with the phone switched on, and the phone nearby.
- For files on a network server: a network resource on the watch - see phone and network folders on the watch.

1 Open the phone's media by kind

On the watch's home screen, open **Phone**. Pick **Video**, **Audio**, **Images**, **Documents** or **All**, and the watch lists what the phone holds of that kind - no digging through folders first. Tap a file and the watch fetches it from the phone and opens it in its own player.

The same categories carry the same names and colors on the watch's own storage and on your network resources, so once you know one list you know them all. Walking the phone's real folder tree, searching and sorting are covered in phone and network folders on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Phone media by kind**
Round watch, Phone section, Audio category open, a list of the phone's audio files.

2 Choose a list or a grid of pictures

Every file list - the watch's own files and those of a network resource - can be shown as a **List**, a **Grid 2** or a **Grid 3**. Pick the one you like under **Files view** in the watch's settings; it is kept separately from **Screens view**, the look of the navigation screens, so a roomy list of sections and a dense grid of photos can live side by side.

In a grid, each cell shows a real picture. For a photo on a server the watch reads only the first part of the file, where the camera tucked a small preview, so thumbnails appear without downloading whole photos over the air. A file with no preview shows a large icon of its kind - a note for music, a film frame for video - filling the cell, and the name underneath runs over two lines instead of being cut off after a few letters.

In a list, each row carries a small colored icon of its kind beside the name. On a small watch where three columns would make every cell too small to hit reliably, **Grid 3** quietly falls back to two.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: File grid**
Round watch, network resource file list in Grid 3 mode, photo thumbnails, a music icon cell, two-line captions.

3 Pick several files and act on them at once

Press and hold a file to start selecting. Tap more files to add them, or tap **Select all**. The top line counts them - **Selected: 3** - and the menu offers what these files allow:

- **Send to phone** - a copy goes to the phone, the watch keeps its own.
- **Move to phone** - the watch removes its copy only after the phone confirms the file arrived whole.
- **Delete** - asks first, because **Deleting from the watch cannot be undone.**
- **Rename** - type a **New name**; a name already taken is changed a little, and the watch shows the final one: **Saved as ...**

Delete and rename work on files the app keeps on the watch. Files from a network resource (SMB, FTP or SFTP) are read-only here - you can open and send them, but not change them on the server.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Selected files**
Round watch, file list, three files marked Selected, action menu with Send to phone, Move to phone, Delete and Rename.

4 See where a sent file ended up

After **Send to phone** or **Move to phone**, the watch tells you for each file where it went:

- **Saved to ..** with the folder name - the file is on the phone.
- **Queued for upload to ..** - the phone is set to pass files from the watch on to a network or cloud folder, and the upload is under way in the background.
- **No destination configured** - the phone has nowhere set up to put files from the watch yet.

If a background upload fails later on, the watch gets an **Upload failed** notification naming the file and the place it was going to, so nothing disappears silently. Where files from the watch land is chosen on the phone - see the watch as a resource on the phone.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Where it landed**
Round watch, per-file result after Send to phone, one row reading Queued for upload to a network folder.

5 Tidy up photos and voice notes made on the watch

A photo you took with the watch or a voice note you recorded there lives in the watch's shared storage, and its press-and-hold menu offers **Delete**, **Rename** and **Move** as well as sending it to the phone. Because those files belong to the watch rather than to the app, the watch first shows its own system prompt asking you to allow the change, and the action finishes as soon as you answer.

If your watch has no such prompt at all, the action simply isn't listed, so the menu never offers something that would only be refused. The menu for one file and the menu for a selection always show the same set.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch file menu**
Round watch, Local section, press-and-hold menu of a photo shot on the watch with Delete, Rename and Move.

6 Open a file on the phone instead

Some files just don't belong on a wrist. In the watch's **Phone** section, tap a file the watch can't show - a PDF, a text file, an archive - or press and hold any file and pick **Open on phone**. Nothing is copied to the watch first, so the offer is there straight away.

- If the phone app is already on screen, the file opens there at once and the watch says **Showing on your phone.**
- If it isn't, the phone shows a notification naming the file, and the watch says **Tap the notification on your phone.** One tap on the phone opens the file in the right viewer.
- If the phone's notifications for the app are switched off, the watch tells you exactly that - **Phone cannot show it - turn on its notifications for the app** - so you know the fix is on the phone, not the distance between you.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Open on phone**
Round watch, Phone section, message Tap the notification on your phone after Open on phone on a PDF.

7 Open a locked FileDO container

A FileDO container is a file sealed with a password - its name ends in `.fd-sec`. Tap one in a watch file list and the watch asks for the password, masked as you type. Enter it and the file inside opens in the usual viewer or player. The unlocked copy lives only in the app's private space on the watch and is wiped the moment you go back to the list.

Tick **Remember password** before you open it, and from then on the watch tries that password first - a container sealed with it opens straight into the viewer. If the remembered password doesn't fit a container, the watch forgets it and says **The saved password did not fit and was forgotten. Enter the password.** The password is kept only on the watch, in its protected storage; it is never shared with the phone and never written to any log.

To seal or unseal files on the watch itself, switch on **FileDO encryption** in the watch settings (it is off by default). A single file's menu then gains **Encrypt FileDO** and **Decrypt FileDO**. Encrypting asks for the password twice, keeps your original and reports **Encrypted. The original is still here.** An empty password is allowed, but the watch warns that it protects nothing.

noLegal version only: a container on a network resource opens the same way, from both the flat list and a folder walk. The watch fetches it over SMB, FTP or SFTP, asks for the password, opens what's inside and deletes the fetched copy right afterwards.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Open the container**
Round watch, Open the container screen, masked password field, Remember password checkbox.

What You Get

Your files on the watch, the phone and your servers behave the same way: you can see them as a list or a grid of real pictures, act on several at once, know where each one ended up, and pass anything too big for the wrist to the phone with one tap.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Can't rename a file from a server?** That's on purpose - files from SMB, FTP and SFTP are read-only on the watch. Send the file to the phone and rename it there.
- **Want more of a photo per cell?** Choose **Grid 2** instead of **Grid 3** under **Files view** in the watch's settings.
- **Sealing something private?** FileDO containers made on the watch open on the phone too - the phone uses the very same format.
- **Looking for the players themselves?** They have their own recipe: players and viewers on the watch.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Phone and network folders on the watch

Walk the phone's folders, add a server on the watch, copy files to the watch.

WATCH

Playing music on the watch

Put music on the watch and play it with the phone left at home.

WATCH

Streaming radio on your wrist

Find a live channel, pin it and listen right from the watch.

Mini Apps and Health

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #04

Both watch versions, except the Extended signing fingerprint in System information and the shade lock during Water flashlight - the full watch version (sideload only).

Wrist Programs, Timers and Tools

The watch's programs turn the wrist into a small toolbox - a calculator, a Network Monitor, a mini-game, a stopwatch, a water flashlight, a voice recorder, System information, Tourist, Phone camera, Clipboard and an on-request screenshot - each reachable straight from the watch, with or without the phone nearby.

Why You'll Love This

Not every trip to the watch is about a song or a photo. Splitting a bill, timing a lap, checking why the connection is acting up, lighting your way in the dark, jotting a quick voice note - none of that needs the phone out of your pocket.

The watch's programs turn the watch itself into a small toolbox: a calculator, a Network Monitor, a mini-game, a stopwatch, a water flashlight, a voice recorder, and a handful of other one-tap helpers, each reachable straight from the wrist, with or without the phone nearby.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed - see installing and pairing the watch .
- For the Extended signing fingerprint in System information and the shade lock during Water flashlight: the full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition .
- For Phone camera, sending logs, the clipboard bridge and an on-request screenshot: the phone paired and nearby, awake.

1 Open Programs

On the watch, swipe to **Programs** to see every built-in tool as a grid of icons - **Calculator**, **Network Monitor**, **Mini-game**, **Stopwatch**, **Water flashlight**, **Voice recorder**, **Clipboard**, **System information**, **Tourist** and **Phone camera** among them, some only where this build offers them. You can also reach the whole grid from the **Programs** tile - see tiles and complications. Each icon is drawn in the same accent color that program carries on the phone, so you recognize the same program at a glance on both devices; the shortcut tiles for programs and sections use that color too, as a filled circle behind the glyph, with the glyph tinted light or dark for contrast against it.

The row on the watch home screen that always used to open the live broadcast now opens whichever program you opened most recently instead - the game, the water flashlight, the stopwatch, whatever it was - under that program's own name and icon. Nothing opened yet, or the broadcast itself was the last thing you opened? The row stays the broadcast shortcut it always was. A program this build does not offer never appears there, and the Programs tile itself is unchanged.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Programs grid**
Round watch, Programs grid open, icons in matching accent colors, home row beneath showing the most recently opened program.

2 Do the math - Calculator

Open **Calculator** for everyday sums without waking the phone. The keypad opens on its first row with every key at a full touch-sized target, the minus sign is drawn full-width so it is never mistaken for a hyphen, and clear and backspace sit on a red plate so neither is pressed by accident. The running value is right-aligned in its own color, like a calculator's own display register, and the operation you picked stays shown beside it - tap it again to repeat that operation on the next number. Its function menu lays its extra operations out in columns instead of one long list.

A tap on the result copies it to the watch clipboard - handy for pasting into a chat or a note on the wrist without going through the phone. Watches older than Android 13 show their own short confirmation; where the system already shows one, the watch does not repeat it. Tapping the display does nothing while it is showing an error.

The Google Play watch build draws the whole calculator inside the round glass; the full sideload build keeps its own established layout.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Calculator**
Round watch, Calculator keypad open first row, running value shown, copy confirmation visible.

3 Play the Mini-game

Open **Mini-game** from Programs for a quick round of dodging the shadows to the exit. The board is capped to the largest square the round display can draw whole, with room left under the header, so on a round watch every corner of the board and the level-finished button stay inside the glass. Score, level and turn count sit in a band around the board instead of stacking two lines above it.

Every round deals a fresh random board, so two games in a row are never the same, and restarting a level draws a new layout rather than a second try at the one you just left - reopening a save from mid-game still returns the exact board and position you left it at. Each new board opens with a short arrow pointing from your figure to the nearest exit, then fades on its own. The board also gets harder as you climb: the number of shadows chasing you rises in steps up to a cap, and the level you have reached is shown beside the turn count. Finish a level and the next one starts by itself after a short pause; press and hold anywhere on the board for a menu to skip the turn, restart the level or exit.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Mini-game**
Round watch, Mini-game board full size, band of counters around it, long-press menu overlay visible.

4 Time it with Stopwatch

Stopwatch runs one, two or four independent timings on a single screen - handy for timing more than one runner, or more than one pot on the stove. Each participant gets its own **Start/Lap** and **Stop/Reset** button, and **Start all**, **Stop all** and **Reset all** control every one of them together. A results page lists every lap you took for each participant, and the reading stays correct even if the screen goes dark while it is running. The stopwatch keeps running after you leave it: the watch face, recent apps and the **Programs** tile show it, one tap away from the running timing. The first start asks you to allow notifications for that; without them the stopwatch counts just the same, only without the indicator.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Stopwatch**

Round watch, Stopwatch screen, two participants running, per-participant Start/Lap/Stop buttons visible.

5 Light the way - Water flashlight

Water flashlight turns the screen itself into a light a wet wrist cannot switch off by accident: the display goes white at full brightness with the time and a short reminder over it, and touch and rotation stop doing anything else. Because a splash on the glass can register as a tap, no single input turns the light off - it takes three quick swipe-back gestures within two seconds, or a long press of a watch button on a watch whose button reaches the app. One stray back gesture, exactly what a wet glass produces, leaves the light burning.

The watch has no flash unit, so the screen is the only light there is. It lives among the other Programs and does not replace the watch's own water-lock mode, which no app can turn on for you.

Sideload version only: the full watch build also holds the system shade closed while the flashlight is open, so a wet swipe down from the top cannot reach quick settings.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Water flashlight**
Round watch, Water flashlight active, full white screen, time and reminder text overlaid.

6 Record a voice note

Voice recorder lets you record, play back and send a note without the phone in hand. Recording keeps running even if the screen goes dark or the watch slips off your wrist, because it runs as a background recording; while it runs, the status dot and the elapsed time carry their own color so you can tell at a glance that it is live. Play a finished note straight from the recorder screen or from any row in **My notes**, in the watch's own player.

Every note gets a readable title built from when it was recorded, and it appears alongside your other audio. Press and hold a note for the same file menu an ordinary file gets, including rename - which is what tells apart two notes taken a second apart - as well as send and delete. A setting chooses whether a finished note is sent to the phone automatically or held until you send it yourself; a note recorded out of the phone's reach is marked as waiting and leaves on its own once the link is back.

If the watch's own note store ever fails to open - a corrupt file, or an update it cannot read - the app rebuilds its list from the recordings still saved on the watch instead of losing them. The recovered notes wait for you to send them by hand so nothing goes out twice, and the list explains once that it was rebuilt.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Voice recorder**
Round watch, Voice recorder, My notes list, several notes with sent/waiting status shown.

7 Check the connection - Network Monitor

Network Monitor opens on a summary dashboard with your active link, local and external address, and a set of sections that each carry a live reading of their own - the sections wrap into a cloud of pill-shaped panels sized to their own text, so the whole set fits with far less scrolling than one full-width row per section would take. Every page shows its own title, its readings and the permission notice, and you leave a section with the usual edge swipe. The sections are **Wi-Fi** with frequency, standard and a restartable signal trend; **Mobile**, which explains itself on a watch with no modem; **Bluetooth**; **satellites** listed by constellation with coordinates, accuracy and fix time; **traffic** rates with resettable counters; **internet** with an on-demand reachability check; and **History**. Addresses copy to the clipboard with a tap, and each section can open its matching system settings screen.

History records a row only when the active connection actually changes, with the time of that change shown above the transport name, so a session that stays on one network leaves one row instead of twenty copies of the same reading. On a watch running Android 12 or newer, tap the permission notice to grant the access the Bluetooth and visible-Wi-Fi readings need - the fields fill in on the next reading.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Network Monitor**
Round watch, Network Monitor summary, active link and addresses at top, wrapped section panels below.

8 Read System information

System information, found in **Applications** rather than Settings, lays out its groups two fields to a row - a field too wide for half the screen keeps a row of its own - and answers questions no watch settings screen does: thermal state, battery temperature, voltage and charge left in mAh, uptime, boot count, whether the watch is exempt from battery optimisation, whether the app is background-restricted, and the reason its process last stopped; the full sensor list with each sensor's maker, power draw and resolution; chipset, instruction set, core count and low-memory flag; and the Wi-Fi bands and standards the watch supports. The phone connection line names each linked device, whether it is nearby or reached through the cloud, both node IDs and the pair's shared capabilities. Storage measures the app's own data, cache and cache reserve, not the whole watch. Long lists collapse to a count you tap open, collapsed group headings sit in a wrapping row of their own so the whole report is reached with far less scrolling, and a **Refresh** button re-reads whatever changes while the screen is open. A section this watch cannot answer says why instead of just disappearing.

Tap any value to copy it to the clipboard with a haptic tick; press and hold the sensor list to copy the whole thing at once. **Send to phone** carries the full report to the paired phone, which saves it as a text file next to its own logs and opens the share sheet from a notification - the watch tells you in words whether it arrived, including when the phone's notifications are off.

Sideload version only: an **Extended** section adds the SHA-256 fingerprint of the certificate the installed app is signed with, for confirming you are running a genuine build.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: System information**
Round watch, System information, collapsed headings cloud at top, Device and App sections expanded below.

9 Lock the screen and check Tourist

Tourist wraps your speed, altitude, compass, coordinates, satellites, steps, trip distance, sun times and heart rate into a set of content-width tiles you can scroll and promote to the top; the compass draws as a large rotating needle, and a **Grant access** button appears only while the location permission is still missing. Body temperature shows up where the watch itself reports a temperature sensor. Its Steps and Heart Rate tiles mirror what Motion Monitor and Heart Rate measure in detail - see viewing health and sensor info.

Swimming or running with a wet or busy screen? Tap the lock icon on the active panel to lock touch - the readings keep updating, but nothing you brush against the glass can change them. Only a press of a watch button unlocks it again.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Tourist**
Round watch, Tourist dashboard, rotating compass needle tile promoted to top, lock icon active.

10 Send watch logs to the developer

Something is not behaving and support asked for a log? Open **About** on the watch and tap **Send logs to developer**. The watch hands the log to your paired phone, which files it beside its own logs and offers both together by email - one message instead of hunting through two devices.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Send logs**
Round watch, About screen, Send logs to developer action, sent confirmation shown.

11 Watch what your phone's camera sees

Phone camera streams a live picture, with sound, from your paired phone's camera to the watch over the shared local Wi-Fi network - every lens the phone offers shows up on the wrist, switching lenses keeps the stream running, and **Stop** on the watch closes the camera on the phone too.

The full sideload build lets you arm this in advance from the phone's Wear OS settings, so the phone can stay in a pocket when you ask for the stream; the Google Play build confirms each request with one tap on the phone's notification instead. If a sideload phone has not been armed yet, the watch now says to start the camera broadcast on the phone, rather than the wrong advice to check the phone's notifications.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Phone camera**
Round watch, Phone camera live view, lens picker and Stop button visible.

12 Send text between the watch and the phone

Clipboard carries text both ways between the watch and the paired phone, one explicit action on each side. On the watch, open **Clipboard** to see what your watch's clipboard holds and send it to the phone, which drops the text straight onto its own clipboard and lets you know it arrived. From the phone, the Wear Companion window carries a matching action to send its own clipboard to the watch. Either side always states the outcome - taken, no device in reach, no answer, or the reason the other side declined - so a send never fails silently. Only text travels this way; files and pictures keep their own transfer - see browsing files on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Clipboard**
Round watch, Clipboard screen, held text visible, sent-to-phone confirmation shown.

13 Grab a picture of the watch screen

Need to show someone exactly what the watch is displaying? From the phone's Wear Companion window, ask the paired watch for a screenshot of itself. The watch photographs whatever the app is currently showing - never the watch face or another app - and sends the picture back the same way any other file from the watch arrives, announced by the usual notification. Nothing needs to be tapped on the watch itself; the phone states the outcome under the action - sent, no watch in reach, no answer, or the reason the watch declined.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch screenshot request**
Phone, Wear Companion window, screenshot action, outcome line confirms the watch sent it.

What You Get

The watch itself becomes a small toolbox: split a bill, time a run, check a slow connection, light your way, take a voice note, watch the phone's camera or grab a screenshot - all without waking the phone.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **A program you expect is missing from the grid?** It is not offered by this build; nothing on the watch is broken.
- **Stuck in Water flashlight?** A single swipe back does nothing on purpose - it takes three fast ones, or a long press of a watch button.
- **Lost mid-game?** Press and hold the board for restart, skip turn or exit, and a fresh random board waits on the other side.
- **Programs speak your language.** Calculator, Stopwatch, Network Monitor and the rest follow the language of the watch app.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

One swipe from the watch face

Pin the Programs grid one swipe from the watch face.

WATCH

Viewing health and sensor info

Heart rate, blood pressure, movement and environment readings.

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

The Wear Companion window these Send to phone and Clipboard actions land in.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #05

Motion Monitor's movement sensors and System information's Environment readings - both watch versions; Heart Rate, Blood Pressure and Motion Monitor's step readings - the full watch version (sideload only).

Viewing Health and Sensor Info

Your watch already carries a heart-rate sensor and an accelerometer against your skin. This page checks your pulse, estimates blood pressure, reads the Motion Monitor program's movement sensors and steps, and shows light, pressure and magnetic-field readings - general-wellbeing numbers, not a medical device.

Why You'll Love This

Your watch already sits against your skin all day with a heart-rate sensor and an accelerometer built in. FastMediaSorter reads what they are seeing and shows it to you in plain numbers - a quick check, not a full fitness suite - and says so honestly whenever a sensor cannot answer.

These readings are for general awareness only. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose or treat anything, and they are no substitute for a doctor or a purpose-built health device.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed - see installing and pairing the watch .
- For Heart Rate, Blood Pressure and the step readings in Motion Monitor: the full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegaledition . The Google Play version does not carry the health permissions they need.
- The watch worn snugly against the wrist, for a reading the sensor can trust.

1 Check your heart rate

Sideload version only. Open **Heart Rate** from Programs - its screen is titled **Heart rate check**. The reading starts on its own the moment you open the screen, which is also when the watch asks for heart-rate access, and keeps updating until you leave the screen or it goes dark; a **Measure** button is there too, in case you want to nudge a fresh reading without leaving and reopening the screen. Readings save once a minute as they come in, so a few minutes of wear leaves a row of values instead of a single number, and a trend chart of the recent readings appears directly under the current figure once there are two or more.

Cannot get a reading? The screen says exactly why instead of leaving you looking at a blank one: no heart-rate sensor on this watch, access not granted, the watch is not being worn, the Wear OS version is too old for the health service, or the measurement timed out or failed.

History keeps every past measurement with its time, up to the newest five hundred. From there, **History & Analytics** adds the average, lowest and highest reading and which zone your latest one falls in - Low, Normal, Elevated, Cardio, Peak or Max, with 60-100 bpm named as the normal resting range.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Heart rate check**
Round watch, Heart rate check screen, large bpm number, trend chart of recent readings below it.

2 Estimate your blood pressure

Sideload version only. Open **Blood Pressure** from Programs. Keep the arm still at heart level and tap **Record pulse wave** - the watch records a 30-second pulse wave from its optical sensor and turns it into a systolic and diastolic estimate, always labelled **Estimate** together with how many calibrations it rests on, how old the newest one is, and the model's margin of error.

The estimate needs calibrating first: open **Calibration**, start a real blood-pressure cuff on the other arm, and type in what the cuff reads while the watch records alongside it - each pair of cuff numbers and watch pulse is saved as one calibration, and the more you add, the tighter the estimate gets. A cuff reading typed in earlier versions of this screen now feeds a calibration rather than being kept as its own tracked value.

A reading can also be refused, always with its own reason: no permission granted, the watch off the wrist, the wrist moved during the 30 seconds, too weak a pulse signal, or too few calibrations recorded yet. **History & Analytics** adds the average, lowest and highest estimate and which category the latest one falls in - Low, Normal, Elevated, Stage 1, Stage 2 or Crisis, with 120/80 mmHg named as normal.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Blood pressure estimate**
Round watch, Blood pressure screen, Estimate label, systolic/diastolic reading, calibration count and error range shown.

3 Watch your movement sensors - Motion Monitor

Open **Activity & Motion** from Programs to see what the watch's movement sensors are reporting right now. The **Motion** group covers the accelerometer, gyroscope and rotation vector, each with its live reading, how many events have arrived, the delivery rate, and how long ago the last one came in - a sensor that stopped answering shows a growing age instead of looking exactly like a healthy one. A sensor this watch does not have says so, rather than sitting at zero, which is itself a real measurement. Every subscription stops the moment you leave the screen.

Sideload version only: the **Activity** group adds the step counter and step detector, asking for activity access only when you open that group rather than at startup. On the Google Play build, or if access is declined, the group names which of three reasons applies instead of showing a step count of zero: no such sensor, access declined, or not carried by this edition.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Activity & Motion**
Round watch, Activity & Motion screen, Motion group with per-sensor delivery stats, Activity group with step counter and detector.

4 Check light, pressure and the magnetic field

System information's **Environment** section - see wrist programs and tools for the rest of that screen - shows live readings from the light, pressure and magnetic-field sensors, and states plainly for each one whether it answered, answered but is not to be trusted, stayed silent, or simply is not fitted to this watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Environment readings**
Round watch, System information, Environment section expanded, light/pressure/magnetic-field rows each with a status word.

What You Get

A quick, honest read of what your watch's sensors are seeing - your pulse, an estimated blood pressure, how you are moving and a few readings about the room around you - with nothing hidden from you when a sensor cannot answer.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **These are general-wellbeing readings, not a medical device.** They do not diagnose or treat anything and are no substitute for a blood-pressure cuff or a doctor.
- **Blood-pressure estimate not close enough?** Add another calibration pair - the more cuff readings behind it, the smaller its margin of error.
- **No Heart Rate or Blood Pressure program in your Programs grid?** You are on the Google Play watch build - these need the full sideload edition's health permissions.
- **A movement sensor's age keeps growing instead of updating?** That sensor stopped answering; leaving and reopening the screen restarts the subscription.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Wrist programs and tools

The rest of the Programs grid, including System information's other sections.

WATCH

One swipe from the watch face

Pin the Programs grid one swipe from the watch face.

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Set up the watch, and the full sideload edition these readings need.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #06

Home screen, navigation and most of Settings - both watch versions; the Permissions screen, color scheme and background synced from the phone - shown only where the build declares the matching access; the Original layout switch - the full watch version (sideload only)

Finding Your Way Around the Watch App - Home Screen, Look and Settings

A tour of the watch app's home screen - its sections, its recent and now-playing rows, Favorites - along with the clock, the back button, the first-run walk, and the Settings behind how it all looks.

Why You'll Love This

A watch screen is small enough that a single resource can take up half of it. FastMediaSorter's watch home screen keeps that in check: everything opens as a grid of shortcuts sorted into a handful of sections, with the things you opened last, and whatever is playing in the background, sitting right at the top.

This recipe is a tour of that home screen, the settings behind how it looks, and the small pieces - the clock, the back button, the first-run walk - that show up on every screen of the watch app.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired with your phone - see installing and pairing the watch.
- For the Resources, Phone, Local and Streams sections, and for the Permissions entry in Settings: the full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- A file, resource or channel favorite on the watch, to see the Favorites section filled in.

1 The home screen: sections, shortcuts and view modes

The watch app opens straight on this screen, no header taking up space above it. What you see is a grid - two or three icons per row, depending on your watch - built from a fixed set of sections, always in the same order: **Resources**, **Phone**, **Local**, **Streams** (only while it is switched on), **Programs**, and, at the very end, **Favorites**.

Switch between **List**, **Grid 2** and **Grid 3** from Settings, and the whole home screen - not just the file lists inside it - redraws itself to match. A cell with nothing in it stays blank rather than becoming a dead tap target, and on a single-column list the sections simply become an ordinary row of chips.

Every cell across the watch, home included, draws a plain rectangle: a thumbnail fills it edge to edge, and an item with no thumbnail shows a small icon inside a thin frame instead of a picture-less plate, in richer, more saturated colors than before, so a video shortcut and a document shortcut read apart at a glance. Lists open with the first item flush against the top of the round glass rather than centered under empty space, and a half-full last row of icons centers itself instead of hugging one edge. On the round screens, an empty section scrolls so its message and button stay reachable on the curved glass instead of being clipped by it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch home screen**
Round watch, home screen, Grid 2 view mode, six sections visible with rectangular cells.

2 What's waiting at the top: recent shortcuts and what's playing

The row right under the top of the screen is not a section - it is a shortcut list of what you opened most recently: resources and the last stream channel you played, newest first, one cell per column. Open something again and it jumps back to the front instead of being listed twice; tap a shortcut to jump straight back in.

While something keeps going in the background - a track, a station - a second line names what is playing and offers **Stop**, or a tap to reopen the full player. Leave the home screen and come back, and it is still there for as long as playback continues.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Recent and now-playing rows**
Round watch, home screen top, three recent shortcuts and a now-playing line with a Stop button.

3 Favorites, always the last stop before Settings

Favorites is the one section guaranteed to be there, right before the Settings row at the bottom - a list of the files and channels you marked with the heart on the watch itself. Tap a row to open it in the matching player; each one also carries its own remove-from-favorites action.

Nothing marked yet? The section says so plainly: "Nothing marked yet. Tap the heart while playing a file." Marked something before the watch learned to remember how to reopen it? It is still listed, by its file name, and you can still take it off the list even though tapping it will not open it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Favorites on the watch**
Round watch, Favorites section, three marked files listed with remove-from-favorites action.

4 Getting around: back, close and screen off

Every screen that is not the home screen itself carries a back arrow at the left edge, level with the middle of the display - a visible affordance alongside the system's own back swipe, so you are never guessing whether a screen has one. The home screen shows a close cross or a minimize-style double chevron in that same spot instead, depending on whether something is currently playing.

The home screen's own bottom row carries two more commands: **Settings**, and beside it **Close app**, which ends the watch app outright rather than leaving it running in the background - the next launch starts fresh at the home screen.

From nearly any screen, a moon-shaped **Screen off** button sits opposite the back arrow, at the right edge. Tap it and the display goes dark without stopping whatever it was doing; a single tap on the dark screen does not wake it - it sends a thin ring spreading out from where you touched and shows the current time and date above that spot for one second, so you can check the time and leave the watch dark. During that answer the screen is at full brightness; while dark it sits at the lowest, and it returns to its earlier brightness once you bring the screen back. To bring the screen back: double tap, press and hold, or use the watch's own button.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch navigation controls**
Round watch, a browse screen, back arrow left edge, moon Screen off button right edge.

5 Always on: the clock, the battery bar and keeping the screen awake

Every screen of the watch app draws a clock at the top, with a thin bar underneath it, the same width as the clock's own digits. The bar fills to match your battery charge and changes color as a plain warning: white while there is nothing to worry about, amber at 25% and below, red at 10% and below. The pair disappears only where the screen is meant to go dark on purpose, such as a player with its controls hidden.

Turn on **Keep screen on** - in Settings, or in Wear Companion on the phone - and the display stays awake everywhere, the startup splash and the first-run permission pages included, not only once you reach the home screen. Leaving a player for an ordinary screen no longer quietly drops the hold this setting is keeping open.

One more small courtesy: screens with their own list - Favorites, the health and motion screens, the network monitor, About - reopen exactly where you left them, instead of scrolling back to the top every time.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Clock with battery bar**
Round watch, top of screen, clock digits with a white battery bar beneath them.

6 First launch: the welcome page and the permission walk

The very first moment the watch app starts, before even the system splash finishes, a full-screen frame shows the real "Fast Media Sorter" wordmark under the app icon and the tagline "All mine, here!" - the system's own splash can only show a picture, never real text, so this frame carries the words. The icon on both surfaces is the same one you tapped to launch the app.

On a brand-new install, the next thing is a welcome page: the app icon, a short "Welcome" greeting, and the tagline "Your media companion on the wrist". From there, a build that has anything to ask for shows one page per group of access it needs - media files, microphone, notifications, heart rate, physical activity, nearby devices - each with its own reason and its own system prompt, and a "Step N of M" line above every one of them. **Skip all** ends the walk in one tap at any point; skip one group instead, and the feature it covers simply asks again the first time you open it. The Google Play version, which asks for none of this, shows only the welcome page.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: First-run permission page**
Round watch, onboarding walk, Media files step, Step indicator, Allow and Skip chips, Skip all below.

7 Permissions, listed and explained any time

Settings carries its own **Permissions** entry, so you are never stuck guessing why a feature refuses to work. It lists every runtime permission this build can ask for:

- **Media & Files** - "Accessing media files for playback"
- **Microphone** - "Recording voice notes on watch"
- **Sensors & Activity** - "Reading heart rate and activity data"

Each row is marked **Granted**, or offered with a **Grant** button. Refused it for good already? The row opens the system's own **App Info** page instead, since the watch app can no longer ask directly.

The entry only appears in a build that actually declares one of these permissions - so on the Google Play version, which asks for none of them, Settings has no Permissions row at all, rather than an empty one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Permissions screen**
Round watch, Settings, Permissions entry, three rows with reasons and grant states.

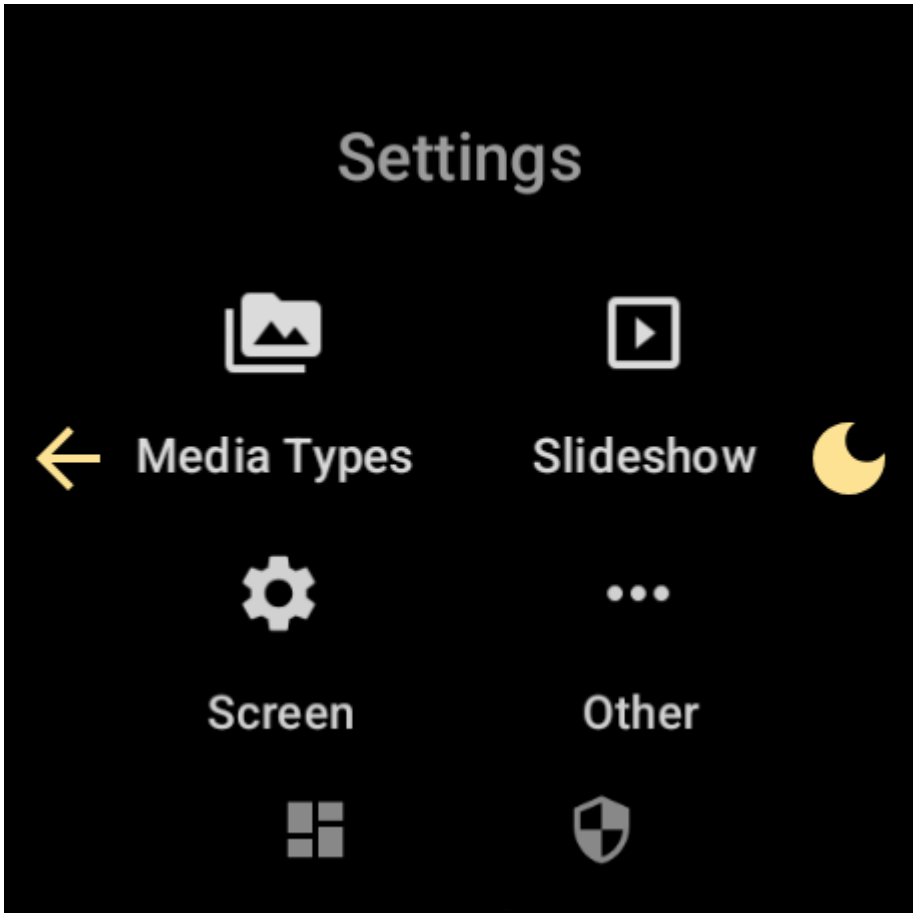
8 Settings, laid out to fit your wrist

Open **Settings** and every screen in it lays its controls out in rows of two or three wherever the display is wide enough - the same rule the file lists use for grid columns - so a short label sits two or three to a row while a longer one keeps the whole width to itself; nothing ever shrinks past a comfortable tap size. Every switch across these screens shares one look, and every icon target in the settings grid sits on a plain, see-through background rather than a filled button - a lighter, more watch-like plate than an ordinary settings list. Text across the watch app, settings included, is drawn from one consistent scale, so a setting label and, say, a reading on the athlete card come out at matching sizes.

Every set of buttons on the watch follows the same rule too: a menu or an action row - from a permission page's Allow and Skip to a settings action - centers itself and sizes to its content, each entry with its own icon, instead of stretching to fill the screen.

On a watch with a rotation sensor, **Settings** > **Other** carries an **Auto rotation** switch of the watch app's own. Turn it off and the screen stops turning with your wrist, without touching any system setting of the watch.

On the phone side, everything about the watch - the button that opens Wear Companion, its panel tile, its launcher shortcut - lives behind one master switch in a single collapsible **Wear OS** group on the Management tab; turn it off, and the whole companion disappears from the phone at once.



Settings, sized to the wrist.

9 Colors and background, your way

In Settings, under **Screen**, **Color scheme** offers the same eight families the phone app does - **Dark**, **Light**, **Dark green**, **Dark blue**, **Dark red**, **Light green**, **Light blue** and **Light red** - applied to every screen at once, no restart needed. The accent hues match the phone's own, so a "blue" scheme reads as the same blue on both devices, while the surfaces underneath are tuned for the watch's own display. **Dark** is where every watch starts.

Right next to it, **Watch Background** sets what sits behind the lists: **Branded animation** (the moving waves), **Branded still**, **Photo from phone**, or **Empty (black screen)**. A photo comes from the phone - see syncing the phone and the watch - and a picked one is dimmed automatically if it is too bright for the labels drawn over it; a dark photo or a branded background is left exactly as it was. Choosing **Light** also lightens that background layer and the veil drawn over a delivered photo, so text stays readable whichever background sits under it. The watch's own settings screens always stay on a plain background, whatever you choose for the rest of the app.

Both of these can also be set from the phone's Wear Companion window, and a change on either device reaches the other.

The FastMediaSorter Watch Face ↗ brings its own waves and drifting particles to the watch face itself. It is a separate, free watch face for Wear OS 6 and newer, with a large time, the date, battery bars and up to eight round buttons; install it from Google Play on the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch color scheme picker**
Round watch, Settings, Screen group, Color scheme list, eight options.

10 The layout from before the store review, if you'd rather have it

Sideload version only. Settings, under **Screen**, carries one more switch: **Original layout**. Turned on, it switches the watch app - every screen at once - back to the layout it had before its shapes were reviewed for the Play Store: content uses the full width of the display, and the round glass is allowed to cut the outer edge of things like the calculator's keys and the game board. That is the intended trade of this layout, not a fault in it. This build starts with **Original layout** on, and flipping it needs no restart.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Original layout switch**

Round watch, Settings, Screen group, Original layout row with summary text.

11 About: your web portal, two ways

About carries the app's version and build number, plus two links to the web portal - the same site this guide lives on. One opens the watch's own browser directly; the other, "Open on phone", hands the address to your paired phone instead, since not every watch has a browser worth using. Either way, the watch tells you what happened - opened, sent to the phone, or the message **No browser on this watch. Use "Open on phone"** if the first one has nowhere to go.

This whole watch guide - the one you are reading - lives on that same portal, in three languages, screenshots included; open it from **About** whenever you would rather read it on a bigger screen.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: About and Web Portal**
Round watch, About section, version and build lines, Web Portal and Open on phone entries.

12 The Google Play version and the full version

Two builds of the watch app exist. The Google Play version keeps to what the store allows: **Calculator**, **Stopwatch**, the mini-game, **Settings** and the **Programs** tile, starting on a plain black background, and it asks Android for no sensitive permission at all - no media, no microphone, no sensors. Everything this recipe covers beyond that - Resources, Phone, Local, Streams, Favorites, the Permissions entry - belongs to the full, sideload version. See the noLegal edition for how to get it.

One more small courtesy, on the phone side: wherever the app names your watch - its row in settings, a watch resource it creates, the sources list, a channel a watch broadcast adds - it uses the human name you gave the watch when you paired it, like "Galaxy Watch 6", never a bare model code.

What You Get

The watch home screen holds every section, your recent shortcuts and whatever is playing, all one glance and one tap away - and Settings, the colors, the background and the first-run walk all look and read the way you set them up.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Every set of buttons on the watch sizes itself to what's on it.** A menu or an action row centers itself and sizes to its content, each entry with its own icon, instead of stretching to fill the screen.
- **Nothing to tap in an empty cell.** A missing shortcut leaves its cell blank rather than turning it into a dead tap target - don't worry if a row looks shorter than expected.
- **Changed your mind about a permission?** Open the feature that needs it and the watch simply asks again - nothing is locked in by skipping it once.
- **Want the colors and background set up without touching the watch?** Do it from the phone - see syncing the phone and the watch.
- **Looking for what's inside Programs?** See wrist programs and tools.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Watching and listening on the watch

What opens when you tap a shortcut from the home screen.

WATCH

One swipe from the watch face

Put a Resource, a station or your Favorites on the watch face itself.

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Set the watch's colors, background and more from the phone.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #07

The full version of the watch app (sideload only) - the Google Play version has no player at all. See the noLegal edition.

Watching and Listening on the Watch - Players and Viewers

A tour of the watch app's three players - image, video and audio - plus its text document reader and sending what's on the watch to a TV.

Why You'll Love This

Opening a photo, a video or a song on a watch this small only works if the controls get out of the way until you actually need them, and stay reachable with one thumb when you do. FastMediaSorter's three watch players - the image viewer, the video player and the audio player - are built around that: tap zones instead of a screen full of buttons, the rotary crown or bezel doing the one thing you would reach for anyway, and a control row that reshapes itself to the size of your particular watch.

This recipe covers all three players, plus the on-watch document reader and sending what's on the watch to a TV.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition; the Google Play version plays nothing at all.
- Something to open: a file on the watch, or one browsed from a synced network resource or the phone - see browsing files on the watch.
- For sending video or a picture to a TV: the phone already connected to a Chromecast.

1 Viewing a picture: tap zones, fit and pinch

Open a photo and the image viewer shows you the picture alone, nothing else. Tap the left or right third of the screen to page to the previous or next picture; tap the middle to bring the controls up. Left alone, they hide themselves again after fifteen seconds. A picture that fills the screen, rather than fitting it whole, can be pinched to zoom and dragged around.

Turning the crown or the rotary bezel does the same job as pinching, in steps: each notch zooms in or out a little further, up to four times the picture's normal size, with a small haptic tick at every step. Turn it back down to normal size and the picture recentres itself.

A command on the same screen switches between **fitting** the whole picture in the frame and **filling** the screen edge to edge; whichever you pick is remembered and comes back the next time you open a picture.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Image viewer tap zones**
Round watch, image viewer, full-screen photo, left/middle/right zone hint overlay.

2 Starting a slideshow, and the viewer's own menu

A **Play**-shaped command on the viewer starts a slideshow right there, showing the next picture at once rather than waiting out a countdown; the same command stops a show that's already running, and turning the slideshow setting off anywhere also stops one that's open on screen.

The scale mode you just read about sits as its own button on the control row instead of hiding behind a second **more** button - and that is the rule behind every player's menu on the watch: whatever already has a button on the row is never repeated inside the menu. The image viewer's menu opens on **Back** and closes again with a tap anywhere past the buttons.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Image viewer menu**
Round watch, image viewer, command row and open more menu, Back as first entry.

3 Watching video: bezel volume, a long press to seek

In the video player, turning the crown or bezel changes the **media volume**, not the playback position, matching how the audio player and the platform itself treat a rotary input - and the current level is drawn right in the control panel while it is visible, so you are never adjusting it blind; turning the bezel brings the panel up if it was hidden. Seeking moved to a long press on the **Previous** and **Next** buttons instead, and both stay on screen even for a single file or a live stream, so seeking is always reachable. TalkBack announces each long press by its own name.

Leave the player and come back, or restart the app entirely, and the frame mode you last chose - **fit** or **crop-and-pan** - is still set; one memory covers both a file and a stream, since they share the same player. Never touched the button? It starts on fit.

With the slideshow turned on, a video that finishes opens the next one in the same set by itself, wrapping back to the first past the end - the same rule the phone app follows for video. With the slideshow off, or with only one file in the set, the player simply stops at the end instead.

The video player follows the same one-row, one-menu rule as the image viewer: scale mode lives on the row, the menu opens on Back, and nothing shown on the row is repeated inside it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Video player controls**

Round watch, video player, control row with time ring and volume readout visible.

4 Listening to music: cover art, and one tidy menu

Before you even open it: in the file browser, an audio file's cell shows its own embedded cover art - read straight from the file's ID3, FLAC or MP4 tags - with the track name written over it, so a cell with a cover and one without still line up neatly next to each other.

The audio player itself carries that same cover, the track controls and the queue. A finished track opens the next file of the set by itself and wraps to the first one past the end - including a shuffled order, which now plays on without a tap on **Next**. Turn on **Keep playing in background** and audio, a file or a stream, keeps going once you leave the app, until you pause it; pausing lets go of the notification that keeps it alive.

The audio player's own menu holds one list too: the commands its row has no room for, then the file actions the open file allows, nothing shown twice. **Screen off** sits right on the row instead of hiding behind **more**.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Audio player**
Round watch, audio player, cover art, track title, control row with Screen off button.

5 Turning the screen off while it keeps playing

The audio player, and an audio stream, offer their own **Screen off**: the display goes dark while the sound keeps going, and one tap brings the picture and controls straight back. A single tap on the dark screen otherwise only sends a thin ring spreading out from the touch point and shows the time and date above it for one second, so a stray touch in your pocket does not wake it by accident; a double tap, a long press or the watch's own button all bring it back properly.

The video player does not offer this - going dark during a video would hide the one thing its screen is open for.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Player screen off**
Round watch, audio player, screen off, fading touch ring, sound still playing.

6 Commands that fit the glass

All three players choose their control row by the size of your particular watch. A small round watch gets three main commands and two secondary ones, with the playing position drawn as a ring around the play button instead of its own time row; a larger watch gets three and three, plus the time row. Whatever does not have room on the row - playback mode, the stream pin, scale mode, screen off, the favorite button on a small watch, and file actions - moves into the menu behind **more**, so nothing becomes unreachable; every button stays at least 48dp on a side either way.

Prefer the layout from before the Play Store's shape review? The same **Original layout** switch covered in finding your way around the watch app also reshapes the players: two rows of four commands each, with the menu keeping only what those eight slots cannot hold.

However the row is showing, the panel that carries it hides itself after a set pause - adjustable right there with the auto-hide -/+ buttons, or from the phone's Wear Companion window, where the mirrored value always matches what the watch is really using, even an unusual number carried over from an older watch app.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Player control grid**
Round watch, small display, video player, three-plus-two control layout, ring position indicator.

7 Reading text documents on your wrist

A text file - stored on the watch or fetched from a network source - opens in its own reader instead of a refusal screen. Scroll it with a finger or the rotary bezel; your place and your chosen font size, **Small**, **Medium** or **Large**, both come back the next time you open it. A file too large to hold whole says so rather than pretending it loaded completely, and an empty file is told apart from one the watch simply could not read. A format the watch does not render at all still lands on the refusal screen - it just names the format now, instead of staying silent about it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Text document reader**
Round watch, text reader, scrolled page, font size row at the bottom.

8 Sending what's on the watch to a TV

From a player's menu, **Show on TV** sends what's playing to the Chromecast your phone is already connected to - a live stream, or a picture or video that came from one of the phone's own network sources. The phone owns that session: it is the phone that was pointed at the TV, so while it runs, the same entry reads **Stop showing on TV** and ends it from either device. Nothing has been chosen yet? The watch says so in words, "Choose a TV on your phone first", rather than failing quietly.

One real limit: a file stored only on the watch itself cannot be sent this way, because its address means nothing off the watch. Only a stream or a phone-sourced file qualifies.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Show on TV**
Round watch, player menu, Show on TV entry, Playing on your TV state.

What You Get

Three players that show and hide their own controls, a crown that zooms or turns the volume up depending on what's open, a reader for the odd text file, and one tap to put any of it on the TV your phone already knows about.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Long-press for seeking, not a drag bar.** In the video player, hold down Previous or Next instead of hunting for a scrub bar - it works even with a single file open.
- **A shuffled playlist now finishes on its own.** Automatic advance follows the shuffle order too, so you don't need to keep tapping Next to hear it.
- **Every menu is one list, not two.** A command already sitting on the control row is never repeated inside the player's menu - the menu only adds what the row had no room for.
- **Prefer bigger, fewer buttons?** Switch on Original layout in Settings > Screen - see finding your way around the watch app.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Finding your way around the watch app

The home screen, sections and Settings these players open from.

WATCH

Browsing files on the watch

Where a file, a resource or a channel comes from before it opens here.

PHONE

Casting and Live Broadcast from the phone

The Chromecast session the watch's Show on TV hands off to.

WEAR OS WATCH FastMedia Wear Watch RECIPE #08

Phone side - Standard and noLegal; browsing the phone, adding a network resource and everything else on this page - the full watch version (sideload only). Testing an already-saved connection also works in the Google Play watch app.

Opening the Phone's and Network Folders on the Watch

Browse your phone's folders and your network resources right from the watch, add a new one by hand, and copy, move or send a file between the two devices - or add the watch itself as a resource on the phone.

Why You'll Love This

Your phone already holds most of what you own - photos in a dozen folders, the NAS in the living room, the FTP share at work. The watch doesn't need its own copy of any of it: it can open your phone's folders directly, add its own network folders, and step into subfolders like a small file browser on your wrist.

It works the other way too. The watch itself can sit in the phone's own resource list, so a file can travel either direction without ever going near a cloud service.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app for most of this recipe. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- At least one network resource reaching the watch - sent from the phone as described in syncing the phone and the watch, or typed in on the watch itself.
- For browsing the phone's own folders: Wear Companion switched on and the phone nearby.

1 Browse what's on your phone, right from your wrist

Open **Phone** on the watch's home screen. It offers the same shape everywhere on the watch: **Recents**, **Video**, **Audio**, **Images**, **Documents**, **All** and **Browse** - the exact same names and colors your watch's own storage and your network folders use, so a category means the same thing wherever you meet it. **All** is a flat list of everything of that kind, newest first; **Browse** walks the phone's actual folders one level at a time, titled with whichever folder you're standing in - the section name only shows at the root. The same screen also lists your local favorites, so a file you starred earlier is never more than a scroll away.

Folders in **Browse** get a cover picture too, and the whole screen follows your chosen list or grid view. Thumbnails load reliably - a stalled first attempt quietly retries instead of leaving a blank square, and the top row stays clear of the search and sort icons so nothing overlaps them.

Tap a photo under Camera Photos or All Images on the phone and it opens right there on the watch - no detour through a path the phone never gave the watch in the first place.

If a category opens empty, the watch tells you why: a folder with nothing in it right now reads **Nothing here yet**, while a category no resource on your phone is even set up to hold says **No phone resource is set up to hold this type** and offers no pointless retry button.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Phone section**

Round watch, Phone section grid with seven categories and thumbnail folders.

2 Search, filter and sort what you're looking at

Every screen that lists files - your phone's, a network resource's, or the watch's own - carries small search and refine icons above the list. They tuck themselves out of the way while you scroll and come back the moment you stop, so they never crowd the files underneath.

Tap the search icon to type or speak a name; tap the refine icon to open **Refine list**, one screen with **Sort** and **Show only** as plain, full-label lists instead of a cramped row of icons. If a list holds only one kind of file, it says so - "This list holds one kind of file, so there is nothing to filter by" - instead of offering a filter with nothing to filter by.

Your type filter and sort order are remembered for next time, even after restarting the watch; a typed search is not, since a hidden query would silently leave you staring at an empty screen. The phone's own folders offer five sort orders instead of seven, because the phone never sends the watch a date for them.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Refine list**
Round watch, Refine list menu, Sort group and Show only group expanded.

3 Add a network folder without touching the phone

Sideload version only. On **Resources**, tap **Add resource**. Pick a **Protocol** - **SMB**, **FTP** or **SFTP** - and fill in **Name**, **Server Address**, **Port**, **Username** and **Password**, plus **Share Name**, **Domain** or **Base path** where the protocol needs them. Every field is its own full-width row showing its name and what's typed into it, one column whatever view mode you've chosen, so there's nothing to pinch or scroll sideways for.

Tap **Test** before **Save** to make sure the watch can actually reach it - the same check the saved-source menu uses later.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Add resource**
Round watch, Add resource form, SMB protocol selected, full-width fields.

4 Keep a saved connection healthy - and in step with the phone

Press and hold a saved source and the watch offers **Test** next to **Delete** instead of heading straight for deletion - so a share that stopped answering can be checked without retyping it. **Test** runs in the free Google Play version too, even though the form that adds a source in the first place does not.

When a connection genuinely fails, the watch names the reason instead of guessing: refused, timed out, wrong user name or password, or the computer isn't found on this network. Behind the scenes it tries every address the phone knows for that resource in turn and settles on whichever one answers - the same trick that keeps a moved home server working.

A network resource that only holds file kinds the watch cannot show says exactly that - "This resource holds only file kinds the watch cannot show. Open it on the phone." - rather than blaming a media-type switch you never touched.

Resources stay in step with the phone on their own: delete one on either device and it disappears from the other at the next sync; clear its tick on the phone's **Resources for the watch** screen and the watch drops it too, with no re-adding needed if you tick it again. That screen only ever lists SMB, FTP and SFTP sources, since those are the only kinds the watch channel can carry.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Test or delete a source**
Round watch, saved SMB source, action dialog with Test chip and Delete as the destructive action.

5 Walk into subfolders, on the watch or on a share

Both the watch's own storage and a network resource offer **Browse** beside their flat category lists. On the watch itself, **Browse** covers the app's own files plus anything copied over from the phone that the system's own media index never sees, and rebuilds the folder structure of your shared storage on the fly. On a network resource, **Browse** opens the same way over SMB, FTP or SFTP: subfolders are their own rows, tapping one shows its contents, the back gesture takes you a level up, and tapping a file opens the player. Thumbnails over FTP and SFTP load properly here too, instead of sitting on "Unavailable".

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Browse**
Round watch, local storage Browse entry, one folder opened showing subfolders and files.

6 Let the phone open something on the watch, and send it onward from there

Pick your watch in the phone's **Send to..** menu and whatever you have open there - a photo, a GIF, a video or a track - opens on the watch. If the watch app was closed and its screen dark, you'd once have found nothing until you opened the app by hand; now the watch raises a notification - **The phone sent something to open** - and one tap plays it straight away. With the watch app already open, the player just starts, no notification needed.

Once a file is in front of you on the watch, its own menu opens with **Send to..** - the very same list your phone offers: email, messengers, printing, the clipboard, the system share. It's built once on the phone, so switching a receiver off there removes it from the watch too, and a receiver the watch can handle by itself works with no phone nearby; one it can't is marked "via phone" and says so before it starts, never as a failure afterward.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Something arrived**
Round watch, notification shade, The phone sent something to open notification.

7 Keep a copy on the watch itself

A photo, track or video you've already opened from the phone, or one browsed over SMB, FTP or SFTP, can move in properly: open its menu and pick **Copy to watch** or **Move to watch**. The copy lands in the watch's own storage next to your other pictures, music and videos, so it shows up in the local lists afterward and survives closing the app. A name already taken gets a new one, and the watch tells you which.

A move only drops the original once the watch has confirmed the copy is whole and correctly sized. If the original can't be removed - the phone needs a confirmation dialog it can't show remotely, the file changed since it was copied, the share is read-only, or the phone stays silent - nothing is lost: the copy stays and the watch says **Copied to the watch - the original stayed where it was**. Not enough room on the watch refuses before anything is written, and documents never offer this, since the watch's own picture, music and video lists have nowhere to put them.

A file that came from the phone this way no longer offers **Send to phone** or **Move to phone**, since the phone still has the original; a file the watch recorded or shot itself keeps both.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Copy to watch**
Round watch, file menu open on a phone photo, Copy to watch and Move to watch rows visible.

8 The watch is one more resource on the phone

It runs the other way too: add your paired watch as its own resource on the phone's main screen, right beside your local and cloud ones. Browse whatever the watch holds, copy or move files onto it from any phone screen, and anything the watch sends back lands wherever you choose. Each transfer is capped at 32 MB and reports its outcome through the usual transfer notification, the same one every other copy or move uses.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Watch as a resource**
Phone, main screen resource list, Paired watch card visible among local and network resources.

What You Get

Your phone's photos, your NAS, the FTP share at work and anything you copy over live on the watch too - browsable, searchable, and just as reachable when the phone is out of the room.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Adding a network folder needs the full watch app.** The free Google Play version can still test a source that's already there - just not add one or browse the phone.
- **A folder full of odd files?** "This resource holds only file kinds the watch cannot show" means exactly that - open it on the phone instead, nothing was switched off.
- **Want the whole library, not one folder?** Send more resources over from syncing the phone and the watch.
- **Not sure which way of connecting your own devices fits you?** The media exchange portal compares the home network, the exchange server and live broadcast, and shows which program does what on each device.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Push network resources to the watch, or pull them back from your wrist.

WATCH

Browsing files on the watch

The watch's own storage, side by side with the phone's and the network's.

WATCH

Tiles and complications

Pin your favorite network folder one swipe from the watch face.

WEAR OS WATCH | FastMedia Wear | Watch | RECIPE #09

The full watch version (sideload only); the phone's Listen to the watch and Live Broadcast screens - Standard and noLegal.

Listening Through the Watch and Broadcasting from It

Listen to your paired watch's microphone from the phone, broadcast the watch's own microphone to listeners on the same Wi-Fi or into a Windows PC, and send a live broadcast from the phone straight to the watch.

Why You'll Love This

Your watch is already on your wrist wherever you are - in the kitchen, in the kid's room, out on a walk. That makes its microphone useful for more than telling the time: your phone can listen through it from across the house, and the watch itself can broadcast what it hears to anyone on the same Wi-Fi, including a Windows PC.

Nothing here needs the internet. Every session runs over your own local network, between devices that are already paired.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- The watch app installed and paired - see installing and pairing the watch.
- The full version of the watch app. *Sideload version only* - see the noLegal edition.
- The phone and the watch on the same Wi-Fi network - sound doesn't travel over Bluetooth.
- For turning the watch into a PC microphone: StreamsPlayer and, optionally, the free VB-CABLE virtual audio cable on the Windows PC.

1 Listen to your watch from the phone

On the phone, open **Listen to the watch** - from the programs menu, the quick-access panel, a launcher shortcut or a home-screen widget - and tap **Start listening**. The watch asks you to confirm; tap **Allow** on its screen and its microphone turns on, with an indicator that stays visible for as long as you're listening.

Want to keep what you hear? Use **Record watch audio** instead of plain listening, and the recording is saved to a file when you stop, or to the local folder if nothing else was chosen.

You never have to remember to stop it: a session with nobody actually taking the watch's audio for 90 seconds, or one where phone playback is paused or stopped from anywhere, ends itself. The watch's own notification carries a **Stop listening** button too, so the microphone never runs unheard by accident.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Listen to the watch**
Phone, Listen to the watch screen, idle state, Start listening button and caption visible.

2 Broadcast audio straight from the watch

Open **Broadcast** from the Programs grid, or from the watch's home screen if it was the program you last used. Tap **Start broadcast** and the watch opens its own microphone and serves the sound over Wi-Fi to anyone you share the address with - several listeners at once. The screen shows **On air** the whole time, and the ongoing notification carries a **Stop** button, so ending it never needs you to reopen the app.

A second button, **Screen off**, blanks the watch's display while the broadcast keeps going; a double tap, a press and hold, or the watch's own button brings the controls back. Broadcasting with the screen on is the hungriest thing the watch does - budget about a third of its battery an hour, so keep it on the charger for a long session.

Repeating a broadcast keeps the same connection address as last time, so its QR code doesn't change, and a phone that already has that stream simply refreshes the entry instead of adding a second one.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Broadcasting**

Round watch, Broadcast screen, On air label, Stop / Show QR code / Screen off buttons.

3 Share the address, and turn the watch into a PC microphone

Tap **Show QR code** and the address appears as a code sized to fit the round dial whole - scan it from any listening device. On a Windows PC, open the same address, or paste the QR code's text, in StreamsPlayer and it plays there directly.

From there, the watch can feed any Windows program: install the free VB-CABLE virtual audio cable, set StreamsPlayer's output to **CABLE Input** in the Windows volume mixer, then pick **CABLE Output** as the microphone inside whichever program you want to use - a call, a stream, anything that takes a microphone input.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Broadcast QR code**
Round watch, Show QR code screen, code sized to the round display.

4 Send your phone's live broadcast to the watch

Already broadcasting from the phone? Open its **Live Broadcast** screen while the broadcast is running and tap **Send to watch**. If the watch app is open, it starts playing there immediately; if it isn't, the watch raises a notification instead, so you never wonder whether the tap did anything.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Send to watch**
Phone, Live Broadcast control screen, live state, Send to watch button visible.

5 The session survives sleep, a service restart, and even a system kill

None of this needs anything from you - it's simply how the watch behaves now. A broadcast or a listening session holds the processor awake for as long as it's serving sound, so the watch going to sleep on your wrist or on the charger no longer cuts the listeners off; Wear OS has no per-app background-work switch to grant here, so the app asks for nothing and just keeps its foreground service running instead.

If the system kills that service anyway, a broadcast restarts itself rather than staying silently dead, and work the watch already received from the phone - a slow sync, a file transfer, a pin - survives the same kind of restart and still gets answered.

A very long, completely undisturbed sleep can still end a session; if that happens, start it again from the watch.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Broadcast after sleep**
Watch broadcasting to one listener, screen turned off and woken again.

What You Get

You can hear what's happening near your watch from anywhere on the same Wi-Fi, and turn the watch's own microphone into a broadcast anyone nearby - or a Windows PC - can pick up, all without leaving the room your phone is in.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Nothing plays on the PC?** Check that StreamsPlayer and the watch are on the same Wi-Fi network - the broadcast never reaches beyond it.
- **Watch screen off during a broadcast?** Double tap it, press and hold, or use the watch's own button - the broadcast itself keeps running the whole time.
- **A long call is draining the watch?** Broadcasting with the screen on costs about a third of the battery an hour - dim the screen or keep it on the charger.
- **Want a phone or a watch to go on air for your other devices?** The media exchange portal explains the routes between devices and marks what is not available yet.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

WATCH

Syncing the phone and the watch

Pair the watch and turn Wear Companion on, if listening and broadcasting aren't offered yet.

PLAYER

Chromecast casting and Live Broadcast

Start a Live Broadcast from the phone in the first place.

WATCH

Wrist programs and tools

Everything else waiting in the watch's Programs grid.

OpenXR

VR AND OPENXR | noLegal and VR | VR headset | RECIPE #01

noLegal and VR, on a compatible headset

Setting Up Meta Quest and OpenXR Devices

Which editions and headsets run FastMediaSorter's immersive mode, how to install it, how the 3D/VR master switch and OpenXR work together, and the VR Cinema, VR badge, immersive browser, controls legend and self-test you will meet before your first film.

Why You'll Love This

A phone screen shows you a photo or a film. A VR headset puts you inside it - a 360° panorama wraps all the way around, a 3D film gets real depth, and a folder of holiday photos becomes a little cinema of its own. FastMediaSorter's immersive mode turns any Meta Quest or other OpenXR ↗-compatible headset into that cinema, right from the files you already have.

This page covers the ground floor: which edition and which headset you need, turning immersive mode on, how the app tells a real headset from an ordinary phone, and the handful of screens - VR Cinema, the file browser's VR badge, the in-headset browser, the controls legend - you will meet before you ever press play. Playback itself and the floating control panel are their own recipes, linked at the bottom.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- FastMediaSorter in the noLegal edition or VR edition - immersive mode does not exist in the Standard, Lite, Photos, Legacy or FOSS.
- A VR headset such as a Meta Quest, or another Android XR / OpenXR-compatible headset. A phone-in-a-box viewer does not qualify - see the disambiguation on that term.
- For the noLegal edition: the APK installed on the headset the same way you would install it on a phone. The VR edition installs like any other headset app.

1 Which edition, which headset

Immersive mode is a headset feature, so it lives in the two editions that run on one: the noLegal edition, the general-purpose sideload build that happens to work on a headset too, and the VR edition, built specifically for one. Every other edition - Standard, Lite, Photos, Legacy, FOSS - never shows a VR button anywhere, because the capability is not compiled in. See the full grid in the edition comparison if you are choosing between them.

On the headset itself, FastMediaSorter checks what it is running on before it shows anything immersive: a real Meta Quest, a non-Quest Android XR headset, or a device with no XR support at all. Nothing here is a manual setting - plug in a supported headset and the VR controls simply appear; leave the app on an ordinary phone and they simply do not.

2 Installing on the headset

The VR edition installs the way any headset app does - from wherever your headset gets its apps. The noLegal edition is a sideload build, so on the headset it goes on the same way it would on a phone: copy the APK across and open it from the headset's own file manager, or use a sideloading tool if you already have one set up.

Either way, the very first thing worth doing after install is the welcome wizard: pick the **VR headset** device profile and FastMediaSorter pre-enables 3D/360° layouts and immersive controls for you, so you are not hunting through Settings before your first film.

3 Turn immersive mode on

Immersive mode has one master switch: **Settings**, the **Media** tab, section **3D-VR playback and controls**. Turn it on and every VR entry point in the app - badges, menu items, the immersive browser - lights up; turn it off and they all disappear together, because the same switch also flips the app's global 3D kill-switch behind the scenes, so the two settings can never disagree.

On a device with no XR support, the switch is disabled and the section shows an advisory instead: **Available on devices such as Meta Quest 3 and Android XR.** Pick the **VR headset** device profile in the welcome wizard and this switch is turned on for you automatically - no need to find it by hand.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: VR settings block**
Settings Media tab, 3D-VR playback and controls section expanded, master toggle on, Test Immersive button visible.

4 What is actually running the show

Under that switch sits OpenXR ↗, the open standard most VR and mixed-reality headsets speak - it is what lets FastMediaSorter talk to a Meta Quest and to other Android XR headsets through the same code instead of one app build per brand. When you step into an immersive session, FastMediaSorter hands off to a dedicated screen of its own with a steady frame loop built for a headset display, so the picture stays smooth while everything else - your file list, your settings - waits for you on the other side, unchanged, for when you step back out.

5 Launch VR Cinema from wherever you are

Editions: noLegal.

FastMediaSorter calls its immersive playback session VR Cinema, and it is never more than one tap away from a video, wherever you found it:

- From a video tile in the file browser, the tile's overflow menu offers **Open in VR Cinema**.
- From a video resource on the main screen, the same entry sits in that resource's own menu.
- From inside the flat video player, it is a badge and an overflow entry - covered in spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback.

If the headset is busy or not reachable at the moment, FastMediaSorter says so plainly - **VR Cinema is unavailable right now** - rather than leaving you staring at nothing.

6 Spot a VR app before you install it

Editions: noLegal.

Browsing a folder full of APK files on the headset? A small badge - a circular VR headset icon - appears in the corner of any APK tile that declares itself VR-capable, so you can tell a Quest app from an ordinary one before you tap it. FastMediaSorter reads this straight out of the APK's own manifest, so the badge is only there for files it can check locally; one sitting on a slow network folder shows no badge rather than making you wait.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: VR APK badge**

File browser grid view, several APK tiles, one carrying the small circular VR headset badge in its top-left corner.

7 Browse your files without taking the headset off

Instead of dropping you back to a flat screen every time you want the next file, FastMediaSorter can show your folder as an immersive browser - a 3D grid of tiles rendered right inside the immersive scene. Point the controller ray at a tile to highlight it and pull the trigger to open it; the thumbstick walks the highlight across the grid too, left and right along a row, up and down between rows, stepping to the next page when you walk off the side. Choosing a video starts it playing immediately, in stereo when the file has it, without a detour back through the flat file browser first.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Immersive browser**
Mirrored headset view, immersive browser grid of media tiles, controller ray highlighting one tile.

8 Learn the controls, right inside the headset

The first time you go immersive after installing, FastMediaSorter shows a legend of every controller binding: touch controllers (Quest 2, 3 and Pro), hand tracking with controllers set aside, a Bluetooth keyboard and a Bluetooth mouse, each in its own section. Any press closes it - you are not stuck reading it - and a **HELP** button on the HUD strip brings it straight back whenever you want a refresher, or long-press the Y button (or F1 on a keyboard) to reopen it yourself.

9 Leaving immersive mode

However you got in, one input reliably takes you back out: the B button on a touch controller, a key press on a Bluetooth keyboard, or the matching hand-tracking gesture - FastMediaSorter treats them all as the same "please exit" signal. There is a short grace period right after the first frame appears, so a stray button press while the picture is still loading will not throw you straight back out again.

10 Something not showing up? Test it and see

Editions: noLegal.

The same **3D-VR playback and controls** section in Settings has a **Test Immersive** button: it opens a sample 360° image in immersive mode on the spot, so you can confirm the headset and the app are talking to each other without hunting down a real 360° file first. If the session cannot start, FastMediaSorter says so directly - **Cannot start VR. Check that your headset is connected.** - and if it drops mid-session, **VR session ended unexpectedly.**

The self-test's decoder is built to survive a low-memory device rather than crash it, and if your own device has no sample media handy, FastMediaSorter ships one anyway: a royalty-free 360° image bundled with the app, used as the fallback whenever the diagnostic needs something to show.

What You Get

Immersive mode is on, the app knows your headset and your edition, and you know the handful of doors into it - VR Cinema from a file, a resource or the player, the VR badge on APK tiles, and the immersive browser for finding the next thing to watch without ever taking the headset off.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Switch not doing anything?** It is disabled on hardware without XR support - the advisory text under it says so, and no amount of retrying will change that.
- **Chose the wrong device profile during setup?** Reopen the welcome wizard from Settings and pick VR headset again, or just flip the 3D-VR master switch by hand - both end up in the same place.
- **Ready to actually watch something?** See spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback.
- **Want to know what every button on the panel does?** See controls in the headset.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VR

Spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback

How 360, 180, cylinder and stereo files actually play once you are inside.

VR

Controls in the headset

The floating panel, the controllers, hand tracking and haptics.

STREAMS

Streams on a TV, a watch or a VR headset

Open a live video channel straight into VR Cinema.

VR AND OPENXR | noLegal and VR | VR headset | RECIPE #02

noLegal and VR, on a compatible headset

Spatial 3D/360 Cinema and Video Player

Step from the flat player into VR Cinema, meet the 360, 180, cylinder and flat virtual cinema screens, watch stereo 3D detected or set by hand, keep walking your playlist with PREV and NEXT, and see how FastMediaSorter handles it when something along the way does not work.

Why You'll Love This

A flat screen is honest about what a video is - a rectangle. VR Cinema is FastMediaSorter's answer to what a video could be instead: a 360° trip wrapped all the way around you, a 3D film with real depth, or simply an ordinary video projected onto a virtual screen the size of a real cinema, floating in a dark room built just for it.

This page is about what happens once you are actually inside - the screen shapes, the stereo formats, the playlist that keeps going without a return trip to the flat player, and the handful of things that can go wrong along the way and how FastMediaSorter tells you about them instead of just going dark. Headset and edition setup is its own recipe, linked below, and so is the floating control panel you use once you are in.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- Everything from setting up your headset and OpenXR: a supported edition, a compatible headset, and the 3D-VR master switch turned on.
- A video - local files work everywhere; the immersive player only opens files it can reach directly, not ones still downloading from the network.
- For the full stereo and 360° effect: a video actually shot or authored that way. An ordinary flat video still plays, just on the virtual cinema screen instead of wrapped around you.

1 Step in from the flat player

Open any video in the ordinary flat video player and, on a headset with immersive mode on, a **VR** badge sits right in the controls row alongside play, seek and volume - tap it and VR Cinema opens on the spot. The same jump is in the overflow menu as **Open in VR**, for when you would rather reach for a menu than a badge.

For a file that is already stereo or panoramic, FastMediaSorter can skip the tap entirely: turn on auto-immersive entry and that kind of file launches straight into VR Cinema the moment you open it, no extra step. Either way, the flat player's state - where you were, what you had set - is captured before the handoff and handed back to you exactly as it was if you return to it, and a brief loading screen covers the transition while the first immersive frame decodes, so you are never staring at a half-built scene.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: VR badge in the player**
Flat video player, controls row visible, VR badge highlighted among play/seek/volume controls.

2 Four shapes for four kinds of file

VR Cinema chooses the screen to match what you are watching:

- **360°** - a full sphere around you, for an equirectangular photo or video.
- **180°** - a hemisphere in front of you, for VR180 and other front-facing fisheye captures.
- **Cylinder** - a wide, gently curved band for 180° content authored as a cylinder rather than a sphere, without the pole distortion a sphere would introduce.
- **Flat** - an ordinary photo or video projected onto a virtual cinema screen in a dark room, styled as **Cinema**, **Full SBS** or **Full OU** in the VR settings block.

Each one is a live OpenXR ↗ composition layer, not a flat texture stretched over a shape, so the picture stays sharp as you turn your head to look around it.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Virtual cinema screen**
Mirrored headset view, flat video playing on a curved virtual cinema screen inside a dark environment.

3 Video, playing for real

Local videos, stereo 3D and 360° alike, play through the same immersive pipeline with the seek position picked up exactly where the flat player's snapshot left off, so switching between flat and immersive mid-film never costs you your place.

4 Stereo 3D – detected, or set by hand

Side-by-side and over-under are the two stereo layouts FastMediaSorter understands, rendered per eye so each one actually sees its own half of the frame. It works out which one a file uses, and whether the file is stereo at all, from three places in order: a marker in the filename, the file's own embedded spatial metadata, and - optionally - an aspect-ratio guess for files that carry neither. A video whose name was changed after downloading no longer has to fall back to flat and mono just because the filename lost its marker - the metadata still carries the truth.

Got it wrong, or just prefer a different layout for one particular file? Override it by hand in that file's own settings, and FastMediaSorter remembers your choice and uses it again next time, ahead of anything auto-detection would have picked.

Once the picture is stereo, a slider on the floating panel - see the controls in the headset - adjusts how much depth the 3D effect has in real time, no need to leave the film to retune it.

5 A playlist that keeps going

VR Cinema does not play one file in isolation - it carries the whole ordered list of images and videos you came from, so **PREV** and **NEXT** on the panel walk the same folder or resource you were already browsing, in the same order, without a return trip to the flat screen. When you reach either end, FastMediaSorter tells you plainly - **First file** or **Last file** - instead of looping silently or doing nothing.

6 Subtitles, right in front of you

Editions: noLegal.

A video's subtitle track follows you into the headset: cues render right in the immersive scene, timed against the same playback clock as the picture and the sound, so you are not choosing between reading captions and staying immersed.

7 When something goes wrong

A file VR Cinema cannot open at all says so honestly - **This file type is not ready for VR yet** - and a stereo or panoramic file that briefly fails to decode gets the same courtesy rather than a silent freeze. If immersive mode itself cannot start, FastMediaSorter stops playback outright instead of leaving audio running behind a black screen - **Immersive mode failed to start. Playback was stopped to avoid background audio.**

A playback error mid-session tears down cleanly: the video surface switches off, the panel stops mirroring a player that is no longer running, and the next file you try does not trip over anything left behind by the last one. And if immersive mode is unavailable for a file that would otherwise qualify, you land in flat mode instead of nowhere - **Immersive mode unavailable - playing in flat mode. You can change the 3D format in player settings.**

What You Get

From a tap on the VR badge to a full 360° film with the depth tuned to your taste, VR Cinema plays what you already have - stereo, panoramic or perfectly ordinary - on the screen shape that suits it, keeps walking your playlist with PREV and NEXT, carries your subtitles with you, and tells you plainly on the rare occasion something does not work.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **No VR badge in the player?** Turn on the 3D-VR master switch in Settings, the Media tab - see setting up your headset and OpenXR.
- **Prefer VR Cinema to open by itself?** Turn on auto-immersive entry so stereo and panoramic files skip the badge entirely.
- **Not sure the layout is right?** Override the stereo format for that one file instead of waiting on auto-detection - see the controls panel's session settings in controls in the headset.
- **Want the panel and its buttons explained end to end?** See controls in the headset.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VR

Controls in the headset

The floating panel, the controllers, hand tracking and haptics.

VR

Setting up your headset and OpenXR

Editions, headsets, the master switch and VR Cinema's entry points.

VIDEO

Subtitles, audio tracks and 3D

How subtitles and stereo formats work in the flat player.

VR AND OPENXR noLegal and VR VR headset RECIPE #03

noLegal and VR, on a compatible headset

Controls in the Headset: the Floating Panel, Controllers and Hands

The floating control panel, its head-locked banner, the session settings behind the menu button, hiding and summoning the strip, thumbstick seeking with the grip modifier, controller haptics, hand tracking, and the FPS overlay - every control VR Cinema puts within reach.

Why You'll Love This

There is no touchscreen inside a headset. Every button VR Cinema offers - play, seek, subtitles, the depth of a 3D film - has to live somewhere you can see it without breaking the scene and reach it without a keyboard or a mouse. FastMediaSorter's answer is a panel that floats in front of you, aimed at with a controller ray or a pinch of the fingers, that shows only the buttons that make sense for whatever is currently playing and gets out of the way the moment you stop looking at it.

This page is the controls themselves, end to end: the banner that always tells you what you are watching, the floating panel and its buttons, the settings panel behind the menu button, and the controller, thumbstick, haptic and hand-tracking input that drives all of it. Getting into VR Cinema in the first place is covered in spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback.

Before You Begin: Ingredients & Prerequisites

- Everything from setting up your headset and OpenXR
- a spatial 3D/360 cinema and video and playback: the headset, the edition, and something already playing in VR Cinema.
- A pair of touch controllers for the fullest set of controls; hand tracking and a Bluetooth keyboard or mouse work too, with a smaller set of gestures.

1 The banner that always tells you what is playing

A banner stays locked to your head rather than to the scene, so it is always readable no matter which way you turn: the current filename, the projection FastMediaSorter detected - 360°, 180°, cylinder or flat - and the stereo layout it is using. If something about the file goes wrong, the same banner turns red instead of silently vanishing, so you always know at a glance whether what you are looking at is actually working.

2 The floating control panel

The main controls live on a world-locked panel that hangs in front of you rather than moving with your head: point the controller ray at a button to highlight it, and pull the trigger to click it, the same ray-and-trigger motion the immersive browser uses. Play/Pause, Previous, Next, and sliders for Volume and depth all sit here, and the panel's own **PREV/NEXT** buttons walk the whole resource list you arrived from, not just the one file.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Floating control panel**
Mirrored headset view, floating control panel with playback buttons and sliders, controller ray pointing at one button.

3 It only shows what applies

The panel does not show every control for every file. An audio-track picker appears only when a file actually has more than one track to choose from; a subtitle picker appears only when subtitles exist; the stereo depth slider appears only for stereo content. Whatever controls do not apply simply are not there, and the remaining ones spread out to use the width that frees up, so the panel never looks half-empty or crowded depending on what you happen to be watching.

4 A seek bar you can actually drag

The panel carries a position bar with the elapsed and total time shown beside it - point the controller ray at it and drag to seek anywhere in the film, the same way you would drag a seek bar with a finger on a phone.

5 Session settings, without pausing anything

The left controller's menu button opens **Session settings** - a second panel for everything you would otherwise have to leave the film to change: **Layout** (Mono, Side by side, Over-under), **Projection** (Mono, 180°, 360°, Cylinder - the same modes covered in the four screen shapes), **Panel distance**, **Panel size**, **Subtitles** (On/Off) and **Resume position**. Every change here applies to this session only, and playback never stops while you make it - close the panel with the menu button again and you are exactly where you left off.

Image Bookmark [Planned] **Screenshot: Session settings panel**
Mirrored headset view, session settings panel open with layout/projection spinners and distance/size/subtitles/resume rows.

6 Hide it, summon it, or let it hide itself

The HUD strip carries **HIDE** and **EXIT** buttons at opposite ends, so a slip of the ray never triggers the wrong one. **HIDE** removes the whole strip from view, and a single trigger pull - pointed at nothing in particular - summons it straight back, no need to aim at where it used to be.

Left alone, the strip does the same thing on its own: after 15 seconds with no ray hovering over it, it fades away so it does not sit between you and the film; any hover or click resets that countdown, and the same trigger-pull summon brings it back exactly as if you had pressed HIDE yourself.

7 Thumbstick seeking, and the grip modifier

Push the thumbstick and the film seeks ten seconds a step - no need to aim at the seek bar for a quick nudge forward or back. Hold the grip button while you push the same stick and it steps between files instead, so you can flip through a folder with the same hand motion you already use to seek, without ever reaching for the panel's PREV/NEXT buttons.

8 Haptics, and playing hands-free

Every click on the panel gives the controller a short vibration, and hovering the ray over a button gives it a lighter one - a bit of feedback that does not depend on looking at exactly the right pixel. Set the controllers aside and FastMediaSorter still works: hand tracking recognizes a pinch as a click, aiming the ray with your hand the same way you would with a controller, and it processes hand gestures for leaving the session too, so nothing here strictly requires holding anything.

9 Curious how smooth it is? Turn on the FPS overlay

Show FPS overlay, in the same VR settings block covered in setting up your headset and OpenXR, draws a live, smoothed frame-rate counter over the immersive view - a diagnostic for the curious rather than something you need in everyday use, and it is off by default so it never gets in the way of the film.

What You Get

Every control VR Cinema offers has a place on the floating panel or the session settings behind it, reachable with a controller ray, a hand-tracked pinch, or a thumbstick nudge, adapting itself to what is actually playing and staying out of your view until you ask for it.

Tips and Troubleshooting

- **Panel gone and you did not hide it?** It auto-hides after 15 seconds of no interaction - a single trigger pull anywhere brings it straight back.
- **Session settings and Settings in the app are not the same thing.** Session settings only affects the film playing right now; the app's own Settings screen is covered in setting up your headset and OpenXR.
- **No controllers on hand?** Set them down - hand tracking clicks with a pinch and points with the same hand you would otherwise hold a controller in.
- **Need a refresher on which button does what?** The controls legend is one long-press of Y (or F1 on a keyboard) away - see setting up your headset and OpenXR.

What to Try Next: Related Recipes

VR

Spatial 3D/360 cinema and video playback

The screens, the stereo formats and the playlist this panel controls.

VR

Setting up your headset and OpenXR

Editions, headsets, the master switch and the controls legend.

VIDEO

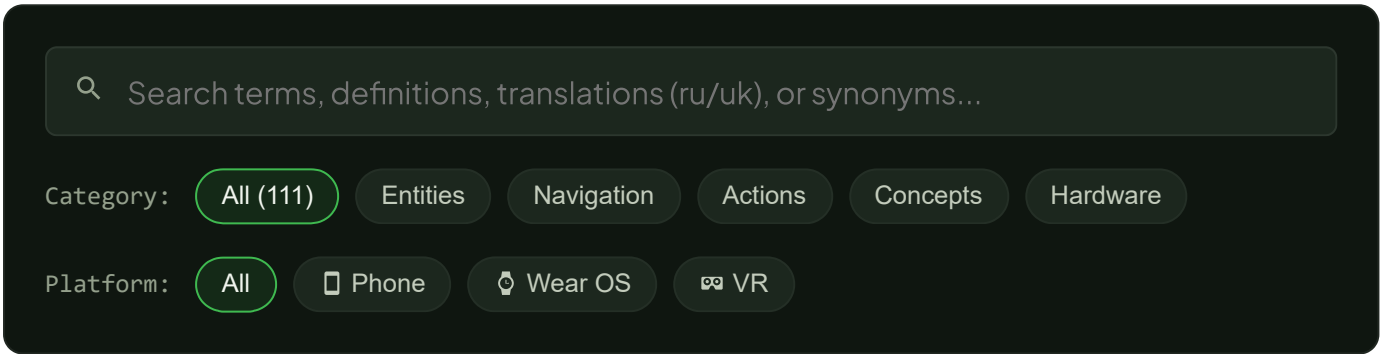
Watching videos - controls, gestures and saving frames

The equivalent flat-screen controls, outside the headset.

DOCUMENTATION All 7 Editions 111 TERMS COMPILED

Glossary of Terms

The authoritative dictionary of Fast Media Sorter concepts, navigation surfaces, media categories, and edition features. Compiled automatically from the single-source-of-truth termbase (`docs/termbase.jsonl`).



A (8 terms)

All apps

UI_COMPONENT Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

All apps is the launcher's full list of the apps installed on the device, opened from the launcher menu.

> **Distinction:** Not the programs menu, which lists FastMediaSorter's own programs. The Russian and Ukrainian screens translate it as 'all programs', which is a known clash.

Translations: RU: Все приложения UK: Усі застосунки

See also: app launcher taskbar

All Documents

ENTITY Phone VR Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr, foss

All Documents is a virtual resource that lists every document found on this device, such as PDF, EPUB, text and Office files, in one place.

> **Distinction:** Not the reader: All Documents is the list you browse, while the reader is the screen that opens one document. A text note created here is saved in the device's Documents folder.

Translations: RU: Все документы UK: Усі документи

See also: virtual resource reader text note

All Files

ENTITY Phone VR All 7 Editions

All Files is a ready-made resource that shows every kind of file on the device, not only media, and it works once All Files mode is allowed in Settings.

> **Distinction:** Not a virtual resource for one kind of media such as All Documents: All Files browses the device storage like a file manager, and how much it can reach depends on the storage access Android grants to your edition.

Translations: RU: Все файлы UK: Усі файли

See also: virtual resource file file browser edition

All Images

ENTITY | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

All Images is a virtual resource that lists every picture found on this device, such as JPG, PNG, GIF or WebP files, in one place.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Camera Photos': Camera Photos holds only what the device camera took, while All Images includes every picture from every folder on the device.

Translations: RU: Все изображения | UK: Усі зображення

See also: virtual resource | Camera Photos | image viewer

All Music

ENTITY | Phone | VR | Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

All Music is a virtual resource that lists every audio file found on this device, such as MP3 or FLAC tracks, in one place.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'playlist' and not the audio player: it is only the collection of local audio files, and it does not include network or cloud folders.

Translations: RU: Вся музыка | UK: Вся музика

See also: virtual resource | audio player | playlist

All Videos

ENTITY | Phone | VR | Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

All Videos is a virtual resource that lists every video file found on this device in one place.

> **Distinction:** Not the video player: All Videos is the collection you browse, while the video player is the screen that plays one video from it.

Translations: RU: Всё видео UK: Усі відео

See also: virtual resource video player

app

ENTITY Phone VR All 7 Editions

An app is any application installed on the Android device, such as a browser or a messenger, that the launcher can list and start.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'program': programs are the extra tools built into FastMediaSorter, such as Calculator, while apps are separate installed applications. The Russian and Ukrainian screens sometimes translate both with the same word.

Translations: RU: приложение UK: застосунок

See also: program All apps launcher watch app

audio player

NAVIGATION Phone Wear OS VR Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

The audio player is the player screen when it plays music or other audio, with the cover picture, the track controls and the queue.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Now Playing', which is the smaller view of the track already playing. Not All Music, which is the collection of audio files.

Translations: RU: аудиоплеер UK: аудіоплеєр

See also: player Now Playing queue All Music

B (1 terms)

badge

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

A badge is a small label drawn on top of a thumbnail or row, such as GIF, VR or Pinned, that tells you something about the item at a glance.

> **Distinction:** Not a button in general, although the VR badge can be tapped to try opening VR again. The word 'badge' itself never appears on screen, so describe what the badge says.

Translations: RU: метка · UK: мітка

See also: channel · immersive mode · media file

C (14 terms)

Calculator

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · All 7 Editions

Calculator is a built-in program for everyday sums that you switch on in Settings and open from the programs menu, a widget or the watch.

> **Distinction:** Not the Android system calculator app: it stays inside FastMediaSorter.

Translations: RU: Калькулятор · UK: Калькулятор

See also: program · widget

camera

NAVIGATION · Phone · All 7 Editions

The camera is the app's built-in way to take photos and record videos and save them straight into a resource or folder you choose.

> **Distinction:** Not the Android camera app, and not 'Camera Photos', which is the virtual resource listing what the device camera took. 'Quick capture' is a widget that jumps straight into shooting.

Translations: RU: камера | UK: камера

See also: Camera Photos | Camera OCR | drawing editor

Camera OCR

NAVIGATION | Phone | Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

Camera OCR is a program that takes a photo, finds the text in it and shows a translation next to the original words.

> **Distinction:** Not general OCR inside the player, which works on photos and documents you already have. The programs menu and Settings call it 'Camera OCR translation'.

Translations: RU: Камера-перевод | UK: Камера-переклад

See also: OCR | camera | program | widget

Camera Photos

ENTITY | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

Camera Photos is a virtual resource that shows the photos and videos taken by this device's camera.

> **Distinction:** Not 'All Images': it holds only camera shots, not every picture on the device. A home-screen widget with the same name opens it.

Translations: RU: Фото с камеры | UK: Фото з камери

See also: virtual resource | All Images | camera | widget

car head unit

HARDWARE_PLATFORM · Phone · All 7 Editions

A car head unit is the Android screen built into the dashboard of a car, where the app can play media with large, easy buttons.

> **Distinction:** Not a phone mounted in the car: it is the car's own Android screen, and the Car head unit device profile sets the app up for it.

Translations: RU: автомагнитола · UK: автомагнітола

See also: device profile · D-pad · TV

catalog

NETWORK_STREAM · Phone · Wear OS · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

The catalog is the built-in list of internet radio and TV channels that the app downloads so you can add them to Streams without typing any web addresses.

> **Distinction:** Not your own channel list: channels you added by hand stay when the catalog is updated or cleared. Spell it 'catalog', never 'catalogue'.

Alternative / Legacy terms: catalogue

Translations: RU: каталог · UK: каталог

See also: Streams · channel · stream · playlist

channel

ENTITY · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

A channel is one saved radio, TV or video station in the Streams list, with its own name, logo and web address.

> **Distinction:** Not the 'stream' itself: the channel is the saved entry you pin, edit or remove, and the stream is what it plays. Not an audio channel such as the left and right sides of stereo sound.

Translations: RU: канал UK: канал

See also: stream Streams catalog streams panel

Chromecast

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, photos, legacy

Chromecast is the technology from Google for sending a video, photo or song from the app to a TV so it plays there instead of on the phone.

> **Distinction:** Not Live Broadcast, which sends your microphone or camera to other devices. Casting is missing from the VR and FOSS editions.

Translations: RU: Chromecast UK: Chromecast

See also: TV video player stream

cloud provider

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr

A cloud provider is the online service whose storage you connect to the app: Google Drive, OneDrive or Dropbox.

> **Distinction:** Not the storage itself: you pick a cloud provider, sign in, and then choose folders from its cloud storage.

Translations: RU: облачный сервис UK: хмарний сервіс

See also: cloud storage Google Drive OneDrive Dropbox

cloud storage

NETWORK_STREAM · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr

Cloud storage is online space from a service such as Google Drive, OneDrive or Dropbox, where your files are kept on the internet instead of on a device.

> **Distinction:** Not a network folder on your own home network. A resource that points into cloud storage needs you to sign in to the service first.

Translations: RU: облачное хранилище · UK: хмарне сховище

See also: cloud provider · Google Drive · Dropbox · OneDrive · resource

color theme

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

The color theme sets the overall look of the app, such as light, dark or automatic.

> **Distinction:** Not the page theme of the reader (light, dark or sepia) and not the separate 'color scheme' of the watch. Always spell it 'color', never 'colour'.

Alternative / Legacy terms: colour => color, coloured => colored, grey => gray

Translations: RU: цветовая тема · UK: колірна тема

See also: Settings · device profile

command bar

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

The command bar is the row of buttons across the top of the main screen, such as Add, Filter, Refresh, Settings and Start Player; when the screen is too narrow it first hides the button labels and then moves the buttons that still do not fit into the three-dots menu.

> **Distinction:** Not the command panel: the command panel belongs to the player and acts on the open file, while the command bar belongs to the main screen.

Translations: RU: панель команд главного экрана | UK: панель команд головного екрана

See also: main screen, three-dots menu, command panel, resource-type tabs

command panel

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

The command panel is the set of buttons in the player for acting on the current file, such as copy, move and delete.

> **Distinction:** Not the three-dots menu and not Quick Sort alone. A setting decides whether it opens by itself when the player starts.

Translations: RU: панель команд | UK: панель команд

See also: player, panel, Quick Sort, touch zones

complication

HARDWARE_PLATFORM · Wear OS · Editions: standard, noLegal

A complication is a small spot on the watch face that shows live information from the watch app, such as the last resource, the number of favorites or the track now playing, and opens it with a tap.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'tile', which is a whole screen you swipe to. The word comes from Wear OS and appears only in the watch face editor, never

in the app's own screens.

Translations: RU: усложнение UK: ускладнення

See also: tile watch Now Playing Favorites

D (6 terms)

D-pad

HARDWARE_PLATFORM Phone All 7 Editions

The D-pad is the four-arrow pad with a center button on a TV remote, game controller or keyboard that moves the selection around the screen.

Distinction: Not touch gestures: everything on screen can also be reached with the D-pad, which matters on TVs and in cars.

Translations: RU: D-pad UK: D-pad See also: TV car head unit

desktop

NAVIGATION Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

The desktop is the launcher's main page, a grid where you place app icons, resources, channels, gadgets and sections, with separate layouts for the upright and the sideways screen.

Distinction: Not the home screen of another launcher and not a computer desktop: it exists only while the FastMediaSorter launcher is in use.

Translations: RU: рабочий стол UK: робочий стіл

See also: launcher gadget section taskbar shortcut home screen

destination

ENTITY · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

A destination is a resource you have marked for Quick Sort, so that one tap can copy or move the current file into it.

> **Distinction:** Not every resource: only resources marked for Quick Sort become destinations, up to 30 of them, each with its own number and color. In copy and move dialogs 'destination' also means simply the place a file is going to.

Translations: RU: назначение · UK: призначення

See also: Quick Sort · resource · command panel

device profile

ENTITY · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

A device profile is a preset for the kind of device you use, such as a personal smartphone, a TV box, a car head unit or a photo frame, that sets sensible defaults for the whole app.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'resource profile', which affects one resource only.

Translations: RU: профиль устройства · UK: профіль пристрою

See also: resource profile · TV · car head unit · VR headset

drawing editor

NAVIGATION · Phone · All 7 Editions

The drawing editor is the screen where you draw or write by hand on a photo, a screenshot or a blank page and save the result as a picture.

> **Distinction:** Not the crop or rotate tools of the image viewer. The menu item that opens it is simply called 'Drawing'.

Translations: RU: редактор рисования UK: редактор малювання

See also: image viewer camera

Dropbox

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr

Dropbox is a cloud storage service that the app can open as a resource after you sign in to your Dropbox account.

> **Distinction:** Not Google Drive or OneDrive: each service needs its own sign-in.

Translations: RU: Dropbox UK: Dropbox See also: cloud storage cloud provider

E (3 terms)

edge gesture

UI_COMPONENT Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

An edge gesture is a short swipe that starts on a band at the left or right edge of the screen and runs a chosen action, such as a screenshot, over any app.

> **Distinction:** Not the system back gesture and not the launcher navigation gestures. The setting that switches the edge bands on is called Gesture overlay.

Translations: RU: краевой жест UK: крайовий жест

See also: screenshot quick-access panel screen recording

edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION Phone Wear OS VR All 7 Editions

An edition is one of the separately published versions of FastMediaSorter, each made for a certain kind of device or store and with its own set of features.

> ⓘ **Distinction:** Never call it a 'flavor' or 'build flavor' in user documentation. An edition is not a version number, which changes with every update.

Alternative / Legacy terms: flavor, flavour

Translations: RU: редакция UK: редакція

See also: Standard edition noLegal edition Lite edition Photos edition Legacy edition VR edition FOSS edition

extension

ENTITY Phone Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

An extension is an optional part of the app, such as text recognition or an extra audio decoder, that you download only when you want it and can delete again to free space.

> ⓘ **Distinction:** Not a separate app from a store and not a paid add-on: an extension is downloaded from the app's own Downloadable Extensions screen and is free.

Alternative / Legacy terms: plug-in, plugin

Translations: RU: расширение UK: розширення

See also: Settings OCR edition

F (7 terms)

Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

NETWORK_STREAM · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows is a separate program for Windows PCs that shares chosen PC folders with the phone app in a couple of clicks, paired by scanning a QR code.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Wear Companion' for the watch, although both are called 'companion' on some screens. The folders it shares arrive in the app as SFTP resources.

Translations: RU: Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows · UK: Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

See also: SFTP · network resource · Wear Companion

★ Favorites

ENTITY · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

Favorites is your own list of the files and channels you marked with a star (a heart on the watch), so you can open them again quickly from one place.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Quick Sort': marking a favorite does not copy or move anything, it only bookmarks the item. Spell it 'favorite', never the British 'favourite'.

Alternative / Legacy terms: favourite => favorite

Translations: RU: Избранное · UK: Обране

See also: file · channel · Quick Sort · widget · tile · complication

ENTITY · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

file

A file is a single item stored in a folder, such as one photo, song, video or document.

> **Distinction:** Not always a 'media file': 'file' covers anything stored on a disk, while 'media file' means only the kinds of files the app can show or play.

Translations: RU: файл UK: файл See also: media file folder Favorites

file browser

NAVIGATION Phone VR All 7 Editions

The file browser is the screen that opens when you open a resource and shows its files and subfolders so you can view, select, copy, move or delete them.

> **Distinction:** Never call it an 'explorer' or a 'file explorer'. A web 'browser' such as Chrome is a different thing, and qualified names such as 'video file browser' are allowed when the media type matters.

Alternative / Legacy terms: explorer

Translations: RU: браузер файлов UK: браузер файлів

See also: main screen resource player grid view list view three-dots menu

folder

ENTITY Phone Wear OS VR All 7 Editions

A folder is a place on a disk, memory card or server where files are kept, and it exists whether or not the app knows about it.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'resource': a resource is the app's saved entry that points to a folder. Use 'folder' only for the real directory itself,

such as creating a new folder or picking one in the system folder window.

Translations: RU: папка UK: папка

See also: resource local folder network folder file

FOSS edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION Phone Editions: foss

The FOSS edition is the open-source edition published in F-Droid, built without any closed-source parts, so it has no cloud storage, Streams, OCR, translation, Chromecast or watch companion.

Distinction: Not a trial edition: it is complete within those limits. When writing about its open-source terms, spell 'license', never 'licence'.

Alternative / Legacy terms: licence => license

Translations: RU: редакция FOSS UK: редакція FOSS

See also: edition Standard edition

FTP

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

FTP is an older, unencrypted way to reach folders on a server, still used by many routers and home servers.

Distinction: Not 'SFTP', which is the encrypted and safer choice when the server supports it. The resource type list shows both together as 'SFTP / FTP'.

Translations: RU: FTP UK: FTP See also: SFTP SMB network resource

G (3 terms)

gadget

UI_COMPONENT Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

A gadget is a small live block on the launcher desktop, such as a clock, weather, compass, battery or map, that shows fresh information and reacts to taps.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'widget': a widget is placed on the Android home screen of any launcher, while a gadget belongs to the FastMediaSorter desktop.

Translations: RU: гаджет UK: ґаджет

See also: desktop launcher widget section Now Playing

Google Drive

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr

Google Drive is the cloud storage from Google, which the app can open as a resource after you sign in with your Google account.

> **Distinction:** Not only a place for resources: the app can also save a copy of its settings and resources to Google Drive. The Russian and Ukrainian screens write it as 'Google Диск'.

Translations: RU: Google Диск UK: Google Диск

See also: cloud storage cloud provider

grid view

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

Grid view shows files, resources or channels as picture tiles arranged in rows and columns.

> **Distinction:** Not 'list view', which shows one item per line with more text. The file browser can be set to open in grid view by default.

Translations: RU: сетка · UK: сітка

See also: list view · file browser · resource list

H (1 terms)

home screen

NAVIGATION · Phone · All 7 Editions

The home screen is the Android start screen you see after unlocking the device, run by whichever launcher app is set as home.

> **Distinction:** Not the app's 'main screen', and not the launcher 'desktop' unless FastMediaSorter is set as the home screen. Home-screen widgets and shortcuts are placed here.

Translations: RU: домашний экран · UK: домашній екран

See also: launcher · desktop · widget · shortcut · main screen

I (3 terms)

image viewer

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

The image viewer is the player screen when it shows a photo or picture, where you can zoom, rotate, crop or start a slideshow.

> **Distinction:** Not a separate app: it is the same player showing an image, and 'Default image viewer' is the Android setting that lets the app open pictures coming from other apps. Not All Images, which is the collection.

Translations: RU: просмотр изображений UK: перегляд зображень

See also: player All Images slideshow drawing editor

immersive browser

NAVIGATION VR Editions: noLegal, vr

The immersive browser is the in-headset screen that shows your files as a 3D grid of tiles inside the immersive scene, so you can find and open something without leaving VR.

> **Distinction:** Not the file browser, which is the flat, two-dimensional screen used outside a headset. The controller ray points and clicks instead of a touch.

Translations: RU: immersive-браузер UK: immersive-браузер

See also: immersive mode VR headset file browser

immersive mode

NAVIGATION VR Editions: noLegal, vr

Immersive mode is the headset view that surrounds you with a 3D or 360-degree photo or video instead of showing it in a flat window.

> **Distinction:** Not full-screen mode on a phone. When immersive mode cannot start, the file plays in 'flat mode' instead.

Translations: RU: immersive-режим UK: immersive-режим

See also: VR headset Meta Quest video player VR edition

(6 terms)

launcher

NAVIGATION Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

The launcher is the part of FastMediaSorter that can replace the device's home screen with its own desktop, taskbar and app list, or show that desktop inside the app.

> **Distinction:** Not every 'launcher' on screen: in messages such as 'Your launcher does not support home-screen shortcuts' the word means whichever home-screen app the device uses. Turning launcher mode off brings back the previous home screen.

Translations: RU: лаунчер UK: лаунчер

See also: desktop taskbar gadget section All apps home screen quick-access panel

Legacy edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION Phone Editions: legacy

The Legacy edition is an edition for older Android devices, starting from Android 6, with most Standard features but without the launcher and the watch companion.

> **Distinction:** Not an outdated or abandoned release: it is published together with the other editions.

Translations: RU: редакция Legacy UK: редакція Legacy

See also: edition | Standard edition

list view

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | Wear OS | VR | All 7 Editions

List view shows files, resources or channels one per line, with the name and details next to a small picture.

> **Distinction:** Not 'grid view', which shows larger picture tiles in rows and columns.

Translations: RU: список | UK: список

See also: grid view | file browser | resource list

Lite edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION | Phone | Editions: lite

The Lite edition is a lighter edition that plays local photos, videos and music only, without network folders, cloud storage, documents or Streams.

> **Distinction:** Not the Photos edition, which keeps network folders and cloud storage but drops video and audio.

Translations: RU: редакция Lite | UK: редакція Lite

See also: edition | Photos edition | Standard edition

Live Broadcast

NETWORK_STREAM | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy

Live Broadcast is a program that sends what the microphone of your phone, and optionally its camera, picks up live over the local network

so that other devices can listen or watch.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'stream' you receive: Live Broadcast sends your own sound or picture out. The Russian and Ukrainian screens name it with a different word from the one used for streams.

Translations: RU: Вещание | UK: Мовлення

See also: stream | Streams | program | widget

local folder

ENTITY | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

A local folder is a folder stored on this device itself or on its memory card, as opposed to one on another computer or online.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'network folder' or 'cloud storage', which live on another machine or on the internet. The resource type list also shows local folders simply as 'Local'.

Translations: RU: локальная папка | UK: локальна папка

See also: folder | resource | network folder | cloud storage

M (3 terms)

main screen

NAVIGATION | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

The main screen is the first screen of the app, where your resources are listed and where you add, open and manage them.

> **Distinction:** Not the Android 'home screen' and not the launcher 'desktop'.

Translations: RU: главный экран UK: головний екран

See also: resource list resource file browser home screen desktop programs panel streams panel

media file

ENTITY Phone Wear OS VR All 7 Editions

A media file is a file the app can show or play, such as a photo, GIF, video, audio track or document.

> **Distinction:** Not every 'file': other files in a folder, such as installers or archives, are not media files and stay hidden unless All Files mode is used.

Translations: RU: медиафайл UK: медіафайл See also: file All Files player

Meta Quest

HARDWARE_PLATFORM VR Editions: noLegal, vr

Meta Quest is a family of VR headsets made by Meta, such as Quest 3, on which the VR edition of the app runs.

> **Distinction:** Not the only supported headset: Android XR headsets work too, so say 'VR headset' when the brand does not matter.

Translations: RU: Meta Quest UK: Meta Quest

See also: VR headset VR edition immersive mode

N (5 terms)

network folder

NETWORK_STREAM | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

A network folder is a shared folder on another computer, a NAS or a router on your home or office network that the app opens over SMB.

> **Distinction:** Not a folder on this device and not cloud storage. People often say 'network share' or 'shared folder'.

Translations: RU: сетевая папка | UK: мережева папка

See also: SMB | network resource | folder | resource

Network Monitor

NAVIGATION | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal

Network Monitor is a program that shows your connection, signal strength, addresses and speed so you can see why the network is slow or down.

> **Distinction:** Not a resource or a network folder: it only reports on the connection and opens no files.

Translations: RU: Сетевой монитор | UK: Мережевий монітор

See also: program | gadget | widget

network resource

NETWORK_STREAM | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

A network resource is a resource that points to a folder on another computer or server over the network, using SMB, FTP or SFTP.

> **Distinction:** Not a cloud resource, which lives with an online service such as Google Drive. Only network resources can be sent to the watch.

Translations: RU: сетевой ресурс | UK: мережевий ресурс

See also: resource | network folder | SMB | FTP | SFTP | Wear Companion

noLegal edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION | Phone | VR | Editions: noLegal

The noLegal edition is a sideload-only edition, installed from an APK file outside the app stores, that adds what stores do not allow, such as the immersive VR player and full storage access.

> **Distinction:** Not the VR edition, which is the store-clean headset edition. The noLegal edition is never published in a store.

Translations: RU: редакция noLegal | UK: редакція noLegal

See also: edition | Standard edition | VR edition | immersive mode | All Files

Now Playing

NAVIGATION | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

Now Playing is the view that shows the track playing right now, with its cover and controls, and leads back to the full audio player.

> **Distinction:** Not the audio player itself and not the queue, which lists what plays next. The same name is used by a launcher gadget, a watch complication and the 'Audio Now Playing' home-screen widget.

Translations: RU: Сейчас играет | UK: Зараз грає

See also: audio player · queue · gadget · complication · widget

(2 terms)

OCR

NAVIGATION · Phone · VR · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

OCR (text recognition) reads the printed or written words in a photo or document page so you can copy, save or translate them.

> **Distinction:** Not translation by itself: OCR only finds the text, and translation is a separate step. 'Camera OCR' is the quick flow that does both from a new photo.

Alternative / Legacy terms: recognise => recognize, recognised => recognized, re:\banalys(e|ed|ing)\b => analyze

Translations: RU: распознавание текста (OCR) · UK: розпізнавання тексту (OCR)

See also: Camera OCR · image viewer · reader

OneDrive

NETWORK_STREAM · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr

OneDrive is the cloud storage from Microsoft, which the app can open as a resource after you sign in with a Microsoft account.

> **Distinction:** Not a network folder on a Windows PC: OneDrive files live on the internet, not on your local network.

Translations: RU: OneDrive · UK: OneDrive

See also: cloud storage · cloud provider

P (9 terms)

panel

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

A panel is a strip of buttons or items along one edge of a screen that can usually be collapsed or hidden.

> **Distinction:** Use the specific name when it matters, such as 'command panel', 'programs panel', 'streams panel', 'quick-access panel' or 'taskbar'. In the headset 'panel' also means the flat window that floats in front of you.

Translations: RU: панель · UK: панель

See also: command panel · programs panel · streams panel · quick-access panel · taskbar

permission

ENTITY · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

A permission is an access right that Android lets you give to or take back from an app, such as reading your photos, using the camera or drawing over other apps; FastMediaSorter asks only for the permissions its features need and lists them all on one screen.

> **Distinction:** Not a setting of the app: a permission is kept by Android and can also be changed in the Android app settings, while an app setting lives only inside FastMediaSorter.

Translations: RU: разрешение · UK: дозвіл See also: welcome wizard · Settings

phone

HARDWARE_PLATFORM · Phone · Wear OS · All 7 Editions

The phone is the Android phone or tablet that runs the main FastMediaSorter app and that the watch connects to.

> **Distinction:** Not only a phone in the strict sense: the same app also runs on tablets, TVs and car head units. On the watch, 'Phone' names the section with files taken from the phone.

Translations: RU: телефон UK: телефон

See also: watch Wear Companion TV car head unit

Photos edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION Phone Editions: photos

The Photos edition is an edition for pictures only, with network folders and cloud storage but without video, audio, documents or Streams.

> **Distinction:** Not the 'Photo frame' device profile, which is a setting inside any edition, and not 'Camera Photos', which is a virtual resource.

Translations: RU: редакция Photos UK: редакція Photos

See also: edition Lite edition device profile Camera Photos

PIN

ENTITY Phone VR All 7 Editions

A PIN is a code of 4 to 6 digits you can set on a resource so that nobody can open it without typing the code.

> **Distinction:** Not the lock-screen PIN of the device and not a 'pinned' channel or app: it protects one resource inside this app only.

Translations: RU: ПИН-код UK: ПІН-код See also: resource

player

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

The player is the full-screen screen that shows one file at a time, whether it is a photo, a GIF, a video or an audio track, and lets you move to the next or previous file.

> **Distinction:** Not only for video: 'player' is the shared name, and 'video player', 'audio player' and 'image viewer' name the same screen when it shows that kind of file. Documents open in the reader instead.

Translations: RU: плеер · UK: плеєр

See also: video player · audio player · image viewer · command panel · touch zones · slideshow

playlist

ENTITY · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

A playlist is a list of tracks or channels that play one after another, such as an M3U file you import into Streams or the Playlist gadget on the launcher desktop.

> **Distinction:** Not the 'queue' in the audio player, which is only the list of tracks lined up for the current session. Not a resource.

Translations: RU: плейлист · UK: плейліст

See also: queue · stream · channel · gadget

program

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · All 7 Editions

A program is one of the extra tools built into FastMediaSorter, such as Calculator, Stopwatch, Network Monitor or the flashlights, that you

switch on in Settings and open from the programs menu.

> **Distinction:** Not an 'app' installed separately on the device, and never a 'mini-program' or 'sub-program'. The watch lists its built-in programs under 'Apps', which is a known wording slip.

Alternative / Legacy terms: mini-program, sub-program, mini-app, programme

Translations: RU: программа | UK: програма

See also: programs panel | app | Calculator | Network Monitor | Settings

programs panel

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

The programs panel is an optional bar above the resource list on the main screen that gives one-tap access to your programs.

> **Distinction:** Not the 'quick-access panel' of the launcher. In Russian and Ukrainian the quick-access panel is also translated as 'panel of programs', which is a known clash.

Translations: RU: панель программ | UK: панель програм

See also: program | main screen | panel | streams panel

Q (3 terms)

queue

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

The queue is the list of tracks lined up to play next in the audio player.

> **Distinction:** Not a saved 'playlist': the queue belongs to the current listening session only.

Translations: RU: очередь | UK: черга

See also: audio player | Now Playing | playlist

Quick Sort

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

Quick Sort is the feature that lets you copy or move the file you are viewing into one of your numbered destinations with a single tap.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Favorites', which only bookmarks a file.

Alternative / Legacy terms: organise => organize, organised => organized, organiser => organizer

Translations: RU: быстрая сортировка | UK: швидке сортування

See also: destination | command panel | touch zones | Favorites

quick-access panel

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | Editions: standard, noLegal

The quick-access panel is a pop-up panel of your chosen apps and shortcuts that you can open from the launcher or with a gesture at the screen edge.

> **Distinction:** Not the 'programs panel' on the main screen.

Translations: RU: панель быстрого доступа | UK: панель швидкого доступу

See also: launcher | panel | app | program

R (5 terms)

reader

NAVIGATION | Phone | VR | Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr, foss

The reader is the screen that opens documents and books, such as PDF, EPUB and text files, page by page.

> **Distinction:** Not the image viewer or the player. The Android default-app setting names the same role 'document viewer'.

Translations: RU: читалка | UK: читалка

See also: All Documents | text note | OCR

resource

ENTITY | Phone | Wear OS | VR | All 7 Editions

A resource is an entry you add to the app that points to a place with your files, such as a folder on this device, a network folder, a cloud folder, a stream or a watch, and it appears as one item on the main screen.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'folder': a folder is a real directory that exists on a disk or server without the app, while a resource is the app's own saved entry that points to it.

Translations: RU: ресурс | UK: ресурс

See also: folder | virtual resource | network resource | main screen | resource profile | destination

resource list

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

The resource list is the list of all your resources on the main screen, shown as rows or tiles.

> **Distinction:** Not the file list inside the file browser, which shows the files of one opened resource.

Translations: RU: список ресурсов | UK: список ресурсів

See also: main screen | resource | grid view | list view

resource profile

ENTITY | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

A resource profile is a preset you pick for one resource, such as Audio Library, Video Library or Photo Storage, that tunes which files it shows and how it opens them.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'device profile', which tunes the whole app for a kind of device. The idea of a 'media library' is simply a resource with the Audio Library or Video Library profile.

Translations: RU: профиль ресурса | UK: профіль ресурсу

See also: resource | device profile

resource-type tabs

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

The resource-type tabs are the strip of tabs under the command bar on the main screen - ALL, Local, SMB, S/FTP, Cloud and Favorites - that show only the resources of one kind.

> **Distinction:** Not the filter dialog: a tab narrows the list with one tap, while the filter dialog combines type, media-type and name filters with a sort order.

Translations: RU: вкладки типов ресурсов UK: вкладки типів ресурсів

See also: main screen resource command bar

S (14 terms)

scheduled operation

ENTITY Phone All 7 Editions

A scheduled operation is a file job, such as copying or moving files from one resource to another, that the app runs by itself on the schedule you set.

> **Distinction:** Not a one-time copy or move: it repeats on its schedule until you pause or delete it.

Alternative / Legacy terms: cancelled => canceled

Translations: RU: операция по расписанию UK: операція за розкладом

See also: resource destination widget

screen recording

NAVIGATION Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

Screen recording is a program that records everything shown on the screen, with sound from the microphone, into a video file until you stop it.

> **Distinction:** Not a screenshot, which saves a single still picture. The programs menu labels it 'Screen video recording'.

Translations: RU: запись экрана UK: запис екрана See also: program camera

screenshot

ENTITY · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal

A screenshot is a still picture of everything shown on the screen at one moment, saved as an image file.

> **Distinction:** Not a screen recording, which saves a video. A frame saved from a playing video is a video frame, not a screenshot.

Alternative / Legacy terms: screen grab, screencap

Translations: RU: скриншот · UK: скріншот

See also: screen recording · edge gesture · drawing editor

section

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal

A section is a named group on the launcher desktop, such as Gadgets, Resources or Apps, that keeps related icons together under one heading.

> **Distinction:** Not a settings category and not a folder: a section only arranges desktop items and can be renamed, re-sorted or deleted.

Translations: RU: раздел · UK: розділ

See also: desktop · launcher · gadget

Settings

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · VR · All 7 Editions

Settings is the screen where you change how the app looks and behaves and switch optional programs and features on or off.

> **Distinction:** Not the Android system settings, which the app sometimes opens for permissions. The launcher has its own 'Launcher settings' and the reader its own 'Reader Settings'.

Alternative / Legacy terms: customisation => customization, customise => customize, customised => customized, behaviour => behavior

Translations: RU: Настройки UK: Налаштування

See also: device profile program launcher color theme

SFTP

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

SFTP is an encrypted way to reach folders on a server or computer by its address, a user name and a password or key.

> **Distinction:** Not 'FTP', which sends everything unencrypted. Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows also shares PC folders with the app over SFTP.

Translations: RU: SFTP UK: SFTP

See also: FTP SMB network resource Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

shortcut

UI_COMPONENT Phone All 7 Editions

A shortcut is an icon you place on the home screen or the launcher desktop that opens one resource, channel, program or contact directly.

> **Distinction:** Not a widget, which shows live content, and not the item itself: removing a shortcut deletes nothing.

Translations: RU: ярлык UK: ярлик See also: home screen desktop widget

UI_COMPONENT Phone Wear OS VR All 7 Editions

slideshow

A slideshow shows the files of a folder one after another by itself, moving to the next photo after the number of seconds you set.

> **Distinction:** Not a video made from photos: nothing is saved, it is only a way of viewing. Music can play in the background during a slideshow.

Translations: RU: слайдшоу UK: слайдшоу

See also: player image viewer Favorites

SMB

NETWORK_STREAM Phone Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal, photos, legacy, vr, foss

SMB is the common way Windows PCs, NAS boxes and routers share folders over a home or office network, and the app uses it to open network folders.

> **Distinction:** Not FTP or SFTP, which reach a server by its address rather than a shared folder. Not a cloud service.

Translations: RU: SMB UK: SMB

See also: network folder network resource FTP SFTP

Standard edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION Phone Editions: standard

The Standard edition is the recommended full edition for phones, tablets, TVs and car head units.

> **Distinction:** Not the noLegal edition, which adds sideload-only extras on top of it. The Legacy edition covers older Android versions.

Translations: RU: редакция Standard | UK: редакція Standard

See also: edition | noLegal edition | Legacy edition | launcher

startup splash

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | Wear OS | VR | All 7 Editions

The startup splash is the screen with the FastMediaSorter logo and name that you see for the moment the app takes to start; it disappears as soon as the app is ready.

> **Distinction:** Not the welcome wizard: the splash shows on every start and asks nothing, while the wizard appears on first launch and asks questions.

Translations: RU: заставка запуска | UK: заставка запуску

See also: welcome wizard | main screen

stream

ENTITY | Phone | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

A stream is a live internet radio, TV or video feed that the app plays from a web address instead of from a saved file.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'channel' in every sentence: the stream is the live feed or its web address, while the channel is the saved entry for it in the Streams list. Not 'Live Broadcast', which sends your own microphone or camera out to others.

Translations: RU: трансляция | UK: трансляція

See also: channel | Streams | catalog | playlist | Live Broadcast | streams panel

Streams

NAVIGATION · Phone · Wear OS · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

Streams is the screen that lists your internet radio, TV and video channels, where you add, pin, edit and play them.

> **Distinction:** Not a single 'stream': 'Streams' with a capital S names the screen, while a stream is one live feed. Not 'Live Broadcast', which sends your own sound or picture out.

Translations: RU: Трансляции · UK: Трансляції

See also: stream · channel · catalog · streams panel · Live Broadcast

streams panel

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal, legacy, vr

The streams panel is an optional bar above the resource list on the main screen that shows your pinned channels for one-tap playback.

> **Distinction:** Not the Streams screen, which lists all channels: only pinned channels appear on this panel.

Translations: RU: панель трансляций · UK: панель трансляцій

See also: Streams · channel · main screen · panel

T (7 terms)

taskbar

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · Editions: standard, noLegal

The taskbar is the launcher's bar at the top or bottom of the screen with the Start button, pinned apps, recently used apps, the clock and status icons.

> **Distinction:** Not the Android status bar or navigation bar.

Translations: RU: панель задач | UK: панель задач

See also: launcher | desktop | All apps | panel

text note

ENTITY | Phone | All 7 Editions

A text note is a plain text file you write in the app and save into the current folder or resource.

> **Distinction:** Not a Google Keep note: the app can send the text to Keep, but a text note is its own file in your folder. Not a voice note recorded on the watch.

Translations: RU: заметка | UK: нотатка

See also: file | All Documents | reader

three-dots menu

UI_COMPONENT | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

The three-dots menu is the menu that opens from the button with three vertical dots and holds the less common actions for an item or a screen.

> **Distinction:** Some settings show the same menu as the symbol :. It is not the programs menu.

Translations: RU: меню с тремя точками | UK: меню з трьома крапками

See also: resource list | file browser | programs panel

tile

HARDWARE_PLATFORM | Wear OS | Editions: standard, noLegal

A tile is a full-screen card on the watch that you reach by swiping from the watch face, showing a chosen resource, stream, your favorites or your programs for one-tap access.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'complication', which is a small spot on the watch face itself. Not the quick settings tiles on the phone, such as Live Broadcast.

Translations: RU: плитка UK: плитка

See also: complication watch watch app Favorites

touch zones

UI_COMPONENT Phone VR All 7 Editions

Touch zones are invisible areas of the full-screen player, laid out as a grid of nine, where a tap does a set job such as next file, copy, move or delete.

> **Distinction:** Not visible buttons: the zones stay hidden unless you turn on the touch zones overlay or hint. With the grid switched off the player uses three simpler zones.

Translations: RU: сенсорные зоны UK: сенсорні зони

See also: player command panel Quick Sort

trash

ENTITY Phone VR All 7 Editions

The trash is a hidden folder named .trash where deleted local files wait, so you can still bring them back with Undo before the resource is closed.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'recycle bin' for the whole device: it works per resource and only where trash is supported, so on some network or cloud

resources a deletion is permanent.

Translations: RU: корзина UK: кошик See also: file resource Settings

TV

HARDWARE_PLATFORM Phone Wear OS All 7 Editions

A TV is a television, an Android TV box or a media box that either runs the app with a remote control or shows what you cast to it.

> **Distinction:** Not 'Live TV', which is a category of channels in Streams. On a TV the app is operated with the D-pad of the remote instead of touch.

Translations: RU: телевизор UK: телевізор

See also: D-pad Chromecast device profile

V (5 terms)

video player

NAVIGATION Phone Wear OS VR Editions: standard, noLegal, lite, legacy, vr, foss

The video player is the player screen when it plays a video, with controls for pausing, jumping forward or back and changing the sound.

> **Distinction:** Not All Videos, which is the collection you browse. 'Default video player' is the Android setting that lets the app open videos coming from other apps.

Translations: RU: видеоплеер UK: відеоплеєр

See also: player | All Videos | immersive mode | Chromecast

virtual resource

ENTITY | Phone | VR | All 7 Editions

A virtual resource is a ready-made resource that gathers files of one kind from all over this device into one list, such as All Music or Camera Photos, without you picking a folder.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'folder': it has no single place on the disk.

Translations: RU: виртуальный ресурс | UK: віртуальний ресурс

See also: resource | All Music | All Videos | All Images | All Documents | Camera Photos | All Files

VR Cinema

NAVIGATION | VR | Editions: noLegal, vr

VR Cinema is FastMediaSorter's name for the immersive session that plays a photo or video inside the headset, on a virtual screen or wrapped all around you.

> **Distinction:** Not 'immersive mode' in every sentence: immersive mode is the general headset view, and VR Cinema is what FastMediaSorter calls it when you launch it from a menu or a badge.

Translations: RU: VR Cinema | UK: VR Cinema

See also: immersive mode | VR headset | video player

VR edition

DISTRIBUTION_EDITION | VR | Editions: vr

The VR edition is the edition published for VR headsets such as Meta Quest, with the full media set and immersive mode for 3D and 360-degree files.

> **Distinction:** Not the noLegal edition, which also runs on headsets but is sideload-only. The VR edition has no Chromecast and no watch companion.

Translations: RU: VR-версия UK: VR-версія

See also: edition noLegal edition VR headset Meta Quest immersive mode

VR headset

HARDWARE_PLATFORM VR Editions: noLegal, vr

A VR headset is a device you wear on your head, such as Meta Quest, that shows 3D and 360-degree photos and videos all around you.

> **Distinction:** Not a phone-in-a-box viewer such as Google Cardboard, which only splits the phone screen in two. Immersive mode needs a real headset with the VR or noLegal edition.

Translations: RU: VR-шлем UK: VR-шолом

See also: Meta Quest immersive mode VR edition noLegal edition device profile

W (6 terms)

watch

HARDWARE_PLATFORM Phone Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal

The watch is a Wear OS smartwatch paired with your phone, which can browse, play and record files with the FastMedia Wear app.

> **Distinction:** Not the software: the app on it is the 'watch app', and the phone-side program that controls it is 'Wear Companion'. A paired watch

can also appear in the resource list as its own resource.

Translations: RU: часы UK: годинник

See also: watch app Wear Companion Wear OS tile complication phone

watch app

HARDWARE_PLATFORM Wear OS Editions: standard, noLegal

The watch app is FastMedia Wear, the part of FastMediaSorter installed on the watch, where you browse and play files, streams and favorites right on your wrist.

Distinction: Not 'Wear Companion', which runs on the phone.

Translations: RU: приложение для часов UK: застосунок для годинника

See also: watch Wear Companion tile complication app

Wear Companion

HARDWARE_PLATFORM Phone Editions: standard, noLegal

Wear Companion is the program on the phone that connects to your watch and decides which resources, streams and settings the phone shares with it.

Distinction: Not the app on the watch, which is the 'watch app'. Not 'Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows', whose screens also say 'companion'.

Translations: RU: Wear-компаньон UK: Wear-супутник

See also: watch watch app program Fast Media Sorter & Sharing for Windows

Wear OS

HARDWARE_PLATFORM · Wear OS · Editions: standard, noLegal

Wear OS is the system from Google that runs on smartwatches, and the FastMedia Wear app works only on watches that use it.

> **Distinction:** Not the watch app itself and not a brand of watch: it is the software platform, the way Android is for phones.

Translations: RU: Wear OS · UK: Wear OS

See also: watch · watch app · tile · complication

welcome wizard

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · VR · All 7 Editions

The welcome wizard is the series of pages FastMediaSorter shows on first launch - language and theme, device profile, network sources, capabilities, permissions and default player - before you reach the main screen; you can open it again from Settings.

> **Distinction:** Not Settings: the wizard sets many things at once through a few questions, while Settings changes one option at a time.

Translations: RU: мастер приветствия · UK: майстер привітання

See also: device profile · main screen · Settings · permission

widget

UI_COMPONENT · Phone · All 7 Editions

A widget is a small live block from FastMediaSorter that you place on the Android home screen, such as Favorites, Random Photo Frame, Stopwatch or Scheduled Operations.

> **Distinction:** Not a 'gadget', which lives on the FastMediaSorter launcher desktop. Not a watch 'tile' or 'complication'.

Translations: RU: виджет UK: віджет

See also: home screen gadget shortcut tile